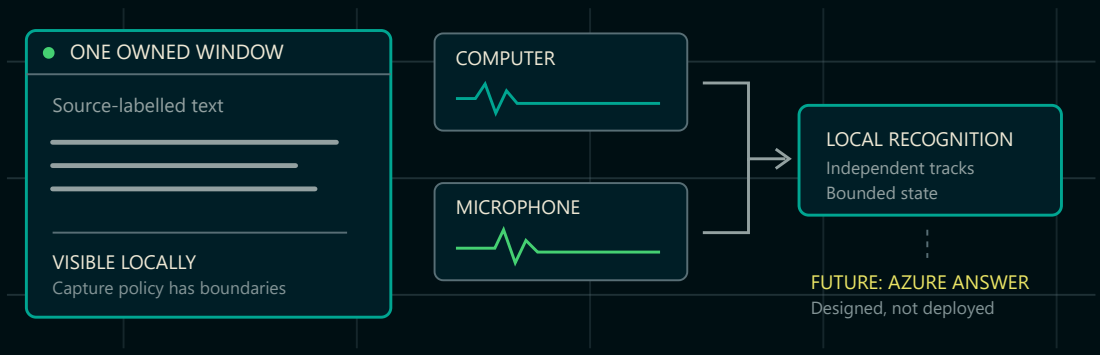
ENGINEERING EDITION 2026-10-10




# Phantom Fudge Engineering Handbook

A local-first conversation companion, from Windows surfaces to source-labelled speech

Local capture and explicit provider answers. Measured evidence is bounded. Direct Azure remains future work.

> This book distinguishes implemented behavior, measured observations, proposals and unknowns. No universal screen-capture or cursor invisibility is promised. Documentation images use synthetic content.

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Source: docs/handbook/00-reading-map.md

# Reading map and current reality

> **TL;DR:** Phantom Fudge is a Windows conversation companion with local speech recognition, not an invisible process and not yet an Azure question-answering product. Read this book as an explanation of boundaries: between presentation and capture, samples and text, a request and its completion, and a researched proposal and working software.

## Overview: what this book is for

**Use the current interface first:** the illustrated workflow brings together device cards, recording status, multi-line questions, optional clarification, current action/font choices and the continuing-work cover. Older dated evidence elsewhere in the book remains historical; it does not redefine the controls in the current source.

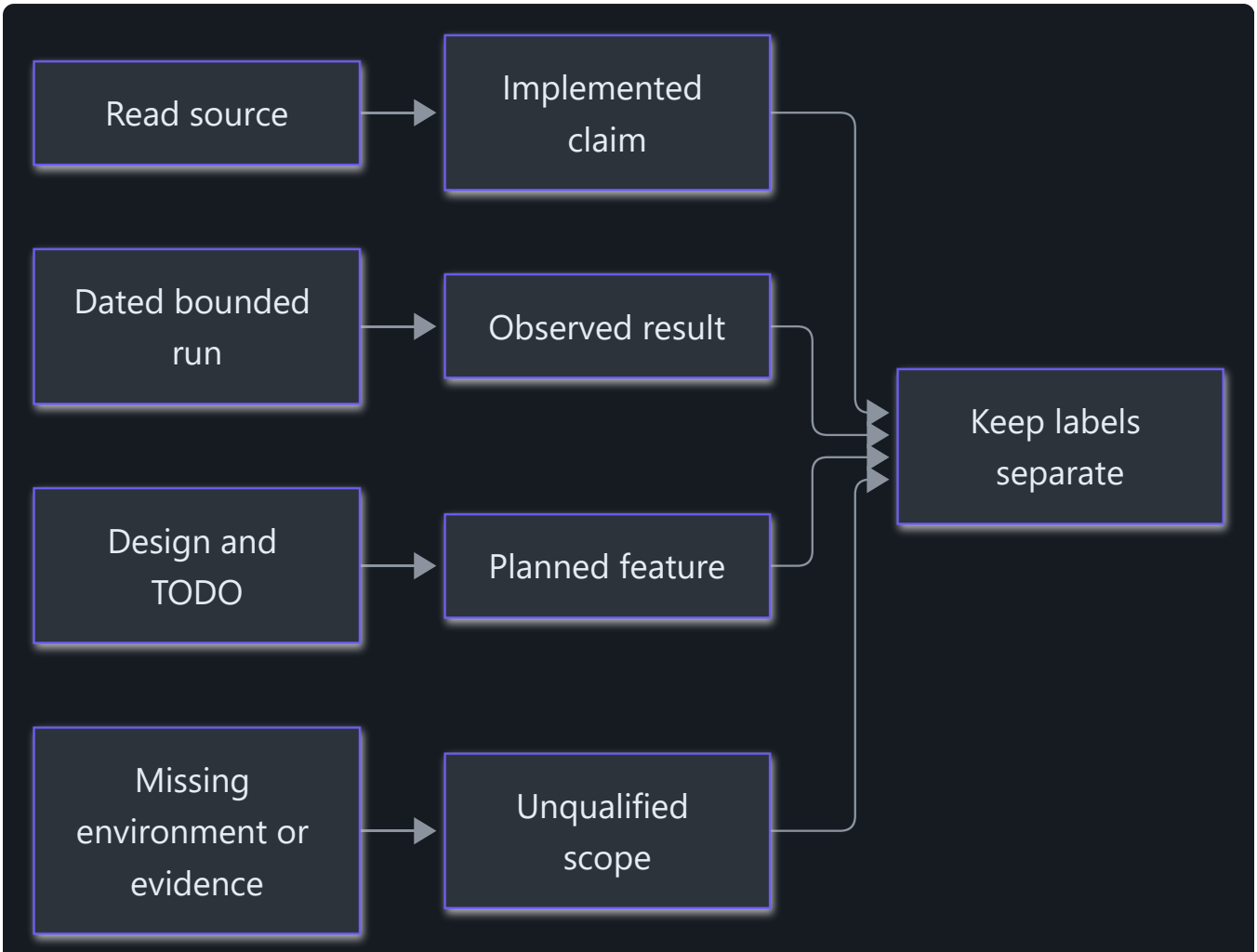
The original problem sounded like a small notepad: show private speaker notes while presenting. That problem expanded into a local transcription-first interface, selectable Computer/Mic/Both inputs, and a researched proposal for explicitly sending a question to an Azure model. The important engineering work is not drawing a rectangle. It is keeping each promise narrow enough to implement and each state transition strong enough to preserve data. The current product contract records those distinct requirements rather than collapsing them into a claim of universal invisibility (`docs\PRODUCT.md:6-37`).

This handbook is intended to support three activities. A new contributor should be able to run and navigate the application without guessing. A senior engineer should be able to review its invariants and tradeoffs. A future book editor should be able to assemble the chapters, figures, screenshots, glossary and development journal into a coherent narrative. The source chapters are Markdown; the generated HTML/PDF is an edition of those sources, not a separate authoritative implementation.

## The four labels used throughout

| Label | What it means | What it does not mean |
|---|---|---|
| Implemented | The cited source contains the behavior | The behavior works on every device/backend |
| Observed | A dated local run or owner report supports a bounded result | A universal guarantee or independent reproduction of an owner report |
| Planned | A design/TODO describes future behavior | The feature exists in the executable |
| Unqualified | Required evidence is missing or incomplete | The implementation is necessarily broken |

These distinctions are repository requirements, not editorial niceties. `AGENTS.md` explicitly separates API configuration from captured pixels, technical passes from human acceptance, and research from a qualified release (`AGENTS.md:14-21`). In particular, a successful `SetWindowDisplayAffinity` call is not a recorder certification.



00 - Reading Map and Current Reality - diagram 1. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

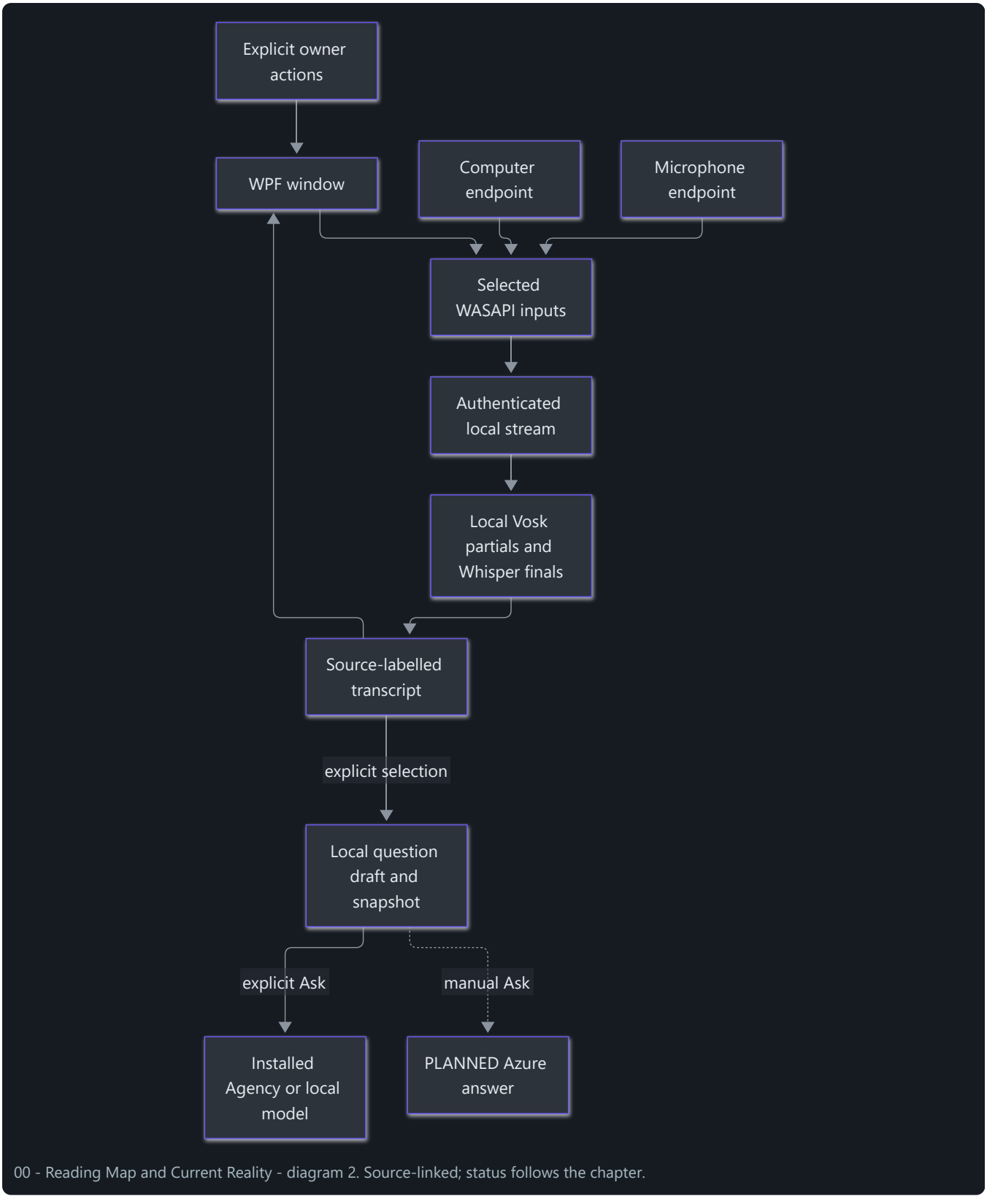
# The implemented system in one page

The WPF application owns its native window and starts without an ordinary taskbar/Alt-Tab entry. Its startup path distinguishes synthetic diagnostics from normal single-instance operation, creates `MainWindow`, installs recovery callbacks, and calls `ShowProtected` (`src\PhantomFudge.App\App.xaml.cs:13-97`). The UI is not a browser or a remote webpage.

The speech path remains local. The native adapter selects explicit audio endpoints, while the Python server accepts one authenticated session and uses separate decoder state for declared sources. `AudioSource` names Computer and Microphone; those are input identities, not detected people (`src\PhantomFudge.Core\AudioSource.cs:3-30`). `TranscriptBuffer` preserves source-specific partials and labelled final lines (`src\PhantomFudge.Core\TranscriptBuffer.cs:6-97`).

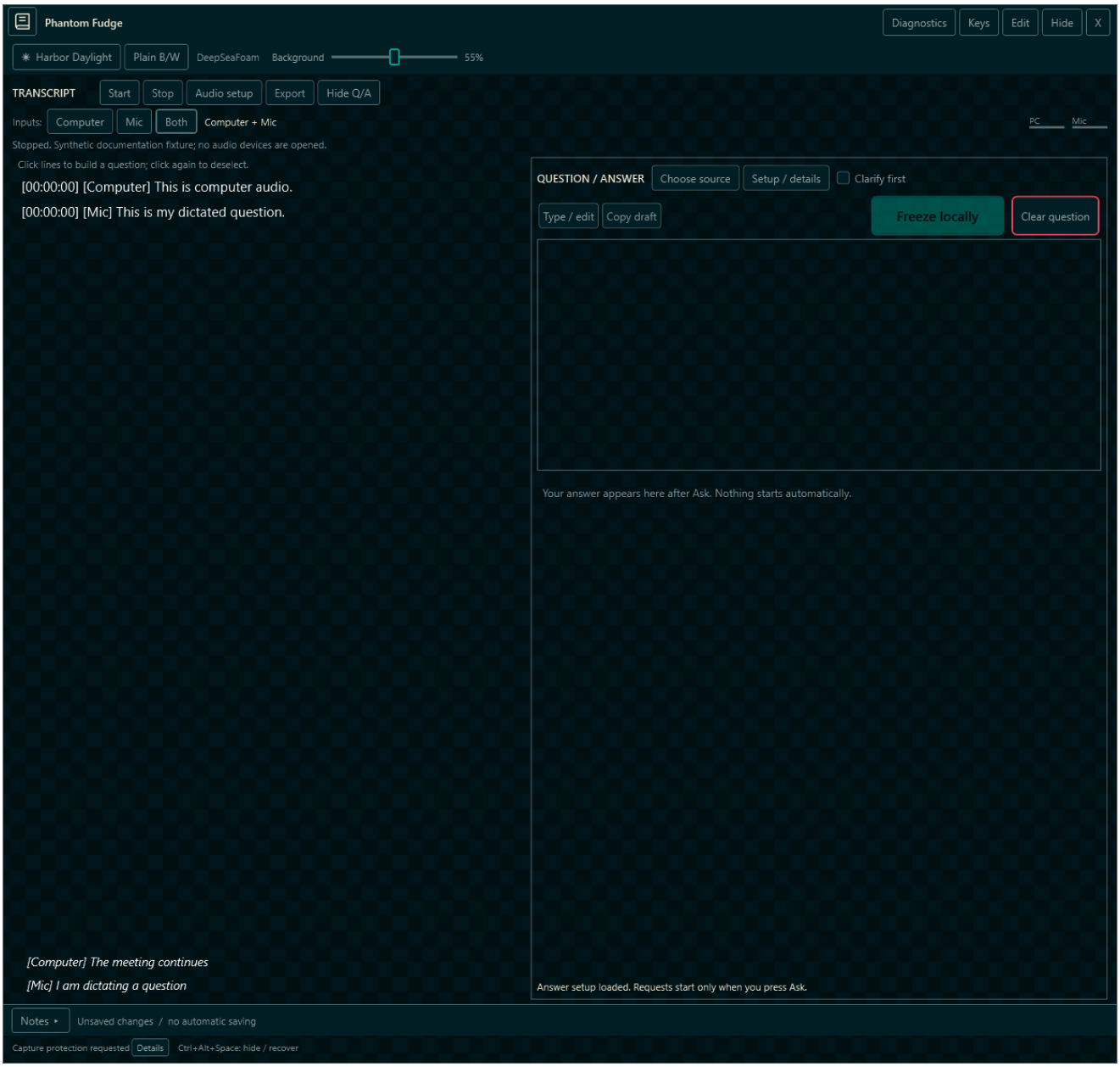
The launch script can start/reuse the local Python service, but that is not permission to start audio capture. `-NotesOnly` avoids service startup, and an existing app is revealed without rebuilding it (`scripts\Run-PhantomFudge.ps1:17-41`). Docker recipes are a possible later deployment of the headless service, not the normal runtime dependency.

The October 9 correction separates provisional speed from final quality: local Vosk partials feed bounded disjoint-span Whisper small.en finals. The expanded UI uses responsive reading columns and opaque white/black text. Configured Agency prepares one empty session without prompting a model; each explicit Ask gets fresh question context. These are implemented changes, not universal recognition/latency guarantees. See measured corrections and local logging boundaries (`src/PhantomFudge.Core/WorkspaceLayout.cs:8-42`; `src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.AnswerLifetime.cs:23-78`; `services/transcription/accurate.py:33-129`).




00 - Reading Map and Current Reality - diagram 2. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

# Visual baseline




*Actual WPF visual-tree render with synthetic notes, transcript and device labels. It is not a recording of a user's desktop or evidence that a meeting recorder excludes the window.*

The screenshot fixture is a separate application entry path. It invokes the same window and its rendering diagnostics, but supplies documentation-safe examples; it does not start the speech service or open a capture endpoint (`src\PhantomFudge.App\App.xaml.cs:47-59`). The accompanying screenshot manifest identifies source and image hashes.

# Choose a reading path

| Reader | Suggested path | Outcome |
|---|---|---|
| New to the stack | Zero to Hero, then Setup and Testing | Understand enough C#/Python/audio terminology to run and trace a path |
| Principal reviewer | Principal Guide, Failure States, Assurance | Identify the invariants and unresolved acceptance gates |
| Desktop contributor | Windows, UI, Storage | Change a window without losing data or weakening the stated policy |
| Audio contributor | Capture, Protocol, Recognition | Follow bytes from the selected device to labelled text |
| Operator | Native Lifecycle, Distribution, Reference | Start, recover, stop and diagnose the local system |
| AI-feature implementer | Benchmark, Proposed Answer Flow, Latency and Identity | Preserve the boundary between current local ASR and future explicit Azure requests |

# What to keep beside the book

The TODO index is the living acceptance map. The public journal explains why direction changed. The implementation status records bounded receipts. The book explains mechanisms and reasoning; it should not become a second, inconsistent task database.

The local draft and immutable snapshot now exist. Explicit selected segments or typed text feed `QuestionDraft`; `Freeze` captures exact text and copied provenance without invoking any provider (`src\PhantomFudge.Core\QuestionDraft.cs:18-95`, `src\PhantomFudge.Core\QuestionSnapshot.cs:5-23`). Source commit and direct Azure identity remain future work. Installed-provider streaming and setup are explained in the new Agency/local-model chapter, separately from Azure (`docs\AI-ANSWER-ARCHITECTURE.md:82-188`). A local-only snapshot is not a model request; configured provider Ask crosses its labelled inference boundary.

# Reading source citations

A citation such as `src\PhantomFudge.Core\AudioSource.cs:3-14` names a repository file and the line interval inspected for this edition. Prefer the named class/function when navigating a later revision: line numbers move. The build checks path/range validity and source freshness; it cannot prove that prose is semantically correct. Human source review remains necessary.

# Checkpoint

Before moving on, explain these differences in your own words:

1. A local ASR service being ready versus a microphone recording.
2. An excluded window versus an undiscoverable process.
3. A labelled Mic track versus speaker identification.
4. A rendered documentation screenshot versus a recipient-side capture test.

5. A researched Azure architecture versus an implemented Ask feature.

If any pair sounds equivalent, revisit the relevant boundary before changing the code.

# References

- `docs\OVERVIEW.md:8-70` — current product and qualification summary, moved from the visual front page.
- `docs\PRODUCT.md:6-37` — requirement and impossibility boundary.
- `AGENTS.md:14-43` — engineering distinctions and privacy rules.
- `src\PhantomFudge.App\App.xaml.cs:13-97` — real startup paths.
- `src\PhantomFudge.Core\AudioSource.cs:3-30` — source identity.
- `src\PhantomFudge.Core\TranscriptBuffer.cs:6-97` — partial/final text representation.
- `scripts\Run-PhantomFudge.ps1:17-41` — launch versus audio/service behavior.
- `docs\AI-ANSWER-ARCHITECTURE.md:82-188` — installed-provider architecture and separately planned Azure extension.

# Principal engineer guide

> **TL;DR:** The central insight is **identity and completion must survive every asynchronous boundary**. Source identity survives audio transport, request identity will survive future model streams, and completion means drained ownership rather than a convenient boolean. Presentation privacy is a separate, bounded contract; it cannot repair lifecycle mistakes.

## Overview: the one idea

It is tempting to describe the application as "audio in, text out, hidden window." That description omits the information required to make it dependable. Computer and Mic can produce interleaved packets; recognizers revise hypotheses; Stop clears visible running state before all final text has drained; a hidden window still owns data; and an excluded HWND remains an ordinary operating-system object. Each boundary needs explicit identity and completion semantics.

The source enum assigns different wire identities to Computer and Microphone (`src\PhantomFudge.Core\AudioSource.cs:3-22`). The transcript store holds separate partials, but final IDs are session-global (`src\PhantomFudge.Core\TranscriptBuffer.cs:9-18`, `src\PhantomFudge.Core\TranscriptBuffer.cs:48-72`). The native adapter separately protects its lifecycle and invalidates queued starts when Stop is requested (`src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:72-156,186-193`). These are concrete mechanisms, not an assumed generic event-driven architecture.

### The insight in a different language

This Python-like pseudocode explains the C# contract; it is not a production implementation:

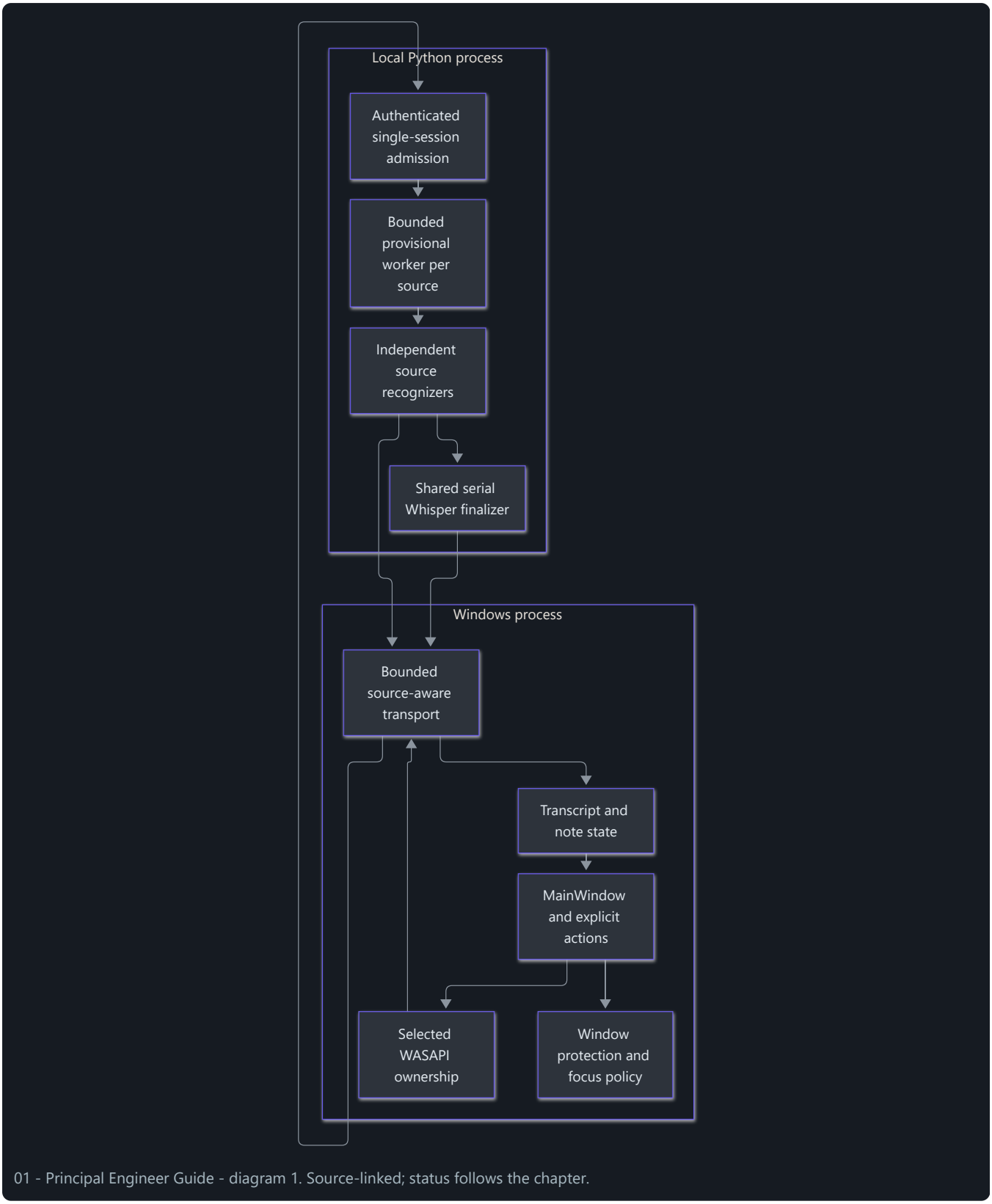
```
def on_packet(source, pcm):
    require(source in selected_sources)
    require(pcm_is_valid(pcm))
    if not queue.try_append(source, pcm):
        fault_entire_session("backpressure")  # do not silently lose a question

async def stop():
    state = STOPPING
    cancel_pending_start()
    await release_selected_inputs()
    await drain_accepted_audio_and_receive_source_finals()
    state = STOPPED

def begin_next_session():
    require(state == STOPPED)                # not merely is_running == False
    preserve_unfinished_text()
    reset_session_global_final_id()
```

The application implements bounded queues and source-aware frames in `TranscriptionSocket`; the server validates each track and finalizes each declared decoder before its stopped event (`src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:11-71`, `services\transcription\server.py:290-505`). The pseudocode's "drain" is therefore a chain of ownership transitions, not a delay inserted to make a race less likely.

# Architecture at review depth



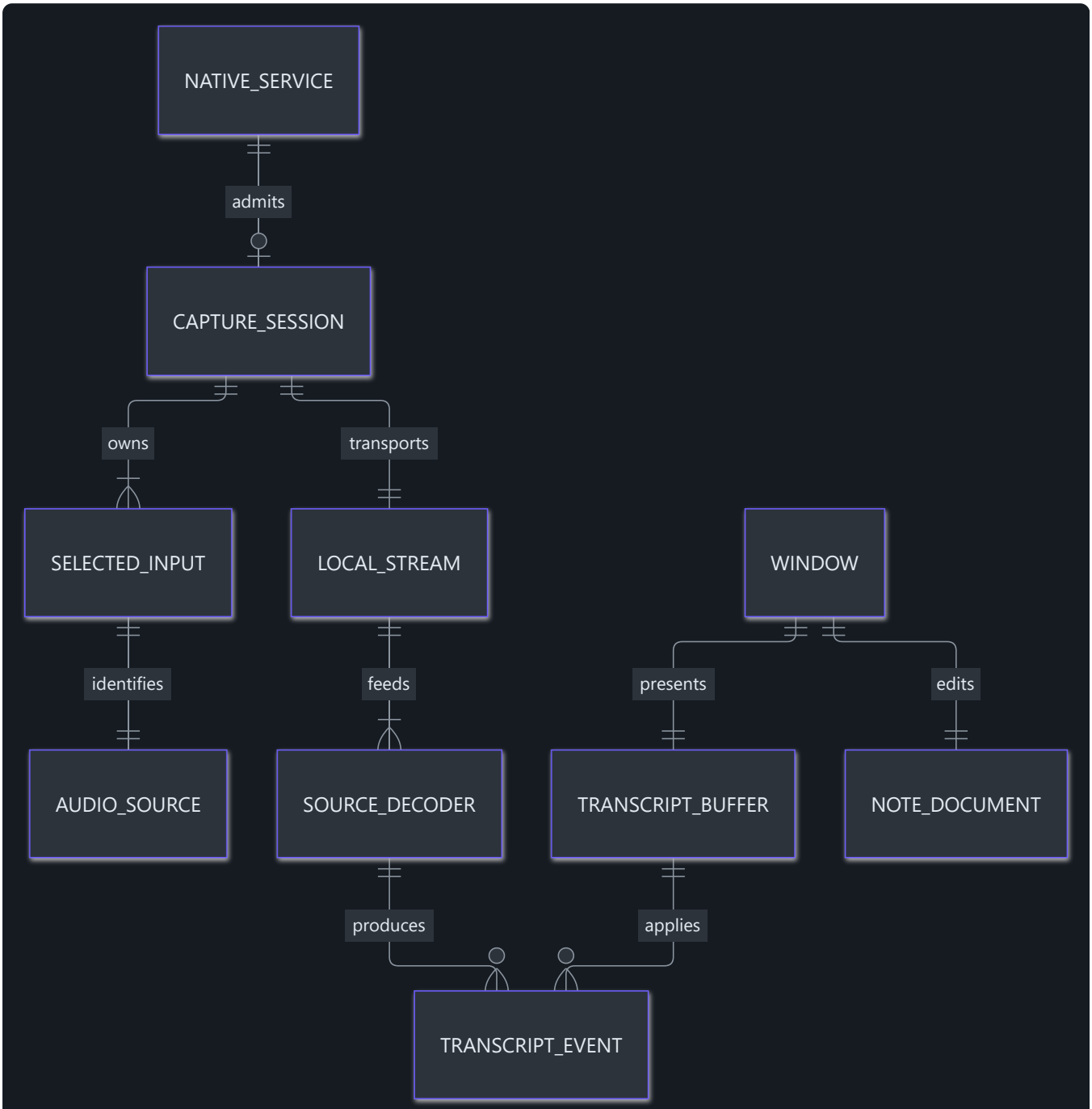

01 - Principal Engineer Guide - diagram 1. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

The separation is intentionally modest. C# is chosen for the native desktop and input integration; Python hosts the recognizer and its protocol. The model does not become more accurate because Python calls it, nor does C# imply Windows' built-in speech engine. The measured engine comparison is explicit about that

distinction (`docs\SPEECH-BENCHMARK.md:15-40`).

The local process boundary is useful for dependency isolation and future packaging, but it adds protocol, authentication, backpressure and service-lifecycle work. The manager does not identify ownership by a PID alone: it authenticates runtime metadata and checks the saved instance ID before reuse or shutdown (`services\transcription\manage.py:155-200`).

## Domain model: implemented concepts, not a database




01 - Principal Engineer Guide - diagram 2. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

This ER diagram is a conceptual ownership map, not a claim that SQL tables exist. `Input`, `Session`, `TranscriptEvent`, `SourceState` and `TranscriptBuffer` are the source concepts; the note document's identity is currently maintained by `MainWindow` plus `NoteFileStore` rather than a separate persistent entity class. No invented repository abstraction is needed to discuss the boundary (`src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptEvent.cs:1-15`, `src\PhantomFudge.Core\NoteFileStore.cs:6-15`).

# The strategic tradeoff table

| Decision | Benefit | Cost or boundary |
|---|---|---|
| One layered WPF HWND | One main capture-policy surface and native controls | Auxiliary OS/auth/file surfaces still need separate reasoning |
| Non-activating Present default | Reduces unnecessary foreground changes | Editing deliberately requires a different interaction mode |
| Arrow cursor policy | Removes the app's I-beam shape cue | Cannot dictate another recorder's cursor stream |
| Separate Computer/Mic tracks | Source labels and independent recognizer state | More lifecycle/queue accounting; no automatic echo cancellation |
| Fail on sustained backlog | Avoids silently dropping words while claiming completeness | Session stops instead of degrading invisibly |
| Independent source workers and serial accurate finalizer | Bound provisional work separately from expensive disjoint-span refinement | Sources still share CPU; this is not sample-synchronous inference or guaranteed accuracy |
| Explicit local saves | Owner controls persistence | Unsaved content can be lost on a crash; no vault or recovery guarantee |
| Native Python default | No container prerequisite for a desktop utility | Interpreter/venv/model setup remains an operational responsibility |
| Proposed direct Azure text call | Smallest initial cloud path for manual Q&A | Identity, data policy, latency and deployment remain unimplemented |

These decisions come from the implementation and current requirements, not a universal design pattern checklist. `WindowProtection.Configure` requests affinity on an owned HWND and validates readback when available (`src\PhantomFudge.App\Native\WindowProtection.cs:19-48`). `NoteFileStore` bounds UTF-8 data and checks prior fingerprints around replacement; it is not a filesystem transaction manager or protection against every race (`src\PhantomFudge.Core\NoteFileStore.cs:16-91`).

# Review the dangerous boundaries first

## Running is not completion

The native adapter can cease reporting Running while cleanup/final delivery continues. The UI must therefore block Start and destructive transcript actions during Stopping, not reset the final-ID counter as soon as a boolean flips. Otherwise an old final can arrive with a large ID after a new session starts, and a valid new final ID1 is rejected as a duplicate. The buffer's global-ID rule is correct only when its session boundary is correct (`src\PhantomFudge.Core\TranscriptBuffer.cs:23-38,48-57`).

### Input identity is not speaker identity

Mic may capture the owner's voice, room sound, or speaker echo. Computer may include all output on a selected endpoint, not only the meeting. The correct labels are source names. Turning those labels into verified people would be a new, unsupported claim. The public contract states this boundary explicitly (`docs\DUAL-SOURCE-AUDIO.md:8-26`).

### Privacy is not one boolean

Window exclusion, source authorization, local token checks, no automatic cloud upload, and unsaved-data behavior answer different questions. A protected window can still coexist with an OS microphone indicator. A successful local GDI fixture does not establish every Teams/Zoom/Meet/ OBS path. The qualification matrix keeps these observations separate (`docs\QUALIFICATION.md:1-26`).

### A plan is not a runtime component

The October 9 hybrid now implements the source-worker/finalizer separation, with selected verified Whisper small.en CPU-int8 finals and no fallback on missing models (`services/transcription/accurate.py:33-129`; `services/transcription/configuration.py:8-34,60-69`). Configured Agency is also operational: it prepares an empty session without inference and sends one exact question only after Ask. Local preparation/diagnostic retention do not make hosted inference offline (`src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.AnswerLifetime.cs:23-78`; provider setup).

Azure Ask currently exists in design documents and TODOs. A principal-level diagram should not quietly insert an operational cloud box into the implemented path. The planned architecture requires immutable question snapshots, source-scoped commit and request-bound streaming; none is implied by the current text buffer (`docs\AI-ANSWER-ARCHITECTURE.md:82-188`).

## Where to go deep

Start with the native lifecycle and transport when reviewing concurrency. Read the server's source state and worker loop when reviewing completeness. Read UI stop coordination and buffer mutation together when reviewing user data preservation. Read the capture policy beside its qualifications—not alone—when reviewing privacy language.

For a product decision, ask whether it changes data origin, lifetime, visibility, authority or completion. A new color mostly changes presentation. A new input changes all five. An Azure answer provider additionally crosses an egress and identity boundary.

## Review exercise

Consider a user who selects Both, starts capture, hides the window during a slow final decode, then immediately asks to start again. Draw the ownership/state sequence. Identify where the native capture, socket, decoder, UI and buffer can legitimately disagree about "running." The correct design does not require those

components to share one boolean; it requires that the coordinator not start a new logical session until the old completion boundary is satisfied.

# References

- `src\PhantomFudge.Core\AudioSource.cs:3-30` — source identity.
- `src\PhantomFudge.Core\TranscriptBuffer.cs:6-97` — source partials and session-global IDs.
- `src\PhantomFudge.Core\NoteFileStore.cs:6-91` — bounded local file behavior.
- `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:72-193` — native lifecycle ownership.
- `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:11-71` — transport state/bounds.
- `services\transcription\server.py:290-505` — source queue and completion.
- `services\transcription\manage.py:155-200` — authenticated process ownership.
- `docs\SPEECH-BENCHMARK.md:15-40` — engines versus host languages.

Source: docs/handbook/02-zero-to-hero.md

# Zero-to-hero learning path

> **TL;DR:** Learn enough of each technology to trace one real packet and one real user action. Do not try to master all of Windows, C#, Python, networking and machine learning before opening the project. The learning path is a sequence of explanations and bounded exercises.

## Overview: two languages, one product

The native project targets `net10.0-windows`, uses WPF and references the Core project plus NAudio (`src\PhantomFudge.App\PhantomFudge.App.csproj:1-16`). The Core project has no WPF dependency, which makes text/identity policies easier to test independently (`src\PhantomFudge.Core\PhantomFudge.Core.csproj:1-5`). Python hosts the local recognition service, with dependencies explicitly pinned (`services\transcription\requirements.txt:1-20`).

This is a technology boundary, not a competition between language quality. C# controls the Windows integration; Vosk's native model does recognition through Python bindings. The benchmark compares actual recognizers, not whether braces or indentation are better.

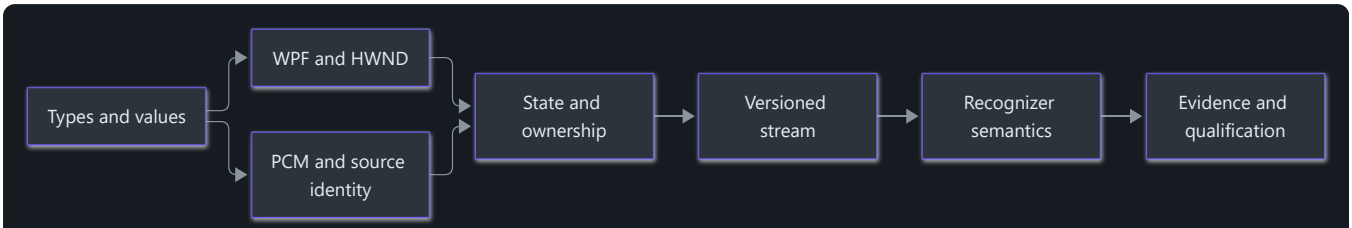
## Part I: foundations in a useful order

| Concept | Learn first | Project anchor |
|---|---|---|
| C# types and records | Values, nullable references, enums, immutable messages | `AudioSource` and `TranscriptEvent` |
| WPF | XAML, dependency properties, visual tree, routed events, dispatcher | `App.xaml` and `MainWindow` |
| Native interop | HWND, P/Invoke, return values, last-error timing | `WindowProtection.Configure` |
| PCM audio | Sample rate, channels, bit depth, bytes, duration | v2 protocol |
| Asynchrony | Tasks, cancellation, queues, callbacks and ownership | native adapter and socket |
| Python asyncio | Event loop versus CPU worker; await versus blocking | server worker loop |
| Recognition | Partial versus final, endpoint versus explicit flush | Vosk wrapper |
| Verification | Unit, protocol, synthetic integration, hardware and recipient evidence | separate test/qualification layers |

`AudioSource` is a small, concrete introduction to strong types: Computer and Microphone have stable byte values and separate wire/display names. An unknown enum value throws instead of silently becoming a source (`src\PhantomFudge.Core\AudioSource.cs:3-30`).

```
# Teaching pseudocode: an enum carries more meaning than an unexplained integer.
source = AudioSource.MICROPHONE
packet = AudioPacket(source=source, pcm=bytes_from_that_input)
```

In Python a dictionary can express the same idea, but the compiler cannot prove that every caller supplied the right key or type. That is why the wire protocol validates fields even when the C# side has strong types: a process boundary can receive malformed bytes.




02 - Zero-to-Hero Learning Path - diagram 1. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

# Part II: trace two paths

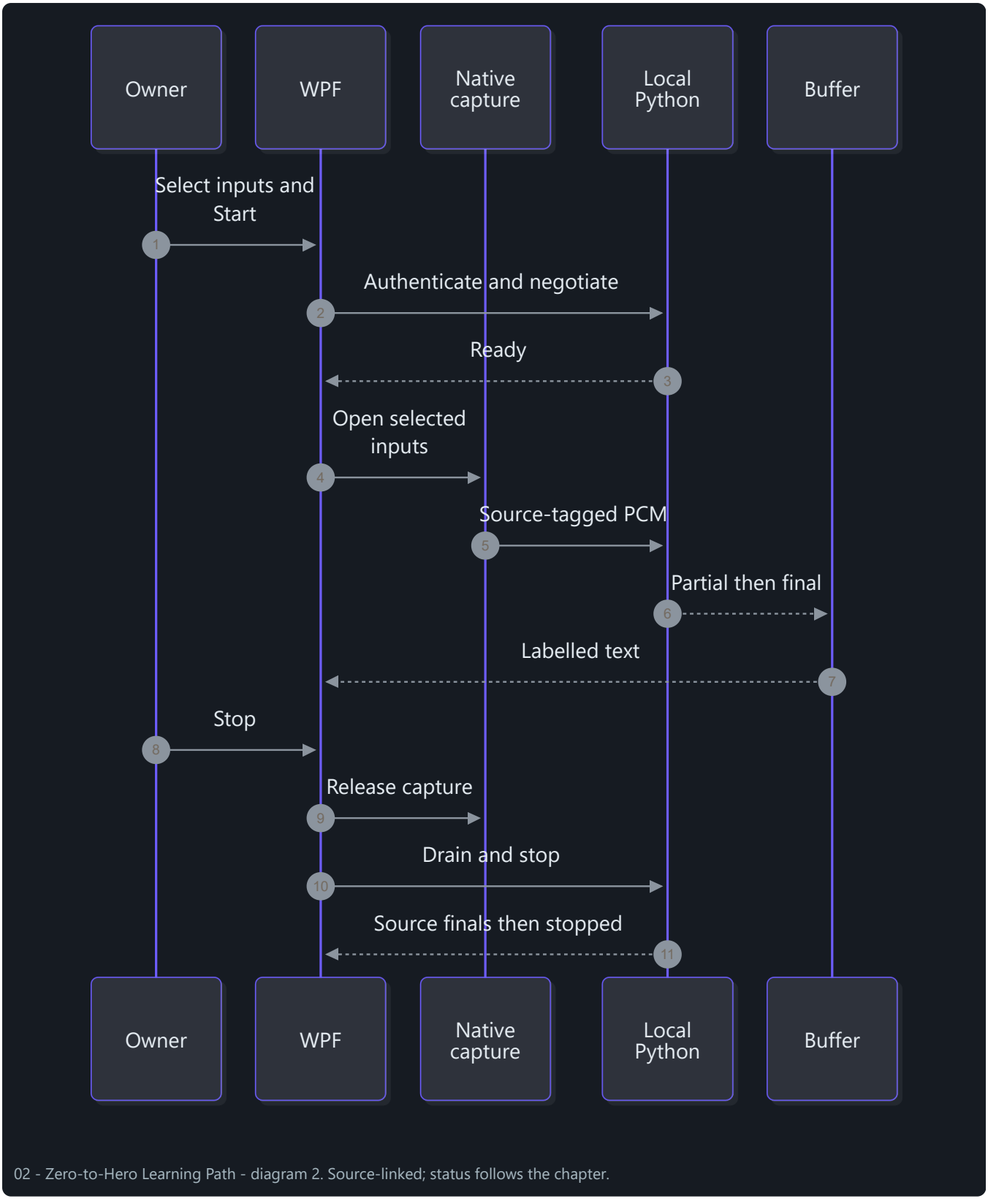
## Path A: opening the application

Follow `Run-PhantomFudge.ps1`. It chooses a source-build or packaged executable, detects an existing instance, optionally builds, and starts the local service unless NotesOnly was chosen. It passes the token through the child environment rather than printing it (`scripts\Run-PhantomFudge.ps1:8-57`).

Then follow `App.OnStartup`: a normal launch establishes per-user ownership and either reveals the existing process or constructs a new protected window (`src\PhantomFudge.App\App.xaml.cs:62-97`). This explains why double-clicking an updated EXE while an old instance is running does not necessarily replace the old UI.

## Path B: one utterance

An explicit Start selects inputs. PCM bytes are tagged with their source, sent over the local socket, decoded independently, and returned as partial/final events. The buffer must clear only the partial corresponding to a final's source. Do not read "partial" as a promise that every character is settled (`src\PhantomFudge.Core\TranscriptBuffer.cs:14-19`, `src\PhantomFudge.Core\TranscriptBuffer.cs:41-72`; `docs\DUAL-SOURCE-AUDIO.md:28-84`).




02 - Zero-to-Hero Learning Path - diagram 2. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

# Part III: learn the byte arithmetic

The wire format is16,000 samples per second, one channel,16 bits per sample. Divide bits by eight to get bytes:16,000 x1 x2 =32,000 PCM bytes per second. A100ms payload is3,200 bytes. V2 adds one source byte per WebSocket message, not per audio sample. Thus a3,200-byte PCM payload becomes a3,201-byte message; it is not a WAV file and has no WAV header (`docs\DUAL-SOURCE-AUDIO.md:37-53`).

This arithmetic helps diagnose errors. An odd-length PCM payload is invalid because a16-bit sample needs two bytes. A source prefix belongs outside the PCM passed to the recognizer. Counting that prefix as sound would shift every subsequent sample boundary.

The phrase "two channels" can be misleading here. The application uses two independent mono source tracks, not one interleaved stereo stream. Each recognizer gets mono audio; the protocol carries source identity separately.

# Part IV: asynchronous thinking

Compare a synchronous function with a lifecycle:

```
result = recognize(audio)       # one call; ownership is simple
```

```
start_requested = True
await service_ready()
open_inputs()
# callbacks and network events now arrive independently
await stop_requested()
await all_inputs_released()
await accepted_audio_drained()
await final_text_received()
```

An `await` does not mean "nothing else can happen." The WPF dispatcher can process another user action while an operation awaits I/O. Conversely, doing CPU recognition on an event loop can prevent other requests from being handled. The server therefore uses a bounded worker for native recognition, while native startup is kept away from a blocked WPF dispatcher (`services\transcription\server.py:115-181`, `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:110-128`).

Three questions prevent many mistakes:

1. Who owns this resource while the operation is incomplete?
2. What identifies this result as belonging to the current source/session?
3. What event proves completion, rather than merely intent to stop?

# Part V: safe first exercises

## Exercise 1: source labels, no devices

Read `SourceTranscriptTests`. Explain why a Computer final must leave a Mic partial visible. Then sketch a table of two partials, one Computer final, and one Mic final. This needs no microphone or backend (`tests\PhantomFudge.Core.Tests\SourceTranscriptTests.cs:1-80`).

### Exercise 2: a rejected save

Read a test that changes a file outside the app, then attempts to save with an old fingerprint. Identify which version should survive. Do not use a real note as the experiment; the test creates an isolated directory (`tests\PhantomFudge.Core.Tests\NoteFileStoreTests.cs:1-110`).

### Exercise 3: protocol without hardware

Run the native synthetic harness only after reading its entry mode. It uses fake transport/input objects for its normal test groups. The separate playback command is deliberately not part of the default suite (`tests\PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests\Program.cs:18-71`).

### Exercise 4: a documentation-only screenshot

The documentation command renders actual WPF controls with synthetic text/device labels. It is not a Snipping Tool workaround for capturing someone else's private window (`src\PhantomFudge.App\App.xaml.cs:54-59`, `scripts\Export-HandbookScreenshots.ps1:1-94`).

## How to avoid learning the wrong lesson

Do not conclude that a successful test suite proves hardware support, that the fastest batch recognizer has the lowest live partial latency, or that a private window is a security boundary. Those are different experiments. The repository deliberately leaves broader acceptance work open.

The glossary provides more than forty terms. Use it when a word becomes a blocker, then return to the code path. A good first contribution is a small test/documentation improvement that follows one real invariant end to end.

## References

- `src\PhantomFudge.App\PhantomFudge.App.csproj:1-16` — native target and dependencies.
- `src\PhantomFudge.Core\PhantomFudge.Core.csproj:1-5` — platform-independent policy layer.
- `src\PhantomFudge.Core\AudioSource.cs:3-30` — typed input identity.
- `scripts\Run-PhantomFudge.ps1:8-57` — launch/reuse/token boundary.
- `src\PhantomFudge.App\App.xaml.cs:13-97` — entry paths.
- `services\transcription\requirements.txt:1-20` — Python dependency baseline.
- `tests\PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests\Program.cs:18-71` — synthetic test entry.
- `docs\DUAL-SOURCE-AUDIO.md:28-84` — byte contract.

Source: docs/INSTALLATION.md

# Install, update and remove Phantom Fudge

**Installer edition: unsigned Windows 11 x64 preview.** Downloads and availability are listed at v0.2.0-preview.1. Candidate checks provide bounded current-host evidence, not clean-VM qualification or universal compatibility. The repository is **private**: its releases inherit that visibility and require repository access. Publication does not make it public. See release evidence and workstream58.

The DLL-qualified oneDNN runtime has passed the full offline rebuild with dependency audits, real synthetic-PCM inference, Unicode-path loading and natural process exit. There are 85 focused runtime tests and 55 native tests passing. The earlier Ruy exit hang and Vosk path failure are historical; their old stages remain rejected. The complete candidate3 build also passed the enforced PE audit, loaded-DLL and real-PCM/clean-exit gates. Lifecycle3 used identical functional runtime bytes; candidate3 added license/provenance files. Release-asset identities belong to the versioned download.

| Scope | Current evidence | Qualification boundary |
|---|---|---|
| Startup | 55 helper tests and 10 exact-EXE self-checks pass | Includes guarded delayed app startup; interactive Close and installed speech remain unqualified |
| Desktop | Packaged UI passes prior regression groups and all 38 keyboard checks | Synthetic UI only; no audio capture or model requests |
| Setup | Lifecycle3 passes 11 checks against 3,682 inventoried files | Current host, random AppId/path, no shortcuts, simulated older version; not a genuine old-binary or clean-VM test |
| Speech | 85 focused tests; real hybrid/VAD/forced decoder execution, Unicode relocation and clean exit pass | Generated PCM only; no actual capture, service, provider request or new performance qualification |
| DLLs | 92 speech PE files and five loaded bundled CRT/OpenMP paths; 861 app/launcher PE files inspected separately | Not a clean VM or app/launcher loaded-DLL test |
| Assets | Consult the versioned release for availability and exact checksums | Component checks alone do not attest an arbitrary downloaded file |

The recipe creates the same gate in both Setup and Uninstall initialization; the native launcher checks it before ordinary/notes-only startup. Detailed receipts and remaining acceptance gates are kept in release evidence, not in the installation procedure. (tools/Installer/PhantomFudge.iss:72-76,150-160) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/Program.cs:47-78) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/LauncherContract.cs:152-165) (scripts/Build-Installer.ps1:30-44,76-114) (scripts/Test-Installer.ps1:15-18,31-84,96-104)

## Before downloading

The installer removes the developer-tool setup burden, not the preview's qualification limits. It targets **Windows 11 x64** only. Windows 10, Windows on ARM, macOS and Linux are unsupported for this package. A compatible OS does not establish performance or device compatibility on every computer; no universal CPU,

memory, microphone or capture guarantee is claimed. The release configuration pins `win-x64`, minimum Windows build22000, version `0.2.0-preview.1` and Windows file version `0.2.0.1`. (tools/Installer/release.json:1-8)

| Included by the planned installer | Not installed or configured for you |
| --- | --- |
| Self-contained .NET desktop app and native Start-menu launcher | .NET SDK, PowerShell7 or a system Python prerequisite |
| Private Python3.13.14 runtime, speech-service files and verified English Vosk/Whisper small.en models | Docker, GPU drivers or universal hardware support |
| Bundled dependency notices and model provenance | An answer-provider CLI, provider model, account, sign-in or a project license |

Both executables are published self-contained; speech preparation belongs to the release build, not a first-launch package restore. The launcher uses fixed installed paths and offline model environment settings. No Python/PowerShell installation step belongs in the installed-user procedure. The release build requires a separate generated-PCM inference/clean-exit gate; import and metadata checks alone are insufficient. (scripts/Build-Installer.ps1:30-44) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/LauncherContract.cs:56-105) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/ChildProcesses.cs:48-105) (tools/Installer/runtime-lock.json:1-11)

This is an **unsigned prerelease**, not a qualified release. Windows SmartScreen or organizational policy may warn or block it. Check the origin and checksum; **do not disable security controls or bypass your organization's policy**. A checksum identifies bytes; it is not a signing identity or evidence of capture exclusion. (scripts/Build-Installer.ps1:79-114)

# Install and open

Once the release evidence confirms that assets are available:

1. Open the versioned release above while signed in with repository access. Download the planned `PhantomFudge-0.2.0-preview.1-win-x64-Setup.exe` and `SHA256SUMS.txt`.
2. Compare the EXE's SHA-256 with its exact filename in the checksum file. Windows PowerShell can perform this optional check; **PowerShell7 is not required to install or run the app**:

   ```
   Get-FileHash .\PhantomFudge-0.2.0-preview.1-win-x64-Setup.exe -Algorithm SHA256
   ```

3. Run Setup as your normal Windows user. The default location is `%LOCALAPPDATA%\Programs\PhantomFudge`. Setup is per-user and requests no administrator rights. A Start-menu shortcut is created; the desktop shortcut is optional.
4. Finish and close Setup, then open **Phantom Fudge** from Start. Setup never launches the app. There is no automatic startup registration or scheduled task.
5. Wait for the local service to become ready, choose the intended Computer/Mic/Both devices, then press **Start** inside the app when you actually want transcription.

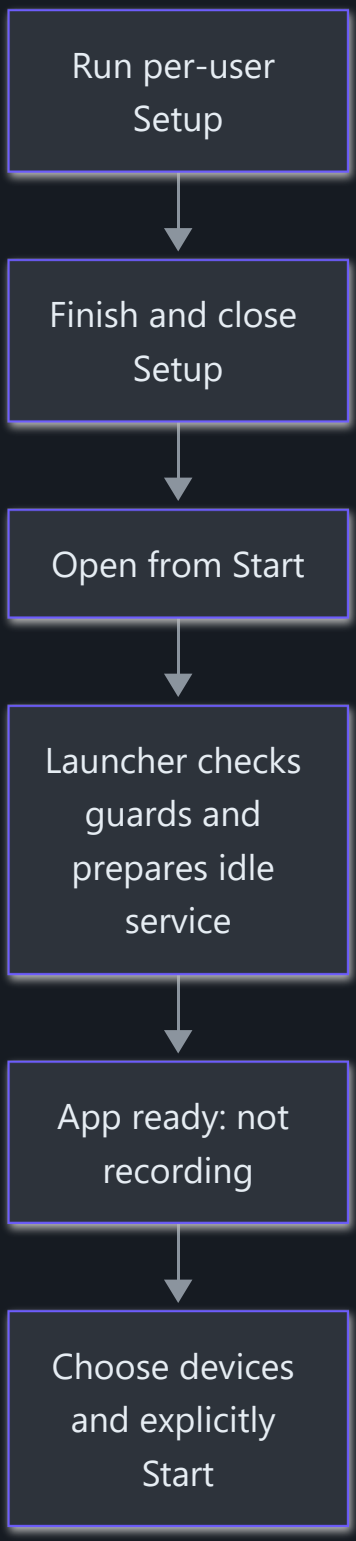
The file names/checksum are build outputs; the installation location, shortcuts and absence of post-install launch come from the Inno recipe. Inno Setup6.7.3 is a build tool, not an end-user prerequisite. The installer does not add process concealment or change the app's taskbar behavior. (scripts/Build-Installer.ps1:100-114) (tools/Installer/PhantomFudge.iss:14-76) (tools/Installer/release.json:6-7)

**Setup and launcher status/error windows are ordinary visible Windows UI.** They do not inherit the notes window's capture-exclusion request. Install, update and launch before sharing if that status UI should not appear to an audience. They contain generic startup messages, not your notes or transcripts. (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/LauncherWindow.cs:18-57)

## Opening the app is not starting capture

Normal and notes-only launch first check the installer-maintenance gate. If present, the launcher records “operation busy” and exits70 without opening a window or starting a child; wait for Setup to finish, then retry. Otherwise it reveals an existing same-user app before touching the speech runtime. A fresh launch acquires its startup guard and checks the installer gate again, so a gate appearing during guard acquisition is not missed. Normal launch then validates files, reads or creates the private token, prepares the service and opens the app; no audio-start command is sent. (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/Program.cs:47-78,127-213) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/LauncherContract.cs:152-165) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/LauncherStatus.cs:15,34,43-61) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/InstanceCoordination.cs:12-57) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/LocalToken.cs:12-39)

The launcher keeps its startup mutex until the app's main-instance mutex appears or the exact child is proven to have exited. After30 seconds it reports **AppStartPending (76)**, not success, and continues watching. Closing that pending progress window hides it; it does not cancel the child or release the update guard. Even early dispatcher shutdown retains the guard while ownership is uncertain. No timeout force-kills the app. (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/ChildProcesses.cs:12-42) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/Program.cs:108-118,186-227) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/LauncherStatus.cs:39)




Install, update and remove Phantom Fudge - diagram 1. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

For notes without service startup, use the installed launcher's `--notes-only` argument:

```
"%LOCALAPPDATA%\Programs\PhantomFudge\launcher\PhantomFudge.Launcher.exe" --notes-only
```

This command is suitable for a shortcut's Target; it is not a command to paste into PowerShell unchanged. A speech-start failure also offers **Open notes without transcription**. Notes-only does not stop an already-running service, remove the audio controls or disable configured answer providers. It is not a privacy sandbox. (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/LauncherContract.cs:14-23) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/Program.cs:153-213) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/LauncherWindow.cs:37-48,70-77)

On a new profile, answers remain **Snapshot only** until you explicitly configure an external provider. Existing `%LOCALAPPDATA%\PhantomFudge\answers.json` and `keyboard.json` remain in use; an upgrade does not reset your previous provider choice or keyboard setting. The installer does not bundle a provider or perform login. Read provider boundaries before enabling one; installed Agency/Copilot can use cloud-hosted models. (src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AnswerConfiguration.cs:8-21) (src/PhantomFudge.Core/KeyboardShortcutConfiguration.cs:31-39) (scripts/Build-Installer.ps1:30-54,56-74)

# Update or repair

1. Save notes, export required transcripts, and copy any question/answer text you need.
2. Stop transcription and close the app with **X**. **Hide and Cover are not Exit.**
3. Run the same installer to repair, or a newer preview installer to update the same per-user installation. The stable AppId keeps the installation identity.
4. Reopen from Start after Setup completes. Select devices and press Start deliberately again.

Setup rejects a downgrade and refuses an unrecognized, nonempty destination. The repair/update recipe uses a **fresh maintenance helper extracted from Setup**, rather than depending on a potentially damaged installed launcher. A numeric version fallback is stored under the per-user `HKCU\Software\PhantomFudge\Installer\<AppId>` key as `WindowsVersion`; if neither that nor `app-version.txt` is valid, Setup refuses. Lifecycle3 passed same-version and damaged-launcher/version repair against candidate2. Its upgrade case changes a version record, not a genuine older binary. (tools/Installer/PhantomFudge.iss:51-52,107-148) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/Program.cs:50-58,94-100) (scripts/Test-Installer.ps1:61-74)

An open app or another launcher operation blocks maintenance instead of being force-closed. For an installation with runtime ownership data, the native maintenance operation takes the shared lifecycle lock and checks the saved receipt before an authenticated loopback shutdown. Only the **owned idle** instance may be stopped. A recorded process confirmed dead or replaced by a reused PID can have its unchanged receipt removed; live or uncertain ownership is not permission to kill. This native operation does not depend on old Python binaries or a valid compact manifest, so repair can replace them. The installation marker is still required. The passing lifecycle fixture does not start the app or speech service; installed speech startup is a separate qualification scope. (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/Program.cs:94-100) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/LauncherContract.cs:87-105) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/MaintenanceOperation.cs:48-118) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/OwnedServiceClient.cs:20-58)

A retained token without a receipt is normal after a successful stop. Maintenance validates it locally and checks that the loopback port is unused without sending credentials. An occupied or uncertain port, or a receipt missing its token, blocks maintenance; deleting ownership files to bypass that refusal is not a repair

procedure. An untouched installation with neither file does not probe another workspace's listener. (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/MaintenanceOperation.cs:52-75,121-134) (tests/PhantomFudge.Core.Tests/InstalledMaintenanceTests.cs:31-74)

Program directories are installer-managed, not a place to save notes, exports, personal scripts or custom models. Update replaces managed application/runtime directories; reinstalling is not a user-data backup strategy. Keep saved content outside the install folder. (tools/Installer/PhantomFudge.iss:47-60)

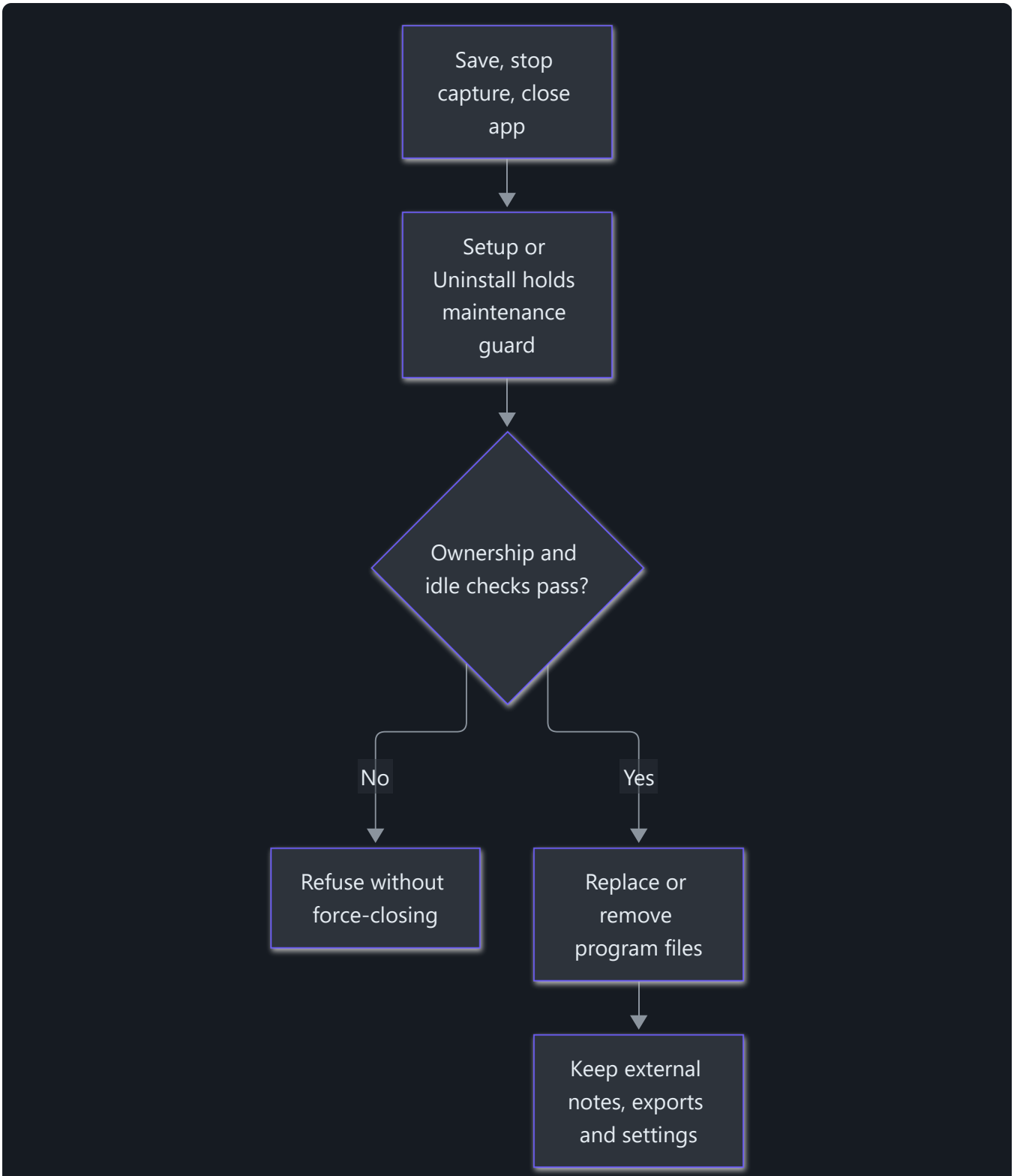
# Remove the application

After saving/exporting, stopping transcription and closing with X, open **Windows Settings → Apps → Installed apps → Phantom Fudge → Uninstall**. Uninstall invokes the installed launcher's maintenance guard. If ownership or shutdown is uncertain, it stops with an error rather than killing a process. Missing launcher files may require repair using the same installer first. (tools/Installer/PhantomFudge.iss:39-40,150-161) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/LauncherStatus.cs:29-39)

| Location | Ownership | Normal update/uninstall policy |
|---|---|---|
| `%LOCALAPPDATA%\Programs\PhantomFudge\app`, `launcher`, `runtime\python`, `services\transcription`, `models`, `licenses`, `docs` | Installed binaries, speech weights and shipped documentation | Update maintains program files; uninstall removes the installed payload and shortcuts |
| `%LOCALAPPDATA%\PhantomFudge\InstalledRuntime\.local` | Installed speech token, ownership/configuration data and local runtime diagnostics | Outside the install tree; retained for reinstall |
| `%LOCALAPPDATA%\PhantomFudge\InstalledRuntime\.local\models` | Explicitly provisioned per-user model files | Retained; separate from installer-managed bundled weights |
| `%LOCALAPPDATA%\PhantomFudge` settings and diagnostics | Existing app answer/keyboard settings, diagnostics and launcher status | Retained; not reset or silently purged |
| Notes and exports saved outside the install folder | Files you selected | Retained |

The separation is intentional: removing software must not silently erase the work or preferences you may want on reinstall. It also means **uninstall is not a privacy wipe**. If you want a full data reset, first understand each retained folder, preserve required files, stop its owned runtime and remove only the specific data you intend to discard. Do not recursively delete the whole profile or unrelated provider profiles. No blanket data-purge command is provided. (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/LauncherContract.cs:56-84) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/LauncherStatus.cs:43-61) (tools/Installer/PhantomFudge.iss:47-65,150-161)

The runtime checks for a per-user model with the pinned directory name first, then uses the bundled model only when that user path is absent. The selected files must pass the same pinned manifest checks; a user override is not permission to load arbitrary weights. Explicit provisioning writes only to the user model directory, not the installation. This keeps deliberately provisioned models outside directories that Setup replaces. (tools/Installer/runtime-contract.json:7-12) (services/transcription/tests/test_installed_runtime.py:74-91)




Install, update and remove Phantom Fudge - diagram 2. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

# If startup or maintenance fails

| Symptom | Next safe action |
| --- | --- |
| Release link is unavailable | Confirm that publication has completed and your account has private-repository access; do not substitute an old ZIP |

| Symptom | Next safe action |
| --- | --- |
| Windows blocks the unsigned EXE | Follow your organization's review process; do not disable SmartScreen or other controls |
| Existing window is hidden | Relaunch from Start or use Ctrl+Alt+Space; save and close it before an update |
| Local speech cannot start | Use the notes-only option if offered; inspect local status, not a real-audio test |
| AppStartPending (76) after30seconds | The launcher is still watching the child; Close hides progress and updates remain guarded. It is not a success or permission to force-close a process |
| Busy or uncertain runtime ownership | Stop capture in its owning app and retry after closing it; do not kill Python by name or delete a receipt just to bypass the guard |
| Installed files are missing | Repair with the same-version installer; retain user data and report a repair that cannot pass maintenance |
| Another workspace uses port8765 | Stop that service through its own normal workflow, or use notes-only; the installer must not adopt or kill it |

After a reboot, try a normal launch first. The manager automatically clears a stale ownership receipt when it can prove the old process is gone, then resumes normal startup checks. A retained PID without a creation timestamp can be cleared only when that PID is confirmed absent. Live or uninspectable processes remain protected; reboot alone does not require reinstalling or manually deleting a token/receipt. (services/transcription/tests/test_installed_runtime.py:129-198)

The launcher's bounded status is `%LOCALAPPDATA%\PhantomFudge\launcher-status.json`. It contains a status code, generic message and time, not token values or captured text. Startup timeouts preserve uncertain process ownership rather than force-killing the child. (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/LauncherStatus.cs:25-61) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/ChildProcesses.cs:107-123)

# Source, portable and licensing boundaries

The existing source-development workflow still uses its own SDK, PowerShell, Python environment and explicit model provisioning. The older timestamped ZIPs are historical and lack later UI features. A planned `win-x64-Portable.zip` from this new build is a different, self-contained payload: keep all its directories together and use `launcher\PhantomFudge.Launcher.exe`; it does not register a Windows Apps uninstall entry. Do not mix files from these workflows. (scripts/Build-Installer.ps1:30-44,105-108) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/LauncherContract.cs:69-84)

Third-party licenses/notices travel with the exact runtime payload. They do **not** choose a license for Phantom Fudge; the owner has not selected one. Preserve the included license files. See third-party notices and the model provenance manifests. (services/transcription/model.json:2-10) (services/transcription/whisper-models.json:1-5,17-26)

The final runtime is a distinct CPU-only build, not the unchanged development stack. Its application-private `faster-whisper 1.2.1+phantomfudge1` removes encoded-file decoding/PyAV while retaining the in-memory PCM array path in source. `CTranslate2 4.6.0+phantomfudge2` uses oneDNN3.1.1 and Microsoft compiler OpenMP (`vcomp140`), without CUDA/cuDNN or proprietary Intel OpenMP. Vosk's package is unmodified: the service adapter loads a non-ASCII Windows model path through a locked, temporary wide-API working-directory change. The final handoff reports real synthetic inference and natural exit, including Unicode relocation. No clean-VM qualification is claimed. Earlier development-build speech timings/accuracy do **not**

qualify these binaries; this guide makes no recognition-performance claim. Exact installer inventory and redistribution review are separate release gates. (tools/Installer/bundle_runtime.py:246-282,332-376,412-462,597-609) (services/transcription/recognizer.py:44-63) (services/transcription/tests/test_packaged_pcm_runtime.py:35-97,126-138)

The current workflow and keyboard guide explain the unchanged desktop UI. Their existing23synthetic WPF images and10README derivatives are UI examples, not installer screenshots or evidence that installation succeeded. No installer screenshots are presented here. Docker remains a separate optional final-stage task, not part of installation. Capture qualification remains NOT_TESTED for the product matrix.

# Implementation map

`install-manifest.json` is compact build/version metadata, bounded to16KiB by the launcher. `payload-files.json` is the separate full path/size/SHA-256 inventory; it deliberately omits its own self-hash. The build inspects hidden entries and rejects reparse points/private payload paths. These controls identify the assembled bytes, not a successful installation or a signing identity. Lifecycle tests and publication evidence remain in implementation status. (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/LauncherContract.cs:38-52,94-105) (scripts/Build-Installer.ps1:56-98)

The engineering-only `--validate-install` command checks the installation marker, compact manifest and required layout without starting the app or service. It does not run inference, verify every model byte or replace the full inventory/lifecycle checks. Maintenance uses the whole self-contained launcher directory extracted by Setup, not a standalone copied EXE. (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/Program.cs:25-43) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/LauncherContract.cs:87-105) (tools/Installer/PhantomFudge.iss:47-49,143-147)

| Source | Responsibility |
| --- | --- |
| (tools/Installer/release.json:1-8) | Preview/Windows versions, runtime target and compiler pin |
| (tools/Installer/PhantomFudge.iss:14-76,107-161) | Per-user files, shortcuts, version fallback and maintenance hooks; no post-install launch |
| (scripts/Build-Installer.ps1:30-54,56-114) | Required PCM gate, payload assembly, compact metadata, full inventory and output identity |
| (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/Program.cs:25-100,103-227) | Headless validation, installer gate, maintenance and guarded normal/notes-only handoff |
| (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/MaintenanceOperation.cs:48-134) | Partial-state refusal, locked receipt checks, owned idle shutdown and safe stale-receipt cleanup |
| (tools/Installer/bundle_runtime.py:332-376,465-535,538-609,668-694) | Disclosed variants/notices, mandatory native-dependency audit, import checks and separate synthetic execution |
| (tools/Installer/runtime_audit.py:32-166,169-234) | Declared PE dependency names and observed bundled CRT paths; not clean-VM qualification |
| (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/LauncherContract.cs:56-105) | Fixed paths, ownership marker, compact metadata and layout validation |
| (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/ChildProcesses.cs:12-42,48-105) | Child readiness proof, fixed arguments and offline installed environment |
| (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/LocalToken.cs:12-85) | Private token creation and validation |

| Source | Responsibility |
| --- | --- |
| (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/LauncherStatus.cs:25-61) | Generic recovery guidance, non-success pending state and local status |

Source: docs/CURRENT-WORKFLOW.md

# Current workflow: an illustrated guide

## Overview: one workspace, separate deliberate actions

Phantom Fudge combines local transcription, an editable question and explicit provider answers. Choosing an input does not record it; selecting words does not send them; covering the workspace does not stop work. This guide brings the current controls and images together so those boundaries are visible before a meeting. It describes **current source**, not the older045022preview ZIP.

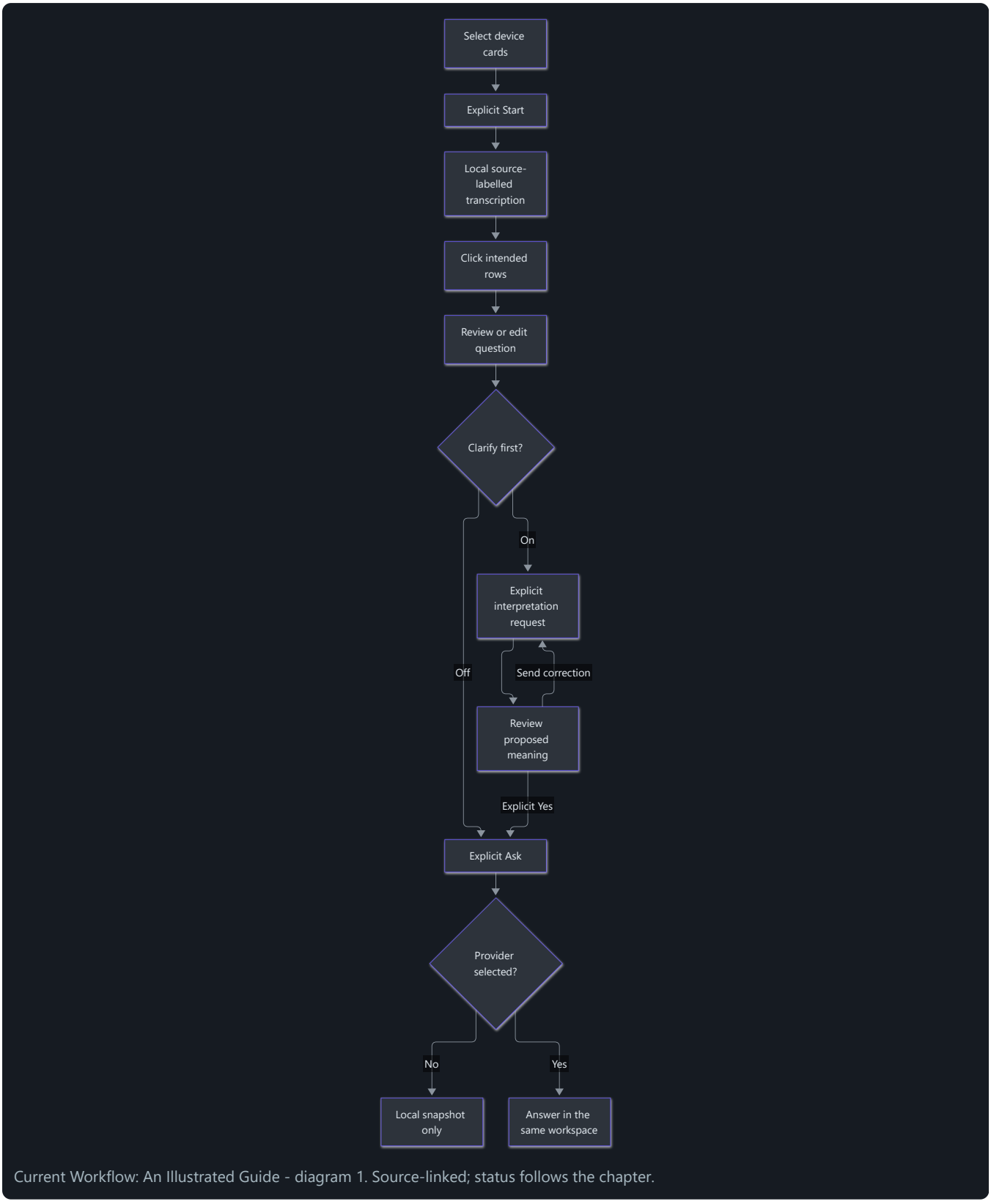
All pictures below are **separate synthetic WPF examples**. They show actual controls with generated text/device labels, not a real conversation, live model result or screen-sharing qualification. The source-image manifest and README-image manifest record their provenance. Current rendering and behavior are defined by the window and its partial classes, not by the historical package. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.xaml:1-10; src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Questions.cs:27-61; src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Cover.cs:22-77.)

Configure an answer provider before the AI steps. Without one, **Freeze locally** only captures a local question snapshot; transcription and notes remain usable.

### Keyboard-first route

Keyboard controls and the answer-size slider are implemented in current source. The guide, source atlas and handbook include the updated workflow and synthetic illustrations. The canonical keyboard guide covers: **Ctrl+Alt+K** → `v` → `j` / `k` → **Space** → **Enter to review** → **Ctrl+Enter to submit**. Edit is literal typing: Enter makes a newline. Escape backs out through Control before a best-effort return to the previous app; `m` in Control masks and disarms without stopping work. There is no cursor locking/hiding/warping or global letter-key capture. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Keyboard.cs:67-85,141-175,218-306,364-368; src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.KeyboardSelection.cs:110-159.) Edit remains armed after submission. Async interpretation retargets the visible editable reply/ original field only while this app is already foreground; it does not steal focus from another app. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Keyboard.cs:127-139,301-306.)

# Architecture: what happens after each click




Current Workflow: An Illustrated Guide - diagram 1. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

The normal speech path is selected native WASAPI inputs, authenticated local transport, fast Vosk partial text and local Whisper small.en finals. Normal Ask sends the frozen question through the configured provider. Clarification deliberately adds only its fixed task instruction and bounded question-specific history; no notes

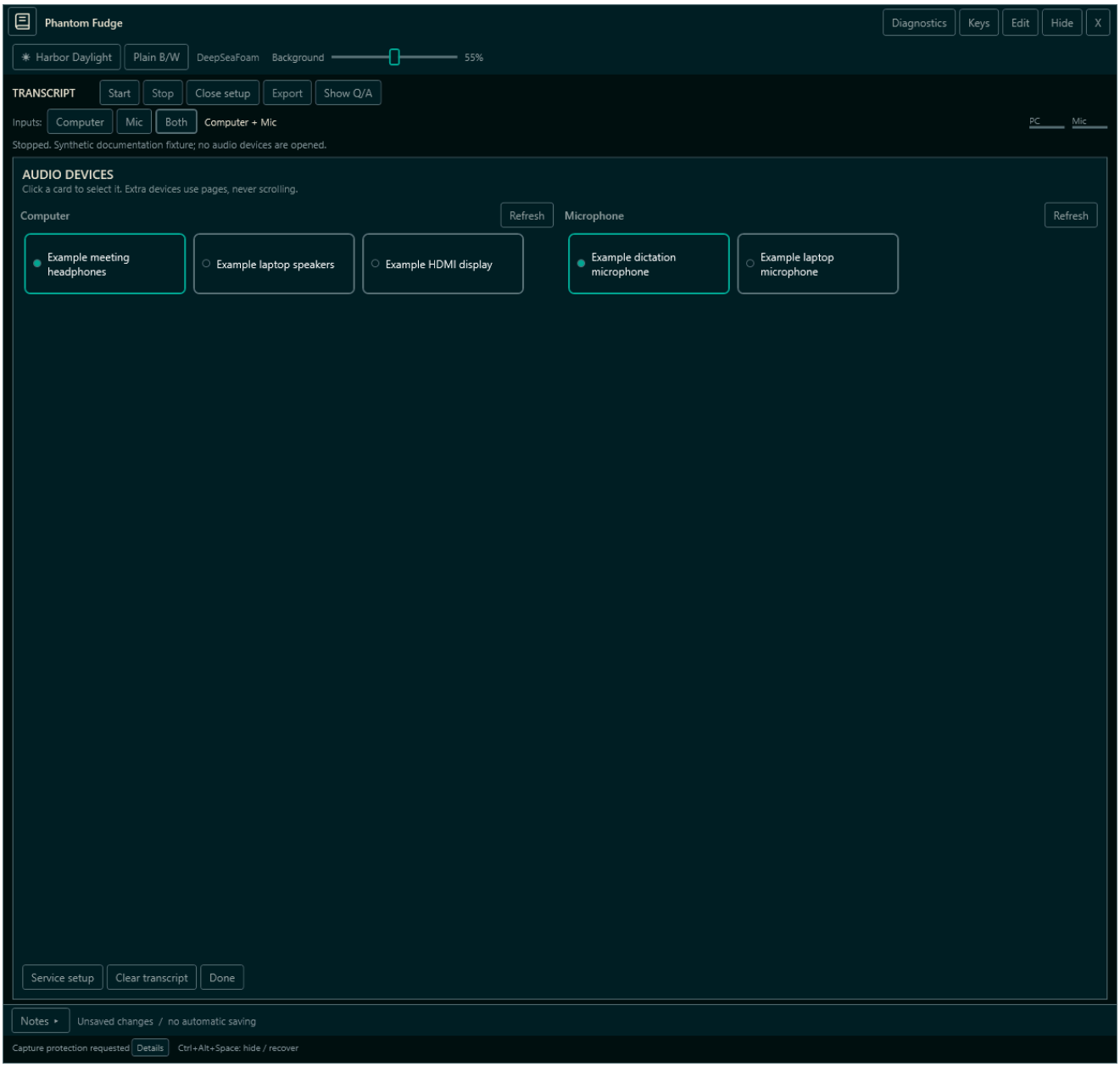
or unselected meeting transcript are appended. (src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/LoopbackTranscriber.cs:65-128; services/transcription/accurate.py:33-129; src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AnswerRun.cs:15-27; src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AnswerClarification.cs:13-69.)

# Components: know the controls before sending

| Control | Meaning |
|---|---|
| Computer / Mic / Both | Select input types; these labels do not identify speakers |
| Audio setup | Open source-specific device cards; Service setup contains the token field |
| Start / Stop | Explicit audio capture and final-text draining |
| Red dot | The transcriber reports Running; hidden while starting/stopped and behind Cover |
| Transcript rows | Ordinary clicks toggle whole segments into the question |
| Type / edit | Deliberate question focus without global Notes Edit |
| Large accent button | Ask provider, Freeze locally, Interpret question or Reply below, according to mode |
| Red-bordered Clear question | Clear the question/snapshot/answer, not the transcript or notes |
| Clarify first | Default-off interpretation and explicit correction/confirmation workflow |
| Book icon, top left | Toggle the visual mask; already-started work continues |
| Keys / Ctrl+Alt+K | Enter modal keyboard control; local selection, review, commands and reading |
| Answer Size | Choose 8–24 for this session; resizing retains a choice, restarting does not |
| Diagnostics | Open local diagnostics and reload its settings |

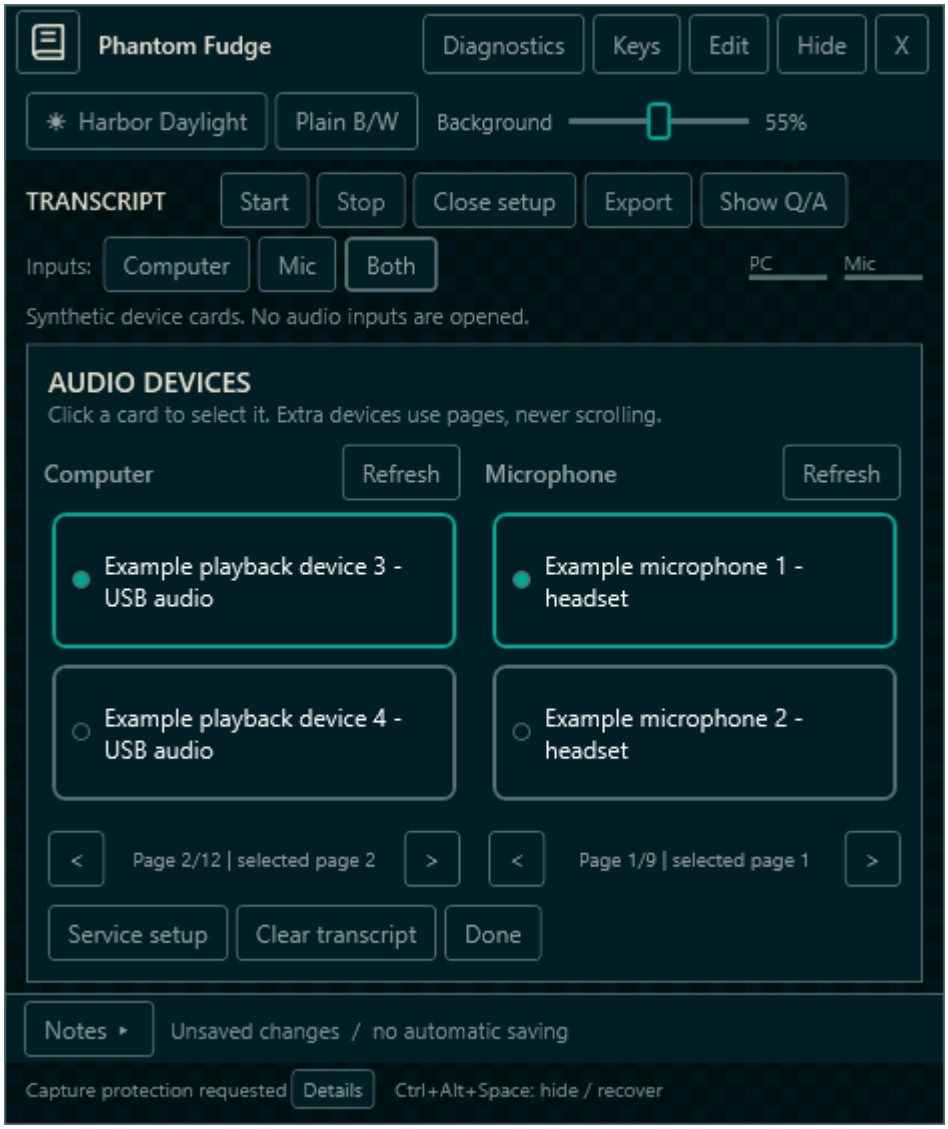
These are distinct handlers and state checks, not alternate names for one global pause action. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Questions.cs:158-212,265-337; src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.RecordingIndicator.cs:7-10; src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Cover.cs:20-77.) Keyboard routing and answer size are separate additions. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Keyboard.cs:177-196; src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.AnswerFont.cs:9-43.)

# 1. Choose audio device cards



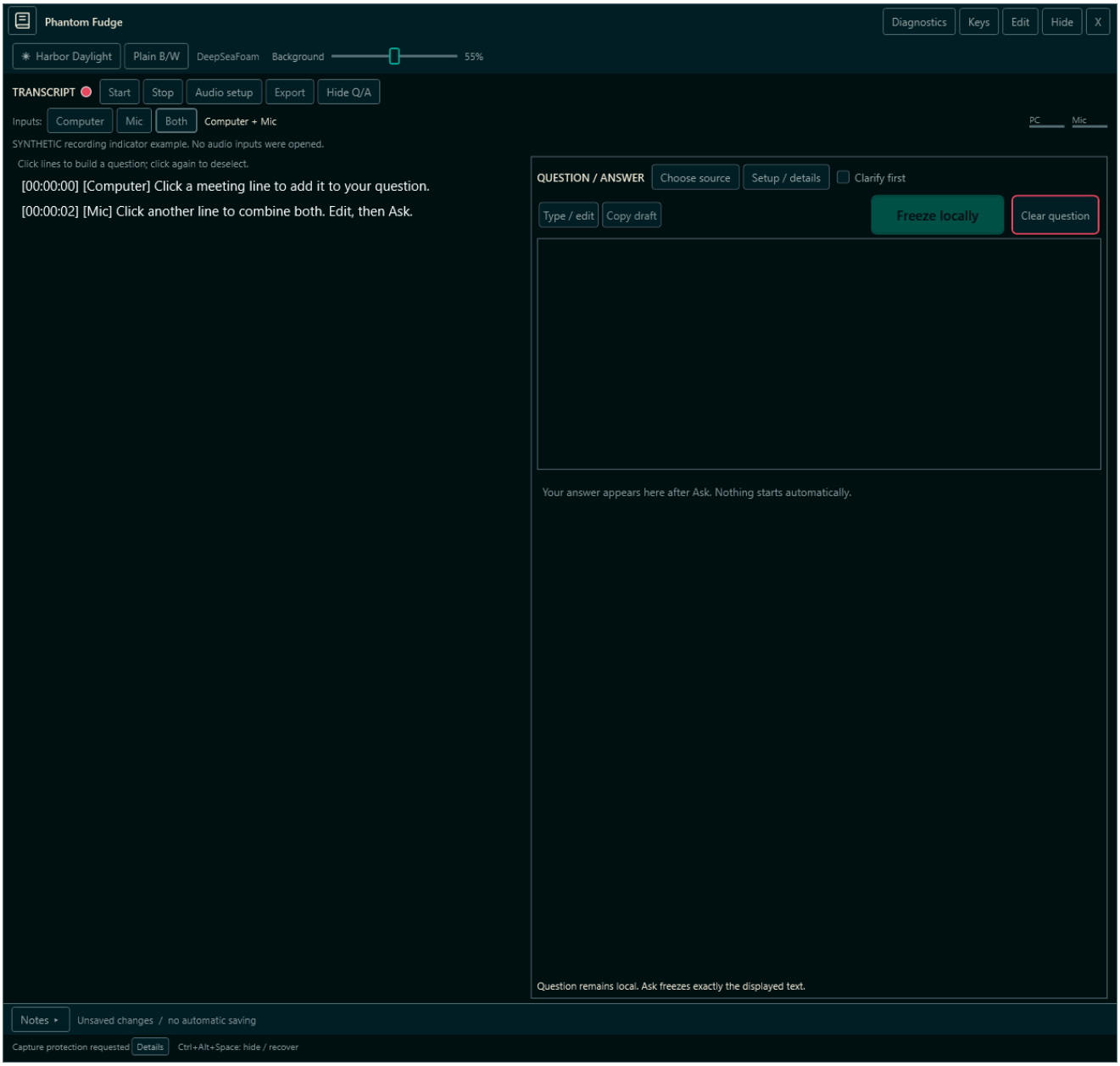

Choose the input mode, open **Audio setup**, then click the intended cards. The accent outline and filled dot identify the selected item. Computer should match the output carrying the meeting; Mic is the input used for your own dictation. **Done** or **Close setup** returns to the reading view.

There are **no device-list scrollbars**. Setup temporarily uses the reading area, with cards wrapping into rows. If a large catalogue or small window cannot show everything, Previous/Next buttons show another page without changing the selected endpoint. The page label identifies the selected card's page. Selection/paging are locked while capture is starting, running or stopping.
(src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.AudioDeviceCards.cs:39-65,96-159.)




The compact image intentionally uses23synthetic outputs and17microphones. It illustrates overflow, not the number of devices on your machine. Friendly names wrap; extremely constrained cards may ellipsize only the displayed name, not the stored name or endpoint ID. Empty lists have an explicit message. **Service setup** reveals the session-only token and existing guidance; missing-token Start opens it automatically. The normal launcher supplies the token, so manual entry is usually unnecessary. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.AudioDeviceCards.cs:80-140; src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.AudioDeviceCardsDiagnostics.cs:39-53,104-131; scripts/Run-PhantomFudge.ps1:43-57.)

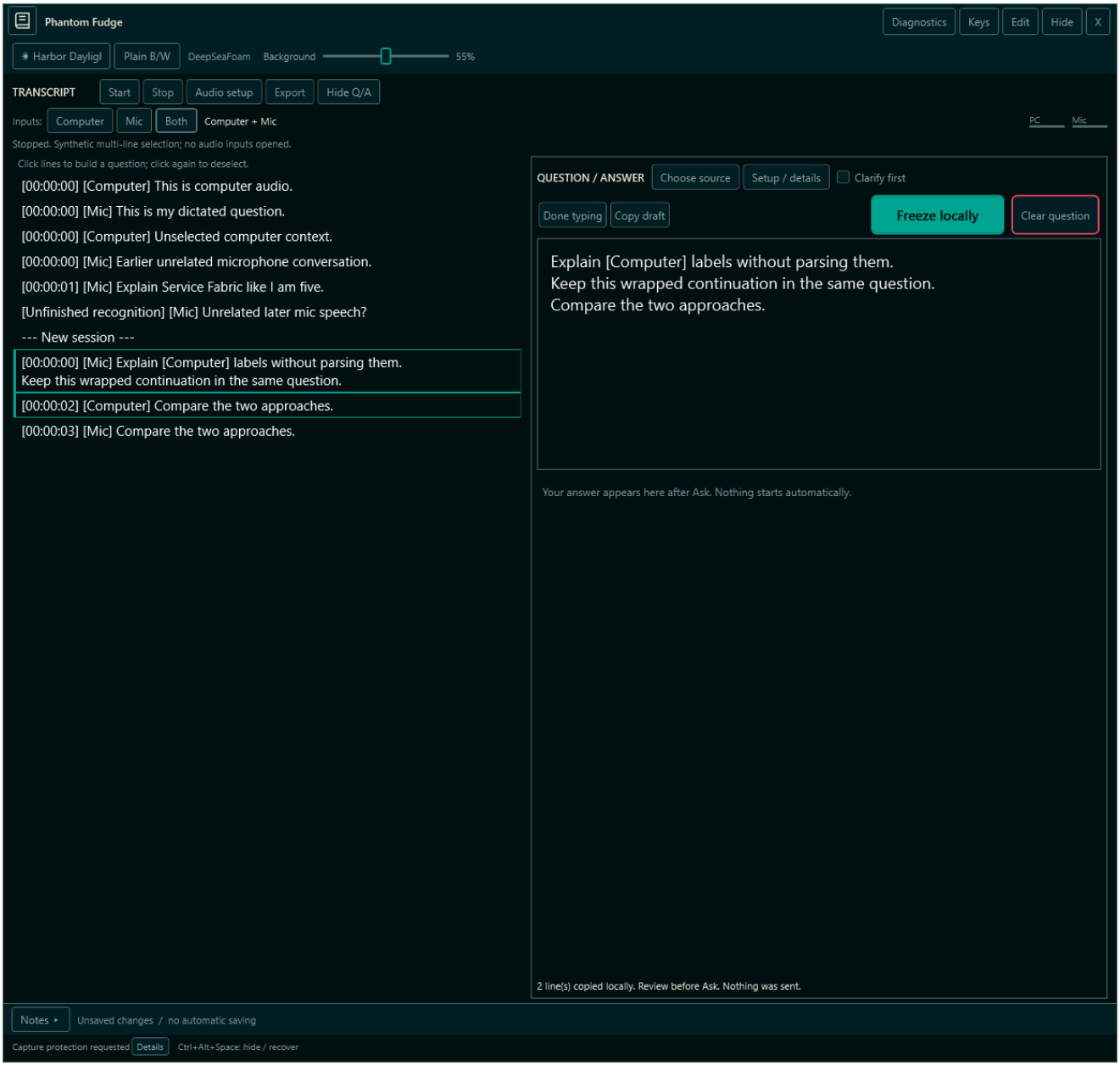
# 2. Start transcription and watch the red dot




Press **Start** only when ready to capture the selected inputs. **Both** is merely the initial mode selection; it is not automatic recording. A red dot beside **TRANSCRIPT** appears when the transcriber reports Running, not merely when the service is connecting or words happen to be visible. It indicates transcription, **not an audio file being saved**. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.RecordingIndicator.cs:7-10; src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/LoopbackTranscriber.cs:30-36,117-128.)

Computer and Mic keep separate labels, meters, partials and identities. Computer output can include other applications or sidetone; this is not meeting-process isolation or speaker diarization. Whisper finals can replace provisional guesses. Stop ends capture and drains accepted work, so a last final line can arrive after active capture has ended. The normal UI remains honest about recognition errors and failures. (src/PhantomFudge.Core/AudioSource.cs:3-30; src/PhantomFudge.Core/StructuredTranscriptStore.cs:37-100; src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/LoopbackTranscriber.cs:387-445.)

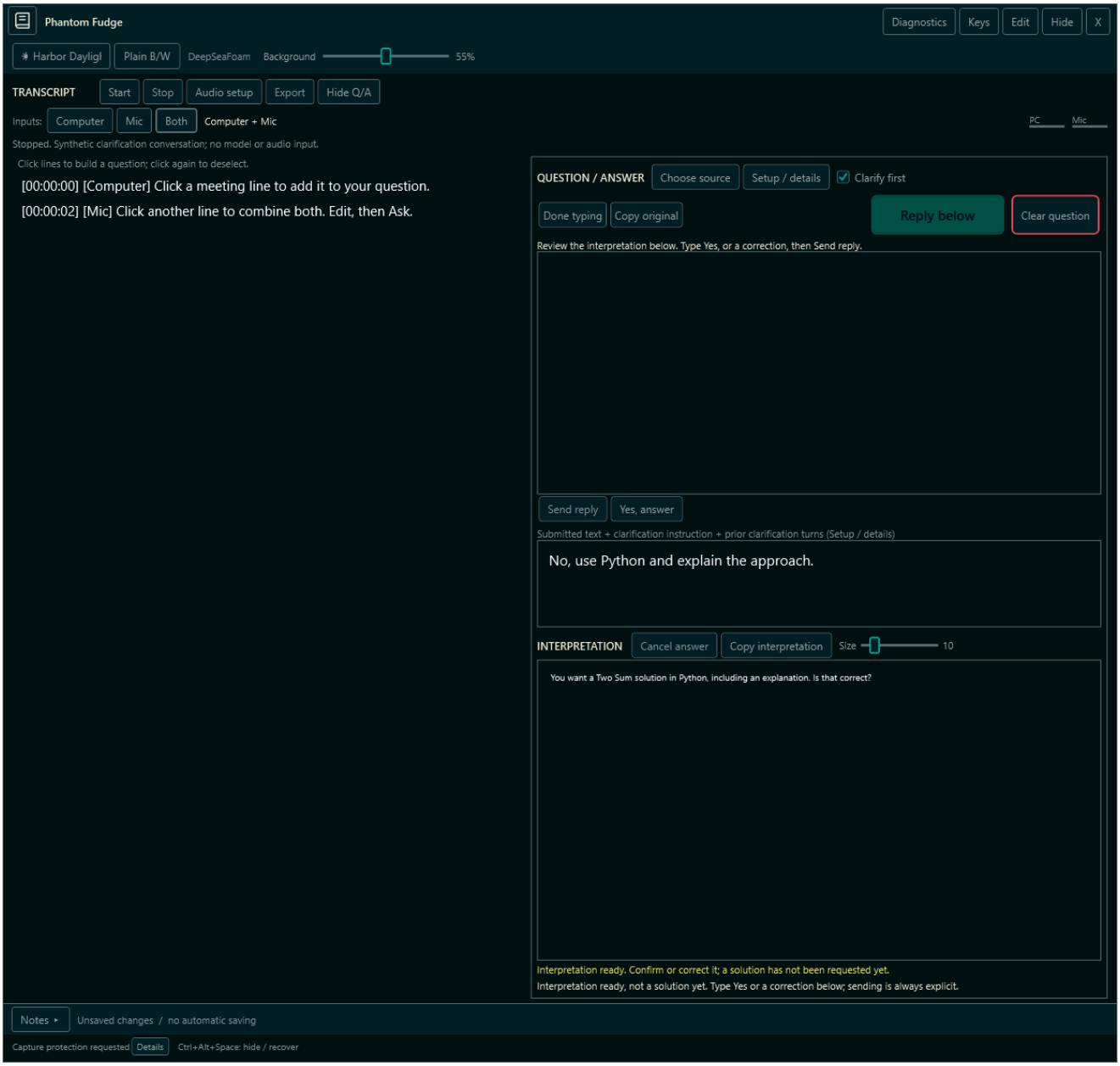
# 3. Select several transcript lines and review the question




Click one or more intended rows. Each click toggles a whole recognition segment; Ctrl is not required. The draft follows displayed history order rather than click order. A wrapped segment remains one selectable unit. Generated timestamps/source prefixes do not enter the question. Selecting rows opens the question editor and deliberately takes editing focus without stopping transcription or sending a request. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.TranscriptSelection.cs:85-147.)

After you manually edit the draft, further direct row changes are refused so a click cannot destroy your corrections. Copy anything needed, then use **Clear question** before starting a different direct selection. The manual **Choose source** → **Mic / Computer / All** → **Use selected** route remains an explicit replacement alternative, except while a clarification locks the original. One draft is limited to256selected entries from one capture session and8192UTF-16 units including inserted newlines. Invalid changes retain the existing text rather than truncating it. (src/PhantomFudge.Core/QuestionDraft.cs:8-45,48-79,105-125; src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Questions.cs:105-131.)

# 4. Optionally ask the model to clarify your intended question



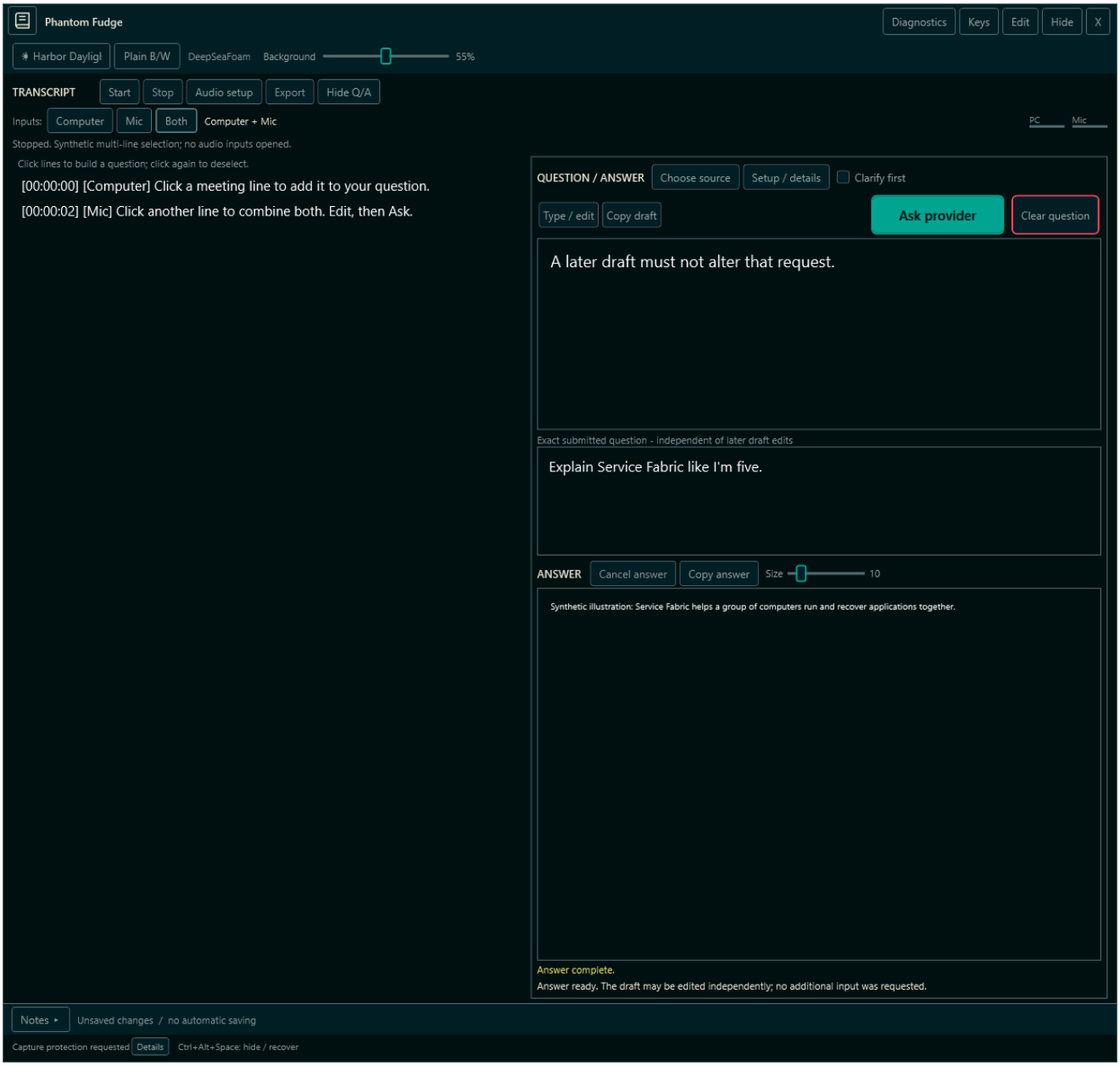

**Clarify first is off on launch.** With a provider configured, enable it and press **Interpret question** when the transcript captures the general subject but is cumbersome to correct. The model should restate the intended question rather than solve it yet. Your original draft stays separate from the reply field.

Type **Yes** and press **Send reply**, or click **Yes, answer**. To correct the proposed meaning, type that correction and press **Send reply** instead. `Yes, but use Python` is a correction, not automatic confirmation. Merely typing or receiving an interpretation never submits the next turn. The confirmation button does not discard a written correction. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Clarification.cs:11-44,85-155.)

Only completed interpretation exchanges enter history. There are at most four interpretations, 8192UTF-16 units per input/interpretation and32768total including the current reply. Turning the option off, clearing the question or changing provider resets the thread; a same-settings reload can retain it for explicit retry. Normal

Ask remains history-free. (src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AnswerClarification.cs:7-69; src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Clarification.cs:46-83,157-184.)

# 5. Ask, read, cancel or clear deliberately




The large accent-filled button is in the right-hand action group, followed by red-bordered **Clear question**. Type/edit and Copy stay on the left. In **Snapshot only**, the button says **Freeze locally** and sends nothing. With a configured provider, **Ask provider** freezes the exact reviewed text and starts that request. Only one answer runs at a time.

**Cancel answer** retains visible partial text as incomplete. **Clear question** clears the question, last displayed snapshot and answer, but does not erase notes or the transcript. It does not erase previously exported files or diagnostic/provider history. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Questions.cs:265-337; src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AnswerRun.cs:32-79.)

Installed Agency uses its existing model service; it is not inherently offline inference. A configured local-model endpoint is a separate option, and direct Azure remains future work. Preparation makes no question request. Older prepared-response timings are bounded historical measurements, not a promise for every question, cold start or clarification conversation. See provider setup and measured limits.

## 6. Cover the workspace without pausing it



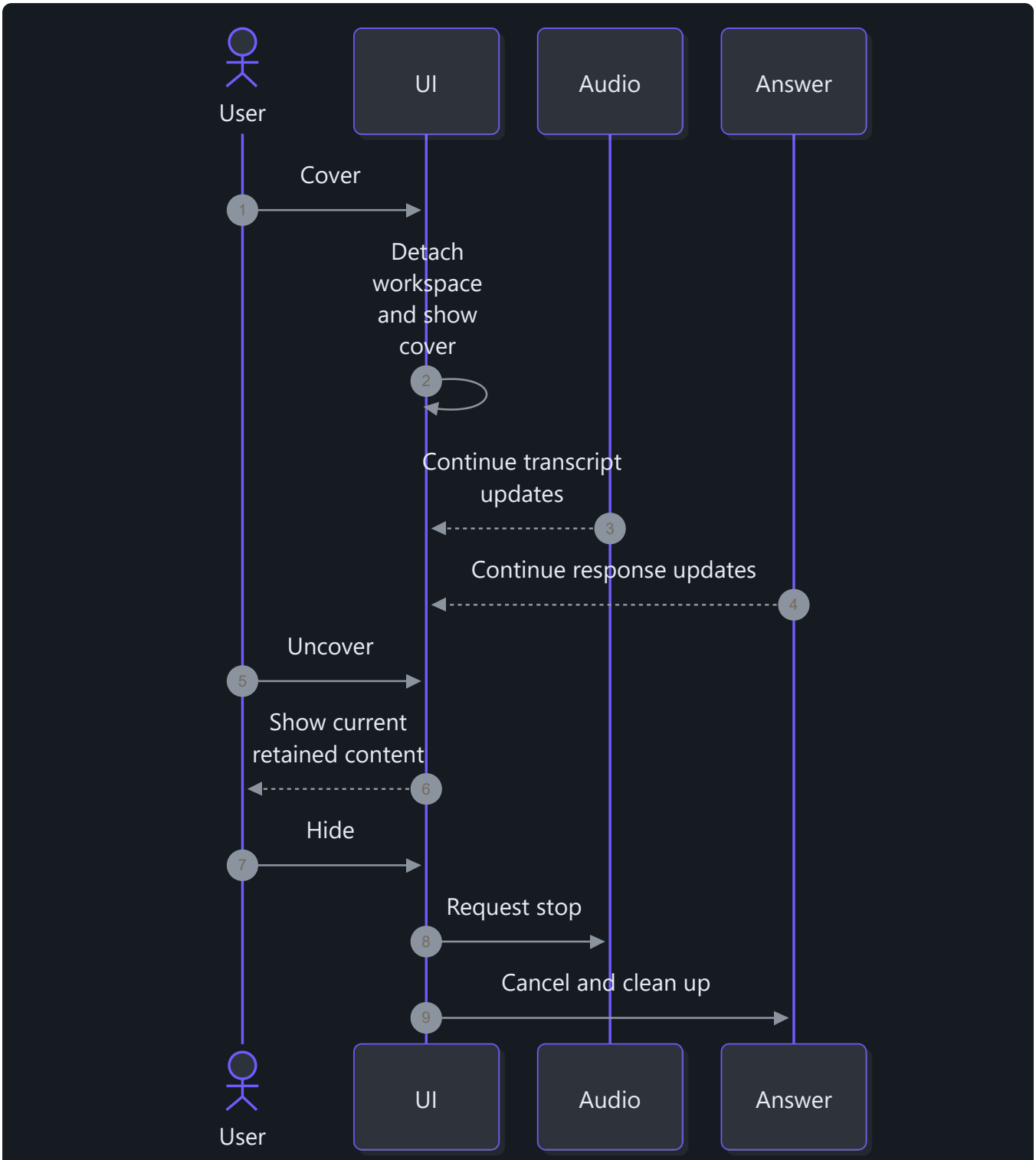

Click the **top-left book icon**. Only **NOTEPAD IS READY** and the same icon remain. Transcription and answers already running continue behind it; no new capture or request is created. Uncover restores current results and the retained workspace. The recording dot is behind the cover, so its absence is not a stopped indicator. File/confirmation operations block covering rather than hiding a required decision. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Cover.cs:22-77.)

The cover disables/detaches the workspace and refreshes the window peer's current children. Fresh in-process accessibility traversal excludes the covered fields, but an already-retained typed value provider **still read the synthetic question**. Process identity, memory, OS microphone indicators, cached data, saved files and provider retention remain independent. Existing display affinity and the Peek-prevention request are limited Windows mechanisms, not global invisibility. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.CoverDiagnostics.cs:68-88; complete privacy matrix.)

# State changes: Cover is not Hide

| Action | Transcription | Current answer |
|---|---|---|
| Cover / Uncover | Continues | Continues; hidden text is not logged as visibly presented |
| Stop | Stops and drains accepted audio | Separate request continues |
| Cancel answer | Unchanged | Cancels; partial result remains incomplete |
| Hide or global Edit/Present | Stops | Cancels/cleans up |
| Hide Q/A, open Audio setup, or expand Notes | Audio is unchanged | Closing Q/A cancels its answer/provider activity |
| Type/edit the question | Continues | Existing frozen request stays independent |
| Ordinary keyboard modes / Escape | Continues | Continues; no implicit cancellation |
| Compact selection/reading layout | Continues | Temporary panel hiding preserves state; not Hide Q/A or cancellation |
| `:devices` | Refused while starting/running/stopping | Refused while answer busy; when allowed, setup closes Q/A/provider activity |
| Clear question | Unchanged | Cancels/clears question and answer state |
| Exit | Stops before preservation checks | Cancels/cleans up; unsaved content still requires a decision |

These differences follow the actual separate handlers. In particular, opening setup is not the same continuation path as Cover. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Questions.cs:40-61,158-208,327-337; src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.AudioDeviceCards.cs:39-49; src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.AnswerLifetime.cs:10-17; `StopTranscriptionAsync`, `ToggleVisibility`, `RequestActionAsync`.) The keyboard setup command adds an explicit busy guard before the same setup path; it is not an ordinary mode switch. `:start` is explicit capture, `:stop` is audio-only, and `:cancel` is answer/preparation-only. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Keyboard.cs:87-125,320-358.)




Current Workflow: An Illustrated Guide - diagram 2. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

# Current sizes, themes and visible status

| Reading surface | Current WPF font size | Change |
|---|---|---|
| Final transcript | 15 | 25%smaller than20 |
| Live partial | 13.5normal /10.5compact | 25%smaller than18/14 |

| Reading surface | Current WPF font size | Change |
|---|---|---|
| Answer and interpretation | 10 normal /9 compact until chosen;8–24 choice | Size slider / `:font` / Read `+` / `-`; session-only |
| Question and clarification reply | 18 | Unchanged by those reductions |
| Device card name | 12 | Independent of transcript/answer typography |

These are WPF logical units, not a guarantee of exact rasterized pixel height at every DPI. Reading text stays opaque white in DeepSeaFoam and black in light/plain themes. The Background slider affects the reading backdrop, not whole-window text opacity; its default is55%, range10–100%. Long text retains its own scrollbar, while the main panels and device choices avoid nested scrolling. (Current declarations; src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Layout.cs:58-110; src/PhantomFudge.Core/ThemePalette.cs:11-29.) The answer-size choice takes precedence over those responsive defaults across resize, but is not written to disk. See answer size. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.AnswerFont.cs:9-43.) At narrow, short sizes, Select/Search temporarily give the reading area to the transcript and restore Q/A when selection ends. Other keyboard modes prioritize expanded Q/A; a chosen size 14+ with a visible answer does so even outside keyboard control. This is reversible panel visibility, not data loss or audio/provider shutdown; wide columns remain unchanged. See compact-window behavior.

# Launch, diagnostics and preservation

On an already-provisioned source checkout, save/copy needed content, close an older instance with **X**, then run:

```
.\scripts\Run-PhantomFudge.ps1
```

Relaunch normally reveals an existing instance instead of replacing its loaded code. A fresh machine or extracted bundle needs its own prerequisites/model setup; do not reuse another workspace's token or kill its service. Follow the setup guide. The older045022ZIP does not contain these later source changes. (scripts/Run-PhantomFudge.ps1:17-57.)

There is no note/transcript autosave or crash recovery. Save notes and export transcripts explicitly. Default diagnostics contain metadata, not conversation bodies; Text mode is a separate local opt-in. Clear and Cover do not erase existing logs. Use **Diagnostics**, `Show-Diagnostics.ps1` or `Export-Diagnostics.ps1` for local investigation, with no automatic upload. (src/PhantomFudge.Core/Diagnostics/LocalDiagnostics.cs:145-184; diagnostic guide.)

# References

Setup · Question selection · Keyboard controls and answer size · Clarification · Providers · Cover/privacy · Current evidence · Annotated source

Source: docs/KEYBOARD-CONTROLS.md

# Keyboard controls and answer size

## Start here: control the workspace, not the system pointer

Keyboard control lets you compose a question without moving the mouse across the workspace. **Ctrl+Alt+K** deliberately brings Phantom Fudge into **Control** mode; the **Keys** button is the pointer fallback. Letters such as `v`, `j` and `m` are local mode keys, not global shortcuts. This feature does **not** lock, hide or warp the cursor, and it cannot repair a recorder's captured-cursor behavior. Activation uncovers the workspace but does not start audio or send a question. (`ToggleKeyboardControl`, `HandleKeyboardKey`; src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Keyboard.cs:65-85,218-266.)

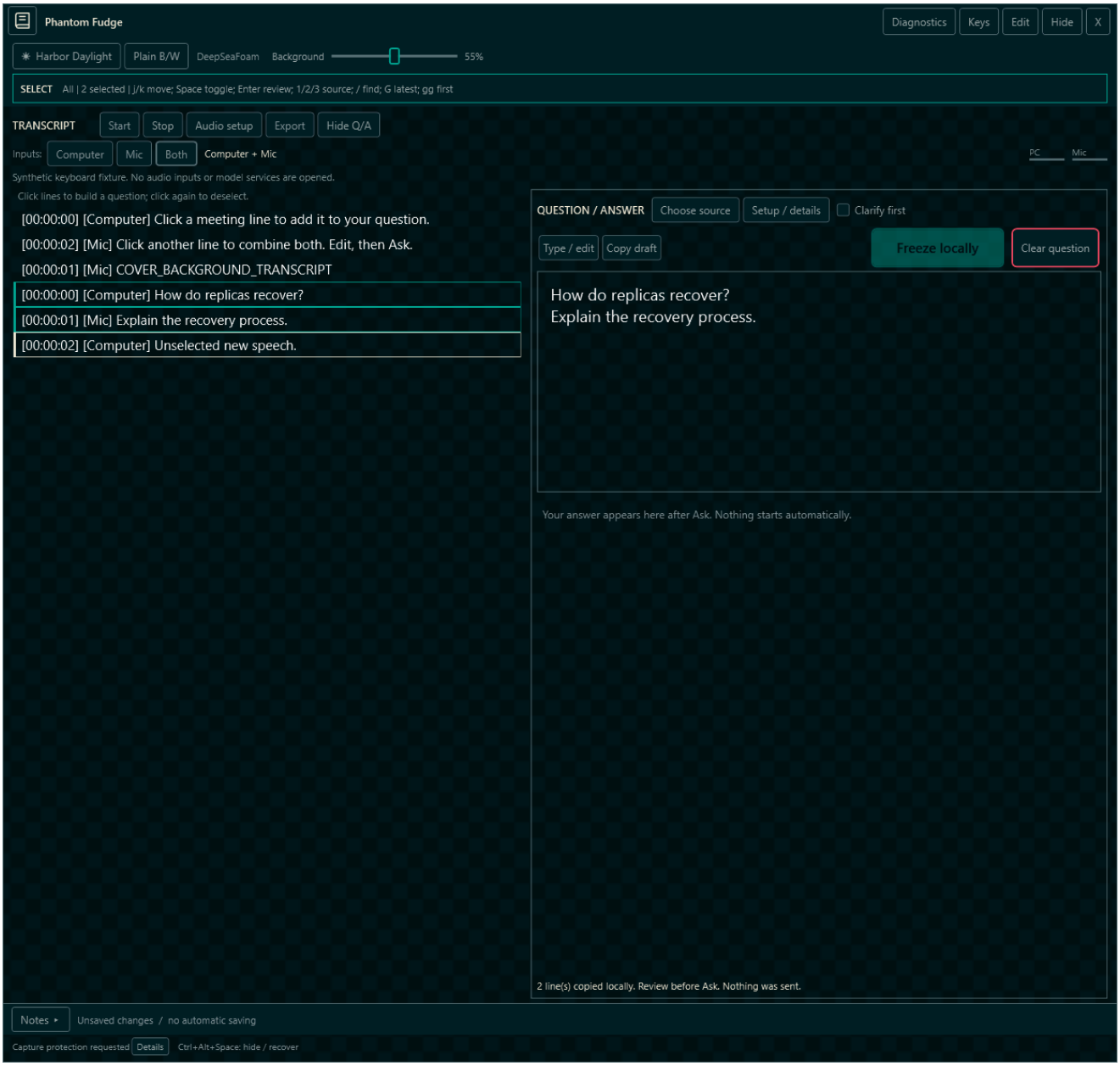
**Implemented in current source.** Save/copy needed text, close an older instance with X, then run `.\scripts\Run-PhantomFudge.ps1`. The older preview ZIP does not contain these controls. The final synthetic UI fixture passed 38 keyboard assertions plus existing regressions; 297 Core and 18 documentation-tool tests passed. The source atlas and illustrated handbook are refreshed. The three images below are synthetic WPF examples, not personal captures or real audio/model results. See workstream57 and implementation status for evidence and qualification boundaries.

## Beginner workflow: select, review, then submit

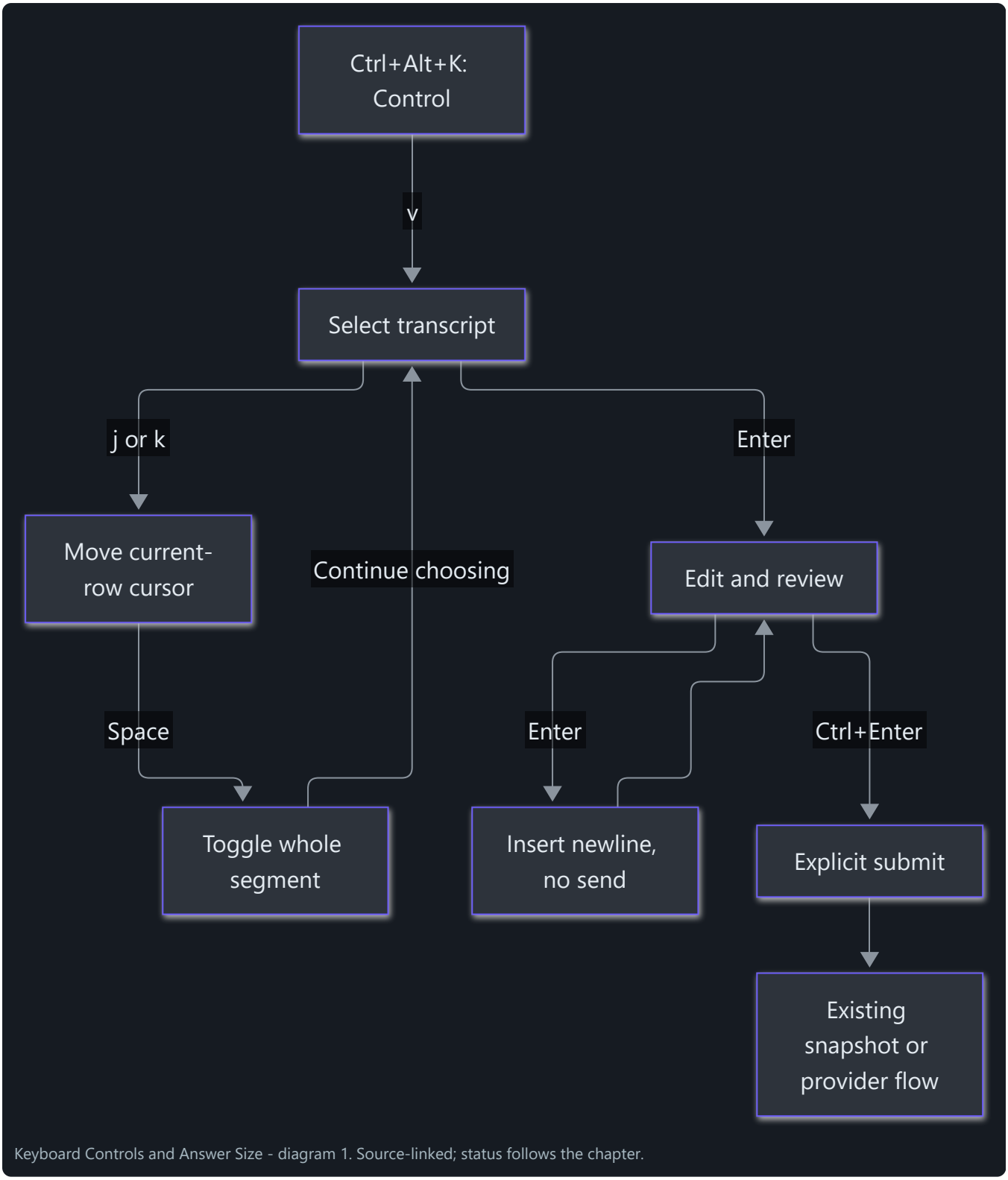
Start with transcript text already available. If you need new transcription, choose inputs first and explicitly use Start or `:start`; keyboard activation alone never records. Configure an answer provider before expecting an answer; Snapshot only freezes locally. The keyboard dispatcher reuses the existing Start and Ask handlers rather than introducing an automatic capture or send path. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Keyboard.cs:301-306,330-358.)

1. **Ctrl+Alt+K** → **Control**. Check the visible mode label.
2. `v` → **Select**. The navigation cursor starts at the latest matching row.
3. `j` / `k` move down/up. Movement alone does not select text.
4. **Space** toggles the current whole transcript segment. Repeat movement and Space for more lines.
5. **Enter** → **Edit question** to review. This does **not** submit.
6. Correct the wording if needed. **Enter inserts a newline** in Edit.
7. **Ctrl+Enter** explicitly submits the reviewed question, or the current clarification reply. In Snapshot only this remains local; with a ready provider it uses the existing Ask flow.

The essential sequence is **Ctrl+Alt+K** → `v` → `j` / `k` → **Space** → **Enter review** → **Ctrl+Enter submit**. Ctrl+Enter in Select is refused with a review reminder. That separation keeps navigating a moving transcript from accidentally sending it. (`BeginKeyboardSelection`, `HandleKeyboardSelectionKey`, `SubmitKeyboardQuestion`; src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.KeyboardSelection.cs:15-28,110-159; src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Keyboard.cs:257-266,301-306.)




*Wide-layout synthetic example: two accent-outlined selected rows compose the draft; the pale current-row outline is on a different, unselected row. Moving the cursor is not selecting or sending.*




Keyboard Controls and Answer Size - diagram 1. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

# Modes, literal editing and leaving safely

| Mode | Keys and behavior |
| --- | --- |
| Control | `v` Select, `i` Edit question/reply, `a` Read answer, `m` Mask, `:` /F2 Commands, `?` /F1 Help |
| Select | `j` / `k` or Down/Up move; Space toggles; Enter reviews; source filters and search below |
| Edit question / Edit reply | Type normally, including `j`, `k`, `v`, `:`, `/` and `?`; Enter is a newline; Ctrl+Enter submits |

| Mode | Keys and behavior |
|---|---|
| Read | `j` / `k` or Down/Up scroll the answer; PageUp/PageDown page; Home/End jump; `+` / `-` adjust answer size |
| Command | Type a built-in command; Tab completes the first matching example; Enter validates/executes |
| Search | Type a local transcript substring; Enter applies it; Escape returns to Select |
| Devices | Arrows move, Space selects, Tab changes source in Both, bracket/page keys change page |
| Help | Shows the local key and command summary; Escape returns to Control |

**Modal means the label matters.** Edit passes ordinary typing to the question/reply editor; it is not global Notes Edit. To run a command while typing, press Escape first, then F2. Function-key alternatives are **F2 for `:`**, **F3 for `/` in Select only**, and **F1 for `?`** outside literal Edit/prompts. The punctuation shortcuts use US OEM key positions; other layouts should prefer these alternatives. They are not universal character-layout mappings. (`UpdateKeyboardBar`, `HandleKeyboardKey`; src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Keyboard.cs:177-299; src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.KeyboardSelection.cs:110-125.)

**Edit stays armed after Ctrl+Enter submission.** A completed asynchronous interpretation changes the mode label to **EDIT REPLY** and targets the reply editor; returning to the original-question state changes it back to **EDIT QUESTION**. You do not need to leave and re-enter Edit between these states. The target must be visible, enabled, focusable and editable. Async focus retargeting occurs only while Phantom Fudge is already the active foreground window, visible, uncovered and protection-ready; it does not activate another window or pull you back from another app. Typing and model completion still do not submit a new turn. To read with `j` / `k` after submitting, use Escape → `a`, rather than typing those letters into Edit. (`RefreshKeyboardEditorTarget`, `SubmitKeyboardQuestion`; src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Keyboard.cs:127-139,257-266,301-306.)

**Escape backs out rather than cancelling work:** ordinary submode → Control → leave keyboard control. Search first returns to Select; Command returns to the mode from which it was opened. Devices also closes setup. Leaving attempts to return foreground focus to the previously active application, after checking its window/process identity. Windows may refuse, or that window may have closed: switch back manually if the status says so. This is **best effort**, not a focus guarantee. Pressing Ctrl+Alt+K again also leaves; switching to another application disarms without pulling focus back. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Keyboard.cs:141-175,198-204,222-232.)

From Control, `m` leaves keyboard control and masks the workspace. From other modes, return to Control first or use `:mask` through Command. Already-running transcription and answers continue behind the mask. Ctrl+Alt+K uncovers and enters Control again. Neither masking nor Escape is an audio Stop or answer Cancel. Read the separate cover/privacy limits; the mask is not process hiding or universal capture protection. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Keyboard.cs:67-85,290-296,364-368.)

# Select: source filters, search and stable intent

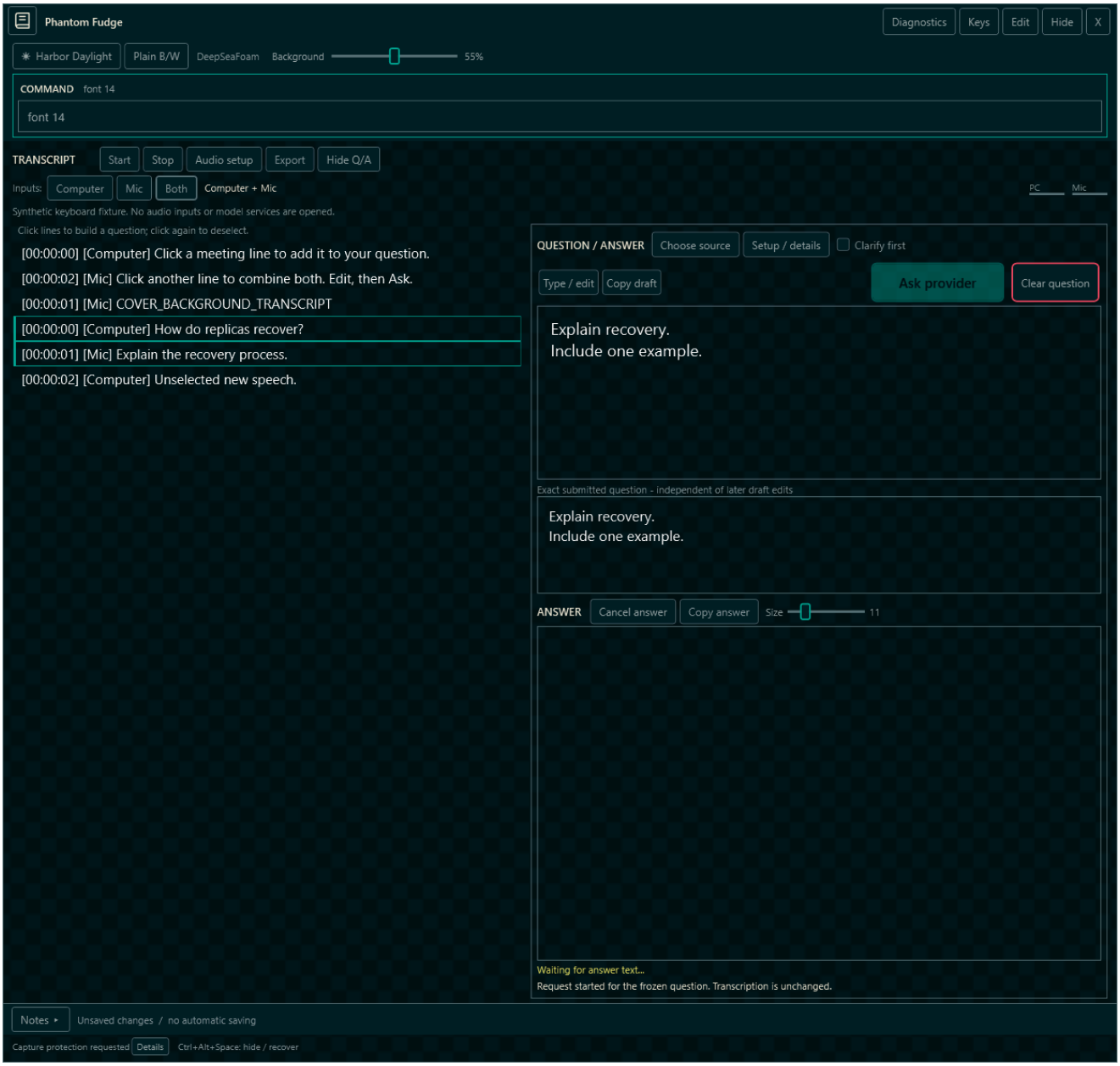
| Key in Select | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `1` / `2` / `3` | Show Mic / Computer / all sources; this is a view filter, not an audio-input change |
| `/` or F3 | Open case-insensitive substring search over raw segment text |

| Key in Select | Meaning |
| --- | --- |
| Enter in Search | Apply the filter locally; an empty search clears it |
| `G` (Shift+G) / End | Move to the last matching row |
| `gg` (two lowercase presses) / Home | Move to the first matching row |
| PageDown / PageUp | Move five matching rows down/up |
| Space | Toggle the current segment; holding Space does not repeatedly toggle |

Filters do **not** deselect previously chosen rows. Check the selected count and review the whole draft, including selections currently outside the filter. Leaving Select removes its view filters. The cursor follows structured segment identity rather than parsing a displayed timestamp. After a manual draft edit, `v`/Space refuse new selection until you deliberately clear the question; copy needed corrections before `:clear question`. Clarification can also lock selection. (`CanKeyboardSelect`, `MatchesKeyboardTranscript`, `ResetKeyboardSelectionView`; src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.KeyboardSelection.cs:30-79,98-159.)

# Built-in commands: deterministic, not a shell or model

Press **F2** (or `:` outside Edit), type a command, then Enter. The prompt accepts an optional leading colon, ignores case and normalizes whitespace. It recognizes only the finite list below; it does not run shell text or ask a model to interpret a command. Suggestions follow the fixed example list in source, and Tab chooses its first prefix match—not a fuzzy or model-generated guess. Unknown commands/arguments stay in the prompt with an error; input is bounded to 128 characters. (`Parse`, `Suggest`, `Tokenize`; src/PhantomFudge.Core/KeyboardCommands.cs:15-79; src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Keyboard.cs:206-256,308-318.)




*The prompt shows `font 14` before execution, while Size still reads11. Enter applies the command; typing it alone does not change the answer.*

| Command | Effect and boundary |
| --- | --- |
| `:start` / `:record start` | Explicitly request capture using the selected sources and existing readiness checks |
| `:stop` / `:record stop` | Stop/drain audio; do not cancel the separate answer |
| `:source mic`, `:source computer`, `:source both` | Choose input mode while audio is idle; never start capture |
| `:devices` | Refuse while audio is starting/running/stopping or an answer is busy; otherwise open device setup and close Q/A |
| `:clarify on`, `:clarify off` | Change optional clarification while no answer is busy; retain existing clarification guards |
| `:confirm` | Invoke the existing explicit clarification confirmation action; not an automatic Yes |
| `:font 8` through `:font 24` | Choose a whole-number answer/interpretation size for this session |

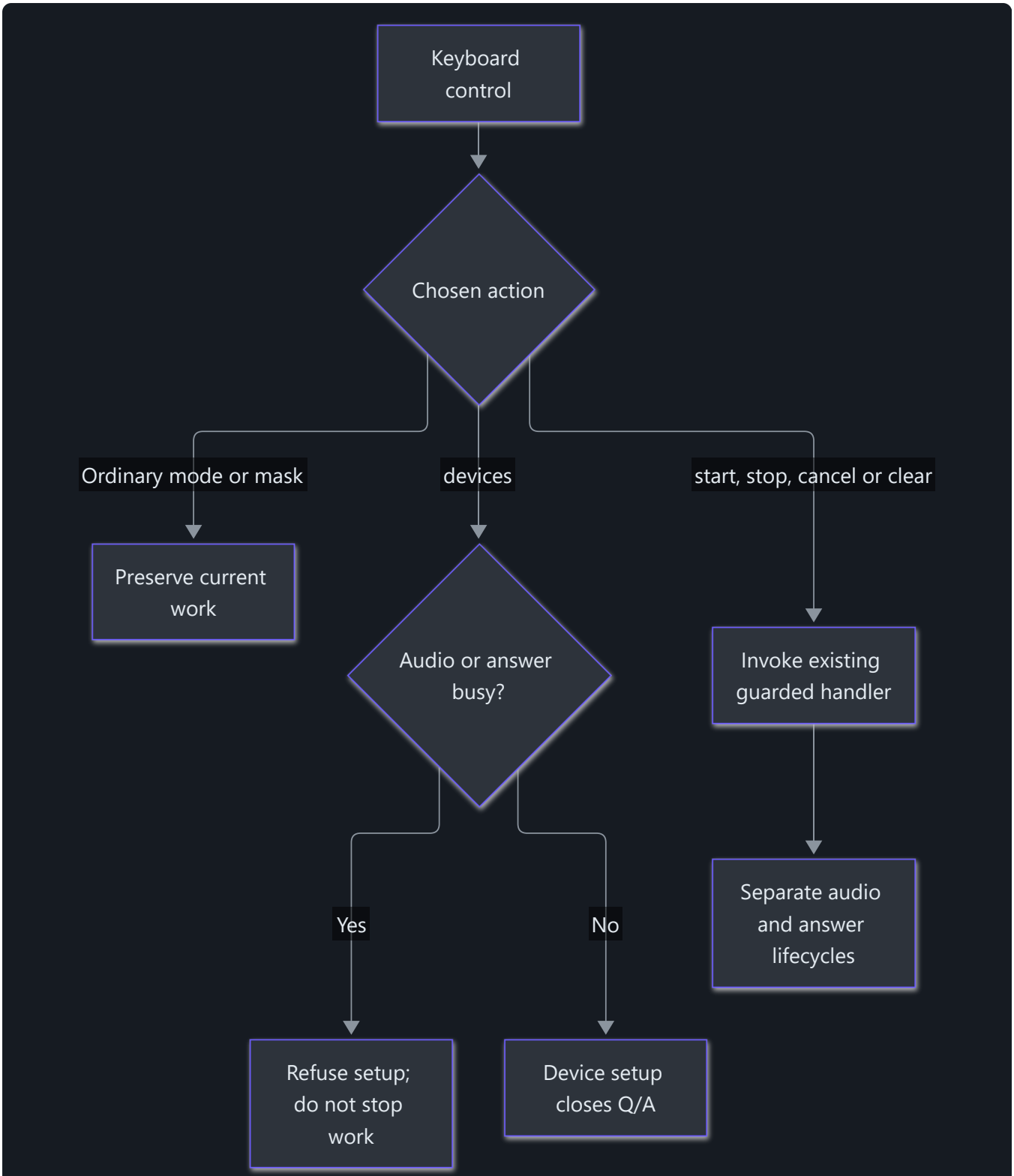
| Command | Effect and boundary |
| --- | --- |
| `:copy question`, `:copy answer` | Use the existing explicit clipboard actions; these are not a send |
| `:clear question` | Clear question/snapshot/answer through the existing handler; it can cancel an active answer, but does not stop audio |
| `:cancel` | Cancel answer/provider preparation only; never an audio Stop |
| `:theme dark`, `:theme light`, `:theme plain` | Select DeepSeaFoam, Harbor Daylight or Plain |
| `:opacity 10` through `:opacity 100` | Choose whole-percent background opacity, not whole-window text opacity |
| `:ask` | Explicitly submit the current question or clarification reply through the same guarded handler |
| `:mask` | Disarm keyboard control and cover the workspace without stopping current work |
| `:help` | Show the local keyboard help |

File/confirmation activity, missing protection or another executing command can reject a command. The dispatcher delegates to existing actions: success is governed by their status, not merely by valid syntax. Opening Command from Select and explicitly issuing `:ask` is still an explicit submission; the beginner Enter-review path is the recommended way to inspect the draft first. (`ExecuteKeyboardCommandAsync`; src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Keyboard.cs:320-362; src/PhantomFudge.Core/KeyboardCommands.cs:26-55.)

# Devices: browse before choosing

Use `:source both` (or a single source), then `:devices` **while idle**. Left/Right move one card; Up/Down or `k` / `j` move by the displayed column count. **Space** chooses the highlighted device. **Tab** switches Computer/Mic only in Both mode. `[` **/** `]` **or PageUp/PageDown** move a page; merely browsing never changes the chosen endpoint or starts recording. Escape closes setup and returns to Control. Use explicit `:start` only after checking the selection. (`BeginKeyboardDevices`, `HandleKeyboardDeviceKey`; src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.KeyboardDevices.cs:12-17,27-71.)

**Setup is the exception to ordinary mode preservation.** `:devices` refuses busy audio/answers instead of silently stopping them. When allowed, opening Audio setup closes Q/A and follows its existing provider-cleanup behavior; it can therefore end idle provider preparation. Ordinary Control/Select/Edit/Read/Command/Help transitions do not invoke Q/A close/cancel or intentionally cancel capture/provider work. A compact layout may temporarily hide a panel to make room; that is not closing it. Start/Stop/Cancel/Clear remain separate explicit actions. (`SetKeyboardMode`, `ExecuteKeyboardCommandAsync`; src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Keyboard.cs:87-125,330-358; integrated lifecycle table.)




Keyboard Controls and Answer Size - diagram 2. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

## Answer size: session choice, not a saved preference

Use the answer's **Size** slider, `:font 14`, or `+` / `-` **in Read mode**. Whole-number sizes range from **8–24 WPF logical units**, applying to answers and interpretations, not transcript, question or Notes fonts. Until you choose, the responsive defaults remain **10 normal / 9 compact**. Once chosen, that value survives resizing in this running instance. It is **not saved across restart** and is not a property in `keyboard.json`.

`chosenAnswerFontSize ?? automaticSize` is why a resize no longer overwrites an explicit choice. (`SetAnswerFontSize`, `ApplyAnswerFontSize`, `AdjustAnswerFont`; src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.AnswerFont.cs:9-43; src/PhantomFudge.Core/KeyboardCommands.cs:15-16; src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Keyboard.cs:274-286.)

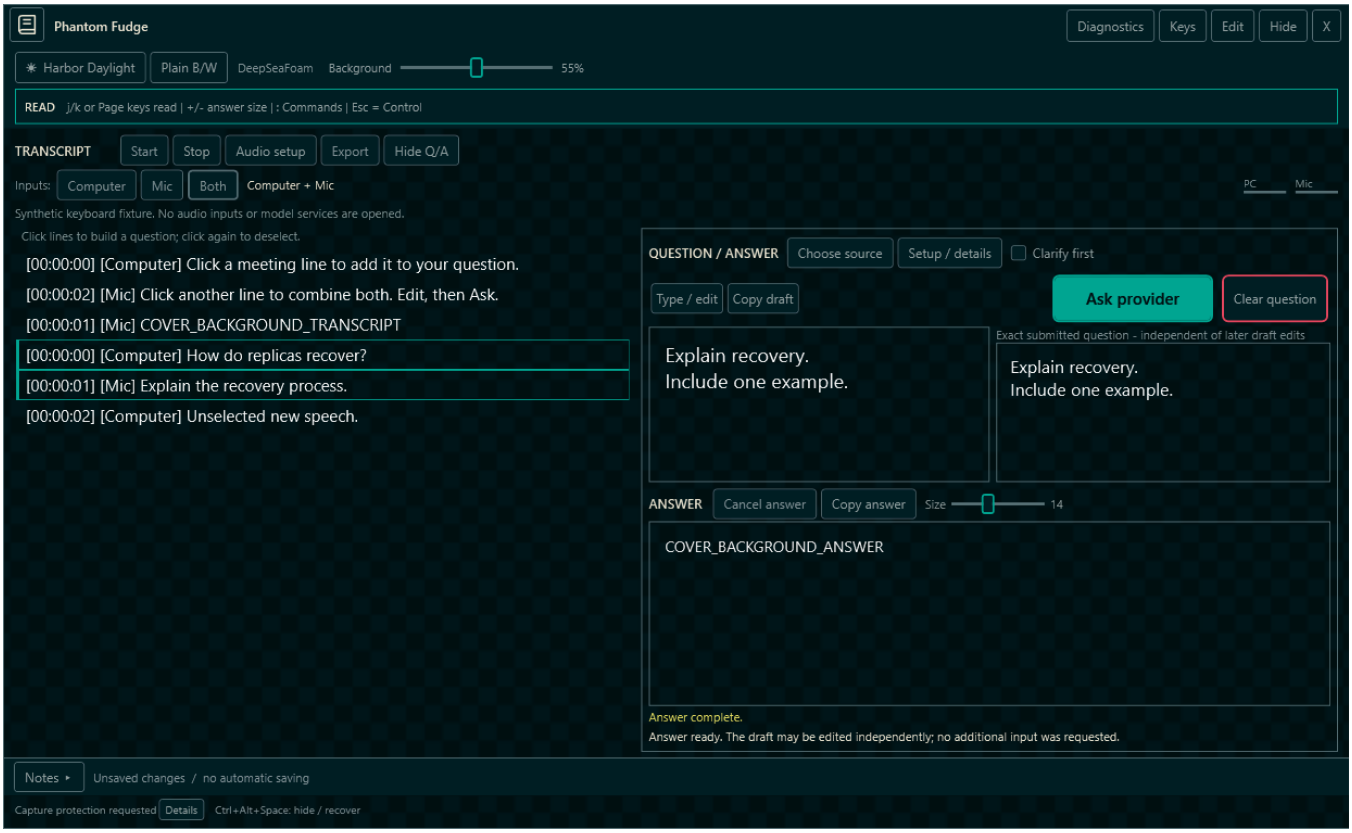
## Compact windows: the active task gets the reading space

At narrow, short sizes such as **470 × 560**, keeping a size 24 answer and every panel visible can leave too little usable reading space. The responsive layout therefore changes which panel is visible, not its content or lifetime:

| Compact situation | What you see |
|---|---|
| Select or Search | Q/A is temporarily hidden; transcript selection uses the reading area |
| Leaving Select/Search | The intended Q/A-expanded state is restored without calling close/cancel |
| Other keyboard modes, with Q/A expanded | Q/A takes priority and the transcript is temporarily hidden |
| A chosen size of 14 or larger with an answer visible and Q/A expanded | Q/A takes priority even outside keyboard control |
| Wide reading columns | The existing side-by-side layout remains unchanged |

The layout remembers the desired Q/A expansion separately from temporary visibility. No question, answer or transcript is discarded, and these layout changes do not stop audio or provider work. **Enter to review** therefore brings Q/A back after compact selection; it does not reopen a cancelled request. Explicit **Hide Q/A** and `:devices` retain their distinct close/cleanup behavior. Mode changes and font choices both request a responsive layout update. (`SetKeyboardMode`, `SetAnswerFontSize`; src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Keyboard.cs:87-125; src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.AnswerFont.cs:19-26.)

This refinement addresses size 24 at the minimum window. The final exporter reports the compact selection and passive size 24 fit assertions passed; it does not establish comfort at every DPI or replace owner review.




*Read mode with Size14.* `COVER_BACKGROUND_ANSWER` *is synthetic fixture text, not a real model result.*

# Shortcut configuration and recovery

The optional file is `%LOCALAPPDATA%\PhantomFudge\keyboard.json`. Save valid UTF-8 containing exactly these three case-sensitive properties:

```
{
  "schemaVersion": 1,
  "enabled": true,
  "activationKey": "K"
}
```

- Missing file/directory uses the default **Ctrl+Alt+K**.
- `activationKey` accepts **A–Z except E**, or **F1–F11** (case-insensitive key names). **E is reserved for Notes Edit; F12 is reserved/rejected.**
- **Ctrl+Alt+NoRepeat is fixed**, not configurable. No bare-letter or Windows-key global binding is offered. The setting changes only keyboard-control activation, not existing Hide/Notes keys.
- Set `enabled` to `false` to disable this global shortcut; keep the other valid fields.
- **Restart the app** after editing this file. It is loaded during initialization, not live-reloaded.
- Unknown/duplicate/missing properties, wrong types/schema, invalid keys, malformed UTF-8/JSON or files exceeding 1024 bytes are rejected. An invalid/unreadable file disables the global shortcut and reports a notice; it does not silently replace your request with another binding.

- A Windows registration conflict also reports a notice. **The Keys button still works** in both failure cases. If the workspace is masked, uncover with the book icon first. Existing reveal/second-launch recovery remains described in the preview guide.

The strict schema prevents a typo from silently changing input behavior. The loader validates the key even when disabled; the UI separately handles file errors and native registration conflicts. (`ResolveVirtualKey`, `Load`, `LoadKeyboardShortcut`, `RegisterKeyboardControlHotkey`; src/PhantomFudge.Core/KeyboardShortcutConfiguration.cs:7-28,31-114; src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Keyboard.cs:30-63.)

**Review correction:** `LoadKeyboardShortcut` now catches `InvalidDataException` as well as the other listed file/JSON/argument errors, disabling only the global shortcut. The final synthetic fixture covers this fallback; real Windows shortcut collisions still need separate observation. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Keyboard.cs:38-63; src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.KeyboardDiagnostics.cs:21-28.)

# Source map and validation boundary

These are implementation entry points, **not passing-test receipts**. Real shortcut conflicts, cross-application foreground return, non-US layouts, accessibility and recipient cursor/capture behavior still need their own observations. The new synthetic diagnostic declares a narrower routing/style boundary; defining those checks does not mean they ran successfully. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.KeyboardDiagnostics.cs:16-18,209-214.)

The final async Edit checks allow the normal dispatcher turn after answer completion before checking the target; they do not force a mode reset to make the reply/original transition work. This verifies the synthetic target/label behavior, not cross-application focus comfort or external hotkey return. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.KeyboardDiagnostics.cs:170-193.)

| Source | Read for |
|---|---|
| MainWindow.Keyboard.cs | Activation, focus return, modal routing and command dispatch |
| MainWindow.KeyboardSelection.cs | Cursor versus selection, filters/search, review and edited-draft guards |
| MainWindow.KeyboardDevices.cs | Card movement, explicit selection and paging |
| MainWindow.AnswerFont.cs | Chosen session size versus automatic responsive size |
| KeyboardCommands.cs | Complete typed grammar, argument bounds and deterministic suggestions |
| KeyboardShortcutConfiguration.cs | Exact JSON schema, UTF-8/size checks and supported activation keys |
| MainWindow.KeyboardDiagnostics.cs | Synthetic assertions and the three illustration outputs |

Full illustrated workflow · Setup/recovery · Clarification · Cover/privacy

# Product boundaries and decisions

> **TL;DR:** Scope changes are not embarrassing historical debris; they are design inputs. The important discipline is to record what superseded what, update the affected contracts, and avoid treating an earlier assumption as a permanent requirement.

## Overview: from a private notepad to a conversation companion

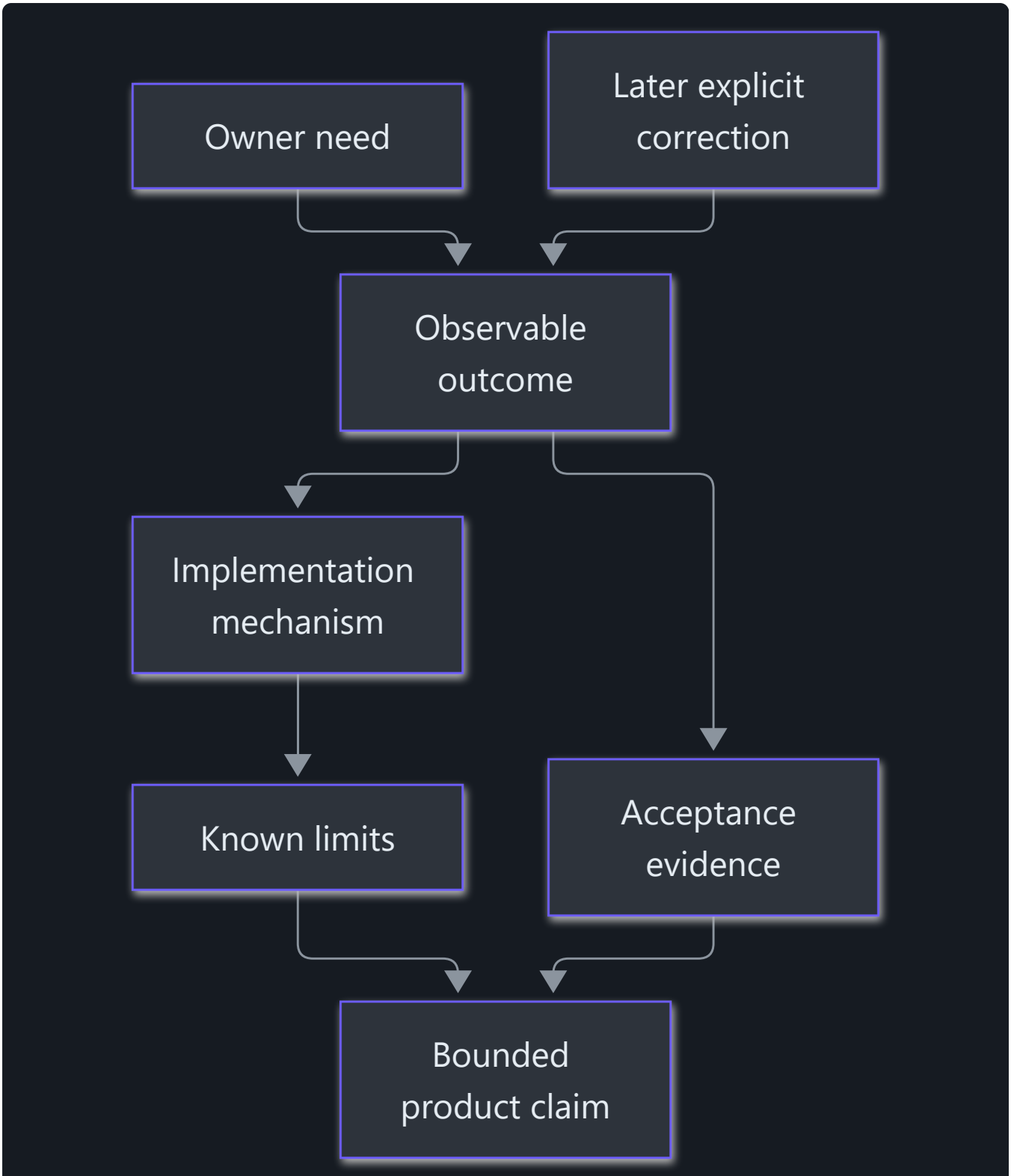
The initial request was a draggable speaker-notes window that would not appear in a screen share. The useful part of that request is implementable on supported Windows capture paths. The absolute version—no software can ever detect or record the surface—is not. The product contract therefore separates plain-text editing, movement, shell presentation, captured pixels, platform support and actual product qualification (`docs\PRODUCT.md:6-37`).

That separation made later changes tractable. Transcription became the main view. Notes became collapsible. The owner removed repetitive permission/rehearsal acknowledgments. Translucency became a real rendering requirement, rather than a hypothetical visual effect. A microphone track became explicitly requested after the original computer-only implementation. Finally, Azure answering became a researched future extension, not an automatic cloud replacement.

The development ledger records these changes as dated decisions and evidence, not a fictional linear plan that was correct from the beginning (`TODO\16_DEVELOPMENT_LEDGER.todo:1-90`). The public journal tells the fuller chronological story.

## Architecture of a requirement

A requirement should identify its observable outcome and the evidence needed to claim it. For example, "no ordinary taskbar button" has a shell observation. "Computer audio becomes text" requires audio/protocol/recognizer evidence. "The recipient never sees the notes" needs the actual capture path; neither of the first two observations supplies it.




03 - Product Boundaries and Decisions - diagram 1. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

The native mechanism uses an owned HWND and display affinity. It does not make the process cease to exist (`src\PhantomFudge.App\Native\WindowProtection.cs:19-48`). Similarly, the source enum means "where samples came from", not "who was speaking" (`src\PhantomFudge.Core\AudioSource.cs:3-30`). Precision in nouns prevents precision failures in code and documentation.

# Decisions that shape the current product

| Decision | Current outcome | Important cost |
|---|---|---|
| Windows11 first | Native WPF/Win32 behavior rather than a lowest-common-denominator overlay | Other operating systems need independent designs |
| Transcript first | Large reading area; notes collapsed until needed | Editing and reading modes must remain understandable |
| Explicit inputs | Computer, Mic or Both, followed by Start | Device selection/permissions can fail and must be visible |
| No repeated acknowledgments | Owner handles permission/recipient check outside the app | This does not create technical evidence that a recorder is safe |
| Background-only alpha | See through content while keeping text opaque | Underlying content can reduce contrast |
| Native Python by default | No Docker prerequisite for ordinary use | Local environment/model setup must be reproducible |
| Local Ask snapshot; future Azure sending | Owner chooses the exact displayed question | Structured identity is implemented; cloud configuration and actual egress are future work |

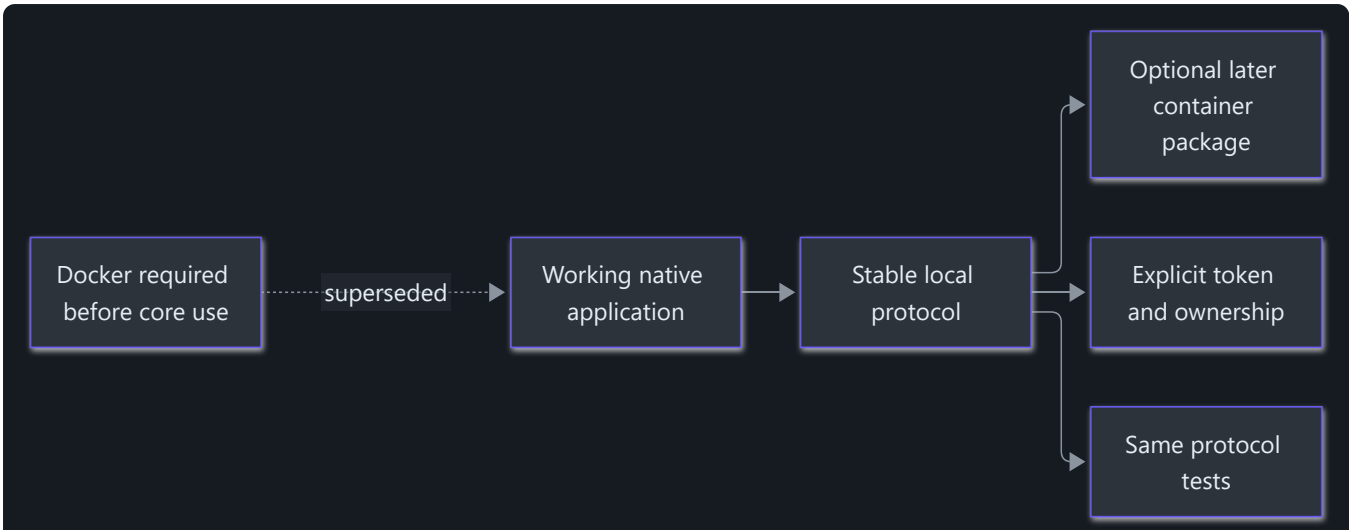
The requirements make the microphone change explicit: the later request supersedes the old never-microphone product scope, while tests still must not open live inputs implicitly (`docs\DUAL-SOURCE-AUDIO.md:1-26`). A repository that keeps both statements as current truth would eventually produce either a broken feature or an unauthorized test.

# Why Docker moved to the end

Containerization and container dependence are different design decisions. A headless Python service with environment-based configuration and a versioned protocol is straightforward to package later. Requiring Docker before a Windows desktop tool can transcribe creates a larger operational dependency without proving an inference benefit.

The current launcher starts native Python unless a separate option is chosen (`scripts\Start-Transcription.ps1:1-24`). `Run-PhantomFudge` can also avoid service startup entirely with NotesOnly (`scripts\Run-PhantomFudge.ps1:1-41`). The Docker TODO now explicitly follows native release acceptance, rather than blocking it (`TODO\20_DOCKER_LOCAL_SERVICE.todo:1-42`).

The lesson is not "containers are bad." It is "portability should preserve an interface before it imposes infrastructure." A service boundary is useful only when its responsibilities are clear: Python recognizes framed PCM; C# controls Windows devices and presentation.



03 - Product Boundaries and Decisions - diagram 2. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

## Interaction choices are privacy choices

The owner observed an I-beam over text and a disappearing cursor in a shared view. The app now uses Arrow and a non-activating default, but those local changes do not control every recorder's cursor stream. The design deliberately records that remaining uncertainty rather than renaming it success (`docs\CURSOR-AND-THEMES.md:1-69`).

At the same time, normal functionality must not be sacrificed to a privacy slogan. Notes must still be editable after an explicit Edit action. Device rows must still be selectable without unnecessarily activating the window. Unsaved-content warnings remain even though permission checkboxes were removed. Those controls answer different questions.

## Defining done without freezing learning

The TODO vocabulary separates NOT_STARTED, IN_PROGRESS, BLOCKED and DONE. DONE applies to the scope of a task: a research document can be complete while its architecture is not implemented. An authored workflow can be complete while execution is not started (`docs\TODO-CONVENTIONS.md:1-63`).

This is especially important for the Azure plan. The proposed path sends a frozen, explicit question to a streamed model request. It does not authorize automatic meeting uploads, resource creation or model calls simply because the diagram exists (`docs\AI-ANSWER-ARCHITECTURE.md:82-188`).

## A worked change-impact exercise

Suppose a new request says, "Also transcribe my microphone." A superficial implementation adds a second device object. A complete change asks:

1. Which device direction is valid, and when may it open?
2. Are samples mixed or kept distinct?

3. How do frame formats, source labels and time offsets change?
4. What happens if only one input starts or disconnects?
5. How does Stop prove both inputs are released and both tails finalized?
6. What does the UI show before recording and during faults?
7. Which old privacy statements are now historical?
8. Which tests can run without activating real hardware?

That checklist explains why the dual-input change involved native capture, protocol, Python state, transcript storage, UI, tests and documentation rather than one checkbox. The contract is written down before pretending that all those surfaces agree (`docs\DUAL-SOURCE-AUDIO.md:28-116`).

# References

- `docs\PRODUCT.md:6-37` — distinct requirements and limits.
- `TODO\16_DEVELOPMENT_LEDGER.todo:1-90` — dated scope/evidence history.
- `src\PhantomFudge.App\Native\WindowProtection.cs:19-48` — actual window mechanism.
- `src\PhantomFudge.Core\AudioSource.cs:3-30` — input identities.
- `scripts\Start-Transcription.ps1:1-24` — native default.
- `scripts\Run-PhantomFudge.ps1:1-41` — launch options.
- `docs\DUAL-SOURCE-AUDIO.md:1-116` — microphone supersession and protocol.
- `docs\AI-ANSWER-ARCHITECTURE.md:82-188` — proposed answer boundary.

# 04 — Windows Capture, Cursors, and Focus

## Overview: four questions, not one invisibility switch

A presentation aid has two audiences: the person reading its local window and the people receiving a captured presentation. Those audiences do not necessarily receive the same pixels. Phantom Fudge asks Windows to exclude its window from supported capture paths; it does not make the process nonexistent, encrypt the desktop, or control another program's recording implementation. `WindowProtection.Configure` performs a native configuration operation, not a recipient-side test. This distinction is the foundation of the feature, rather than a disclaimer added after it. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Native\WindowProtection.cs:19-49)

Keep four observations separate:

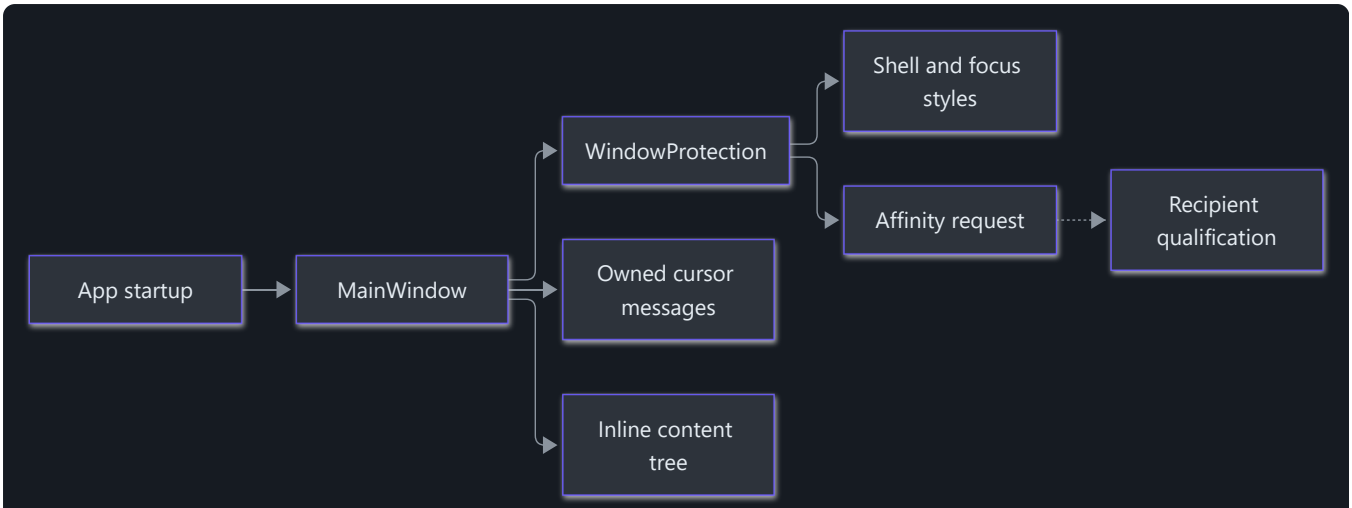
| Question | Mechanism or evidence |
|---|---|
| Was capture exclusion requested successfully? | Setter result, optional getter readback, composition flush |
| Does the window appear in ordinary shell navigation? | WPF settings and native tool-window styles, followed by observation |
| Does a sharing picker list it? | The particular picker's behavior; not established by tool-window style |
| What does the audience actually receive? | Independent recipient frames and recordings for that exact configuration |

The qualification plan explicitly separates these dimensions. A successful API call cannot fill in the other three columns. Nor does a visible local Arrow establish that a recorder includes the pointer. (docs\QUALIFICATION.md:9-26; docs\CURSOR-AND-THEMES.md:45-61)

**Newcomer path:** follow startup, then read the cursor section. **Principal-engineer path:** inspect the native error semantics, invalidation ordering, and evidence limits. Chapter 11 connects this window lifecycle to asynchronous audio shutdown.

## Architecture: one content surface, several independent policies

The production surface is a topmost, layered WPF window with a generic title, no ordinary taskbar entry, transparent window background, and custom move/resize chrome. The root content is not click-through. Capture affinity belongs to the native window handle, whereas text controls and inline panels belong to its WPF visual tree. A panel inside that tree is not equivalent to a separate native dialog. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml:1-116,195-210,536-606)



04 — Windows Capture, Cursors, and Focus - diagram 1. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

The dotted edge means “requires separate evidence,” not “automatically proves.” The implementation behind the solid edges is `OnStartup`, `ShowProtected`, and `WindowMessage`. (src\PhantomFudge.App\App.xaml.cs:62-75; src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:99-131,178-211)

## Components and ownership

| Component | Responsibility and important boundary |
|---|---|
| `App.OnStartup` | Chooses the owning instance and calls `ShowProtected`; ordinary startup does not use `StartupUri`. (src\PhantomFudge.App\App.xaml.cs:62-98; src\PhantomFudge.App\App.xaml:1-4) |
| `WindowProtection` | Checks Windows 11/DWM, adjusts native styles, requests affinity, and interprets readback. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Native\WindowProtection.cs:19-49) |
| `CursorPolicy` | Loads the standard Windows Arrow and sets the current cursor shape. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Native\CursorPolicy.cs:6-24) |
| `WindowHotkeys` | Registers fixed Ctrl+Alt shortcuts with no-repeat behavior; does not hook arbitrary keystrokes. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Native\WindowHotkeys.cs:6-26) |
| `SingleInstance` | Uses per-user instance naming and a narrow current-user pipe command. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Native\SingleInstance.cs:18-59) |
| `LocalFailureNotice` | Writes a fixed generic failure message instead of opening a content-bearing error window. (src\PhantomFudge.App\LocalFailureNotice.cs:5-29) |

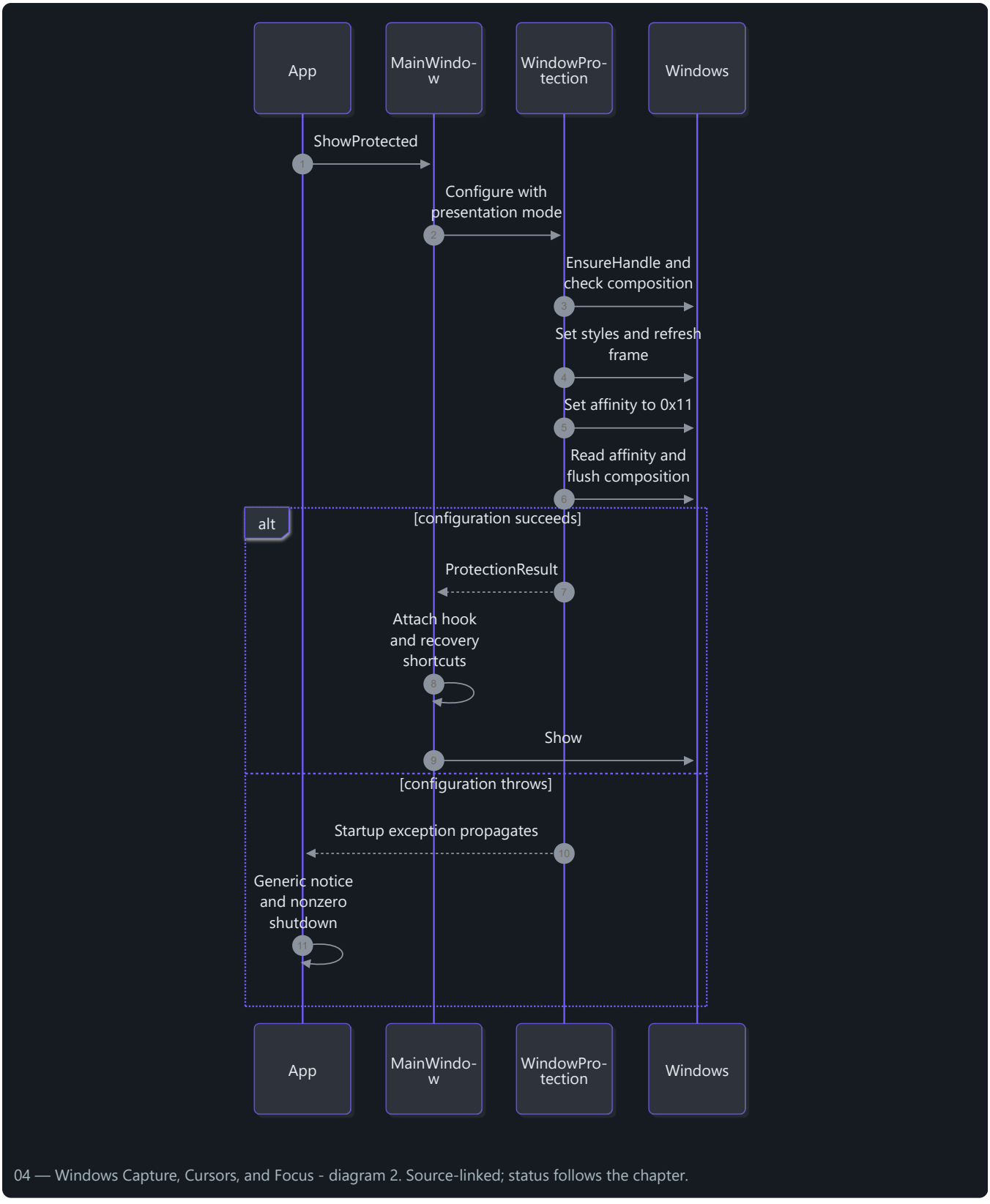
The architecture document names additional target abstractions, including a surface registry. They should not be mistaken for classes already implemented: current orchestration lives principally in `MainWindow`. (docs\ARCHITECTURE.md:47-93; src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:21-48)

## Data flow: configuring before first show

The current native setup also requests `DWMWA_DISALLOW_PEEK=true` for this HWND. This suppresses the documented taskbar-hover Peek surface where honored; it is not a process-hiding or arbitrary recorder-preview policy. A failing HRESULT follows the existing protection failure path. The local fixture establishes

setter acceptance, not observed shell/recipient pixels. (Native setup, cover/privacy evidence.)

`App.OnStartup` constructs the window explicitly. `ShowProtected` marks protection unready, calls `Configure`, and only then marks it ready and invokes `Show`. The constructor prepares resources, handlers, and device enumeration; it does not start audio. Thus window creation, device discovery, visible presentation, and recording are distinct operations. (src\PhantomFudge.App\App.xaml.cs:70-75; src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:50-131,652-700)




04 — Windows Capture, Cursors, and Focus - diagram 2. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

`Configure` calls `EnsureHandle`, which obtains an HWND without requiring an already-visible content window. It checks Windows build 22000 or later and requires desktop composition. It preserves unrelated extended-style bits, adds `WS_EX_TOOLWINDOW`, removes `WS_EX_APPWINDOW`, and conditionally sets `WS_EX_NOACTIVATE`. `SetWindowPos` refreshes the frame without moving, resizing, reordering, or activating it. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Native\WindowProtection.cs:12-37)

The affinity setter requests `0x11`, `WDA_EXCLUDEFROMCAPTURE`. A failed setter throws. A successful getter returning anything else also throws. An unavailable getter is recorded in `ProtectionResult`; it is not treated identically to contradictory readback. Finally, `DwmFlush` checks submitted composition work. None of these calls creates an independently observed capture-frame barrier. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Native\WindowProtection.cs:36-48,73; docs\ARCHITECTURE.md:128-131)

### Why the native wrapper checks zero carefully

`GetWindowLong` / `SetWindowLong` can return zero without implying failure. The wrapper clears the last-error slot first, performs the appropriate 32- or 64-bit call, then throws only when a zero result accompanies a nonzero error. This preserves the distinction between a legitimate zero value and an API failure. C# `nint` represents a native-sized integer; it is not the HWND's logical identity across arbitrary future replacements. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Native\WindowProtection.cs:51-71)

## Implementation: focus policy is not pointer capture policy

Present starts with `presenting = true`. The window uses `ShowActivated=false`; native setup adds `WS_EX_NOACTIVATE`; `WM_MOUSEACTIVATE` returns `MA_NOACTIVATE` (`3`). These mechanisms reduce accidental foreground takeover while retaining deliberate pointer interaction. They do not forward clicks through the app. Edit reverses the interaction policy, enables note focus and input methods, and deliberately focuses the editor after successful reveal. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:33,201-205,253-293)

Cursor shape is handled at two levels:

1. WPF declares Arrow and `ForceCursor` on the window and text controls.
2. `WindowMessage` handles `WM_SETCURSOR` for the owned HWND by calling `CursorPolicy.SetArrow`.

The native policy loads resource `32512`, the standard Arrow. It does not replace system cursor resources or manipulate global visibility counters. Arrow is also used in Edit; editable text and an I-beam are not inseparable concepts. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml:6-9; src\PhantomFudge.App\App.xaml:48-76; src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:180-184; src\PhantomFudge.App\Native\CursorPolicy.cs:8-24)

A recorder may include, exclude, or separately composite cursor imagery. Consequently, the reported remote cursor disappearance remains unresolved until tested in the actual sharing product and mode. Local foreground preservation, native Arrow equality, and content-exclusion samples answer different questions. (docs\CURSOR-AND-THEMES.md:47-61)

### Invalidation hides before waiting

Display/DPI messages, selected session changes, and suspend/resume notifications dispatch `InvalidateAsync`. It clears `protectionReady`, hides immediately, then awaits audio Stop. That ordering avoids leaving content intentionally visible while cleanup drains. It cannot revoke frames already captured or make OS notifications instantaneous. Reveal deliberately re-runs `Configure`. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:206-236,152-164)

Ordinary Hide also stops transcription, but does not destroy the document or exit the process. Mode switching hides, stops audio, changes editability, and reconfigures before showing again. Theme, opacity, and Notes expansion are different operations: they update existing controls rather than changing this native policy. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:239-276,482-521)

If reveal setup fails, `TryReveal` starts invalidation and records a fixed failure notice. Unsaved text remains in the running process, not in an automatic recovery file. `LocalFailureNotice.Record` overwrites one timestamped generic notice under `%LOCALAPPDATA%\PhantomFudge\last-window-error.txt`; it does not serialize the exception, note, transcript, or filename. Failure to write that notice produces another fixed console message. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:160-164; src\PhantomFudge.App\LocalFailureNotice.cs:9-29)

## Recovery without a taskbar button

The shortcuts are Ctrl+Alt+Space for visibility and Ctrl+Alt+E for deliberate editing. Registration failures produce an inline status while preserving second-launch recovery. These are fixed defaults, not a currently implemented configurable-hotkey UI. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:115-143,186-197; src\PhantomFudge.App\Native\WindowHotkeys.cs:13-18)

`SingleInstance` derives a name from the current Windows SID, creates a session-local mutex, and exposes a `CurrentUserOnly` named pipe. A second launch sends six bytes, `REVEAL`, with a five-second connection deadline. The listener reads a six-byte command with a two-second request deadline; it does not deserialize notes, paths, scripts, or executable commands. This is narrow recovery IPC, not a general command server. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Native\SingleInstance.cs:18-75)

`RevealAndReset` invokes monitor-aware clamping before protected reveal. `CurrentMonitorWorkArea` converts the HWND's nearest monitor work rectangle into WPF units, falling back to `SystemParameters.WorkArea` only when a handle or monitor query is unavailable. Recovery accounts for minimized restore bounds and can reduce minimum dimensions to fit a constrained work area; it is not persisted placement restoration or broad mixed-monitor qualification. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:146-149; src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.Layout.cs:14-53; src\PhantomFudge.Core\WorkspaceLayout.cs:17-42)

## Why auxiliary surfaces change the problem

Capture policy is applied to the HWND passed to the native setter, not to an abstract application identity. Consequently, moving a find box from an inline panel into a separate popup would change the surface inventory even if it looked almost identical. The current find and unsaved-confirmation controls are elements of `MainWindow.xaml`; text-box context menus and spell checking are disabled in the application style. These choices reduce additional app-generated surfaces, but do not establish that every framework helper, input-method candidate, or accessibility window has been qualified. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Native\WindowProtection.cs:24-37; src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml:195-210,634-639; src\PhantomFudge.App\App.xaml:48-50; docs\QUALIFICATION.md:120-122,139-140)

Native Open/Save dialogs are a deliberate exception available through Edit. Their behavior must not be described as inheriting the main window's capture assurance merely because `ShowDialog(this)` supplies an owner. The current UI explicitly refuses saving/exporting in Present and reports the dialog boundary after

Open. This is a concrete example of preferring a narrower, understandable workflow over an unsupported "everything this process draws is private" promise. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:306-311,373-390,399-405,828-834)

## Worked example: a display change during transcription

The following Python-shaped pseudocode explains ordering only; it is not production code, a Win32 binding, or a proposal to port the WPF application:

```
async def invalidate():
    state.protection_ready = False
    window.hide()                  # Do not wait for recognizer drain first.
    await stop_transcription()
    status.set_generic_reason()

def reveal():
    try:
        configure_native_window(nonactivating=state.presenting)
        state.protection_ready = True
        window.show()
    except KnownProtectionFailure:
        schedule(invalidate())
        record_generic_local_notice()
```

In C#, `Task` represents eventual completion, while `Dispatcher.BeginInvoke` schedules work on the WPF UI thread. The code must arrange both: a native notification must not directly manipulate controls on an arbitrary thread, and waiting for Stop must not precede Hide. `Dispatch` and `InvalidateAsync` express those responsibilities separately. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:170-174,206-236)

## Tests, limitations, and review questions

`CaptureProof.RunAsync` establishes an unprotected synthetic positive control and an underlying baseline, then samples four show cycles with four protected frames each. Its outcome is deliberately named `PASS_LOCAL_GDI_SAMPLES_ONLY`; `Grab` uses cropped GDI `BitBlt`. This is not continuous first-frame coverage or qualification of Teams, Zoom, Meet, OBS, or their cursor streams. Do not run this visible positive-control fixture during an actual presentation merely to read the chapter. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Diagnostics\CaptureProof.cs:19-114,168-199)

`RunUiSmokeAsync` separately checks initial foreground preservation, passive styles, `MA_NOACTIVATE`, and the Arrow policy. Its rendered PNGs are visual-tree diagnostics, not independent capture evidence. All meeting-product qualification rows remain open in the maintained matrix. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:930-976,1205-1218; docs\QUALIFICATION.md:28-53)

**Question:** Does successful getter value `17` establish universal exclusion?
**Answer:** No. It confirms a configuration readback; recorder behavior still needs independent evidence.

**Question:** Should a protection failure display the note inside an error dialog so it can be recovered?
**Answer:** No. The implemented failure path hides and preserves memory, emitting only a generic notice.

**Question:** Can a local Arrow test close the remote-cursor issue?
**Answer:** No. Record the sharing backend, source type, pointer-capture setting, and actual recipient frames. These answers follow the configuration, failure, and qualification contracts above. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Native\WindowProtection.cs:41-48; src\PhantomFudge.App\LocalFailureNotice.cs:11-24; docs\QUALIFICATION.md:134-140)

# References and maintenance checkpoints

- Native configuration: `Configure`, style wrappers, and `FlushComposition`.
- Window lifecycle: `ShowProtected`, `WindowMessage`, invalidation, and recovery.
- Cursor policy, hotkeys, and instance recovery.
- Failure notice and synthetic capture proof.
- Qualification matrix and cursor investigation.

Revisit this chapter whenever HWND construction, native styles, popups, focus behavior, or the rendering framework changes. Such changes require new evidence, not inheritance of an old compatibility claim. (docs\QUALIFICATION.md:24-26,113-130)

Source: docs/handbook/05-desktop-ui-and-themes.md

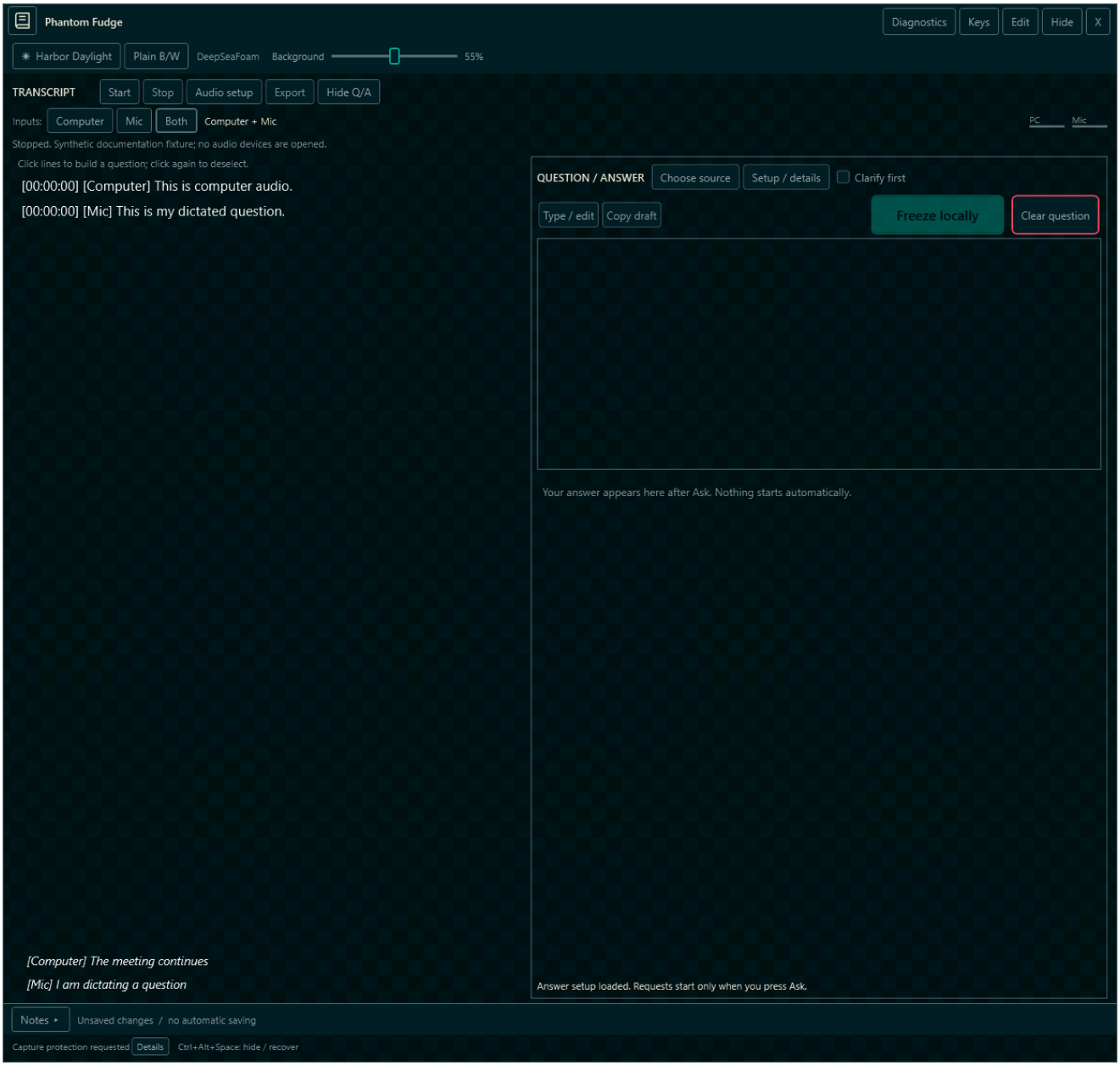
# 05 — Desktop UI and Semantic Themes

## Overview: a reading surface before an editor

The most important UI decision is not a color. It is which activity receives space and focus by default. Phantom Fudge starts with passive transcript reading, Q/A expanded and Notes collapsed. Question typing has its own deliberate transition: click a transcript row or choose **Type / edit**, rather than entering global Notes Edit. This separates "I need to see the meeting" from "I intend to compose a question." The initial fields and XAML establish the reading surface. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:33-35,50-96; src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml:262-617.) Direct selection enters question editing through `TranscriptRows_SelectionChanged`; the default Q/A expansion is in `InitializeQuestionView`. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.TranscriptSelection.cs:94-147.)

The UI is native C#/WPF. WASAPI capture begins only after explicit Start, for Computer, Mic, or Both. Both is the initial selection, not an instruction to record immediately. Labels describe input sources, not identified speakers. The planned Azure Ask experience is not an existing control or hidden mode. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:35,652-700; src\PhantomFudge.Core\AudioSource.cs:3-30; docs\IMPLEMENTATION-STATUS.md:214-230)

**Newcomer path:** read the visual-tree map, then the worked theme change. **Principal-engineer path:** inspect resource replacement, alpha compositing, passive selection, and the limits of the contrast tests. Chapter 04 explains the native capture and cursor policy; Chapter 06 explains the content retained beneath the controls.




*Actual WPF visual-tree render with synthetic content, not a screen-sharing capture.* The fixture inserts source-labelled transcript examples without starting transcription. It demonstrates layout, not recognition accuracy, remote exclusion, or reader acceptance. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:920-968,1205-1218)

All documentation device labels are synthetic. Later fixture images may show "Wait until transcription has fully stopped before clearing": the fixture deliberately exercises that guard without opening audio inputs, then retains its status text while rendering opacity and Notes. It is not a report of a live recording. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:1061-1095)

# Architecture: one visual tree, explicit priorities

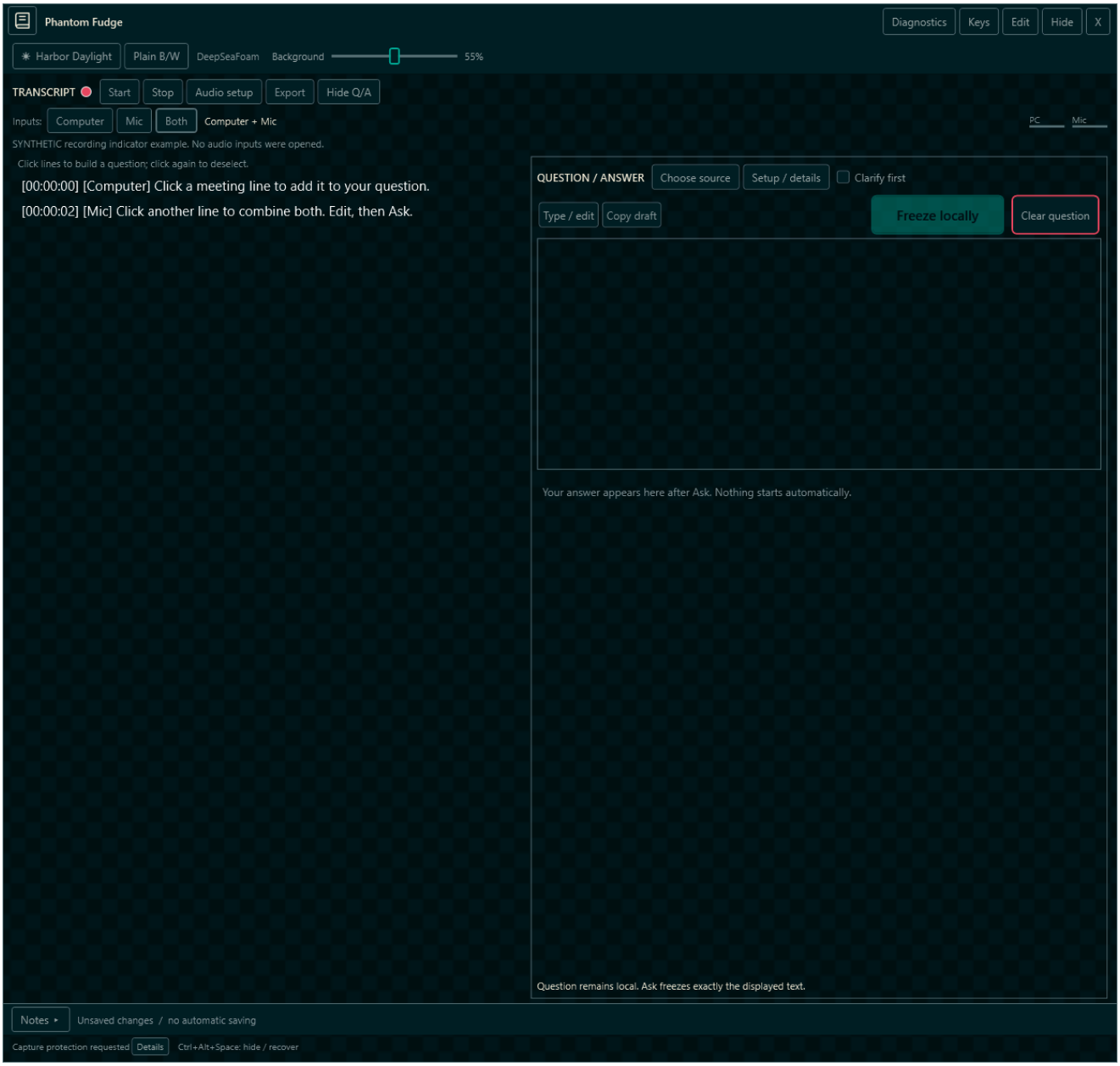
The **top-left book icon** swaps the workspace for **NOTEPAD IS READY** and the same icon-only return action in the same HWND. The disabled workspace is detached, not painted over; its controls/models still receive transcript and answer updates. The user explicitly requested continuing work, so this path never calls the

normal Hide/Stop/Cancel lifecycle. Uncover restores layout and content. File/confirmation operations block covering so their required decisions cannot disappear. (Cover implementation.)




Fresh in-process automation traversal sees the cover after the window peer's supported children-cache refresh, but the fixture also demonstrates that an already-retained value provider can still read question text. The application title/process identity remains Phantom Fudge. No claim of global screen-reader, process or recorder invisibility follows; read the feasibility matrix.

The red12-unit recording dot beside the transcript heading follows `transcriber.IsRunning`, not input selection, microphone level or the presence of transcript text. `UpdateAudioControls` refreshes it on start/status/stop/fault paths. Hidden state reserves the icon's place so the controls do not jump. A solid outline and accessible recording-state name accompany the theme-red fill. This is the app's active-transcription state, not an audio-file save or a replacement for the Windows microphone indicator. (Indicator, `UpdateAudioControls`.)




*Synthetic WPF indicator example: the fixture drives only presentation state and opens no audio inputs.*

The right-hand action group contains the large accent-filled **Ask**, followed immediately by **Clear question** with a two-unit red `ThemeError` border. Type/edit and Copy remain on the left. Ask stays148WPF units wide and at least44high with15-unit semibold text; Clear is98wide and at least44high. Hover/focus do not replace Clear's red border. Existing mode labels and handlers remain unchanged: visual emphasis is not permission to send. (Action row and local templates, `IsPrimaryAskAction`.)

The owner later requested a50%reduction specifically in answer text. `AnswerText` defaults to10WPF font units normally and9in narrow short layouts, replacing20and18. Question typography is unchanged. The same reader displays clarification interpretations, so they use the smaller answer type as well. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.xaml:523-527; src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Layout.cs:93-94.)

The 19:36 keyboard increment adds a **Size** slider and local reading controls: choose 8–24 via the slider, `:font 14`, or `+` / `-` in Read. A chosen value takes precedence over responsive defaults across resize, but is not saved for restart. Ctrl+Alt+K / Keys enters local modal control; `v` → movement/Space → Enter reviews selected text,

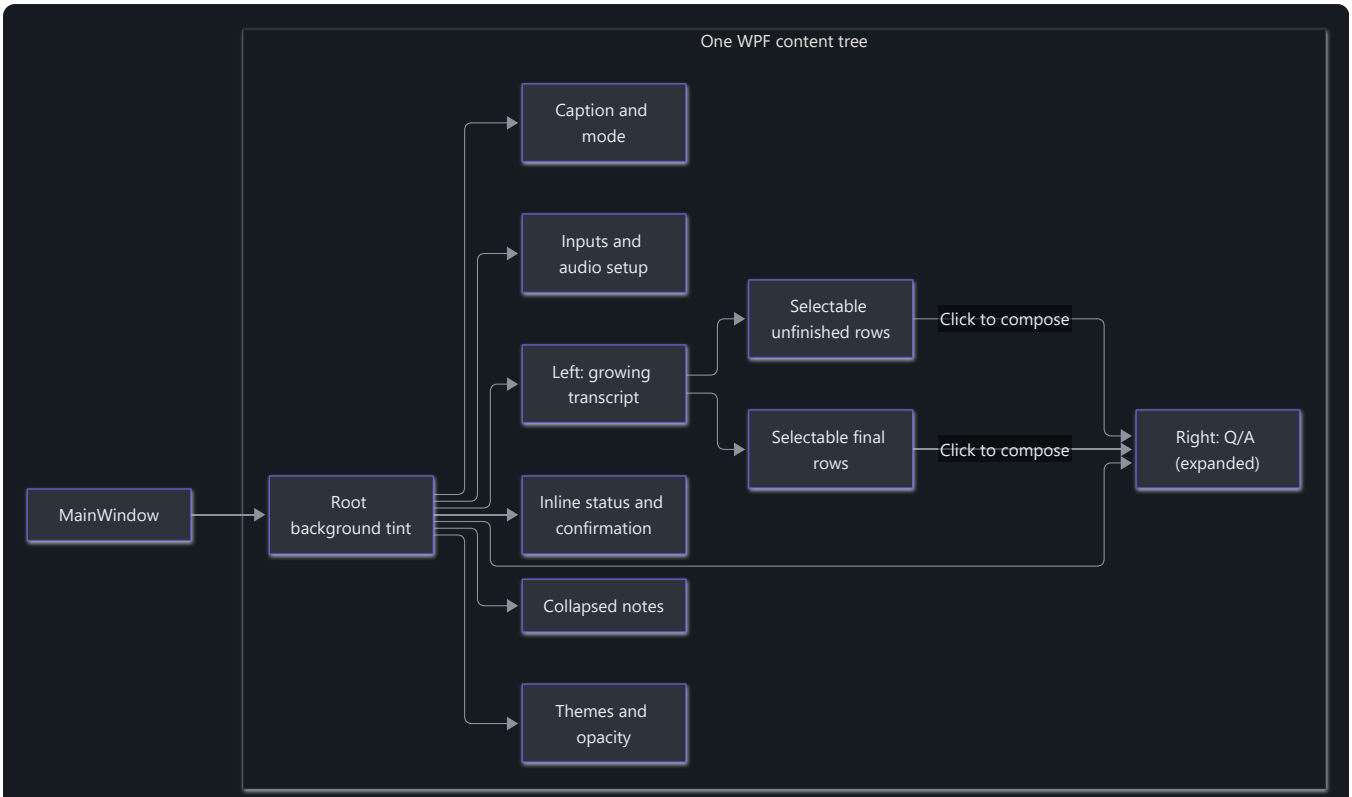
then Ctrl+Enter explicitly submits. Edit remains literal text entry. Ordinary mode changes and masking preserve capture/provider work; `:devices` instead refuses busy audio/answers and closes Q/A for setup. Read the canonical keyboard guide; final runtime-fixture evidence is recorded there, not a release claim. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.AnswerFont.cs:9-43; src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Keyboard.cs:87-139,218-368; src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.KeyboardSelection.cs:110-159.) The compact-font refinement temporarily gives Select/Search the transcript area and restores Q/A on leaving selection, preserving its intended expansion and running work. Other compact keyboard modes, or a chosen size 14+ with a visible answer, prioritize Q/A instead; wide columns are unchanged. This is layout visibility, not the explicit Q/A close/cancel path. See compact reading space; the final exporter/full UI fixture passed, including compact selection and passive size24fit. The source atlas and handbook include this increment. Edit stays armed after submit; asynchronous interpretation retargets the visible editable reply/original field only while the app is foreground. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Keyboard.cs:127-139,301-306.)

The later13:15request reduces transcription text by25%: finalized Computer/Mic rows use15instead of20, and live partials use13.5instead of18, or10.5instead of14in compact Q/A. Question, answer and device-card text retain their existing sizes. The current viewport fixture checks the exact final and partial sizes across compact and normal layouts. (Transcript declarations, responsive assignment, font/layout assertions.)

The default-off **Clarify first** control adds another deliberate path: interpret the selected question, then type a separate Yes/correction reply. It retains the original draft and renders interpretation/reply controls in the same window; typing or model completion never sends the next turn. See the complete clarification chapter and `MainWindow.Clarification`.

The requested window is now **1240 by 1520 WPF units**, twice the former dimensions, with a normal minimum of 470 by 560. `WorkspaceLayout.FitToWorkArea` clamps placement and size with a 12-unit inset rather than putting controls off-screen. The observed 1920 by 1200 work area fits 1240 by 1176. Smaller work areas can lower the minimum safely; this is not a demand for a physically impossible 1520-pixel height. (`src/PhantomFudge.Core/WorkspaceLayout.cs:8-42`.)

At widths of at least 900, transcript and Q/A use reading columns. Narrow layouts stack them; short-window source/setup tools can temporarily replace the transcript pane until closed. There is no outer scrolling main/question panel, while long text retains its own scrollbar. Primary controls remain outside those text scroll regions. (`src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Layout.cs:58-111`.)




05 — Desktop UI and Semantic Themes - diagram 1. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

The caption uses `WindowChrome` with a 38-unit caption region and six-unit resize border. Its buttons opt into hit-testing inside chrome, while the title text does not intercept pointer input. The transcript and editor remain normal content hit regions; transparency is not an instruction to send clicks to another application. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml:112-147)

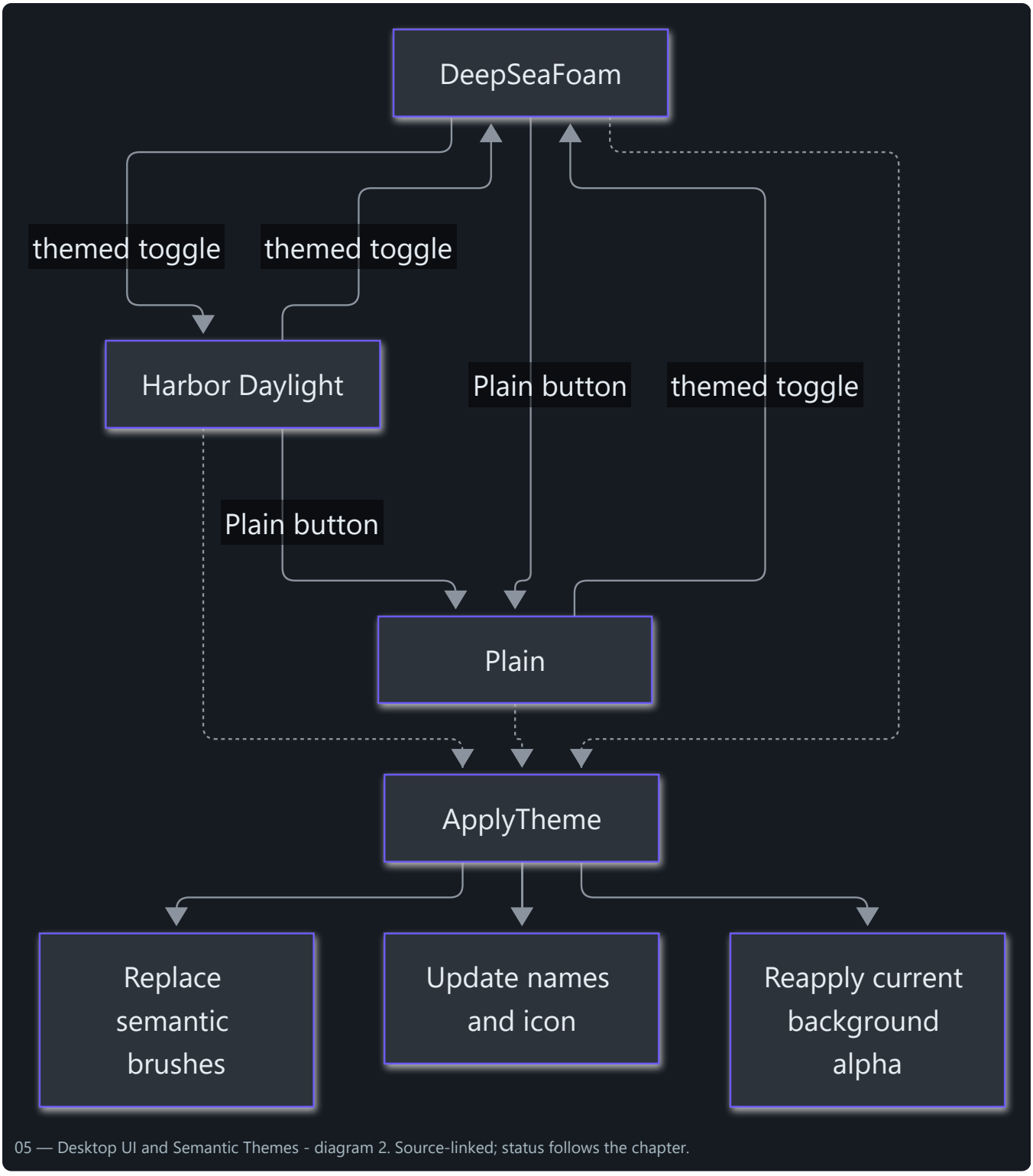
## Components: separate meaning from painting

| Layer | What it owns |
|---|---|
| `ThemePalette` | Immutable semantic color values and the three theme identities. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\ThemePalette.cs:3-29) |
| `ThemeBrushes` | Conversion to frozen WPF brushes and resource-key replacement. (src\PhantomFudge.App\ThemeBrushes.cs:9-41) |
| Application styles | Templates for button, text, list, scrollbar, slider, and progress states. (src\PhantomFudge.App\App.xaml:6-239) |
| `ApplyTheme` | Current selection, button labels, accessible name, and reapplication of root alpha. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:492-509) |
| `UpdateInteractionControls` | Read-only/focus/input-method policy and file-operation availability. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:278-293) |
| `TranscriptRow` / `TranscriptRows_SelectionChanged` | Immutable display/segment pairing, whole-row toggles, draft guards and deliberate question focus. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.TranscriptSelection.cs:13-20,85-147) |
| `RunUiSmokeAsync` | Synthetic layout, style, preservation, and interaction assertions. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:920-1195) |

A C# `record` is useful here because palette data is a value-shaped object rather than a control. Think of a frozen Python dataclass containing named color strings—not of a Python GUI implementation. The WPF-specific brush conversion stays in the App project, while Core tests can inspect the palette without constructing a window. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\ThemePalette.cs:5-26; src\PhantomFudge.App\ThemeBrushes.cs:9-41; tests\PhantomFudge.Core.Tests\ThemePaletteTests.cs:5-17)

## Data flow: what a theme click actually changes

The themed button calls `NextThemed`. DeepSeaFoam advances to Harbor Daylight; every other current value advances to DeepSeaFoam. Plain has a separate button, so the themed toggle is a two-theme companion switch with an exit from Plain, not a three-item carousel. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\ThemePalette.cs:28-29; src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:507-509)




05 — Desktop UI and Semantic Themes - diagram 2. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

`ThemeBrushes.Apply` replaces semantic resources such as `ThemeText`, `ThemeSurface`, `ThemeSelection`, and `ThemeWarning`; it also maps selected WPF `SystemColors` resource keys. Controls reference these through `DynamicResource`, allowing replacement to update existing controls. Each new brush is frozen, so later changes replace a resource rather than mutating a shared brush in place. (src\PhantomFudge.App\ThemeBrushes.cs:12-41; src\PhantomFudge.App\App.xaml:9-11,53-58)

`ApplyTheme` updates the displayed current name, the *next* theme's button label, a sun/moon glyph, and the button's automation name. It emphasizes the Plain button when selected, then rebuilds the root background using the existing slider value. It does not assign note text, clear the transcript, start audio, or recreate the

HWND. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:492-505)

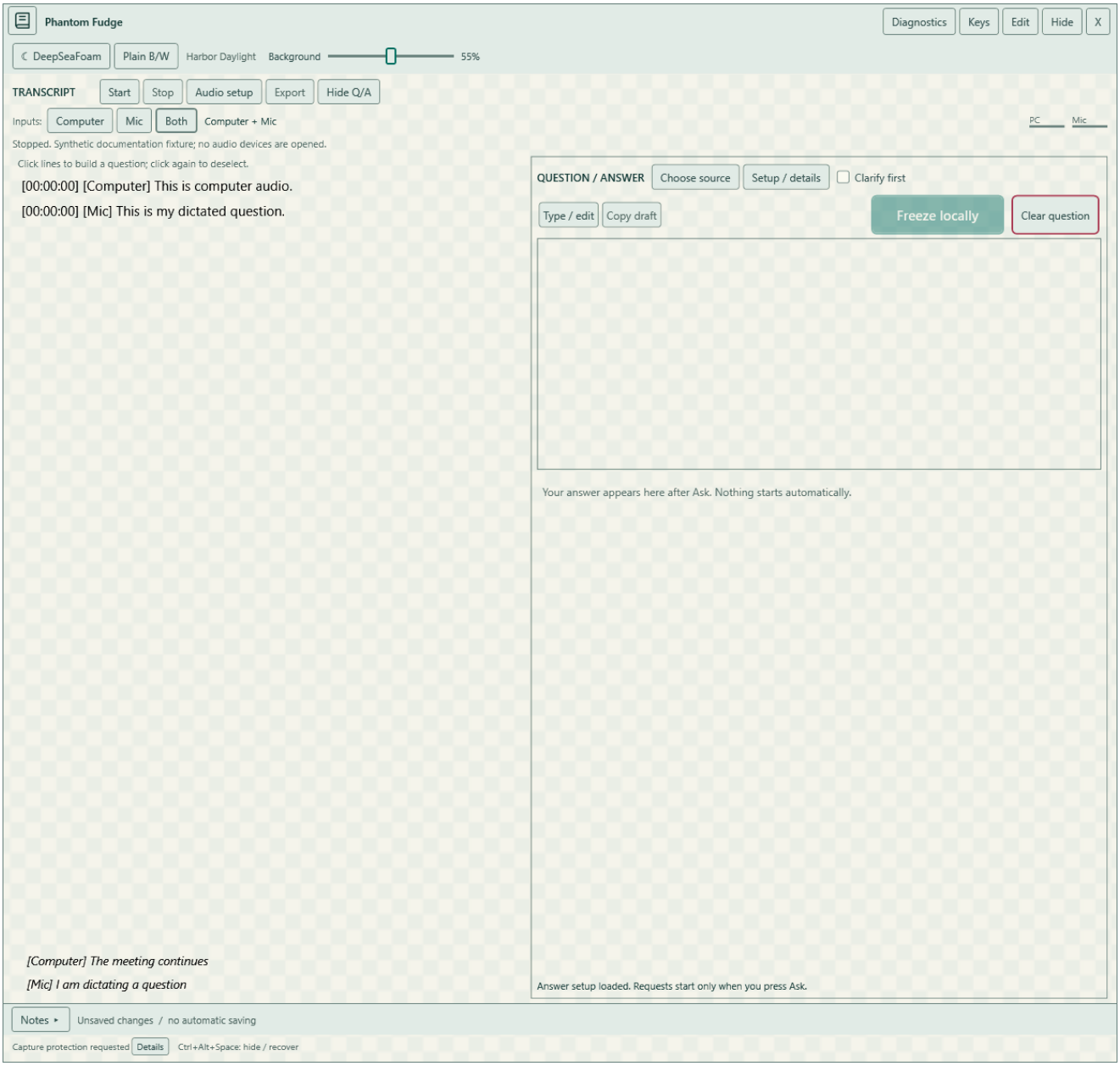
# Implementation and tradeoffs

## Semantic palettes include interaction states

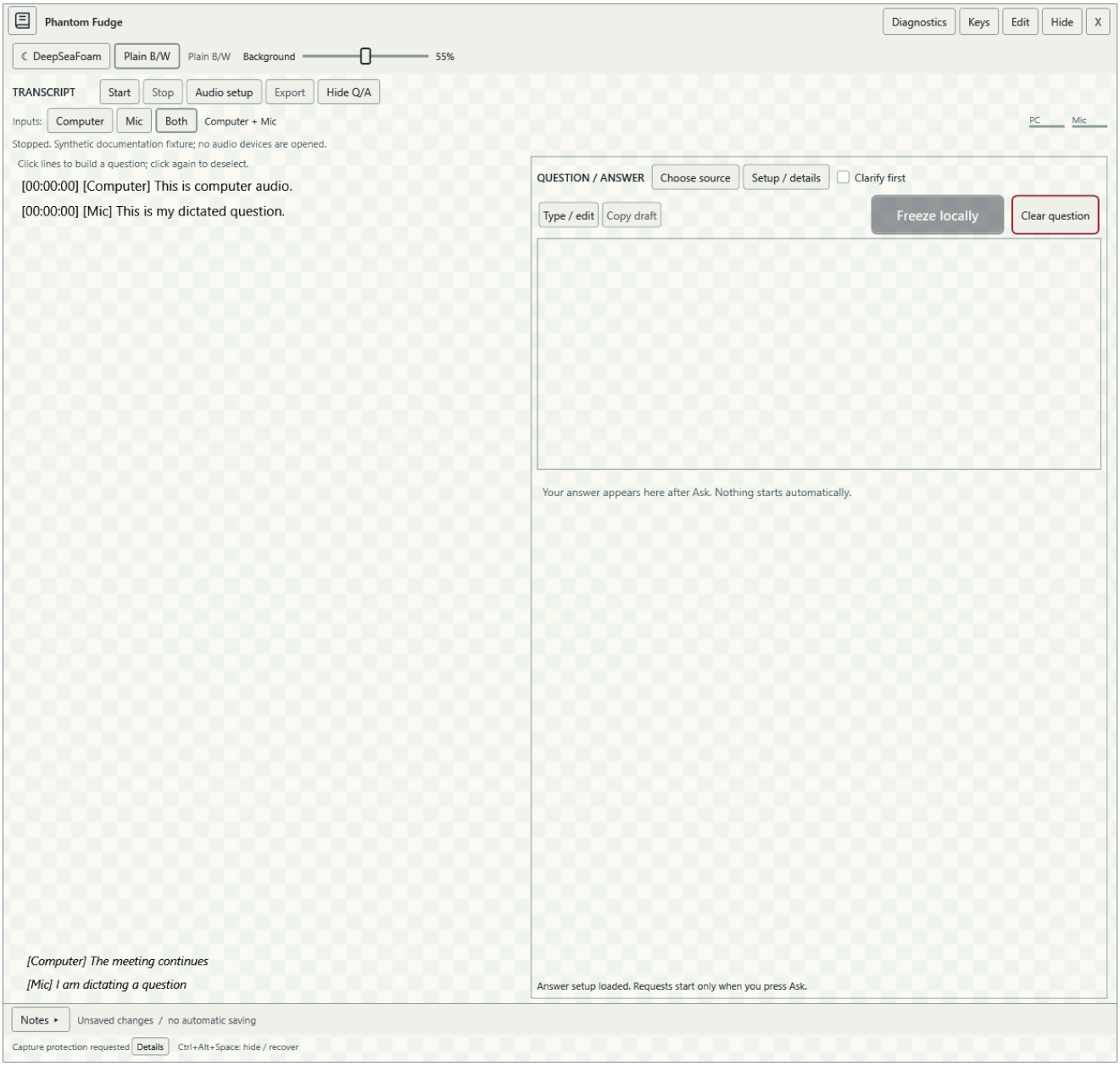
The following are selected roles, not the entire palette:

| Role | DeepSeaFoam | Harbor Daylight | Plain B/W |
|---|---|---|---|
| Background | `#000F13` | `#F3F2E9` | `#FAF9F6` |
| Surface | `#001E26` | `#E3ECE7` | `#F0F0EC` |
| General UI text | `#93A1A1` | `#355451` | `#202B30` |
| High-contrast reading | `#FFFFFF` | `#000000` | `#000000` |
| Accent | `#00A591` | `#006F63` | `#202B30` |
| Selection | `#003748` | `#C7DDD7` | `#D7E1DC` |

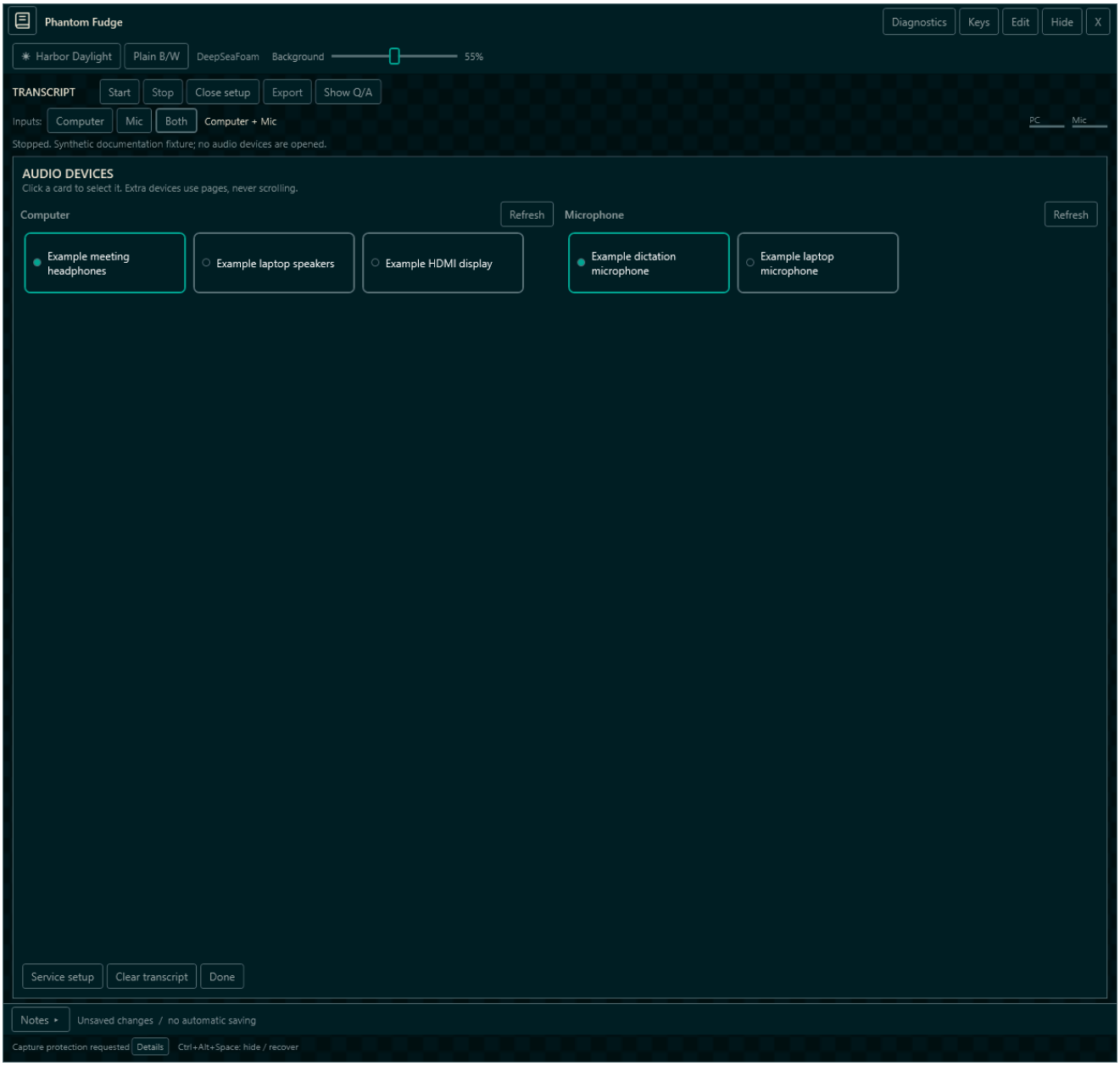
`ThemePalette.For` defines these values along with muted, heading, border, hover, selected text, action text, input, warning, and error roles. Plain B/W is a neutral interface name, not literally only two RGB values. The white/black reading role is the owner's October 9 override, not an unchanged canonical color. The maintained provenance document records the canonical palette revision and composites; the WPF mapping is original to this app. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\ThemePalette.cs:5-25; docs\CURSOR-AND-THEMES.md:93-118)



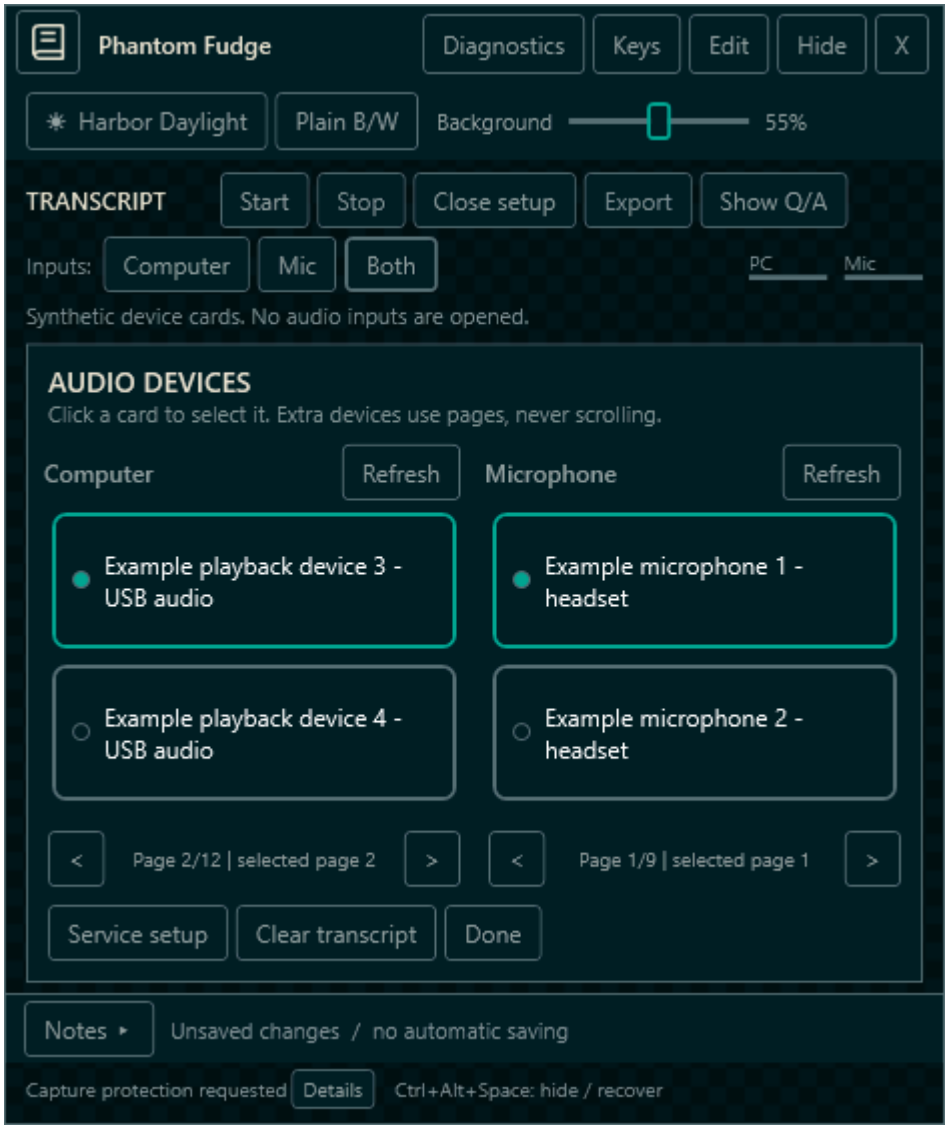

*Actual WPF visual-tree render with synthetic content, not a screen-sharing capture.* `RunUiSmokeAsync` applies every theme and checks key resource and foreground colors before rendering the examples. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:982-994)




*Actual WPF visual-tree render with synthetic content/device labels.* Plain B/W is the neutral reset, not a claim that every pixel is exactly black or white. The stopped fixture status makes clear that choosing Both does not mean either source is recording. The corresponding DeepSeaFoam theme-only image is retained separately from the opening transcript fixture in the provenance manifest.




Device selection now uses cards in the full inline reading area. Each source keeps its original `ListBox` selection and endpoint record, but the template contains an `ItemsPresenter` and `WrapPanel`, **not a ScrollViewer**. Width and wrapped friendly-name height determine how many cards fit. When a large catalogue exceeds that space, explicit Previous/Next controls collapse off-page containers without replacing the collection or selecting another endpoint. The selected-page label keeps an off-page selection visible as state. Names can ellipsize only when the available card is exceptionally constrained; the stored name and endpoint ID are unchanged. (Card coordinator, card templates.)




*Synthetic470x560fixture with23outputs and17microphones; no audio input was opened.* The fixture checks actual card bounds, absence of a ScrollViewer, selection preservation across pages, passive clicks, busy locks, single-source layouts, advanced service controls and empty-state notices. (Card diagnostic.)

Setup replaces the transcript/Q&A reading view only while open. Its bottom **Service setup** toggle reveals the existing session-only token and guidance; **Done** restores reading. Normal device selection needs neither token-field scrolling nor a new popup. Capture remains explicit and the existing source-change lock applies throughout starting/running/stopping.

*Actual WPF visual-tree render with synthetic content/device labels, not a desktop capture.* Computer and microphone selectors are separate; the setup panel scrolls rather than creating a second window. The token is blank. No physical input was opened to produce this view. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:939-958,1001-1003)

Button templates distinguish hover, pressed, keyboard-focused, and disabled states. List items have separate hover and selected presentations. Scrollbars and sliders use app brushes rather than leaving conspicuous system-default fragments. Text boxes suppress their context menu and spell checking, reducing app-generated auxiliary surfaces without removing ordinary deliberate editing. (src\PhantomFudge.App\App.xaml:25-58,84-109,146-225)

## Background alpha is not whole-window opacity

The root `WindowSurface` receives a new brush with:

```
alpha = round(clamp(percent, 10, 100) × 255 / 100)
```

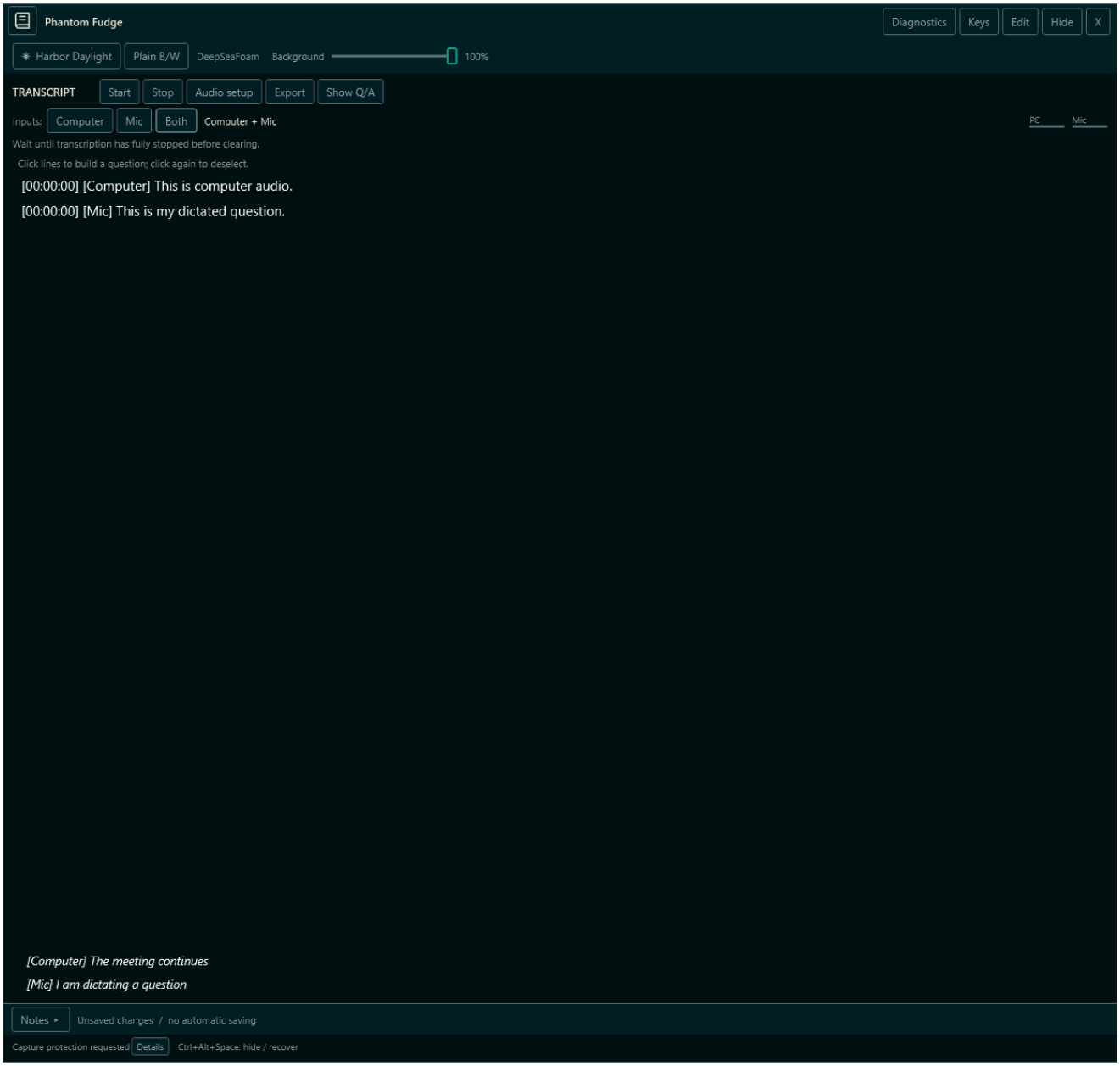
At 10%, 55%, and 100%, the byte alpha is respectively 26, 140, and 255. `MainWindow` remains transparent behind that tint; note and final-transcript control backgrounds are also transparent. The answer-reading tint follows the same slider; its parent no longer blocks transparency with an opaque content container. Header, setup, and confirmation surfaces use opaque theme brushes. The application never fades the glyphs with the background. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:482-489; src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml:7,130,195-197,536-538,279-288,640-646)

The slider exposes 10–100%, defaults to 55%, and snaps to five-percent ticks. It remains available in Present. The implementation does not set `Window.Opacity`; the diagnostic explicitly checks window/editor/transcript opacity equals one and text brush alpha equals 255. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml:165-173; src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:1087-1091,1118-1121)

Why stop at 10% rather than zero? The maintained design calls out nonzero background alpha as avoiding entirely transparent mouse holes while keeping the surface usable. Why not promise readable text over every background? Composited contrast depends on the underlying desktop: approximately `alpha × tint + (1 − alpha) × background`. Solid glyphs alone cannot prevent visual interference from a busy slide. Increasing opacity or moving the window is a usability choice, not a capture-policy change. (docs\ARCHITECTURE.md:206-210; docs\CURSOR-AND-THEMES.md:81-86)




*Actual WPF visual-tree render with synthetic content at10% background alpha.* The reader's checkerboard is an illustrative backing for transparent PNG pixels, not a captured desktop. Header/control opacity stays unchanged.



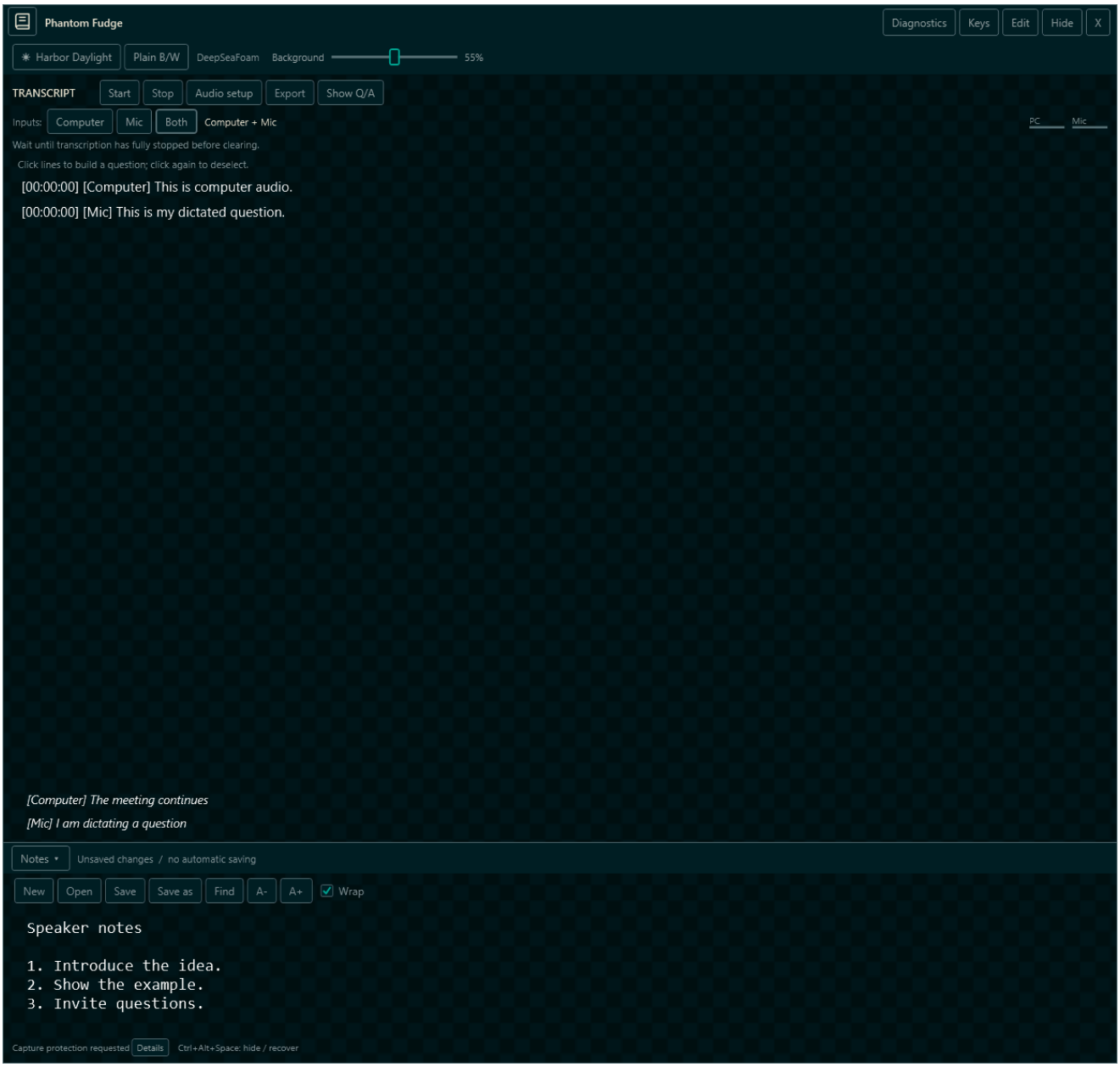

*The same synthetic fixture at100% background alpha.* Compare background coverage, not whether a recorder can capture the window. Both images come from the diagnostic alpha/render assertions; their retained stop-guard message is explained above. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:1061-1091)

## Passive interaction requires more than read-only text

`UpdateInteractionControls` changes the shared `ControlsFocusable` resource, note editability, transcript focusability, and editor input-method availability. File operations and export require Edit; token entry additionally requires idle audio. Start is gated by technical readiness and explicit user action, not permission or rehearsal checkboxes. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:278-293,652-700,720-743)

The device selectors illustrate a subtle WPF issue: their ordinary click path requires focus. In Present, `OutputDevices_PreviewMouseLeftButtonDown` identifies the clicked `ListBoxItem`, assigns `SelectedItem` directly, and handles the event. Both playback and microphone lists use this handler. This preserves pointer selection without depending on keyboard focus transfer. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:628-638; src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml:550-590)

Opening Audio setup collapses Notes. Expanding Notes closes Audio setup; collapsing Notes also closes Find. These actions change visibility, not stored text. In contrast, switching Edit/Present hides and stops transcription before reconfiguring the native window. A theme click must not accidentally be implemented through that heavier mode-transition path. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:253-276,511-521,641-649)




*Actual WPF visual-tree render with synthetic content, not a screen-sharing capture.* Expansion is shown while still presenting; it does not itself enable editing. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:1092-1095)

The separate Present-after-mode-switch image preserves the same synthetic note/transcript content after the fixture explicitly enters Edit and returns to Present. It illustrates the stable surface, not keyboard-focus or recipient behavior by itself. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:1118-1122)

# Worked example: changing appearance without changing the session

Imagine a reader using DeepSeaFoam at 55% with Notes collapsed. They click the themed button, lower Background to 10%, then expand Notes. The theme becomes Harbor Daylight, the root tint becomes alpha 26 in the new background color, and the existing notes become visible but remain read-only. None of these handlers starts or stops capture; an already-running session is not intentionally restarted. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:482-525)

This Python-shaped sketch explains the separation of values and presentation; it is **not production code**:

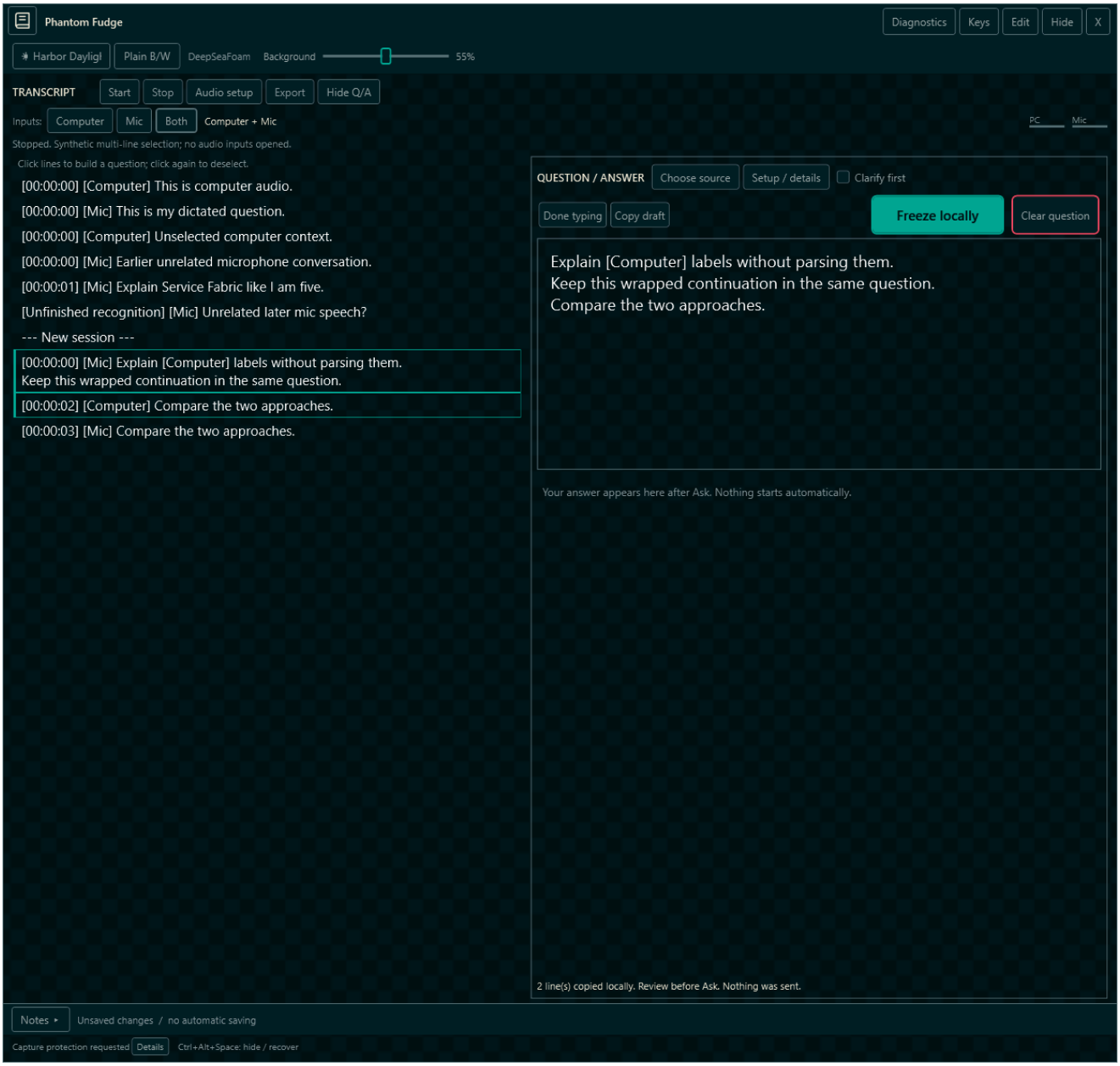
```
def apply_theme(theme):
    palette = palettes[theme]          # Like the C# record.
    resources.replace_colors(palette) # Like DynamicResource replacement.
    ui.current_name = palette.name
    ui.next_name = palettes[next_themed(theme)].name
    ui.root_brush = rgba(palette.background, opacity_percent)
    # No document assignment, audio command, or HWND reconstruction.
```

In the actual C# path, `ApplyTheme` calls `ThemeBrushes.Apply`, and brush construction calls `Freeze`. The slider handler updates the shared root background brush, not text opacity. That small separation makes it possible to test color selection independently of native capture, while still checking the integrated window for text preservation and stable handle identity. (src\PhantomFudge.App\ThemeBrushes.cs:9-41; src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:492-505,1086-1091,1123-1126)

# The local question panel

**QUESTION / ANSWER** is expanded initially, with **Hide Q/A** / **Show Q/A** controlling visibility. The first-class workflow is to click several Mic/Computer rows directly in the main transcript. Each ordinary click toggles one whole segment without Ctrl, including all wrapped or embedded newline text. `TranscriptRow` pairs the displayed string with its immutable `TranscriptSegment`; composition uses raw `Text` in displayed history order, not click order or parsed labels. (`src\PhantomFudge.Core\TranscriptSegment.cs:3-20,52-65`; `src\PhantomFudge.Core\QuestionDraft.cs:18-46`; src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.TranscriptSelection.cs:13-20,85-147; `InitializeQuestionView`.)

The live transcript is beside the composer at wide sizes and above it at narrow sizes. In a short, narrow workspace, explicitly expanded source/setup tools temporarily replace the transcript; closing those tools restores reading space. Notes and Audio setup close when the composer expands (`src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Layout.cs:58-145`). Direct selection opens Q/A and closes those tools, then calls `SetQuestionEditing(true)`. Like **Type / edit**, this deliberately permits keyboard focus without the global Notes mode switch that stops audio. **Done typing** / Escape restores passive behavior. Unlike passive device selection, a main-transcript click is intentionally activating; it does not stop transcription, enable Notes editing, freeze a snapshot or send a model question. Native ListBox keyboard/automation `SelectionChanged` uses the same composition path. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.TranscriptSelection.cs:94-147; `SetQuestionEditing`.)



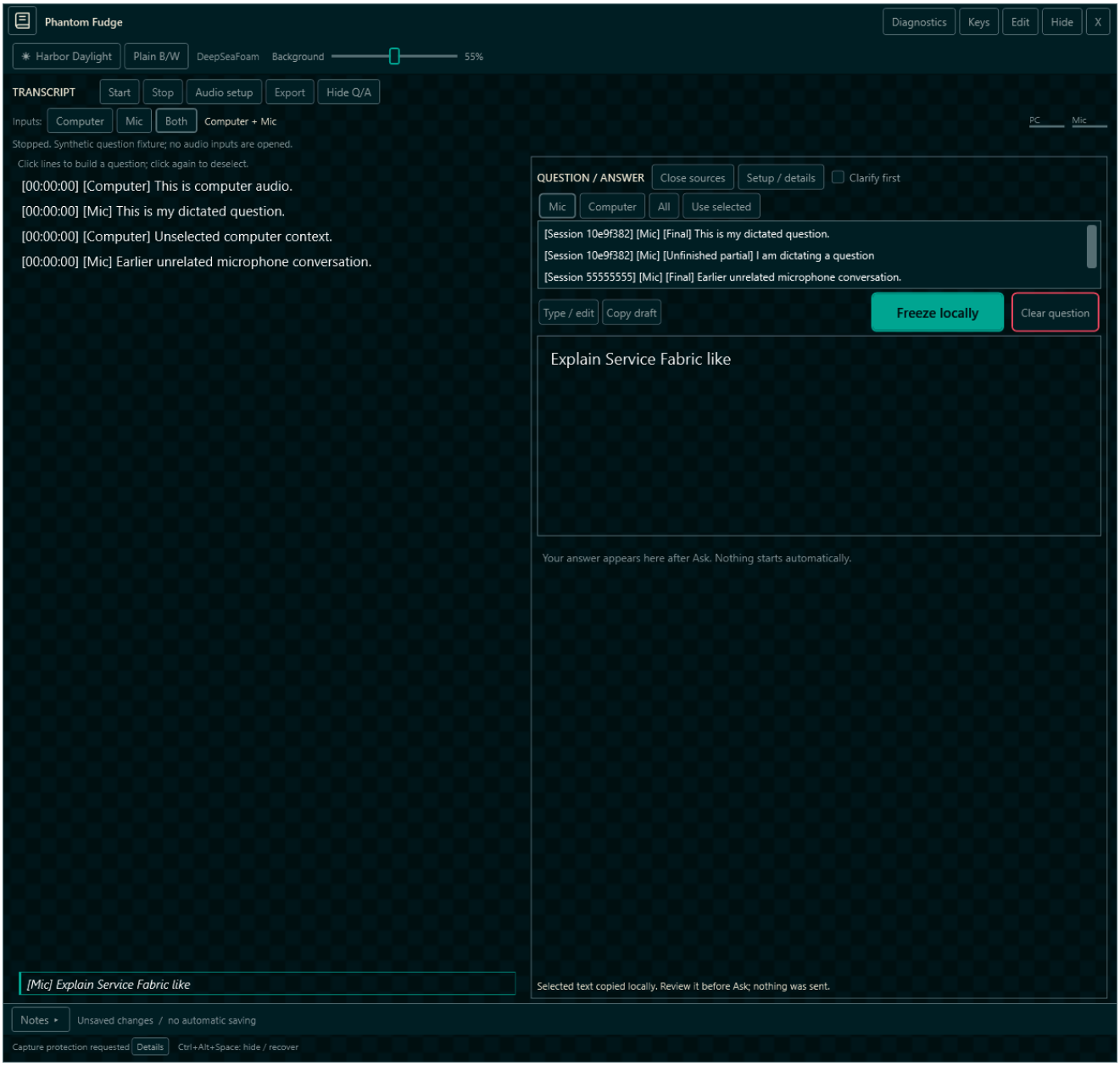

*Actual synthetic WPF render, with no audio input or model request.* The outlined Mic and Computer rows compose in displayed order even though the fixture clicks Computer first. The Mic row selects its whole wrapped/multiline segment. The duplicate unselected sentence stays outside the draft. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.TranscriptSelectionDiagnostics.cs:21-53.)

After a user edit, further direct row changes are refused with an inline retained-draft status; the previous highlights are restored. **Clear question** resets the draft and highlights so a new set can be chosen. The guard avoids destroying corrections with an incidental click, without adding a popup. Before editing, selected partials follow their stable keys into revised/final rows. Main history survives smaller chooser eviction, including archived unfinished rows; separator rows have no segment and cannot be selected. New finals scroll only if the reader was already at the end. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.TranscriptSelection.cs:13-83,94-147.)

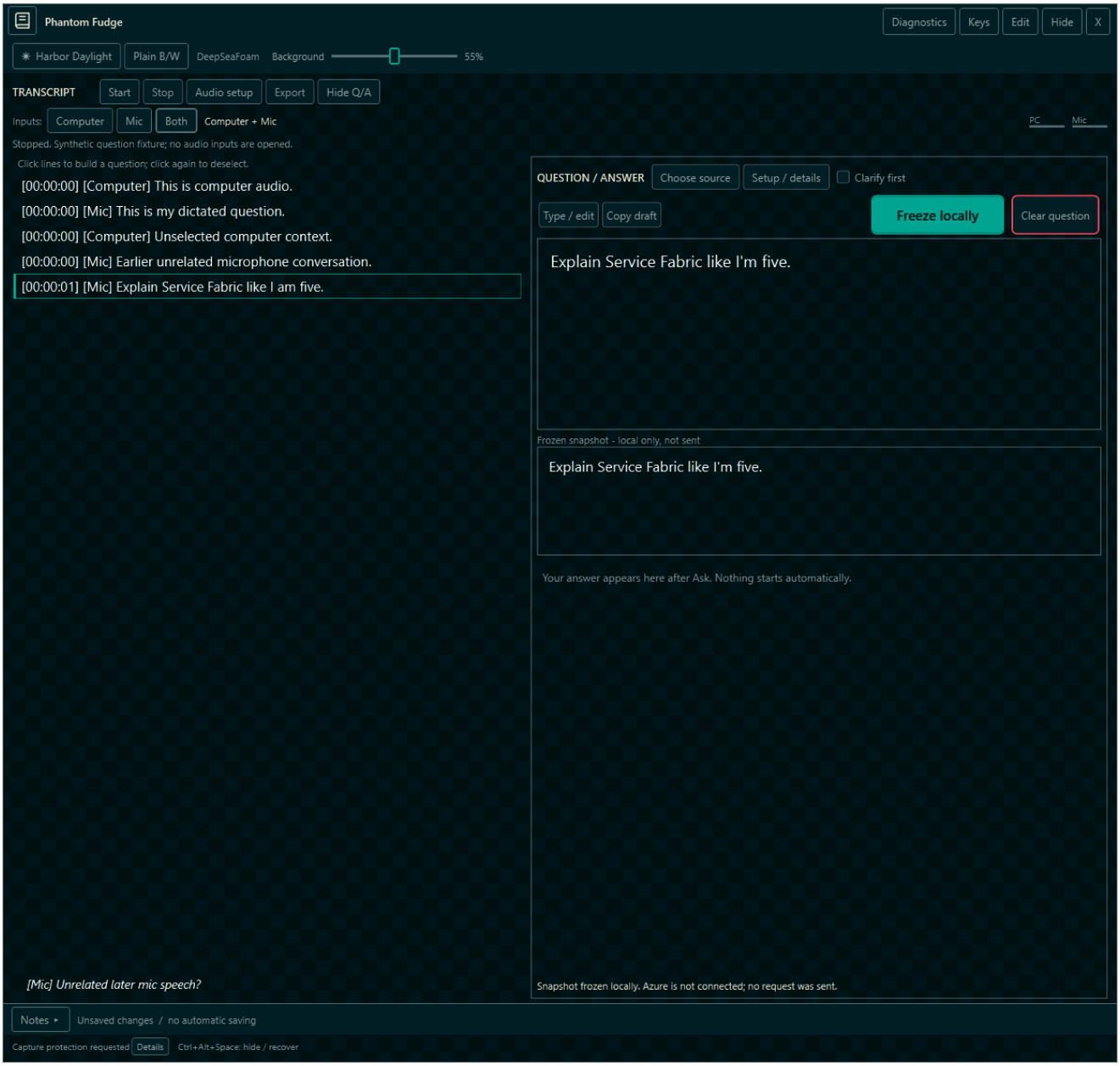
The manual fallback is **Choose source** → **Mic / Computer / All** → **Use selected**. Mic is that chooser's initial filter; **All** broadens visibility only. **Use selected** remains an explicit replacement action, including for an edited draft, and can be used passively before **Type / edit**. This differs from guarded direct clicks. See

`UseQuestionSelection_Click` and the local question contract.

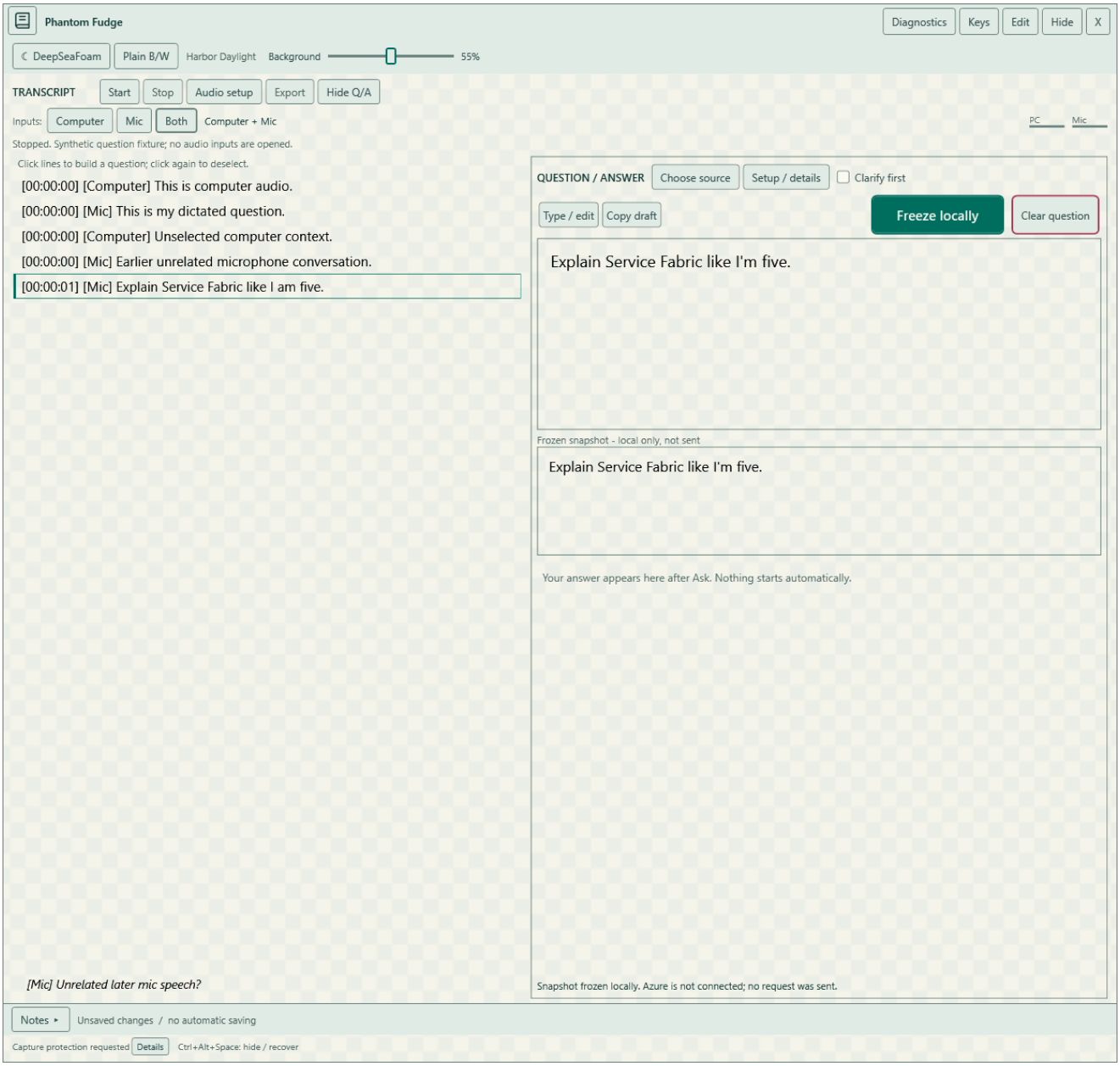
Selected main rows use a thin accent outline rather than an opaque selection fill. Their glyphs remain white/black and their transparent backgrounds share the root alpha. Keyboard focus has a separate outline state. See `TranscriptRowStyle` / `TranscriptRowTemplate` in the XAML; this is not universal readability or capture qualification.




*Actual WPF visual-tree render of the manual chooser, with synthetic content/device labels.* The selected Mic partial is identified structurally, while other transcript text stays outside the draft.




*Actual WPF visual-tree render using synthetic content and device labels.* The unrelated Computer and earlier Mic lines remain in the transcript but are not in the question. The frozen text is local only; no model was called and no audio endpoint was opened.

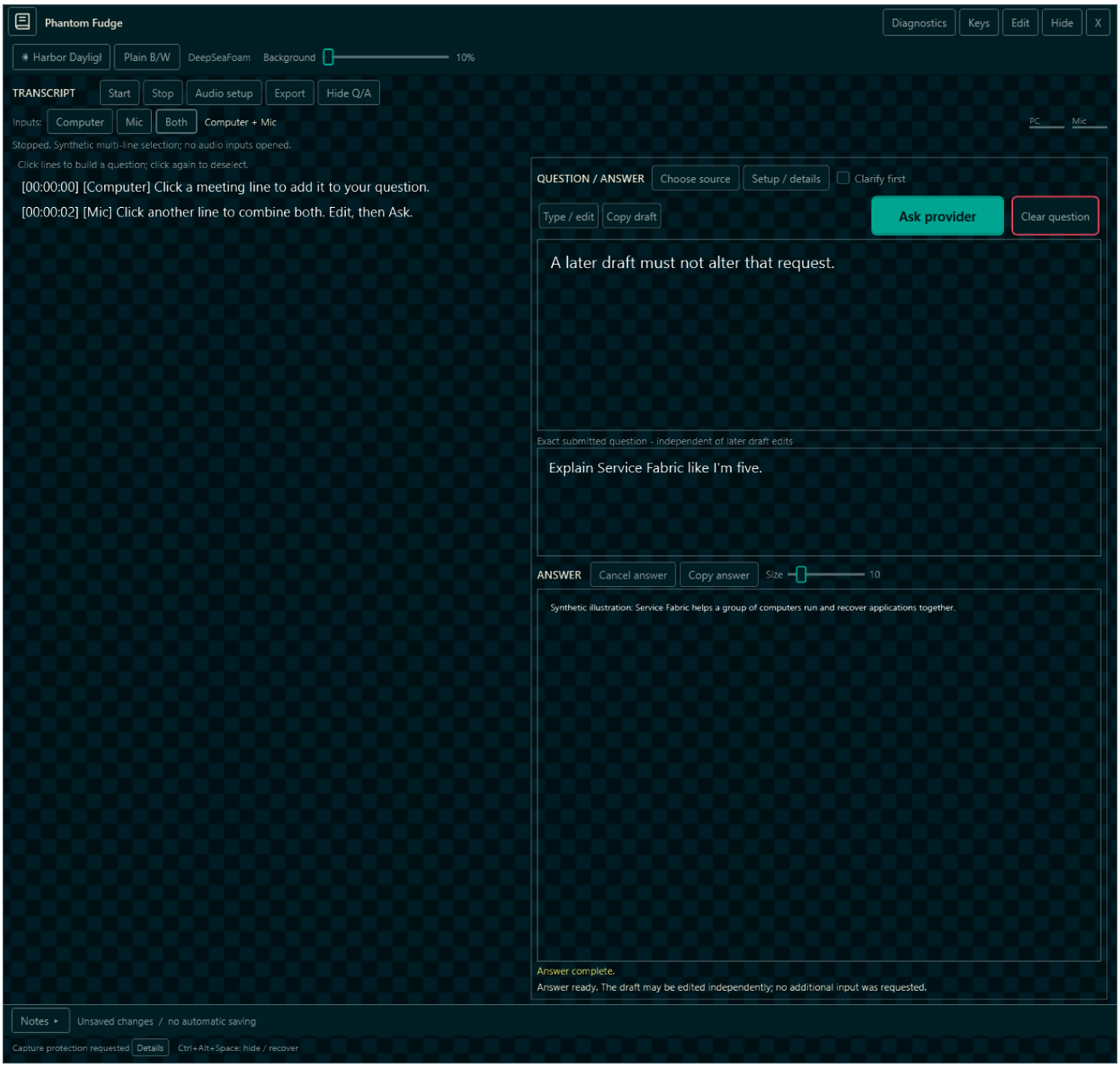


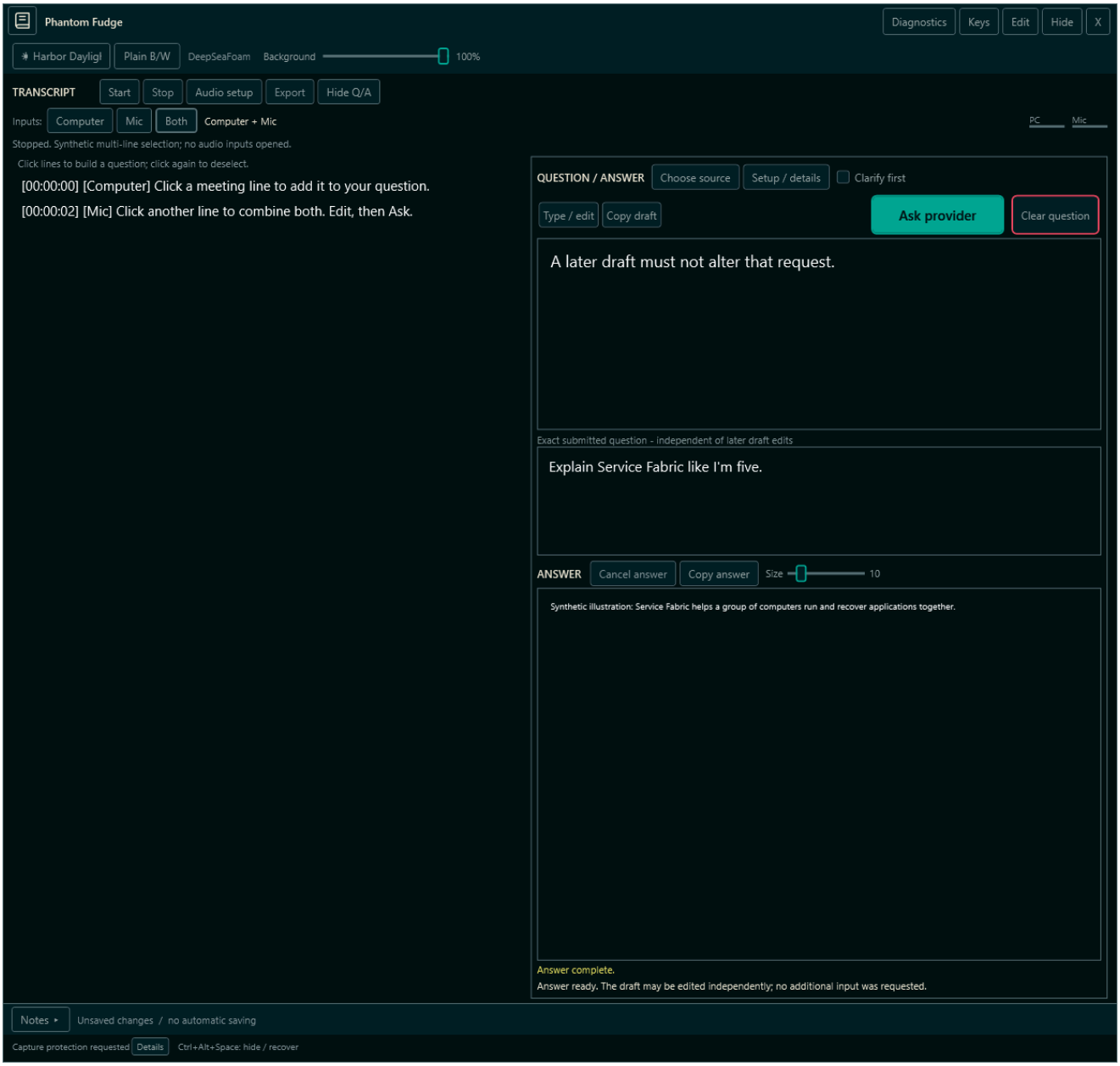

*The same synthetic state in Harbor Daylight.* Theme changes preserve the draft and frozen snapshot. A frozen snapshot is a deep immutable copy of selected provenance and exact text; later recognition or edits can change the draft but not that copy. (`src\PhantomFudge.Core\QuestionSnapshot.cs:5-23`; `src\PhantomFudge.Core\QuestionDraft.cs:61-95`.)

Selection is limited to one capture session,256entries and8192UTF-16 code units including inserted newlines. The limit rejects an oversized paste/selection/update rather than silently truncating. User edits detach recognition replacement. Copy and Clear are explicit local actions, and closing with question content uses the existing unsaved-content guard; note save/transcript export do not pretend to persist it. A future Azure adapter must send `ExactText`, not serialize local `SourceRefs` that retain pre-edit provenance. Accurate armed-Mic start/end boundaries and direct Azure answers remain later workstreams; installed Agency answers are implemented separately. (`src\PhantomFudge.Core\QuestionDraft.cs:48-79,98-125`; `src\PhantomFudge.Core\QuestionSnapshot.cs:17-23`.)

# Validation, exercises, and open questions

## Transparent answers and quiet status



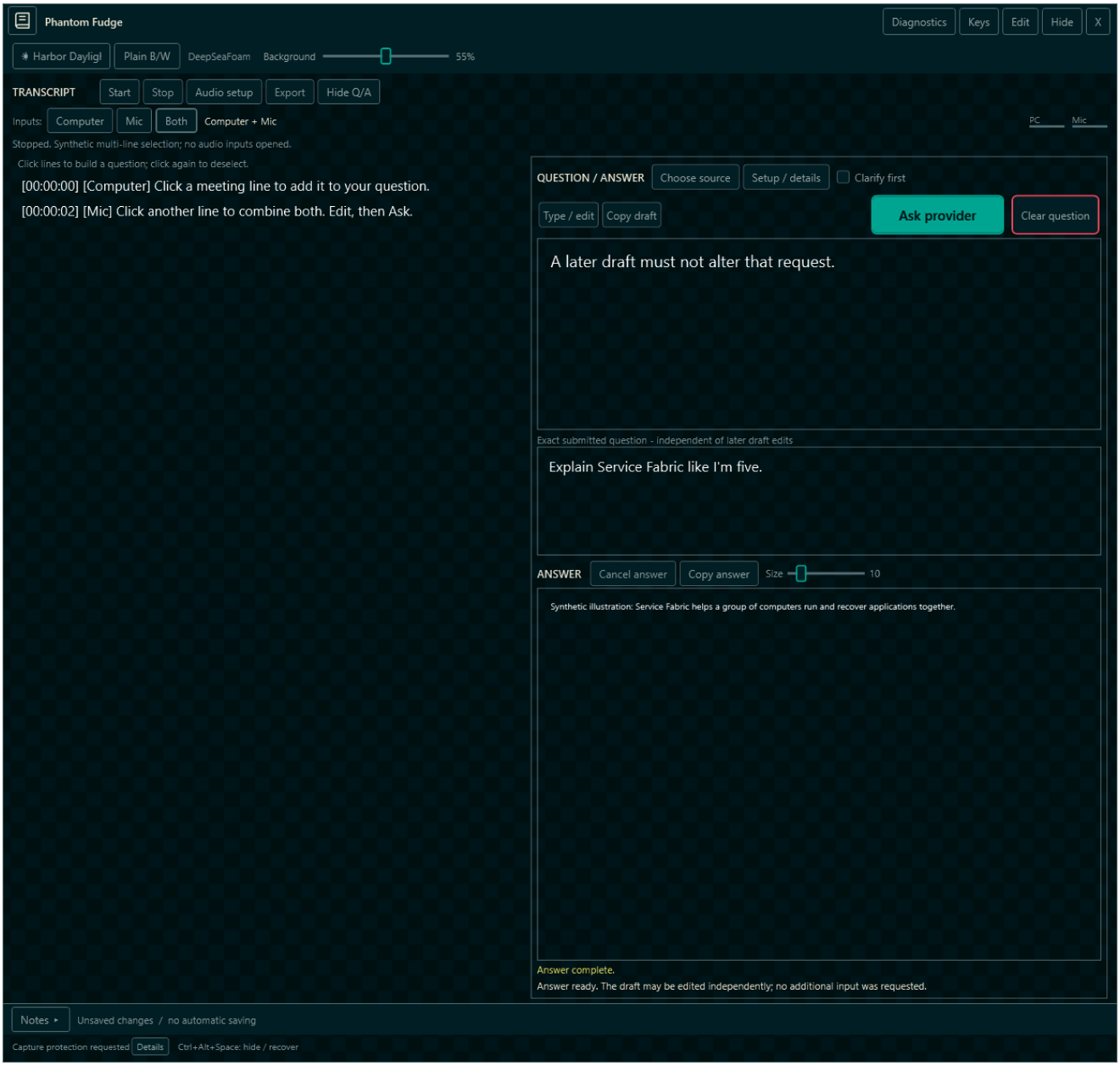



*Two actual synthetic WPF renders; text remains opaque while answer-background coverage changes.* No model prompt, audio device, desktop capture or real provider preparation produces these images. The separate fixture constructor prevents background warming. Their hashes and dimensions are in the screenshot manifest; see the operational correction.

The footer now says **Capture protection requested**, not a long persistent yellow warning or a success claim. **Details** expands the limitations inline. Error reporting and hide-on-failure remain separate; reducing warning clutter is not weakening the capture boundary. (`src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Layout.cs:36-39,148-153`.)

## Installed-provider answers

The question panel now distinguishes **Snapshot only** from an explicitly configured answer provider. Its destination notice identifies installed Agency's remote model service versus an offline loopback model. A plain-text answer stays paired with the frozen question, not the draft being edited afterward. Cancel/Hide/clear/close invalidate the active request; partial output is labelled incomplete rather than silently resumed.




*Actual WPF visual-tree render with a deterministic fake provider.* This image illustrates the answer surface; it is **not** a screenshot of the actual Agency smoke response or evidence of capture exclusion. The real synthetic Agency request is separately recorded in the provider smoke receipt. See provider setup and limits.

`ThemePaletteTests` checks canonical roles, toggle behavior, invalid theme rejection, and contrast of three opaque pairs: reading text/background, selection text/selection, and action text/accent. Its luminance calculation linearizes sRGB channels and requires a ratio of at least 4.5. It does not evaluate every control state, arbitrary backgrounds, or human comfort. (tests\PhantomFudge.Core.Tests\ThemePaletteTests.cs:5-74)

`RunUiSmokeAsync` checks passive device selection, theme resources, alpha samples, scrolling, caption/resize/editor hit tests, and preservation across visibility/mode operations. The documentation mode substitutes generic device names and synthetic text. PNGs use `RenderTargetBitmap` on the actual visual tree; they are not desktop screenshots with the underlying application composited behind them. No live capture is necessary to understand these fixtures. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:942-968,1004-1121,1205-1218)

**Exercise:** Why not implement translucency as `Opacity = 0.1` on the window?
**Answer:** That would fade text and controls as well as the background, violating the implemented solid-text invariant.

**Exercise:** After Plain, which theme does the companion button select?
**Answer:** DeepSeaFoam; `NextThemed` has only one special case, DeepSeaFoam → Harbor Daylight.

**Review question:** What still needs people and hardware?
**Answer:** Readability over real backgrounds, accessibility and mixed-DPI behavior, presentation-focus acceptance, and recipient-side content/cursor qualification. Local tests do not supply owner approval. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:1087-1091; src\PhantomFudge.Core\ThemePalette.cs:28-29; docs\IMPLEMENTATION-STATUS.md:358-366)

# References and maintenance checkpoints

- Main window layout and interaction code.
- Direct transcript selection and synthetic selection diagnostics.
- Application templates: state styling and dynamic resources.
- Palette values, brush adapter, and contrast tests.
- Source labels and palette provenance.

Theme and opacity choices are session-only. Persisted preferences and broader accessibility acceptance must not be inferred from the current controls. Any future popup, template, or rendering change should revisit both local usability assertions and the capture qualification matrix. (docs\CURSOR-AND-THEMES.md:77-86; docs\QUALIFICATION.md:113-130)

# 06 — Notes, Transcripts, and Explicit Storage

## Overview: persistence is a deliberate boundary

Seeing text, retaining it in memory, and saving it are three different events. Phantom Fudge keeps one editable note and an in-memory transcript; neither is automatically a file. The note tracks its last successful saved value. The transcript tracks its last explicitly exported value. These distinctions let the UI warn about unsaved work without silently persisting meeting content. They also mean a crash can lose unexported text: the preview does not implement automatic recovery. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:24-32,303-323,424-431,848-855; docs\IMPLEMENTATION-STATUS.md:304-309,365-366)

Capture exclusion does not extend to a `.txt` file, the clipboard, a native file dialog, or process memory. File storage is therefore designed for bounded input and accidental-overwrite resistance, not advertised as a secure vault. Saving to a user-selected location is an explicit act with the ordinary privacy properties of that location. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:390,431; docs\PRODUCT.md:184-200)

**Newcomer path:** start with the transcript example, then follow Save. **Principal-engineer path:** inspect session-local ID reset, snapshot comparisons, byte bounds, and the remaining check-to-replace race. Chapter 11 explains why session reset must wait for final draining.

## Architecture: separate content lifetimes, one file primitive

Notes use the WPF text editor as their current text surface. `TranscriptBuffer` separately owns accumulated final text and source-specific unfinished text. Both explicit note saves and transcript exports use `NoteFileStore`; no recognizer callback writes a document file. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:303-304,399-444,796-863)

Main transcript rows also retain immutable segment references for direct selection. This lets a reader choose older visible text after the smaller structured chooser evicts it, without parsing the formatted export or changing its capacity/format. Selecting a row creates or revises a local draft, not a saved document. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.TranscriptSelection.cs:13-64,118-131.)




06 — Notes, Transcripts, and Explicit Storage - diagram 1. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

## Components and units

| Component or value | Contract |
| --- | --- |
| `NoteSnapshot` | Text, UTF-8 BOM presence, and SHA-256 fingerprint of original bytes. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\NoteFileStore.cs:6,41-44) |

| Component or value | Contract |
| --- | --- |
| `NoteFileStore.MaximumBytes` | 1,048,576 encoded bytes, including a three-byte BOM when present. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\NoteFileStore.cs:12-19) |
| `TranscriptBuffer.MaximumCharacters` | 250,000 .NET character units for accumulated final/session text; partials are separately bounded. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\TranscriptBuffer.cs:8-10,23-45,63-66) |
| `TranscriptEvent` | Type, text, optional ID/timestamps/source; an event, not a speaker identity. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptEvent.cs:9-15) |
| `AudioSourceNames` | Wire names `computer` / `microphone`; display names `Computer` / `Mic`. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\AudioSource.cs:16-30) |
| `savedText` / `exportedTranscript` | Successful persistence baselines used for equality-based dirty checks. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:28-29,303-304) |

These units must not be conflated. A C# string length counts UTF-16 code units, not UTF-8 bytes or human-perceived characters. `Fits` asks the strict encoder for its actual byte count, including BOM allowance; unpaired surrogates fail rather than becoming replacement characters. The paste handler checks the *resulting note after selection replacement*, while saving checks again. This is not a universal keystroke-by-keystroke size limiter on the editor. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\NoteFileStore.cs:13-24; src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:468-476; src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml:640-647)

# Data flow: recognition becomes a readable history

Transport events are dispatched to the UI thread and handled by `ReceiveTranscript`. A partial calls `SetPartial`; a final calls `AddFinal`. The UI updates structured question state and the visible rows, then hides the placeholder when content exists. Invalid data or a full transcript stops transcription and preserves the existing buffer for export. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:66,170-174,796-824.) `AppendFinalTranscriptRow` follows a new final only when the scrollbar was already at the end; otherwise choosing older history does not jump to the latest speech. Partial rows refresh independently. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.TranscriptSelection.cs:22-64.)

Partials replace a dictionary entry rather than append to history. Keys distinguish Computer and Mic; a legacy unspecified source has its own key. Display ordering is by source key, not arrival time. A final removes only its source's partial. This prevents a Computer sentence from erasing a simultaneously unfinished dictated question. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\TranscriptBuffer.cs:14-19,41-46,69-71,87-96)

Final IDs are globally increasing within a session, not independently increasing per source. `AddFinal` ignores an ID no greater than the last accepted ID *before* removing any partial. An empty valid final advances the ID and clears its source's partial without appending an empty transcript line. The socket is stricter at the protocol boundary: non-increasing received IDs are invalid messages, rather than harmless deduplication. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\TranscriptBuffer.cs:48-72; src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:446-466)

Timestamps are optional in the buffer and rendered as hours/minutes/seconds. Hours do not wrap at 24. Source timestamps may differ because they describe separate input timelines; the display appends received finals, not a globally time-sorted speaker conversation. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\TranscriptBuffer.cs:58-71; tests\PhantomFudge.Core.Tests\TranscriptBufferTests.cs:85-90; tests\PhantomFudge.Core.Tests\SourceTranscriptTests.cs:13-19)

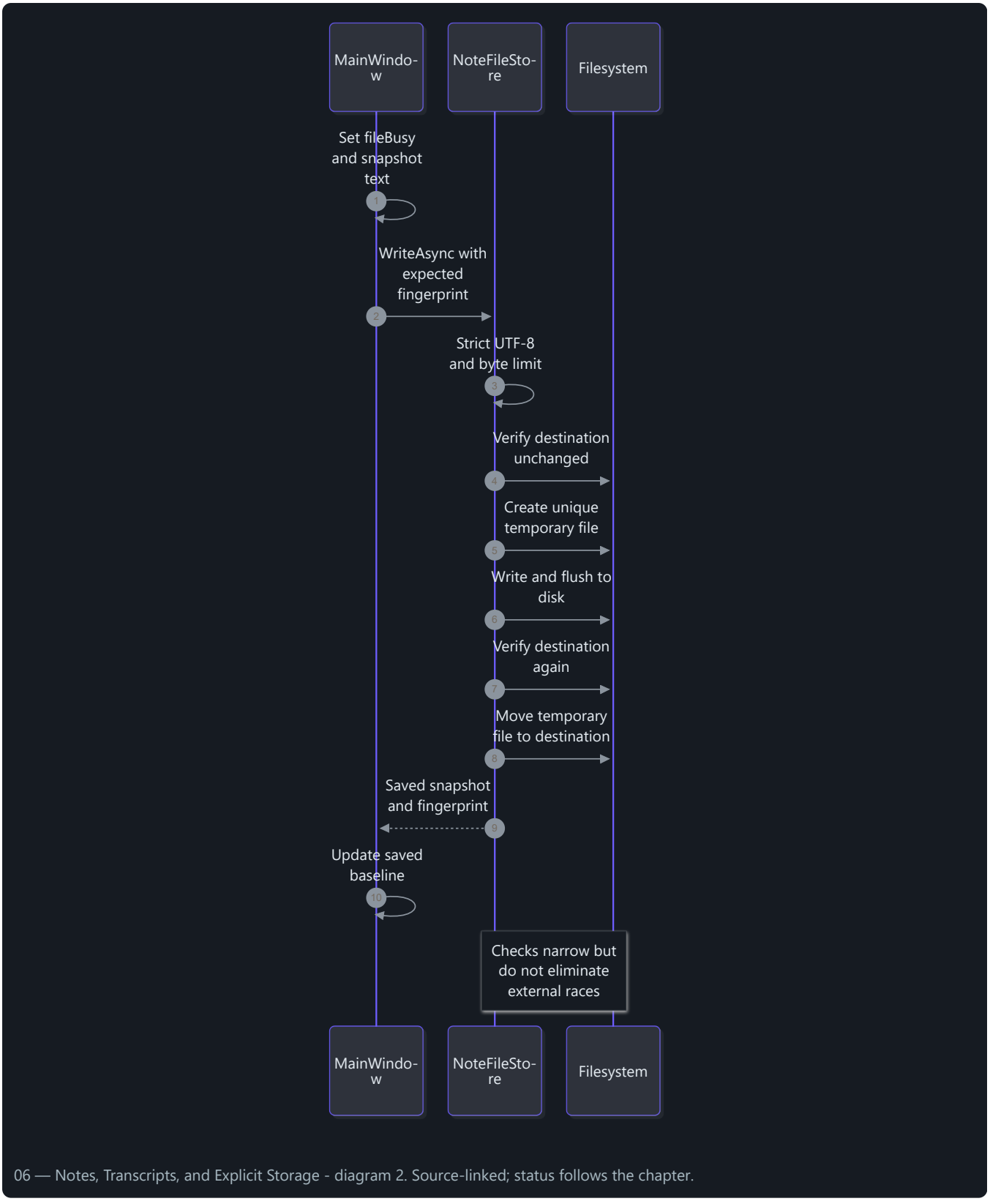
### Session boundaries preserve unfinished work

`BeginSession` first calculates the space needed to preserve old partials as `[Unfinished recognition]` lines and append `--- New session ---` when appropriate. Only after the capacity check succeeds does it append, reset the last ID to zero, and clear partial entries. Failure leaves the previous content available for export. A new Start can therefore retain earlier transcript history without pretending unfinished words were finalized. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\TranscriptBuffer.cs:23-39; tests\PhantomFudge.Core.Tests\TranscriptBufferTests.cs:40-62)

Each partial/final text value is limited to 16,384 character units. Final/session accumulation is capped, but `ExportText` can additionally include the separately bounded partials and markers; 250,000 is not an exact total-memory budget. The buffer uses a `StringBuilder`, while properties materialize strings for the UI. This is bounded content management, not a zero-allocation streaming renderer. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\TranscriptBuffer.cs:8-19,41-66,75-77)

## File implementation: validate, stage, verify, rename

`ReadAsync` reads in 16,384-byte chunks and enforces the cap as data arrives rather than trusting a pre-read file length. It recognizes an optional UTF-8 BOM, decodes strictly, and fingerprints the complete original byte sequence. It does not normalize line endings or guess UTF-16. The file is opened with `FileShare.ReadWrite`, so this is not a locked snapshot against a concurrent external writer. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\NoteFileStore.cs:27-44)




06 — Notes, Transcripts, and Explicit Storage - diagram 2. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

`WriteAsync` stages bytes in `.phantom-<guid>.tmp` beside the destination, with exclusive sharing and `CreateNew`. It flushes asynchronously and then requests a disk flush. After a second fingerprint check and cancellation check, it calls `File.Move` with overwrite allowed only when an expected fingerprint was supplied. The `finally` block attempts to delete any remaining temporary file. This is a same-directory staged/atomic-rename pattern, not an in-place rewrite of the original. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\NoteFileStore.cs:47-80)

The expected fingerprint carries two meanings:

- **Null:** the caller expects a new path. An existing file is a conflict, and the move must not overwrite.
- **Non-null:** the caller expects particular existing bytes. Missing or changed bytes are a conflict.

For Save As over an existing file, the UI first obtains that file's current fingerprint after the user's dialog decision. A later conflict reports that edits remain in memory and recommends Save As, without silently choosing whose version wins. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\NoteFileStore.cs:83-95; src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:408-438)

The tradeoff is optimistic coordination. A writer can still change the destination between the final verification and move. The code provides no cross-process compare-and-swap primitive, secure erasure, encryption, directory durability guarantee, or universal network-filesystem atomicity. Temporary cleanup can itself fail. These limitations matter when interpreting “atomic save”: staged replacement avoids many partial-write failures but does not make every concurrent or catastrophic failure impossible. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\NoteFileStore.cs:60-95; TODO\08_LOCAL_STORAGE.todo:15-34)

## UI snapshots and unsaved decisions

`SetFileBusy` disables the note editor and confirmation panel and updates command availability. `SaveNoteAsync` captures `NoteEditor.Text` into `content`; only a successful write changes `savedText`, path, and fingerprint. Open updates the editor only after a successful read and resets undo history. Failures retain the current note. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:373-456)

Export similarly snapshots `transcript.ExportText()` and records that exact value after success. Unlike the note editor, recognition callbacks can continue while an export is awaiting I/O in Edit mode. If new transcript content arrives, it differs from `exportedTranscript`, so it remains dirty rather than being falsely marked saved. Exports are BOM-free and include unfinished-recognition labels; they do not save raw audio. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:303-304,796-819,828-863)

Exit awaits Stop before checking transcript dirtiness. New/Open concern note dirtiness; Exit considers both. The inline confirmation offers save, export, discard, or cancel. Saving notes alone cannot finish Exit while the transcript remains dirty, and exporting alone cannot proceed while notes remain dirty. In Present, save/export are refused until deliberate Edit. Clear is also refused while running, starting, or stopping, and while transcript content is unexported. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:306-371,399-405,828-834,866-886)

## Preserve content; reset the right metadata

New deliberately resets the note path, fingerprint, BOM flag, saved baseline, and editor text. It then toggles undo off and on so a new document does not inherit the previous document's undo history. Open performs an equivalent undo reset only after decoding succeeds. In contrast, collapse, theme, wrapping, and font-size changes do not represent document replacement. Keeping those categories separate prevents a visual operation from accidentally becoming a data-loss operation. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:341-350,381-389,480-481,492-527)

Dirty tracking is equality-based rather than a permanently latched “was edited” bit: returning the note to `savedText` makes it clean again. That answers whether the current in-memory text differs from the last successful save; it does **not** answer whether an external program has since edited the disk file. The fingerprint

comparison answers that second question when a save is attempted. This separation explains why the UI can show a locally clean note while a later Save reports an external conflict. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:303,424-438,464-466; src\PhantomFudge.Core\NoteFileStore.cs:83-95)

# Worked examples and Python comparison

Consider this sequence, using conceptual timestamps:

```
partial Computer: "remote words"
partial Mic:      "my question"
final #1 Computer at 1.0 seconds: "remote sentence"
final #2 Mic      at 0.5 seconds: "my question"
```

The first final removes only the Computer partial. The Mic partial remains until final #2. Output order follows accepted IDs, even though the Mic start time is lower. Replaying final #1 cannot erase newer unfinished Mic text. These exact properties are exercised in `SourceTranscriptTests`. (tests\PhantomFudge.Core.Tests\SourceTranscriptTests.cs:5-19,37-55)

The following **explanatory pseudocode is not production code**. It omits encoding, cancellation, filesystem semantics, and native UI behavior:

```
def add_final(segment_id, source, words):
    if segment_id <= last_id:
        return False
    line = format_line(source, words) if words else ""
    check_capacity_before_mutation(line)
    last_id = segment_id
    partials.pop(source, None)
    history.append(line)

async def save_snapshot(text, expected_hash):
    verify_current_bytes(expected_hash)
    temporary = await write_and_flush_beside_destination(text)
    verify_current_bytes(expected_hash)
    rename_to_destination(temporary)
```

The C# `Dictionary` provides source-keyed replacement, `StringBuilder` accumulates history, and `await using` scopes asynchronous file disposal. Two fingerprint checks are an intentional narrowing of a race window, not proof that the window has vanished. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\TranscriptBuffer.cs:9-10,48-72; src\PhantomFudge.Core\NoteFileStore.cs:60-80)

# Tests, exercises, and remaining limits

`NoteFileStoreTests` covers Unicode and mixed-newline/BOM round trips, changed/deleted destinations, invalid UTF-8, oversized reads/writes, byte accounting, and pre-cancelled writes. Transcript tests cover deduplication, unfinished preservation, long timestamps, full-buffer behavior, and independent sources. These

are deterministic policy checks, not exhaustive disk-full, permission, crash-recovery, or filesystem-race qualification. (tests\PhantomFudge.Core.Tests\NoteFileStoreTests.cs:13-109; tests\PhantomFudge.Core.Tests\TranscriptBufferTests.cs:5-115; tests\PhantomFudge.Core.Tests\SourceTranscriptTests.cs:5-87; TODO\08_LOCAL_STORAGE.todo:25-34)

**Exercise:** Why fingerprint bytes rather than only compare decoded text?
**Answer:** The byte fingerprint also distinguishes representation changes such as a BOM. The snapshot returns text and BOM separately.

**Exercise:** Is `[Mic]` a person identifier?
**Answer:** No; it is the selected microphone track's display label.

**Exercise:** Does collapsing Notes save or discard them?
**Answer:** Neither. The handler changes visibility; persistence remains explicit.

The answers follow `ReadAsync`, `AudioSourceNames.DisplayName`, and `SetNotesExpanded`, respectively. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\NoteFileStore.cs:41-44; src\PhantomFudge.Core\AudioSource.cs:25-30; src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:511-521)

# A separate local question is not a saved transcript

Optional Clarify first keeps the original question apart from its reply field and stores only completed interpretation exchanges. Those exchanges are explicitly included with a correction/confirmation request, not appended to the transcript export or ordinary Ask. Clear, toggle-off and destination changes reset this local conversation, not remote retention. (Clarification state.)

The question composer does not change `TranscriptBuffer` export. Its smaller `StructuredTranscriptStore` chooser retains at most256entries/64000characters with source/session/ utterance/revision identity, preserving active partial identities or rejecting an update that cannot fit. `QuestionDraft` keeps copies of explicitly selected entries, so rolling history eviction cannot silently change the chosen prompt. A manual edit prevents later ASR from replacing its text. (`src\PhantomFudge.Core\StructuredTranscriptStore.cs:13-34,134-145`; `src\PhantomFudge.Core\QuestionDraft.cs:18-79`.)

The main final and partial ListBoxes bind `TranscriptRow`, pairing display text with a structured segment. Main-history rows survive chooser eviction until transcript clearing; accumulated history still obeys `TranscriptBuffer`'s250000-character final/session bound, with live partials separately bounded. `ArchiveTranscriptPartials` preserves unfinished identity when a session ends; separators carry no segment and cannot be selected. This is retained visible history, not unlimited storage or permission to mix capture sessions. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.TranscriptSelection.cs:13-64; `TranscriptBuffer`.)

Ordinary clicks toggle several whole segments, including wrapped/multiline text. The handler combines selected raw `Text` in displayed history order and calls `QuestionDraft.ReplaceSelection`, just as the manual **Choose source** → **Mic / Computer / All** → **Use selected** path does. Both enforce one capture session,256entries and8192UTF-16 units including newlines before committing. Direct clicks add a user-edit guard: once corrections exist, retain draft/highlights and show inline status until **Clear question**, instead of silently replacing them. Selection itself never calls Ask or Freeze. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.TranscriptSelection.cs:85-147; `QuestionDraft.ReplaceSelection`; `UseQuestionSelection_Click`.)

Selection highlights follow stable keys through partial revisions and finalization before manual editing. Clearing a stopped/exported transcript clears visible rows without erasing copied draft text; **Clear question** instead resets the draft/highlights and last displayed snapshot. Neither mutates a previously created snapshot object. The diagnostic exercises these lifetimes without opening audio or invoking a model. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.TranscriptSelection.cs:66-83; src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.TranscriptSelectionDiagnostics.cs:55-124.)

`QuestionSnapshot` is an immutable in-memory object. It is neither a note save nor a transcript export, and its local provenance includes original selected text that a future model adapter must not serialize as hidden context. Only `ExactText` is the installed-provider question payload. The local UI extends unsaved-exit handling for questions; Copy/Clear are explicit. Azure submission remains absent. (`src\PhantomFudge.Core\QuestionSnapshot.cs:5-23`; `src\PhantomFudge.Core\QuestionDraft.cs:81-102`; local question guide.)

This object-lifetime statement is not a blanket no-retention claim. Installed Agency/model services can retain their own session data, and explicit diagnostic Text mode can retain final transcripts, submitted questions and answers locally. Default app logs contain metadata only; notes, tokens and raw audio are never diagnostic content categories. Clear does not erase already-written logs. (`src/PhantomFudge.Core/Diagnostics/LocalDiagnostics.cs:18-24,132-159`; diagnostic retention.)

# References and maintenance checkpoints

- File store and file tests.
- Transcript buffer, source definitions, and event record.
- Retained rows and direct selection and question usage.
- UI commands, buffer tests, and source-isolation tests.
- Storage workstream: open fault-injection and recovery gates.

Changing encoding, session IDs, export format, or automatic persistence would change the contracts in this chapter. In particular, planned recovery must remain labelled unimplemented until its retention, failure, and reveal behavior actually exists. (docs\ARCHITECTURE.md:264-278)

# 7. Dual-input capture: two sources, one owned session

## Why two inputs must not become one waveform

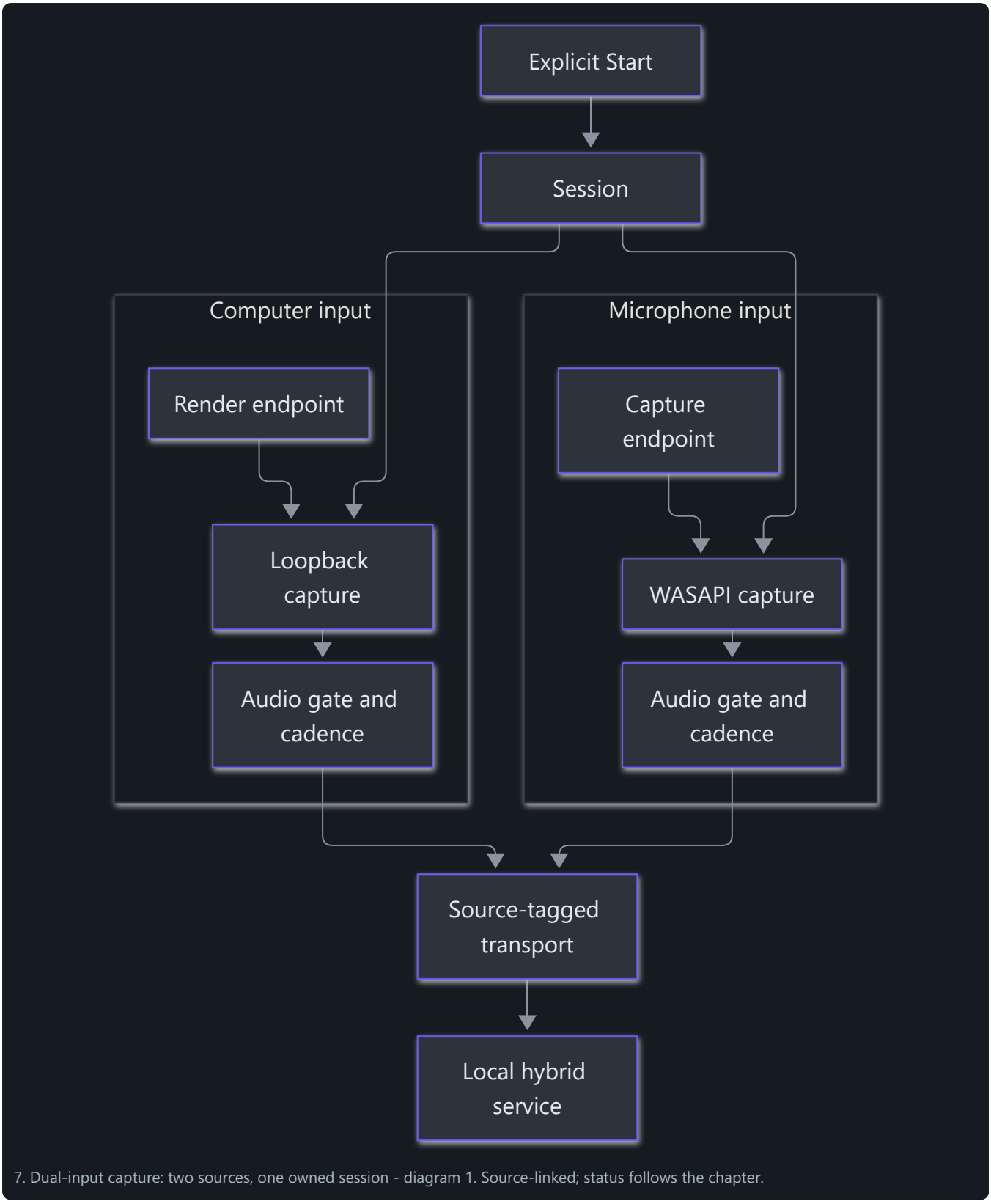
Imagine listening to computer playback while dictating a question into a microphone. Adding the samples together would discard the distinction the reader needs: which text came from playback, and which came from dictation? Phantom Fudge instead preserves two acquisition paths. `WasapiInput` selects render loopback for Computer and a capture endpoint for Microphone; each becomes a separate source-tagged stream. This is input attribution, **not speaker identification**. Several people can speak through Computer, and playback can acoustically reappear in Mic. The implementation contains no mixing or acoustic-echo-cancellation stage. (`src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\WasapiInput.cs:20-55`, `WasapiInput`; `docs\DUAL-SOURCE-AUDIO.md:8-23`, "Design and boundaries".)

The equally important distinction is **selection versus capture**. `MainWindow` defaults `captureMode` to `Both`, populates device lists, and subscribes to notifications; its constructor does not start recording. `Start_Click` checks the requested selections, protection readiness, and token before calling the transcriber. Merely launching the idle Python service is not permission to acquire audio. (`src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:35-96`, `MainWindow`; `src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:652-700`, `Start_Click`; `scripts\Run-PhantomFudge.ps1:39-55`, launcher.)

This chapter follows that boundary from a deliberate Start to the last endpoint release. Chapter 8 continues at the socket; chapter 9 follows the independent recognizers.

## The ownership map

The class name `LoopbackTranscriber` preserves its computer-only history, but its `Session` now owns an array of `Input` objects. Each input owns its endpoint ID, callback handlers, audio lock, silence cadence, startup task, recording-stopped completion, and latest level. The session owns one transport and shared cancellation/failure state. This divides mutable audio state without dividing the user's Start/Stop transaction. (`src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:496-547`, `Input` and `Session`.)




7. Dual-input capture: two sources, one owned session - diagram 1. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

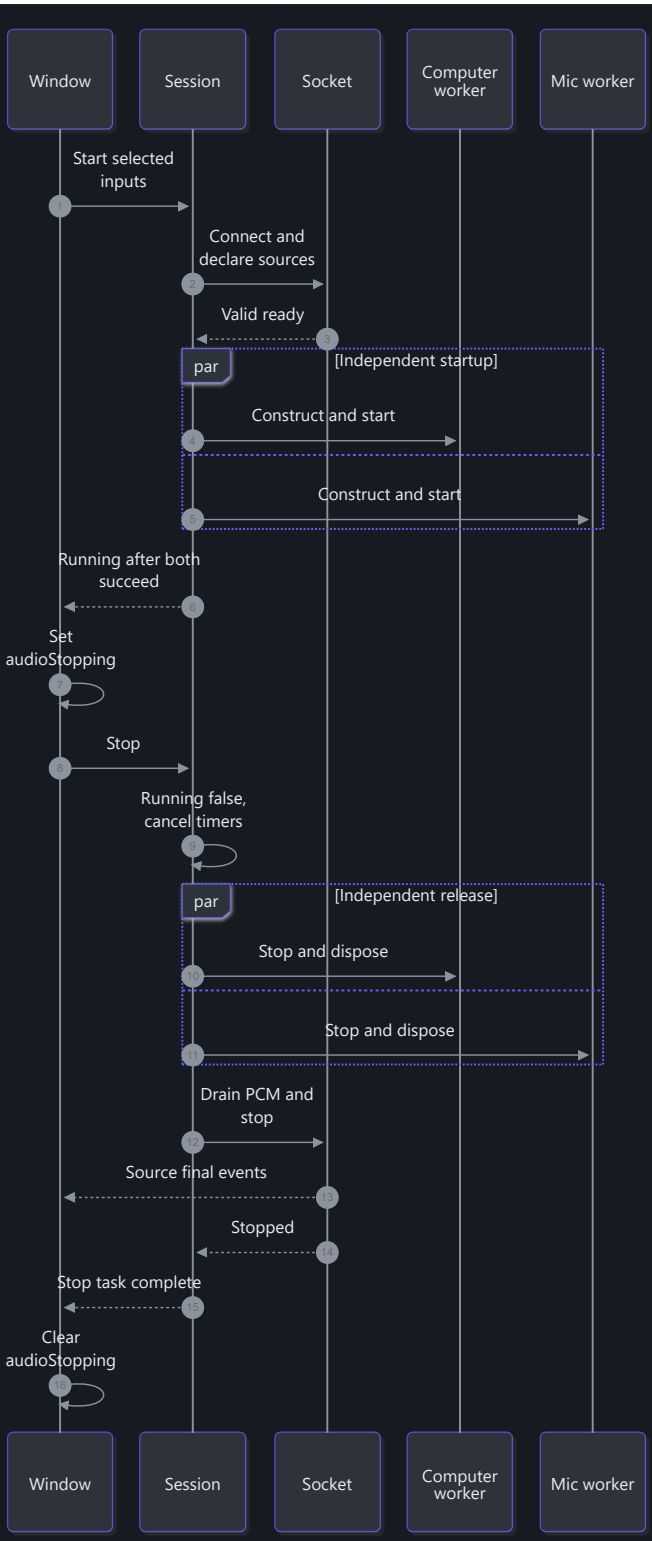
The diagram describes ownership and data flow, not synchronized acoustic clocks. The endpoint branches are constructed independently after transport readiness.
(`src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:102-128`, `StartCoreAsync`.)

| API or type | Exact role and consequence |
| --- | --- |
| `AudioSource` | Byte values `Computer = 1`, `Microphone = 2`; wire/display names are centralized. (`src\PhantomFudge.Core\AudioSource.cs:3-30`, `AudioSourceNames`.) |
| `AudioInputSelection` | Nullable Computer/Microphone IDs represent the requested subset. (`src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptEvent.cs:5-7`, record declarations.) |
| `StartAsync(string, Uri, string, CancellationToken)` | Legacy Computer-only, protocol-v1 entry point. (`src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:65-66`, `StartAsync`.) |
| `StartAsync(AudioInputSelection, …)` | Protocol v2, including either single-source mode. (`src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:68-70`, `StartAsync`.) |
| `SourceLevelChanged` | Reports a source and its latest normalized RMS value. (`src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:288-311`, `PublishLevel`, `CalculateLevel`.) |
| `LevelChanged` | Compatibility aggregate: maximum of latest input levels, not a mixed waveform's RMS. (`src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:288-298`, `PublishLevel`.) |

# The Start journey: readiness before native acquisition

`ValidateSelection` rejects an empty subset, whitespace IDs, and identical IDs for both requested inputs. `WasapiInput.MatchesSelection` then requires exact ordinal ID equality, the correct direction, and `DeviceState.Active`. Enumeration does not silently choose the current Windows default at capture time. The UI may initially select the first enumerated device, but the actual start uses that explicit ID. (`src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:142-157`, `ValidateSelection`; `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\WasapiInput.cs:64-74`, `MatchesSelection`; `src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:589-617`, `RefreshDevices`.)

Startup first reserves a session and connects its transport. Only after `ConnectAsync` accepts the service's `ready` response are input startup tasks scheduled. Native construction itself is inside `Task.Run`, not just `StartRecording`. The source comment identifies why: NAudio captures the construction-time synchronization context, so constructing on the WPF dispatcher could make a later native join depend on the very UI thread waiting for completion. (`src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:87-115`, `StartCoreAsync`.)




7. Dual-input capture: two sources, one owned session - diagram 2. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

`Running` becomes true only when every startup succeeded, no input already reported `RecordingStopped`, no fault exists, and Stop was not requested. This is not a promise that the two devices started at the same physical instant. Audio acceptance is enabled inside each worker before its `StartRecording` call, whereas the aggregate running state is established after all startup tasks complete.
(`src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:112-125`, `StartCoreAsync`; `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:195-219`, `StartCapture`.)

# A callback, measured in bytes rather than intuition

Both WASAPI wrappers request shared-mode **16,000 Hz, 16-bit, mono PCM**. Computer uses `WasapiLoopbackCapture`; Mic uses `WasapiCapture`. The wrapper documents NAudio's shared-capture conversion flags rather than implementing a custom application resampler. (`src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\WasapiInput.cs:48-54`, constructor.)

The format yields:

- `16,000 samples/second × 2 bytes/sample = 32,000 bytes/second` per source.
- A 100 ms silence frame contains `1,600 samples = 3,200 bytes`.
- A 48,000-byte callback represents 1.5 seconds of this PCM. `OnAudio` splits it into 32,000 and 16,000 bytes; the v2 transport adds a source byte to each, producing 32,001- and 16,001-byte binary messages.
- Two live sources produce 64,000 PCM bytes/second before framing overhead—not a 32 kHz mixed track.

These are calculations from `WaveFormat`, the socket constants, and the callback chunking loop, not measured hardware callback sizes. (`src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\WasapiInput.cs:53-54`, constructor; `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:13-18`, constants; `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:234-278`, `OnAudio`; `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:217-226`, `TryEnqueueAudio`.)

`OnAudio` rejects invalid lengths, records packet arrival under that input's `AudioGate`, and enqueues copied chunks. Copying matters because a capture callback's buffer is reusable: the sender must not later observe a buffer that the capture implementation or caller has overwritten. A full transport budget faults the session rather than pretending the missing chunk was silence. (`src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:239-271`, `OnAudio`; `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:191-238`, `TryEnqueueAudio`.)

Metering is throttled to approximately one update per 100 ms of callback time. Samples are read little-endian, divided by 32,768, squared, averaged, and square-rooted. Alternating `+16,384` and `-16,384` therefore yields RMS `0.5`, not zero; opposite signs cancel in an arithmetic mean but not in energy. `LevelAsync` tests that exact distinction. (`src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:273-310`, `OnAudio`, `CalculateLevel`; `tests\PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests\Program.cs:202-209`, `LevelAsync`.)

# Silence cadence is transport continuity, not endpoint tuning

An idle track has its own 100 ms periodic timer. `SilenceCadence.TrySchedule` permits one silence frame only after at least 250 ms without a real packet and at least 100 ms since the previous synthetic frame. A real packet resets both timestamps. The shared per-input lock prevents a recent packet and silence decision from racing within that track. (`src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\SilenceCadence.cs:5-19`, `SilenceCadence`; `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:313-338`, `SupplySilenceAsync`.)

For example, after a packet at 1,000 ms, a decision at 1,249 ms fails; one at 1,250 ms may succeed. A delayed decision at 10,000 ms still emits only one 3,200-byte frame—it does not manufacture every missing interval. Timer scheduling can place the actual decision later than the threshold. Computer activity does not reset Mic's cadence, and vice versa. The corresponding synthetic tests check both the threshold and cross-source independence. (`tests\PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests\Program.cs:212-225`, `SilenceCadenceAsync`; `tests\PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests\DualSourceTests.cs:502-523`, `DualInputPolicyAsync`.)

Consequently, these timestamps describe **callback arrival and supplied PCM**, not acoustic onset measurements. Cadence does not change Vosk endpoint settings; its implementation only creates zero PCM. The Vosk wrapper retains its separate 30-second history reset, but that is **not the current hybrid span policy**. Hybrid recognition cuts owned PCM at an endpoint or a 15-second target, with a 16-second maximum, and replaces the provisional decoder at each cut. (`src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:15`, `SilenceFrame`; `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:325-333`, `SupplySilenceAsync`; `services\transcription\recognizer.py:96-107`, `VoskRecognizer.accept`; `services\transcription\accurate.py:12-14`, span constants; `services\transcription\accurate.py:48-71`, `HybridRecognizer.accept`, `finish`.)

### What the October 9 accuracy change does—and does not—change

The default recognizer now uses Vosk for provisional text and local Whisper `small.en` for finals, configured as CPU int8 with four threads and disclosed general technical vocabulary. This changes interpretation **after acquisition**; it does not replace WASAPI, merge the inputs, repair microphone acoustics, or make a provisional spelling authoritative. `HybridRecognizer.finish` hands retained PCM to the finalizer rather than promoting Vosk's last guess. (`services\transcription\configuration.py:8-35`, defaults and `load_config`; `services\transcription\accurate.py:65-88`, `finish`, `WhisperFinalizer.__init__`.)

At 32,000 bytes/second, the 15-second target represents 480,000 PCM bytes per source. A maximum-size frame may cross that target, so `FinalSpan` allows at most 512,000 bytes. These retained recognition spans are distinct from the native transport's pending-byte budget. A responsive meter proves callback energy, not successful Whisper finalization; similarly, an empty final may represent silence while still closing an owned time interval. The finalizer uses exact sample-span boundaries, not microphone onset or word-alignment measurements. (`services\transcription\accurate.py:17-30`, `FinalSpan`; `services\transcription\accurate.py:41-63`, span extraction; `services\transcription\accurate.py:90-118`, `WhisperFinalizer.__call__`.)

## Cancellation must invalidate tomorrow's queued Start

A semaphore alone would serialize requests but could allow a Start already queued behind another operation to run after the user's Stop. `_stopVersion` solves that ordering problem. Start snapshots it before waiting; Stop increments it before waiting for lifecycle ownership. A queued Start with an old version is rejected before allocating its session. (`src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:72-94`, `StartCoreAsync`; `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:159-192`, `StopAsync`, `RequestStop`.)

The following Python-shaped pseudocode translates that C# algorithm; it is not another implementation:

```
async def start(selection):
    observed_stop_version = atomic_read(stop_version)
    async with lifecycle:
        require_not_disposed()
        require_no_session_or_outstanding_release()
        inputs = validate(selection)
        with request_lock:
            if observed_stop_version != stop_version:
                raise StartupCanceled()
            session = reserve(inputs)
        await connect_and_validate_ready(session)
        await start_each_input_on_workers(session)

async def stop():
    with request_lock:
        increment_stop_version()
        request_current_session_stop()
    async with lifecycle:
        await finish_current_session()
```

`V2QueuedStartAsync` tests both Stop and Dispose against a pending handshake and a second queued Start. Its important assertion is not merely “eventually stopped”: only one handshake occurred, and no hardware seam was reached. ( `tests\PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests\DualSourceTests.cs:475-500` , `V2QueuedStartAsync` .)

# Stop is a drain, while failure is an abort

| Boundary | Implemented behavior |
| --- | --- |
| Normal Stop | Clear `Running` , cancel startup/silence, release inputs, then dispose the transport through its drain path. ( `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:387-447` , `StopSessionAsync` , `FinishSessionAsync` ; `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:532-546` , `Session.RequestStop` .) |
| Startup wait | Ten-second capture-start wait, cancellable; this cannot forcibly terminate a native call. ( `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:13-14` , constants; `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:112-115` , `StartCoreAsync` .) |
| Native release | Independent release workers; aggregate five-second wait. A hung input does not prevent the responsive input's worker from releasing it. ( `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:408-426` , `FinishSessionAsync` .) |
| Late native return | Worker awaits its startup task, stops capture, waits for recording completion when applicable, disposes, and detaches handlers. ( `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:449-493` , `ReleaseInputAsync` .) |
| Unsafe restart | Outstanding release blocks another Start; cleanup failure sets a sticky guard. ( `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:82-85` , `StartCoreAsync` ; `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:479-483` , `ReleaseInputAsync` .) |

Five seconds is **not an end-to-end Stop deadline**: transport final-drain has a separate maximum wait, now 90 seconds for the hybrid backend's conservative 85-second pending-work envelope. This is a failure-containment ceiling, not normal latency. Nor does timing out prove the operating system released the endpoint. Ownership remains with the outstanding worker; the user-facing fault asks for app closure rather than silently opening another device. ( `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:20-79` , transport

timeout ownership; `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:264-289`, `StopAsync`; `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:408-434`, `FinishSessionAsync`; `tools\SpeechBench\results\synthetic-quality-20261009.json:12733-12742`, production setup check and `max_stop_seconds`.)

For comparison, the adopted synthetic short-case run measured Stop-to-`stopped` median **0.480 seconds** and p95 **0.746 seconds**. Its long dual-source stress drained in **3.419 seconds**. Neither measures physical endpoint release or an actual user's Stop gesture through WPF; the distinct measurements must not be collapsed into "Stop takes 90 seconds" or "all stops complete within 746 ms." (`tools\SpeechBench\results\synthetic-quality-20261009.json:6614-6618`, adopted stop distribution; `tools\SpeechBench\results\synthetic-quality-20261009.json:8693-8726`, long stress.)

The UI therefore maintains `audioStopping` independently of `IsRunning`. It disables Start and input changes until the stop task finishes. Without that distinction, `transcript.BeginSession()` could reset final-ID and partial state while old-session finals were still arriving. (`src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:652-689`, `Start_Click`; `src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:720-793`, audio controls and stop methods; `src\PhantomFudge.Core\TranscriptBuffer.cs:23-39`, `BeginSession`.)

For faults, `SignalFault` publishes only the first failure, disables both inputs, aborts transport, and queues cleanup. It deliberately avoids acquiring the other input's audio lock from a callback: simultaneous failures would otherwise risk lock inversion. Normal final-drain guarantees do not apply to this abort path. (`src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:362-385`, `SignalFault`.)

# Failure scenarios and evidence limits

Unplugging either selected endpoint stops the whole session; changing the Windows default does not switch it. `RenderEndpointNotification` filters by ID, invalidates once, and dispatches cleanup notification onto the thread pool so the Core Audio callback returns promptly.
(`src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\RenderEndpointNotification.cs:10-30`, notification methods.)

Synthetic tests exercise denied construction, failed startup, concurrent device loss, hung startup/stop, and failed disposal. `DualCaptureAsync` additionally checks readiness-before-opening, copied PCM, independent silence, and levels. These are executable descriptions of ownership guarantees—not evidence that every microphone driver behaves correctly. No tests were run for this documentation task.
(`tests\PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests\DualSourceTests.cs:526-602`, `DualCaptureAsync`; `tests\PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests\DualSourceTests.cs:702-868`, failure scenarios.)

The October 9 public validation receipt records **104 service tests and 18 benchmark tests**, with no real endpoint or cloud ASR. The accompanying operator handoff separately reports **46 native checks** and a real C# → hybrid v2 generated-PCM integration: Computer produced two finals/seven partials and Mic two finals/five partials. Those native counts are handoff evidence, not fields in the Python receipt or executions performed by this documentation pass. Generated PCM reaching real models is stronger than a fake decoder, but remains different from acquiring the user's voice. (`tools\SpeechBench\results\quality-validation-20261009.json:4-17`, recorded test scope; `tools\SpeechBench\results\synthetic-quality-20261009.json:6620-6627`, synthetic qualification limits.)

Actual microphone permission behavior, echo, recorder-visible OS privacy indicators, and hardware quality remain separate qualification questions. Source labels cannot remove echo, suppress Windows indicators, or establish who spoke. (`docs\DUAL-SOURCE-AUDIO.md:10-26`, boundaries; `docs\QUALIFICATION.md:1-7`, qualification status.)

## Reader checkpoints

1. Trace a Stop arriving while a second Start waits on `_lifecycle`. Which comparison prevents reopening?
2. Compute the two wire-message lengths for a 40,000-byte Computer callback. Which byte is excluded from PCM duration?
3. Explain why a Mic stop hang must not block Computer release, yet must block a fresh session.
4. At 300 ms of callback silence, what can be inferred about supplied PCM—and what cannot be inferred about acoustic timing?
5. Why can a correct source label and byte-exact final span coexist with an incorrect “to” instead of “two”? Distinguish acquisition, ownership, and recognition quality.

## Source-reading route

Read source identities, endpoint ownership, session orchestration, silence decisions, then synthetic lifecycle cases. Following this order separates format, ownership, timing, and evidence before introducing the wire protocol.

# 8. Streaming protocol: preserving identity under backpressure

## Why the protocol is more than a pipe

A socket that moves bytes successfully can still produce an incorrect transcript: it can mix sources, accumulate unbounded delay, accept replayed final IDs, or report completion before a decoder flushes. Phantom Fudge's protocol makes those boundaries explicit. The C# client owns admission and copied PCM; Python owns per-source decoding and publication; both reject invalid transitions rather than guessing how to recover. (`src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:194-238`, `TryEnqueueAudio`; `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:398-477`, `ProcessMessage`; `services\transcription\server.py:280-536`, `Session`.)

Compatibility is deliberately additive. Both speech versions use `/v1/transcribe`; v1 has unprefixed Computer PCM, while v2 declares a source subset and prefixes each binary message. The URL's `v1` does not imply Computer-only operation. Management independently retains `protocolVersion: 1` and advertises `speechProtocolVersions: [1, 2]`. (`services\transcription\server.py:100-112`, `parse_start`; `services\transcription\server.py:218-244`, `runtime_info`; `services\transcription\server.py:319-326`, `Session.receive`; `services\transcription\server.py:649-652`, routes.)

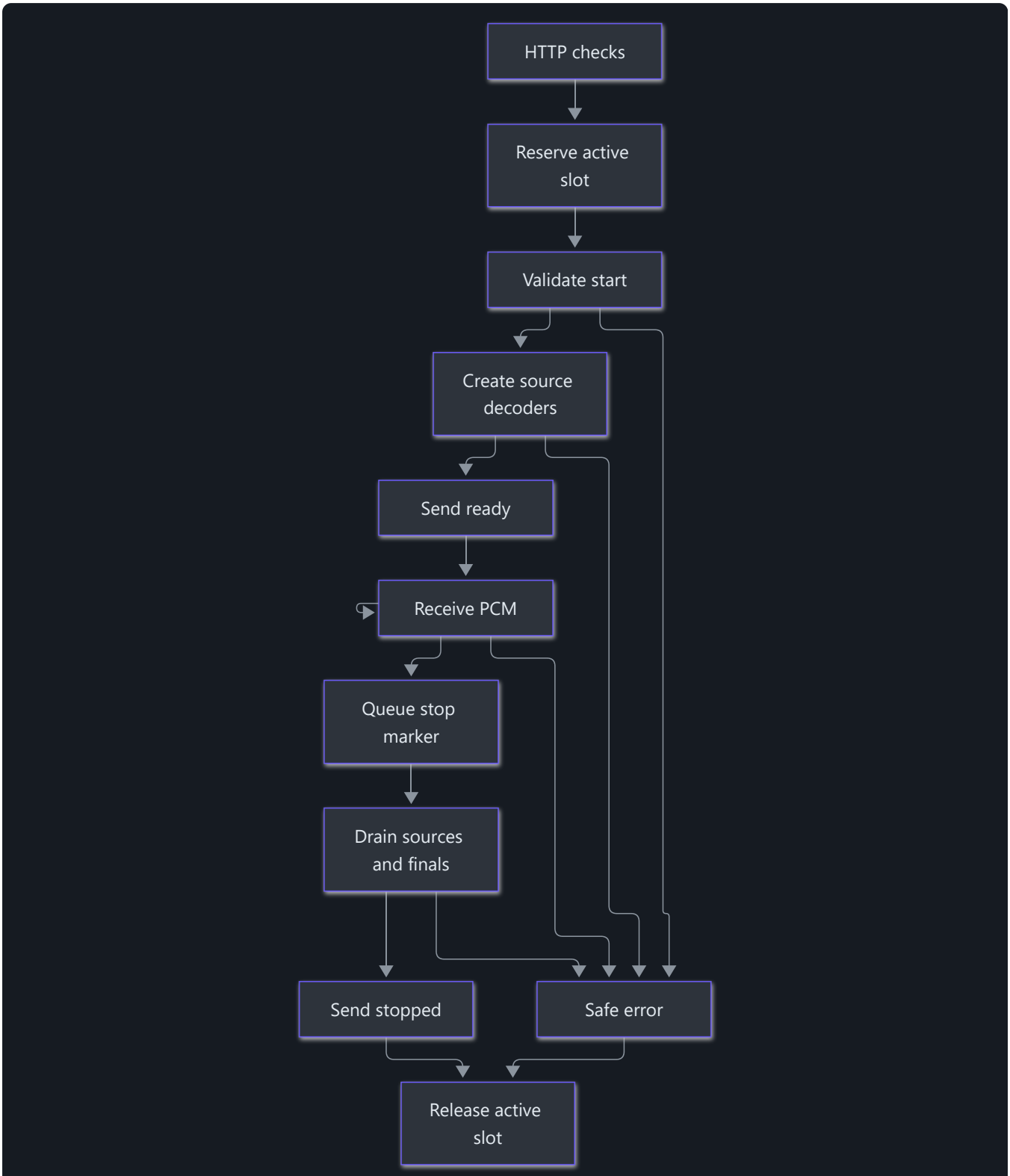
The October 9 hybrid engine changes the work **behind** this contract, not the JSON schema or source byte. Vosk supplies provisional text; Whisper supplies final text from bounded, disjoint PCM spans. Neither an engine selector nor vocabulary belongs in a speech start message. The public validation receipt still records versions 1 and 2; pipeline version 2 is a runtime implementation identity, not speech v3. (`services\transcription\accurate.py:48-71`, `HybridRecognizer`; `services\transcription\configuration.py:8-14`, defaults and `PIPELINE_VERSION`; `tools\SpeechBench\results\quality-validation-20261009.json:7-10`, protocol versions.)

## Admission before audio

`TranscriptionSocket.ValidateEndpoint` accepts only literal IPv4 or IPv6 loopback WebSocket URLs with the exact path. It rejects hostname resolution, user information, queries, fragments, escaped paths, and alternate numeric IP spellings. Proxies and redirects are disabled. The production native launcher uses IPv4 `127.0.0.1`; accepting `[::1]` in the client does not mean the default server binds IPv6. (`src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:26-31`, HTTP handler; `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:82-98`, `ValidateEndpoint`; `services\transcription\manage.py:229-234`, `start`.)

On the server, nonempty `Origin` headers are rejected, authentication requires exactly one Bearer header, and token comparison uses `hmac.compare_digest`. Query strings and request bodies are not accepted. Readiness and the single active-session gate are checked before upgrading. `runtime.active = True` occurs without an

intervening `await`, so even a client stalled before its start message occupies the only admission slot. (`services\transcription\server.py:210-215`, `authorized`; `services\transcription\server.py:538-563`, `transcribe`.)




8. Streaming protocol: preserving identity under backpressure - diagram 1. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

This state sketch includes the normal stop marker, not an automatic retry or reconnect. A `TranscriptionSocket` is single-use; a fresh transcription session creates a fresh transport. (`src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:128-142`, `ConnectCoreAsync`; `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:517-524`, `Session`.)

# The contract, field by field

These are complete start messages, with no token in JSON:

```
{"type":"start","sampleRate":16000,"channels":1,"encoding":"pcm_s16le"}
```

```
{"type":"start","protocolVersion":2,"sampleRate":16000,"channels":1,"encoding":"pcm_s16le","sources":["computer","microphone"]}
```

The server compares the parsed object against the exact expected shape. For v2, valid lists are `["computer"]`, `["microphone"]`, and `["computer","microphone"]`. Reversal, duplicates, unknown names, empty lists, extra fields, and noninteger format/version values fail. C# copies and sorts a caller's source list before sending, but the wire contract itself requires canonical order. (`services\transcription\server.py:100-112`, `parse_start`; `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:104-114`, source-aware `ConnectAsync`; `services\transcription\tests\test_dual_protocol.py:57-92`, `StartSchemaTests`.)

| Message | Direction | Required content |
|---|---|---|
| `start` | Client → server | Format fields above; v2 adds version and sources. |
| `ready` | Server → client | Accepted format; v2 echoes version and canonical sources. |
| Binary audio | Client → server | V1: PCM only. V2: one source byte followed by PCM. |
| `partial` | Server → client | `type`, `text`; v2 additionally requires `source`. |
| `final` | Server → client | `type`, `text`, `segmentId`, `startSeconds`, `endSeconds`; v2 adds `source`. |
| `stop` | Client → server | Exactly `{"type":"stop"}`; no source-specific stop exists. |
| `stopped` | Server → client | Exactly `{"type":"stopped"}`, after every source finalization. |
| `error` | Server → client | `type`, safe `code`, safe `message`; unchanged between versions. |

The table is implemented by `parse_start`, `Session.receive`, `Session.publish`, `Session.recognize`, and `error`. (`services\transcription\server.py:71-72`, `error`; `services\transcription\server.py:100-112`, `parse_start`; `services\transcription\server.py:296-498`, `Session`; `services\transcription\server.py:563-574`, ready construction.)

## A frame calculation

`AudioSource` assigns byte `1` to Computer and `2` to Microphone. For 100 ms of 16 kHz mono PCM16, the payload is `16,000 × 0.1 × 2 = 3,200` bytes. V2 sends `1 + 3,200 = 3,201` application-message bytes. The first byte is metadata, not a sample; duration, queue bytes, and byte-rate credit count only the remaining PCM. WebSocket/TCP overhead is additional and is not included in this calculation.

( `src\PhantomFudge.Core\AudioSource.cs:3-7` , `AudioSource` ;
`src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:13-17` , constants;
`src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:217-226` , `TryEnqueueAudio` ;
`services\transcription\server.py:319-357` , `Session.receive` .)

The smallest legal v2 message is three bytes: a source plus one two-byte sample. The largest is 32,001 bytes: a source plus one second of PCM. Legal message lengths are therefore odd, while legal PCM lengths are even. A prefix without PCM, an undeclared source, or 32,002 PCM bytes is invalid.
( `services\transcription\server.py:321-327` , `Session.receive` ;
`tests\PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests\DualSourceTests.cs:75-88` , `DrainV2Async` .)

# Backpressure: bytes, objects, and source fairness

| Budget | Native client | Python service |
|---|---|---|
| Maximum PCM per message | 32,000 bytes | 32,000 bytes |
| Pending PCM per source | 64,000 bytes | 64,000 queued bytes |
| Dual-source PCM maximum | 128,000 pending bytes | 128,000 queued bytes |
| Source frame slots | No separate 32-frame source cap | 32 queued frames per source |
| Aggregate queue slots | Channel capacity 64,000 frame objects | Hybrid: separate 32-slot source queues, at most 64 total |
| Pending lifetime | Released after send completes | Released when worker dequeues, before recognition |

These are different accounting boundaries. Native pending bytes include the frame currently sending; server queued bytes exclude the frame currently being decoded. The table is not a total-process-memory guarantee: message objects, socket buffers, copies, and decoder memory exist outside these PCM counters.
( `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:13-43` , constants/channel;
`src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:207-230` , admission;
`src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:322-336` , sender;
`src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:552-559` , `ReleaseFrame` ;
`services\transcription\server.py:280-290` , `Session.__init__` ; `services\transcription\server.py:342-357` , receive budgets; `services\transcription\server.py:418-451` , dequeue.)

At 3,200 bytes per frame, twenty queued frames consume a source's full 64,000-byte budget: two seconds of audio. At two bytes per frame, the server's 32-frame cap wins after just 64 queued PCM bytes. Both limits are necessary: a byte-only rule permits many tiny objects, while a frame-only rule permits too much audio latency. A busy Computer stream cannot borrow Mic's unused source quota. Hybrid intake now has an independent FIFO and one executor worker per source; explicit legacy Vosk retains shared intake. This removes shared-intake blocking, not CPU contention or every latency difference. ( `services\transcription\server.py:287-288` , `Session.__init__` ; `services\transcription\server.py:342-357` , `Session.receive` ;
`services\transcription\tests\test_dual_protocol.py:461-497` , source-budget tests;
`tools\SpeechBench\results\synthetic-quality-20261009.json:12704` , retained shared-intake failure and replacement.)

There is a second bounded stage: at most two pending final spans per source, including work currently finalizing, and at most four across Both. Each span is at most `16 × 32,000 = 512,000` bytes, so the pending-span allowance is 1,024,000 bytes/source or 2,048,000 bytes for two sources. It is **additional to** the small PCM intake queues; current accumulation, temporary copies, float conversion, and model memory are outside that allowance. A shared single-worker finalizer consumes admitted spans in queue order. Per-source span order is preserved; there is no promise of alternating Computer/Mic finals. The adoption receipt records a maximum of two pending finals/source without faults or drops. (`services\transcription\accurate.py:12-30`, span bound and `FinalSpan`; `tools\SpeechBench\results\synthetic-quality-20261009.json:6597-6603`, adopted pending-work counters.)

Translated from the C# admission algorithm:

```
def admit(source, pcm):
    validate_declared_source_and_even_nonempty_pcm(pcm)
    with queue_lock:
        if not accepting:
            return False
        if len(pcm) > 64000 - source_pending[source]:
            overflow = True
        elif len(pcm) > 128000 - total_pending:
            overflow = True
        else:
            frame = prefix_if_v2(source) + copy_bytes(pcm)
            reserve_pcm_budget(source, len(pcm))
            if try_write_channel(frame):
                submitted[source] += len(pcm)
                return True
            release_budget_and_clear_copy(frame)
            overflow = True
    if overflow:
        fault_entire_session()
    return False
```

Overflow is visible failure, not silent packet dropping or disk spill. The real method also handles closed/disposed state and per-version framing. (`src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:194-238`, `TryEnqueueAudio`.)

## Rate is not backlog

Each server source separately starts with 64,000 byte credits and 200 frame credits, replenished at 32,000 bytes/second and 100 frames/second using monotonic elapsed time. Credits are capped at their burst sizes. Thus a source can spend an initial two-second byte burst, but sending 32,000 additional bytes immediately needs replenishment even if the decoder has emptied its queue. Conversely, a slow decoder can trigger backlog at an otherwise valid live rate. (`services\transcription\server.py:45-59`, `Limits`; `services\transcription\server.py:263-273`, `SourceState`; `services\transcription\server.py:329-346`, `Session.receive`.)

Other defaults are a five-second start-message wait, fifteen-second receive-idle wait, five-second provisional-decoder operation wait, two-second send wait, and eight hours of **submitted PCM duration per source**. The five-second provisional deadline must not be applied to Whisper finalization: final work has a separate

bounded wait. These are not advertised latency targets. (`services\transcription\server.py:46-59`, `Limits`; `services\transcription\server.py:340-341`, duration enforcement; `tools\SpeechBench\results\synthetic-quality-20261009.json:12704`, retained experiment exceeding the 20-second final native-call deadline.)

# Transcript clocks: global order, local time

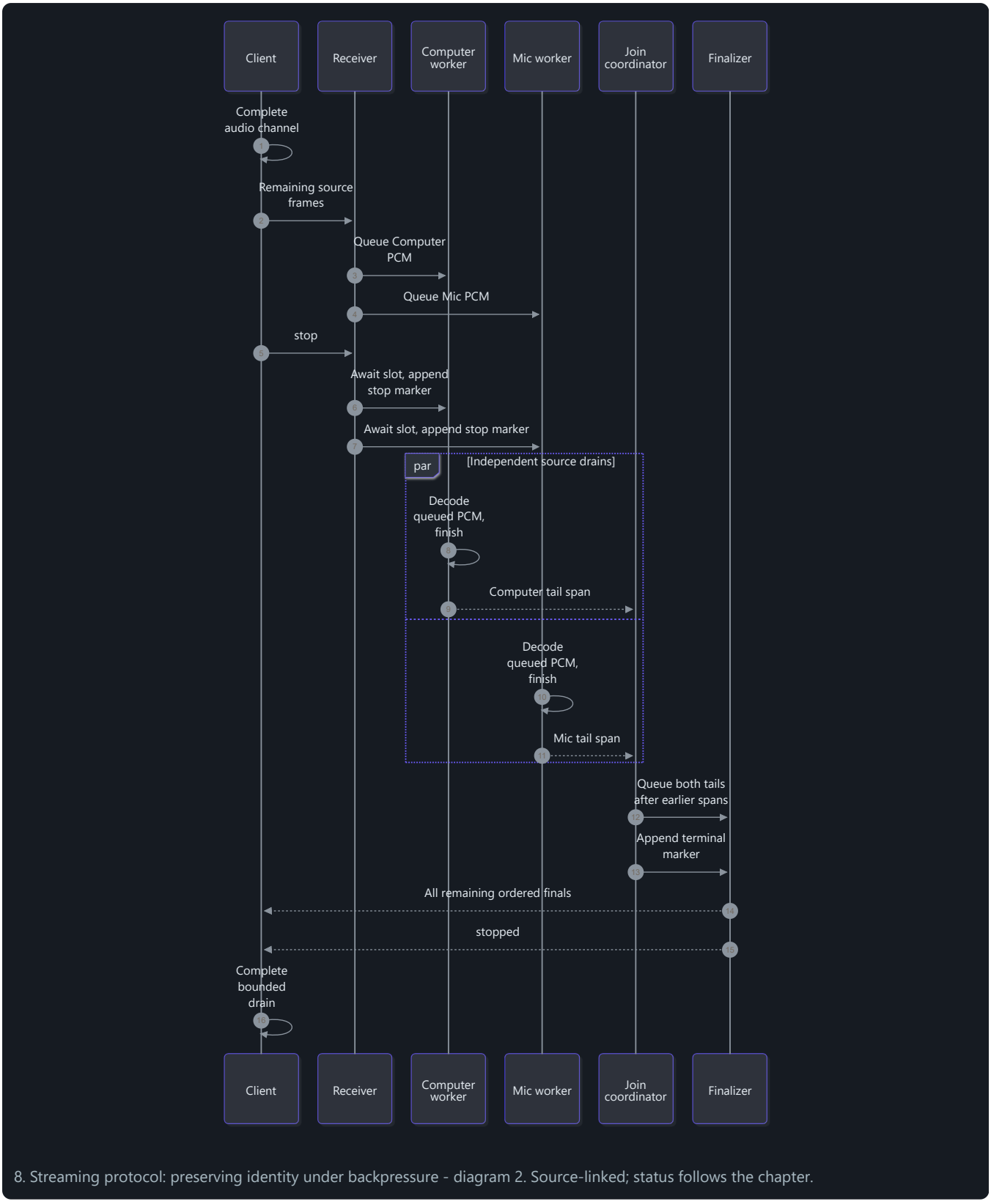
Consider three emitted finals: Computer ID 1 at `0.0–0.2`, Mic ID 2 at `0.0–0.1`, then Computer ID 3 at `0.2–0.3`. This is legal. IDs order session publication; timestamps order only the corresponding source's PCM. Comparing Mic's `0.1` against Computer's previous `0.2` would falsely reject valid interleaving. `Session.publish` keeps one global counter and a `last_end` per source. (`services\transcription\server.py:263-290`, state; `services\transcription\server.py:361-392`, `publish`; `services\transcription\tests\test_dual_protocol.py:182-200`, interleaved-final test.)

The server requires finite, nonnegative, nonregressing source times bounded by that source's received duration. V2 has no pre-rounding duration tolerance. Millisecond rounding is then clipped to whole elapsed milliseconds: 18 bytes represent `18 / 32,000 = 0.0005625` seconds, but cannot become a `0.001`-second wire endpoint, so the result is `0.000`. The native client independently checks finite times, increasing global IDs, and v2 source monotonicity, but its submitted-duration bound allows one extra second. Do not describe the two validators as identical. (`services\transcription\server.py:371-385`, `publish`; `services\transcription\tests\test_dual_protocol.py:214-222`, rounding test; `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:446-466`, final validation.)

Partials are also source-local. An unchanged Mic partial remains suppressed even after Computer finalizes. On the UI side, `TranscriptEvent.Source` carries the label, and `TranscriptBuffer.AddFinal` removes only that source's partial. A final can be empty while still advancing ordering and clearing pending text. (`services\transcription\server.py:378-392`, `publish`; `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptEvent.cs:9-15`, `TranscriptEvent`; `src\PhantomFudge.Core\TranscriptBuffer.cs:41-72`, partial/final methods.)

Hybrid concurrency requires an additional ordering rule. While a source has outstanding finals, its latest provisional replacement is deferred. Publishing a final and assigning its global ID share a lock with partial publication; when that source's pending-final count reaches zero, its latest eligible partial can follow. Enqueuing another committed span clears the deferred text for the old span. This prevents a late Whisper final from clearing a newer visible provisional prematurely. The final timestamps themselves are owned-span boundaries, not word-aligned speech times. (`services\transcription\accurate.py:41-71`, disjoint span creation; `services\transcription\accurate.py:90-118`, final timestamps.) The publication and queue coordination belong to `Session`, within the server chain traced above.

# Why Stop joins the queue




8. Streaming protocol: preserving identity under backpressure - diagram 2. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

The client's sender emits Stop only after its channel drains. The hybrid receiver awaits space for a `None` marker in every source queue instead of rejecting Stop because valid PCM occupies the slots. Each source worker drains its earlier PCM and returns a tail; the coordinator waits for all workers, enqueues tails in

canonical source order, and finally places the finalizer's terminal marker. The finalizer—not the source worker—sends `stopped` after all earlier spans and tails have completed. An unused source still has an empty tail and final. During Stop, a full pending-final allowance is drained rather than rejecting an already accepted tail solely because two earlier spans remain outstanding. (`src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:322-340`, `SendAudioAsync`; `services\transcription\server.py:306-316`, `receive`; `services\transcription\server.py:394-498`, `recognize`; `services\transcription\accurate.py:65-71`, `finish`; `services\transcription\accurate.py:93-95`, empty final.)

The v2 client refuses `stopped` before Stop or without observing a final for every declared source after its stop-sent flag. Its **90-second maximum flush wait** accommodates the backend's conservative **85-second** pending-timeout envelope; failure warns that final text may be unavailable. Neither number is typical Stop latency: the adopted short-case receipt reports median/p95 **0.480/0.746 seconds**. This remains a completion barrier, not recovery after a broken connection or an unconditional final-delivery guarantee. (`src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:241-289`, `StopAsync`; `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:463-474`, `ProcessMessage`; `tools\SpeechBench\results\synthetic-quality-20261009.json:12733-12742`, production maximum; `tools\SpeechBench\results\synthetic-quality-20261009.json:6614-6618`, observed stop distribution.)

# Defensive parsing and testable limits

Server control messages are capped at 1,024 UTF-8 bytes. Decoder text is capped at 8,192 Python characters before publication, whereas native transcript text validation allows 16,384 .NET string characters inside its separate message-byte limit. Character budgets and encoded-message budgets are not interchangeable, especially for escaped Unicode. (`services\transcription\server.py:46-48`, `Limits`; `services\transcription\server.py:88-90`, `parse_control`; `services\transcription\server.py:361-369`, `Session.publish`; `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:439-449`, `ProcessMessage`.)

Native inbound JSON is limited to 32,768 bytes and depth eight; only text messages are accepted. Duplicate properties are rejected, v2 ready requires an exact source echo, and transcript properties are exact. However, legacy ready validation is less restrictive about extra properties. Python uses ordinary `json.loads`, so duplicate-key rejection is not a symmetric server guarantee. A precise specification must preserve those implementation distinctions. (`src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:352-432`, receive/ready parsing; `services\transcription\server.py:88-97`, `parse_control`.)

Server protocol failures normally attempt a fixed error envelope and close code 1008; grossly oversized messages can instead hit aiohttp's transport ceiling and close with 1009. Native code never displays a service-provided error string directly. (`services\transcription\server.py:29-42`, error catalogue; `services\transcription\server.py:194-198`, `close_with_error`; `services\transcription\tests\test_dual_protocol.py:257-264`, ceiling test; `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:406-414`, error handling.)

Read `V2FramingAsync`, `V2BackpressureAsync`, and `V2MissingFinalAsync` for copied bytes, independent native budgets, and incomplete stop rejection. Python's full-queue stop test proves sentinel ordering, while `RunDualSyntheticServiceCheckAsync` streams two in-memory fixtures through the actual C# transport and checks source-specific phrases. None of these test definitions constitutes a new passing run here, acoustic isolation, or cloud integration. Protocol v3 and question commit are not accepted by the current start parser.

(`tests\PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests\DualSourceTests.cs:96-140`, `V2FramingAsync`; `tests\PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests\DualSourceTests.cs:356-428`, stop/budget tests; `services\transcription\tests\test_dual_protocol.py:499-522`, full-queue stop test; `tests\PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests\DualSyntheticServiceCheck.cs:49-79`, synthetic runner; `services\transcription\server.py:100-112`, `parse_start`.)

## Reader checkpoints

1. Why can a two-byte PCM flood hit the server's frame cap before its byte cap?
2. Which counters include the source prefix? Explain why the correct answer is none of the PCM counters.
3. Why is Computer ID 9 ending at 12 seconds compatible with Mic ID 10 ending at 3 seconds?
4. What changes if a decoder throws while finalizing the second source? Distinguish a received first final from a successful stopped barrier.
5. Why do 128,000 bytes of dual-source intake capacity and 2,048,000 bytes of pending-final allowance describe different stages rather than contradictory limits?

## Source-reading route

Compare native transport with server session, then read dual-protocol tests and transcript state. Continue to recognition for the timing values the protocol validates.

Source: docs/handbook/09-python-recognition.md

# 9. Python recognition: fast previews, bounded Whisper finals

## Why a preview and a final need different contracts

The October 9 default separates responsiveness from final recognition quality. Vosk still produces provisional replacements quickly, but its endpoint text is no longer promoted into the authoritative transcript. An endpoint or size boundary instead transfers exact PCM to local Whisper. A final means that this bounded span has completed final recognition—not that every word is correct. This separation is implemented by `HybridRecognizer.accept` returning either `Recognition` or `FinalSpan`, and by `finish` returning PCM rather than Vosk's final spelling. (`services\transcription\accurate.py:33-71`, `HybridRecognizer`.)

Two sources still need independent histories, not two loaded Vosk models. `VoskFactory` shares model weights while each source gets its own `KaldiRecognizer`; `HybridFactory` adds one shared Whisper finalizer and constructs a fresh hybrid wrapper per source. Neither Computer samples nor its provisional decoder state becomes Mic context. (`services\transcription\recognizer.py:44-81`, factories and decoder state; `services\transcription\server.py:563-576`, `transcribe`; `services\transcription\accurate.py:121-129`, `HybridFactory`.)

The old single-executor description is now correct only for explicit legacy Vosk. Hybrid uses independent bounded source queues and single-worker source executors, plus one finalizer executor. The event loop coordinates these stages without executing their native recognition calls inline. The manager's `OPENBLAS_NUM_THREADS=1` and `OMP_NUM_THREADS=1` do not mean Whisper is configured for one CPU thread: its explicit `cpu_threads` default is four, with `num_workers=1`. These limits constrain different layers; they do not guarantee equal source latency. (`services\transcription\server.py:115-181`, `Runtime`; `services\transcription\manage.py:229-242`, `start`; `services\transcription\accurate.py:75-81`, `WhisperFinalizer.__init__`.)

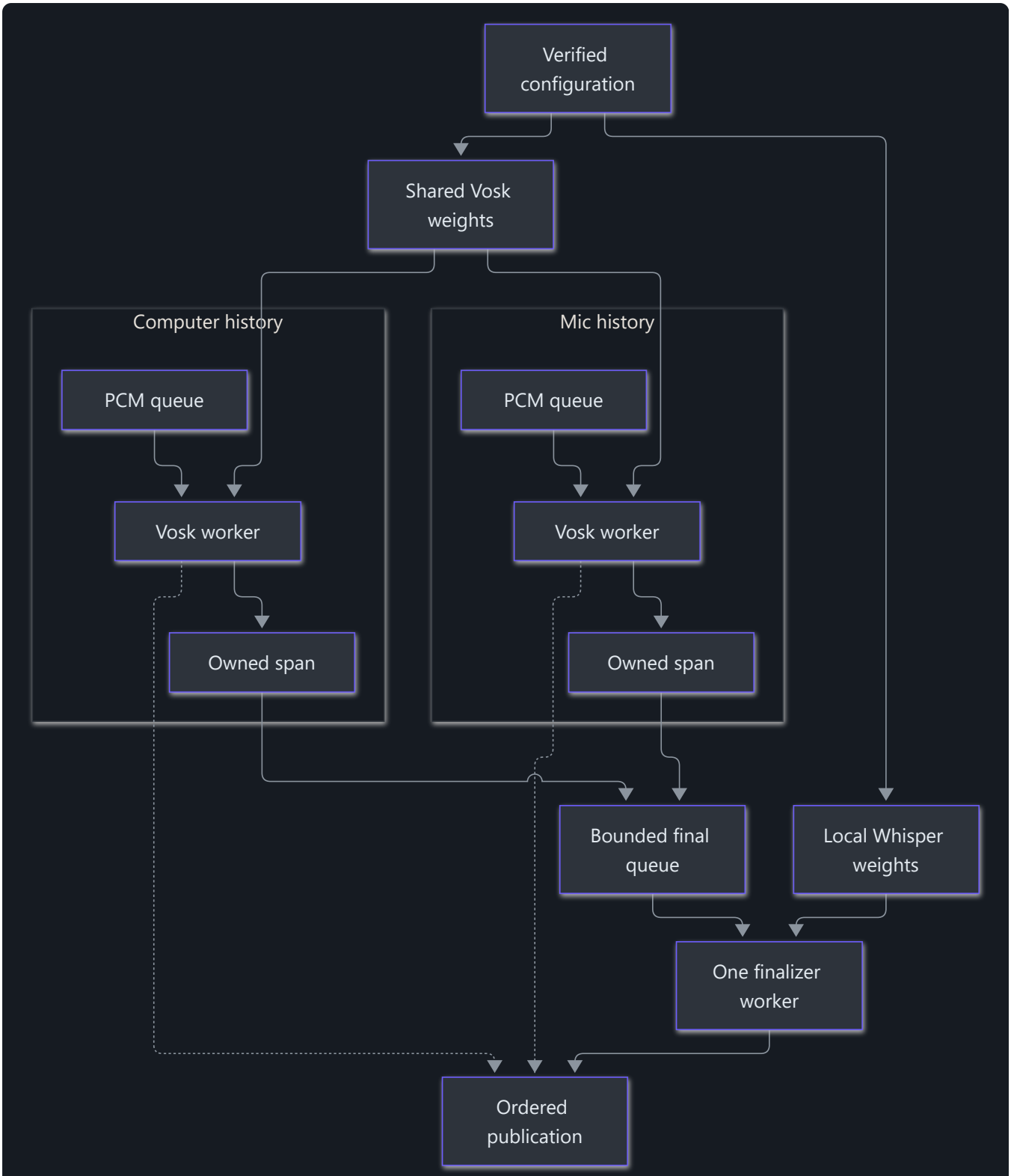
## The operational configuration—not an implicit fallback

| Setting | Operational default | Allowed alternative or boundary |
|---|---|---|
| `engine` | `hybrid-whisper` | Explicit `vosk` selects legacy recognition. |
| `model` | `small.en` | `base.en` is supported, not silently substituted. |
| Compute | CPU `int8` | Finalizer constructor fixes device and compute type. |
| `threads` | `4` | Integer 1–8 in validated configuration. |
| `vocabulary` | `technical` | `none` disables disclosed general hotwords. |
| PCM span | 15-second target | 16-second hard maximum, including a crossing frame. |
| Speech protocol | v1 and v2 | Pipeline version 2 is not a new wire version. |

These defaults come from `load_config`, not the standalone finalizer constructor's `vocabulary="none"` argument; production passes the validated selection explicitly. Missing config uses defaults, missing vocabulary receives `technical`, and unknown keys or invalid values fail. An engine environment override is explicit configuration, not failure recovery. (`services\transcription\configuration.py:8-35`, defaults and `load_config`; `services\transcription\accurate.py:75-88`, constructor; `tools\SpeechBench\results\quality-validation-20261009.json:7-10`, speech versions.)

The provisional dependency remains Vosk 0.3.45 with the pinned English 0.15 model. Its 41,205,931-byte archive is approximately 40 MB, **not the entire hybrid model footprint**. The original observed hash is an integrity pin, not a publisher signature or an accuracy guarantee.
(`services\transcription\requirements.txt:1-20`, dependency pins; `services\transcription\model.json:2-10`, Vosk metadata; `scripts\Initialize-Transcription.ps1:78-88`, original provisioning.)

Both model families are verified before use. Vosk checks an exact file set and SHA-256 identities; Whisper additionally checks declared byte lengths and rejects symlinked files/parents. Runtime supplies an explicit local path and `local_files_only=True`. The separate provisioning command may copy a verified cache or download a pinned revision only with explicit consent; invalid existing files require repair. Request handling never provisions weights, and failure does not switch to Vosk finals.
(`services\transcription\recognizer.py:25-63`, `verify_model`, `VoskFactory`; `services\transcription\provision_whisper.py:28-90`, verification/provisioning; `services\transcription\configuration.py:60-69`, `verify_config`; `services\transcription\accurate.py:75-81`, local loading.)




9. Python recognition: fast previews, bounded Whisper finals - diagram 1. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

Each `SourceState` owns its queue, credits, last partial, pending-final counters, and clock. One source can therefore advance provisional processing while the other is busy. Final work remains serialized and bounded; this is not unlimited parallel decoding. Loading weights alone opens no audio endpoint. (`services\transcription\server.py:263-290`, `SourceState`, `Session`; `services\transcription\server.py:565-574`, source construction; `services\transcription\accurate.py:121-129`, `HybridFactory`.)

# Following bytes into one exact span

At 16 kHz mono PCM16, a 3,200-byte frame contains 1,600 samples, or 100 ms. The source worker releases intake accounting when it dequeues the frame, then calls that source's hybrid recognizer. Received duration can include queued work; processed span duration advances only as PCM reaches `accept`. The old intake limits—64,000 bytes and 32 frames/source—therefore do not bound all recognition memory. (`services\transcription\server.py:339-357`, `Session.receive`; `services\transcription\server.py:394-498`, recognition chain; `services\transcription\recognizer.py:96-98`, processed samples; `services\transcription\accurate.py:48-63`, hybrid intake.)

`HybridRecognizer` appends each frame once. A provisional endpoint or accumulated 480,000 bytes triggers `_take`: immutable PCM bytes plus exact sample indices, followed by clearing the accumulator and constructing a fresh provisional decoder. No earlier PCM is replayed. `FinalSpan` requires `len(pcm) == 2 × (end_sample − start_sample)` and ordered nonnegative integer indices; malformed ownership is an error, not a best-effort timestamp. (`services\transcription\accurate.py:17-63`, `FinalSpan`, `_take`, `accept`.)

The target is checked after accepting a complete legal frame. For example, 14.9 seconds plus a one-second frame becomes one 15.9-second span; the frame is not split or replayed. The hard ceiling is `16 × 16,000 × 2 = 512,000` bytes. Two pending spans/source permit at most 1,024,000 pending PCM bytes/source, separate from current accumulation, intake, float arrays, and model memory. Stop waits for pending capacity rather than discarding its already accepted tail. (`services\transcription\accurate.py:12-30`, bounds; `services\transcription\accurate.py:48-71`, whole-frame ownership; `tools\SpeechBench\results\synthetic-quality-20261009.json:6597-6603`, observed pending-final limit.)

## The ownership algorithm in JavaScript-shaped pseudocode

This translates the Python wrapper; it is not another runtime implementation. The bounds use PCM bytes, never the v2 source prefix. (`services\transcription\accurate.py:33-71`, `HybridRecognizer`.)

```
function accept(pcm) {
  requireLiveEvenFrame(pcm, 32000);
  if (retained.length + pcm.length > 512000) throw decoderError();
  retained.append(pcm);
  const preview = provisional.accept(pcm);
  requireRecognition(preview);
  const rotate = retained.length >= 480000;
  if (preview.final || rotate) {
    const end = startSample + retained.length / 2;
    const span = immutableSpan(retained, startSample, end,
                               rotate ? "rotation" : "endpoint");
    startSample = end;
    retained.clear();
    provisional = provisionalFactory();
    return span;             // Never promote preview.text to a final.
  }
  return preview;
}
```

The standalone Vosk wrapper still has its 30-second history rotation and word-time clamping. Hybrid normally replaces that provisional decoder earlier, at each owned-span boundary. Its 15-second policy is neither a wall-clock timer nor the native 250 ms callback-silence threshold. Changing these boundaries can split a sentence; byte-exact ownership does not promise linguistically optimal cuts.
(`services\transcription\recognizer.py:96-107`, legacy rotation; `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\SilenceCadence.cs:11-19`, cadence; `services\transcription\accurate.py:57-61`, hybrid rotation.)

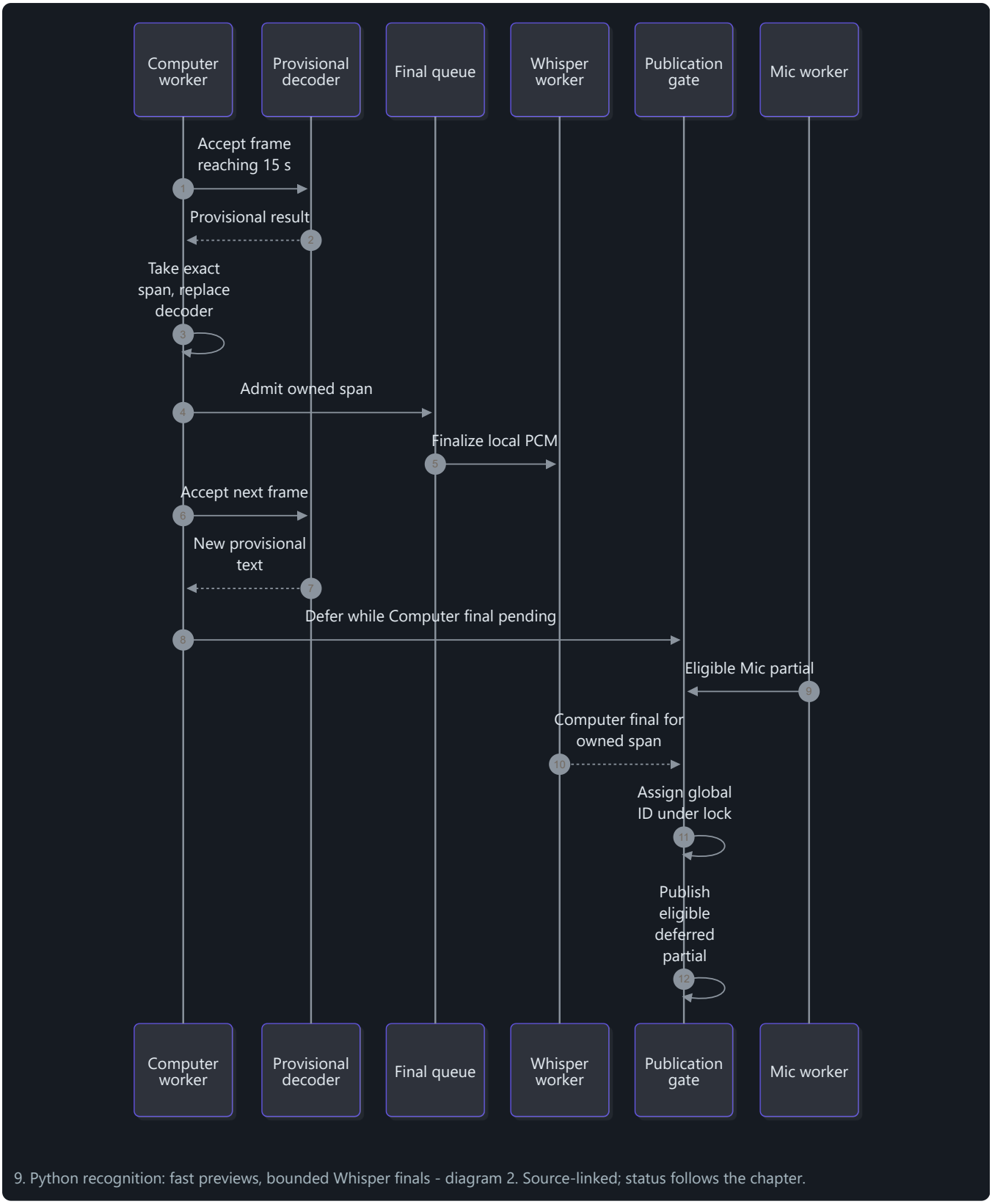
# Whisper finalization and the meaning of time

`WhisperFinalizer` converts little-endian signed 16-bit PCM into float32 by dividing by 32,768. Empty spans and near-digital silence with peak magnitude below `0.001` produce empty finals without inference. This does not use a Vosk spelling guess as proof that speech occurred: quiet/noisy speech classification remains imperfect. A peak magnitude of 32 is classified as near-digital silence; 33 proceeds to model processing. Neither value identifies a speaker. (`services\transcription\accurate.py:90-100`, `WhisperFinalizer.__call__`.)

| Decode control | Fixed policy and reason to distinguish it |
|---|---|
| Language/task | English transcription, not translation or language discovery. |
| Search | Beam 5, temperature 0; no adaptive temperature-retry loop. |
| Context | No initial prompt or previous-text conditioning; optional general hotwords only. |
| VAD | Enabled; 400 ms minimum silence and 200 ms speech padding, unrelated to WASAPI cadence. |
| Filtering | No-speech 0.6, log probability −1.0, compression ratio 2.4, hallucination-silence 1 second. |
| Timing | Word timestamps disabled; returned bounds come from owned sample indices. |

The table is the actual `transcribe` call, not recommended settings invented for this chapter. Technical vocabulary is a disclosed list of terms, not reference sentences, user notes, a postprocessing replacement table, or transcript adaptation. The finalizer consumes the segment generator, rejects nonfinite times/nonstring text, and bounds assembled text before returning. (`services\transcription\accurate.py:83-118`, hotwords, decoding, and result validation.)

Suppose Computer owns `[0, 240000)` samples and then a 100 ms tail `[240000, 241600)`. Their final ranges are `[0, 15]` and `[15, 15.1]` seconds—even if words occupy only part of either interval. Whisper's internal segment times do not replace these ledger boundaries. Mic's independent 1,600 samples still end at 0.1 seconds, not Computer's 15.1. (`services\transcription\accurate.py:41-46`, `_take`; `services\transcription\accurate.py:93-118`, returned times.)




9. Python recognition: fast previews, bounded Whisper finals - diagram 2. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

`Session` serializes publication because source workers and finalization can now finish independently. `decode_frame` defers a pending source's newest partial, `queue_final` clears obsolete deferred text when committing another span, and `finalize` releases eligible deferred text when pending count reaches zero. Changed partials remain replacements, while `_publish` validates text and monotonic source times before assigning a session-global ID. Trace these named methods together in the server; the illustrative diagram

assumes Mic has no pending final and is not a latency measurement. (`services\transcription\server.py:361-392`, publication; `services\transcription\server.py:263-271`, source state; `services\transcription\accurate.py:48-71`, committed span boundaries.)

# Failure containment around native work

Native calls remain **shielded** futures: cancelling an asyncio waiter cannot safely kill a decoder. Provisional work has a five-second deadline; final work has its own longer deadline. An exception/timeout marks the runtime failed and produces generic `decoder_error`, not an automatic legacy fallback. Cancellation retains admission while outstanding work is awaited within its bounded cleanup policy. (`services\transcription\server.py:46-54`, provisional limits; `services\transcription\server.py:147-181`, CPU wait machinery; `services\transcription\server.py:578-606`, cleanup; `tools\SpeechBench\results\synthetic-quality-20261009.json:12704`, observed 20-second final-call timeout.)

Model initialization is separate: `production_app` loads the selected factory directly on an executor, outside those per-operation waits. The manager's 45-second readiness observation is not a model-inference deadline; it retains ownership evidence on failure. A healthy model selection requires both Vosk and Whisper verification for hybrid. (`services\transcription\server.py:658-683`, `production_app`; `services\transcription\manage.py:254-273`, `start`; `services\transcription\configuration.py:60-69`, `verify_config`.)

| Failure example | Observable policy |
|---|---|
| Missing or modified model | Factory cannot load; service readiness is unavailable, with no request-time download. (`services\transcription\recognizer.py:25-63`; `services\transcription\server.py:658-682`.) |
| Second decoder fails to initialize | No ready message for the partially constructed source set; runtime becomes unavailable. (`services\transcription\server.py:565-583`, `transcribe`; `services\transcription\tests\test_dual_protocol.py:282-294`, initialization test.) |
| Mic decoder raises or hangs | Entire session faults; Computer is not silently retained as the only source. (`services\transcription\tests\test_dual_protocol.py:296-305`, exception test; `services\transcription\tests\test_dual_protocol.py:325-347`, timeout test.) |
| Mic finish fails after Computer final | The Computer final may already have arrived, but there is no successful `stopped` barrier. (`services\transcription\tests\test_dual_protocol.py:308-315`, finish-failure test.) |
| Result timestamp is NaN | Rejected rather than serialized as plausible time. (`services\transcription\recognizer.py:89-90`, `_final`; `services\transcription\tests\test_recognizer.py:53-59`, nonfinite test.) |

## Metadata-only diagnostics, not retained speech

"No diagnostics are persisted" is now incorrect. Production retains allowlisted JSONL at `.local\diagnostics\transcription.jsonl`, rotating at 1 MiB with three backups. Events are model load, session start/stop, decode, finalize, fault, and disconnect. Each record carries schema/time, event/source, engine/model, a safe fault code, and numeric decode/audio duration, queue bytes/frames, pending finals, fault count, and drop count. There is no transcript, waveform, token, path, or arbitrary exception-message field. (`services\transcription\diagnostics.py:12-22`, schema; `services\transcription\diagnostics.py:45-77`, `emit`.)

Writes are locked, symlink destinations are refused, counters must be finite/nonnegative, and I/O failure marks logging unavailable with a generic notice. This does not guarantee secure memory erasure. Content-bearing native stderr/access logs remain suppressed, and native transport still replaces service error text with a safe client message. (`services\transcription\diagnostics.py:24-43`, failure state; `services\transcription\diagnostics.py:59-77`, rotation/I/O; `services\transcription\server.py:686-712`, `main`; `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:406-414`, `ProcessMessage`.)

# What the tests can establish

Original `DecoderFixture` rotation tests and `RecordingRecognizer` routing tests remain useful for the provisional/legacy path; their single-executor assertion must not be generalized to hybrid scheduling. The October 9 receipt reports 104 service tests and 18 benchmark tests, but this documentation pass reran neither. (`services\transcription\tests\test_recognizer.py:10-75`, fixture/tests; `services\transcription\tests\test_dual_protocol.py:30-54`, `RecordingRecognizer`; `services\transcription\tests\test_dual_protocol.py:150-180`, legacy independence; `tools\SpeechBench\results\quality-validation-20261009.json:4-17`, validation scope.)

The adopted synthetic run recorded 19 word edits over 432 reference words (**4.40% WER**) and five character edits over 1,900 normalized characters (**0.263% CER**). Unhinted small.en had lower raw WER; the technical vocabulary's compound `LeetCode` spelling costs word edits against `leet code`. Residual `to`/`two` and `some`/`sum` errors remain. Long dual-source stress reached `stopped`, with global IDs 1–14 and zero faults/drops; that validates this run, not arbitrary microphone quality or zero-WER speech. Chapter 12 preserves the comparisons and failed experiments. (`tools\SpeechBench\results\synthetic-quality-20261009.json:6589-6603`, adopted WER; `tools\SpeechBench\results\synthetic-quality-20261009.json:7831-7835`, CER; `tools\SpeechBench\results\synthetic-quality-20261009.json:8693-8726`, stress; `tools\SpeechBench\results\synthetic-quality-20261009.json:12744-12753`, selection and residuals.)

The implementation described here is local English recognition with streaming provisional text and bounded-span finals. Source identity is not diarization, AEC, or a privacy-indicator bypass. Loading Whisper is not evidence of answer-provider readiness, answer latency, or a new speech protocol; the separate Ask/provider lifecycle is outside this chapter's recognition measurements. Actual user-voice and microphone quality remain unverified. (`services\transcription\model.json:2-4`, language metadata; `docs\DUAL-SOURCE-AUDIO.md:10-17`, boundaries; `tools\SpeechBench\results\synthetic-quality-20261009.json:6620-6627`, qualification limits.)

## Reader checkpoints

1. After 15 seconds of Computer PCM and 100 ms of Mic PCM, which weights are shared and which histories differ?
2. Why is a 512,000-byte owned span compatible with a 64,000-byte source intake queue?
3. Explain why `asyncio` cancellation cannot be treated as proof that a native decoder stopped executing.
4. Explain why an exact span endpoint is not a forced-aligned word endpoint, then calculate the bounds for a 3,200-byte tail.
5. Why can technical hotwords improve CER while worsening raw WER against a two-token reference?

## Source-reading route

Read configuration identity, provisional Vosk, span ownership and Whisper, server scheduling, and metadata diagnostics. Compare them with the public quality receipt. Chapter 10 explains provisioning and process ownership.

# 10. Native service lifecycle: readiness without accidental capture

## Why process ownership is a protocol problem

“Something is listening on port 8765” is insufficient evidence that Phantom Fudge may reuse or stop it. The listener could belong to another checkout, lack the installed client's speech version, run the wrong recognition configuration, or be transcribing an active session. `manage.py` treats a local service as owned only after combining a workspace receipt, authenticated runtime response, expected service identity, management version, and matching instance UUID. It does not convert a discovered PID into permission to terminate a process. (`services\transcription\manage.py:94-165`, `read_record`, `owned_info`; `services\transcription\manage.py:186-200`, `stop_owned`.)

The second boundary is **ready service versus recording application**. Initialization provisions dependencies and weights. Start makes an idle recognizer service available. The application still requires explicit Start before endpoint acquisition, and transport readiness precedes native capture. Keeping these operations distinct makes a launcher convenient without turning it into an automatic recorder. (`scripts\Initialize-Transcription.ps1:119-165`, Python setup; `scripts\Start-Transcription.ps1:8-15`, native start; `src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:652-700`, `Start_Click`; `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:102-115`, `StartCoreAsync`.)

## Installed preview: a different entry point, the same capture boundary

The planned v0.2.0-preview.1 Windows11 x64 installer replaces end-user PowerShell/Python setup with a native Start-menu launcher and a bundled runtime/model payload. Candidate2 built and lifecycle3 passed bounded current-host checks; the clean committed release build and publication remain **pending**. Follow Installation for the short procedure and implementation status for evidence. (scripts/Build-Installer.ps1:30-44) (tools/Installer/PhantomFudge.iss:23-30,62-76)

`Program.Main` first refuses normal/notes-only launch when the installer-maintenance gate is present, before revealing an existing same-user app or touching files/service state. Fresh launch rechecks the gate after acquiring its startup mutex; detection exits70 through generic status, without creating WPF UI or child processes. Maintenance and validation bypass this gate so Setup can still perform its own checks. A fresh normal launch starts the manager through the installed Python interpreter, with fixed arguments and offline environment values, then opens the app. `--notes-only` skips speech preparation; it neither shuts down a separate service nor disables providers. Installed mutable runtime data belongs to `%LOCALAPPDATA%\PhantomFudge\InstalledRuntime\.local`, outside the replaceable program tree. (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/Program.cs:25-78,127-213)

(src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/LauncherContract.cs:152-165)
(src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/LauncherStatus.cs:15,34) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/ChildProcesses.cs:48-105) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/LauncherContract.cs:56-84)

Setup never starts the app: finish and close it, then launch from Start. Setup/launcher progress and errors are ordinary visible UI, not covered by the notes HWND's capture-exclusion request. Launch before sharing. Once the app child starts, the launcher keeps its operation mutex until the main-instance mutex appears or that child is proven exited. After30seconds, status76 means **pending**, not success; Close hides progress while monitoring continues, including a guard retained through early dispatcher shutdown. This prevents maintenance from replacing an initializing app merely because a timer elapsed.
(tools/Installer/PhantomFudge.iss:14-76) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/LauncherWindow.cs:18-57)
(src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/ChildProcesses.cs:12-42) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/Program.cs:108-118,186-227)

Maintenance refuses an open app or concurrent launcher operation, takes the shared runtime lock and uses authenticated loopback shutdown only after matching the installed ownership receipt. It does not require a Python `maintenance` verb or working old Python binaries. Update/repair uses a fresh helper directory extracted from Setup so damaged old launcher files do not prevent repair; the explicit-root native path requires the installation marker but not a healthy compact manifest. Uninstall invokes the installed launcher. Neither path may stop another source workspace's listener. The installer keeps external settings/diagnostics and saved notes/exports for reinstall; it is not a data wipe. Candidate2's lifecycle3 receipt passes 11 checks against 3,682 inventoried files, including repair/uninstall and retained external data. This random-AppId/path fixture omits shortcuts and does not start the app or speech service; its simulated older-version record is not a genuine old-binary upgrade or clean-VM test. (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/Program.cs:50-58,94-100)
(src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/LauncherContract.cs:87-105)
(src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/MaintenanceOperation.cs:48-118)
(src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/OwnedServiceClient.cs:20-58) (tools/Installer/PhantomFudge.iss:143-161)
(scripts/Test-Installer.ps1:15-18,31-84,96-104)

Partial ownership does not authorize shutdown. A retained token alone permits only a credential-free port-presence check; a receipt without its token refuses. No token and no receipt is the untouched case and does not probe another workspace's listener. See the installed reference for the exact cases.
(src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/MaintenanceOperation.cs:52-75,121-134)

The installed model contract keeps explicit provisioning in the mutable user's `.local\models` directory. An existing pinned-name user model takes precedence over the bundled weights and must pass the same manifest verification; only absence selects the bundled path. This prevents update/uninstall from overwriting deliberate user model data. Targeted path tests cover precedence and user-only provisioning without inference. (tools/Installer/runtime-contract.json:7-12,20-22)
(services/transcription/tests/test_installed_runtime.py:74-91)

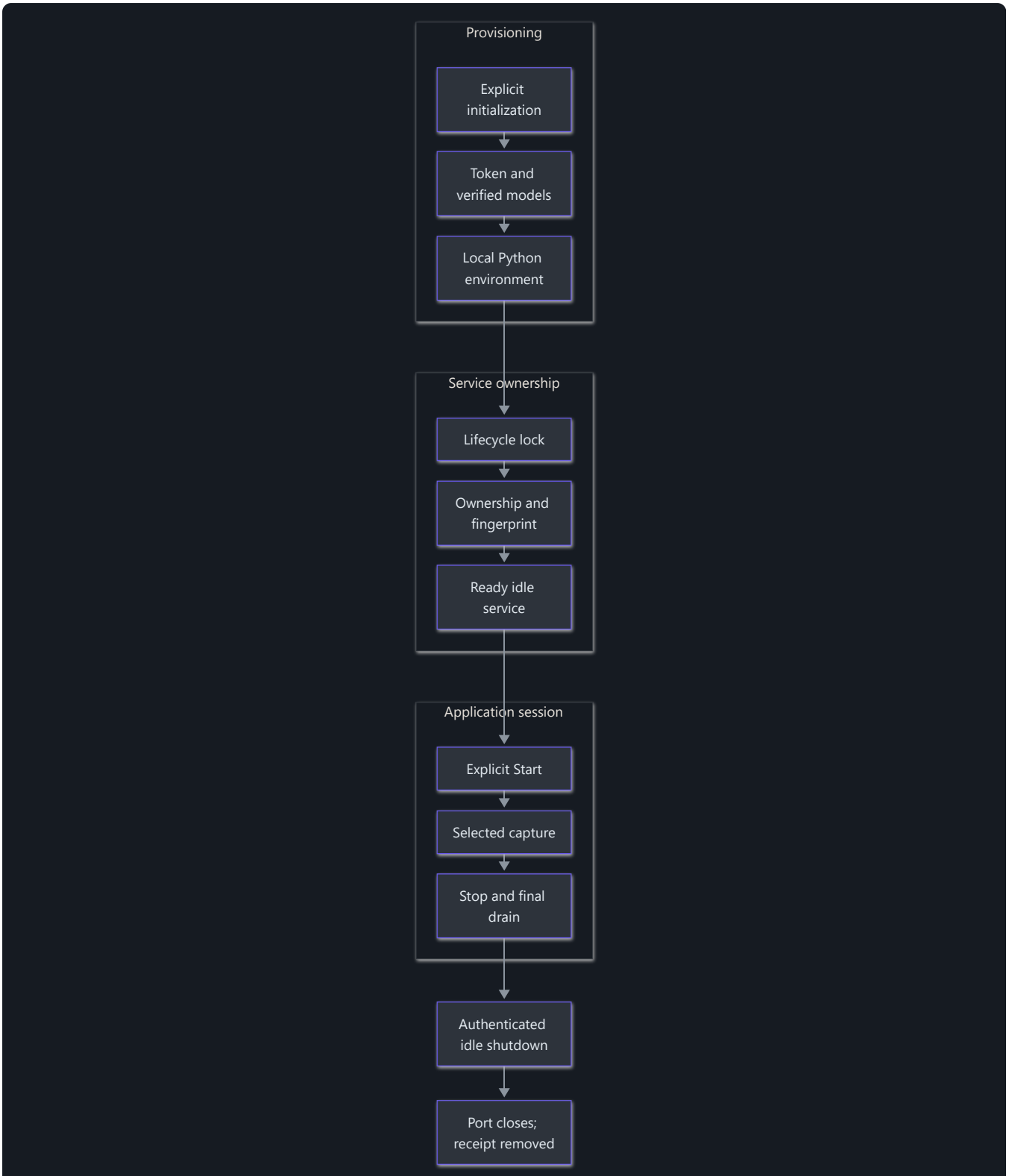
Normal startup also recovers confirmed stale ownership after reboot or PID reuse; it is not a manual-repair-only path. The child PID is persisted before querying its creation time, so an inspection failure cannot discard the known PID. A PID-only record can later be cleared only after proving that process absent; live/ambiguous initializers remain protected. Regression tests call the actual manager start path with mocked process/port observations, not a real reboot or speech service. (services/transcription/tests/test_installed_runtime.py:98-198)

The parent confirms85 focused runtime tests, superseding78; the final offline rebuild passes real generated-PCM hybrid inference, including production VAD, a forced Whisper encoder/decoder pass and natural exit after Unicode relocation. Vosk remains unmodified; `VoskFactory` uses a locked, temporary working-directory adapter for Windows non-ASCII model paths. These checks resolve the earlier runtime blockers, not captured-speech quality, clean-VM or new-backend performance qualification. (services/transcription/recognizer.py:47-77) (services/transcription/tests/test_packaged_pcm_runtime.py:35-97,126-138)

# Source/legacy journey: provision, launch, select, stop

| Entry point | Supported switches | What it changes |
| --- | --- | --- |
| `Initialize-Transcription.ps1` | `-DownloadModel`, `-SkipPythonSetup`, `-Engine`, `-WhisperModel`, `-Vocabulary` | Token, selected verified models, config/receipts, and normally the service-local Python environment; no service or capture start. |
| `Start-Transcription.ps1` | `-Docker` | Default: invoke native `manage.py start`; Docker is an explicit alternate branch. |
| `Run-PhantomFudge.ps1` | `-NoBuild`, `-NotesOnly`, `-PassThru` | Build when appropriate, start/reuse service unless notes-only, launch or reveal the app. |
| `Stop-Transcription.ps1` | `-Docker` | Default: authenticated native manager stop; optional Docker branch is separate. |
| `manage.py` | `start`, `stop`, `status` | Serialized native runtime lifecycle and status inspection. |

These are source-supported interfaces, not commands executed while writing this chapter. (`scripts\Initialize-Transcription.ps1:1-11`, parameters; `scripts\Start-Transcription.ps1:1-15`, native branch; `scripts\Run-PhantomFudge.ps1:1-55`, launcher; `scripts\Stop-Transcription.ps1:1-22`, stop branches; `services\transcription\manage.py:301-314`, `main`.)




10. Native service lifecycle: readiness without accidental capture - diagram 1. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

The diagram's shutdown edge is deliberate: managed shutdown rejects an active speech session. Service readiness can also be reused without traversing provisioning again. (`services\transcription\server.py:247-260`, `managed_shutdown`; `services\transcription\manage.py:203-220`, `start`.)

# Provisioning without hidden repair

Initialization creates a token only if one is absent, using 32 cryptographically random bytes rendered as lowercase hexadecimal. That is 256 generated bits represented by 64 ASCII characters—not a hard-coded credential. Exclusive file creation prevents an existing token from being overwritten through this path. On Windows, the script replaces the token file's DACL with a current-user full-control rule and disables inherited permissions, without changing ownership/audit sections that could require elevation. (`scripts\Initialize-Transcription.ps1:42-76`, token generation and ACL setup.)

Existing token content must match the accepted 32–512-character URL-safe pattern. The setup script does not silently rotate invalid credentials; it requests explicit repair. The manager reads and validates the token, while the server prefers the configured token file over an environment token. These are source-defined storage operations; this chapter neither reads nor cites a user's generated token. (`scripts\Initialize-Transcription.ps1:74-76`, validation; `services\transcription\manage.py:34-41`, `token`; `services\transcription\server.py:75-85`, `load_token`.)

Model provisioning is similarly explicit. The provisional Vosk manifest specifies a 41,205,931-byte English archive and observed SHA-256 identity. Setup checks byte count and checksum before extraction, rejects unexpected extracted content, and refuses to overwrite a failed existing model directory. Runtime performs its own manifest verification; a setup receipt is not a substitute for checking the bytes currently present. That archive size does not describe the additional Whisper weights. (`services\transcription\model.json:2-10`, model metadata; `scripts\Initialize-Transcription.ps1:26-39`, `Test-Model`; `scripts\Initialize-Transcription.ps1:78-118`, archive/receipt path; `services\transcription\recognizer.py:25-46`, `verify_model`, `VoskFactory`.)

Hybrid adds a separately pinned Whisper model. `provision_whisper` accepts `small.en` or `base.en`, verifies the exact file set, lengths, hashes, and nonsymlink paths, and can reuse a verified benchmark cache. Missing bytes are downloaded only with explicit `--download`; invalid existing files cause a repair error. Exclusive `.partial` creation and verification precede replacement, and cleanup removes only a partial created by that invocation. This is explicit setup, not background request-time repair.
(`services\transcription\provision_whisper.py:19-44`, manifest/verification; `services\transcription\provision_whisper.py:47-107`, `provision`, CLI.)

Python setup creates a virtual environment if necessary, hashes the maintained requirements file, and decides whether restore is needed from that receipt and an import check. Restore runs pinned installation followed by `pip check`; successful setup does not itself start the service. A requirements hash receipt is a restore optimization, not a claim that every installed wheel is cryptographically attested on each launch.
(`scripts\Initialize-Transcription.ps1:119-165`, environment provisioning; `services\transcription\requirements.txt:1-20`, dependency pins.)

# Serializing the launcher without trusting process names

`lifecycle_lock` is Windows-specific. It opens a workspace lock file, ensures at least one byte exists, and repeatedly attempts a nonblocking `msvcrt` lock on that byte. The acquisition deadline is 50 seconds with 100 ms polling. Start, Stop, and Status share this lock, so competing manager invocations cannot simultaneously rewrite the ownership receipt. This serializes cooperating managers for the workspace; it is not an operating-

system-wide monopoly on the port. (`services\transcription\manage.py:66-91`, `lifecycle_lock`; `services\transcription\manage.py:203-207`, `start`; `services\transcription\manage.py:276-295`, `stop`, `status`.)

The receipt contains schema version 1, an instance UUID in canonical hexadecimal form, and a PID field. `write_record` writes a temporary sibling and replaces the receipt. `owned_info` authenticates the listener and compares service name, management version 1, and instance UUID. Crucially, it does **not** use the receipt PID as ownership proof or a kill target: process IDs can be reused, whereas the authenticated instance value participates in the shutdown contract. (`services\transcription\manage.py:94-165`, receipt/ownership methods; `services\transcription\manage.py:226-228`, initial receipt; `services\transcription\manage.py:259-262`, PID update.)

Management requests use literal `http://127.0.0.1:8765`, a two-second timeout, no proxy, and a redirect handler that fails rather than forwarding credentials. Reading 4,097 bytes detects whether a response exceeds the 4,096-byte allowed payload. Parsing also requires a JSON object. These are bounded control-plane responses, not transcript downloads. (`services\transcription\manage.py:22-31`, base URL and `NoRedirects`; `services\transcription\manage.py:44-57`, `request`.)

# Fingerprint-aware reuse and verified idle replacement

| Existing listener state | `start()` decision |
|---|---|
| No matching receipt | Refuse adoption. |
| Wrong token, service identity, management version, or UUID | Refuse reuse/change. |
| Owned but `ready` is not exactly true | Fail; require explicit stop/setup repair. |
| Owned, ready, speech v2 and matching configuration fingerprint | Reuse; do not restart merely because it is active. |
| Owned, ready, stale speech capability or fingerprint, explicitly idle | Verify selected models/dependency availability **before** authenticated shutdown and replacement. |
| Owned, ready, stale capability/fingerprint, active or ambiguous | Refuse restart; ask the user to stop transcription. |
| Owned idle stale instance, replacement model missing/invalid | Leave the existing service running; require explicit provisioning, never legacy fallback. |

Ownership, speech capability, and engine identity are separate tests. `supports_current_audio` looks for integer `2`, while `supports_current_engine` compares `configFingerprint`. Management `protocolVersion: 1` remains current. Requiring `active is False` is stricter than accepting a missing or false-like field; `validate_start` checks both model families and the hybrid dependency before taking a healthy old idle instance down. (`services\transcription\manage.py:155-220`, ownership/capability/start chain; `services\transcription\server.py:218-244`, `runtime_info`; `services\transcription\configuration.py:60-69`, `verify_config`.)

The fingerprint is more than the string `small.en`. `metadata` includes pipeline version, engine, pinned model revision, compute type, thread count, vocabulary identity, and a digest of its named runtime/dependency/manifest files. Technical vocabulary contributes its own digest. Sorted compact JSON makes the identity deterministic. Thus a ready v2 Vosk listener can still be stale, as can a hybrid listener with old code or vocabulary. This is not an attestation of every checkout file or installed wheel. (`services\transcription\configuration.py:38-57`, `metadata`.)

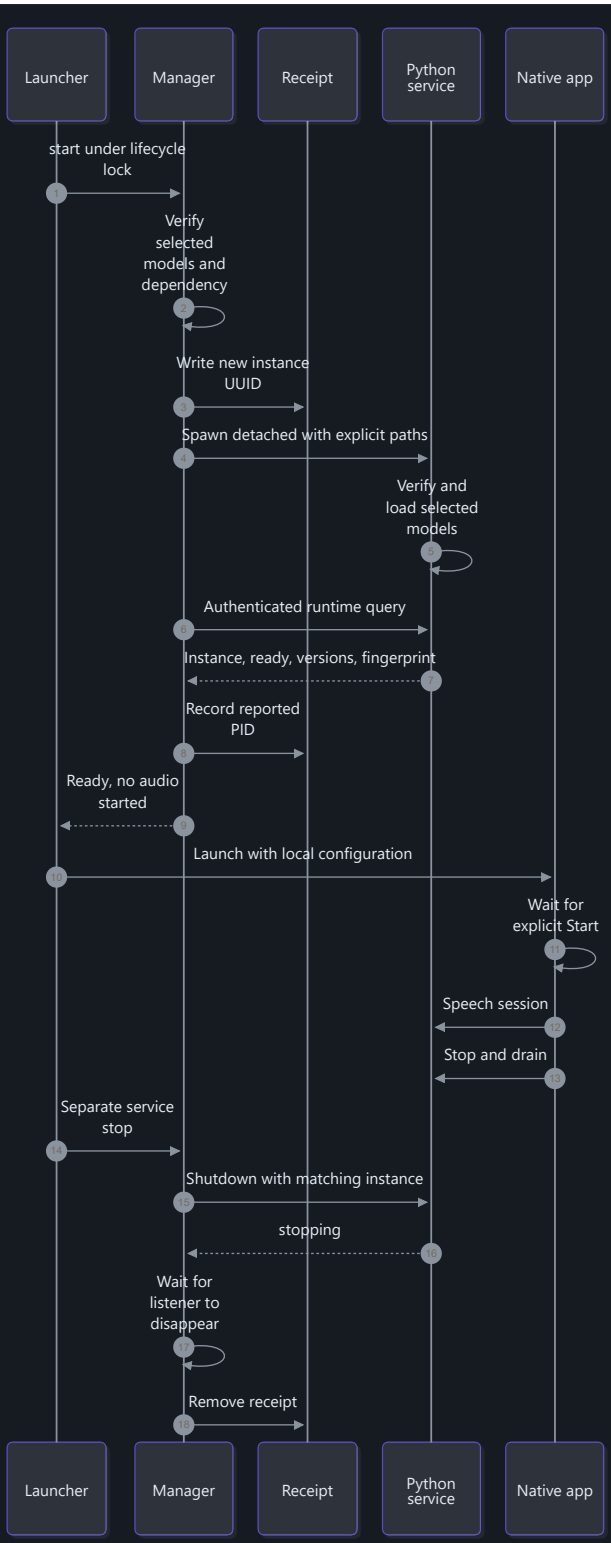
The following JavaScript-shaped pseudocode translates the manager's Python decisions:

```
function startNative() {
  const credential = readValidatedToken();
  withLifecycleLock(() => {
    const config = loadValidatedConfig();
    const receipt = readValidatedReceipt();
    if (portInUse()) {
      const info = authenticateOwnedInstance(credential, receipt);
      if (info.ready !== true) throw new RepairRequired();
      if (supportsSpeechV2(info) && fingerprintMatches(info, config)) return;
      if (info.active !== false) throw new StopCaptureFirst();
      verifyModelsAndDependency(config); // Before touching the old service.
      shutdownOwnedAndWaitForPort(credential, receipt);
    } else if (receipt !== null) {
      clearOnlyConfirmedDeadOrRecycledProcessReceipt();
      // Live, uninspectable or incomplete ownership still refuses.
    }
    verifyModelsAndDependency(config);
    const instance = newUuidHex();
    writeReceiptBeforeSpawn(instance);
    spawnDetachedService(instance);
    waitForAuthenticatedReadinessVersionsAndFingerprint();
  });
}
```

The real manager keeps its receipt after a slow or failed startup instead of claiming success or killing a process by name. On a later operation with no listener, it may remove a receipt only after process inspection establishes that the recorded process is dead or its PID has been reused. Live or uncertain ownership still refuses. (`services\transcription\manage.py:224-273`, `start`.)

# The cold-start chain

After verifying the selected configuration's models and dependency, `start` generates a fresh instance UUID and writes the receipt before spawning. An existing receipt with no reachable service requires process-identity inspection: confirmed death or PID reuse permits cleanup, while a live/unknown instance or insufficient ownership data refuses a second startup. The service uses the current Python interpreter, detached process/new process group, no stdin, closed inherited descriptors, and a generic local log. The manager polls for up to 45 seconds; readiness requires authenticated instance identity, speech v2, and the selected fingerprint, not merely a listening socket. (`services\transcription\manage.py:224-273`, `start`; `services\transcription\configuration.py:60-69`, model verification.)




10. Native service lifecycle: readiness without accidental capture - diagram 2. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

`production_app` loads the selected factory on an executor before returning its aiohttp application. Hybrid verifies/loads Vosk and local Whisper; an error leaves the factory unavailable rather than downloading a replacement or selecting legacy Vosk. `/health` reports 503 when unready; authenticated runtime management can still describe the unavailable instance after it starts listening.

( `services\transcription\server.py:201-207` , `health` ; `services\transcription\server.py:658-683` , `production_app` ; `services\transcription\accurate.py:75-81` , local-only Whisper; `services\transcription\accurate.py:121-129` , `HybridFactory` .)

## Configuration is explicit, not discovered from a meeting

| Configuration | Consumer and behavior |
|---|---|
| `PHANTOM_TRANSCRIPTION_TOKEN_FILE` | Server token source; manager supplies it. |
| `PHANTOM_TRANSCRIPTION_TOKEN` | Server fallback token source; launcher also passes a token to the app. |
| `PHANTOM_TRANSCRIPTION_MODEL_PATH` | Required explicit model directory for the production server. |
| `PHANTOM_TRANSCRIPTION_HOST` | Manager fixes `127.0.0.1` ; server allows `127.0.0.1` or `0.0.0.0` , not arbitrary names. |
| `PHANTOM_TRANSCRIPTION_INSTANCE` | Managed service instance UUID; enables matching-instance shutdown. |
| `PHANTOM_TRANSCRIPTION_URI` | Launcher supplies the app's literal-loopback speech URI. |
| `OPENBLAS_NUM_THREADS` , `OMP_NUM_THREADS` | Manager sets both to `1` . |
| `PHANTOM_TRANSCRIPTION_WORKSPACE` | Mutable configuration/receipt workspace override; not a replacement for authenticated native receipt ownership. |
| `PHANTOM_TRANSCRIPTION_MODELS_ROOT` | Separate installed model root; avoids storing shipped weights inside mutable user data. |
| `PHANTOM_TRANSCRIPTION_ENGINE` | Explicit engine override, validated as `hybrid-whisper` or `vosk` . |
| `.local\transcription-config.json` | Schema 1; defaults: hybrid-whisper, small.en, four threads, technical vocabulary. |
| Offline model flags | Manager sets Hub/Transformers offline mode and disables Hub telemetry/implicit token use. |

The server binds port 8765; there is no production port environment setting in `main` . Config permits integer thread counts 1–8, model `small.en` / `base.en` , and vocabulary `technical` / `none` ; initialization writes four threads rather than exposing a thread-count switch. Unknown config keys fail. The local file path describes the interface, not a file inspected or copied into this chapter. Token values are omitted.
( `services\transcription\server.py:75-85` , `load_token` ; `services\transcription\server.py:695-712` , `main` ; `services\transcription\manage.py:229-242` , environment; `scripts\Run-PhantomFudge.ps1:43-55` , app environment; `services\transcription\configuration.py:8-35` , validated configuration.)

Runtime status also distinguishes recognition readiness from diagnostic availability. Metadata-only JSONL rotates at 1 MiB plus three backups and contains allowlisted events/counters, never speech text or audio. A write failure sets logging unavailable rather than claiming successful persistence; the generic startup log is a different artifact. The schema is explained by the public service README, not by copying any generated log.
( `services\transcription\diagnostics.py:12-43` , schema/failure state; `services\transcription\diagnostics.py:45-77` , `emit` .)

# Shutdown: authority and idleness are rechecked

The manager first requires explicit idle state, then posts `/v1/shutdown` with Bearer authentication and `X-Phantom-Instance`. The server independently rejects browser origins, bad auth, queries/bodies, missing management ownership, mismatched UUIDs, and active transcription. That second active check closes the gap between the manager's earlier runtime query and the actual shutdown request. (`services\transcription\manage.py:186-194`, `stop_owned`; `services\transcription\server.py:247-257`, `managed_shutdown`.)

On acceptance, the server marks itself stopping immediately, schedules managed exit after 0.2 seconds, and responds `{"status":"stopping"}`. The manager then waits up to 12 seconds for the port to become unused, removing the receipt only after that observation. If the port remains occupied, the receipt remains and the operation fails. No arbitrary OS termination is used as a timeout fallback. (`services\transcription\server.py:258-260`, `managed_shutdown`; `services\transcription\manage.py:193-200`, `stop_owned`.)

The timeouts are per phase, not one promised shutdown duration: management HTTP has a two-second timeout, listener disappearance has a twelve-second polling budget, and lock acquisition has its own fifty-second budget. A receipt with no reachable listener is not erased merely because the port is closed: `stop` requires evidence of a dead or recycled recorded process before cleanup, and preserves live/unknown ownership. (`services\transcription\manage.py:50-51`, `request`; `services\transcription\manage.py:77-86`, lock wait; `services\transcription\manage.py:195-200`, listener wait; `services\transcription\manage.py:276-287`, `stop`.)

# Application launch and deployment tradeoffs

`Run-PhantomFudge.ps1` first recognizes an existing app at the expected executable path and requests reveal without building or restarting the service. Otherwise it builds a source checkout unless `-NoBuild`, skips build for a packaged executable, optionally starts the service, and launches the app with token/URI environment configuration. `-NotesOnly` skips service startup; it is not a separate microphone implementation. (`scripts\Run-PhantomFudge.ps1:10-55`, launcher.)

Native Python is the normal path. `-Docker` is explicit, optional, and last—not a prerequisite or the evidence for this hybrid upgrade. The maintained Dockerfile explicitly selects legacy Vosk and copies named helper modules; Compose remains a separate deployment recipe. It was not executed for this update, and hybrid readiness must not be inferred from it. The start wrapper requires an existing engine rather than installing Docker. This speech service continues to advertise v1/v2; its readiness is distinct from the application's separate Ask/provider lifecycle and does not measure answer latency. (`scripts\Start-Transcription.ps1:8-36`, native/Docker branches; `services\transcription\server.py:218-244`, `runtime_info`; `services\transcription\manage.py:168-170`, `supports_current_audio`.)

# Evidence and operational checkpoints

Management tests cover unauthenticated queries, browser origins, wrong instance UUIDs, unmanaged shutdown, active-session refusal, and idle shutdown. A dual-source test confirms that two recognizers still occupy one active runtime and prevent management stop until final drain completes. Manager unit tests reject missing/mismatched receipts and redirects. These are maintained test definitions, not newly executed results. (`services\transcription\tests\test_management.py:38-90`, management cases; `services\transcription\tests\test_management.py:92-122`, dual/session controls; `services\transcription\tests\test_management.py:126-150`, `ManagerTests`.)

The native lifecycle script exercises blank-window reveal/minimize/hide/close and refuses to touch an existing app or service. It is a different evidence layer from service authentication, and neither layer qualifies live microphones, meeting capture exclusion, or acoustic quality. No lifecycle script, service, installation, or hardware probe was run for these chapters. (`scripts\Test-NativeLifecycle.ps1:16-22`, preconditions; `scripts\Test-NativeLifecycle.ps1:69-103`, lifecycle checks; `docs\QUALIFICATION.md:1-7`, qualification boundary.)

The October 9 production-factory check used real local models on **ephemeral ports**, reporting ready, diagnostics available, zero faults/drops, and an 85-second maximum stop envelope. Its receipt explicitly says port 8765 was untouched. Separately, the later operator handoff reports that the parent actually upgraded the authenticated, owned, idle 8765 instance and observed ready hybrid-small.en with no active audio. That later action is handoff evidence, not something this documentation pass repeated or something the earlier test receipt proves. Readiness still does not qualify an actual microphone. (`tools\SpeechBench\results\synthetic-quality-20261009.json:12706-12742`, production-factory check; `tools\SpeechBench\results\quality-validation-20261009.json:15-17`, validation exclusions.)

## Reader checkpoints

1. Why is a matching PID weaker evidence than the authenticated instance contract used here?
2. A ready listener supports speech v2 but has a stale fingerprint and is active. Why must the launcher refuse replacement?
3. What remains on disk when startup exceeds 45 seconds, and why is that not a successful ready result?
4. Distinguish stopping capture, finishing recognition, stopping the Python service, and closing the native window.
5. A stale owned idle service works, but small.en fails verification. Why must verification happen before shutdown?

## Source-reading route

Follow initialization, native start wrapper, manager ownership, server management endpoints, application launcher, and management tests. Together they describe a local, explicitly owned service—not an automatic recorder or an external process supervisor.

Source: docs/handbook/11-state-machines-and-failure-containment.md

# 11 — State Machines and Failure Containment

## Overview: a Boolean cannot describe a shutdown

“Running” answers whether a session is currently considered active. It does not answer whether a device has released its capture thread, whether queued audio has reached the recognizer, whether final text has returned, or whether a new session may safely reuse the UI's transcript IDs. Phantom Fudge's most important lifecycle rule is therefore:

> `IsRunning == false` **does not mean fully stopped, drained, and reusable.**

`Session.RequestStop` immediately sets `Running=false`; `StopSessionAsync` and transport disposal still have substantial work afterward. The UI separately holds `audioStopping` through its awaited Stop path. A documented review found and fixed a stop/restart race by preserving this distinction. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:30,387-447,532-546; src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:763-793; docs\IMPLEMENTATION-STATUS.md:232-234)

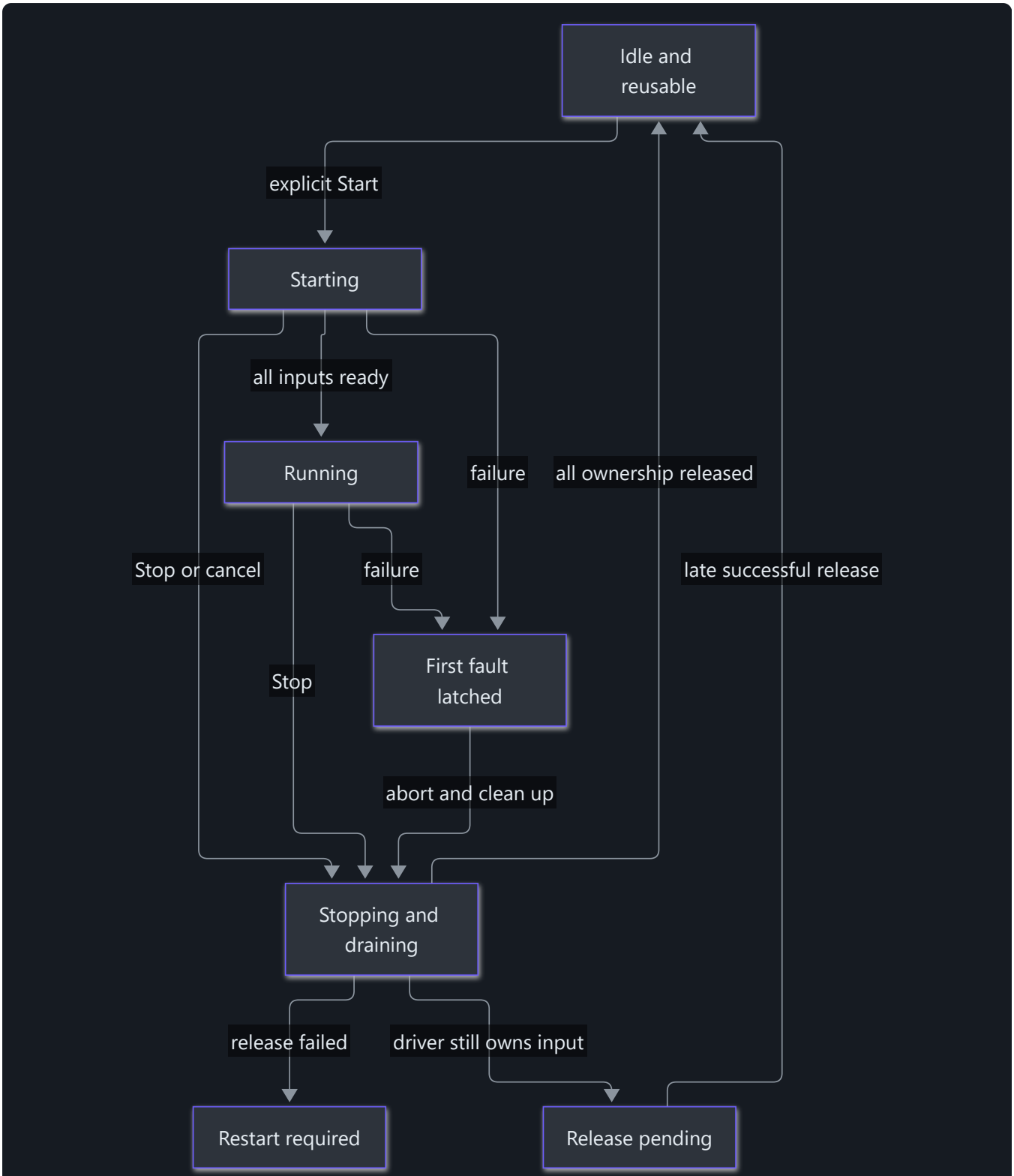
**Newcomer path:** follow the normal Stop sequence before reading the locks. **Principal-engineer path:** inspect queued-start invalidation, ownership after driver timeouts, and the difference between graceful drain and fault abort. The diagrams below name conceptual states; the production code implements them through fields, tasks, locks, and guards, not one central state enum.

## Architecture: several coordinated state dimensions

| Dimension | Actual representation | What it must not imply |
|---|---|---|
| Interaction | `presenting`, WPF visibility, `fileBusy` | A visible window need not be editable or recording. |
| Capture setup | `protectionReady`, `lastProtection` | Successful setup is not remote capture qualification. |
| UI audio operation | `audioBusy`, `audioStopping`, `audioStopTask` | `IsRunning` alone is insufficient for enabling commands. |
| Audio ownership | `_session`, `_pendingCaptureRelease`, `_captureReleaseFailed` | No active session does not necessarily mean no worker owns a device. |
| Transport | ready/fault/stop flags, sender/receiver tasks | Closing admission does not mean queued audio has drained. |

These fields live at their relevant boundaries rather than in a generic workflow framework. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:33-48; src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:16-23;

src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:44-67)




11 — State Machines and Failure Containment - diagram 1. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

The “release pending” distinction comes from a concrete Start guard: it rejects while the prior release task is incomplete or a release failure has been recorded. A timed-out operation can finish later; a recorded disposal failure remains a separate restart-blocking condition.
(src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:81-85,408-440,478-483)

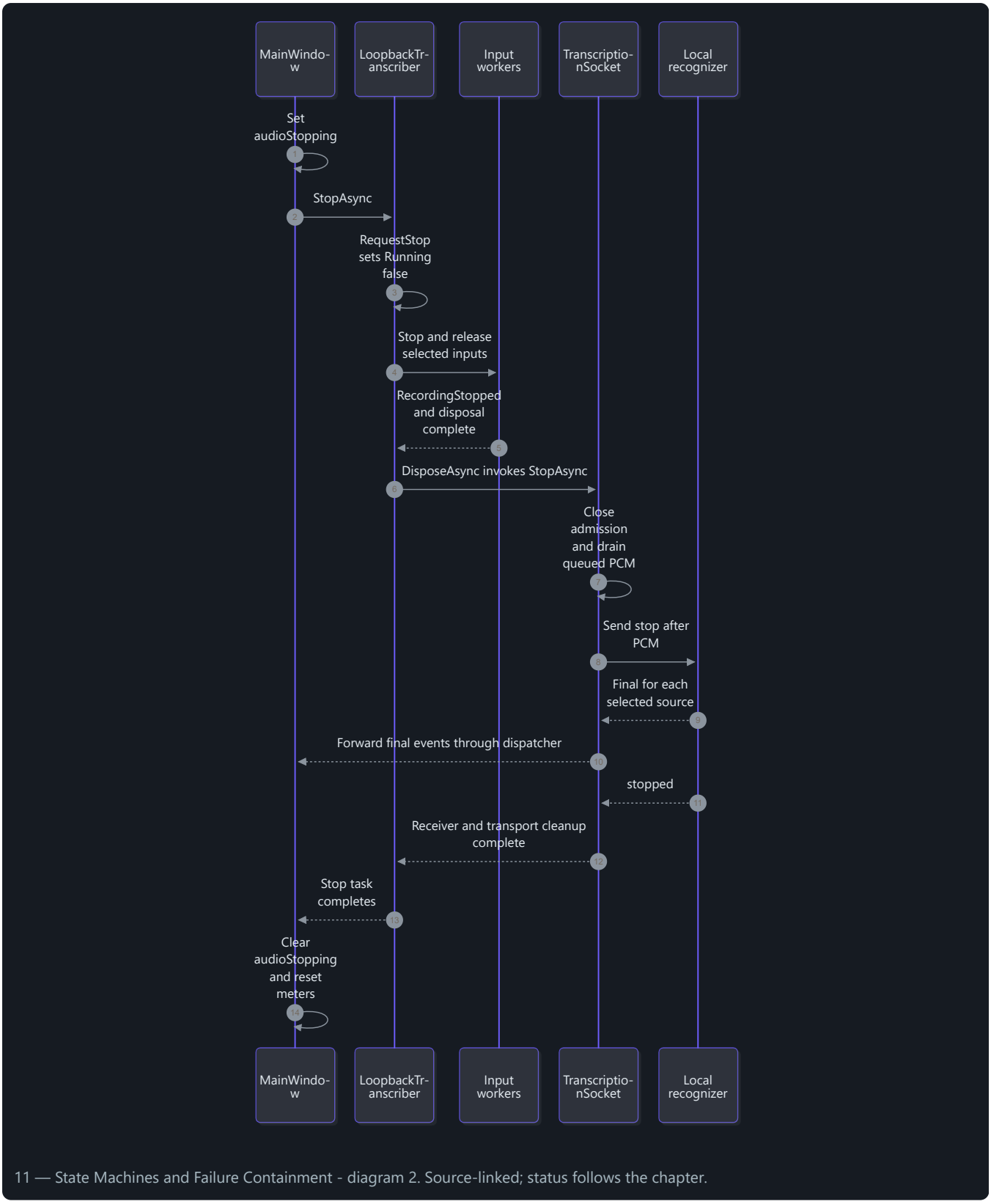
# Components: who owns each decision?

`MainWindow` owns user intent and command availability. `LoopbackTranscriber` owns selected inputs and their lifecycle. `WasapiInput` owns an endpoint, capture object, and endpoint-notification registration. `TranscriptionSocket` owns one authenticated connection and bounded audio queue. `TranscriptBuffer` owns accumulated text and session-local ordering. No one layer can safely infer all the others' completion from a single flag. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:652-793; src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\WasapiInput.cs:11-18,97-119; src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:10-47; src\PhantomFudge.Core\TranscriptBuffer.cs:8-11,23-39)

The UI invokes `BeginSession` only after its Start guards pass. It rejects Start during startup, stopping, or running; mode selection and transcript clearing apply equivalent busy/stopping restrictions. `UpdateAudioControls` mirrors these rules visually, but handlers also enforce them: disabling a button is not the only protection against reentrant or programmatic calls. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:652-700,720-750,866-871)

# Data flow: a normal Stop is a protocol

`StopTranscriptionAsync` returns an already-pending stop task when one exists. Otherwise it sets `audioStopping` *before* cancelling startup and starting cleanup. This gives Hide, Exit, the Stop button, and other callers a shared completion operation rather than independently resetting session state. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:763-793)




11 — State Machines and Failure Containment - diagram 2. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

This is the no-fault path. Input shutdown precedes transport drain so normal final capture callbacks can still contribute queued PCM. The sender consumes its channel to completion, then sends `stop`. The receiver accepts `stopped` only after Stop was sent and, for protocol v2, after a post-Stop final from every selected source. An empty final still satisfies that protocol requirement. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:401-442,449-492; src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:241-288,322-340,446-474)

The guarantee is conditional: a timeout, device failure, malformed response, or connection loss takes a fault path where final text can be unavailable. The status messages say so rather than reporting a clean complete transcript. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:280-289; src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:782-785)

# Implementation: concurrency tools serve different purposes

## Serialization does not cancel queued intent

`SemaphoreSlim _lifecycle` serializes asynchronous Start/Stop/Dispose bodies. But a semaphore alone would allow a Start already waiting behind another operation to run after Stop. The controller therefore captures `_stopVersion` before waiting, increments that version in `RequestStop`, and compares it under `_requestLock` before publishing a new session. A queued stale Start is rejected rather than resurrecting recording. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:72-94,159-193)

After connection acceptance, each selected input starts on a worker task. Running becomes true only when every requested input started, no stop/failure is recorded, and no input already reported `RecordingStopped`. Thus Both is all-requested-inputs behavior, not "start whichever device happened to succeed." (src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:102-136)

## The first fault wins

`SignalFault` uses `Interlocked.CompareExchange` to store one safe failure message. Subsequent simultaneous faults return early. It disables audio admission flags, clears Running, requests cancellation, aborts transport, and schedules serialized cleanup. The cleanup checks that its session is still the controller's current session. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:362-384)

The code explicitly avoids acquiring another input's `AudioGate` while processing a callback failure. Otherwise two failing sources could each hold one gate and wait for the other. Per-input volatile admission flags and transport admission close the path without cross-track lock acquisition. This is a concrete deadlock-avoidance choice, not a reason to remove all synchronization. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:239-270,362-373)

## Timeouts bound waiting, not driver execution

| Deadline | Meaning in the implementation |
|---|---|
| Connection: 10 seconds | Deadline includes the service's ready response. |
| Capture startup: 10 seconds | Wait for selected input startup tasks. |
| Capture stop/release: 5 seconds | Bound waits around release and recording-stop completion. |
| Transport flush: 90 seconds | Bound sender drain, accurate finals, acknowledgement and receiver completion; not normal latency. |

These are operation-specific waits, not a promised sum or end-to-end latency SLO. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:20-79,147-161,264-277; src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:13-14,112-115,419-426,461-468)

The accurate backend publishes a conservative 85-second maximum including its drain deadline, in-flight native timeout and send/cleanup allowance. The 90-second client bound avoids discarding accepted finalizations early. Recorded normal short-case Stop median/p95 were 0.480/0.746 seconds. The timeout envelope is not a claim that every Stop waits 90 seconds (measured quality and limits).

Answer preparation is a separate lifecycle: the window keeps one Agency provider, prepares one empty session without a model prompt, and cancels/disposes it on Hide/Clear/protection/reload/close. Preparation and shutdown block conflicting actions; late answer events cannot revive an old request. (`src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.AnswerLifetime.cs:18-128`.)

A hung driver is not forcibly made safe by cancelling a managed token. Release workers retain ownership and eventually finish startup/join/disposal if the driver returns. Inputs release independently, so a stuck microphone does not prevent the responsive Computer input from being released. The UI thread does not perform these joins. `WasapiInput.Dispose` also attempts notification and endpoint cleanup in nested `finally` blocks. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:110-113,408-442,449-492; src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\WasapiInput.cs:97-119)

### Fail closed without inventing a complete transcript

The socket budgets two seconds of PCM per source: 64,000 bytes at 16 kHz, mono, 16-bit; total pending PCM is capped at 128,000 bytes. A queue overflow faults the session rather than silently dropping frames and continuing a success-shaped transcript. Released frame arrays are cleared, but this is not a secure-erasure guarantee for every memory copy or crash dump. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:13-18,191-238,552-559; docs\QUALIFICATION.md:139-140)

Endpoint validation restricts the transport to literal loopback, and the HTTP handler disables proxies and redirects. Recognizer error bodies are schema-checked but replaced with fixed local messages rather than displayed verbatim. This limits accidental propagation of paths, secrets, or transcript text through an error surface. It is not a claim that every possible exception everywhere in the app is contained. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:26-31,82-98,398-414)

Device notifications invalidate only the explicitly selected endpoint, once, and dispatch work away from the notification callback. Default-device changes do not switch input identity. A lost selected source faults the entire session; the app does not quietly substitute a microphone or another playback device. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\RenderEndpointNotification.cs:10-29; src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:199-204,362-373)

## Worked example: the stop/reset race

Suppose session A has accepted final ID 20. Stop makes Running false, but final ID 21 is still returning. If the UI resets `TranscriptBuffer.lastSegmentId` for session B now, the late A final could advance B's ID baseline to 21. B's new final ID 1 would then be ignored by `AddFinal`. Text would disappear from the new session even

though the user saw a plausible restart. This is an explanatory interleaving derived from the actual reset/deduplication logic and the recorded bug, not a claim of a newly executed reproduction. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\TranscriptBuffer.cs:23-38,48-56; docs\IMPLEMENTATION-STATUS.md:232-234)

The repaired UI keeps Start, source-mode changes, and Clear blocked through its awaited stop task. A synthetic regression explicitly sets `audioStopping`, attempts those actions, and verifies that the transcript/session selection remain unchanged. Controller-level ownership guards remain necessary underneath this UI protection. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:652-655,720-750,866-871,1061-1068; src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:81-91)

The following **Python-shaped pseudocode is explanatory, not production code**:

```
async def stop_from_ui():
    if stop_task_is_pending():
        await existing_stop_task()
        return
    state.stopping = True
    try:
        await controller.stop()  # Running may already be False here.
    finally:
        state.stopping = False

def may_start_or_reset():
    return not (state.starting or state.stopping or controller.running)
```

C# `Task` tracks completion; `CancellationToken` requests cooperation; `SemaphoreSlim` serializes async ownership transitions; `Interlocked` performs atomic state changes. They are complementary, not interchangeable spellings of "thread safe." `Dispatcher.BeginInvoke` supplies the separate requirement that WPF control updates run on the UI thread. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:77-94,159-192,362-384; src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:66-94,170-174)

# Window and document failures remain separate

Protection invalidation clears readiness and hides before awaiting Stop. It preserves note/transcript memory. Mode changes similarly hide and stop before changing native interaction policy. Exit waits for Stop, then evaluates unsaved work; it does not confuse stopped audio with permission to discard text. Saving has its own `fileBusy` guard and only updates the saved baseline after successful I/O. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:228-275,306-323,424-455)

Protection errors use a generic local notice rather than an unprotected automatic message box. This is an application containment policy for detected failures—not a universal capture boundary, nor crash recovery. (src\PhantomFudge.App\LocalFailureNotice.cs:9-29; src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:160-164)

# Tests, exercises, and qualification boundaries

Targeted synthetic tests verify:

- Missing Mic final before `stopped` is rejected: `V2MissingFinalAsync`. (tests\PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests\DualSourceTests.cs:356-371)
- Stop/Dispose invalidates a queued Start before opening hardware: `V2QueuedStartAsync`. (tests\PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests\DualSourceTests.cs:475-499)
- Repeated sessions detach callbacks; simultaneous source faults release both inputs. (tests\PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests\DualSourceTests.cs:658-758)
- Hung startup retains ownership, hung Stop releases the responsive input, and disposal failures prevent unsafe restart. (tests\PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests\DualSourceTests.cs:762-868)

The maintained evidence records 41 Core tests, 46 native synthetic groups, 71 backend tests, and four manager-upgrade guards. Those are existing results, not tests rerun for this chapter. They do not establish actual microphone permissions, hardware echo behavior, OS microphone-indicator visibility, or remote cursor inclusion. (docs\IMPLEMENTATION-STATUS.md:226-234; docs\QUALIFICATION.md:127-140)

**Exercise:** Why retain `_pendingCaptureRelease` after the visible session stops?
**Answer:** A worker may still own a device; allowing another Start would obscure ownership.

**Exercise:** Why not silently drop PCM when the queue fills?
**Answer:** Continuing would hide a gap in the audio-to-text history. The implemented policy faults instead.

**Exercise:** Does cancelling startup prove its driver worker has terminated?
**Answer:** No. Cancellation is cooperative; ownership remains until release completes. These answers follow the guards and cleanup paths described above. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:84-85,408-442; src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:236-238)

# References and maintenance checkpoints

- UI lifecycle and audio controller.
- Transport state, endpoint owner, and device notifications.
- Transcript state, failure notice, and synthetic lifecycle tests.
- Recorded implementation evidence and qualification gaps.

Per-source commit and Azure submission still need their own request/session rules. Current Stop drains the complete selected-input session, not a "commit question and ask cloud model" operation. Local question selection and immutable Freeze now exist separately; `Clear` changes question identity and snapshots retain their own copied state. (`src\PhantomFudge.Core\QuestionDraft.cs:81-95`; `src\PhantomFudge.Core\QuestionSnapshot.cs:5-23`; src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:159-168)

Question typing introduces another interaction flag, not a new audio state. It temporarily allows keyboard focus in the same protected HWND while keeping notes read-only and the audio lifecycle unchanged. Done typing/Escape restores passive behavior. The existing global Notes Edit/Present, Hide and invalidation paths retain their stop policy. This is why the new editor must not simply call the old global mode switch. See the implemented local interaction contract.

# 12. Performance and Benchmarks

## Why a fast decoder is not necessarily a responsive application

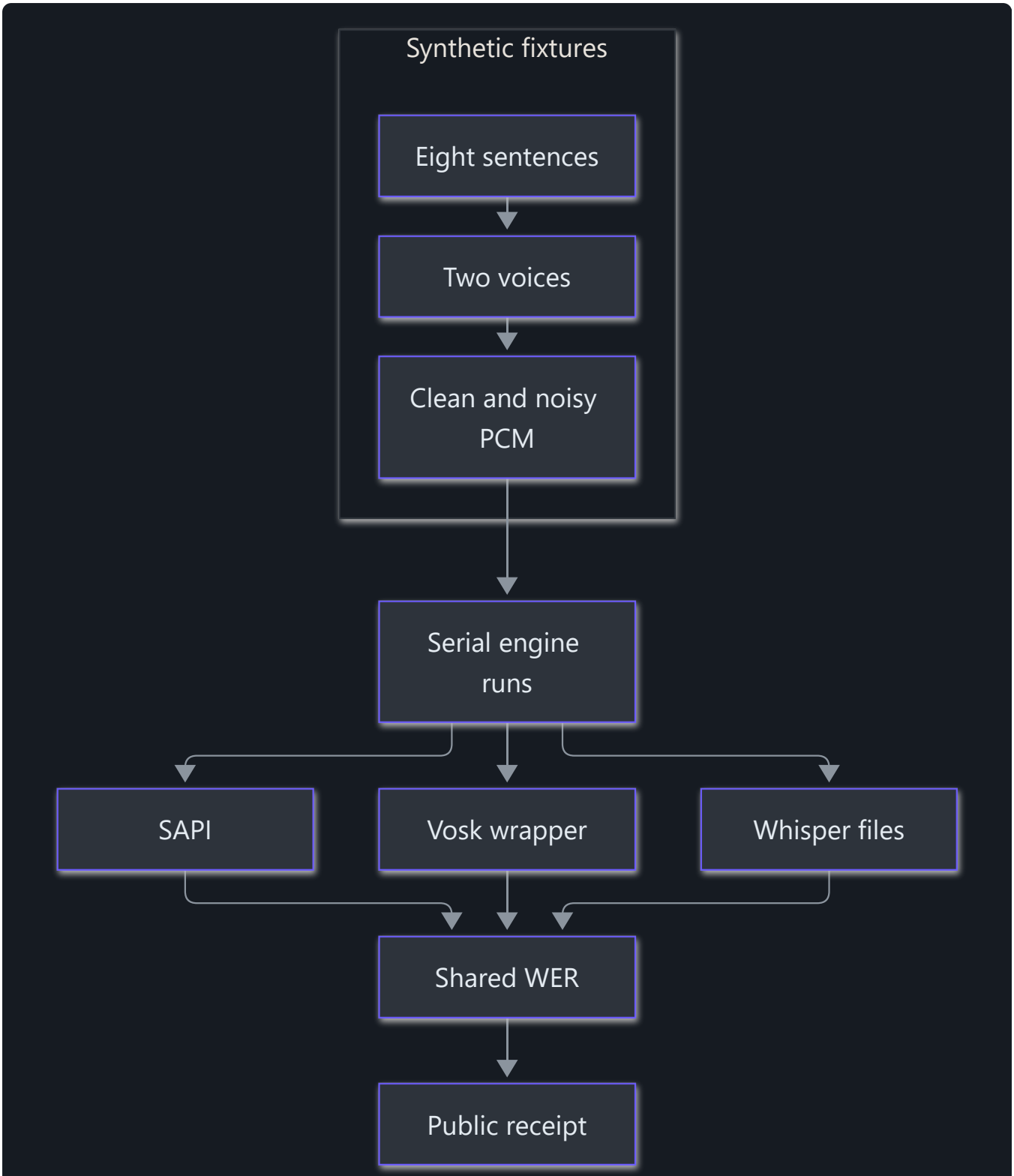
Performance starts with a question, not a stopwatch. “How quickly can this engine decode a complete recording?” differs from “When does the presenter see a useful partial?” An engine can process a finished file faster than its duration yet wait too long before showing live text. The repository deliberately separates unpaced file decoding from a small paced-delivery experiment; neither measures the complete capture-to-WPF path. (tools\SpeechBench\bench.py:207-230, `worker.decode`; docs\SPEECH-BENCHMARK.md:93-123, “Speed and live-update limits”.)

This chapter analyzes existing evidence, not a newly executed benchmark. The **October 8 historical** synthetic receipt records **32 cases, 164.070 seconds of audio, two serial warm passes, and 292 normalized reference words per pass**. Repeating a recording improves timing observations; it does not create another independent speaker or double the accuracy sample. The later October 9 quality receipt is a different experiment and does not rewrite these results. (tools\SpeechBench\results\synthetic-20261008.json:13-22, experiment metadata; tools\SpeechBench\results\synthetic-20261008.json:65-109, `summary`; tools\SpeechBench\bench.py:354-369, `run`.)

The comparison is also not C# versus Python. SAPI, Vosk, and Whisper are different recognition engines with different models and exposed APIs. C# hosts the installed Windows dictation engine; Python hosts Vosk and faster-whisper. Language-host differences are confounded with engine differences, so the experiment cannot isolate language overhead. (tools\SpeechBench\SapiBridge.cs:113-145, `Recognize`; tools\SpeechBench\bench.py:188-255, `worker`; docs\SPEECH-BENCHMARK.md:15-20, engine-versus-language distinction.)

## Architecture of the original file experiment

The harness gives each engine the same completed PCM fixtures, runs engines serially, and scores their materialized transcripts with one normalization function. The diagram describes that file-only path, not device capture. (tools\SpeechBench\bench.py:106-152, `make_fixtures`; tools\SpeechBench\bench.py:319-369, `run`.)




12. Performance and Benchmarks - diagram 1. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

## Components and controlled inputs

| Component | Responsibility and experimental consequence |
| --- | --- |
| `corpus.json` | Eight original sentences cover ordinary speech, technical terms, and numbers; coverage is intentionally small. |

| Component | Responsibility and experimental consequence |
| --- | --- |
| `SapiBridge.Synthesize` | Writes synthesized PCM to a memory stream and then files, never a playback device. |
| `make_fixtures` | Adds identical endpoint padding and a reproducible noisy condition. |
| `worker` | Loads one model, excludes one warm-up decode, then times full passes. |
| `errors` / `aggregate` | Uses common tokenization and corpus-weighted edit counts. |
| `verify_results` | Checks hashes, row coverage, scores, and timing totals in a local run receipt. |

Sources: (tools\SpeechBench\corpus.json:1-10, corpus entries); (tools\SpeechBench\SapiBridge.cs:53-73, `Synthesize`); (tools\SpeechBench\bench.py:125-150, `make_fixtures`); (tools\SpeechBench\bench.py:257-279, `worker`); (tools\SpeechBench\metrics.py:28-62, `errors`, `aggregate`); (tools\SpeechBench\bench.py:282-316, `verify_results`).

Fixture construction matters because endpoint behavior can dominate short utterances. Every case receives 250 ms of leading silence and 1,000 ms of trailing silence. Noise uses a deterministic Gaussian generator and a target 15 dB ratio against active synthesized samples whose absolute amplitude is at least 100. Noise also covers padding. This is a precise laboratory transformation, **not recorded office noise** or a full-file SNR definition. (tools\SpeechBench\bench.py:125-150, `make_fixtures`.)

The two voices are Microsoft David Desktop and Microsoft Zira Desktop. Combined with clean/noisy variants, eight sentences become 32 cases, but the conditions remain correlated. Technical vocabulary examples include Kubernetes and authentication; they do not establish accent, overlap, distant-microphone, or real-meeting coverage. (tools\SpeechBench\corpus.json:2-9, sentence categories; docs\SPEECH-BENCHMARK.md:44-57, fixture description; docs\SPEECH-BENCHMARK.md:225-228, coverage limits.)

# The scoring algorithm

## Normalize before aligning

`normalize` applies Unicode NFKC, lowercases, expands `%`, converts numeric strings through English cardinal words, removes apostrophes, and extracts alphabetic tokens. It does not drop stop words or repair one engine's terminology after seeing its output. Consequently, the benchmark ignores capitalization and punctuation but retains many genuine lexical errors. (tools\SpeechBench\metrics.py:8-25, `NORMALIZATION`, `normalize`.)

Normalization is a measurement policy, not semantic interpretation. `9:30` becomes two cardinals, while `9.30` uses decimal “point” wording; these can describe a similar intended time but score differently. Conversely, “don't” and “dont” become identical tokens. The tests make several such choices executable rather than leaving readers to infer them. (tools\SpeechBench\test_metrics.py:7-17, `test_numbers_are_common`, `test_apostrophes`; docs\SPEECH-BENCHMARK.md:79-82, numeric-format limitation.)

### Levenshtein alignment and ties

For reference prefix length `i` and hypothesis prefix length `j`, the dynamic-programming table stores `(total edits, substitutions, deletions, insertions)`. Equal tokens inherit the diagonal cell. Unequal tokens compare substitution, deletion, and insertion candidates, each costing one additional edit. When totals tie, candidate order prefers substitution, then deletion, then insertion. This stabilizes the reported S/D/I breakdown without making the alignment a semantic explanation of the recognizer's mistake. (tools\SpeechBench\metrics.py:28-55, `errors`.)

The table contains `(reference length + 1) × (hypothesis length + 1)` cells; thus this implementation's time and storage grow with their product. That is acceptable for the short fixture sentences, but a future long-recording evaluator should account for the matrix explicitly rather than assuming a streaming metric. This complexity follows directly from the allocation and nested loops. (tools\SpeechBench\metrics.py:31-48, `errors`.)

Corpus WER is:

```
WER = sum(substitutions + deletions + insertions)
      / sum(normalized reference words)
```

Do not average sentence percentages: one error in a one-word sentence should not outweigh one error in a much longer sentence simply because each sentence gets equal weight. An empty reference produces undefined WER; an empty hypothesis produces deletions. WER can exceed 100%, so `100 − WER` is not a general “accuracy percentage.” (tools\SpeechBench\metrics.py:49-62, `errors`, `aggregate`; tools\SpeechBench\test_metrics.py:24-37, empty-input and weighted-aggregation tests.)

## Reading the October 8 historical result

These are historical results on the synthetic corpus, rounded for readability:

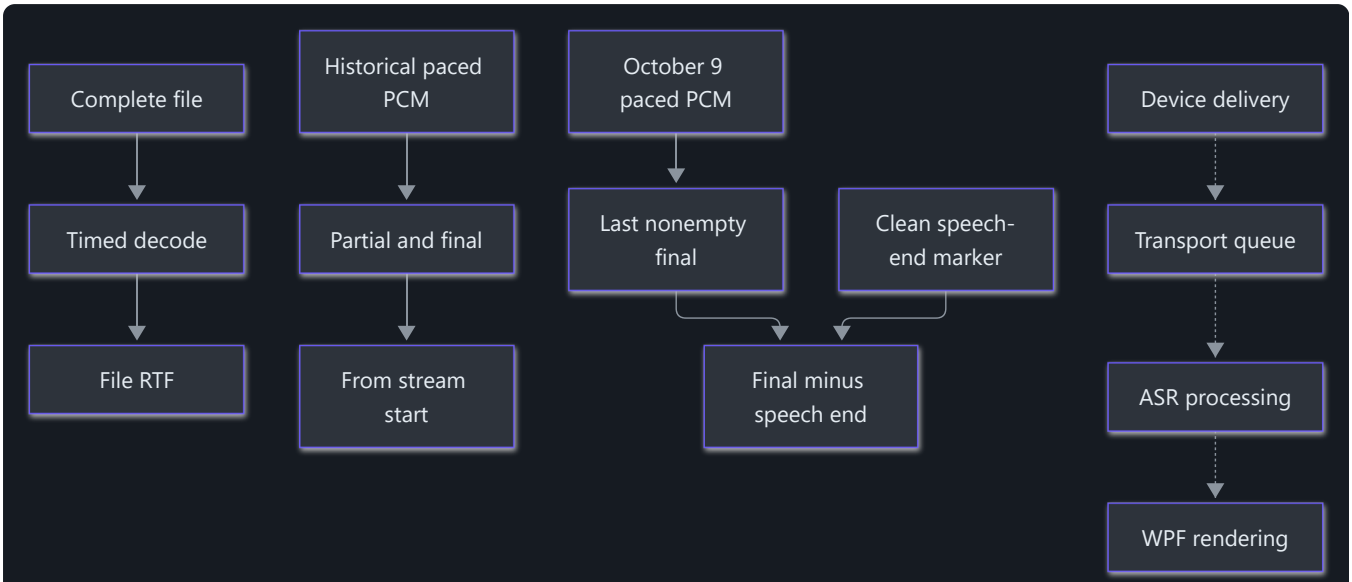
| Engine/configuration | WER | S / D / I | Warm decode median | RTF |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Installed SAPI en-US dictation | 45.89% | 99 / 2 / 33 | 10.139 s | 0.062 |
| Vosk small-en-us-0.15 | 8.22% | 14 / 0 / 10 | 41.754 s | 0.254 |
| faster-whisper base.en, CPU int8, beam 5 | 4.79% | 9 / 0 / 5 | 25.745 s | 0.157 |

The receipt contains the unrounded numbers and the separate pass totals. Its `transcripts_changed_across_repeats` arrays are empty: the repeats did not change the scored text. SAPI's clean/noisy WER is 17.12%/74.66%; Vosk is 8.22%/8.22%; Whisper is 4.79%/4.79%. Equal percentages in two conditions are observations on these fixtures, not noise-invariance guarantees. (tools\SpeechBench\results\synthetic-20261008.json:65-173, `summary`; docs\SPEECH-BENCHMARK.md:22-32, configuration table.)

RTF divides median decoding seconds by audio seconds. A value below one says this completed corpus decoded faster than its playback duration. It says nothing by itself about the time required to collect an utterance, endpoint it, authenticate a service connection, or render a partial.

(tools\SpeechBench\bench.py:355-369, `run`; docs\SPEECH-BENCHMARK.md:102-123, timing exclusions.)

### Which clock did the experiment actually observe?




12. Performance and Benchmarks - diagram 2. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

Dashed edges identify application stages outside the file experiment. In the separate paced Vosk probe, first partials arrived at **0.976 and 0.960 seconds from stream start**, after 0.9 seconds of PCM had been supplied. Both natural finals arrived near **3.807 seconds from stream start**, not 3.807 seconds after speech ended. Without an annotated last spoken sample, those figures cannot be converted into end-of-speech lag. Two observations also cannot establish a p95 latency distribution. (tools\SpeechBench\results\synthetic-20261008.json:9027-9151, `paced_pcm`; docs\AI-ANSWER-EVALUATION.md:12-40, A1 and latency definitions.)

## October 9: measuring the actual hybrid pipeline

The new receipt evaluates **real local models with synthetic PCM**, including two TTS voices, clean/noisy speech, three nonspeech controls, and a longer dual-source run. It explicitly excludes the user's recording, real endpoint acquisition, playback, and cloud ASR. It retains the original WER normalization: no reference-sentence prompts, fixed text substitutions, or retrospective word repairs make the score look better. These boundaries matter more than calling an engine "accurate." (`tools\SpeechBench\results\synthetic-quality-20261009.json:1-30`, safety and scoring.)

### Accuracy: keep the inconvenient comparison visible

| October 9 configuration | Word edits / reference words | Raw WER |
|---|---:|---:|
| Vosk streaming baseline | 52 / 432 | 12.04% |
| Hybrid base.en comparison | 23 / 432 | 5.32% |
| Hybrid small.en, unhinted | 11 / 432 | **2.55%** |
| Adopted small.en, technical vocabulary, parallel 15-second path | 19 / 432 | **4.40%** |

These figures come from separate completed runs, not a pooled count across pipeline experiments. The new Vosk 12.04% is not a correction to the old 8.22%: the experiment and reference corpus differ. (`tools\SpeechBench\results\synthetic-quality-20261009.json:56-63`, Vosk totals; `tools\SpeechBench\results\synthetic-quality-20261009.json:1362-1369`, base.en; `tools\SpeechBench\results\synthetic-quality-20261009.json:2668-2675`, unhinted small.en; `tools\SpeechBench\results\synthetic-quality-20261009.json:6589-6596`, adopted totals.)

Why choose the technical-vocabulary variant when its raw WER is worse than unhinted small.en? A reference containing `leet code` has two normalized words, while `LeetCode` becomes one: that compound can cost one substitution plus one deletion even when the proper-name spelling improves. The report therefore preserves WER as primary and adds a disclosed character metric: concatenate normalized words without spaces, then count character edits. Adopted CER is `5 / 1900 = 0.263%`, versus unhinted small.en's `19 / 1900 = 1.00%`. This is an explanatory secondary view, not permission to silently replace the worse primary score. (`tools\SpeechBench\results\synthetic-quality-20261009.json:3910-3914`, unhinted CER; `tools\SpeechBench\results\synthetic-quality-20261009.json:7831-7835`, adopted CER; `tools\SpeechBench\results\synthetic-quality-20261009.json:12744-12753`, rationale.)

The vocabulary is general programming terminology, passed as hotwords—not the evaluated sentences or user content. Remaining `to`/`two` and `some`/`sum` errors are explicitly retained; longer speech has additional errors. The 4.40% aggregate must not be marketed as a guarantee about the user's target phrase, accent, microphone, or arbitrary technical question. (`services\transcription\accurate.py:83-108`, vocabulary/context controls; `tools\SpeechBench\results\quality-validation-20261009.json:18-27`, selection and remaining errors.)

## Latency: preserve the clock and the failure ceiling

| Adopted short-case measurement | Observed p50 | Observed p95 |
|---|---|---|
| First provisional from stream start | 0.977 s | 1.114 s |
| End of speech to last nonempty final | 2.736 s | 3.017 s |
| Stop request to `stopped` | 0.480 s | 0.746 s |

Unlike the old two-observation probe, the new harness defines speech end: the last clean synthesized sample with absolute amplitude at least `100/32768`, fixed **before** adding noise. This is still a synthetic annotation, not a measured microphone onset/offset. Each run starts a fresh process, records import/verification/load separately, retains its first model call, and then includes warmer rows; OS caches and competing CPU work are uncontrolled. Its p95 is a sample quantile, not a service-level promise. (`tools\SpeechBench\results\synthetic-quality-20261009.json:21-30`, clock/load definitions; `tools\SpeechBench\results\synthetic-quality-20261009.json:6587-6627`, adopted timings and limits.)

The backend's advertised **85-second** maximum stop envelope is a conservative pending-work timeout, not one of those observations. The native **90-second** wait described in chapter 8 allows that envelope to complete; it does not mean normal Stop takes 90 seconds. Even the successful long dual-source run differs from the short-case median: its one measured drain was **3.419 seconds**. (`tools\SpeechBench\results\synthetic-quality-20261009.json:12733-12742`, maximum envelope; `tools\SpeechBench\results\synthetic-quality-20261009.json:8693-8726`, stress drain.)

### Long runs must test ownership and failure, not just words

The adopted long run uses production endpoint behavior and exercises four forced rotations. Its Computer ledger records 1,973,256 input bytes and exactly the same owned-span bytes: `1,973,256 / 32,000 = 61.66425` seconds, with matching input/decoded-PCM hashes and every sample owned once. It reaches `stopped`, assigns global final IDs 1–14, and records zero faults/drops; maximum observed source intake is 19,200 bytes/15 frames and pending finals two/source. That is evidence against loss/replay in this run, not proof of zero recognition errors. (`tools\SpeechBench\results\synthetic-quality-20261009.json:7887-7905`, ledger; `tools\SpeechBench\results\synthetic-quality-20261009.json:8693-8726`, completion/counters.)

The receipt deliberately retains unsuccessful approaches:

- The initial natural long run passed runtime/PCM checks but failed the harness's forced-rotation coverage assertion.
- Injected 30-second spans produced 44 Computer word insertions.
- A bounded temperature-retry experiment exceeded the 20-second native-call deadline and visibly faulted; incomplete scores are not comparable to completed runs.
- A shorter-window probe reduced that source's insertions to two, but the first production 15-second run hit the shared intake's 32-frame cap.

Dedicated bounded source workers replaced shared hybrid intake, followed by a new production-policy measurement. Thus “zero faults/drops” describes the **adopted completed runs**, not every experiment in the JSON file. Failed trials explain why the shipping policy uses 15-second targets, 16-second maximum spans, and independent intake instead of merely changing the model name. (`tools\SpeechBench\results\synthetic-quality-20261009.json:12704`, retained-experiment interpretation; `services\transcription\accurate.py:12-30`, implemented span bounds.)

## Historical timing fairness and provenance

The Python worker reads audio before timing, measures import/verification/load separately, and consumes Whisper's segment generator inside the decode call. PCM-to-float conversion is outside Whisper timing. SAPI times wave-stream binding through recognition completion, excluding initial file reads. These are exposed-API measurements, not isolated native-kernel timings. (tools\SpeechBench\bench.py:184-255, `worker`; tools\SpeechBench\SapiBridge.cs:75-110, `Decode`; tools\SpeechBench\SapiBridge.cs:123-157, `Recognize`.)

In the original benchmark, “cold load” means a new model instance, **not flushed OS caches**. The fixed order is SAPI → Vosk → Whisper. Common affinity limits placement to four logical processors, while requested native thread counts do not make all engines schedule identically. Thermal state, unrelated work, and same-vendor voices remain confounders. No confidence interval follows from two serial passes. (tools\SpeechBench\results\synthetic-20261008.json:4-22, environment/order; docs\SPEECH-BENCHMARK.md:95-100, cold-instance definition; docs\SPEECH-BENCHMARK.md:125-138, resource boundaries.)

The earlier documentation inspection identified a `bench.py` hash mismatch between the historical receipt and then-current harness. Do not turn that historical inspection into a claim that all present files were rerun or reverified. The stored source hashes preserve provenance; the October 9 validation separately records the

original benchmark's digest alongside the new quality receipt's digest. They identify two evidence artifacts, not an amended October 8 result. (tools\SpeechBench\results\synthetic-20261008.json:55-64, `source_sha256`; tools\SpeechBench\bench.py:378-387, receipt construction; `tools\SpeechBench\results\quality-validation-20261009.json:13-17`, receipt identities and exclusions.)

This documentation audit checked both receipt digests and the adopted run's seven recorded source hashes against the frozen files; all matched. That is a content-identity check, not a new inference run, installation, or test result. (`tools\SpeechBench\results\synthetic-quality-20261009.json:6629-6637`, adopted `source_sha256`; `tools\SpeechBench\results\quality-validation-20261009.json:13-14`, receipt digests.)

# Worked pseudocode: auditing without decoding audio

The following is explanatory pseudocode, not a benchmark invocation. It audits the public result's internal arithmetic and repeat coverage; unlike `verify_results`, it cannot establish unchanged raw WAVs from the public receipt alone. (tools\SpeechBench\bench.py:282-316, `verify_results`; tools\SpeechBench\results\synthetic-20261008.json:175-189, public case metadata.)

```
receipt = read_public_synthetic_receipt()
for name, engine in receipt["engines"].items():
    rows = engine["rows"]
    summary = receipt["summary"][name]
    require_unique_pairs(rows, keys=("id", "repeat"))
    require_complete_case_repeat_grid(rows, receipt["cases"],
                                      receipt["repeats"])
    first_pass = [row for row in rows if row["repeat"] == 0]
    expected_errors = sum(row["substitutions"] + row["deletions"]
                          + row["insertions"] for row in first_pass)
    expected_words = sum(row["reference_words"] for row in first_pass)
    assert summary["wer"] == expected_errors / expected_words
    pass_times = [sum(r["decode_seconds"] for r in rows if r["repeat"] == k)
                  for k in range(receipt["repeats"])]
    assert summary["median_decode_seconds"] == median(pass_times)
# No capture, synthesis, download, or inference is necessary for this audit.
```

The October 8 recommendation—to retain Vosk streaming and investigate optional Whisper refinement—was a decision under the older evidence, not the current default. The original Vosk implementation remains available explicitly. October 9 configuration instead selects **hybrid-whisper, small.en, CPU int8, four threads, technical vocabulary**, with fast provisional text and bounded local finals. It makes no silent fallback if selected weights are missing. (services\transcription\recognizer.py:96-110, legacy `accept`, `finish`; docs\SPEECH-BENCHMARK.md:34-40, historical recommendation; `services\transcription\configuration.py:8-35`, current defaults/validation; `services\transcription\configuration.py:60-69`, required models; `services\transcription\accurate.py:75-81`, CPU loading.)

The public validation reports **104 service tests and 18 benchmark tests**. Neither those counts nor the synthetic accuracy improvement qualifies actual user speech, echo/AEC, endpoint permissions, or meeting capture. No build, test, service, model provisioning, synthesis, playback, or cloud action was performed for this

chapter update. (`tools\SpeechBench\results\quality-validation-20261009.json:4-17`, validation scope; `tools\SpeechBench\results\synthetic-quality-20261009.json:6620-6627`, qualification limits.)

### Failure outcomes belong in the experiment

An unavailable engine is not an infinitely slow engine, a zero-error engine, or a reason to install a new component silently. The SAPI bridge records unavailable status when no en-US recognizer exists; subprocess failures likewise produce an unavailable result rather than a fabricated timing row. A comparison report must retain that outcome and explain which configurations actually ran. (tools\SpeechBench\SapiBridge.cs:113-121, `Recognize`; tools\SpeechBench\bench.py:328-353, `run`.)

Inputs also have a contract: the loader rejects duplicate IDs and empty corpora, and the WAV reader requires uncompressed 16 kHz mono signed 16-bit PCM. Silent resampling would move preprocessing work and change the experiment without an explicit decision. Empty reference strings are technically accepted, but their undefined WER makes them inappropriate for ordinary accuracy ranking. These are methodological limits to document, not inconveniences to bypass. (tools\SpeechBench\bench.py:99-103, `pcm_from_wav`; tools\SpeechBench\bench.py:155-176, `load_cases`; tools\SpeechBench\metrics.py:49-54, `errors`.)

## Exercises

1. Hand-align reference “do not restart” with hypothesis “do restart.” Explain why a modest token error can reverse intent, motivating fidelity checks beyond WER. (tools\SpeechBench\metrics.py:28-55, `errors`; docs\AI-ANSWER-EVALUATION.md:84-86, question fidelity.)
2. Calculate WER for one erroneous one-word case and one correct four-word case. Compare corpus weighting with an unweighted mean; the existing test expects 0.2. (tools\SpeechBench\test_metrics.py:34-37, `test_weighted_aggregation_not_mean_of_case_wer`.)
3. Design, but do not run, a representative follow-up: independent speakers, annotated speech end, randomized engine order, and separate warm/cold strata. State which current limitation each addition addresses. (docs\SPEECH-BENCHMARK.md:132-138, run-order limits; docs\SPEECH-BENCHMARK.md:218-228, corpus limits; docs\AI-ANSWER-EVALUATION.md:33-43, clocks.)
4. Score `leet code` against `LeetCode` with the primary token metric and the secondary joined-character metric. Why must both results remain visible?
5. Explain why a byte-exact 61.66425-second span ledger, zero drops, and a nonzero WER are compatible observations.

## References

- Existing comparison and methodology.
- Public synthetic result.
- October 9 quality and retained experiments and validation receipt.
- Harness, metric implementation, and SAPI bridge.
- Metric tests and harness boundary tests; the latter explicitly reject escaped output paths, implicit resampling, duplicate case IDs, and empty corpora. (tools\SpeechBench\test_harness.py:8-38,

`HarnessTests`.)

- Planned answer evaluation, which must not be read as an executed cloud benchmark.

# 13. Local Questions, Installed Providers and Future Azure

## Why question selection is the architectural center

**Persistent Agency ACP now implements controlled direct Q&A; measured evidence is provider-level, not WPF acceptance. Direct Azure remains optional future work.** TODO28 established exact local Freeze. Accurate armed Mic spans remain TODO29; they do not block asking reviewed segments or typed text. Azure30/31 still need an approved profile and adapter. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.Questions.cs:265-304, `QuestionAsk_Click`; TODO\29_QUESTION_COMMIT_LATENCY.todo:13-22, planned commit; TODO\31_STREAMING_ANSWER_CLIENT.todo:30-36, completion evidence.)

The owner redirected the primary path to installed **Agency** after an organization-auth popup: no new login and no organization-data access. The parent stopped the owned login and reset the app to SnapshotOnly. Agency mode and `AnswerSettings.AgencyPath` support that direction. The earlier single Copilot smoke **failed at the customization/tool gate**; its allowance remains consumed because a model call cannot be ruled out. The later Agency probe had **new, separate authorization**, not a retry of that allowance. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\Answers\AnswerContracts.cs:3-20, contract and modes; src\PhantomFudge.Core\Answers\AnswerConfiguration.cs:13-29, `Load`.) See provider setup/status and workstream39.

The earlier Sonnet marker smoke established connectivity only. The final authorized ledger contains **48 question submissions**, including failures, with no audio, organization data or new login; no further model calls are planned. The new default is `gpt-5.6-sol-fast` **/ low**, catalog-advertised and actually tested on pinned Agency **2026.10.7.4** / Copilot **1.0.92**. LocalModel still has mocks only, and existing authentication can expire. (tools\AgencyProbe\results\summary-final.json:2-31, scope, accounting and selection; tools\AgencyProbe\results\summary-final.json:197-224, catalog/isolation boundaries.)

**H passed three exact-text prepared-session trials: 4.066, 4.176 and 2.992 s** to complete useful answers, including session close, with **33/33** compiled checks. Two requests used intended wording; one preserved “okay so right mean the solution for the lead good problem to some” and received Two Sum under an explicit assumption. This tests supplied text, not live recognition. Initial preparation took **19.987 s**, outside those completion intervals; the results establish neither a cold-start budget nor an SLO. (tools\AgencyProbe\results\latency-suite-20261009-h-exact-fast.json:2-56, exact inputs/answers/timing; tools\AgencyProbe\results\latency-suite-20261009-h-quality.json:2-186, compiled checks.)

Keep the failed path visible: historical Haiku E passed five prepared original-variation trials below five seconds, but did not use owner ASR. Exact-text Haiku F chose two wrong problems and appended one follow-up; mini G interpreted the title correctly but failed ten wider-range overflow checks. F/G first Asks after transport-only readiness took **5.041/6.470 s**. H does not erase those outcomes or imply every future question is solved correctly. (tools\AgencyProbe\results\latency-suite-20261009-f-exact.json:2-98, Haiku failures; tools\AgencyProbe\results\summary-final.json:141-180, E–H comparison.)

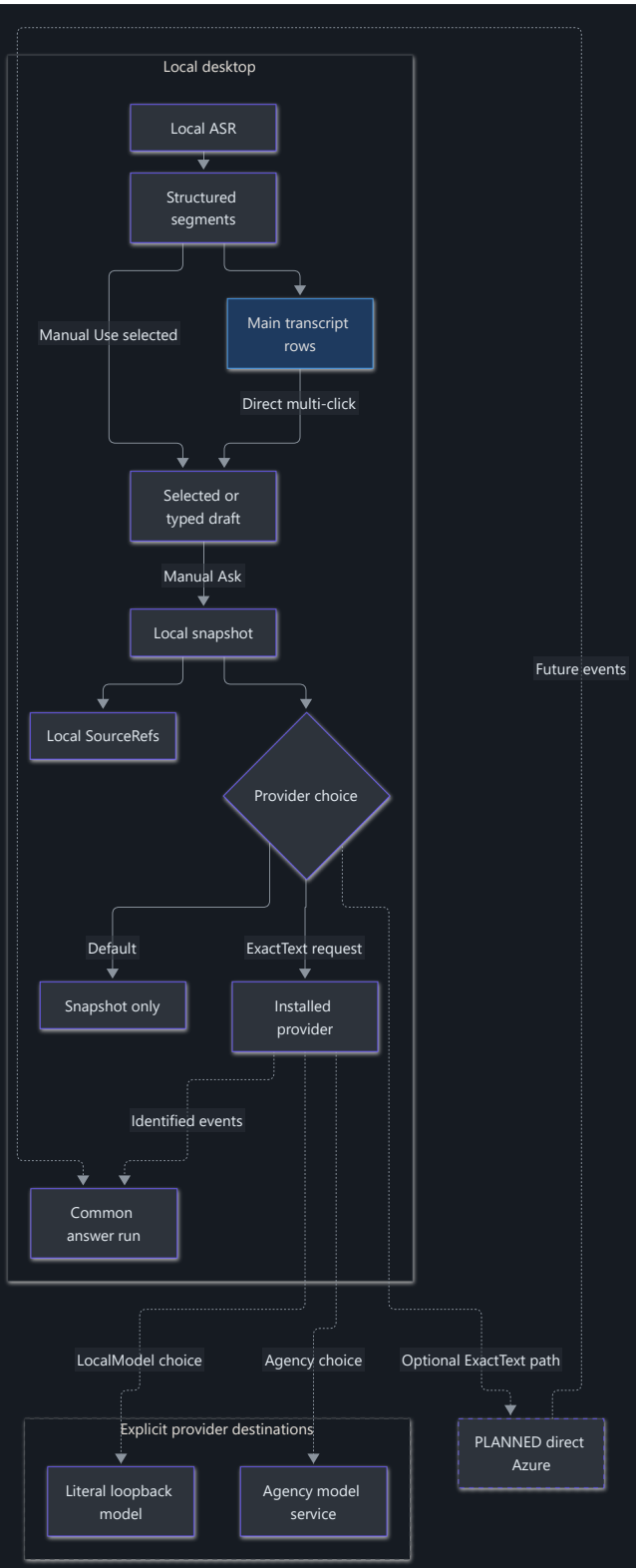
The hard problem is not posting text to a model. It is knowing **which text the user intended to send**, keeping that text stable during asynchronous recognition, and associating a future answer with the right question. A microphone may contain earlier conversation while Computer audio continues. The implemented solution to the local part is an explicit editable draft followed by an immutable snapshot at Ask, not an implicit whole-transcript prompt. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\QuestionDraft.cs:18-45, `ReplaceSelection`; src\PhantomFudge.Core\QuestionDraft.cs:90-95, `Freeze`; docs\AI-ANSWER-PRIVACY.md:11-25, proposed text boundary.)

The October9 source-only update makes direct multi-click selection the normal entrance to that draft: click Mic/Computer rows, review their combined text, then Ask separately. The historical045022 ZIP does not contain it. Selection changes no provider contract and creates no model request. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.TranscriptSelection.cs:85-147; local workflow.)

A useful mental model has three objects: the transcript is an evolving observation, the draft is a working selection, and the snapshot is an immutable local commitment. Its copied `SourceRefs` remain **local provenance**, not provider input. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\QuestionSnapshot.cs:5-23, `QuestionSnapshot`.) `AnswerRun` now constructs a fresh request ID plus `snapshot.ExactText`; serializing the whole snapshot would undo that deliberately narrow boundary. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\Answers\AnswerRun.cs:15-27, constructor and `Request`.)

# Architecture: local speech, explicit text egress

The implemented path preserves native Python ASR. C# has a common asynchronous answer contract; Agency background prompting is the requested installed-provider path, with direct Azure later if chosen. Routing inference through the speech service would add coupling without a demonstrated requirement. Neither subprocess management nor model work belongs in capture callbacks or the recognizer CPU worker. (docs\AI-ANSWER-ARCHITECTURE.md:82-188, recommended baseline.)




13. Local Questions, Installed Providers and Future Azure - diagram 1. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

Dashed edges mark destination boundaries or planned Azure, not simultaneous calls or fallback. No partials, chat reader or whole-meeting context are forwarded automatically. Cloud ASR and an enterprise broker remain separate optional workstreams; Docker stays last rather than becoming a CLI prerequisite. (docs\AI-ANSWER-ARCHITECTURE.md:82-188, baseline; TODO\36_OPTIONAL_AZURE_SPEECH.todo:13-25, optionality; TODO\37_OPTIONAL_ANSWER_BROKER.todo:13-26, conditional broker; TODO\35_ANSWER_RELEASE_ACCEPTANCE.todo:23-26, Docker-last gate.)

**Installed Agency is not offline.** `agency copilot` launches locally but may use Agency's remote model service; existing model authentication is distinct from organization-data access. LocalModel remains a separate compatible Copilot-engine OFFLINE/BYOK path with an explicit model and literal-loopback server. Settings reject remote/DNS endpoints, embedded credentials, queries and fragments, but cannot prove a local server never proxies elsewhere. No local-server failure may trigger hosted-model fallback. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\Answers\AnswerContracts.cs:22-55, `AnswerSettings.Validate`, `ValidateLocalEndpoint`.)

# What the existing interfaces provide—and omit

| Existing component | Implemented contract | Consequence for the proposal |
|---|---|---|
| `AudioSource` | Stable byte values and separate wire/display names | Source identity must not be inferred from rendered labels. |
| `TranscriptSegmentKey` | Capture GUID, source, epoch, stable local utterance ID | Local provenance now exists independently of formatted display text. |
| `StructuredTranscriptStore` | Bounded immutable records and revisions | Current v2 events use local epoch 0, not negotiated commit metadata. |
| `TranscriptRow` / selection handler | Main-history display paired with immutable segment identity | Visible rows remain selectable after smaller chooser eviction; click order is not question order. |
| `QuestionDraft` / `QuestionSnapshot` | Explicit selection/editing and copied immutable Freeze | Remains independent of provider settings and armed sample boundaries. |
| `AnswerRequest` / `AnswerRun` | Exact-text projection, fresh request identity and bounded event state | Provider output cannot be associated by mutable draft text alone. |
| `TranscriptBuffer` | Per-source partials, flattened finals, bounded text | Display/export storage is not a segment-selection database. |
| `TranscriptionSocket` | Single-use session, v1/v2 negotiation, strict response fields | New controls and metadata require explicit version/capability negotiation. |
| `Session` | Hybrid per-source PCM queues/workers, a bounded shared finalization queue, and serialized session-global final IDs | Preserve each source's processing order; received PCM is not processed coverage for commit. |

Sources: (src\PhantomFudge.Core\AudioSource.cs:3-30, `AudioSource`, `AudioSourceNames`); (src\PhantomFudge.Core\TranscriptSegment.cs:3-20, `TranscriptSegmentKey`); (src\PhantomFudge.Core\StructuredTranscriptStore.cs:13-37, defaults and sessions); (src\PhantomFudge.Core\QuestionDraft.cs:8-16, draft fields); (src\PhantomFudge.Core\QuestionSnapshot.cs:17-23, snapshot fields); (src\PhantomFudge.Core\TranscriptBuffer.cs:6-19, `TranscriptBuffer`); (src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:117-169, `ConnectCoreAsync`; src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:491-515, property validation); (services\transcription\server.py:280-290, `Session`).

The additional answer seam is implemented in (src\PhantomFudge.Core\Answers\AnswerContracts.cs:3-12, `AnswerRequest`, `IAnswerProvider`; src\PhantomFudge.Core\Answers\AnswerRun.cs:15-30, run identity/state).

The retained-row seam and common mouse/keyboard/automation composition path are in (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.TranscriptSelection.cs:13-83,85-147).

`TranscriptBuffer.AddFinal` appends a formatted line and advances one global final ID; `BeginSession` resets that ID while retaining existing text with a separator. Therefore `17` is not a durable cross-session reference. Likewise, `[Mic]` is presentation text that a user could type. The unchanged display/export buffer is deliberately not the selection database. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\TranscriptBuffer.cs:23-38, `BeginSession`; src\PhantomFudge.Core\TranscriptBuffer.cs:48-72, `AddFinal`; src\PhantomFudge.Core\TranscriptBuffer.cs:87-96, source formatting.)

# Implemented components and local dataflow

The store accepts the local capture GUID supplied with each event and uses epoch 0 for current v2. A partial and its eventual final share a local utterance key; revisions distinguish replacement text. Qualified final times are audio-relative seconds, not word-level/sample-exact boundaries. A stale session/epoch or duplicate/out-of-order protocol final ID is rejected. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.Questions.cs:134-142, `UpdateQuestionTranscript`; src\PhantomFudge.Core\StructuredTranscriptStore.cs:36-100, `SetPartial`, `AddFinal`; src\PhantomFudge.Core\StructuredTranscriptStore.cs:120-125, freshness; src\PhantomFudge.Core\TranscriptSegment.cs:28-58, segment fields.)

Direct main-transcript clicks toggle whole Mic/Computer segments without Ctrl, composing raw text in displayed history order. Wrapped/multiline segments are indivisible rows, not arbitrary text ranges. Both final and unfinished ListBoxes route `SelectionChanged` to the same validator. Selection opens Q/A and enters independent editing but never creates a snapshot or submits it. After a manual edit, further direct changes are rejected with inline retained-draft status and restored highlights until **Clear question**. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.TranscriptSelection.cs:85-147.)

The alternative **Choose source** chooser defaults to **Mic**. **Computer** or **All** are explicit filters; changing one never selects its contents automatically. **Use selected** is an explicit replacement action, including after editing, and copies only chosen keys. Typing is another alternative. Both selection paths use `ReplaceSelection`: one capture session, at most256entries and8,192UTF-16 code units including newline separators. Empty Ask and oversized changes reject without truncation. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.Questions.cs:14-17, default filter; src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.Questions.cs:70-128, selection; src\PhantomFudge.Core\QuestionDraft.cs:18-45, session/copy rules; src\PhantomFudge.Core\QuestionDraft.cs:90-124, validation.)

Store retention is separate: 256 records/64,000 text characters. `ApplyUpdate` stages changes and evicts oldest non-active records except the current update; it fails if protected live data cannot fit. Drafts retain copied selections through eviction. `Refresh` can improve a selected unfinished record, but `EditText` makes user text authoritative—even reasserting the same text blocks later ASR replacement. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\StructuredTranscriptStore.cs:13-18, limits; src\PhantomFudge.Core\StructuredTranscriptStore.cs:134-145, eviction; src\PhantomFudge.Core\QuestionDraft.cs:48-79, edit/refresh.)

Main-history rows retain their own structured identity after chooser eviction and remain bounded by the unchanged display/export buffer. Archived unfinished partials stay selectable/provisional; separators are not selectable. Before editing, selected keys follow partial revisions into finals. New finals follow scrolling only

when already at the end, avoiding jumps during history selection.
(src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.TranscriptSelection.cs:13-83; `TranscriptBuffer`.)

### Worked local ordering

For a synthetic Mic partial "Explain Service Fabric like", the actual Core APIs support this sequence; the assertions illustrate expected behavior rather than a newly executed test:

```
draft.ReplaceSelection(new[] { micPartial });
var frozen = draft.Freeze();                // local only
store.AddFinal(session, AudioSource.Microphone, 3,
    "Explain Service Fabric like I am five.", 1, 2);
draft.Refresh(store);                       // draft may improve
draft.EditText("Explain Service Fabric like I'm five.");
draft.Refresh(store);                       // user edit wins
Assert(frozen.ExactText == "Explain Service Fabric like");
```

The snapshot copies text and provenance; later recognition, typing, eviction or Clear cannot mutate the already-created object. Copy draft is deliberate and uses the Windows clipboard, outside capture protection. These local objects remain memory-only, but the configured CLI path does not: external profiles can retain prompts and sessions. Clear is not a deletion request to that profile or cloud service.
(src\PhantomFudge.Core\QuestionSnapshot.cs:5-23, copied immutable fields;
src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.Questions.cs:14-22, state;
src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.Questions.cs:265-337, Ask/Copy/Clear.)

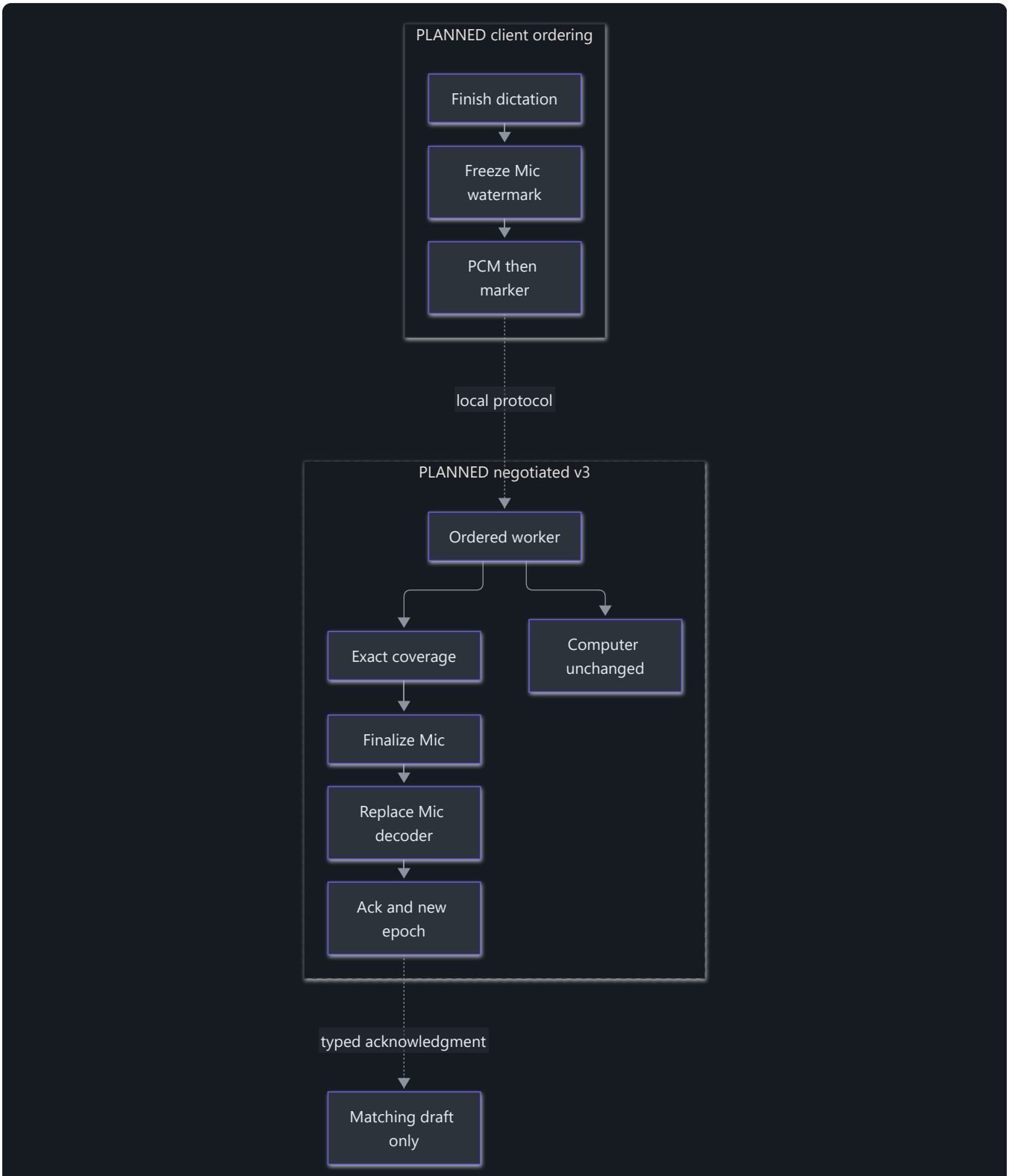
**Finish dictation remains planned.** Selecting text does not arm a sample-exact live span. `IQuestionCommitter` remains proposed, whereas `IAnswerProvider.StreamAsync` now exists. Fake streams are validation tools, never pretend real answers. This distinction allows explicit Ask before source commit without claiming acoustic completeness. (docs\AI-ANSWER-ARCHITECTURE.md:611-642, provider/commit separation;
TODO\29_QUESTION_COMMIT_LATENCY.todo:13-22, commit work.)

## Planned algorithm: Mic-only commit as an ordered barrier

Today, `SendAudioAsync` drains queued PCM and sends a global Stop. The server accepts only the exact Stop control, then finalizes **every** selected decoder before acknowledging stopped. Calling that path to submit a question would terminate Computer transcription too.
(src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:322-340, `SendAudioAsync`;
services\transcription\server.py:306-316, `Session.receive`; services\transcription\server.py:394-498, `Session.recognize`.)

The proposed v3 capability inserts a Mic commit envelope into the **same ordered sender queue**, under the same synchronization boundary that freezes its delivered-sample watermark. A second concurrent WebSocket sender would break the intended ordering guarantee. Server processing must reach exactly that source watermark before finalization; bytes received into a queue are not evidence of decoded coverage. Current `SourceState.total_bytes` increments in receive, before the worker calls `accept`, so it cannot serve as the

proposed processed counter. (docs\AI-ANSWER-ARCHITECTURE.md:461-506, commit design; services\transcription\server.py:339-357, `Session.receive`; services\transcription\server.py:418-451, `Session.recognize`.)




13. Local Questions, Installed Providers and Future Azure - diagram 2. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

The wrapper already provides a useful implementation pattern: after 30 audio seconds it retrieves a final, advances its cumulative offset, and constructs a new decoder. `finish()` alone retrieves a final but does not prepare continued recognition. The proposed commit must adapt finalize-and-replace for Mic while preserving Computer state and session-global final numbering. This is feasibility evidence, not an existing commit API. (services\transcription\recognizer.py:69-110, `VoskRecognizer`; TODO\29_QUESTION_COMMIT_LATENCY.todo:13-22, planned tasks.)

## Worked pseudocode: retries without duplicate finalization

This sketch specifies invariants for a future implementation, not methods currently callable in the service:

```
def process_commit(marker, session):
    key = (session.capture_id, marker.source, marker.request_id)
    prior = session.completed_commits.get(key)
    if prior is not None:
        require(prior.parameters == marker.parameters)
        return prior.ack            # no second final or epoch increment

    track = session.sources[marker.source]
    require(marker.epoch == track.epoch)
    require(track.processed_samples == marker.through_sample)
    final = track.finalize_and_replace_preserving_offset()
    final_ref = session.record_final(final)   # including an empty final
    old_epoch = track.epoch
    track.epoch += 1
    ack = Ack(key, old_epoch, track.epoch,
              marker.through_sample, final_ref)
    session.remember_bounded_commit(key, marker.parameters, ack)
    return ack
```

Lookup precedes current-epoch validation so a genuine retry can replay its original acknowledgment after the epoch has advanced. Changed parameters under the same request ID must fail. The eventual implementation also needs a defined publication/failure boundary and bounded deduplication lifetime; the sketch does not promise durable exactly-once delivery across process crashes. (docs\AI-ANSWER-ARCHITECTURE.md:461-506, commit ordering/idempotency; TODO\29_QUESTION_COMMIT_LATENCY.todo:26-28, duplicate/empty-commit acceptance.)

An armed question needs a start boundary as well as an end. Otherwise earlier Mic conversation enters the question. Current partials disable word-level timing, so arbitrary retrospective acoustic cuts cannot be reconstructed exactly from displayed text. A click watermark also covers delivered samples, not audio still inside a device buffer. A bounded tail-drain policy must be specified and measured rather than disguised as sample-exact knowledge of when the user finished speaking. (services\transcription\recognizer.py:78-81, `_new_decoder`; docs\AI-ANSWER-ARCHITECTURE.md:461-506, start and device-buffer boundaries.)

# Common answer state, then optional Azure

`AnswerRun.Apply` accepts only its request's events while Streaming. Sequence values must increase strictly; duplicates or events after a completion marker fail. Text deltas must be nonempty, and the 32,768-code-unit cap rejects an overflowing delta without silently truncating it. `Completed` carries no text and only latches a terminal marker. `Complete` requires that marker and nonblank text after **request enumeration ends**. Persistent ACP process EOF is not normal request completion. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\Answers\AnswerRun.cs:32-63, `Apply`, `Complete`.)

The common UI retains one active request, a 120-second overall deadline and a 40-ms render timer. Hide/Clear/protection invalidation/reload/close stop and dispose the cached Agency provider; cancellation awaits owned-process cleanup. Partial text stays incomplete unless deliberately cleared, and Copy is explicit. Reveal may prepare readiness but never resend a question. The lifetime owner also suppresses actual warm-up in diagnostic-constructor mode. See the provider guide; a successful Core transition alone does not prove process cleanup. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\Answers\AnswerRun.cs:65-79, retained cancellation/failure state.)

`Initialize-Answers.ps1 -Provider Agency` resolves the executable without login. The controlled profile is not a personal coding session or organization-data connector. Missing existing authentication must fail visibly, not trigger app-owned sign-in/account switching. Settings/profile separation and a `.exe` path check prove neither isolation nor zero retention; supported launch details belong in the provider guide. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\Answers\AnswerConfiguration.cs:8-29, paths and strict loading; src\PhantomFudge.Core\Answers\AnswerContracts.cs:16-33, settings fields/path validation.)

## Actual ACP transaction: no implicit provider history

The default-off Clarify first extension deliberately sends a bounded history of this question's interpretation/reply exchanges. Each explicit action still creates a fresh, terminal provider request; the app never leaves the CLI waiting for interactive user input. Normal Ask and confirmed answers retain the no-follow-up rule. The earlier latency receipts below do not establish this loop's end-to-end latency or model interpretation quality.

One cached engine serves at most 32 created sessions before rotation. **Normal configured startup/reveal intentionally calls** `WarmUpAsync`, preparing one empty session with no model prompt. Successful answers close their conversation and prepare another empty one, never a follow-up. The separate `WarmUpTransportAsync` creates no session and leaves that setup cost on Ask; it is not the current app readiness policy. The lifetime owner keeps the readiness state distinct from question submission. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\Answers\AgencyAcpConnection.cs:41-88, reuse/session creation; tools\AgencyProbe\results\agency-selected-fast-default-preparation.json:2-16, selected-default empty preparation.)

```
on explicit Ask(exact frozen text):
    acquire provider gate; obtain fresh empty session
    select controlled agent through ACP; verify role/model/allow_all=off
    send ONE user message: fixed policy + JSON { userQuestion: exact text }
    stream identified bounded text; reject tool/plan/capability requests
    require end_turn and acceptable nonblank answer
    await session/close acknowledgment
    emit Completed; end this request's enumeration, keep engine alive
```

```
    prepare next EMPTY session; do not submit another question
on cancellation/failure/owned shutdown:
    stop engine; remove owned workspace; retain only incomplete visible text
```

The explicit ACP role selection matters: CLI `--agent` alone did not select the custom agent in this pinned engine. The fixed policy is installed in the **SYSTEM role**. The single user payload also includes fixed policy plus JSON-escaped `ExactText`; it is not a raw-question-only wire message. Normal Ask attaches no provenance, notes or previous answers. Only opted-in clarification requests attach their typed conversation metadata. `@` is escaped to prevent file-reference interpretation without changing the decoded question. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\Answers\AgencyAcpConnection.cs:61-122, selection/prompt/close; src\PhantomFudge.Core\Answers\AgencyAnswerPrompt.cs:8-97, policy/envelope; tools\AgencyProbe\results\summary-final.json:197-219, observed role and history isolation.)

No clarification/permission/tool wait is successful completion. Protocol plans and capability requests fail; the heuristic scans bounded answer prose outside code fences for selected missing-input/follow-up phrases. It is not semantic proof: F chose wrong problems; G chose the correct problem but omitted arithmetic safeguards. H's finite checks support the selected profile, not universal correctness. General arithmetic, title-disambiguation and labelled-assumption policy must not become a hard-coded answer or snapshot rewrite. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\Answers\AgencyAcpConnection.cs:213-265, rejected requests/plans; src\PhantomFudge.Core\Answers\AgencyAcpConnection.cs:330-354, heuristic; src\PhantomFudge.Core\Answers\AgencyAnswerPrompt.cs:12-43, useful-answer requirements; tools\AgencyProbe\results\summary-final.json:109-180, retained failures.)

## Optional Azure preserves the same narrow interface

The optional future Azure provider would call **v1 Responses** with `stream:true`, `store:false`, `background:false`, no tools, conversation ID or `previous_response_id`. Its model field identifies an approved deployment alias. “Foreground” describes API execution, not desktop activation. Research examples are not an installed Azure client or CLI request format. (docs\AI-ANSWER-RESEARCH.md:163-204, inference API; TODO\31_STREAMING_ANSWER_CLIENT.todo:13-21, adapter tasks.)

The research shortlist is `gpt-5.4-mini`, `gpt-5.4-nano`, and `gpt-5-mini`, with documented versions and lifecycle dates as of the existing research. None is established as fastest; subscription entitlement, quota, capacity, processing policy, and actual deployment availability remain unknown. (docs\AI-ANSWER-RESEARCH.md:139-161, shortlist and availability intersection; docs\AI-ANSWER-RESEARCH.md:257-272, uncertainty summary.)

Question, answer, connection, audio and capture-protection states remain separate. Common events now carry identity/sequence; future Azure terminal/filter handling must preserve that separation. HTTP 200 or stream closure is not completion, and local cancellation does not guarantee stopped remote billing. (docs\AI-ANSWER-ARCHITECTURE.md:507-610, state machines; docs\AI-ANSWER-ARCHITECTURE.md:643-670, streaming failures.)

The question pane is inside the protected WPF surface, and common answer UI is integrated there. Global `TogglePresentationAsync` still stops transcription before changing Notes modes. Question typing instead uses `SetQuestionEditing`: deliberate focus, no transcription stop and no Notes-edit enablement. The manual chooser can remain passive, but direct main-row clicks deliberately enter that question-editing path. Neither selection path is Ask. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:253-275, `TogglePresentationAsync`;

src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.Questions.cs:37-58, inline expansion;
src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.Questions.cs:156-208, separate focus;
src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.TranscriptSelection.cs:131-147.)

## Tradeoffs and adversarial event ordering

Consider an ordinary scheduling race rather than a network attack: the user asks A, cancels it, and asks B; a previously queued A delta then reaches the dispatcher. Disposing the HTTP stream is insufficient because the callback may already exist. The UI must compare the delta's request identity with the current answer generation before appending it. A cancellation acknowledgment and a stale-output guard solve different problems. (docs\AI-ANSWER-ARCHITECTURE.md:507-610, answer state and event rules; TODO\32_ANSWER_UI_LIFECYCLE.todo:19-25, delayed callbacks.)

User edits already block ordinary ASR replacement; the future commit path must preserve that rule across acknowledgment races. Immediate local Freeze favors visible user control, whereas planned Finish dictation adds acknowledged recognition coverage. Neither permits a later result to overwrite a frozen question or secretly send it. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\QuestionDraft.cs:48-79, edit ownership; docs\AI-ANSWER-ARCHITECTURE.md:461-506, planned epochs and boundaries.)

Core snapshot tests assert stability across later recognition, edits, Clear, eviction and capture restart; these are not provider-process or recipient qualification. (tests\PhantomFudge.Core.Tests\QuestionSnapshotTests.cs:30-70, `SnapshotSurvivesLateAsrEditsClearsEvictionAndCaptureRestart`.) The historical TODO28 handoff recorded an unexplained foreground failure before a successful identical-source repeat and no significant review defects. That local completion is not TODO39 acceptance, proof of CLI restrictions or model latency.

## Exercises

1. Trace Ask on revision 4, then a final producing draft revision 5. Specify the snapshot/editor contents and explain how SnapshotOnly differs from configured provider mode without changing the frozen text. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\QuestionDraft.cs:61-95, `Refresh`, `Freeze`; src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.Questions.cs:265-290, snapshot boundary.)
2. Place a Mic marker behind two Mic frames and an interleaved Computer frame. Explain why acknowledging reception is insufficient and why global Stop is incorrect. (services\transcription\server.py:296-498, `Session.receive`, `recognize`.)
3. Retry a commit after its epoch changes, then retry the same ID with a different watermark. Write expected acknowledgment/rejection assertions without opening audio devices. (TODO\29_QUESTION_COMMIT_LATENCY.todo:16-28, retry and boundary requirements.)

## References

- Detailed proposal, research and source register, and identity/privacy design.
- Implemented local composer, draft, and snapshot.
- Direct transcript selection, synthetic selection diagnostic, and workstream44.
- Installed-provider setup, common contract and run state.

- ACP connection, controlled policy, final provider evidence and metadata diagnostics.
- H exact-text timing and H compiled correctness.
- Draft workstream, commit workstream, and streaming workstream.
- Existing transport, server, and recognizer.
- Azure Responses primary documentation, recorded in the existing research; not newly retrieved or account-verified for this chapter.

# 14. Answer Latency, Identity, and Privacy

## Why these concerns belong together

**Persistent Agency ACP now has finite provider-level latency and correctness evidence. It does not have a universal five-second guarantee or a voice-to-visible-answer benchmark.** Direct Azure remains optional future work; no Azure entitlement or retention configuration was verified here. Existing Azure research cannot establish Agency's account policies. (TODO\30_AZURE_ANSWER_CONNECTION.todo:31-37, completion evidence; TODO\33_ANSWER_LATENCY_QUALITY.todo:30-36, completion evidence; docs\AI-ANSWER-PRIVACY.md:138-156, primary-reference scope.)

After an organization-auth popup, the owner rejected new login and organization-data access, choosing the existing installed Agency background-prompt path. The parent stopped the owned login and reset SnapshotOnly. **Local Agency installation does not mean offline inference**; the probe used its remote model service. LocalModel retains a separate literal-loopback OFFLINE/BYOK route. The earlier direct Copilot smoke failed at the customization/tool gate, consuming its allowance because model invocation cannot be ruled out; the later successful Agency request received new, separate authorization. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\Answers\AnswerContracts.cs:14-55, modes and validation; src\PhantomFudge.Core\Answers\AnswerConfiguration.cs:13-29, `Load`.) See provider boundaries and workstream39.

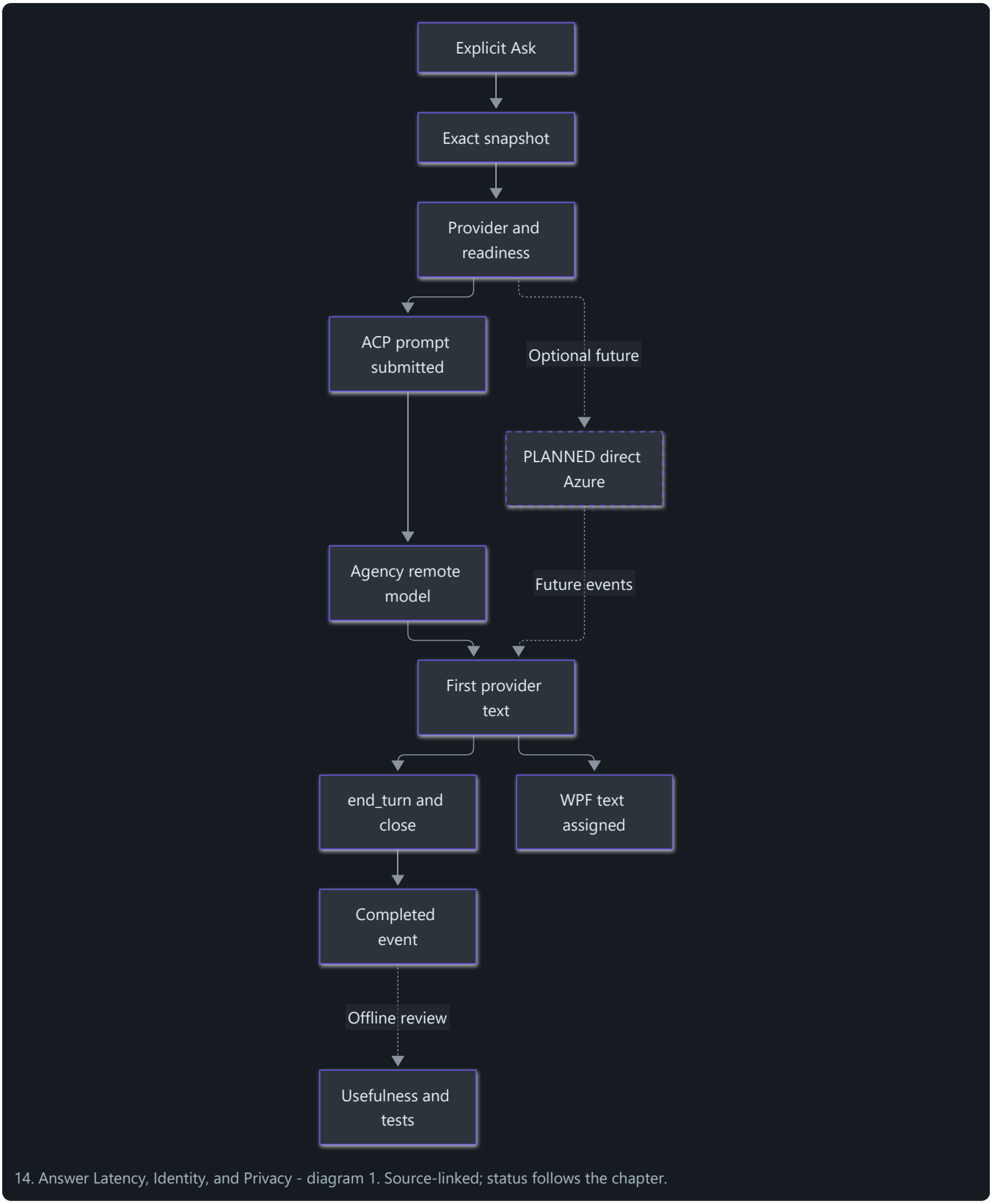
The older Sonnet marker receipt remains connectivity evidence, not a useful-answer baseline. The completed authorized ledger records **48 client question submissions**, including failed/superseded trials; hidden upstream retries are not observable and no further model calls are planned. Agency **2026.10.7.4** / Copilot **1.0.92** now defaults to `gpt-5.6-sol-fast` **/ low**, selected after catalog discovery and actual exact-text trials. No local model was installed; that alternative still has mocks only. (tools\AgencyProbe\results\summary-final.json:2-31, scope/accounting/selection; tools\AgencyProbe\results\summary-final.json:197-224, catalog and isolation.)

Latency, identity and privacy interact. Surprise sign-in delays the answer and introduces an external surface outside capture protection. A whole-transcript prompt violates selected-text scope; retrying partial output can duplicate disclosure and spending. The useful objective remains **an answer to an explicitly frozen question**, not merely an early network byte. The existing Azure design expresses those principles, which the new provider path must preserve. (docs\AI-ANSWER-PRIVACY.md:32-45, authentication flow; docs\AI-ANSWER-PRIVACY.md:117-136, application safeguards; docs\AI-ANSWER-EVALUATION.md:33-43, user-visible metrics.)

The baseline keeps ASR local and permits provider text egress only at explicit configured Ask. Optional cloud audio is a separate decision; good answer performance cannot authorize uploading PCM. Source commit29 remains planned but does not block asking a reviewed draft. (docs\AI-ANSWER-PRIVACY.md:11-25, proposed default; TODO\36_OPTIONAL_AZURE_SPEECH.todo:13-25, separate cloud-audio gate.)

# Measurement architecture: name every boundary

A duration is meaningful only when both endpoints are defined. The evaluation plan uses one local monotonic clock for client observations, retaining source-relative sample positions as a separate coordinate system. Subtracting a server wall clock from a desktop clock is not a defensible latency measurement without a synchronization model. (docs\AI-ANSWER-EVALUATION.md:10-31, stage-clock definitions.)




14. Answer Latency, Identity, and Privacy - diagram 1. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

The diagram describes configured Agency, not automatic dispatch in SnapshotOnly. The earlier evaluation's N4 means actual rendering; current `FirstAnswerVisible` instrumentation means assignment to a visible WPF control, **not measured paint or a recipient frame**. Keep them distinct. Likewise, ACP `ModelStarted` means prompt submission, not the remote model's internal compute start. HTTP headers N2 and planned commit acknowledgment Q2 are not text. (docs\AI-ANSWER-EVALUATION.md:22-31, Q/N events.) See diagnostic event semantics.

| Metric | Definition | What it answers |
|---|---|---|
| First visible partial | A4 − A0 | How soon a controlled utterance becomes visible |
| Natural-final lag | Final A4 − annotated A1 | How much delay follows the last spoken sample |
| Commit latency | Q2 − Q0 | How long explicit finalization takes |
| Provider first-text delay | N3 − explicitly named provider start | State whether engine/session preparation is included; ACP submission is not HTTP start |
| Ask-to-first-text | N4 − Q0 | Delay the user experiences after Ask |
| First useful sentence | N5 − Q0 | When a task-relevant answer becomes usable |

These definitions are not interchangeable benchmarks. Stage/process metadata now exists, but does not measure every proposed endpoint. Separate startup, session preparation, credentials, model loading and response. Paced Vosk numbers start at stream onset and cannot replace an A1 annotation. (docs\AI-ANSWER-EVALUATION.md:33-43, metrics; docs\SPEECH-BENCHMARK.md:111-123, paced-test limits.)

### Current local mechanisms that affect future measurements

The production callback splits delivered packets into bounded frames under the input audio lock. Silence scheduling shares that lock and follows per-source activity, so device delivery and inserted continuity samples must remain distinguishable from acoustic speech boundaries. `SilenceCadence` waits for 250 ms without a packet and spaces silence scheduling by at least 100 ms; that is **not** a recognizer endpoint-silence setting. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:234-278, `OnAudio`; src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:313-333, `SupplySilenceAsync`; src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\SilenceCadence.cs:11-19, `TrySchedule`.)

The Vosk wrapper's sample counter advances when `accept` processes PCM. It supports partials, natural finals, and periodic decoder replacement. Meanwhile, the transport separately maintains submitted-byte counts and bounded pending queues. Combining these different counters into one generic “audio latency” field would conceal where time was spent. (services\transcription\recognizer.py:96-110, `VoskRecognizer.accept`, `finish`; src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:13-18, queue limits; src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:194-237, `TryEnqueueAudio`.)

## Current useful-answer evidence

The visual cover can receive an entire answer while the workspace is detached. Such delivery is not logged as **FirstAnswerVisible** until the answer control becomes visible on Uncover. Receiving data and presenting it remain different timestamps; the metric still does not prove pixel presentation or recipient visibility. (Current renderer, cover fixture.)

The owner's criterion is **a complete useful answer in under five seconds**, not a token, filler or a promise to investigate. An initial mini trial reached first text around 2.946 s but completed at 5.377 s: it missed. Final H selected `gpt-5.6-sol-fast` / low on **complete answers and compiled correctness**, not TTFT alone. (tools\AgencyProbe\results\summary.json:29-40, historical mini timing.)

| H prepared trial | Exact text category | First provider text | Complete, session closed |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Owner's intended question | 1.868 s | **4.066 s** |
| 2 | Owner-supplied actual ASR wording | 2.473 s | **4.176 s** |
| 3 | Repeated intended question | 1.016 s | **2.992 s** |

The intended text was “Write me the solution for the leet code problem two sum”; the ASR text was “okay so right mean the solution for the lead good problem to some”. All three answers gave the Two Sum algorithm, complete C# and complexity without a follow-up; the ASR case labelled its interpretation as an assumption. **All three compiled implementations passed 33/33 checks**, including duplicates, indices, negative/zero values, no-pair cases and full-range overflow boundaries. These were supplied text inputs, not newly recorded speech. (tools\AgencyProbe\results\latency-suite-20261009-h-exact-fast.json:2-56, exact trials; tools\AgencyProbe\results\latency-suite-20261009-h-quality.json:2-186, compiled checks.)

## Preparation is real work, not a hidden free operation

H's first empty-session preparation took **19.987 s**, excluded from its 4.066-second first answer. Residual preparation before trials 2/3 was **396/483 ms**; adding it gives **4.572/3.475 s**, still below five seconds for those two observations. A separate selected-default preparation receipt records **21.183 s**, zero questions and no model prompt. **Normal startup/reveal deliberately uses `WarmUpAsync` to prepare one empty session** before the app advertises readiness; that is allowed preparation, not automatic Ask. See the lifetime owner. (tools\AgencyProbe\results\latency-suite-20261009-h-exact-fast.json:13-54, preparation and completion; tools\AgencyProbe\results\agency-selected-fast-default-preparation.json:2-16, zero-question preparation.)

The separate `WarmUpTransportAsync` stops before session creation. Its first-Ask cost was **5.041 s** on Haiku F and **6.470 s** on mini G; that boundary is **unmeasured on the final fast model**. Historical Haiku E took **24.874 s** from cold through completion. None of these is an under-five-second cold guarantee. H explicitly selected the fast model before its promotion to default, so its assembly receipt is also not a timing measurement of a subsequently rebuilt WPF package. (tools\AgencyProbe\results\summary-final.json:58-73, cold/transport boundaries; tools\AgencyProbe\results\summary-final.json:234-271, assembly and qualification limits.)

## Keep unsuccessful evidence beside the selected result

| Earlier batch | Retained result and why it was insufficient |
|---|---|
| A–B, mini | Slow/generic or missing-input answers; not useful-answer passes. |
| C, mini | Explicit SYSTEM-role selection still left fast nonanswers. |
| D, Haiku | Fast responses, but eight overflow failures: only 58/66 checks passed. |
| E, Haiku | Five prepared original-variation answers in 2.928–3.748 s and 66/66 checks; **not owner ASR**. |
| F, exact Haiku | Two wrong-problem guesses, one follow-up footer and three completions over five seconds. |

| Earlier batch | Retained result and why it was insufficient |
|---|---|
| G, exact mini | All six understood Two Sum, but ten wider-range overflow checks failed; the first transport-only Ask was slow. |

E's ambiguous control was **"Explain to some problem and give optimal solution."**, not the actual owner-supplied ASR string. G's boundary failures were against the required full-int policy, beyond usual constrained LeetCode inputs. Neither historical speed nor correct title selection alone established the complete contract that H's three samples passed. (tools\AgencyProbe\results\latency-suite-20261009-e-haiku.json:9-95, E inputs/timing; tools\AgencyProbe\results\latency-suite-20261009-e-quality.json:28-364, E correctness; tools\AgencyProbe\results\latency-suite-20261009-f-exact.json:2-98, retained exact-text failures; tools\AgencyProbe\results\summary-final.json:109-180, A–H comparison; tools\AgencyProbe\results\latency-suite-20261009-g-quality.json:361-364, G check totals.)

This is **provider-API evidence**, not a WPF, live-voice, recipient or p95 benchmark. H contains only three prepared samples and **one** actual-ASR-text case. It supports the selected profile, not a universal SLO, broad prompt accuracy or speech-recognition quality.

# Other targets remain hypotheses

The later, explicitly requested Clarify first loop adds one request for interpretation and another for each correction or final confirmation. It is off by default. Neither the earlier three prepared direct-answer timings nor a synthetic UI pass establishes its end-to-end latency. Its optional history contains only the current clarification conversation, not telemetry, unselected transcript or a resumed provider session.

The proposed warm-path budgets are starting points for authorization and measurement:

| Planned metric | Proposed target |
|---|---|
| Freeze reviewed draft | At most 50 ms |
| Source commit to frozen text | p95 at most 500 ms |
| First visible partial | p95 at most 1.5 s |
| Ask to first rendered answer | p50 at most 1 s; p95 at most 2.5 s |
| Ask to useful short sentence | p50 at most 2 s; p95 at most 4 s |
| Local cancellation acknowledgment | At most 100 ms |
| Stream UI batching | 16–50 ms |

None is a provider SLA or measured result. The common UI currently chooses a **40-ms render timer** and **120-second overall deadline**; neither demonstrates first-text performance or exact scheduling. End-to-end p95 must come from complete observations, not summed stage p95s. Keep cold/warm CLI, credential and model cases separate. (docs\AI-ANSWER-EVALUATION.md:45-62, proposed targets; docs\AI-ANSWER-EVALUATION.md:101-115, controlled comparison.) The current integration choices are described in the provider guide.

A fair model comparison fixes question content, output requirements, deployment/version, processing policy, and filtering. It preserves errors, filtered outcomes, and incomplete answers rather than dropping slow or unsuccessful samples. A ten-word non-answer must not win against a correct explanation simply by finishing sooner. (docs\AI-ANSWER-EVALUATION.md:97-119, Azure comparison.)

The Azure research shortlist—5.4-mini, 5.4-nano and 5-mini—is not an Agency/CLI model list, speed ranking or entitlement receipt. Hidden reasoning can consume output budgets before visible text appears. Azure asynchronous filtering can expose text before delayed moderation; do not transfer those API-specific assumptions to Agency or a local server. (docs\AI-ANSWER-RESEARCH.md:139-161, candidates; docs\AI-ANSWER-RESEARCH.md:222-236, reasoning budget and filtering.)

# Agency identity: existing model access is not organization-data access

`AnswerConfiguration` separates `answers.json` metadata from CLI-profile state, bounds the settings file and rejects unknown fields/numeric enum values. The corrected mode adds `AnswerSettings.AgencyPath`; parsing its executable path does not establish existing model authentication, policy eligibility or isolation. No new login is authorized by this setup change. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\Answers\AnswerConfiguration.cs:8-29, `Load`; src\PhantomFudge.Core\Answers\AnswerContracts.cs:16-43, `AnswerSettings`.)

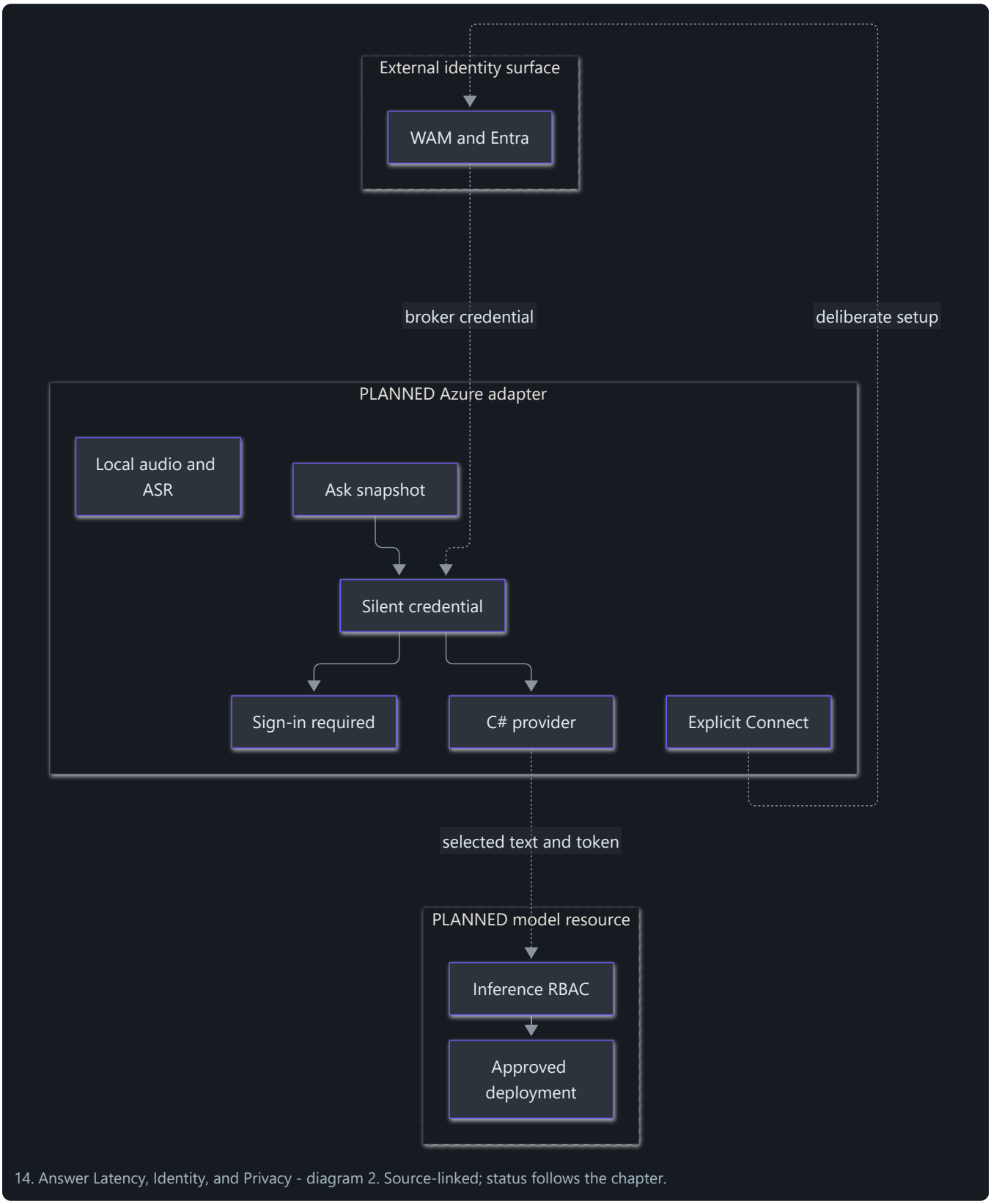
`Initialize-Answers.ps1 -Provider Agency` resolves the installed executable without login. The pinned persistent ACP launch uses a controlled profile and only the fixed app-owned direct-Q&A agent. Incoming tool/client requests, plans and authentication failures terminate the answer rather than waiting for permission or opening app-owned login. Existing credentials may expire; supported launch and observed no-login runs do not prove universal popup/browser suppression. Existing model-service authentication does not authorize organization-data connectors. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\Answers\AgencyAcpConnection.cs:213-265, request/update guards.) See current setup boundaries.

LocalModel remains a separate compatible Copilot-engine OFFLINE/BYOK route, not an Agency-hosted call. It requires an explicit model and HTTP literal-loopback `/v1` endpoint. Rejecting DNS names, remote hosts and credential-bearing URLs protects destination selection, not the behavior of a separately managed proxy/server. No missing model/server may cause hosted-model fallback. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\Answers\AnswerContracts.cs:34-55, local-mode validation.)

**The configured path is not memory-only.** Each question gets a fresh closed conversation, but its engine/workspace can serve up to 32 sessions. Owned artifacts are removed on teardown; prompt/session files may exist until then, and upstream copies are outside that deletion claim. Hide/Clear/protection/reload/close stop the cached owner; successful completion instead prepares another **empty** session. “ExactText only” excludes unrelated application content, not the controlled SYSTEM policy, fixed user-message instructions or service metadata. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\Answers\AgencyAcpConnection.cs:41-122, session lifecycle; src\PhantomFudge.Core\Answers\AgencyAnswerPrompt.cs:8-97, fixed policy/envelope; tools\AgencyProbe\results\summary-final.json:210-224, retention limits.)

# PLANNED direct Azure identity: explicit setup, silent Ask

The desktop is a **public client**. It cannot safely protect a distributed application secret, so the plan uses a tenant-bound Entra user identity through supported MSAL/WAM or broker integration. The registration's client ID is not a secret; API keys, private keys, and refresh tokens must not be bundled into the EXE, Python service, configuration, or ZIP. (docs\AI-ANSWER-PRIVACY.md:27-36, desktop identity.)




14. Answer Latency, Identity, and Privacy - diagram 2. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

The isolated audio node is intentional: there is no raw-audio cloud edge. In this **future Azure adapter**, interactive authentication would occur only through explicit setup; Ask would try cached/silent acquisition and surface sign-in-required inline. These are not claims that the installed CLI already implements WAM or shares an Azure credential cache. (docs\AI-ANSWER-PRIVACY.md:35-45, silent/interactive separation.)

Resource-scoped **Cognitive Services OpenAI User** is the researched inference role for the documented Azure OpenAI path. Management Contributor is not a substitute for data-plane permission, and this feature needs no Graph chat/mail permissions. The exact token audience depends on the pinned adapter: the research records v1's `https://ai.azure.com/.default`, while ARM uses a different audience. Those strings are integration inputs to verify, not evidence that any local account has access. A laptop does not acquire an Azure managed identity merely by using Azure libraries. (docs\AI-ANSWER-PRIVACY.md:46-67, RBAC and token audiences.)

# Privacy is several contracts, not one switch

For future Azure Responses, `store:false` avoids the requested storage behavior; it is **not universal zero retention**, nor a switch applied to the current CLI. Existing research distinguishes training restrictions, service state, abuse monitoring and geography. Flagged content may enter automated/human review; modified monitoring requires separate eligibility and approval. (docs\AI-ANSWER-PRIVACY.md:88-112, data statements and limits.)

Global deployments may process prompts in supported geographies; a DataZone constrains processing to its zone, not necessarily one resource region. Therefore a nearby resource name proves neither locality nor low latency. Destination, deployment type, retention policy, and account configuration require explicit approval before a cloud test. (docs\AI-ANSWER-PRIVACY.md:102-115, geography; TODO\30_AZURE_ANSWER_CONNECTION.todo:13-22, connection prerequisites.)

Local behavior needs equally precise language:

- The current transport rejects nonliteral-loopback ASR endpoints and disables proxying and redirects. CLI inference and any future HTTPS Azure client are **separate** boundaries, not reasons to relax speech validation. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:26-31, HTTP handler; src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:82-98, `ValidateEndpoint`.)
- Remote speech errors are replaced with a generic local message because server text may contain paths, secrets, or transcript content. The answer adapter should preserve that principle while distinguishing useful safe error codes. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:406-414, `ProcessMessage`; docs\AI-ANSWER-PRIVACY.md:128-134, diagnostics.)
- Application transcript/answer buffers are bounded and Copy/export is explicit. This does not make the external CLI memory-only. App diagnostics should use random IDs, durations, counts and safe result codes, not content or content hashes. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\TranscriptBuffer.cs:6-8, `MaximumCharacters`; src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:828-855, `ExportTranscriptAsync`; docs\AI-ANSWER-PRIVACY.md:130-136, logging/persistence.)
- `ShowProtected` requests protection before showing the window, but neither it nor the same-HWND answer view guarantees exclusion from every recorder. Authentication surfaces, clipboard, profiles and process memory have separate boundaries. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:99-129, `ShowProtected`; docs\PRODUCT.md:184-200, privacy boundaries.)

`LocalDiagnostics` now defaults to metadata-only records: correlation IDs, monotonic/process times, durations, counts and safe codes. Its nonblocking bounded queue must not stall capture or UI; files rotate with bounded retention. Bodies require explicit `RecordContent` opt-in, and Clear does not delete existing diagnostic files. Do not inspect or export logs casually to demonstrate the feature. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\Diagnostics\LocalDiagnostics.cs:9-24, metadata fields; src\PhantomFudge.Core\Diagnostics\LocalDiagnostics.cs:40-111, queue/rotation; src\PhantomFudge.Core\Diagnostics\LocalDiagnostics.cs:145-184, default and content opt-in.)

The provider receives a new request ID and `ExactText`, never `SourceRefs`; the richer snapshot remains on the run for local association. Only explicitly enabled clarification may attach its bounded typed exchange history and fixed task instruction. The 32,768-code-unit answer cap is a memory/display boundary, not a token or retention guarantee. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\Answers\AnswerContracts.cs:3-12, request interface; src\PhantomFudge.Core\Answers\AnswerRun.cs:10-27, projection; src\PhantomFudge.Core\Answers\AnswerRun.cs:46-50, output cap.)

# Worked pseudocode: useful timing without content telemetry

This teaching sketch distinguishes implemented metadata from a **future measured paint acknowledgment**. Current `FirstAnswerVisible` stops at control assignment; the stronger `renderer.present_bounded_batch` contract below is not yet a pixel measurement. Usefulness and compiled-answer checks remain separate evaluation.

```
async def measure_explicit_ask(draft, selected_provider):
    q0 = monotonic()
    snapshot = freeze_exact_displayed_revision(draft)
    if selected_provider.is_snapshot_only:
        return snapshot
    run = AnswerRun(snapshot, selected_provider.label)
    # Existing model authentication only; no new login or interactive fallback.
    n1 = monotonic()
    first_delta = None
    first_render = None
    try:
        async for event in selected_provider.stream(run.Request, deadline_token):
            if run.Apply(event) and event.is_text_delta:
                first_delta = first_delta or monotonic()
                await renderer.present_bounded_batch(run.Text)
                first_render = first_render or monotonic()
        run.Complete()  # request enumeration ended; ACP engine can remain alive
    except Cancelled:
        run.Cancel()
    except SafeProviderFailure as error:
        run.Fail(error.safe_message)
    emit_metadata(run.Request.RequestId, run.State,
                  provider_first_text=elapsed_or_missing(n1, first_delta),
                  ask_to_render=elapsed_or_missing(q0, first_render))
```

`Apply` rejects nonmonotonic and post-terminal events; `Complete` requires the marker plus nonblank text. No automatic retry is added by retaining a warm engine. Cancel/Hide/Clear/protection failure/close must await owned cleanup, leaving retained text incomplete. Local cancellation cannot promise stopped remote compute or billing. (docs\AI-ANSWER-ARCHITECTURE.md:507-610, event identity/completion; docs\AI-ANSWER-ARCHITECTURE.md:643-670, failure policy; TODO\31_STREAMING_ANSWER_CLIENT.todo:18-20, adapter requirements.) Common state behavior is implemented in (src\PhantomFudge.Core\Answers\AnswerRun.cs:32-79, `Apply`, `Complete`, `Cancel`, `Fail`).

For a hypothetical trace, Ask at 0 ms, provider dispatch at 70 ms, first text at 480 ms and rendering at 510 ms give 410 ms dispatch-to-text and 510 ms user-visible delay. They are **invented teaching numbers**, not CLI/API measurements. Only an observed HTTP-start boundary permits calling the first value HTTP TTFT. (docs\AI-ANSWER-EVALUATION.md:37-40, metric definitions.)

# Tradeoffs: optimize the critical path without hiding failures

UI batching avoids a dispatcher operation per tiny delta. A 40-ms timer within the earlier 16–50-ms tuning range is not permission for unbounded provider buffering, nor proof every frame appears within 40 ms. A process that emits metadata without answer text must not appear successful or run without bounds. (docs\AI-ANSWER-ARCHITECTURE.md:643-670, batching and deadlines; docs\AI-ANSWER-EVALUATION.md:57-62, no-progress policy.)

A future Azure broker may enforce central quotas/private routing but adds an authentication and streaming hop. APIM buffering and body diagnostics require review because they can defeat streaming or expose content. Neither broker nor direct Azure is required for the installed-CLI path, and neither was provisioned here. (docs\AI-ANSWER-PRIVACY.md:69-86, optional broker and APIM; TODO\37_OPTIONAL_ANSWER_BROKER.todo:28-34, completion evidence.)

# Exercises

1. Design a fake-stream case with headers, metadata, one text delta, and a post-200 error. Identify the timing fields and incomplete UI state. (docs\AI-ANSWER-EVALUATION.md:128-134, failure matrix.)
2. Explain why a 403 must not trigger another region or public-network fallback, even if that alternative appears faster. (docs\AI-ANSWER-EVALUATION.md:130-132, network/auth failure policy.)
3. Review a proposed diagnostic payload containing a prompt hash. Replace it with fields that support correlation without identifying question content. (docs\AI-ANSWER-PRIVACY.md:130-134, metadata-only diagnostics.)
4. Cancel a local-model run after its first delta. List which app, CLI-profile and model-server copies may remain; explain why terminating the local process is not a universal deletion guarantee. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\Answers\AnswerRun.cs:65-79, local terminal state; src\PhantomFudge.Core\Answers\AnswerConfiguration.cs:8-11, separate profile.)

# References

- Evaluation plan, privacy/identity design, and research.

- Connection workstream and privacy/resilience gate.
- Installed-provider setup and retention and common run implementation.
- Diagnostics semantics, final ACP summary, H exact-text timings and H correctness.
- Existing research primary URLs: Azure data privacy, abuse monitoring, and MSAL.NET WAM. These were not freshly retrieved or verified against an account for this chapter.

# Development and testing

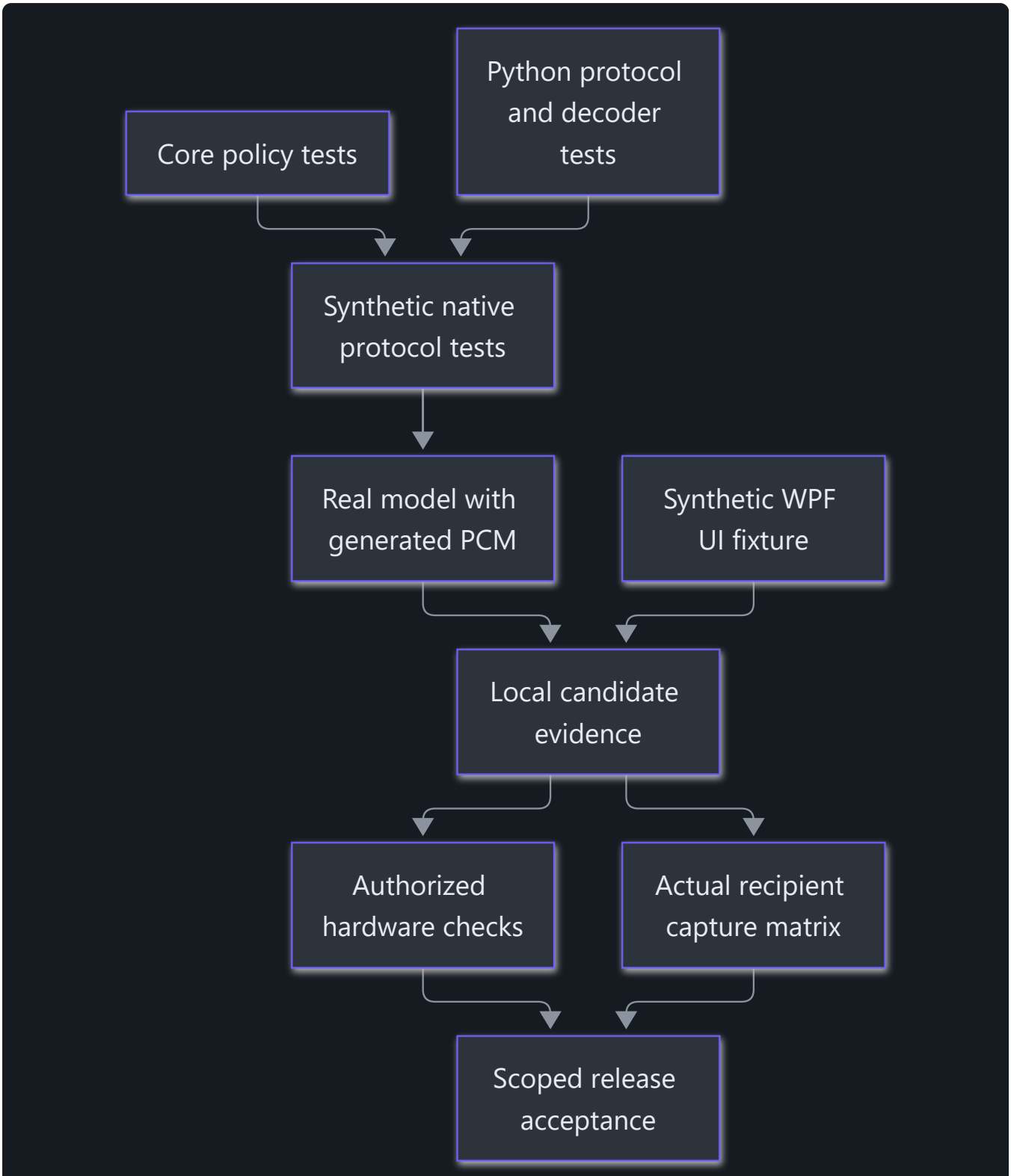
> **TL;DR:** There is no single command that proves the whole product. Build/unit tests, transport tests, real-model synthetic tests, UI fixtures, hardware tests and recipient-side capture qualification each establish different evidence. Run the smallest relevant layer, then cross the next boundary deliberately.

## Overview: reproducibility starts before a test assertion

The repository pins .NET SDK10.0.112 with patch roll-forward and prerelease disabled (`global.json:1-7`). Common build properties enable nullable references, implicit usings, deterministic builds, warnings as errors and dependency lock files (`Directory.Build.props:1-9`). These choices make local differences easier to diagnose; they do not eliminate differences in Windows, drivers or external capture applications.

Python dependencies are pinned separately from the .NET graph (`services\transcription\requirements.txt:1-20`). The service uses a local virtual environment. Do not install packages globally because a test needs them, and do not add Docker as a shortcut around understanding the native setup.

## Architecture of the test portfolio




15 - Development and Testing - diagram 1. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

This is not a strict test-pyramid claim. Some layers run independently. The diagram shows how evidence accumulates before a broad release claim, not a requirement to rerun every test for every prose edit.

# The real runners

| Layer | Command | What it establishes |
|---|---|---|
| Native build | `dotnet build .\PhantomFudge.slnx -c Release` | Compiler/project consistency |
| Core xUnit | `dotnet test .\tests\PhantomFudge.Core.Tests -c Release` | Text, source, palette and persistence policies |
| Audio console harness | `dotnet run --project .\tests\PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests -c Release` | Synthetic transport/native-lifecycle cases |
| Python unittest | `.\services\transcription\.venv\Scripts\python.exe -m unittest discover -s .\services\transcription\tests` | Server/decoder/management cases |
| Dual real-model fixture | `.\scripts\Test-DualSourceSynthetic.ps1 -NativeClient` | Generated PCM through C# v2 and actual local recognition |
| UI fixture | `PhantomFudge.exe --ui-smoke <private-output>` | Local synthetic rendering/state assertions |
| Documentation views | `.\scripts\Export-HandbookScreenshots.ps1` | Actual UI images with synthetic labels/content and source hashes |

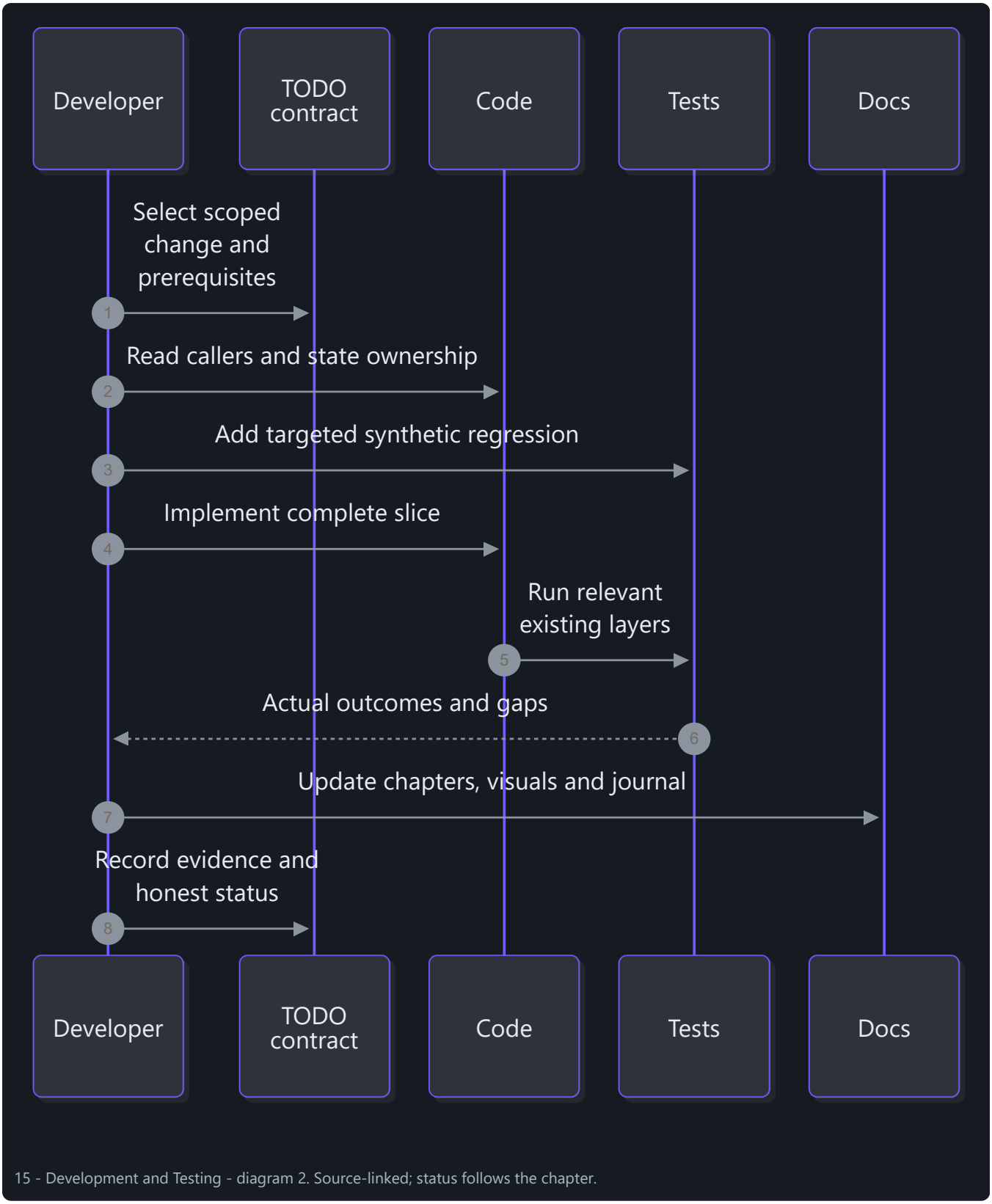
The Core project is an xUnit test project with explicit test SDK/runner references (`tests\PhantomFudge.Core.Tests\PhantomFudge.Core.Tests.csproj:1-30`). The audio project is an **executable harness**, not another xUnit assembly; it links the actual audio sources and references ASP.NET Core for local test servers (`tests\PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests\PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests.csproj:1-13`). Do not assume `dotnet test` alone executes its scenarios.

# Safe setup

The initialization script verifies the model manifest, creates a random local token if absent, restricts its Windows ACL, and creates/repairs the service-local Python environment as needed. Model download is explicit; it is not performed silently while handling live audio (`scripts\Initialize-Transcription.ps1:21-53`, `:65-140`).

Use the documented setup command once, then ordinary builds/runs. Existing lock files should be respected. If a restore fails, inspect the actual failure rather than changing TLS settings or switching to an unapproved feed. A shell HTTP probe and the .NET restore stack can behave differently; the development record already contains such a distinction.

## The developer loop




15 - Development and Testing - diagram 2. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

A useful test is tied to an invariant. "The app launches" would not have caught a late final poisoning the next session's IDs. A source-partial test that proves one track's final leaves the other pending text intact is much stronger for that specific requirement (`tests\PhantomFudge.Core.Tests\SourceTranscriptTests.cs:1-80`).

# Working on a shared Windows desktop

An agent or test must not kill a running user's app to overwrite a locked executable. Build to an isolated output directory or create a new candidate. The native lifecycle script refuses to touch a preexisting PhantomFudge process and tracks only the processes it starts (`scripts\Test-NativeLifecycle.ps1:16-22`, `:69-113`).

Avoid parallel .NET commands that write the same project `obj` tree. Parallel research or independent Python checks are fine; two builds of the same Core project can race on generated cache files even when they use different final output directories. Compile once, then use `--no-build` where appropriate for follow-up checks.

The documentation fixture must never use real notes or chat content. It has its own command line path and validates a synthetic/no-recording result before copying images (`src\PhantomFudge.App\App.xaml.cs:47-59`, `scripts\Export-HandbookScreenshots.ps1:1-94`). A screenshot request is not authorization to capture a meeting or disable display affinity.

# Failure tests worth keeping

The native harness covers authentication, framing, cancellation, bounded queues and delayed shutdown. Its entry point reports named groups and returns failure on a failing group (`tests\PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests\Program.cs:18-71`). Tests must also cover the interaction between layers: a fake device can fail after another input has started, or a final can arrive while UI Stop is still awaiting cleanup.

Python tests use injected recognizers for deterministic failure cases, while separate real-model fixtures prove that the production decoder can recognize generated speech. A fake recognizer is appropriate for protocol determinism, not evidence of speech accuracy. Conversely, one recognized synthetic sentence does not prove every cancellation path.

# Interpreting results

Record source identity, environment, exact command, pass/failure, sample size and limitations. The implementation-status document is a bounded receipt, not a badge that everything is safe (`docs\IMPLEMENTATION-STATUS.md:1-279`).

For capture, an in-process `RenderTargetBitmap` image proves UI appearance. A cropped GDI fixture proves only the sampled local path. Neither proves what a remote participant sees. Run an intentionally unprotected positive control only outside a live presentation; it is supposed to be capturable.

# Contributor exercises

1. Locate the normal audio harness dispatch and explain why it does not open hardware.
2. Identify which tests should change when a source label is added.
3. Explain why a successful model fixture cannot replace a malformed-frame test.
4. Write the expected sequence for Start, immediate Stop, then another Start.

5. Choose the smallest checks for a theme-only change versus a protocol change.

# References

- `global.json:1-7` — SDK pin.
- `Directory.Build.props:1-9` — common build rules.
- `tests\PhantomFudge.Core.Tests\PhantomFudge.Core.Tests.csproj:1-30` — xUnit runner.
- `tests\PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests\PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests.csproj:1-13` — executable harness.
- `tests\PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests\Program.cs:18-71` — synthetic group execution.
- `scripts\Initialize-Transcription.ps1:21-165` — environment/model/token setup.
- `scripts\Test-NativeLifecycle.ps1:16-113` — owned-process testing.
- `docs\QUALIFICATION.md:1-26` — evidence separation.

# Distribution and troubleshooting

> **TL;DR:** Use Installation for the Windows11 x64 installer. It bundles runtime/models and adds guarded update/uninstall; the older source/setup ZIP is a different workflow. Consult the versioned release for available downloads and exact identities. Neither distribution promises that every machine or recorder is supported.

## Installer versus development bundle

The new recipe publishes the app and native launcher self-contained, assembles an offline speech runtime/model payload and emits versioned Setup, optional Portable ZIP and checksums. The target is `v0.2.0-preview.1` / Windows version `0.2.0.1`, unsigned and private-repository scoped. End users do not need PowerShell7, a system Python or the .NET SDK. Builds require actual generated-PCM inference and natural process exit, separately from import and dependency-metadata checks. (scripts/Build-Installer.ps1:30-44,76-114) (tools/Installer/release.json:1-8)

The Inno recipe is per-user, uses a stable AppId, rejects downgrades and unrecognized nonempty destinations, and gates update/uninstall on maintenance. Repair/update uses a fresh self-contained helper directory extracted from Setup rather than a potentially corrupted old launcher. Lifecycle3 passed the current candidate's isolated repair/lifecycle fixture. Uninstall invokes the installed launcher. `WindowsVersion` under `HKCU\Software\PhantomFudge\Installer\<AppId>` is the fallback for a damaged version file. It does not force-close an app. Save/export, stop capture and close with X first. External user settings, diagnostics and saved files are retained; do not save personal content inside managed program directories. The canonical guide explains the directory and retention policy. (tools/Installer/PhantomFudge.iss:10-40,47-65,107-161) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/Program.cs:50-58,94-100) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/MaintenanceOperation.cs:48-118)

The repository remains private, so a GitHub prerelease is available only to permitted readers. The owner authorized this prerelease work without making it a qualified release or selecting a project license. Unsigned-policy blocks must be respected, not bypassed. Exact hashes, lifecycle tests and publication state belong in implementation status, not inferred from this build recipe.

Setup never launches the app. Finish and close it, then open Phantom Fudge from Start. Setup and launcher status/error windows are ordinary visible UI, not capture-excluded; install and launch before sharing. (tools/Installer/PhantomFudge.iss:14-76) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/LauncherWindow.cs:18-57)

If an ordinary or notes-only launch detects the installer gate, it returns70 with generic “operation busy” status, without opening a launcher window or starting a child. Let Setup finish and retry rather than deleting ownership files. The gate is checked before existing-instance reveal and again after acquiring the startup mutex; maintenance and layout validation bypass it. (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/Program.cs:25-78,240-244) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/LauncherContract.cs:152-165) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/LauncherStatus.cs:15,34)

App startup is not proven by surviving a short delay. The launcher retains its operation mutex until the main app mutex appears or the exact child exits. Status76 after30seconds is pending, not success; Close hides progress without releasing that guard, even if the dispatcher shuts down early. Uncertain liveness stays protected rather than authorizing replacement or process killing. (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/ChildProcesses.cs:12-42) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/Program.cs:108-118,186-227)

## Inventory and repair evidence are different checks

The final runtime is not a copy of the developer's venv: it uses pinned embedded CPython3.13.14, `faster-whisper 1.2.1+phantomfudge1` for PCM-only input and `CTranslate2 4.6.0+phantomfudge2` with oneDNN3.1.1/Microsoft compiler OpenMP (`vcomp140`). It excludes CUDA/cuDNN/proprietary Intel OpenMP and PyAV/FFmpeg. Variants/notices are listed in third-party notices. The parent confirms85 focused runtime tests; the final offline rebuild passes real generated-PCM hybrid inference, production VAD, forced Whisper encoder/decoder execution and natural exit, repeated after Unicode relocation. Vosk's unmodified package uses a first-party startup adapter for non-ASCII Windows model paths. The older Ruy stages failed at process exit and remain rejected; metadata closure alone describes only the modified installed graph and cannot establish execution. No actual capture, service, provider request or clean-VM test was performed by this runtime qualification. Final redistribution/provenance review remains separate from the passing lifecycle fixture, and existing development speech measurements must not be inherited by this different binary set. See dated runtime evidence for the exact payload identity. (tools/Installer/runtime-lock.json:1-11) (tools/Installer/bundle_runtime.py:246-282,332-376,412-462,538-609) (services/transcription/recognizer.py:44-63) (services/transcription/tests/test_packaged_pcm_runtime.py:35-97,126-138)

Fresh-machine confidence needs more than a restricted `PATH`. The frozen builder now checks PE normal/delay imports and exported forwarder DLL names against bundled files or a reviewed Windows11 inbox list, then observes actual DLL paths in its import and synthetic-PCM probes. The parent reports 92 speech PE files and five bundled CRT paths passing, plus a separate static pass over 861 app/launcher PE files. The final DLL-qualified runtime rebuild has passed this stronger gate and recorded new provenance; functional DLLs are reported unchanged from candidate2. Neither static closure nor these selected loaded-module observations are a clean-VM or universal dynamic-loading test. (tools/Installer/bundle_runtime.py:677-694) (tools/Installer/runtime_audit.py:126-166,169-234) (services/transcription/tests/test_packaged_pcm_runtime.py:14,88-97)

The launcher consumes compact `install-manifest.json` metadata with a16KiB size bound, while `payload-files.json` lists full payload paths, lengths and SHA-256 values. Separating them prevents the large runtime inventory from invalidating ordinary startup. The inventory includes the compact manifest but excludes its own self-hash. `Build-Installer` enumerates hidden files/directories and rejects reparse points and private payload paths before writing the inventory. (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/LauncherContract.cs:38-52,94-105) (scripts/Build-Installer.ps1:56-98)

`Test-Installer.ps1` defines an isolated fixture with a random AppId and a separate installation path; shortcut creation is omitted and Setup has no launch action. It compares the inventory's filenames with the payload exactly, then checks installed lengths/hashes. Repair, damaged-launcher/version record recovery, downgrade

rejection, uninstall and a retained synthetic external file are distinct assertions. The inspected lifecycle3 receipt passes 11 checks for 3,682 inventoried files from the parent's current-runtime candidate2 build. The earlier lifecycle2 result is historical. (scripts/Test-Installer.ps1:15-18,31-84) (tools/Installer/PhantomFudge.iss:62-76)

The “upgrade” case writes an older numeric version record into the current fixture. It does not install a genuine older binary or qualify a clean Windows VM, migration across actual releases, Start-menu behavior or the supported hardware matrix. Lifecycle3's PASS retains those limits. (scripts/Test-Installer.ps1:69-74,96-104)

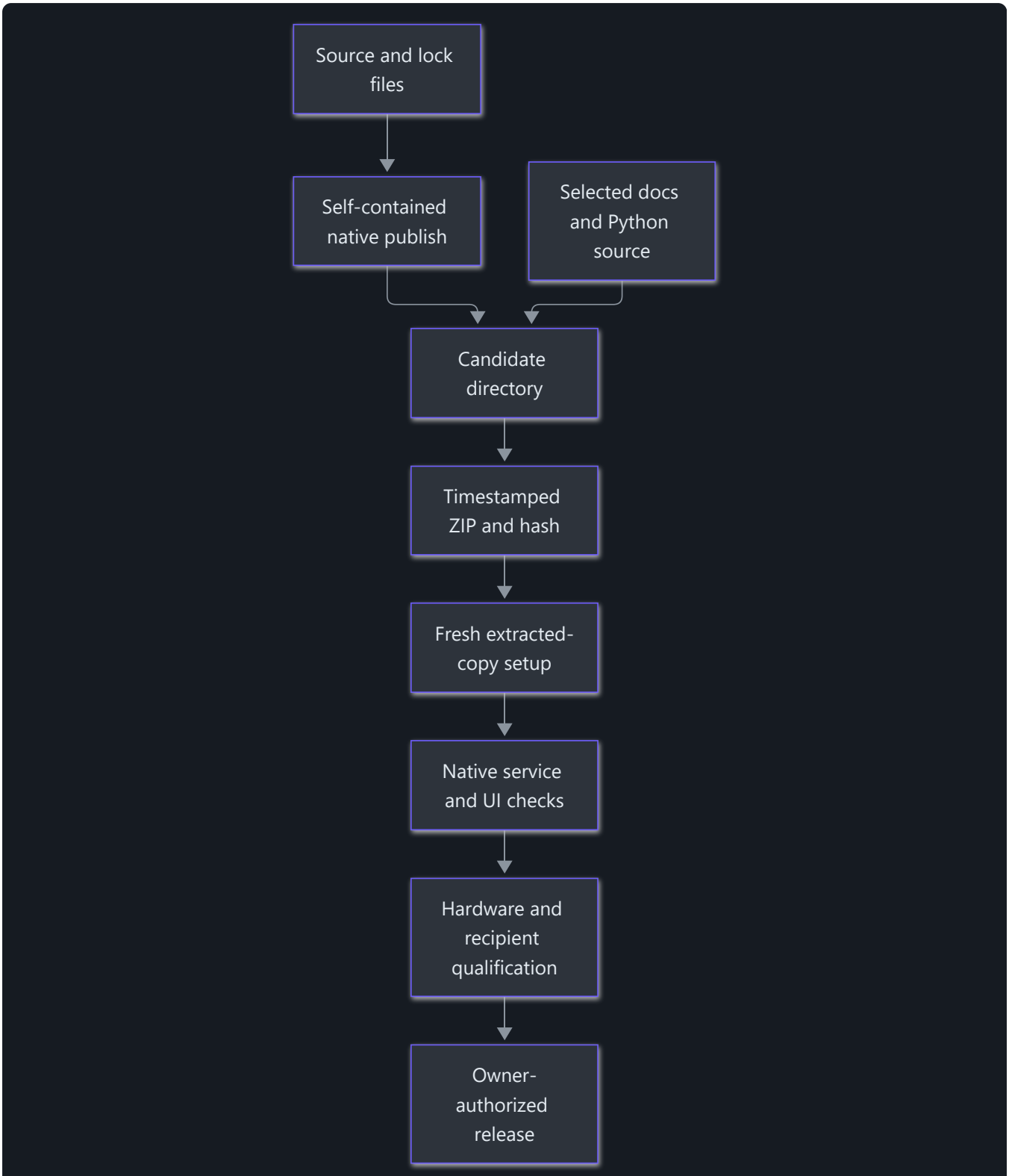
The frozen launcher's separate `--validate-install` mode checks the owned marker, bounded compact manifest and expected file/model-directory layout without invoking the app, Python or inference. Historical pre-gate exact-EXE checks returned0for a synthetic valid layout and65for oversized/corrupt metadata. Placeholder layout validation is not a model-hash, native ABI, executable-launch or full installer-repair test. See current evidence. (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/Program.cs:25-43) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/LauncherContract.cs:87-105) (tests/PhantomFudge.Core.Tests/InstalledMaintenanceTests.cs:210-239)

# Legacy overview: what gets shipped

`Publish-Preview.ps1` builds a self-contained win-x64 application into a timestamped directory, copies a selected documentation/script/service allowlist, and creates a ZIP plus SHA256 output (`scripts\Publish-Preview.ps1:1-52`). The exact list matters: copying the repository wholesale would also risk models, token files, captures, temporary data and unrelated development tooling.

In this legacy ZIP, the native runtime and Python runtime are different dependencies. Self-contained .NET publishing includes the .NET runtime needed by the executable. It does not install Python, create the service's venv or embed either ASR model. Those operations are owned by explicit initialization (`scripts\Initialize-Transcription.ps1:119-165`).

# Legacy candidate-to-qualified-release flow




16 - Distribution and Troubleshooting - diagram 1. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

The final arrows describe qualification, not a prerequisite for honestly labelled experimental prerelease access. They are deliberately not automatic. A passing local smoke test is not signing, distribution authorization, enterprise-policy acceptance or four-product capture qualification. The implementation-status document

identifies the actual local candidate and its remaining boundaries (`docs\IMPLEMENTATION-STATUS.md:1-309`).

## Source checkout versus legacy extracted bundle

The launcher detects whether `PhantomFudge.exe` sits at the root of its working package. If it does, it uses that executable without building. Otherwise it targets the source-build path. An already-running source instance is revealed rather than rebuilt underneath the user (`scripts\Run-PhantomFudge.ps1:8-36`).

| Situation | Correct action | Avoid |
|---|---|---|
| First source setup | Run explicit initialization with model-download permission | Expecting the app to fetch weights during a meeting |
| First extracted bundle | Keep the full folder, then run its setup/launcher | Copying only the EXE away from dependent files |
| Existing app running | Save/close when an update requires replacement, or reveal it | Killing an unknown process to release a file lock |
| Notes-only use | Use the explicit NotesOnly launcher option | Pretending a missing ASR service is healthy |
| Speech service idle | Use its managed Stop command | Broad process-name termination |
| Service active | Stop transcription in the UI first | Discarding queued audio by terminating the backend |

## Legacy setup is intentionally explicit

The initializer checks a pinned archive size/hash and verifies the extracted model files. An existing damaged model is not silently overwritten. Token creation uses random bytes, does not rotate an existing valid token automatically, and restricts the Windows DACL (`scripts\Initialize-Transcription.ps1:26-76`, `:69-109`).

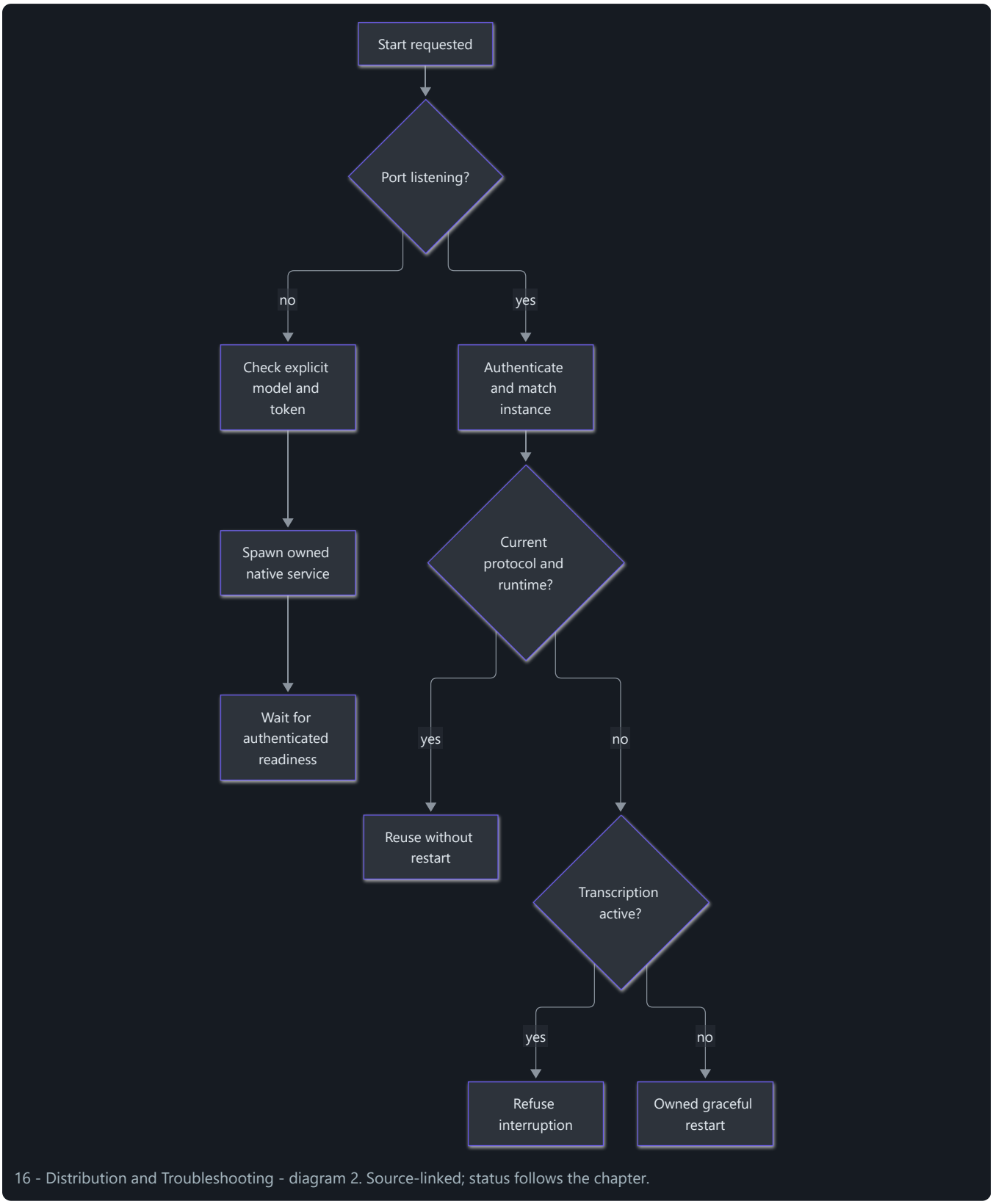
The recorded archive hash is an observed integrity value from a known public download, not a publisher-signed guarantee. That distinction is explained in the service guide (`services\transcription\README.md:140-235`).

Vosk and Whisper models can be reused from verified local caches. The native default is hybrid-whisper/small.en/int8/four threads/technical vocabulary; explicit legacy Vosk or base.en are configuration choices, not automatic fallbacks. The new allowlisted runtime includes accurate/configuration/diagnostics/provisioning modules and both model/vocabulary manifests. (`services/transcription/configuration.py:11-35,61-70`.) Dependency repair is controlled by the requirements hash/import check and stays in the service's venv. Setup does not mean recording; launching the service still leaves audio idle until the user presses Start.

## Service ownership is more than a port

A listening port may belong to another workspace or process. The manager authenticates `/v1/runtime`, checks the service identifier/management version and matches the saved instance ID before reuse or shutdown (`services\transcription\manage.py:114-159`). A stale owned idle service can be restarted for a

changed speech protocol, engine/model/source fingerprint, but active transcription is refused and the selected model is verified before replacement.




16 - Distribution and Troubleshooting - diagram 2. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

This design refuses ambiguity instead of adopting an arbitrary process. The manager's status output intentionally reports only readiness/activity/PID, not token or transcript content (`services\transcription\manage.py:244-268`).

# Troubleshooting by symptom

## The window is missing

First distinguish Hidden, minimized, failed initialization and a different running instance. Ctrl+Alt+Space and relaunch recovery are intended paths. The single-instance pipe accepts one fixed recovery command under current-user restrictions, not arbitrary scripts or filenames (`src\PhantomFudge.App\Native\SingleInstance.cs:18-75`).

If protection setup fails, the app withholds content and records a generic local notice rather than displaying an unprotected branded error window (`src\PhantomFudge.App\LocalFailureNotice.cs:1-30`). That notice is diagnostic data, not saved notes.

## Start fails

Check the selected input mode, every requested device, local token, model and service version. In Both mode, a missing microphone must not silently become Computer-only. The native adapter validates selection and waits for protocol readiness before opening inputs (`src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:72-156`).

## Nothing is transcribed

A selected playback endpoint may not be the meeting application's actual output. A microphone may be muted or denied by Windows policy. A zero meter and an empty transcript are not enough to diagnose the same problem. Do not "fix" either by opening a different device automatically. Actual hardware diagnosis needs explicit user authorization and the named device configuration.

## Stop seems slow

The application may be releasing native inputs, draining accepted audio or waiting for final recognition. IsRunning is not a complete shutdown contract. A hung native call cannot be safely treated as disposed merely because a UI timeout expired. The source retains ownership and blocks unsafe restart rather than using a success-shaped fallback.

## Answers are slow or return no useful solution

Separate provider preparation, first text, complete answer/session close and UI assignment. Startup/reveal/reload prepares one empty Agency session without inference; cold preparation can take roughly 20–31 seconds. Wait for Ready, then Ask. Three prepared exact-text GPT-5.6 Sol Fast / low responses completed below five seconds; this does not guarantee future latency. Earlier fast wrong answers and slow cases remain in the quality record. (`src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.AnswerLifetime.cs:23-78`.)

Default local diagnostics provide request/capture IDs, stages, counts and safe errors, not conversation bodies. `Show-Diagnostics.ps1` excludes synthetic UI timings by default. `Export-Diagnostics.ps1` strips Text unless explicitly requested and includes only four allowlisted metadata-only speech logs from that workspace; it does

not upload anything ( `scripts/Export-Diagnostics.ps1:14-80` ; `src/PhantomFudge.Core/Diagnostics/LocalDiagnostics.cs:20-24,40-69` ).

### Docker is missing

Normal native operation does not require it. Docker recipes are optional final-stage packaging. Only an explicit Docker mode should require a Docker engine ( `scripts\Start-Transcription.ps1:1-35` ). Do not turn a portability task back into a mandatory infrastructure dependency.

## Release discipline

Keep candidate names/hashes immutable. If source, runtime, rendering or protocol changes, create a new candidate and rerun the affected evidence. Signed versus unsigned status must be explicit; signing does not guarantee SmartScreen or organizational acceptance.

The handbook and journal are now part of that discipline. A release that changes what the user sees needs current screenshots; a protocol change needs a current sequence diagram and source references. Freshness tooling detects changed inputs, but semantic review remains the author's job.

## References

- `scripts\Publish-Preview.ps1:1-52` — package recipe.
- `scripts\Initialize-Transcription.ps1:26-165` — model/token/runtime setup.
- `scripts\Run-PhantomFudge.ps1:8-57` — source/package launch selection.
- `services\transcription\manage.py:114-268` — instance ownership, reuse and stop.
- `src\PhantomFudge.App\Native\SingleInstance.cs:18-75` — window recovery channel.
- `src\PhantomFudge.App\LocalFailureNotice.cs:1-30` — non-content failure notice.
- `docs\IMPLEMENTATION-STATUS.md:1-309` — candidate evidence and limits.

Source: docs/handbook/17-privacy-and-assurance.md

# Privacy and assurance

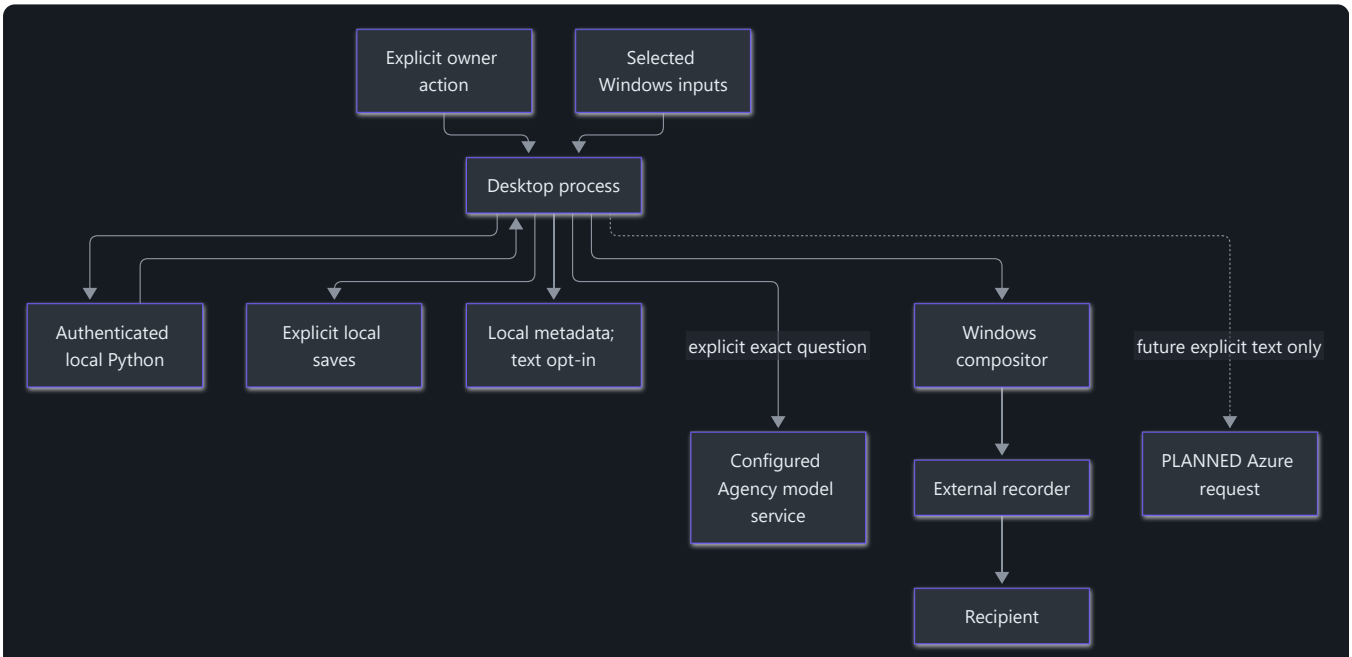
> **TL;DR:** The application can control its own inputs, storage, windows and requests. It cannot turn those controls into a universal guarantee about another recorder, the operating system, an administrator, a camera or a person. Assurance requires both a mechanism and the right experiment for the claim.

## Overview: separate the questions

"Private" can mean that notes are absent from a recipient's frames, audio stays local, a token is not logged, a file is encrypted, or a process is not listed. Those are different properties. The current product explicitly does not promise process invisibility or a security/DRM boundary (`docs\PRODUCT.md:184-200`).

The first useful threat-model step is therefore to state what is controlled. The app owns its HWND and can request display affinity. It owns the selected capture objects and can require explicit Start. It owns the local protocol and can authenticate it. It does not own a meeting application's cursor-inclusion setting, the Windows microphone indicator or a camera aimed at the display.

## Trust boundaries




17 - Privacy and Assurance - diagram 1. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

The compositor/recorder boundary is deliberately outside the local socket boundary. Securing localhost traffic does not prove pixel exclusion; setting display affinity does not authenticate the local service.

# Window and cursor controls

The visual **Cover** is not a process or screen-reader invisibility feature. It detaches the disabled workspace and refreshes the current window-peer children while retaining data and ongoing work. Fresh in-process traversal sees the cover, but an already-retained value provider still reads the synthetic question. The native protection path also requests `DWMWA_DISALLOW_PEEK`; setter acceptance is not shell-preview or recipient qualification. The complete feasibility matrix separates these implemented measures from cached clients, process/memory inspection, unsupported capture paths and physical observation.

`WindowProtection.Configure` checks the platform/composition path, updates owned-window styles, requests exclusion and records readback. It does not inject into a recorder or change a global system privacy setting (`src\PhantomFudge.App\Native\WindowProtection.cs:19-48`).

The cursor policy chooses the standard Arrow for the app, while the default Present mode avoids unnecessary activation. The owner still reported a recipient-side disappearing pointer, and that exact sharing configuration remains unqualified. Local shape/foreground observations are useful but not substitutes for recipient frames (`docs\CURSOR-AND-THEMES.md:1-69`, `src\PhantomFudge.App\Native\CursorPolicy.cs:1-25`).

Automatic protection failures should not reveal the application through a new unprotected message box. A generic, bounded local notice contains no note/transcript payload (`src\PhantomFudge.App\LocalFailureNotice.cs:1-30`). Explicit OS file/auth surfaces are still separate from the main protected window.

# Audio authority and retention

The later microphone request changed product authority: Computer, Mic or Both may be selected, but no endpoint opens before Start. Source labels are not people. Computer can include other app audio and sidetone; Mic can include speaker echo. Headphones reduce one practical risk but do not create an acoustic-echo-cancellation guarantee (`docs\DUAL-SOURCE-AUDIO.md:1-26`).

Raw audio is handled as bounded in-memory frames. The test harness uses synthetic PCM and must not implicitly open real devices. This is a meaningful policy, but it is not a claim of secure memory erasure, immunity to dumps, or control over host swap/administrators.

# Local service authentication

The server uses a bounded local token, constant-time comparison, a one-active-session admission rule and explicit frame limits. Management operations additionally match an instance identity; they are not arbitrary process-control APIs (`services\transcription\server.py:71-215`, `services\transcription\manage.py:155-200`).

A malicious process running as the same user or an administrator is not contained by calling the service "localhost." The token and current-user boundaries reduce accidental/cross-context access; they do not transform the workstation into a trusted enclave. The service itself does not open microphones or read chats; the C# client owns the selected device operations.

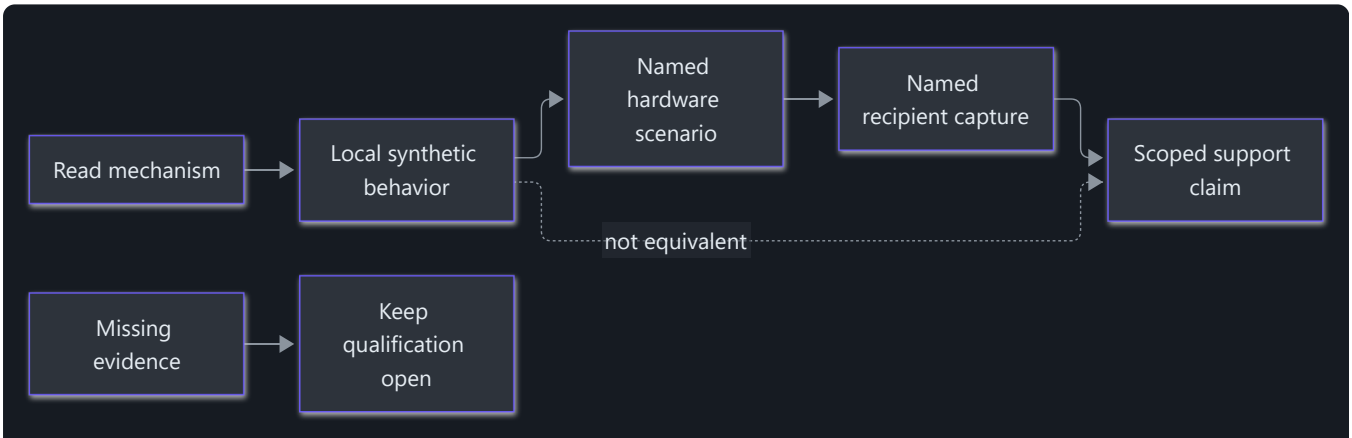
# Storage boundaries

Notes are not automatically persisted. Transcripts remain memory-only unless explicitly exported or diagnostic Text mode is enabled. Default logs record metadata without conversation bodies. Explicit file saves are bounded UTF-8 operations with conflict checks and same-directory replacement (`src\PhantomFudge.Core\NoteFileStore.cs:16-91`). Ordinary file deletion does not establish secure erasure from SSDs, backups or snapshots. An unsaved warning prevents one kind of data loss, not every crash.

Do not log note hashes as a supposedly harmless substitute for text. A short predictable question can be dictionary-tested against a hash. Use random correlation IDs and counts where diagnostics need identity without content.

App logs rotate at 2 MiB with at most ten files and a 1024-record nonblocking queue; dropped/failed records are observable. Backend logs rotate separately at 1 MiB with three backups and never include transcript text. Their identities are independent: correlate UTC/source/stages without inventing a shared session ID. Text opt-in does not add notes, audio, tokens or provider stderr. Local export removes Text by default and never uploads (`src/PhantomFudge.Core/Diagnostics/LocalDiagnostics.cs:20-24,40-110`; `scripts/Export-Diagnostics.ps1:14-80`; diagnostics).

# Evidence ladder




17 - Privacy and Assurance - diagram 2. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

A screenshot in this book is an actual WPF visual-tree render with generated content. It proves that the controls can render, not that a recorder did or did not capture them. A GDI positive/negative fixture is a different experiment. A remote meeting capture is different again. The qualification matrix names these dimensions and failure cases (`docs\QUALIFICATION.md:1-40`).

The same separation applies to speech: fake decoder tests prove deterministic protocol handling; a real recognizer with generated audio proves integration; real-speaker/device/echo tests establish a different scope. No single green test count can replace the others.

## The planned Azure boundary

The local question implementation does not cross that boundary. It copies only explicitly selected structured segments or typed text, and freezes the displayed draft on explicit Ask. Source references stay local, including original text that may differ after editing. A future provider must use `ExactText` as its question payload; serializing the complete snapshot would defeat that separation. Snapshot-only mode sends nothing. An explicitly configured Agency provider is connected and normally uses hosted inference, while the local-model option has a separate loopback endpoint. Neither is a direct Azure adapter. Startup/reveal/reload may prepare one empty Agency session without a prompt; only explicit Ask sends question data (`src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.AnswerLifetime.cs:23-78`). (`src\PhantomFudge.Core\QuestionDraft.cs:18-95`; `src\PhantomFudge.Core\QuestionSnapshot.cs:5-23`; local guide.)

The future Ask design intentionally sends a chosen immutable question, not the whole transcript. Cloud audio is optional and separately configured. Model text is displayed as data, not executed as code or used to choose tools/URLs. The desktop is a public client and must not contain a distributed application secret (`docs\AI-ANSWER-PRIVACY.md:1-93`).

`store:false` is not universal zero retention, and a resource's nominal region does not necessarily pin all Global deployment processing to that region. Those statements belong in the product contract before cloud execution, not after an incident. At this edition, Azure Ask is design only; no direct Azure identity/profile or Azure latency result exists. Installed Agency has its own bounded measured results, not evidence that an Azure deployment or universal five-second SLO exists.

## Review questions

1. What evidence would establish that an actual Teams screen-share mode excludes the new answer pane?
2. Which data could still be visible through an OS indicator or an explicit file dialog?
3. Why is the source label Mic not proof that the owner spoke?
4. Why does local authentication not defend against every same-user process?
5. What must an Azure Ask implementation avoid logging even when diagnostics are enabled?

## References

- `docs\PRODUCT.md:184-200` — privacy scope.
- `src\PhantomFudge.App\Native\WindowProtection.cs:19-48` — owned-window policy.
- `src\PhantomFudge.App\Native\CursorPolicy.cs:1-25` — standard cursor behavior.
- `src\PhantomFudge.App\LocalFailureNotice.cs:1-30` — generic local error notice.
- `services\transcription\server.py:71-215` — protocol/authentication boundaries.
- `services\transcription\manage.py:155-200` — owned shutdown.
- `src\PhantomFudge.Core\NoteFileStore.cs:16-91` — local file semantics.
- `docs\AI-ANSWER-PRIVACY.md:1-93` — proposed cloud boundary.

# 18. Extending the System

## Why a small feature can require a wide review

An extension is safe when its responsibilities are narrow **and its consequences are traced completely**. Adding a source is not just another selector; it affects byte framing, queue budgets, timestamp validation, stop behavior, display provenance, tests, and privacy wording. Adding a theme is not just changing a background; selection, disabled controls, alpha composition, and capture qualification also matter. The architecture explicitly prefers small testable interfaces over a generic plugin framework. (docs\ARCHITECTURE.md:47-72, component responsibilities; src\PhantomFudge.Core\AudioSource.cs:3-30, source identity; src\PhantomFudge.App\ThemeBrushes.cs:9-32, semantic resources.)

This chapter teaches change analysis; it does **not** add runtime capabilities. TODO28 established structured questions and exact Freeze; the Agency provider now uses **persistent ACP with controlled fresh sessions**. "Ask never sends" applies only to SnapshotOnly. Source commit29 and direct Azure30/31 remain separate future work, not prerequisites for reviewed explicit Ask. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.Questions.cs:265-304, `QuestionAsk_Click`; TODO\29_QUESTION_COMMIT_LATENCY.todo:13-22, protocol tasks; TODO\30_AZURE_ANSWER_CONNECTION.todo:13-22, prerequisites.)

Missing settings select SnapshotOnly, and the parent restored that mode after stopping the owned login. The owner requests existing installed Agency, with no new login or organization-data access; LocalModel remains separate. The earlier Copilot smoke failed at the customization/tool gate and consumed its allowance because a model call cannot be ruled out. The successful Agency probe had new, separate authorization, not a retry of that allowance. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\Answers\AnswerConfiguration.cs:13-29, `Load`; src\PhantomFudge.Core\Answers\AnswerContracts.cs:14-20, modes.) See provider boundaries and workstream39.

The marker smoke remains connectivity history. The completed authorized ledger records **48 client question submissions**, including failed/superseded trials; no further model calls are planned. Agency **2026.10.7.4** / Copilot **1.0.92** now defaults to the advertised and tested `gpt-5.6-sol-fast` **/ low**. H's three prepared exact-text responses completed usefully in **4.066, 4.176 and 2.992 s**; all three implementations compiled and passed **33/33** checks. Two inputs used intended wording and one the owner's actual ASR string. These are provider observations, not app/voice acceptance or a universal SLO. LocalModel has mocks only; credentials may expire. (tools\AgencyProbe\results\summary-final.json:2-64, scope/results; tools\AgencyProbe\results\latency-suite-20261009-h-exact-fast.json:2-56, exact-text trials; tools\AgencyProbe\results\latency-suite-20261009-h-quality.json:2-186, compiled checks.)

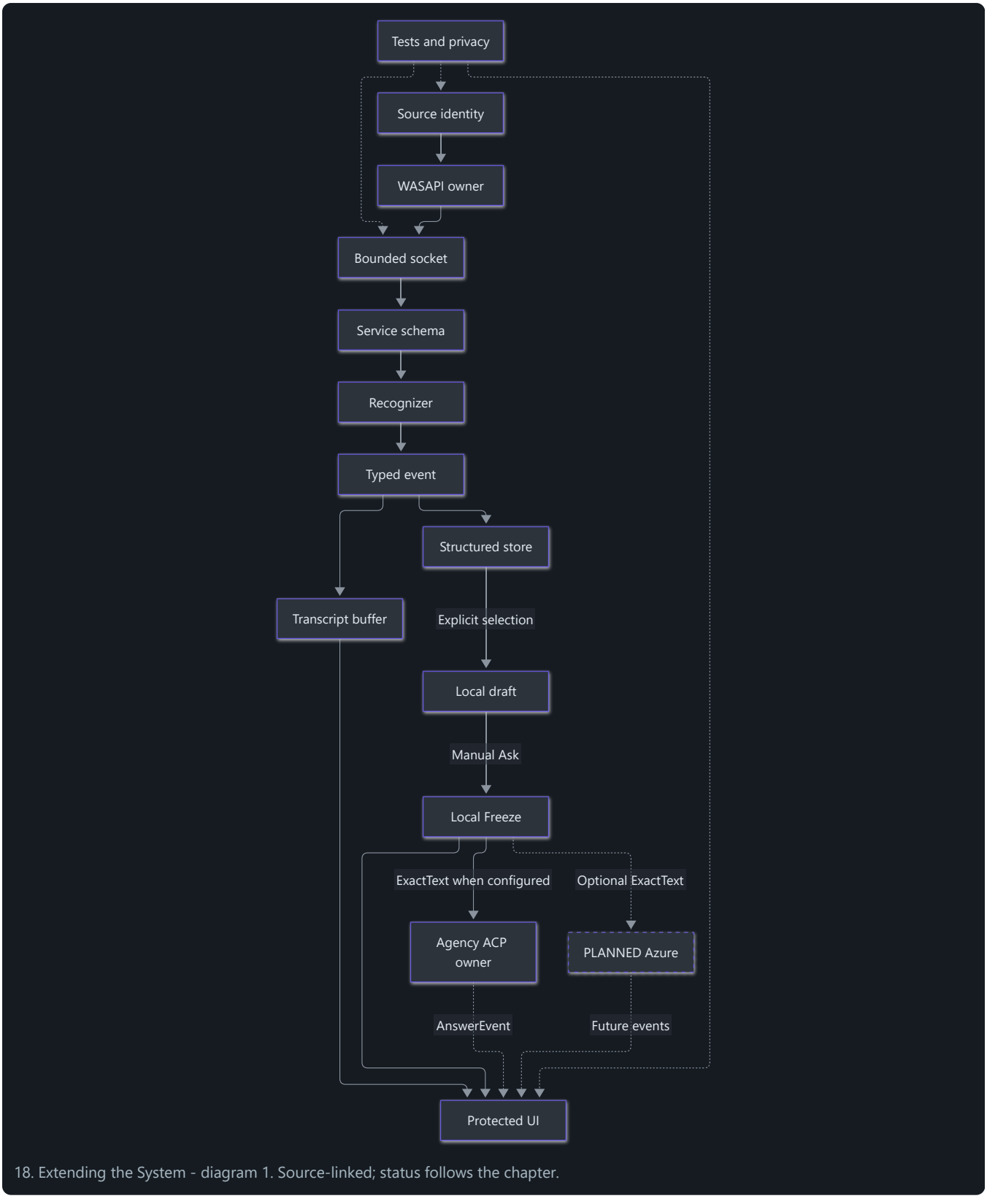
Keep the failed path visible. Haiku E's five fast original-variation responses were not exact owner-ASR evidence. Haiku F chose two wrong problems and appended one follow-up; mini G understood all six exact questions but failed ten full-range overflow checks. H's selected result does not erase either. Cold Haiku took **24.874 s**; first transport-only Asks took **5.041 s** on F and **6.470 s** on G. Never turn a prepared-session success

into a cold-start promise. (tools\AgencyProbe\results\latency-suite-20261009-f-exact.json:2-98, retained failures; tools\AgencyProbe\results\summary-final.json:58-73, cold/transport boundaries; tools\AgencyProbe\results\summary-final.json:141-180, E–H comparison.)

The key discipline is to write the invariant before the edit. “A selected source cannot borrow another source's queue allowance” is testable. “Support more audio” is not. Existing tests already express this distinction through canonical schemas, bounded per-source resources, independent timing, and explicit rejection of undeclared input. (services\transcription\tests\test_dual_protocol.py:57-92, `StartSchemaTests`; services\transcription\tests\test_dual_protocol.py:150-200, independent tracks; services\transcription\tests\test_dual_protocol.py:250-255, undeclared-source rejection.)

# Architecture: trace both directions across the boundary

For audio changes, follow data downstream from selected device to rendered transcript, then follow failures upstream to cancellation and cleanup. The local capture GUID is now attached to events before dispatcher delivery; a stale callback must not acquire the identity of a later Start. The unchanged display/export buffer and new structured question store are separate consumers, not interchangeable representations. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:86-136, `StartCoreAsync`; src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:194-237, `TryEnqueueAudio`; services\transcription\server.py:394-498, `Session.recognize`; src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:796-824, `ReceiveTranscript`; src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.Questions.cs:134-153, `UpdateQuestionTranscript`.)




18. Extending the System - diagram 1. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

This map is intentionally not a claim that every box is a formal interface. For example, Python expects recognizer objects with `accept` and `finish`, returning `Recognition`; C# injects a capture-construction delegate for tests. Understanding the actual seam prevents introducing abstraction machinery that the code does not need. (services\transcription\recognizer.py:17-22, `Recognition`; services\transcription\server.py:394-498, recognizer calls; src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:18-28, capture injection.)

# Checklist 1: a new audio source

**Start with product meaning.** Define what the source captures, how the user chooses it, and what its label does not mean. Current `Computer` and `Mic` labels identify inputs, not speakers; no source addition should silently become diarization or automatic meeting discovery. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\AudioSource.cs:16-30, `AudioSourceNames`; tests\PhantomFudge.Core.Tests\SourceTranscriptTests.cs:81-87, `LabelsDescribeInputNotSpeaker`.)

Then inspect these concrete surfaces:

1. **Identity and selection:** extend the enum and explicit selection model deliberately. `AudioInputSelection` currently has only two device fields; `ValidateSelection` constructs at most two inputs and rejects duplicate device IDs. A new enum value alone is insufficient. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptEvent.cs:5-7, selection records; src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:142-156, `ValidateSelection`.)
2. **Native ownership:** specify endpoint direction and exact identity matching, construction failure, disconnect, stop, and disposal. `WasapiInput` distinguishes Render from Capture and releases both endpoint notifications and native capture ownership. Do not substitute a default device after selection fails. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\WasapiInput.cs:20-74, constructor and `MatchesSelection`; src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\WasapiInput.cs:97-119, `Dispose`.)
3. **Transport capacity:** audit fixed arrays of length three, allowed source counts, byte prefixes, and total pending-byte limits. Those structures encode the present two-source contract. Update resource arithmetic explicitly rather than increasing a limit until tests stop failing. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:13-18, limits; src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:51-56, source-indexed fields; src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:104-114, source validation.)
4. **Server symmetry:** align `SOURCES`, canonical source ordering, declared-source validation, per-source rate credits, and queue accounting. Stop must drain source workers and pending finalization, publishing every selected source's final before stopped. (services\transcription\server.py:26-28, source map; services\transcription\server.py:100-112, `parse_start`; services\transcription\server.py:319-357, `Session.receive`; services\transcription\server.py:394-498, stop drain.)
5. **UI, tests, privacy, documentation:** update selectors, meters, source visibility, export labels, denied-device behavior, and user-facing capture scope. Existing UI branches explicitly on Computer/Microphone/Both; do not let a new value fall into an accidental “Both” default. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:720-760, `UpdateAudioControls`, `SetCaptureMode`; tests\PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests\DualSourceTests.cs:17-44, synthetic regression catalogue.)
6. **Question provenance:** update `TranscriptValidation.Source`, structured keys and chooser filters as well as display names. The Mic default must not silently select a new source. All sources is a visibility filter, not authorization to include every row; Use selected still copies only explicit keys. Test new-source partial/final identity and local provenance retention separately from export formatting. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\TranscriptSegment.cs:5-14, `TranscriptSegmentKey`; src\PhantomFudge.Core\TranscriptSegment.cs:76-80, source validation; src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.Questions.cs:70-120, filtering/selection.)

# Checklist 2: a new recognition backend

Begin at the recognition contract, not the model download. The current hybrid uses **independent per-source provisional queues and single-thread workers**, plus a separate **serial finalizer** for retained PCM spans. It does not funnel both stages through one executor. Source decoders produce provisional `Recognition` or bounded `FinalSpan` handoffs; finalization produces bounded final text with finite ordered times, and Stop drains pending work before stopped. Decoder faults/timeouts still invalidate readiness; native calls cannot simply be killed safely. Preserve these ordering, ownership and deadline rules when adding a backend. (services\transcription\server.py:115-181, `Runtime.cpu` and CPU ownership; services\transcription\server.py:361-498, `Session.publish`, `recognize`.) The current `Runtime.source_cpu` / `final_cpu` and `Session.recognize_source` / `finalize` separate source progress from expensive finalization; publication remains serialized.

Specify the backend's answers to five questions:

- Does `accept` produce useful revisable partials, completed text, or bounded PCM-span handoffs?
- Does `finish` flush every processed sample, and does it permit continuation?
- Are timestamps cumulative, and how are reset offsets preserved?
- Can independent source decoders share immutable model weights without sharing recognition history?
- Are inference and setup strictly separated so recognition cannot trigger an implicit download?

`VoskFactory` and `VoskRecognizer` still supply verified local models, independent provisional decoders and the explicit Vosk-only alternative; their absolute-timing/source-isolation tests remain relevant, but do not describe the whole hybrid. (services\transcription\recognizer.py:25-66, `verify_model`, `VoskFactory`; services\transcription\recognizer.py:69-110, `VoskRecognizer`; services\transcription\tests\test_recognizer.py:37-75, `RecognizerTests`.) The production default is `hybrid-whisper` **/** `small.en`: Vosk supplies streaming provisional text while CPU/int8 Whisper finalizes disjoint retained spans. `HybridRecognizer` cuts spans at an endpoint, its bounded rotation threshold or Stop; `WhisperFinalizer` uses explicitly provisioned local files rather than downloading during recognition. (services\transcription\configuration.py:12-34, `DEFAULT`, `load_config`; services\transcription\accurate.py:33-71, `HybridRecognizer`; services\transcription\accurate.py:74-129, `WhisperFinalizer`, `HybridFactory`.)

Do not advertise batch throughput as streaming latency. The earlier benchmark/research recommendation for optional question-only Whisper refinement is **historical**, not the current hybrid runtime configuration. Current Whisper finalization also does not remove Vosk's streaming provisional role or establish a live-latency guarantee. Any later recognition result must respect edit/snapshot ownership: it cannot overwrite user-edited text or mutate an already-frozen question. Backend changes still require protocol, UI, privacy, model-provenance and benchmark review even when their wire shape stays unchanged. (docs\SPEECH-BENCHMARK.md:34-40, historical recommendation; docs\AI-ANSWER-RESEARCH.md:90-99, earlier optional-refinement research; src\PhantomFudge.Core\QuestionDraft.cs:48-79, edit/refresh; src\PhantomFudge.Core\QuestionSnapshot.cs:5-23, immutability.)

# Checklist 3: a new theme or semantic color role

Theme changes have a narrower code surface but a wider visual evidence surface. `ThemePalette.For` provides semantic colors; `ThemeBrushes.Apply` maps those roles into both application resources and standard WPF control resources. Adding a role requires checking each palette and its consumers, not inserting an isolated literal into one control. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\ThemePalette.cs:5-26, `ThemePalette.For`; src\PhantomFudge.App\ThemeBrushes.cs:9-32, `Apply`.)

Review text, muted text, headings, selection foreground/background, action text, warning/error, input, hover, and border states. Preserve frozen brushes and dynamic-resource bindings. Also decide whether a new theme participates in the two-theme toggle: `NextThemed` currently alternates the companions and exits Plain toward DeepSeaFoam. That behavior is tested and should not change accidentally. (src\PhantomFudge.App\ThemeBrushes.cs:35-41, `Brush`; src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml:116-163, dynamic resources; src\PhantomFudge.Core\ThemePalette.cs:28-29, `NextThemed`; tests\PhantomFudge.Core.Tests\ThemePaletteTests.cs:19-25, toggle test.)

The background slider controls the shared translucent backdrop visible behind notes, transcript **and question/answer reading surfaces**. Its setter changes the root brush alpha; transparent Q/A panels and editors let that backdrop show through while reading text remains fully opaque. Do not reintroduce an opaque answer background that masks the slider, or "simplify" this into whole-window opacity that fades text. The `QuestionPanel`, `QuestionEditor`, `QuestionSnapshotText` and `AnswerText` declarations make this composition explicit. Existing contrast tests cover **opaque** reading/selection pairs, not arbitrary content behind a translucent window. Recheck actual UI, focus/hit regions and capture scenarios without promoting local rendering into meeting compatibility. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:482-505, opacity and `ApplyTheme`; tests\PhantomFudge.Core.Tests\ThemePaletteTests.cs:31-40, opaque contrast test; docs\QUALIFICATION.md:111-137, transition matrix.)

Include the local question pane in that review: selected rows, editable/read-only draft, provisional/user-edited indicators and read-only snapshot are different visual states. Verify that theme switching preserves their text; an immutable snapshot alone does not prove visual correctness, recipient invisibility or every contrast combination. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.Questions.cs:198-208, interaction states; src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.Questions.cs:246-259, provenance display; src\PhantomFudge.Core\QuestionSnapshot.cs:5-23, immutable snapshot.)

# Checklist 4: a provider is a new trust boundary

Answer providers must stay separate from local speech transport. Do not loosen `ValidateEndpoint` to accommodate cloud inference or a model server: it deliberately accepts only literal loopback addresses and the exact transcription path. A second loopback API is not the same protocol simply because both run locally. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:82-98, `ValidateEndpoint`.)

The future Azure checklist—explicit Ask, destination approval, identity, bounds, cancellation, terminal reasons and safe output—still applies. Installed-CLI integration makes those concerns immediate rather than proving them solved. Render text as data, not XAML/HTML, commands or automatically opened links. Offline fake-

stream/process checks must precede a real-call receipt. (TODO\31_STREAMING_ANSWER_CLIENT.todo:13-28, provider contract; TODO\34_ANSWER_PRIVACY_RESILIENCE.todo:13-28, failure/privacy gates; docs\AI-ANSWER-PRIVACY.md:117-134, output and logging boundaries.)

The snapshot remains a **local** provenance contract, not a provider DTO. Repeated Freeze can retain the same question ID/revision, so an answer attempt needs its own identity. Keep mode-specific notices: "nothing sent" is correct for SnapshotOnly, not a guarantee for configured Agency, whose model service may be remote. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\QuestionSnapshot.cs:5-23, snapshot data; src\PhantomFudge.Core\QuestionDraft.cs:90-95, `Freeze`; src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.Questions.cs:265-304, snapshot action.)

Review these additional concrete surfaces before extending the new common interface:

1. **Request projection:** `AnswerRun` generates a fresh GUID and normally passes only `ExactText`; `SourceRefs`, notes, audio and unselected text stay outside `AnswerRequest`. The explicitly requested, default-off Clarify first option may add only its typed instruction/history metadata. Do not widen that exception into generic app context. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\Answers\AnswerContracts.cs:3-12, request/events/interface; src\PhantomFudge.Core\Answers\AnswerRun.cs:15-27, projection.)
2. **Settings versus readiness:** Agency mode adds `AgencyPath` for the supported `agency copilot` launcher; local installation is not offline inference or authorization to inspect organization data. LocalModel remains the separate Copilot-engine OFFLINE/BYOK route to an explicit literal-loopback `/v1` server. Destination validation cannot verify model installation or prevent server-side proxying. No hosted-model fallback is permitted. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\Answers\AnswerContracts.cs:22-55, settings validation.)
3. **Executable and profile authority:** setup resolves Agency without login; a `.exe` path is not proof of authenticity or isolation. Preserve the pinned profile-only launch and reject ambient hooks, permissions, plugins, MCPs and resumed sessions. The exact generated direct-Q&A agent is a deliberate controlled exception, not permission to import a personal coding agent. Missing existing authentication must not trigger app-owned login/account switching. These controls are not an OS sandbox or organization-data grant. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\Answers\AnswerContracts.cs:28-33, syntactic validation; src\PhantomFudge.Core\Answers\AnswerConfiguration.cs:8-29, profile/settings paths.)
4. **Terminal protocol:** TextDelta/Completed retain request IDs and increasing sequence. Completion carries no text and only latches a marker; nonblank text and clean **request enumeration end** are also required. The persistent engine's pipe must not close after each answer. Test duplicate, late, wrong-request and post-terminal events without turning raw diagnostics into answers. The 32,768-unit cap rejects an overflowing delta whole. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\Answers\AnswerRun.cs:32-63, `Apply`, `Complete`.)
5. **Ownership and retention:** one active request, a 120-second deadline and 40-ms render timer remain unchanged. Cancel/Hide/Clear/protection/reload/close must reach the cached provider and await owned cleanup, even during preparation. Keep partials incomplete and Copy deliberate; never retry/resend automatically. Engine/workspace artifacts can survive individual answers until teardown, so app memory bounds are not end-to-end memory-only operation. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\Answers\AnswerRun.cs:65-79, `Cancel`, `Fail`.) Inspect the lifetime owner and provider guide, not just Core state.

## Persistent-provider additions to that checklist

Persistence moves ownership outside a single request's `await foreach`. A new provider must declare whether success releases a request, conversation, process, workspace or all four. Agency acknowledges `session/close` before Completed, keeps the engine, then prepares another **empty** session. It never reuses a question conversation and rotates the engine after at most 32 created sessions. **Normal startup/reveal intentionally calls** `WarmUpAsync`, preparing one empty session without a model question. The alternative `WarmUpTransportAsync` prepares only transport and leaves session creation on Ask; it is not the current app readiness policy. The selected-default preparation took 21.183 seconds with zero questions. Keep that readiness cost separate from prepared completion.
(src\PhantomFudge.Core\Answers\AgencyAcpConnection.cs:41-122, reuse/session/prompt/close; tools\AgencyProbe\results\agency-selected-fast-default-preparation.json:2-16, empty-session preparation; tools\AgencyProbe\results\summary-final.json:210-224, cleanup and retention.)

Before prompt submission, verify advertised configuration: controlled agent, exact requested model, reasoning effort and `allow_all=off`. CLI `--agent` alone was insufficient in pinned ACP; explicit `session/set_config_option` installs the intended SYSTEM-role policy. Preserve one user text containing fixed instructions plus JSON `userQuestion`, not a serialized snapshot. Normal Ask excludes history; only explicit Clarify first requests may include their bounded typed clarification exchanges. Validate Unicode and escape file-reference syntax while retaining the decoded exact question.
(src\PhantomFudge.Core\Answers\AgencyAcpConnection.cs:61-96, agent selection/one prompt; src\PhantomFudge.Core\Answers\AgencyAcpConnection.cs:296-319, configuration validation; src\PhantomFudge.Core\Answers\AgencyAnswerPrompt.cs:8-97, controlled policy and envelope.)

The receiver rejects tools, permission/client requests and protocol plans instead of waiting. The full-answer prose check excludes code fences and rejects selected missing-input/follow-up phrases; it is a heuristic, not proof of usefulness. Keep semantic/correctness gates alongside timing: A–C preserved slow/generic/clarification failures; D failed eight overflow checks; E passed a surrogate question set; F chose wrong problems; G omitted full-range arithmetic safeguards despite correct title interpretation. H passed the finite exact-text contract on the new selected model. Neither three successful samples nor first text establishes a universal complete-answer guarantee. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\Answers\AgencyAcpConnection.cs:213-265, rejected requests/plans; src\PhantomFudge.Core\Answers\AgencyAcpConnection.cs:330-354, heuristic; src\PhantomFudge.Core\Answers\AgencyAnswerPrompt.cs:12-43, answer policy; tools\AgencyProbe\results\summary-final.json:109-180, retained failures and selected result.)

A default-model change also has a display and diagnostics surface. Keep the provider's public `DefaultModel` / `EffectiveModel` as the source of truth; the UI `ProviderLabel` already derives its default from that property, so recompilation updates the label. Preserve explicit overrides, fixed safe model metadata and no fallback. A newly compiled default is not itself a new latency measurement of the app binary.
(tools\AgencyProbe\results\summary-final.json:234-260, measurement assembly and public model properties.)

Finally, extend diagnostics without silently extending disclosure. Default events have correlation, duration/process/count/code fields; bodies require explicit content opt-in. Preserve the nonblocking queue and bounded file retention. The diagnostic constructor must suppress real warm-up, and fixtures must not turn session preparation into a cloud question. See diagnostics.

(src\PhantomFudge.Core\Diagnostics\LocalDiagnostics.cs:9-24, metadata schema; src\PhantomFudge.Core\Diagnostics\LocalDiagnostics.cs:40-111, bounds; src\PhantomFudge.Core\Diagnostics\LocalDiagnostics.cs:145-184, content opt-in.)

Cloud ASR changes audio egress; an enterprise broker changes authentication, routing, hosting, and streaming behavior. Neither is a routine interchangeable implementation detail. Both need separately justified policy and evaluation decisions, and neither makes Docker an ordinary runtime requirement. (TODO\36_OPTIONAL_AZURE_SPEECH.todo:13-25, optional Speech; TODO\37_OPTIONAL_ANSWER_BROKER.todo:13-26, optional broker.)

# Checklist 5: a new state field is a lifecycle change

For every proposed field, write down its owner, creation boundary, mutation authority, reset rule, serialization version, memory bound and logging/export policy. Existing display-buffer `BeginSession` resets final numbering, while `AddFinal` deduplicates globally within that session. The new structured key therefore separates capture identity from protocol final numbering. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\TranscriptBuffer.cs:23-38, `BeginSession`; src\PhantomFudge.Core\TranscriptBuffer.cs:48-72, `AddFinal`; src\PhantomFudge.Core\TranscriptSegment.cs:3-20, `TranscriptSegmentKey`.)

The implemented local fields provide a concrete lifecycle checklist:

| Field or owner | Preserve this invariant when extending it |
|---|---|
| Capture GUID / local utterance ID | New capture identity per Start; partial→final retains its local key. Store Clear does not recycle local IDs. |
| Source epoch | Current UI events use local 0; a field's existence is not wire negotiation or commit support. |
| Selected records | Copies survive 256-entry/64,000-character store eviction; reject cross-session selection. |
| Draft revision / user edit | Compose and validate the full 8,192-character candidate before assignment; explicit editing blocks ASR replacement. |
| Frozen snapshot | Copy provenance/text; future draft changes cannot mutate a previously returned snapshot. |
| Answer request/run | New GUID per attempt, exact-text-only request, increasing event sequence and a terminal marker distinct from completed state. |
| Cached engine / readiness | Distinguish transport from empty-session readiness; stop/dispose on owner teardown, not merely at enumeration end. |
| Prepared session / model | One prompt maximum, unique session identity, exact configured role/model and bounded engine rotation. |

Sources: (src\PhantomFudge.Core\StructuredTranscriptStore.cs:13-34, capacity/session; src\PhantomFudge.Core\StructuredTranscriptStore.cs:76-109, final identity/Clear); (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.Questions.cs:134-142, epoch-default calls); (src\PhantomFudge.Core\QuestionDraft.cs:18-79, selection/refresh transaction); (src\PhantomFudge.Core\QuestionSnapshot.cs:5-23, immutable copy).

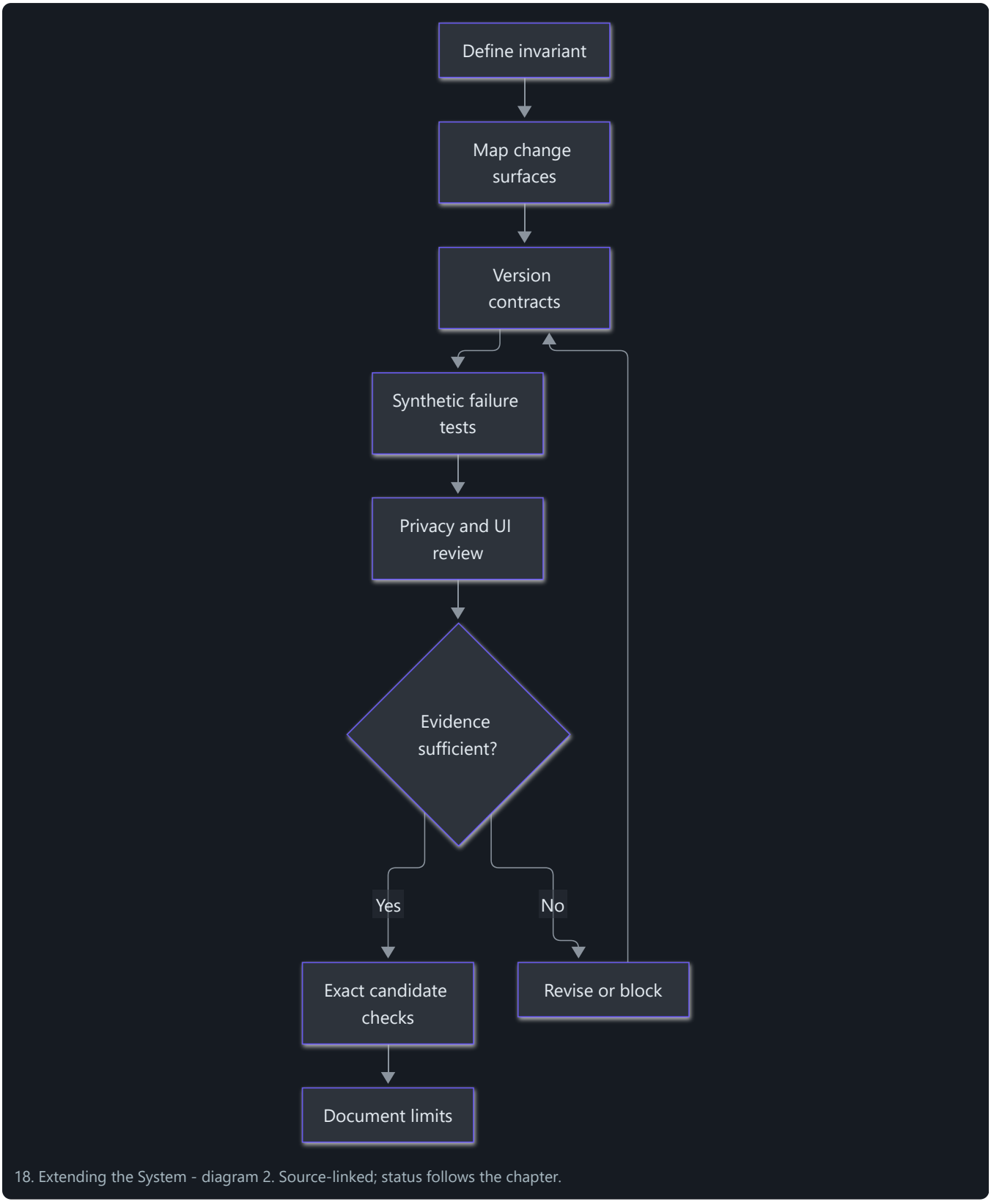
The answer fields have their own lifecycle in (src\PhantomFudge.Core\Answers\AnswerRun.cs:15-63, constructor, `Apply`, `Complete`). They must not reset transcription IDs or turn a new draft revision into a hidden resend.

An empty final is not permission to retain the last guessed partial: it settles that selected record to empty. Blank editing remains possible, but blank Ask rejects. Oversized selection, edit or refresh must leave the prior draft intact; do not “help” by truncating its meaning. Preserve the staged-update pattern when adding fields. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\StructuredTranscriptStore.cs:80-86, empty final; src\PhantomFudge.Core\QuestionDraft.cs:90-124, `Freeze`, `Compose`; src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.Questions.cs:214-243, edit/paste rejection.)

Wire evolution is especially surgical. The current service requires exact start objects, accepts only Stop after start, and the C# client checks exact response property sets. Even an apparently optional extra JSON field can break compatibility. Preserve v1/v2 behavior and negotiate a new version or capability rather than silently weakening parsers. (services\transcription\server.py:100-112, `parse_start`; services\transcription\server.py:306-316, `Session.receive`; src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:491-515, `RequireTranscriptProperties`, `RequireProperties`.)

Focus is also state, not decoration. `PassiveWindow` depends on presentation **and** question editing. The separate question path deliberately focuses typing without stopping audio or enabling Notes editing; global Notes Edit/Present/Hide behavior is not redefined. New answer controls must preserve that distinction while adding their own cancellation lifetime. Check protection readiness, file-busy rejection, return to passive interaction and audio-start cancellation independently. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.Questions.cs:24-25, `PassiveWindow`; src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.Questions.cs:156-208, focus transition.)

# A repeatable change algorithm




18. Extending the System - diagram 2. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

This is a recommended engineering workflow, not an executed release pipeline. Qualification must identify the exact packaged candidate and distinguish source tests, UI observations, recipient capture evidence, and owner approval. A successful build cannot fill an untested sharing-product row. (docs\QUALIFICATION.md:3-7,

current matrix; docs\QUALIFICATION.md:142-168, result record; TODO\35_ANSWER_RELEASE_ACCEPTANCE.todo:13-26, candidate acceptance.)

### Worked pseudocode: evolving local epochs into negotiated commit

`SourceEpoch` already exists locally; current v2 ingestion supplies 0. TODO29 requires a producer/consumer agreement for armed start/end boundaries, ordered sample coverage and acknowledged epoch advancement—not merely another field. The following **future commit** matrix extends existing local guards; its transition functions are illustrative, not implemented APIs. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\TranscriptSegment.cs:17-20, key fields; src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.Questions.cs:134-142, v2 ingestion.)

```
cases = [
    ("same_session_same_epoch", "accept"),
    ("old_session_same_segment_id", "reject_stale"),
    ("old_epoch_after_commit", "reject_stale"),
    ("duplicate_commit_same_parameters", "replay_ack"),
    ("duplicate_commit_changed_watermark", "reject"),
    ("late_final_after_user_edit", "preserve_user_revision"),
    ("selected_record_evicted", "preserve_local_copy"),
    ("freeze_then_late_final", "preserve_exact_snapshot"),
    ("new_field_sent_to_v2_peer", "reject_protocol"),
]
for scenario, expected in cases:
    state, event = synthetic_fixture(scenario)
    before = snapshot_unrelated_source(state)
    actual = proposed_transition(state, event)
    assert actual == expected
    assert unrelated_source(state) == before
    assert no_request_was_sent_without_explicit_ask(state)
```

This matrix connects protocol changes to UI/privacy consequences. Existing local guards do not establish a sample-exact live-Mic span from v2 text. Future commit must finalize only Mic, preserve Computer capture and use processed—not merely received—sample coverage. Tests should use generated data and injected capture, not silently open hardware. (tests\PhantomFudge.Core.Tests\SourceTranscriptTests.cs:5-56, source isolation tests; src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:25-28, synthetic capture seam; TODO\29_QUESTION_COMMIT_LATENCY.todo:13-28, proposed commit requirements.)

## Tradeoffs and the final change-surface review

Before calling a surgical change complete, review six surfaces even when some require no edit:

| Surface | Question to answer in the change record |
|---|---|
| UI | Did focus, protection lifecycle, source visibility, or status meaning change? |
| Protocol | Can an older peer reject, misinterpret, or accept an unsupported message? |
| Tests | Which existing invariant survives, and which new failure ordering is exercised? |
| Privacy | Did captured, transmitted, retained, logged, or exported data expand? |

| Surface | Question to answer in the change record |
| --- | --- |
| Resources | Are per-source limits, total limits, deadlines, and cleanup still bounded? |
| Documentation | Are implemented behavior, proposed behavior, and qualification gaps still distinguishable? |

This checklist synthesizes the existing strict transport, resource controls, and qualification record rather than introducing a new runtime framework. “No change required” is useful only when accompanied by the reason: a palette-only edit may leave framing unchanged, while a provider edit necessarily revisits egress and credential handling. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:13-18, limits; src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:512-515, strict properties; docs\QUALIFICATION.md:142-168, evidence record; docs\AI-ANSWER-PRIVACY.md:117-136, provider safeguards.)

Prefer a smaller supported contract over a permissive parser or automatic fallback that conceals unsupported behavior. Preserve failed and untested outcomes in the handoff: a new backend passing synthetic tests does not qualify a new window surface, a real microphone, or a cloud data policy. (docs\QUALIFICATION.md:24-26, outcome vocabulary; TODO\35_ANSWER_RELEASE_ACCEPTANCE.todo:23-26, acceptance boundaries.)

# Exercises

1. Find every fixed two-source assumption in the checklist. Explain why changing only the enum can compile in one layer while violating another layer's runtime schema. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:51-56, arrays; services\transcription\server.py:100-112, `parse_start`.)
2. Propose a warning color with acceptable opaque contrast, then explain why translucent-background readability still needs separate observation. (tests\PhantomFudge.Core.Tests\ThemePaletteTests.cs:31-73, contrast calculation; docs\PRODUCT.md:118-125, translucency limits.)
3. Draft a provider change receipt that records capability and privacy differences without including a real question, token, or account secret. (docs\AI-ANSWER-EVALUATION.md:140-149, receipt requirements.)
4. Select a partial, freeze it, edit the draft, then deliver an empty final and evict the original store row. Explain each object's expected text and why `SourceRefs` must not become the Azure request body. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\QuestionDraft.cs:48-95, edit/refresh/Freeze; src\PhantomFudge.Core\QuestionSnapshot.cs:5-23, local immutable provenance.)
5. On paper, apply TextDelta(1), Completed(2), then TextDelta(3) to one run; contrast that with request enumeration ending before Completed. Explain why neither is complete, why ACP process EOF is a different failure, and why none permits provider fallback. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\Answers\AnswerRun.cs:32-63, event/terminal guards.)

# References

- Architecture responsibilities and qualification contract.
- Source model, transport, and recognizer.
- Theme roles and brush mapping.

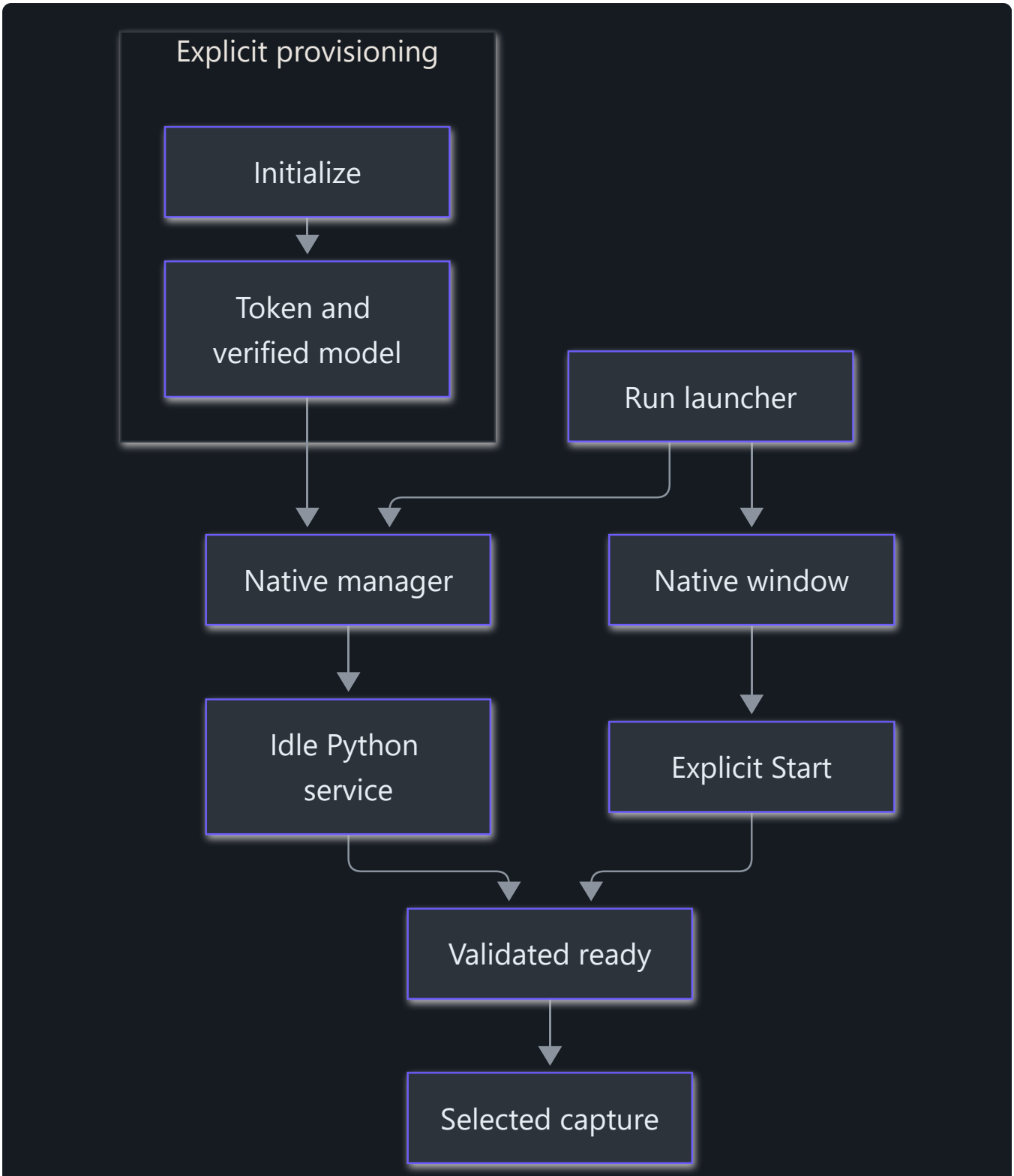
- Local question contract, structured store, and question diagnostics.
- Installed-provider boundaries, common interface, run state, and configuration.
- ACP session ownership, controlled policy, diagnostics and evolving provider evidence.
- Selected H exact-text timing and H compiled checks.
- Source-state tests and dual-protocol tests.
- Planned answer architecture and release acceptance.

# 19. API and configuration reference

## Readiness is not recording

This reference distinguishes three operations that must never be conflated: **provisioning**, **starting an idle service**, and **starting selected audio capture**. The launcher starts/reuses Python, but the window separately requires explicit Start, valid selections, protection readiness, and a token. Both is the initial input-mode selection, not automatic recording. (`scripts\Run-PhantomFudge.ps1:39-55`, launcher; `src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:35-65`, initial state; `src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:652-700`, `Start_Click`.)

Commands below are reference examples from the repository root, not actions performed to produce this chapter. No credential value is reproduced. Follow capture, protocol, recognition, and service ownership for the implementation narratives.




19. API and configuration reference - diagram 1. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

The final gate is implemented by `StartCoreAsync`: native construction follows successful transport connection, not merely process launch. (`src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:102-115`, `StartCoreAsync`.)

# Installed launcher reference

The planned Windows11 x64 installer has a native entry point, separate from the PowerShell source/legacy commands below. Candidate2/lifecycle3 passed bounded checks; the clean committed release build and publication remain **pending**. Use Installation for current availability and safe update/uninstall steps.

| Installed launcher arguments | Meaning |
| --- | --- |
| No arguments | Refuse while the installer gate is present; otherwise reveal an existing same-user app or prepare the installed local service and open the app with audio still idle |
| `--notes-only` | Same installer gate; open/reveal without speech preparation; does not stop a service or disable configured answer providers |
| `--maintenance [installation-root]` | Noninteractive guard: refuse a running app/busy launcher; require the owned marker and perform native authenticated idle shutdown, independent of old Python/compact manifest |
| `--validate-install installation-root` | Headless marker, compact metadata and required layout validation; no app/service/audio/inference startup |
| `--self-test` | Synthetic launcher contract/child-process checks; not real app, audio, provider or installed-copy qualification |

The presence of `Local\PhantomFudge-Installer-Maintenance` blocks normal/notes-only launch before coordination or existing-instance reveal. It is checked again after acquiring the startup mutex. Detection records generic status and exits70 without WPF UI or child processes; maintenance and validation bypass the gate. The targeted presence/lifetime test uses a randomly named mutex, not the production gate, so it does not claim a real Setup concurrency run. (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/Program.cs:25-78,240-244) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/LauncherContract.cs:152-165) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/LauncherStatus.cs:15,34) (tests/PhantomFudge.Core.Tests/InstalledLauncherTests.cs:176-195)

The repair/update hook uses a fresh Setup-extracted helper directory and an explicit absolute installation-root argument, rather than requiring a healthy old launcher. The native path is covered by lifecycle3's 11-check current-candidate fixture, including damaged-launcher/version repair. Its 3,682-file inventory pass is not a genuine old-binary upgrade, shortcut or clean-VM qualification. The explicit root does not override the fixed current-user data workspace and is not a general startup-path override. Uninstall continues through the installed helper. A second numeric version record in the per-user `HKCU\Software\PhantomFudge\Installer\<AppId>` key (`WindowsVersion`) supports repair of a damaged `app-version.txt`; both invalid means refusal, not an assumed upgrade. (tools/Installer/PhantomFudge.iss:51-52,107-161) (scripts/Test-Installer.ps1:15-18,40-84,96-104)

Arguments are exact whitelist forms, not shell expressions. Validation/maintenance accept an absolute installation root and require its bounded ownership marker; normal launch paths stay fixed. The fixed install layout is `app`, `launcher`, `runtime\python`, `services\transcription` and `models`. Mutable speech data is external at `%LOCALAPPDATA%\PhantomFudge\InstalledRuntime\.local`. The launcher sets literal-loopback service coordinates and an offline speech environment; it preserves the app's existing answer/keyboard settings location. (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/LauncherContract.cs:8-23,56-105) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/Program.cs:25-100,127-213) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/ChildProcesses.cs:48-105)

The normal-launch manager argument prefix is `-I -B -X utf8`, followed by the fixed manager path and `start`; the launcher deadline is 180 seconds. Fresh credentials use 32 random bytes encoded as 64 lowercase hexadecimal characters. Existing valid URL-safe tokens, including earlier Base64URL tokens, are preserved rather than rotated. These constants match the installed-runtime contract; the model root is supplied through `PHANTOM_TRANSCRIPTION_MODELS_ROOT`. (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/ChildProcesses.cs:48-61,81-105) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/Program.cs:13) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/LauncherContract.cs:31-36) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/LocalToken.cs:12-39,42-63) (tests/PhantomFudge.Core.Tests/InstalledLauncherTests.cs:135-155)

The model-resolution contract preserves user provisioning separately: `InstalledRuntime\.local\models\<pinned-model-name>` takes precedence when present; otherwise the bundled `models` directory is selected. Both paths require the same pinned manifest. Explicit provisioning writes only user model data, so it cannot silently modify installer-managed weights. Targeted tests cover both path selection and the write destination. (tools/Installer/runtime-contract.json:7-12,20-22) (services/transcription/tests/test_installed_runtime.py:74-91)

Maintenance uses the native authenticated loopback client and shared receipt lock, not a Python `maintenance` command. It matches instance/activity/process identity before shutdown; confirmed dead/recycled identity permits removing only an unchanged receipt. A live/unknown process is not terminated. The runtime's documented manager verbs remain `start`, `stop`, and `status`. (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/MaintenanceOperation.cs:48-118) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/OwnedServiceClient.cs:35-84) (tools/Installer/runtime-contract.json:11-24)

Partial ownership has explicit, different outcomes:

| Installed runtime state | Maintenance behavior |
| --- | --- |
| Token and receipt both absent | Succeed without probing a source-workspace listener |
| Receipt present, token absent | Refuse without authentication or file deletion |
| Token present, receipt absent | Validate the private token locally, then make a credential-free one-second TCP presence probe; succeed only on connection refused, not an occupied/uncertain port |
| Token and receipt present | Prove stale process identity or authenticate the exact owned idle runtime; remove only an unchanged receipt, never kill a PID |

A successful stop intentionally retains the token, so token-only state is not automatically corruption. The probe sends no token or shutdown request to an untracked listener. For stale PID-only receipts, Windows must confirm that PID absent before unauthenticated cleanup; an inspectable live legacy PID still requires matching authenticated service identity. An uninspectable process remains protected. (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/MaintenanceOperation.cs:52-118,121-134) (tests/PhantomFudge.Core.Tests/InstalledMaintenanceTests.cs:31-108,149-172)

`%LOCALAPPDATA%\PhantomFudge\launcher-status.json` records a bounded generic result. Self-test uses `launcher-self-test.json`. A runtime timeout preserves uncertain process ownership; it is not an instruction to terminate Python or delete a retained receipt. Reinstall/repair and manual data reset are different operations. (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/LauncherStatus.cs:6-61) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/ChildProcesses.cs:107-123)

App handoff has a separate wait from the180-second manager deadline:

| Observation after spawning the app | Meaning |
|---|---|
| Main-instance mutex appears | Startup handoff succeeds; elapsed time alone never proves this |
| Exact child is proven exited before readiness | AppStartFailed67, even if the child's exit code is0 |
| Neither can be proved | Retain the launcher operation mutex and keep watching |
| Still unresolved after30seconds | Write/show AppStartPending76, not Success and not an automatic exit |
| Close while handoff is pending | Hide progress, retain the guard and continue watching; early dispatcher shutdown retains a synchronous watcher |

Setup never launches the app. Finish/close Setup before using Start. Setup and launcher status/error UI are ordinary visible windows, not capture-excluded; launch before sharing. The latest handoff reports55helper tests and10exact-EXE self-checks, including delayed synthetic child/mutex coordination. It does not claim an interactive WPF Close test. (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/ChildProcesses.cs:12-42) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/Program.cs:108-118,186-227,321-354) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/LauncherStatus.cs:20,31,39) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/LauncherWindow.cs:18-57) (tools/Installer/PhantomFudge.iss:14-76)

The compact `install-manifest.json` contains release metadata and stays within the launcher's 16KiB bound. `payload-files.json` holds the full file inventory separately, including the compact manifest but excluding its own self-hash. The build enumerates hidden entries and rejects reparse points/private data; the fixture checks exact inventory coverage and installed hashes. Those are integrity checks, not publication or cross-version/clean-VM qualification. (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/LauncherContract.cs:38-52,94-105) (scripts/Build-Installer.ps1:56-98) (scripts/Test-Installer.ps1:40-54,96-104)

`--validate-install` succeeds on file/directory layout and valid compact metadata; it does not hash every payload/model file or execute those binaries. Validation returns0on success and65on missing/invalid installation data. Maintenance deliberately does **not** require compact metadata or old runtime executables, because it must remain usable for repair. The helper itself is a whole self-contained deployment, not a single-file executable. (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/Program.cs:25-43,94-100) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/LauncherStatus.cs:6-19) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/LauncherContract.cs:87-105) (tools/Installer/PhantomFudge.iss:47-49,143-147)

# 1. Source/legacy startup commands and argument semantics

The source/legacy operational sequence is:

```
# Explicit provisioning; may download dependencies and the pinned model.
.\scripts\Initialize-Transcription.ps1 -DownloadModel

# Start/reuse native Python and launch/reveal the application.
.\scripts\Run-PhantomFudge.ps1
```

```
# After stopping capture in the app, stop the owned idle service.
.\scripts\Stop-Transcription.ps1
```

| Command/switch | Exact implemented meaning |
|---|---|
| `Initialize-Transcription.ps1` | Verify/provision token and model; normally create/restore the service-local Python environment. |
| `-DownloadModel` | Permit downloading an absent model archive. A valid cached archive does not require another download. |
| `-SkipPythonSetup` | Skip environment/dependency setup, **not** token/model work. |
| `-Engine hybrid-whisper` | Native default: Vosk provisional text plus accurate local Whisper finals; `vosk` is an explicit legacy choice. |
| `-WhisperModel small.en` | Default accurate model; `base.en` explicitly selects a smaller alternative. |
| `-Vocabulary technical` | Default disclosed individual-word hints; `none` disables them. |
| `Start-Transcription.ps1` | Invoke the existing service-local interpreter with `manage.py start`. Missing setup fails; it is not installed here. |
| `Run-PhantomFudge.ps1 -NoBuild` | Skip source-build work; an executable must already exist. Packaged launches skip build regardless. |
| `-NotesOnly` | Skip service startup; it does not remove transcription controls or disable a separately running service. |
| `-PassThru` | Also return the launched process object, including the recovery process on the reveal path. |
| Start/Stop `-Docker` | Explicit optional container branch; never selected automatically. Start requires existing recipes/engine. |

Definitions: `Initialize-Transcription` parameters/provisioning (`scripts\Initialize-Transcription.ps1:1-24`, `scripts\Initialize-Transcription.ps1:78-165`); native/Docker branches (`scripts\Start-Transcription.ps1:8-36`, `scripts\Stop-Transcription.ps1:8-22`); launcher branches (`scripts\Run-PhantomFudge.ps1:1-57`). The launcher requires PowerShell 7.2 or later, prefers the packaged executable when present, and reveals an existing app at the expected executable path **before** any build/service operation. (`scripts\Run-PhantomFudge.ps1:1-37`, launcher.)

The application itself recognizes three exact two-argument diagnostic patterns: `--capture-proof outputDirectory`, `--ui-smoke outputDirectory`, and `--documentation-screenshots outputDirectory`. These dispatch capture/UI diagnostics, not ordinary headless unit tests. Unmatched argument shapes fall through to normal single-instance startup; there is no implemented `--ask`, input-selection, or automatic-capture CLI switch. (`src\PhantomFudge.App\App.xaml.cs:13-75`, `App.OnStartup`.)

# 2. Environment, defaults, and secret ownership

## Keyboard activation is a separate local setting

The optional `%LOCALAPPDATA%\PhantomFudge\keyboard.json` is loaded at app initialization. Use the exact three-property JSON and recovery guide: `schemaVersion: 1`, boolean `enabled`, and string `activationKey` (default `"K"`). Allowed keys are A–Z except E or F1–F11; F12 is reserved/rejected. Ctrl+Alt+NoRepeat remains fixed.

Missing settings use the default; malformed/unreadable settings disable the shortcut with a notice, while the Keys button remains available. Registration conflicts also retain Keys. Restart after editing; this is not the diagnostics reload action. (src/PhantomFudge.Core/KeyboardShortcutConfiguration.cs:7-28,31-114; src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Keyboard.cs:30-63.)

The command prompt uses the finite `KeyboardCommands.Parse` grammar, not a shell or model. See the complete command table. Answer font 8–24 is a session-only choice, **not** a permitted JSON property. The final exporter passed after correcting the configuration-error boundary to catch `InvalidDataException`. The guide records that bounded evidence; citation/atlas/book completion and external shortcut/foreground qualification remain separate. (src/PhantomFudge.Core/KeyboardCommands.cs:15-79; src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.AnswerFont.cs:9-43.)

## Speech environment and secret ownership

| Variable | Consumer, default, and precedence |
|---|---|
| `PHANTOM_TRANSCRIPTION_URI` | App speech endpoint; defaults to `ws://127.0.0.1:8765/v1/transcribe`. Launcher explicitly sets this value. |
| `PHANTOM_TRANSCRIPTION_TOKEN` | App initial token field, empty when absent. Server uses it only when a token-file setting is not supplied. |
| `PHANTOM_TRANSCRIPTION_TOKEN_FILE` | Server reads this file first; native manager supplies the workspace token-file path. It is not an app token-file setting. |
| `PHANTOM_TRANSCRIPTION_MODEL_PATH` | Required by production server; no implicit model download or default model directory in `server.main`. Manager supplies the pinned directory. |
| `PHANTOM_TRANSCRIPTION_WORKSPACE` | Shared mutable workspace; installed launch uses `PhantomFudge\InstalledRuntime` beneath LocalAppData. |
| `PHANTOM_TRANSCRIPTION_MODELS_ROOT` | Separate shipped-model root for the installed runtime; not the mutable `.local` data directory. |
| `PHANTOM_TRANSCRIPTION_HOST` | Server default `127.0.0.1`; only `127.0.0.1` and `0.0.0.0` accepted. Native manager overrides to loopback. |
| `PHANTOM_TRANSCRIPTION_INSTANCE` | Optional canonical UUID-hex identity; manager generates it. Without managed identity/callback, authenticated shutdown is unavailable. |
| `PYTHONDONTWRITEBYTECODE` | Manager sets `1` for its child. |
| `OPENBLAS_NUM_THREADS`, `OMP_NUM_THREADS` | Manager sets each to `1`; these are child environment settings, not WebSocket controls. |
| `PHANTOM_AUDIO_TEST_TOKEN` | Native fixture/playback harness credential; distinct from the application's token-variable name. |

Source: `MainWindow` initialization and `Start_Click` (`src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:50-65`, `src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:674-700`); launcher environment (`scripts\Run-PhantomFudge.ps1:43-55`); `load_token`, `main`, and `production_app` (`services\transcription\server.py:75-85`, `services\transcription\server.py:658-705`); manager child environment (`services\transcription\manage.py:229-242`, `start`); harness lookup (`tests\PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests\DualSyntheticServiceCheck.cs:24-27`, `RunDualSyntheticServiceCheckAsync`).

**Do not infer a port setting:** production `server.main` binds port 8765. The C# validator allows other valid ports on literal `127.0.0.1` or `[::1]`, but that does not reconfigure the server. It rejects `localhost`, remote hosts, `wss`, query credentials, fragments, user information, and normalized/escaped alternate paths. The default native server is IPv4 despite client IPv6-loopback acceptance. Redirects and proxies are disabled. (`services\transcription\server.py:695-712`, `main`; `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:26-31`, HTTP handler; `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:82-98`, `ValidateEndpoint`.)

Initialization generates 32 random bytes as 64 hexadecimal characters and restricts the Windows token DACL to the current user. Existing invalid tokens require explicit repair, not silent rotation. Manager/server validation requires `[A-Za-z0-9_-]{32,512}`; the native socket's broader lexical check is not the server's credential contract. Never put credentials in URLs or command arguments. (`scripts\Initialize-Transcription.ps1:42-76`, token setup; `services\transcription\manage.py:34-41`, `token`; `services\transcription\server.py:75-85`, `load_token`; `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:117-144`, `ConnectCoreAsync`.)

Engine/model pins are `vosk==0.3.45`, `aiohttp==3.14.3`, and English `vosk-model-small-en-us-0.15`. The archive is 41,205,931 bytes; its recorded hash is observed download identity, not a publisher-signed checksum. Runtime verifies the exact manifest file set and hashes before explicit-path model loading. (`services\transcription\requirements.txt:1-2`, dependency pins; `services\transcription\model.json:2-10`, manifest; `services\transcription\recognizer.py:25-63`, `verify_model`, `VoskFactory`.)

Those are the provisional/legacy pins, not the entire hybrid footprint. The native default also uses faster-whisper 1.2.1, CPU-int8 small.en and four CPU threads. Configuration lives in `.local\transcription-config.json`; schema/engine/model/thread/vocabulary fields are validated, both model families are checked before load, and missing accurate files never trigger fallback. (`services/transcription/configuration.py:8-34,60-69`; `services/transcription/accurate.py:75-81`; `services/transcription/provision_whisper.py:28-90`.)

# 3. Native management contract

```
.\services\transcription\.venv\Scripts\python.exe .\services\transcription\manage.py status
```

The source/legacy management workflow uses `start`, `stop`, or `status`; exit codes are `0` success, `1` runtime failure, and `64` invalid usage. Status reports `ready`, `active`, and `pid` when it authenticates a listener; no listener produces a textual status instead. The installed launcher's maintenance integration is documented separately above. (`services\transcription\manage.py:290-314`, `status`, `main`.)

Start/Stop/Status share a workspace byte-range lock. Ownership requires the receipt's UUID plus authenticated service name and management version, not merely a PID or occupied port. Reuse requires current speech capability and engine/model/source/dependency/vocabulary fingerprint. Automatic replacement is limited to an authenticated owned idle instance after verifying the selected models. Active, ambiguous, foreign, or unready instances are not silently repaired. (`services\transcription\manage.py:66-91`, `lifecycle_lock`; `services\transcription\manage.py:155-220`, ownership/capability/start decisions.)

The Python decision can be read as this JavaScript pseudocode:

```
if (listenerExists()) {
  const info = authenticateReceiptInstance();
  require(info.ready === true);
  if (supportsSpeechV2(info) && matchesRuntimeFingerprint(info)) return;
  require(info.active === false);
  verifySelectedModels();
  await authenticatedShutdownAndPortClosure();
} else if (receiptExists()) {
  clearOnlyConfirmedDeadOrRecycledProcessReceipt();
}
await spawnWithNewReceiptAndVerifyReadiness();
```

Management waits are phase-specific: lock acquisition 50 seconds, HTTP request 2 seconds, startup observation 45 seconds, shutdown-port wait 12 seconds. Failed shutdown/startup preserves ownership evidence rather than killing an arbitrary OS process. The request reader caps JSON at 4,096 bytes and forbids redirects/proxies. (`services\transcription\manage.py:44-91`, request/lock; `services\transcription\manage.py:186-273`, stop/start.)

# 4. HTTP routes

| Route | Authentication and successful response |
|---|---|
| `GET /health` | No authentication; `status` (`ready` / `unavailable`) and Boolean `modelAvailable`; HTTP 200/503. This is readiness, not ownership proof. |
| `GET /v1/runtime` | Bearer authentication; `service`, management `protocolVersion: 1`, `speechProtocolVersions: [1,2]`, `instanceId`, `pid`, `ready`, `active`. |
| `POST /v1/shutdown` | Bearer plus matching `X-Phantom-Instance`; no body; idle managed instance returns `{"status":"stopping"}`. |
| `GET /v1/transcribe` | Authenticated WebSocket upgrade; one active session, reserved before the start handshake. |

Authenticated runtime metadata additionally exposes engine/model/revision, configuration fingerprint, diagnostic availability and numeric queue/fault/drop bounds, including `maxStopSeconds:85`. This does **not** add fields to strict v1/v2 ready/stopped/speech messages or expose model paths. (`services/transcription/configuration.py:38-57`; runtime contract.)

These routes are registered by `create_app`. Runtime/shutdown/transcription reject query strings and bodies. Authentication requires exactly one Bearer header; nonempty browser Origin is rejected—403 on transcription, 401 on management. An identity mismatch or active shutdown attempt yields 409; unavailable speech yields 503. (`services\transcription\server.py:201-260`, `health`, `authorized`, management handlers; `services\transcription\server.py:538-563`, `transcribe`; `services\transcription\server.py:636-655`, `create_app`.)

# 5. Speech v1/v2 messages and bytes

Both versions use `/v1/transcribe`. Send one of these complete text messages after upgrade:

```
{"type":"start","sampleRate":16000,"channels":1,"encoding":"pcm_s16le"}
```

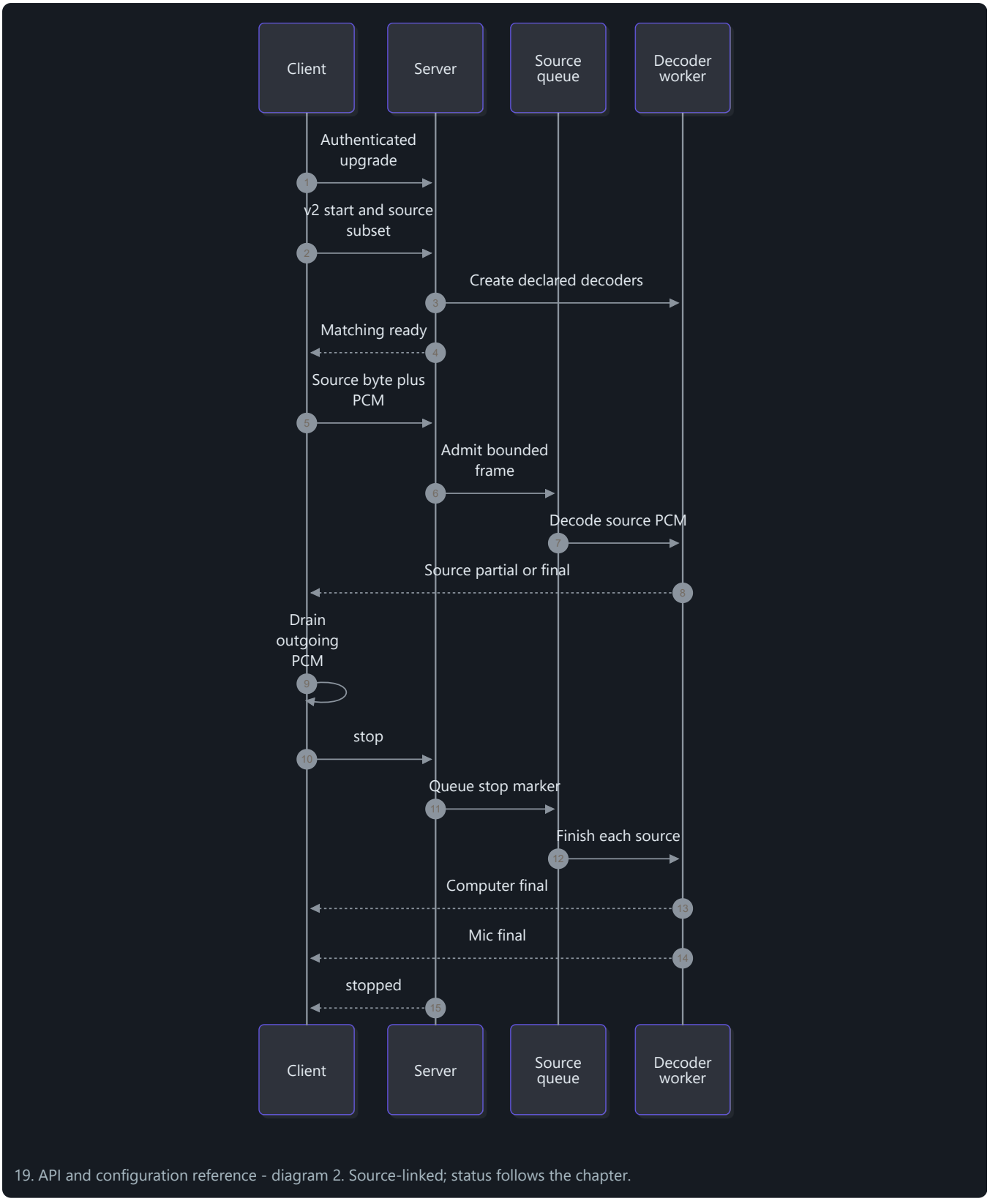
```
{"type":"start","protocolVersion":2,"sampleRate":16000,"channels":1,"encoding":"pcm_s16le","sources":
["computer","microphone"]}
```

V1 is Computer-only. V2 source subsets must be nonempty, unique, and canonically ordered: Computer alone, Mic alone, or Computer then Mic. Version/rate/channel values must be integers; extra fields or unknown sources fail. `ready` echoes the accepted start fields with a different `type`; v2 clients reject downgrade. (`services\transcription\server.py:100-112`, `parse_start`; `services\transcription\server.py:563-574`, ready construction; `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:416-435`, `ProcessMessage`.)

| Item | V1 | V2 |
|---|---|---|
| Binary message | Unprefixed PCM | Source byte, then PCM |
| Source byte | Absent | `1` Computer; `2` Microphone; must be declared |
| PCM | Signed 16-bit little-endian, mono, 16 kHz | Same, separate tracks—not mixed |
| PCM length | Even, 2–32,000 bytes | Same |
| Application-message length | 2–32,000 bytes | Odd, 3–32,001 bytes |
| Partial fields | `type`, `text` | Also `source` |
| Final fields | `type`, `text`, `segmentId`, `startSeconds`, `endSeconds` | Also `source` |

The server strips the prefix before validation/accounting. At 32,000 PCM bytes/second, 100 ms means 3,200 PCM bytes or 3,201 v2 message bytes; neither duration nor queue credit includes the prefix. (`services\transcription\server.py:26-28`, source/format constants; `services\transcription\server.py:319-357`, `Session.receive`; `services\transcription\server.py:361-392`, `Session.publish`; `src\PhantomFudge.Core\AudioSource.cs:3-23`, wire identities.)

Final IDs increase globally across the session, while final times and replacement partials are source-local. Thus Computer ending at 5 seconds followed by Mic ending at 2 seconds is valid. Labels identify inputs, not speakers. `{"type":"stop"}` stops the entire session; source-scoped commit and speech v3 remain **unimplemented**. The desktop Ask action freezes a snapshot and optionally invokes its configured installed answer provider; it is not a speech-protocol control or a direct Azure request. (`services\transcription\server.py:306-316`, control handling; `services\transcription\server.py:361-417`, publication/drain; `docs\DUAL-SOURCE-AUDIO.md:10-17`, identity boundary; `docs\AI-ANSWER-ARCHITECTURE.md:461-506`, proposed commit.)




19. API and configuration reference - diagram 2. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

Stop waits for a queue slot rather than discarding accepted PCM. Each declared source receives a final, even if empty, before `stopped`. Native drain has its own timeout and requires v2 stop-final evidence from every source; disconnection is not equivalent to completed drain. (`services\transcription\server.py:306-316`, `Session.receive`; `services\transcription\server.py:394-498`, `Session.recognize`; `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:241-289`, `StopAsync`; `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:463-474`, `ProcessMessage`.)

# 6. Resource defaults are code limits, not CLI knobs

| Boundary | Current default |
|---|---|
| Server control text | 1,024 UTF-8 bytes |
| Server queue per source | 64,000 PCM bytes **and** 32 frames; Both totals 128,000 bytes/64 frames |
| Native pending audio | 64,000 PCM bytes/source, 128,000 total; no server-style 32-frame/source cap |
| Server source rate credit | 64,000-byte burst, 32,000 bytes/s refill; 200-frame burst, 100 frames/s refill |
| Server start / idle / decoder / send waits | 5 / 15 / 5 / 2 seconds |
| Source duration ceiling | 28,800 seconds of received PCM, not wall time |
| Native connection / final-drain waits | 10 / 90 seconds; backend conservative maximum 85 seconds, not normal latency |
| Native capture startup / release waits | 10 / 5 seconds; separate from socket waits |
| Native idle-silence cadence | At least 250 ms without real packets, at least 100 ms between synthetic frames |
| Recognizer history rotation | Hybrid targets 15-second disjoint spans, at most 16 with a crossing frame; explicit legacy Vosk uses 30 seconds |
| Native response limit | 32,768 bytes, JSON depth 8 |
| Text limits | Server 8,192 Python characters; native 16,384 .NET string characters |

Defaults are declared in `Limits` and native constants/parser, not environment overrides. Per-source queue quotas cannot borrow another source's spare capacity. For 3,200-byte frames, the byte quota is twenty queued frames; tiny two-byte frames instead reach the server's frame quota first. (`services\transcription\server.py:45-59`, `Limits`; `services\transcription\server.py:280-357`, `Session`; `services\transcription\server.py:361-369`, text validation; `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:13-43`, constants/channel; `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:352-375`, `ReceiveAsync`; `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:439-449`, transcript parser.)

Hybrid provisional decoding has independent bounded source workers and a separate serial finalizer. At most two immutable final spans per source include the executing span. The final native-call deadline is 20 seconds, distinct from the provisional five-second decoder wait. A failed/timed-out native call is not silently retried as success. Span ownership is exact audio accounting, not word-aligned timestamps or an accuracy guarantee (`services/transcription/accurate.py:33-118`; recognition lifecycle).

Capture waits, silence scheduling, and decoder rotation are distinct mechanisms, not one end-to-end deadline or acoustic endpoint setting. A timed-out native release retains worker ownership and blocks unsafe restart; a delayed silence tick does not backfill elapsed time. (`src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:13-15`, constants; `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:82-85`, restart gate; `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:313-333`, `SupplySilenceAsync`; `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:408-426`, `FinishSessionAsync`; `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\SilenceCadence.cs:11-19`, scheduling; `services\transcription\recognizer.py:96-104`, rotation.)

# 7. Testing commands: choose the evidence layer

```
dotnet run --project .\tests\PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests -c Release
.\services\transcription\.venv\Scripts\python.exe -m unittest discover -s .\services\transcription\tests
```

The native harness is an executable, not an xUnit project; ordinary arguments filter test names case-insensitively. A filter matching nothing still returns success with zero checks, so inspect the reported count. Python protocol tests create isolated test servers with fake recognizers; they do not require a running production listener. (`tests\PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests\PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests.csproj:1-11`, executable definition; `tests\PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests\Program.cs:26-75`, `RunAsync`; `services\transcription\tests\test_protocol.py:23-62`, fixtures/setup.)

| Specialized entry | Inputs and side effects |
|---|---|
| `scripts\Test-DualSourceSynthetic.ps1 [-NativeClient]` | Generates in-memory speech; existing cached model and ephemeral loopback server. Switch builds/uses C# transport. |
| `services\transcription\tests\Test-DualSyntheticTranscription.ps1 [-ModelPath path]` | Cached-model Python integration; no playback, real token, or persistent service. |
| Harness `--service URI --synthetic-pcm - --expect phrase` | Raw synthetic PCM stdin, at most 60 seconds; connects to the supplied service using the test-token environment variable. |
| Harness `--service URI --synthetic-wave path --expect phrase` | Same v1 check, but an explicitly supplied synthetic PCM16 WAV. |
| Harness `--service-v2 URI --synthetic-tracks-stdin --expect-computer phrase --expect-microphone phrase` | JSON stdin containing two base64 PCM tracks, at most 60 seconds each; checks source-specific finals. |
| `scripts\Test-PlaybackTranscription.ps1 -AllowPlayback` | **Audible/hardware test:** plays synthetic speech and captures all default render-device output. Explicit approval and paused unrelated audio are required. |

These distinctions follow the actual wrappers and runners: `Test-DualSourceSynthetic` (`scripts\Test-DualSourceSynthetic.ps1:1-47`), probe `run` (`tools\DualSourceProbe\probe.py:19-65`), cached-model wrapper (`services\transcription\tests\Test-DualSyntheticTranscription.ps1:1-45`), v1 runner (`tests\PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests\Program.cs:78-136`), v2 runner (`tests\PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests\DualSyntheticServiceCheck.cs:10-79`), and playback wrapper/runner (`scripts\Test-PlaybackTranscription.ps1:1-14`; `tests\PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests\PlaybackCheck.cs:39-78`, `RunAsync`). The `--playback` executable branch itself has no `-AllowPlayback` switch: do not bypass the consent-bearing wrapper.

The repository's testing contract explicitly requires consent and paused unrelated audio for playback; ordinary development tests must not open the live microphone. (`AGENTS.md:65-67`, unattended-test boundaries.)

# 8. Errors and recovery interpretation

Service errors have exactly `type: "error"`, `code`, and a fixed safe `message`. The client replaces remote error text with its own generic message. Protocol errors normally attempt close code 1008; oversized transport messages can close with 1009 instead. (`services\transcription\server.py:29-72`, catalogue/`error`;

`services\transcription\server.py:194-198`, `close_with_error`; `src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:406-414`, error handling; `services\transcription\tests\test_dual_protocol.py:257-264`, transport-ceiling test.)

| Code | Meaning and first distinction to check |
|---|---|
| `auth`, `origin` | Credential/header failure versus unsupported browser-origin access. |
| `busy` | Another session owns admission; do not kill its process. |
| `bad_format` | Invalid start schema, version, source subset, or PCM format. |
| `bad_frame` | Invalid binary/control message, undeclared source, or disallowed request shape. |
| `backlog`, `rate_limit` | Queue/send pressure versus input arriving faster than permitted live rate. |
| `timeout`, `session_limit` | Expected-message wait expired versus source PCM-duration ceiling. |
| `decoder_error`, `model_unavailable` | Recognition failure versus unavailable readiness/model; neither invokes cloud fallback. |
| `server_stopping` | Service shutdown notification, not a successful transcription-completion acknowledgement. |

The meanings come from `ERRORS` and their enforcing paths. A decoder-operation failure marks runtime readiness failed; an idle-only managed restart cannot safely terminate a stuck native call. Repair and restart are deliberate operational steps, not promises of automatic recovery. (`services\transcription\server.py:29-42`, `ERRORS`; `services\transcription\server.py:147-181`, `Runtime.cpu`; `services\transcription\server.py:296-357`, receive limits; `services\transcription\server.py:620-626`, shutdown; `services\transcription\manage.py:186-200`, `stop_owned`.)

## Checkpoints and reference boundary

Before integrating, answer: Which component reads a token **file**? Does `modelAvailable` prove ownership? Why does a 3,201-byte message represent only 3,200 PCM bytes? Why must empty Mic finals precede `stopped`? The tables and cited functions above resolve these without inspecting generated private files.

This chapter describes source contracts, not running-service health, microphone quality or meeting compatibility. Local question state uses a256entry/64000character structured history and8192character draft ceiling. `Freeze` validates nonblank exact text and creates an immutable local snapshot, with no cloud setting or provider. Azure answers and v3 remain proposals, not available configuration options. (`src\PhantomFudge.Core\StructuredTranscriptStore.cs:13-22`; `src\PhantomFudge.Core\QuestionDraft.cs:8-9,90-103`; `docs\QUALIFICATION.md:1-7`.)

That is the local `Freeze` operation, not the whole Ask integration. Installed Agency is explicitly configured separately and uses one exact question per fresh session. Startup prepares one empty session, never an inferred model prompt (`src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.AnswerLifetime.cs:23-78`). Default local logs omit bodies; text opt-in, safe summary and local export are documented in Diagnostics and implemented with bounded records (`src/PhantomFudge.Core/Diagnostics/LocalDiagnostics.cs:20-24,40-69,132-159`).

For direct lookup, use the manager, HTTP/session implementation, native transport, initialization script, and fixture entry points. All references resolve to maintained source, not generated receipts or local credentials.

# 20 — Glossary and Repository Map

## Overview: vocabulary is part of the architecture

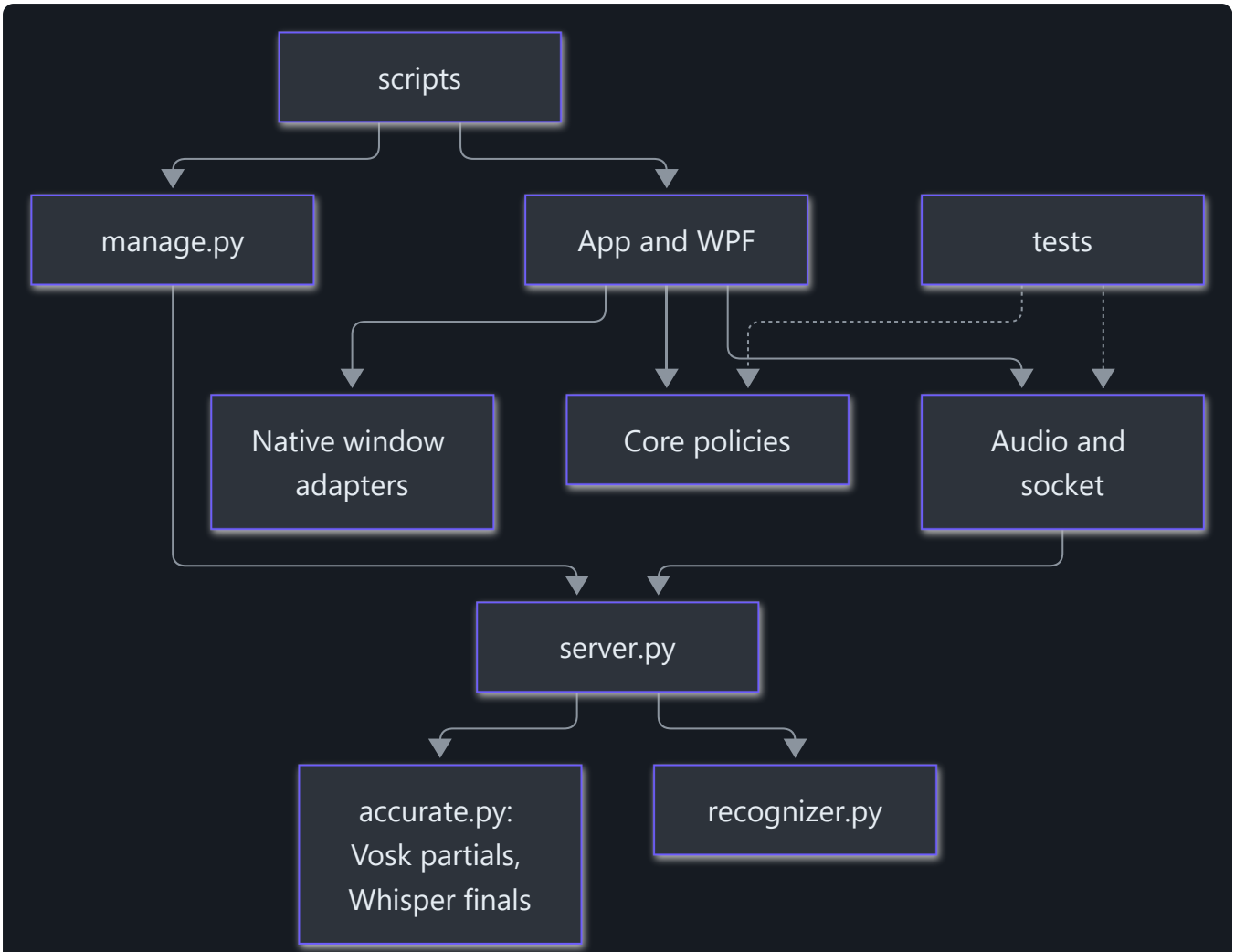
Many dangerous misunderstandings are substitutions between nearly related words: *source* becomes *speaker*, *configured* becomes *qualified*, or *stopped* becomes *fully drained*. This chapter makes those substitutions visible. A term is useful when it identifies an owner, a unit, or a completion condition—not merely when it expands an acronym.

For example, `AudioSource` names Computer and Microphone, while `Session.RequestStop` clears Running before cleanup finishes. Snapshot-only Ask freezes without sending; a configured installed provider can answer the exact question. Source-specific commit and direct Azure submission remain proposed operations. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\AudioSource.cs:3-30; src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:532-546; src\PhantomFudge.Core\QuestionDraft.cs:90-95; docs\AI-ANSWER-ARCHITECTURE.md:461-506)

Use this chapter as a junction rather than a replacement for the detailed chapters. Start with a question, locate the responsible boundary, then follow the cited function. Source establishes implementation; a test establishes its asserted conditions; qualification requires separate environmental evidence. (docs\QUALIFICATION.md:9-26)

## Architecture and repository map

The main dependency direction is native application → Core policies and local speech service. The service manager owns process lifecycle, not microphone capture. Recognition remains in Python; controls, selected WASAPI inputs, and transcript presentation remain in C#. (src\PhantomFudge.App\PhantomFudge.App.csproj:3-13; src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\WasapiInput.cs:20-54; services\transcription\manage.py:203-270; services\transcription\server.py:538-576)




20 — Glossary and Repository Map - diagram 1. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

This is an ownership map, not a claim that the manager processes PCM. `Run-PhantomFudge.ps1` starts the service unless NotesOnly is selected, then launches the app with a local endpoint; audio still requires `Start_Click`. (scripts\Run-PhantomFudge.ps1:39-55; src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:652-700)

| Repository area | Open this first; why |
|---|---|
| `src\PhantomFudge.App` | App entry, then `MainWindow`: startup, recovery, UI orchestration. `OnStartup` explicitly calls protected reveal. (src\PhantomFudge.App\App.xaml.cs:62-98) |
| `src\PhantomFudge.Core` | TranscriptBuffer and NoteFileStore: text/encoding policies without WPF controls. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\TranscriptBuffer.cs:6-39; src\PhantomFudge.Core\NoteFileStore.cs:10-44) |
| `services\transcription` | server.py owns protocol; recognizer.py owns Vosk adaptation; manage.py owns authenticated lifecycle. (services\transcription\server.py:636-654; services\transcription\recognizer.py:44-110; services\transcription\manage.py:155-200) |
| `scripts` | Run-PhantomFudge.ps1: source/package launch and existing-window recovery, not automatic recording. (scripts\Run-PhantomFudge.ps1:9-41) |
| `tests` | Core file tests and native harness: deterministic policies and synthetic protocol checks. (tests\PhantomFudge.Core.Tests\NoteFileStoreTests.cs:13-109; tests\PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests\Program.cs:26-75) |

| Repository area | Open this first; why |
| --- | --- |
| `spikes` and `tools` | CaptureProof project links diagnostic code; SpeechBench and DualSourceProbe serve separate experiments. (spikes\CaptureProof\CaptureProof.csproj:9-12; tools\SpeechBench\bench.py:1-25; tools\DualSourceProbe\probe.py:19-41) |
| `docs` and `TODO` | Qualification defines evidence; TODO index records dependencies and status, not executable behavior. (docs\QUALIFICATION.md:142-168; TODO\00_INDEX.todo:49-58) |
| Repository root | Solution lists projects; global.json pins SDK policy. Compose is optional, last-stage packaging—not a native prerequisite. (PhantomFudge.slnx:1-13; global.json:2-6; docs\IMPLEMENTATION-STATUS.md:263-266) |

# Navigation by question

New implementation seams are `WorkspaceLayout` for monitor-clamped reading dimensions, `MainWindow.AnswerLifetime` for retained provider preparation/teardown, and `LocalDiagnostics` for bounded metadata with explicit text opt-in. Accurate ASR lives behind the unchanged speech protocol in `accurate.py`; `configuration.py` fingerprints selected models/runtime inputs. (`src/PhantomFudge.Core/WorkspaceLayout.cs:8-42`; `src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.AnswerLifetime.cs:23-128`; `src/PhantomFudge.Core/Diagnostics/LocalDiagnostics.cs:20-24,40-69`; `services/transcription/configuration.py:38-69`.)

| Question | Read next |
| --- | --- |
| “Where do I start?” | Reading map, then newcomer guide |
| “Why isn't capture affinity a security boundary?” | Windows and cursors, assurance |
| “Which device produced these words?” | Dual-input capture, protocol |
| “Why does Stop take time?” | State machines |
| “Why is the service ready but nothing recorded?” | Native lifecycle, recognition |
| “What is saved, and what survives collapse?” | Storage, UI/themes |
| “Does the app already send questions to Azure?” | Proposed answer flow, identity/privacy |
| “Which experiment or check should I inspect?” | Testing, benchmarks, troubleshooting |

# Grounded glossary

## Audio: units before labels

| Term | Meaning here |
| --- | --- |
| **Sample** | One amplitude value. `VoskRecognizer.accept` counts one sample per two PCM bytes—not one sentence or callback. (services\transcription\recognizer.py:96-98) |
| **PCM16** | Signed 16-bit, little-endian pulse-code modulation. `StartMessage` requires this encoding; compressed audio is not interchangeable. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:13-24) |

| Term | Meaning here |
| --- | --- |
| **Sample rate** | Samples per second per channel: 16,000 in this contract, giving 32,000 PCM bytes/second for mono PCM16. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:13-23) |
| **Channel** | A waveform dimension, not a person. `WasapiInput` requests one channel for each independently selected input. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\WasapiInput.cs:48-54) |
| **Audio frame** | Here, a bounded transport payload: at most 32,000 PCM bytes. It is not a video frame or necessarily one sample frame. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:15-18,191-204) |
| **Chunk** | A convenient processing slice, not a fixed-duration semantic unit. `OnAudio` splits a callback's bytes into bounded transport pieces. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:234-270) |
| **Source** | Computer or Microphone, explicitly selected; `DisplayName` renders the latter as Mic. Identity describes origin, not speaker recognition. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\AudioSource.cs:3-30) |
| **Stream / track** | One source's ordered PCM and decoder state. Both tracks share a WebSocket without becoming one mixed waveform. (services\transcription\server.py:280-290,319-357,563-576) |
| **Session** | One negotiated transcription conversation: selected sources, decoders, queue, and global final-ID counter. It is shorter-lived than the service process. (services\transcription\server.py:280-290,563-606) |
| **Speaker** | A human identity the current source labels do not establish. Two voices on Computer remain Computer, not automatically separate people. (tests\PhantomFudge.Core.Tests\SourceTranscriptTests.cs:81-87) |
| **Loopback** | Capture of a render endpoint's output through `WasapiLoopbackCapture`, not capture limited to a particular meeting application. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\WasapiInput.cs:48-54; docs\PRODUCT.md:92-105) |
| **Endpoint** | The selected Windows audio device identified by ID, direction, and active state—not the WebSocket network address. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\WasapiInput.cs:64-74) |
| **ASR** | Automatic speech recognition: `VoskRecognizer.accept` turns PCM into recognition results. It does not answer the semantic question spoken aloud. (services\transcription\recognizer.py:96-110) |

## Transport and lifecycle: readiness is not recording

| Term | Meaning here |
| --- | --- |
| **WebSocket** | The persistent local message connection carrying source-prefixed binary PCM and text controls/results. `ConnectCoreAsync` negotiates the session first. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:144-169,217-227) |
| **Ready** | Scope matters: `Runtime.ready` describes service availability; a session `ready` response confirms negotiated format/sources. Neither means hardware capture already began. (services\transcription\server.py:143-145,563-576; src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:102-113) |
| **Backpressure** | More incoming work than bounded processing capacity permits. `TryEnqueueAudio` faults on overflow rather than silently dropping PCM and continuing. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:207-238) |
| **Stop** | A session-wide request: close audio admission, drain queued PCM, send `stop`, and await terminal recognition—not a source-only question commit. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:241-289,322-340) |
| **Drain** | Completion of previously admitted work. `Session.recognize` consumes queued audio before finishing every decoder and sending `stopped`. (services\transcription\server.py:306-316,394-498) |
| **IsRunning** | A current-activity flag, not proof of drain or released devices. `RequestStop` clears Running before asynchronous cleanup finishes. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\LoopbackTranscriber.cs:30,401-447,532-546) |
| **Service instance** | The manager's process-lifecycle identity. `start` generates an instance ID; it is not a transcript session ID or speaker ID. (services\transcription\manage.py:226-234) |

| Term | Meaning here |
| --- | --- |
| **Receipt** | Lifecycle metadata checked against authenticated runtime identity by `owned_info`; it is not a transcript or authorization to kill unrelated processes. (services\transcription\manage.py:94-165) |
| **Authentication token** | The local shared credential checked by `authorized`, not an Azure identity or a model token-count unit. (services\transcription\server.py:210-215) |

## Text and storage: provisional, durable, and dirty differ

| Term | Meaning here |
| --- | --- |
| **Partial** | Replaceable unfinished recognition, held separately per source by `SetPartial`; appending every revision would duplicate words. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\TranscriptBuffer.cs:10-19,41-46) |
| **Final** | A recognizer-finalized segment, possibly empty. `AddFinal` clears only its source's partial; “final” does not certify transcription accuracy. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\TranscriptBuffer.cs:48-72) |
| **Segment ID** | Session-global ordering across sources, not a durable cross-session identifier. `publish` increments one counter; `BeginSession` resets the UI baseline. (services\transcription\server.py:378-388; src\PhantomFudge.Core\TranscriptBuffer.cs:35-38) |
| **Audio-relative timestamp** | Position in a source's audio timeline, not wall-clock meeting time. `publish` checks bounds against that source's received PCM duration. (services\transcription\server.py:361-388) |
| **Session reset** | `BeginSession` retains earlier history and marks unfinished text before resetting IDs/partials. It is not `Clear`. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\TranscriptBuffer.cs:23-39,79-85) |
| **Export** | Explicit file persistence of a text snapshot, including labelled unfinished recognition. `ExportTranscriptAsync` writes text, not raw audio. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:828-863; src\PhantomFudge.Core\TranscriptBuffer.cs:75-77) |
| **Dirty** | Current text differs from the last successful save/export baseline. It does not mean the disk file was checked recently. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:303-304,424-438) |
| **UTF-8 byte cap** | `Fits` permits at most 1 MiB encoded bytes; character count alone is insufficient for multibyte Unicode. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\NoteFileStore.cs:12-24) |
| **BOM** | Optional three-byte UTF-8 signature, preserved in `NoteSnapshot` and included in the byte budget—not visible document text. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\NoteFileStore.cs:19,41-44,56-58) |
| **Fingerprint** | SHA-256 of file bytes used by `VerifyUnchangedAsync` for optimistic conflict detection, not encryption or a tamper-proof vault. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\NoteFileStore.cs:41-44,83-95) |
| **Staged rename** | `WriteAsync` writes and flushes bytes beside the destination, rechecks, then moves. This narrows failure exposure without eliminating check-to-move races. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\NoteFileStore.cs:53-80) |

## Desktop: pixels, focus, and discovery are separate

| Term | Meaning here |
| --- | --- |
| **HWND** | Native window handle obtained by `EnsureHandle`; capture affinity is configured on this object, not on every surface in the process. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Native\WindowProtection.cs:24-37) |
| **Visual tree** | WPF's nested content/control structure. Inline setup and confirmation panels belong to `MainWindow`; an external dialog is a different boundary. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml:116-130,195-210,536-606) |

| Term | Meaning here |
| --- | --- |
| **DWM** | Desktop Window Manager composition, checked and flushed by `Configure`; a flush is not independent recipient observation. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Native\WindowProtection.cs:25-28,46-48) |
| **Affinity** | Here, display affinity `0x11`: a Windows capture-exclusion request. It is unrelated to CPU affinity and not universal invisibility. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Native\WindowProtection.cs:16-48; docs\QUALIFICATION.md:9-26) |
| **Opacity** | The root background brush's alpha, 10–100%; `BackgroundOpacity_ValueChanged` does not fade the whole window or glyphs. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:482-489,1087-1091) |
| **Taskbar presence** | Shell presentation controlled by `ShowInTaskbar` and tool-window styles, not proof of picker omission or hidden processes. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml:5-8; src\PhantomFudge.App\Native\WindowProtection.cs:30-32; docs\QUALIFICATION.md:13-18) |
| **Focus** | Keyboard/foreground interaction state, distinct from visibility and cursor shape. `UpdateInteractionControls` changes focusability separately from content. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:278-293) |
| **Present** | Default passive, read-only interaction mode; it neither starts capture automatically nor certifies the sharing configuration. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:33-36,278-293,652-700) |
| **Edit** | Deliberate focusable editing. `TogglePresentationAsync` currently hides and stops transcription before switching—not a purely cosmetic toggle. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:253-275) |
| **Arrow** | Standard local cursor shape set by `CursorPolicy`, not an instruction controlling a recorder's separate pointer stream. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Native\CursorPolicy.cs:8-24; docs\CURSOR-AND-THEMES.md:47-61) |
| **Semantic theme** | Named color roles converted into WPF resources by `ThemeBrushes.Apply`; appearance changes do not constitute content or session replacement. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\ThemePalette.cs:5-29; src\PhantomFudge.App\ThemeBrushes.cs:9-41) |

## Plans and evidence: naming is not implementation

| Term | Meaning here |
| --- | --- |
| **Commit** | Planned source-scoped finalization through a negotiated watermark/acknowledgement—not current global Stop, and not a Git commit. (docs\AI-ANSWER-ARCHITECTURE.md:461-506) |
| **Ask** | Explicitly freeze the exact draft; snapshot mode stays local, while configured Agency/local-model mode submits to that provider. Azure submission is future work, and v2 still has no Ask/commit control. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\QuestionDraft.cs:90-95; services\transcription\server.py:306-316) |
| **QuestionSnapshot** | Implemented immutable exact question text/revision with copied local source provenance, provisional/edit flags and a monotonic creation timestamp. It is not proof of submission. (src\PhantomFudge.Core\QuestionSnapshot.cs:5-23) |
| **Synthetic fixture** | Deliberately generated test content. `RunUiSmokeAsync` uses synthetic text/devices; visual-tree renders are not screen-sharing captures. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:920-968,1205-1218) |
| **Qualification** | Configuration-specific recipient/recording evidence with controls and explicit outcomes; neither build success nor API readback substitutes for it. (docs\QUALIFICATION.md:9-26,79-107) |
| **Preview** | Implemented development software with open release gates, not “planned only” and not a universally supported release. (docs\IMPLEMENTATION-STATUS.md:1-3,358-367) |

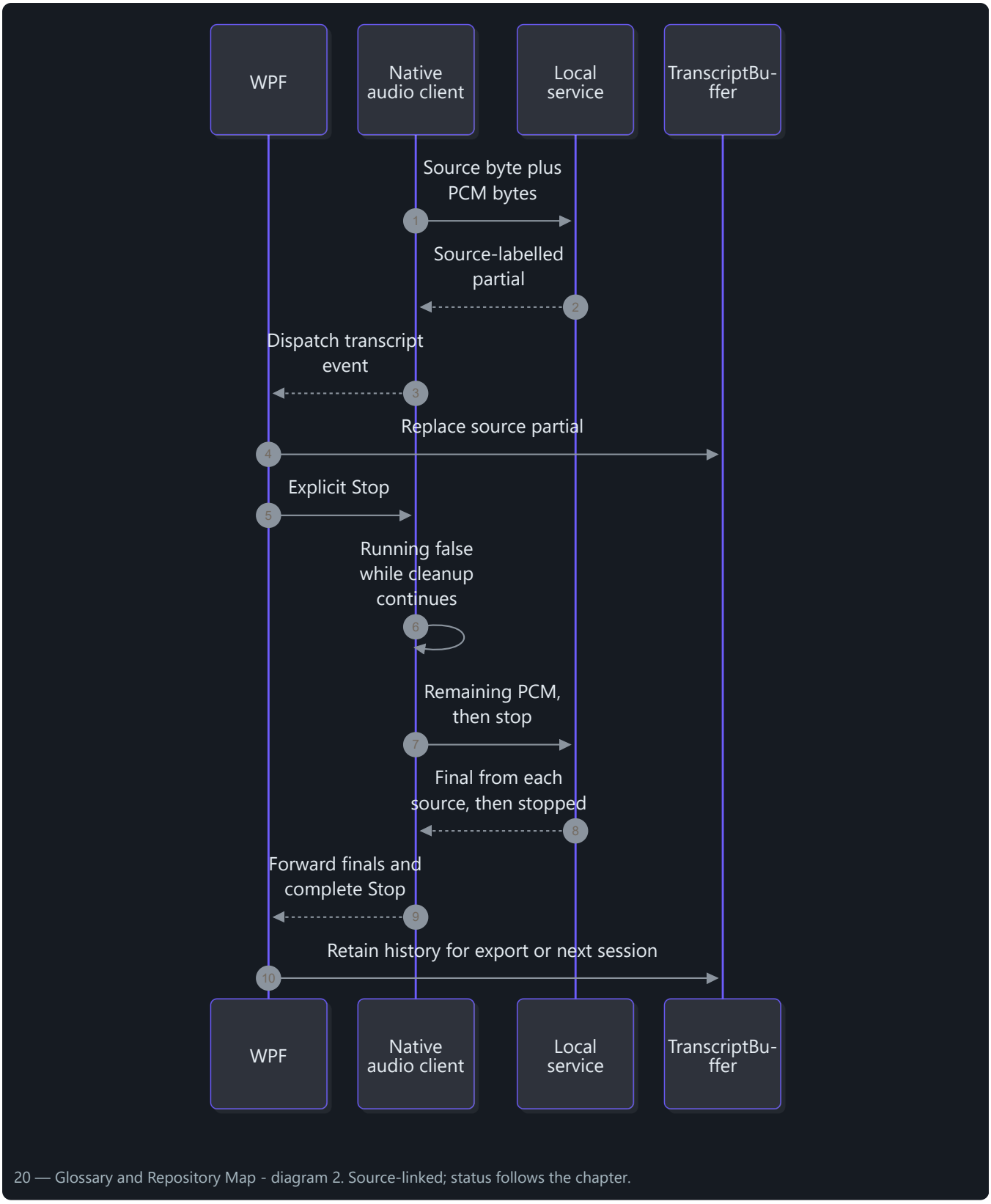
# Data flow: one worked boundary trace

A 100 ms mono PCM16 block at 16 kHz contains 1,600 samples and 3,200 PCM bytes. Protocol v2 adds one source byte, so the binary message contains 3,201 bytes. It still represents one source, not 3,201 samples or one recognized sentence. `TryEnqueueAudio` explicitly keeps PCM length separate from prefixed wire bytes. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:13-17,217-227)

C#'s `ReadOnlySpan<byte>` and Python's `bytes` describe byte containers, not automatic sample counters. `VoskRecognizer.accept` performs the byte-to-sample conversion explicitly; changing languages does not change the units. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:194-204; services\transcription\recognizer.py:96-98)

This Python-shaped arithmetic is explanatory, not production capture code:

```
samples = 16_000 // 10
pcm_bytes = samples * 2
wire_bytes = 1 + pcm_bytes
assert (samples, pcm_bytes, wire_bytes) == (1600, 3200, 3201)
```




20 — Glossary and Repository Map - diagram 2. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

The diagram shows a graceful path, not a guarantee after transport or device failure. Python's stop sentinel follows queued PCM; the client validates finals before terminal acknowledgement; the UI holds `audioStopping` until its awaited operation finishes. (services\transcription\server.py:306-316,394-498; src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\TranscriptionSocket.cs:446-474; src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:763-793)

# Glossary pitfalls and review exercises

**“Two streams means two speakers.”** No: independent source tracks prevent state mixing, not acoustic echo or multiple voices sharing one endpoint. Inspect source labels before inferring people. (docs\PRODUCT.md:92-105)

**“Final means saved.”** No: final concerns recognizer state; export concerns filesystem persistence. The buffer can contain finals while `TranscriptDirty` remains true. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:303-304,828-855)

**“Hidden means stopped and exited.”** No: Hide awaits Stop but retains the process and content; Exit separately evaluates unsaved work. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:239-250,306-340)

**Exercise:** Is 100% background opacity stronger capture exclusion than 10%?
**Answer:** No. Brush alpha and native affinity are independent mechanisms. (src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:482-489; src\PhantomFudge.App\Native\WindowProtection.cs:36-48)

**Exercise:** Can an idle ready Python service contain several successive sessions?
**Answer:** Yes. Session admission is released after cleanup; service identity need not change. (services\transcription\server.py:549-576,601-606)

# References and maintenance rule

Follow the repository links above for implementation; use qualification for evidence and answer architecture for proposed contracts. Update a glossary entry when its owner, units, or completion condition changes—not merely when a class is renamed. Preserve the implemented/planned distinction until the corresponding call path exists.

# 21. Evidence and Roadmap

## Why evidence needs its own architecture

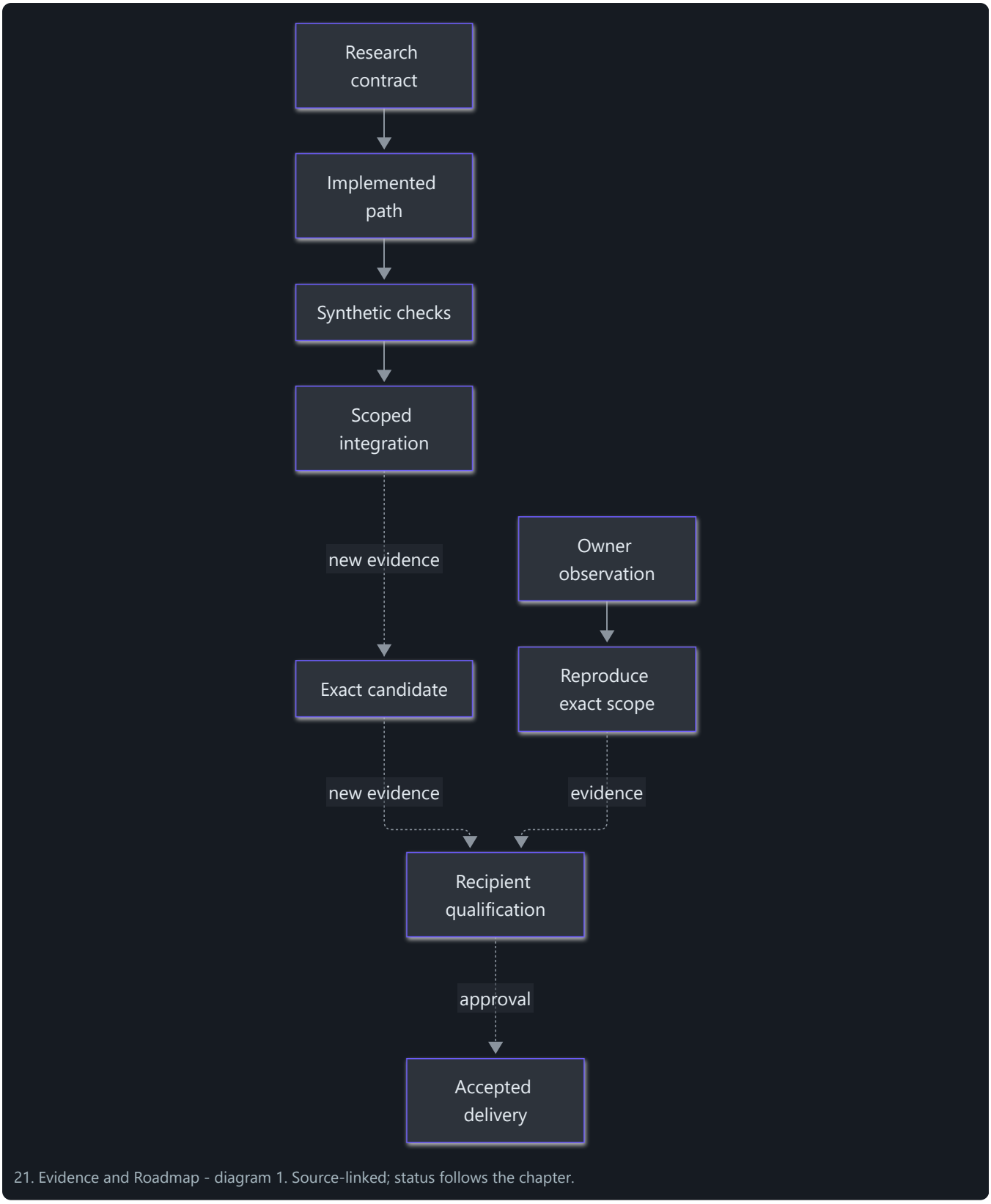
A living engineering book must distinguish **what exists**, **what was observed**, and **what is justified for users**. Phantom Fudge has an implemented native preview and recorded local results; it does not have a qualified public release or an implemented Azure answer feature. A plausible design, passing synthetic test, and owner acceptance answer different questions. Combining them into one “done” badge would discard the most important information. (docs\IMPLEMENTATION-STATUS.md:3-230, current scope; docs\TODO-CONVENTIONS.md:58-70, evidence classes.)

This chapter reads the frozen application source and current public evidence summaries. It does not rerun application tests, inspect private capture receipts, requalify a package, or perform cloud/audio operations. “Recorded result” below means the cited repository reports that observation, not that this documentation session independently repeated it. The qualification contract explicitly rejects substituting local previews, API return codes, or missing recordings for recipient evidence. (TODO\13_COMPATIBILITY_QUALIFICATION.todo:24-35, acceptance and evidence.)

The engineering unit of assurance is therefore a **bounded claim**: a behavior, an exact subject, an environment, a procedure, an observation, and its limits. The repository's result template already asks for source identity, package hash, operating system, GPU, sharing backend, positive controls, frame coverage, and reviewer approval. A result without those boundaries may help investigation, but should not silently widen support. (docs\QUALIFICATION.md:142-168, result record.)

## The evidence ladder: stronger claims require additional proof

The ladder is not permission to infer the next rung. Each transition requires evidence appropriate to its scope; an owner report remains a separate observation until reproduced under a known configuration. (docs\TODO-CONVENTIONS.md:64-70, noninterchangeable evidence; docs\CURSOR-AND-THEMES.md:45-62, unresolved owner report.)




21. Evidence and Roadmap - diagram 1. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

| Evidence class | What it establishes | What it cannot establish alone |
| --- | --- | --- |
| Primary research | A documented API capability or proposed design | This account's permissions or a working integration |
| Source inspection | An implemented branch and its invariants | Successful execution on a user's machine |

| Evidence class | What it establishes | What it cannot establish alone |
|---|---|---|
| Synthetic checks | Behavior under controlled inputs and injected failures | Real microphone quality or recorder compatibility |
| Real engine, synthetic PCM | Model/protocol integration without live capture | Real-speaker, room, echo, or meeting accuracy |
| Scoped hardware observation | A particular device path actually worked | Other devices, capture backends, or environments |
| Exact-package qualification | Observed behavior for an identified candidate/configuration | All future versions or unsampled frames |
| Owner/release acceptance | Deliberate approval of delivered scope | A universal privacy or invisibility guarantee |

These distinctions are instantiated by the native-runtime evidence, dual-source integration limits, qualification procedure, and final acceptance gates. (TODO\22_NATIVE_PYTHON_RUNTIME.todo:30-38, native results; TODO\26_MICROPHONE_AND_COMPUTER.todo:34-41, synthetic integration; docs\QUALIFICATION.md:79-107, capture procedure; TODO\17_RELEASE_ACCEPTANCE.todo:13-29, acceptance.)

## Configuration is not observation of captured pixels

`WindowProtection.Configure` checks Windows/DWM conditions, sets window styles and affinity, inspects available readback, and flushes composition. None of those calls observes another participant's screen. `ShowProtected` configures before showing and reports an unqualified-preview status. This is implemented failure-prevention logic, not recipient certification. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Native\WindowProtection.cs:19-48, `Configure`; src\PhantomFudge.App\MainWindow.xaml.cs:99-129, `ShowProtected`.)

Similarly, `CursorPolicy.SetArrow` sets the local standard cursor. It does not choose the recorder's cursor-capture option. The owner's reported disappearing shared cursor is credible as a reported symptom, while its exact product/backend reproduction remains missing. Local Arrow and nonactivation evidence cannot close that gap. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Native\CursorPolicy.cs:8-24, `SetArrow`; docs\CURSOR-AND-THEMES.md:47-61, recorder boundary.)

# What the current evidence actually says

The earlier dual-source update records **41 Core tests, 46 native synthetic groups, 71 backend tests, and four manager-upgrade guards**. The subsequent local-question slice adds96Core cases, bringing that historical Core run to137, and repeats the46native groups with GUID identity assertions. Python's s71cases remain earlier evidence, not a fresh run for the C#-only change. These are distinct scopes, not one interchangeable total. (docs\IMPLEMENTATION-STATUS.md:226-234, earlier dual-source evidence; local-question receipt.)

The recorded real Python recognizer processed generated dual-source PCM with Computer/Mic partial counts of **11/8** and three finals each. The actual C# v2-to-Python path produced **13/10** partials and two finals each, with expected phrases and tail drain. “Real” describes the engine and transport; the input was still synthetic. No physical microphone, device-permission, echo, or OS-indicator qualification follows. (docs\IMPLEMENTATION-STATUS.md:226-230, integration results.)

Two earlier observations have different boundaries:

- An explicitly approved playback-loopback check recorded 11 partials, three finals, 37 nonzero-meter updates, expected phrase matching, and zero faults. That establishes one actual render-endpoint path, not the later dual-input hardware matrix. (docs\IMPLEMENTATION-STATUS.md:328-340, playback evidence.)
- A cropped GDI proof reported a 100,000-differing-pixel positive control and 16 protected samples matching the underlying baseline. That is specific BitBlt evidence, not continuous startup-frame coverage or Teams/Zoom/Meet/OBS qualification. (docs\IMPLEMENTATION-STATUS.md:329-336, synthetic capture evidence.)

The public speech benchmark covers **32 synthetic cases, 164.070 seconds, and 292 normalized reference words**, with two serial warm passes. Its recorded results are:

| Engine | WER | Median warm decode |
|---|---:|---:|
| SAPI en-US dictation | 45.89% | 10.139 s |
| Vosk small-en-us-0.15 | 8.22% | 41.754 s |
| Whisper base.en, CPU int8 | 4.79% | 25.745 s |

Those values are present in the public receipt, not extrapolated from model names. WER is normalized edit count divided by reference words, not a general accuracy percentage. File RTF is throughput, not live latency. Two paced Vosk first partials near 0.96 seconds and finals near 3.807 seconds are measured **from stream start**, not end-of-speech lag. Vosk was then the streaming implementation; the October 9 hybrid adoption is measured separately below. (tools\SpeechBench\results\synthetic-20261008.json:13-22, run metadata; tools\SpeechBench\results\synthetic-20261008.json:65-173, `summary`; docs\SPEECH-BENCHMARK.md:66-123, metrics and timing; TODO\23_SPEECH_ENGINE_BENCHMARKS.todo:31-35, disposition.)

# October 9 corrections: fresh evidence, bounded claims

The new local implementation expands the requested window to 1240 x 1520 clamped to monitor work area, removes outer main-panel scrolling, adds exact white/black reading text and makes answers share background transparency. Fifteen synthetic WPF image fixtures cover the new appearance; none records a meeting or establishes recorder compatibility (`src/PhantomFudge.Core/WorkspaceLayout.cs:8-42`; `src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Layout.cs:58-111`).

The paced synthetic speech study reports Vosk WER 12.04% versus hybrid small.en technical-final WER 4.40%, CER 6.37% versus 0.263%, and final median/p95 2.736/3.017 seconds. This is a different corpus from October 8; raw compound-word errors, homophones and failed policies remain preserved. Service 104 and benchmark 18 tests are recorded, with no actual microphone qualification (`tools/SpeechBench/results/quality-validation-20261009.json:1-40`; quality record).

Final model selection uses the owner's exact intended and reported ASR text: the H batch produced three prepared GPT-5.6 Sol Fast / low complete answers in 4066/4176/2992 ms. All three C# answers compiled and passed 33 full-range checks. Earlier E used different wording; F wrong-problem/follow-up and G overflow failures remain failures. Forty-eight client submissions were counted across the correction study. Cold

preparation around 20–31 seconds remains outside the five-second result (`tools/AgencyProbe/results/latency-suite-20261009-h-exact-fast.json:1-56`; `tools/AgencyProbe/results/latency-suite-20261009-h-quality.json:184-186`).

Default diagnostics now provide bounded metadata rather than retroactive claims about the old interaction. Text is an explicit local opt-in and export strips it by default; raw audio, notes and tokens remain excluded (`src/PhantomFudge.Core/Diagnostics/LocalDiagnostics.cs:18-24,40-69`; `scripts/Export-Diagnostics.ps1:14-80`).

# A preview artifact is an identity, not a release claim

The historical installed-provider bundle before the quality correction was:

```
artifacts\phantom-fudge-0.1.0-preview-win-x64-20261008-235421.zip
Size: 76,252,854 bytes
Contents: 489 files
Recorded SHA-256:
88D98E7CAFA56B067A521571778D0F661A879DDCBF5EBBE9D412987D2BFA5A69
```

The new archive was hashed and its exact executable exercised with the synthetic fixture. Question checks include immutable/no-auto-send behavior, source/session isolation, editing without audio cancellation, multiline fidelity and minimum layout, with no real recording/model call. The first source attempt's unexplained foreground assertion failure is retained; later source and package passes do not establish universal activation or recipient behavior. Earlier145231/123245/ 035959bundles are historical, not alternative qualification for183107. (Current implementation receipt; packaging evidence.)

The publication script creates a timestamped self-contained x64 preview, refuses overwrite, copies selected documentation/scripts/service source, archives the result, and prints its hash as a **local unqualified preview**. Running that script would not satisfy clean-machine, signing, recipient, or release gates. The latest package was generated for the implementation milestone, not as proof of release qualification. (scripts\Publish-Preview.ps1:10-52, publication flow; TODO\14_PACKAGING_RELEASE.todo:13-30, remaining acceptance.)

# What still needs qualification

**Recipient pixels:** the required meeting/OBS candidates remain `NOT_TESTED`. Record product/version, exact sharing source and backend, local visibility, remote live view, applicable recording, positive controls, and transitions. A window/tab result cannot justify whole-screen support; a missing licensed recording capability is not a pass. A black rectangle can fail the intended experience even without readable text. (docs\QUALIFICATION.md:3-7, status; docs\QUALIFICATION.md:28-64, matrix and artifact criteria; docs\QUALIFICATION.md:79-107, procedure.)

**Cursor:** reproduce the owner's report in the actual sharing mode and record hover/click/drag/type, foreground changes, and recipient cursor behavior independently. Do not substitute a fake cursor, recorder modification, or the local value `MA_NOACTIVATE=3` for that observation. (TODO\24_CURSOR_AND_FOCUS.todo:14-26, open gates; docs\QUALIFICATION.md:127-137, C15.)

**Hardware and usability:** microphone access/denial, selected-device loss, echo, privacy indicators, headsets, alternative GPU/display/DPI/HDR combinations, startup transitions, accessibility, and long-session behavior remain scoped work. The code selects render versus capture endpoints explicitly; source inspection proves that branch exists, not that every physical configuration works. Owner readability/focus approval remains separate from automated success. (src\PhantomFudge.App\Audio\WasapiInput.cs:20-74, selection and `Direction`; TODO\26_MICROPHONE_AND_COMPUTER.todo:34-41, hardware gaps; docs\QUALIFICATION.md:66-77, environments; docs\IMPLEMENTATION-STATUS.md:358-367, remaining work.)

The owner handles permission and recipient rehearsal externally; those preferences removed repeated runtime confirmations. They are not an engineering pass, and this roadmap does not reintroduce those dialogs. (docs\PREVIEW-GUIDE.md:79-84, interaction contract; TODO\16_DEVELOPMENT_LEDGER.todo:63-65, decision record.)

# Roadmap: statuses describe scope, dependencies describe order

The current index covers workstreams **01–43**; documentation work adds an ongoing maintenance obligation without changing the implemented-versus-planned application boundary:

| IDs | Current disposition |
|---|---|
| 01–12 | 02 research is DONE; 11 accessibility is NOT_STARTED; the remaining product/core workstreams are IN_PROGRESS. |
| 13–18 | 13 qualification, 17 acceptance, and optional 18 future scope are NOT_STARTED; 14 packaging, 15 guide, and 16 ledger are IN_PROGRESS. |
| 19–26 | 22 native runtime and 23 benchmark are DONE; 20 Docker is NOT_STARTED; 19, 21, and 24–26 remain IN_PROGRESS. |
| 27 | DONE for research/design only. |
| 28 | DONE for local selected/typed drafts and immutable snapshots; provider submission is supplied separately by39. |
| 29–35 | NOT_STARTED: commit, approved Azure connection, real client/UI, evaluation, resilience, and answer acceptance. |
| 36–37 | NOT_STARTED optional cloud-ASR and conditional broker extensions. |
| 38 | DONE for the initial illustrated book and public journal; workflow06 continues maintenance with later changes. |
| 39 | DONE for installed Agency/local-model adapters; one Agency synthetic request and local/package checks passed with bounded evidence. |
| 40–43 | Local quality-correction scope: readable workspace, accurate local finals, direct prepared answers and diagnostics. Current completion/evidence is in the TODO index; broad UX/hardware/latency qualification is not closed. |

“DONE” is scoped: a local Ask snapshot does not mean cloud submission or answers exist. `NOT_STARTED` does not automatically mean `BLOCKED`; the latter requires a concrete attempted-work blocker and needed action. Stable numbers are not execution order. (TODO\00_INDEX.todo:49-58, statuses; docs\TODO-CONVENTIONS.md:40-56, dependency semantics.)

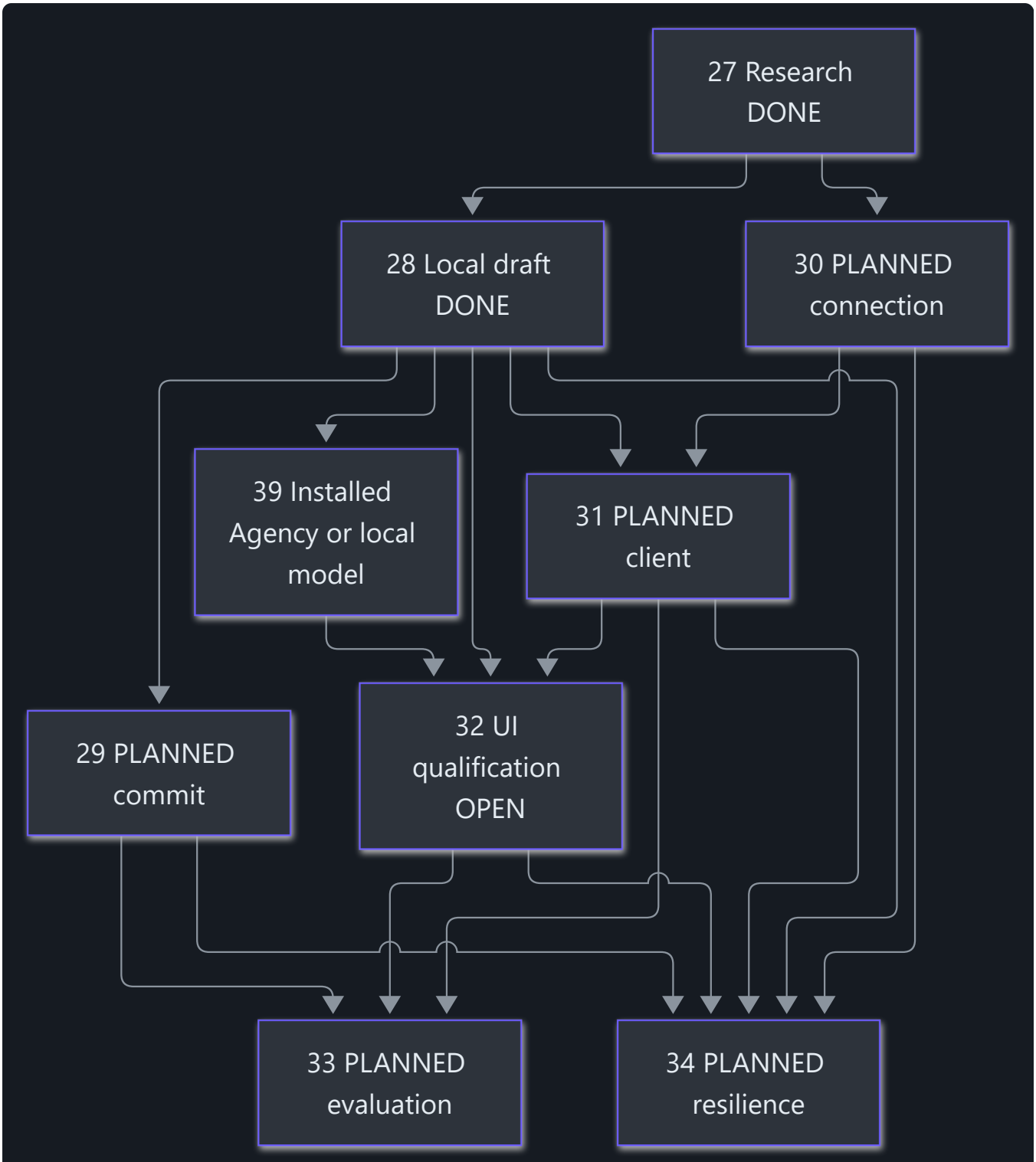
## Candidate, qualification, and release




21. Evidence and Roadmap - diagram 2. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

The diagram abbreviates native prerequisites, not their completion requirements. Packaging **14 precedes qualification 13**; the current expanded release graph also includes planned answer client/UI/resilience work. Final acceptance 17 requires 13, 14, 15, and 35. Docker **20 is LAST, optional, and depends on 17**—never a prerequisite for ordinary transcription or native release. Recipe files do not prove a container ran. (TODO\00_INDEX.todo:121-160, dependency map; TODO\14_PACKAGING_RELEASE.todo:3-5, prerequisites; TODO\20_DOCKER_LOCAL_SERVICE.todo:3-10, final-stage contract; TODO\20_DOCKER_LOCAL_SERVICE.todo:29-36, execution limits.)

## Installed answers exist; commit, Azure and qualification remain open




21. Evidence and Roadmap - diagram 3. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

The local selected/typed draft and immutable snapshot are implemented. Continue with source-specific start/commit boundaries and approved cloud connection, not an automatic deployment. The target remains local ASR and direct C# streamed text in the same protected UI. Azure identity/resource/geography approvals, actual model availability, and latency measurements remain future gates. Optional 36 depends on 27 and 33;

conditional 37 depends on 27 and 30, neither silently becoming mandatory. (TODO\00_INDEX.todo:137-150, answer dependencies; TODO\27_AI_ANSWER_RESEARCH.todo:13-32, research-only scope; docs\AI-ANSWER-ARCHITECTURE.md:671-753, delivery and unresolved decisions.)

# Worked review algorithm: promote claims, not enthusiasm

The following is explanatory pseudocode for reviewing evidence, not an implemented tool or a test executed here. Its checks derive from the exact-candidate and positive-control requirements. (docs\QUALIFICATION.md:79-107, procedure; TODO\14_PACKAGING_RELEASE.todo:22-30, candidate freeze.)

```
def assess_support_claim(claim, evidence):
    matching = [e for e in evidence
                if e.artifact_hash == claim.artifact_hash
                and e.configuration == claim.configuration]
    if not matching:
        return "NOT_TESTED"
    if any(e.observed_readable_content for e in matching):
        return "FAIL_CONTENT_LEAK"
    if any(e.observed_unacceptable_artifact for e in matching):
        return "FAIL_ARTIFACT"
    if not has_required_controls_and_recipient_frames(matching):
        return "INSUFFICIENT_EVIDENCE"  # review result, not a matrix status
    return "SCOPED_PASS_CANDIDATE"      # still needs review and acceptance
```

For example, a claim that the `145231` package supports Teams desktop sharing cannot be promoted using an older cropped GDI result. Both artifact and capture scope differ. Likewise, an owner's rehearsal preference cannot replace the missing recipient record. Retain failed and unavailable cases; changing a binary or backend makes prior results historical rather than transferable. (docs\QUALIFICATION.md:24-26, version changes; docs\QUALIFICATION.md:166-168, exact artifact; docs\IMPLEMENTATION-STATUS.md:236-242, historical dual-source package.)

# Keeping the book honest as the project changes

Reviewing the book exposed historical wording that no longer matched the implementation. The summary now describes Computer/Microphone/Both and labels its initial-preview evidence historical; workstream17 distinguishes the existing preview from unstarted final acceptance; Workstream13 follows the current C01-C19 scenario set. These corrections preserve the earlier journey without erasing implemented work or promoting a local package to a qualified release. (docs\IMPLEMENTATION-STATUS.md:310-319, corrected summary and historical heading; TODO\17_RELEASE_ACCEPTANCE.todo:31-37, final acceptance scope; TODO\14_PACKAGING_RELEASE.todo:45-57, local artifacts; TODO\13_COMPATIBILITY_QUALIFICATION.todo:18-21, current scenario list; docs\QUALIFICATION.md:127-137, added scenarios.)

**Current documentation coordination:** workstream **38** is **DONE for the initial local edition**. Its receipt records the generated HTML/PDF, reviewed illustrations and freshness result. Workflow **06**, `06_LIVING_DOCUMENTATION.todo`, is **DONE as a procedure definition**, with ongoing execution **IN_PROGRESS**: future feature changes still need matching book updates. This is documentation completion, not application

release acceptance. The documentation update did not replace the current preview ZIP. (TODO\38_LIVING_DOCUMENTATION.todo:3-22, status and tasks; TODO\WORKFLOWS\06_LIVING_DOCUMENTATION.todo:3-11, definition/execution distinction; docs\IMPLEMENTATION-STATUS.md:376-382, documentation edition boundary.)

The public journal now supplies the narrative counterpart to the operational ledger. Future behavior changes require corresponding chapter, citation, diagram, image, and journal maintenance. Mechanical freshness detects drift in recorded inputs, but cannot prove semantic correctness or discover every uncited feature; human source review remains necessary. This extends the evidence discipline instead of relaxing application qualification. (JOURNAL.md:8-16, journal scope; docs\DOCUMENTATION-MAINTENANCE.md:12-27, completion requirements; docs\DOCUMENTATION-MAINTENANCE.md:69-81, freshness limitations; TODO\00_INDEX.todo:195-203, documentation definition of done.)

# Exercises and references

1. Classify the dual-source PCM result, owner cursor report, and Azure latency target. For each, write one supported claim and one prohibited inference. (docs\IMPLEMENTATION-STATUS.md:226-230; docs\CURSOR-AND-THEMES.md:47-61; docs\AI-ANSWER-EVALUATION.md:45-62.)
2. Given a rebuilt package with unchanged UI, identify which previous qualification claims must become historical and which observations remain useful diagnostics. (docs\QUALIFICATION.md:24-26, version semantics.)
3. Trace why completing optional Docker or cloud-ASR work cannot close native release 17. (TODO\00_INDEX.todo:143-150, release dependencies.)

Continue with the implementation evidence, qualification matrix, TODO index, ledger, public journal, and maintenance contract. The benchmark and answer architecture provide detailed measured-versus-planned boundaries.

# Desktop source walkthrough

## Why the desktop needs separate state boundaries

The difficult problem is not displaying text. It is preventing one action from accidentally authorizing another: revealing is not capture certification, choosing **Both** is not starting audio, editing a question is not editing Notes, and receiving an interpretation is not permission to send confirmation. The implementation expresses those distinctions through separate fields, immutable snapshots and guarded event handlers—not through separate windows. The central predicate is now `PassiveWindow => presenting && !questionEditing && !KeyboardControlActive`; question typing or deliberately armed keyboard control can take focus while Notes remain read-only. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Questions.cs:24) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.xaml.cs:278)

This chapter follows the desktop source. The table below records the earlier reviewed atlas snapshot, not a new coverage receipt for the in-progress keyboard increment. The source atlas carries authored explanations and selected excerpts; its reading guide explains navigation. Core and audio dependencies have separate source groups.

### Current increment: keyboard intent without cursor manipulation

`MainWindow.Keyboard` owns activation, guarded mode transitions and best-effort previous-window return. `KeyboardSelection` separates the current-row key from selected segments and requires Enter review before the beginner Ctrl+Enter path. `KeyboardDevices` moves a card cursor without selecting until Space. `AnswerFont` retains a nullable session choice ahead of the responsive default; it does not write settings. These paths use local key routing, not global letter capture, and do not lock/hide/warp the system pointer. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Keyboard.cs:65-175,218-306; src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.KeyboardSelection.cs:10-28,110-159; src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.KeyboardDevices.cs:42-71; src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.AnswerFont.cs:9-43.)

The important lifecycle distinction is ordinary mode preservation versus explicit actions: `:devices` refuses busy audio/answers and opens setup, which closes Q/A; `:stop` stops audio, `:cancel` affects answers/preparation, and `:clear question` retains existing cancellation. The canonical guide owns keys, JSON, illustrations and final runtime-fixture evidence. The maintained atlas covers all new and changed files; diagnostic definitions alone must still be distinguished from the actual synthetic receipts. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Keyboard.cs:320-368; src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.KeyboardDiagnostics.cs:209-214.) The compact layout now separates intended Q/A expansion from rendered visibility. Select/Search borrow its space for transcript selection; leaving restores Q/A without its close/cancel handler. Other compact keyboard modes and chosen size 14+ answers prioritize Q/A while retaining transcript content. This does not change wide columns or capture/provider lifetime. The canonical compact-layout section records the size 24 / 470 × 560 motivation and final synthetic fit checks without implying owner comfort or external foreground qualification.

`LoadKeyboardShortcut` catches invalid-data failures as well as other configuration errors. `RefreshKeyboardEditorTarget` keeps Edit armed across submission and switches between the original and reply only when that target is visible, enabled, focusable and editable. Async focus changes require an already-active, visible, uncovered, protected app; they never activate it from another application. The final synthetic checks wait a normal dispatcher turn rather than re-entering Edit. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Keyboard.cs:38-51,127-139,301-306; src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.KeyboardDiagnostics.cs:170-193.)

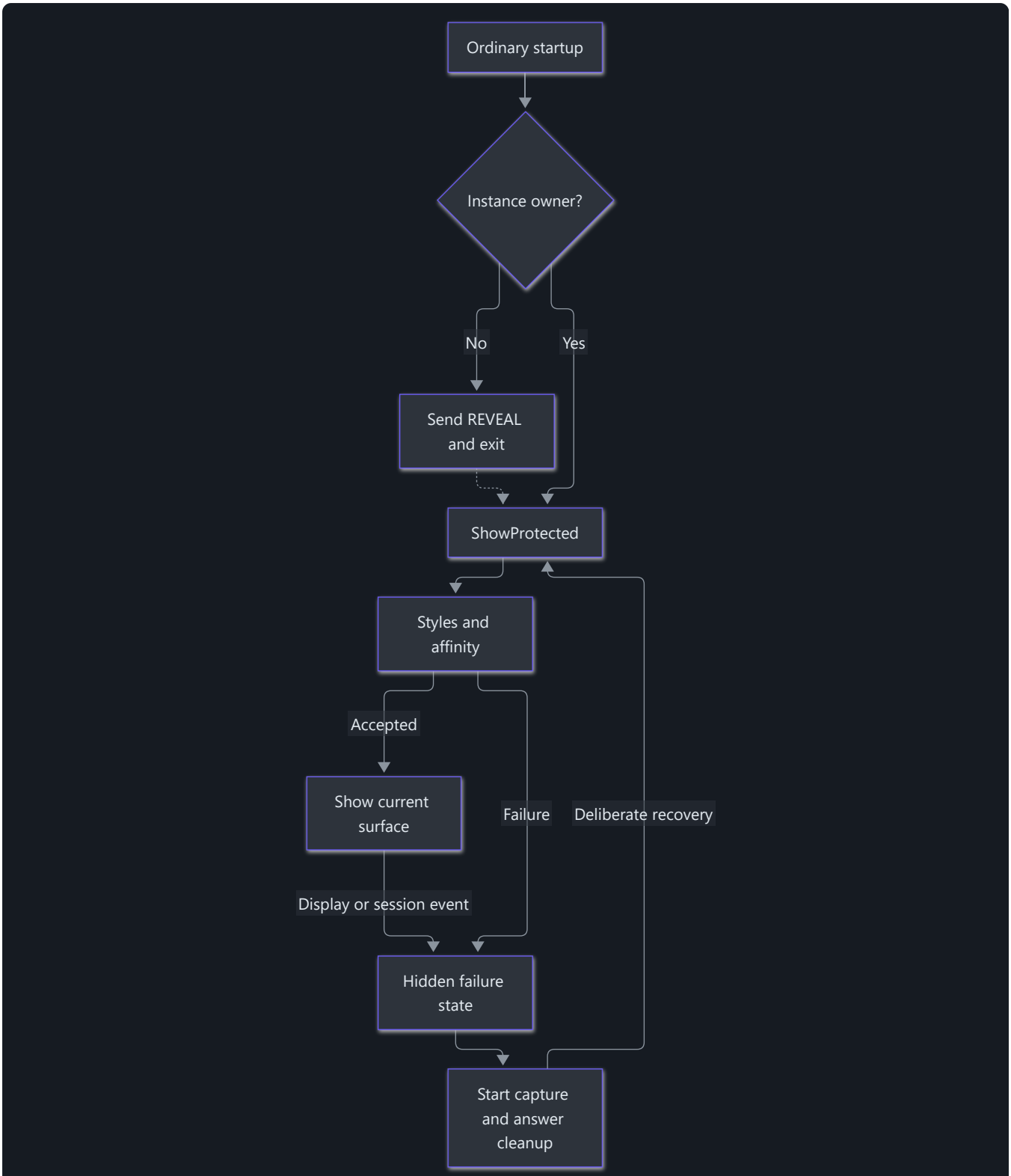
| Reading route | Assigned files | Physical lines | Authored blocks |
|---|---|---|---|
| Startup, failure notice, project declaration | 3 | 155 | 10 |
| Four native adapters | 4 | 252 | 13 |
| Application/window XAML and theme brushes | 3 | 946 | 38 |
| Main window coordinator and layout | 2 | 1,411 | 46 |
| Questions, direct selection, clarification | 3 | 669 | 23 |
| Answers and provider lifetime | 2 | 468 | 17 |
| Indicator, diagnostics and synthetic UI assertions | 8 | 1,173 | 45 |
| Audio device-card layout and paging | 1 | 160 | 6 |
| Visual cover lifecycle | 1 | 78 | 4 |
| **Total** | **27** | **5,312** | **202** |

The project declares a Windows .NET 10 WPF executable, a Core reference and NAudio 2.2.1; that declaration is not evidence of a build or device qualification. Selection/clarification increments 44/45 are source-only, and the historical `045022` ZIP excludes them. Direct Azure remains future work and Docker remains optional/last, not prerequisites of these handlers. (src/PhantomFudge.App/PhantomFudge.App.csproj:1) (TODO/00_INDEX.todo:39)

# 1. From process startup to protected reveal

`App.xaml` uses explicit shutdown and no `StartupUri`. Consequently, WPF does not automatically display a startup window before application code can configure it. `App.OnStartup` first handles exact command-line modes: explicit provider preparation, capture proof, UI smoke or documentation screenshots. Ordinary startup then constructs `SingleInstance`. A nonowner sends a six-byte `REVEAL` command and exits; the owner installs dispatcher-marshalled recovery callbacks and calls `ShowProtected`. (src/PhantomFudge.App/App.xaml:1) (src/PhantomFudge.App/App.xaml.cs:18) (src/PhantomFudge.App/App.xaml.cs:62)

Recovery is deliberately narrow. `SingleInstance` hashes the current SID to name its channel, uses a `Local` mutex and `CurrentUserOnly` pipes, and accepts no file path or arbitrary text command. Connection/write uses a five-second deadline; the server gives an established peer two seconds to supply six bytes. It compares those six bytes with `REVEAL`, not the entire remainder of a peer stream. Mutex ownership is session-local; the hashed name itself is not a secret. (src/PhantomFudge.App/Native/SingleInstance.cs:18) (src/PhantomFudge.App/Native/SingleInstance.cs:28) (src/PhantomFudge.App/Native/SingleInstance.cs:51)




Desktop source walkthrough: one window, explicit intent - diagram 1. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

The diagram's reconfiguration path is implemented by `RevealAndReset → TryReveal → ShowProtected`; initial startup failures instead reach `App.OnStartup`'s catch and shutdown. `ShowProtected` clears readiness, configures native protection, repairs placement, attaches first-use hooks/hotkeys, updates controls and only then calls `Show`. `Configure` itself does not hide the window: callers performing interaction transitions hide first. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.xaml.cs:99) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.xaml.cs:146) (src/PhantomFudge.App/App.xaml.cs:77)

The consequential native distinction is:

```
var readback = GetWindowDisplayAffinity(handle, out var affinity);
var readbackError = readback ? 0 : Marshal.GetLastPInvokeError();
if (readback && affinity != ExcludeFromCapture)
    throw new InvalidOperationException("Capture-affinity readback contradicts the requested setting.");
```

An unavailable getter is recorded as unavailable; a successful contradictory getter aborts. Before this, Windows build 22000 and DWM composition are required, unrelated style bits are preserved, ToolWindow is added, AppWindow removed and NoActivate selected by interaction mode. Setter failure is fatal. `DwmFlush` follows, but none of these operations observes recipient pixels. “Capture protection requested” is therefore the accurate UI wording. (src/PhantomFudge.App/Native/WindowProtection.cs:19) (src/PhantomFudge.App/Native/WindowProtection.cs:30) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Layout.cs:36)

Detected display/session/power invalidation clears readiness, hides immediately, cancels the answer and awaits activity cleanup. Generic failure notices contain fixed messages, not note text or exception bodies. Ctrl+Alt hotkeys use `RegisterHotKey`, not a keystroke hook; collision leaves second-launch recovery available. Listener disposal cancels first and disposes its token source only after the listener finishes. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.xaml.cs:178) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.xaml.cs:228) (src/PhantomFudge.App/LocalFailureNotice.cs:11) (src/PhantomFudge.App/Native/WindowHotkeys.cs:13) (src/PhantomFudge.App/Native/SingleInstance.cs:79)

# 2. Resources, alpha and hit regions are behavioral code

The window is layered, topmost and initially nonactivating. `WindowChrome` supplies a 38-unit caption and six-unit resize border; the title ignores hit testing, while header actions explicitly opt into client hit testing within chrome. Without that exception, clicking an apparent button could begin a window drag. Text areas remain client regions, not custom drag handles. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.xaml:5) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.xaml:112) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.xaml:135)

The background slider does **not** change whole-window opacity:

```
var alpha = (byte)Math.Round(Math.Clamp(args.NewValue, 10, 100) * 255 / 100);
var background = ThemeBrushes.Color(ThemePalette.For(currentTheme).Background);
WindowSurface.Background = new SolidColorBrush(Color.FromArgb(alpha, background.R, background.G,
background.B));
```

Only the root brush receives alpha. Reading controls have transparent backgrounds and opaque high-contrast foregrounds; opaque toolbar/setup surfaces remain readable. Theme changes replace frozen semantic brushes and then reapply the existing slider value. `HighContrastReading` is a separate palette role, not the ordinary muted chrome text color. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.xaml.cs:482) (src/PhantomFudge.App/ThemeBrushes.cs:9) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.xaml:523)

Dynamic `ControlsFocusable` connects App-level button/list/checkbox templates to interaction state. Text boxes retain WPF's `PART_ContentHost`, while custom scrollbar templates change both page commands and dimensions for horizontal orientation. Direct transcript rows intentionally differ from normal chooser rows: selection changes an outline, not the transparent fill. Null-segment separators are disabled. A transparent

rendering surface is not click-through. (src/PhantomFudge.App/App.xaml:14) (src/PhantomFudge.App/App.xaml:48) (src/PhantomFudge.App/App.xaml:177) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.xaml:77)

Placement converts native work-area pixels through `TransformFromDevice`, then fits logical bounds. At 900 units the reader becomes two columns; narrow short layouts sometimes replace transcript space with source tools or clarification replies. Each reader scrolls internally. The geometry assertions measure line-height/padding, width and containment above Notes; they do not establish accessibility or readability over every background. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Layout.cs:41) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Layout.cs:58) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Layout.cs:155) (src/PhantomFudge.Core/WorkspaceLayout.cs:12)

# 3. Follow a transcript click into a question

Audio setup is a separate inline workspace: measured cards wrap by source and use explicit pages only when they do not fit. The full item collections and selected records remain intact; hiding a card on another page does not change capture identity. Visibility, size and collection notifications coalesce a layout refresh, while capture lifecycle guards reject page changes. See `LayoutDeviceCards` and its synthetic viewport/selection checks.

There are three representations for three different jobs:

| Representation | Responsibility | Important distinction |
|---|---|---|
| `TranscriptBuffer` | Display/export text and unfinished labels | Not the source of question identity |
| `StructuredTranscriptStore` | Session/source/segment identity and revisions | Bounded chooser can evict old records |
| `TranscriptRow` and `QuestionDraft` | Visible history plus copied explicit selection | Selected text can survive store eviction |

These responsibilities follow `ReceiveTranscript`, `AppendFinalTranscriptRow` and `QuestionDraft.ReplaceSelection`, rather than being inferred from names. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.xaml.cs:796) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.TranscriptSelection.cs:13) (src/PhantomFudge.Core/QuestionDraft.cs:18)

An audio event first passes its capture GUID check. `LoopbackTranscriber` stamps events from its own session before invoking the subscriber; a stale dispatcher callback therefore cannot relabel itself as the new session. Only diagnostic rendering may supply the current GUID for an unstamped synthetic event. Accepted events update export text, structured state and then row presentation. Those updates are sequential, not a transaction across both stores; invalid data/capacity stops capture and leaves memory available for export. (src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/LoopbackTranscriber.cs:95) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.xaml.cs:798)

Direct row clicks toggle `IsSelected` and consume the preview event. The selection handler:

1. Rejects missing protection, file work, manually edited drafts or a clarification lock.
2. Applies additions/removals to a dictionary keyed by structured identity.

3. Orders visible selections by main-history rows followed by partial rows, not click order; copied entries outside the view are retained.
4. Calls `ReplaceSelection`, then opens Q/A, closes tools and calls `SetQuestionEditing(true)`.

That final call deliberately takes keyboard focus; direct transcript clicks are **not** passive device/chooser clicks. They do not call Freeze, StartAsync or a provider prompt.
(src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.TranscriptSelection.cs:85)
(src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.TranscriptSelection.cs:118)

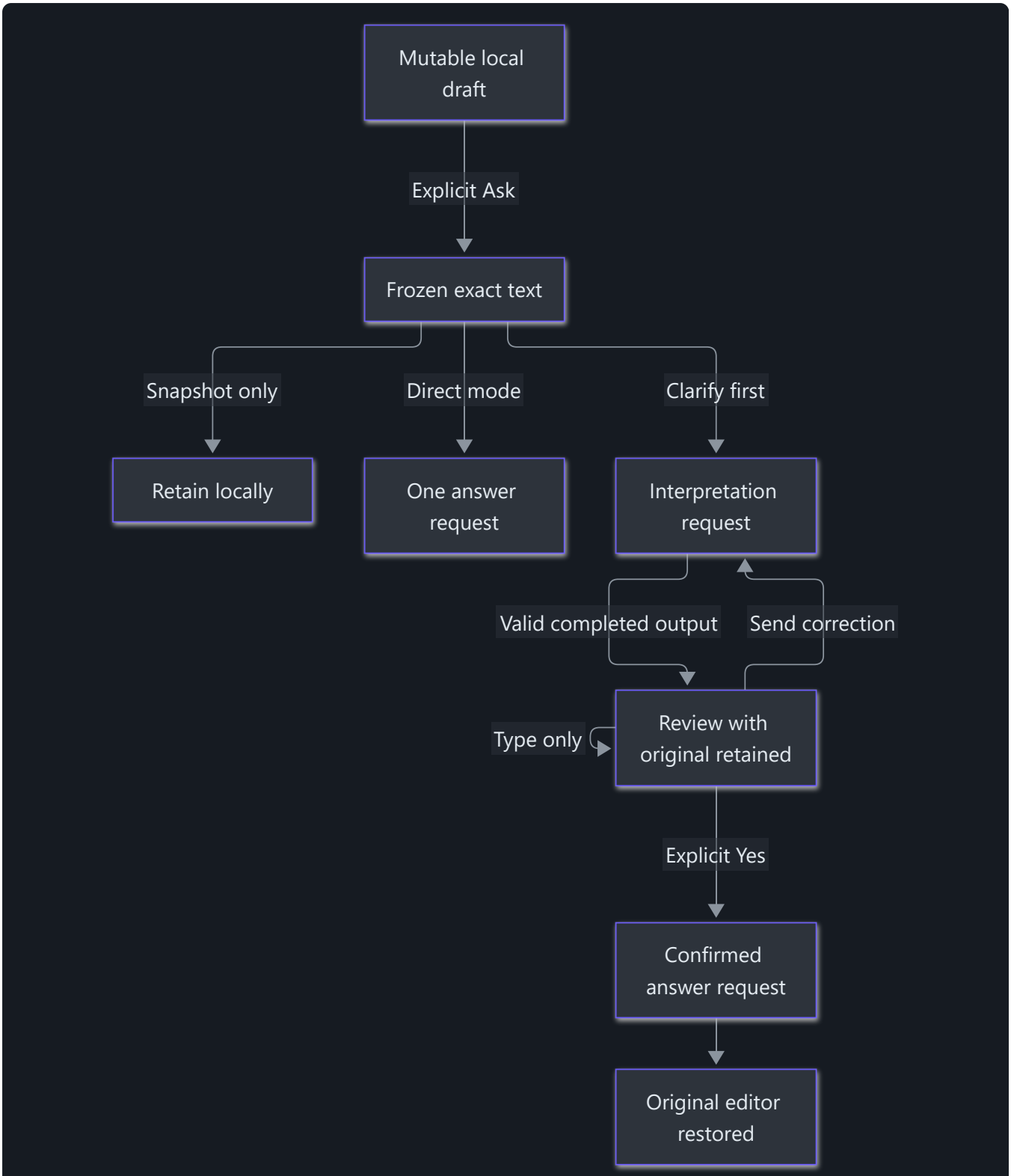
`ReplaceSelection` validates a complete candidate before assigning state: one session, at most 256 distinct keys and 8192 UTF-16 code units including inserted platform newlines. It copies raw `segment.Text`, so literal `[Computer]` inside speech is not stripped or interpreted. Selected partials refresh by the same key/revision; manual edits block ASR replacement. Main rows outlive the smaller structured chooser, and appending a final scrolls only when already near the end. (src/PhantomFudge.Core/QuestionDraft.cs:18)
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/QuestionDraft.cs:61)
(src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.TranscriptSelection.cs:22)

**Do not unify the two selection handlers by assumption.** Manual **Choose source → Use selected** is explicit replacement: it checks clarification lock and empty selection but does not contain the direct handler's `UserEdited`, `protectionReady` or `fileBusy` checks. It can deliberately replace an edited draft. Documentation must describe that difference rather than claim every path has identical guards.
(src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Questions.cs:105)

Independent question typing hides, changes `questionEditing`, updates controls and reapplies protection before focus. It never calls `StopVisibleActivityAsync`; global Notes Edit does. Routing both actions through global Edit would therefore violate continuing dictation.
(src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Questions.cs:158) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.xaml.cs:253)

# 4. Original question, submitted text and reply are not interchangeable

Ordinary Ask checks reply/busy/readiness/protection/file guards, freezes the draft and displays its `ExactText`. SnapshotOnly stops there. Configured direct Ask creates an `AnswerRun`; its request contains a fresh request ID and exact text, not the entire snapshot's source provenance. The Agency direct prompt adds fixed answer-only policy but no clarification history, requesting a standalone answer without follow-up input. A policy instruction is not proof of every model's compliance. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Questions.cs:265)
(src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Answers.cs:136) (src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AnswerRun.cs:15)
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AgencyAnswerPrompt.cs:89)



Desktop source walkthrough: one window, explicit intent - diagram 2. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

Clarify first starts unchecked and its backing Boolean defaults false. Opting in only changes state; the next explicit Ask stores `clarificationOriginal` and begins an unconfirmed request. `ClarificationLocksQuestion` starts immediately, whereas `AwaitingClarificationReply` requires completed history. A cancelled/failed first interpretation can therefore leave the original locked without a reply panel; clear or mode change resets the

flow rather than treating partial output as an accepted interpretation. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.xaml:321) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Clarification.cs:11) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Clarification.cs:39)

Replies use a **new temporary draft**:

```
var metadata = new AnswerClarification(IsConfirmationReply(reply), clarificationHistory);
metadata.ValidateFor(reply);
var draft = new QuestionDraft();
draft.EditText(reply);
var snapshot = draft.Freeze();
```

The original `questionDraft` remains untouched. `lastQuestionSnapshot` now records this submitted reply, even when that reply is `" yEs "`. Confirmation recognition trims and compares case-insensitively, but does not normalize `ExactText`. The Yes button refuses to discard a non-Yes written correction. Copy original still copies the original draft, not the reply. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Clarification.cs:85) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Clarification.cs:117) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Clarification.cs:134) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Questions.cs:307)

Before accepting an interpretation, `ValidateClarificationResult` checks that appending it still leaves a valid explicit Yes transaction. Core limits are four interpretations, 8192 units per text and 32768 total context units. No silent history trimming occurs. Acceptance additionally matches both current run reference and clarification request ID; confirmed completion unlocks the original but sends nothing further. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Clarification.cs:157) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Clarification.cs:166) (src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AnswerClarification.cs:9)

# 5. Cancellation means “stop accepting,” then “finish cleanup”

`AnswerBusy` follows task completion, not run state. `CancelAnswer` first makes the run terminal and cancels its token, preserving already received text; `StopAnswerAsync` still awaits the task before disposing cancellation state and the Agency provider. A 120-second linked deadline is distinguished from user cancellation. Every streamed event checks current run identity/state, and Core separately validates request ID, increasing sequence and terminal completion. Clear nulls the visible run, so late work cannot repopulate that pane. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Answers.cs:26) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Answers.cs:177) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Answers.cs:271) (src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AnswerRun.cs:32)

The shutdown ordering is intentionally short:

```
var capture = stopCapture();
var provider = stopProvider();
return Task.WhenAll(capture, provider);
```

Capture-stop **initiation** precedes provider cleanup, but neither whole cleanup is awaited before starting the other. Replacing this with `await stopProvider(); await stopCapture();` would postpone the capture stop behind a slow provider. Audio stop itself coalesces repeated calls and cancels pending startup before awaiting the transcriber. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.AnswerLifetime.cs:12) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.xaml.cs:763)

Agency preparation is separate from answering: an empty session may be warmed at startup/reveal, but no question prompt is submitted by `WarmUpAsync`. Preparation/shutdown tasks, readiness, a deferred-prepare latch and a closing flag govern ownership. Cleanup failure sets closing rather than silently authorizing reuse. Terminal handlers queue button reevaluation because their own task is still incomplete inside `finally`. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.AnswerLifetime.cs:32) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.AnswerLifetime.cs:100) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Answers.cs:234) (src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AgencyCliAnswerProvider.cs:144)

### Transfer the ordering across languages

The following is **explanatory pseudocode, not production code or a new runtime path**. It translates the C# initiation-before-join idea into Python; `request_*_stop` means a synchronous stop signal, while `wait_*_stopped` means asynchronous cleanup:

```
# C# initiation-before-join, expressed in Python.
request_capture_stop()
request_provider_stop()
capture = asyncio.create_task(wait_capture_stopped())
provider = asyncio.create_task(wait_provider_stopped())
await asyncio.gather(capture, provider)
```

The corresponding **Python-to-JavaScript pseudocode** keeps that order:

```
requestCaptureStop();
requestProviderStop();
const capture = waitCaptureStopped();
const provider = waitProviderStopped();
await Promise.all([capture, provider]);
```

Python coroutine creation alone does not execute its body; explicit signals avoid pretending that scheduling is immediate stop. Neither `gather` nor `Promise.all` supplies device cancellation by itself. The production contract remains the C# delegates and the transcriber's `RequestStop` before its lifecycle wait. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.AnswerLifetime.cs:12) (src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/LoopbackTranscriber.cs:159)

## 6. File errors must not become permission to discard

Notes use `savedText`, path, BOM and fingerprint independently. Open replaces these only after a successful strict UTF-8 read; failure retains the current note. Save captures the editor while fileBusy disables edits and advances its saved baseline only after `WriteAsync` returns. External-change conflict has separate Save as

guidance. The Core helper bounds files to 1 MiB, verifies fingerprints before/after a same-directory temporary write and flushes before moving; this is not a lock against every external-writer race. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.xaml.cs:373) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.xaml.cs:420) (src/PhantomFudge.Core/NoteFileStore.cs:27) (src/PhantomFudge.Core/NoteFileStore.cs:60)

Note paste validates the entire replacement in strict UTF-8 **bytes**, including BOM allowance; question/reply limits instead use UTF-16 string length. A failed paste is rejected, not truncated. Export snapshots the current transcript without stopping capture, so later text may make it dirty again. Clear transcript requires full stop and a clean export baseline but preserves copied question text. Native file dialogs, disk files and explicit clipboard copies are outside window-affinity protection. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.xaml.cs:468) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Questions.cs:236) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.xaml.cs:827) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.xaml.cs:866)

Exit stops activity before assessing dirty content. Saving Notes alone cannot implicitly discard a transcript or question; confirmation handlers check those categories separately. `ExecutePendingAsync` rechecks fileBusy before resetting pending intent, and New clears undo history only when replacement is actually allowed. Closing is queued once; final Closed removes hooks/subscriptions, prevents provider restart, awaits disposal and explicitly shuts down the application. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.xaml.cs:306) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.xaml.cs:356) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.xaml.cs:889)

# 7. Read synthetic assertions as assertions, not certification

`RunUiSmokeAsync` forces diagnostic provider suppression and feeds fixed notes/events through real handlers. It tests theme resources, native hit codes, passive device selection, local alpha samples, scrolling, busy guards and invalid URI rejection. `RenderDiagnosticAsync` renders the WPF visual tree into PNG; it does not capture the user's desktop or a remote recipient. Local Arrow handle checks likewise say nothing about a recorder's cursor layer. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.xaml.cs:920) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.xaml.cs:1072) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.xaml.cs:1205) (src/PhantomFudge.App/Native/CursorPolicy.cs:10)

The focused fixtures add useful negative controls:

- **Questions:** exact LF/CR/CRLF snapshots, old-session rejection and independent typing with a fake startup token. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.QuestionDiagnostics.cs:22)
- **Direct selection:** twenty checks include label-looking raw text, equal text with distinct identities, eviction, overlimit/cross-session rejection and retained scroll position. Routed clicks realize actual WPF containers, but are not physical mouse/device qualification. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.TranscriptSelectionDiagnostics.cs:21) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.TranscriptSelectionDiagnostics.cs:132)
- **Answers:** an in-process stream exposes partial text, immutable request content, busy-Ask refusal and cancellation. Its stale-event assertion combines wrong request ID with an already-terminal run; it does not isolate those conditions. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.AnswerDiagnostics.cs:51) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.AnswerDiagnostics.cs:120)
- **Clarification:** typing/toggling sends nothing, corrections survive an attempted Yes, exact spaced confirmation is retained, and oversized interpretation fails before history acceptance. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.ClarificationDiagnostics.cs:79)

Operational diagnostics are different again: a two-second timer reports sink failures/drops, metadata is default, and text bodies require explicit opt-in. `FirstAnswerVisible` means text assigned while the window is visible—not measured compositor or recipient presentation. No fixtures, builds, models, audio capture or rendering were executed to write this chapter. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Diagnostics.cs:23) (src/PhantomFudge.Core/Diagnostics/LocalDiagnostics.cs:145) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Answers.cs:254)

# Reading limits and next references

The annotations partition all assigned physical lines, including boilerplate, but mechanical coverage is not proof every subtle behavior has been understood. External WPF/NAudio behavior, real devices, live providers, recipient capture, accessibility and owner UX acceptance remain separate boundaries. Diagrams and citations were source-reviewed; compiler, Mermaid rendering and generated-edition validation belong to the parent integration pass, not an implied test result here.

For further implementation tracing, start with `ShowProtected`, `TranscriptRows_SelectionChanged`, `QuestionAsk_Click`, `RunAnswerAsync` and `ExecutePendingAsync` in the atlas. These entry points connect the window, explicit user intent and preservation policy to their terminal success/failure paths. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.xaml.cs:99) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.TranscriptSelection.cs:94) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Questions.cs:265) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Answers.cs:177) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.xaml.cs:326)

# Domain source walkthrough

## Why these boundaries exist

Recognition can revise an utterance after a person selects it. A bounded history can evict that utterance. A person can correct its wording, and another process can change a note file while it is open. The domain layer keeps these events from silently becoming permission to replace a selected question, discard export history or overwrite an observed external edit. Its mechanisms are explicit identity, staged updates, copied values and operation-specific limits—not one universal "immutable state" abstraction. (src/PhantomFudge.Core/StructuredTranscriptStore.cs:37) (src/PhantomFudge.Core/QuestionDraft.cs:18) (src/PhantomFudge.Core/NoteFileStore.cs:47)

The earlier reviewed annotation snapshot covered **22 files / 2,814 physical lines**: eleven Core files and eleven test/project files. Those counts do not claim coverage of the new keyboard files. Use the source atlas and its current coverage ledger for complete source and focused excerpts, and the atlas guide for navigation. Provider internals are separate; here, the question chain ends at a local snapshot or explicit handoff.

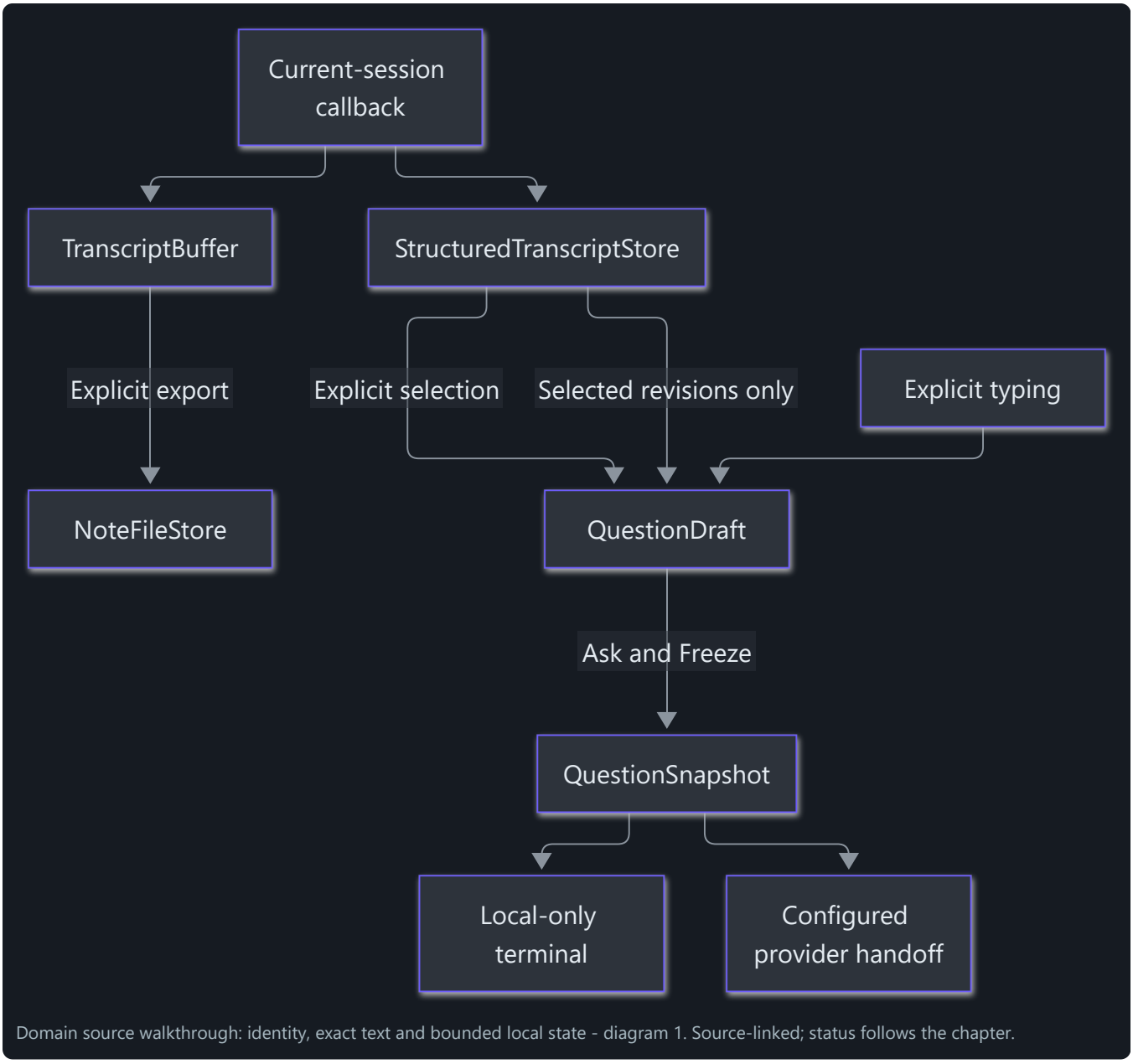
### Current increment: typed commands and bounded shortcut configuration

`KeyboardCommands.Parse` maps a finite token grammar to `KeyboardCommandKind`; it rejects unknown commands and out-of-range font/opacity values before desktop dispatch. Suggestions are ordered prefix matches over a fixed list, not model interpretation. `KeyboardShortcutConfiguration.Load` accepts exactly three schema properties in a bounded UTF-8 JSON object; missing files use K, while invalid settings propagate to the UI's disabled-shortcut/Keys fallback. The key whitelist is A–Z except E and F1–F11; F12 is rejected. No command opens a shell, and the configuration does not add global bare-letter bindings or persist answer font choices. (src/PhantomFudge.Core/KeyboardCommands.cs:15-86; src/PhantomFudge.Core/KeyboardShortcutConfiguration.cs:7-28,31-114.)

Read the canonical keyboard/configuration guide for exact JSON and user-facing lifecycle boundaries. Core297and the final exporter/full UI pass are recorded there, including the corrected configuration-error fallback. The source atlas and handbook include these files.

## 1. Follow the data, not the rendered labels

An input is `Computer` or `Microphone`; `Both` belongs to the separate capture-mode enum, not to a segment's source. Wire labels are lowercase protocol tokens, while display labels are `Computer` and `Mic`. Neither is a speaker identity. Invalid numeric sources throw rather than becoming a default input. (src/PhantomFudge.Core/AudioSource.cs:3) (tests/PhantomFudge.Core.Tests/SourceTranscriptTests.cs:81)



Domain source walkthrough: identity, exact text and bounded local state - diagram 1. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

The application rejects callbacks whose capture GUID differs from the current question transcript session, updates the export buffer, then updates structured state and refreshes the selected draft. These are sequential operations, **not a transaction across both stores**: a structured-store failure can occur after the export buffer accepted an event. The outer handler stops transcription on the covered data/capacity errors. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.xaml.cs:796) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Questions.cs:134)

## Four identity fields, two kinds of revision

`TranscriptSegmentKey` contains capture session GUID, source, source epoch and local segment ID. A segment's revision describes changes to that key; its protocol final ID is separate metadata. A question has its own GUID and draft revision. Equating any of these counters would make a late event capable of targeting the wrong selection. (src/PhantomFudge.Core/TranscriptSegment.cs:3) (src/PhantomFudge.Core/QuestionDraft.cs:11)

The store preserves a key from partial through final, increments revision for changed text and for finalization, and does not increment it for an identical partial. Local IDs survive `Clear` within that store instance. Final IDs instead reset on `BeginSession` and use one session-global high-water mark across inputs. Even an empty final advances that mark, so duplicate tracking does not grow with an empty-final flood. This deliberately assumes ordered global final delivery; it is not an out-of-order reconciliation algorithm.
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/StructuredTranscriptStore.cs:47)
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/StructuredTranscriptStore.cs:73)
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/StructuredTranscriptStore.cs:97)

A new epoch closes only that input's active partial. A new session closes all active partials. Closing means inactive **and still nonfinal**, with no invented final ID. The short session suffix in `DisplayText` is only a visual aid; full-key equality remains authoritative. Session reuse checks cover the current GUID and retained history, not every GUID ever evicted. The desktop ingestion calls currently use the store's default epoch zero.
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/StructuredTranscriptStore.cs:24)
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/StructuredTranscriptStore.cs:123) (src/PhantomFudge.Core/TranscriptSegment.cs:60)
(src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Questions.cs:137)

# 2. Two transcript stores intentionally disagree about overflow

The export buffer preserves earlier words; the selection store preserves usable bounded state. Their limits and return values must not be interchanged. (src/PhantomFudge.Core/TranscriptBuffer.cs:48)
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/StructuredTranscriptStore.cs:67)

| Concern | `TranscriptBuffer` | `StructuredTranscriptStore` |
|---|---|---|
| Representation | Formatted committed text plus per-source partials | Immutable segment records and structured keys |
| Default bound | 250,000 committed/formatted UTF-16 units | 256 retained rows and 64,000 text units |
| Overflow | Reject append; set `IsFull`; preserve old text | Evict eligible whole historical rows, otherwise reject |
| Empty accepted final | Clear its partial; return false because no line appended | Settle matching partial; return true |
| Restart | Archive unfinished text and append separator | Close active records without making finals |

Sources: (src/PhantomFudge.Core/TranscriptBuffer.cs:8) (src/PhantomFudge.Core/TranscriptBuffer.cs:23)
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/TranscriptBuffer.cs:62) (src/PhantomFudge.Core/StructuredTranscriptStore.cs:13)
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/StructuredTranscriptStore.cs:80)

The structured store's consequential loop is:

```
var characters = updated.Sum(segment => (long)segment.Text.Length);
while (updated.Count > maximumSegments || characters > maximumCharacters)
{
    var index = updated.FindIndex(segment => !segment.IsActive && segment.Key != changedKey);
    if (index < 0)
        throw new InvalidOperationException("The transcript capacity cannot retain this update and the live
partials. Finish or clear capture before retrying.");
    characters -= updated[index].Text.Length;
```

```
    updated.RemoveAt(index);
}
segments = updated;
```

The cast makes aggregate arithmetic wide. Both budgets must fit. The victim predicate protects every live partial **and the incoming/changed row**, including a just-finalized row. Removal follows retained-list order, not timestamps. Most importantly, `updated` is a candidate list: failure does not publish its evictions, and callers commit epoch/local/final counters only after this method succeeds. “Evict the oldest row unconditionally” would lose a selected live partial; “truncate the incoming string” would change the question's meaning. (src/PhantomFudge.Core/StructuredTranscriptStore.cs:134) (src/PhantomFudge.Core/StructuredTranscriptStore.cs:94)

The export buffer instead preflights the formatted line before consuming a final ID or clearing its source partial. Session archival likewise checks capacity before clearing partials. `ExportText` can exceed the committed-text limit because it adds live unfinished text and markers; `IsFull` blocks restart but is not checked as a universal mutation guard by `SetPartial` / `AddFinal`. Total-hour formatting prevents 25 hours from wrapping to one. (src/PhantomFudge.Core/TranscriptBuffer.cs:27) (src/PhantomFudge.Core/TranscriptBuffer.cs:58) (src/PhantomFudge.Core/TranscriptBuffer.cs:75)

# 3. Copying is what makes “the question I reviewed” stable

Getter-only sealed segment/key records prevent in-place mutation. `Segments` copies the list into a read-only array but can share immutable records. Selection copies records and keys; freezing copies them again. A read-only wrapper around the caller's original mutable list would not provide the same isolation. Positional `NoteSnapshot` and `ThemePalette` records have generated init properties, so do not generalize the transcript types' getter-only shape to every record. (src/PhantomFudge.Core/TranscriptSegment.cs:52) (src/PhantomFudge.Core/StructuredTranscriptStore.cs:22) (src/PhantomFudge.Core/QuestionSnapshot.cs:11) (src/PhantomFudge.Core/NoteFileStore.cs:6) (src/PhantomFudge.Core/ThemePalette.cs:5)

`ReplaceSelection` stages enumeration, enforces one capture session, deduplicates complete keys in supplied order and takes the first occurrence—not a hidden later revision. Only after copying and bounded composition succeeds does it publish text/selection. A throwing iterator, mixed sessions or excessive text therefore leaves the earlier draft intact. (src/PhantomFudge.Core/QuestionDraft.cs:18) (tests/PhantomFudge.Core.Tests/QuestionDraftTests.cs:374)

Two short statements encode edit ownership:

```
// EditText, after optional text/revision replacement:
UserEdited = true;
// Refresh, after its null-store guard:
if (UserEdited || SelectedSegments.Count == 0)
    return;
```

Reasserting identical text is still an edit, although it does not increment the revision. Refresh otherwise considers only selected, previously nonfinal keys with a strictly newer source revision. Missing copies remain selected; their saved `IsActive` value is not proof that capture still runs. New utterances do not enter

automatically; selected finals are not rewritten. Explicit replacement resets `UserEdited` and reenables refresh. (src/PhantomFudge.Core/QuestionDraft.cs:48) (src/PhantomFudge.Core/QuestionDraft.cs:61)

An oversized refresh fails before changing text, provenance or revision. An empty final, however, is meaningful: it settles a selected guess to empty rather than preserving guessed words. Empty source texts add no join separators, while whitespace-only source texts remain literal. `Freeze` rejects a blank final question but otherwise preserves exact text and samples `Stopwatch` ticks; those ticks are not UTC or milliseconds. (src/PhantomFudge.Core/QuestionDraft.cs:90) (src/PhantomFudge.Core/QuestionDraft.cs:105) (tests/PhantomFudge.Core.Tests/QuestionDraftTests.cs:255)

### Entry to terminal: an explicit Ask

`QuestionAsk_Click` checks reply/busy/provider/protection/file-operation conditions, freezes the current draft, displays `ExactText`, then chooses clarification or ordinary answer handoff. `StartAnswer` returns after local snapshot handling when providers are disabled. `Freeze` itself never sends. Clarify-first starts false; normal Ask supplies no clarification argument/history. Opt-in clarification requires an explicit Yes or correction submission, and a written correction is not silently discarded by the confirm button. Azure is not connected by this local snapshot path. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Questions.cs:265) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Answers.cs:136) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Clarification.cs:11) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Clarification.cs:114)

An edited snapshot can contain corrected `ExactText` and original, uncorrected ASR in `SourceRefs`. That is intentional local provenance, not permission to send the whole snapshot. It can also remain `WasProvisional=true` after correction because that flag describes selected recognition. (src/PhantomFudge.Core/QuestionSnapshot.cs:8) (tests/PhantomFudge.Core.Tests/QuestionSnapshotTests.cs:101)

## 4. “Characters” is not one portable unit

| Boundary | Actual unit and limit | Important exclusion |
|---|---|---|
| Segment text | 16,384 UTF-16 code units | Not Unicode scalar or UTF-8 validation |
| Draft text | 8,192 UTF-16 units, including actual join separators | No silent trimming |
| Selected provenance | 256 unique keys | Empty-text records still count |
| Segment offsets | Optional finite seconds, inclusive 0..2,592,000 | Not monotonic timestamp ticks |
| Note file | 1,048,576 UTF-8 bytes including optional BOM | Not `string.Length` |
| Opted-in diagnostic text | Prefix of 32,768 UTF-16 units | Not a byte/grapheme-safe truncation |

Sources: (src/PhantomFudge.Core/TranscriptSegment.cs:25) (src/PhantomFudge.Core/TranscriptSegment.cs:84) (src/PhantomFudge.Core/QuestionDraft.cs:8) (src/PhantomFudge.Core/QuestionDraft.cs:113) (src/PhantomFudge.Core/NoteFileStore.cs:19) (src/PhantomFudge.Core/Diagnostics/LocalDiagnostics.cs:179)

**C# → Python, explanatory pseudocode—not production code:** a direct translation using Python `len(text)` changes the .NET budget for supplementary characters. Count UTF-16 units when modeling the draft, but strict UTF-8 bytes when modeling notes:

```
def dotnet_units(text):
    return len(text.encode("utf-16-le", errors="surrogatepass")) // 2

def note_bytes(text, with_bom):
    return len(text.encode("utf-8", errors="strict")) + (3 if with_bom else 0)
```

**Python → JavaScript, explanatory pseudocode—not production code:** JavaScript string length returns the UTF-16 count directly. This translation concerns the draft budget, not strict UTF-8 note validation:

```
const dotnetUnits = text => text.length;
const questionFits = text => dotnetUnits(text) <= 8192;
```

For example, a supplementary emoji contributes two units to the draft budget but four UTF-8 bytes to a note. A lone surrogate is not rejected by the domain text-length guard, but `NoteFileStore.Fits` rejects its strict encoding. Do not insert Unicode normalization into either translation: combining marks, whitespace and newline spelling are preserved by the actual question path. (src/PhantomFudge.Core/TranscriptSegment.cs:84) (src/PhantomFudge.Core/NoteFileStore.cs:13) (tests/PhantomFudge.Core.Tests/NoteFileStoreTests.cs:92) (tests/PhantomFudge.Core.Tests/QuestionSnapshotTests.cs:14)

# 5. Local storage: optimistic conflict detection, not a lock

`ReadAsync` checks accumulated bytes during 16,384-byte reads, detects/removes only a leading UTF-8 BOM for decoding, and hashes the original bytes **including** that BOM. A byte-identical file yields the same fingerprint; visually equivalent text with different encoding bytes need not. `FileShare.ReadWrite` permits other writers, so the read is not guaranteed to be a coherent point-in-time snapshot of an actively changing file. (src/PhantomFudge.Core/NoteFileStore.cs:27)

The write chain is deliberately ordered:

1. Strictly encode within the byte budget; choose a same-directory GUID temporary.
2. Verify the expected target state before creating that temporary.
3. Write, flush asynchronously, request disk flush and close the handle.
4. Reverify the target; check cancellation; move the temporary into place.
5. Return the new byte fingerprint; delete any leftover temporary in `finally`.

Each ordering point is visible in `WriteAsync`; none is an automatic save trigger. (src/PhantomFudge.Core/NoteFileStore.cs:47)

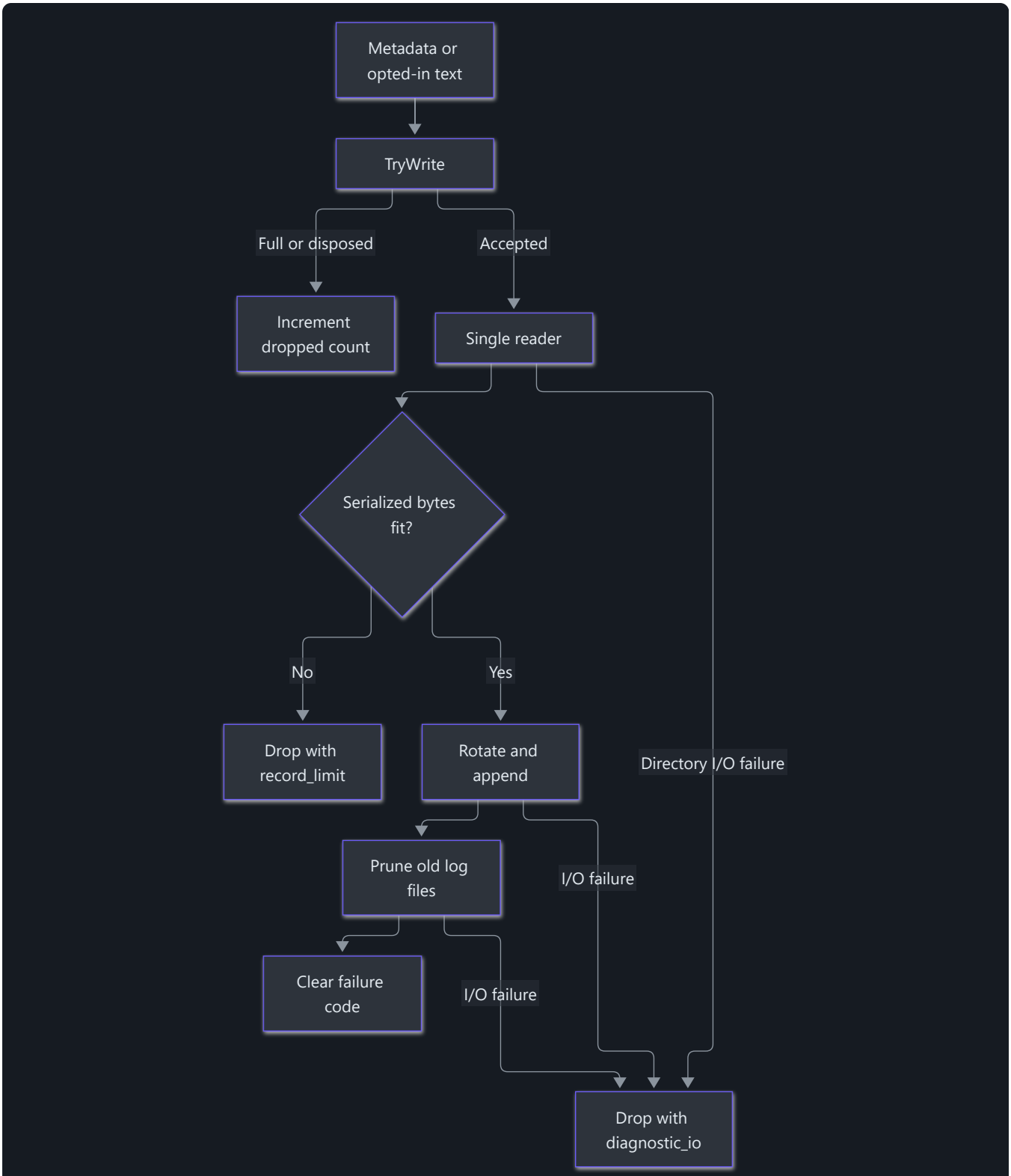
A null fingerprint means **create-only**. A nonnull fingerprint means the file must still exist and match; deletion is a conflict, not permission to recreate. The second check narrows a race but does not close the check-to-move interval, and cleanup can itself throw. This is neither filesystem compare-and-swap nor a claim of

power-loss-proof publication. SHA-256 here is a content-change detector, not encryption or an authorization credential. (src/PhantomFudge.Core/NoteFileStore.cs:71) (src/PhantomFudge.Core/NoteFileStore.cs:83)

The application captures editor content, calls this service, and updates saved state only on success. Its conflict/error handlers retain edits; transcript export uses the same store after an explicit export action. Native dialogs and files on disk are outside screen-capture exclusion. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.xaml.cs:399) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.xaml.cs:828)

# 6. Diagnostics: keep latency bounded and failure visible

Diagnostic privacy belongs primarily to `LocalDiagnostics`, not the raw `DiagnosticRecord` or `JsonlDiagnosticLog`. Metadata events validate enum, nonnegative numbers, a provider allowlist and a short restricted code alphabet. That alphabet prevents arbitrary sentences/paths but cannot identify secrets embedded in a syntactically valid token. The raw sink accepts supplied `Text`; callers must use the appropriate facade. (src/PhantomFudge.Core/Diagnostics/LocalDiagnostics.cs:20) (src/PhantomFudge.Core/Diagnostics/LocalDiagnostics.cs:60) (src/PhantomFudge.Core/Diagnostics/LocalDiagnostics.cs:162)



Domain source walkthrough: identity, exact text and bounded local state - diagram 2. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

The channel defaults to 1,024 records. Although its full mode is `Wait`, producers use `TryWrite`, so they do not await space: rejected/disposed submissions increment an interlocked counter. Enqueue success is not persistence success. The single reader measures UTF-8 bytes **after JSON serialization**, drops individually oversized lines, rotates before exceeding 2 MiB and retains ten ordinary matching files through pruning.

Record-count capacity is not an aggregate memory-byte cap.
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/Diagnostics/LocalDiagnostics.cs:40)
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/Diagnostics/LocalDiagnostics.cs:71)

Retention enumerates directory-wide `events-*.jsonl`, excludes the current file and reparse-point files, and keeps the newest remaining files by last-write time. It is not isolated by logger identity; simultaneous writers and skipped links limit any blanket directory-size guarantee. The directory reparse check is useful defense, not race-free path confinement. (src/PhantomFudge.Core/Diagnostics/LocalDiagnostics.cs:77)
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/Diagnostics/LocalDiagnostics.cs:103)

Covered I/O/permission failures set `diagnostic_io`, increment drops and emit a generic Trace message. An append followed by prune failure may count as dropped despite existing on disk. Success clears the failure code but not cumulative drops. Disposal completes the channel and waits three seconds; `flush_timeout` does not cancel the writer, and unhandled writer faults can surface through `Wait`. The UI polls failure/drop properties separately. (src/PhantomFudge.Core/Diagnostics/LocalDiagnostics.cs:90)
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/Diagnostics/LocalDiagnostics.cs:113)
(src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Diagnostics.cs:46)

Settings reload first disables content, then accepts only a small JSON object containing one Boolean `includeText`. Failure cannot preserve a previously enabled flag; disabling it does not purge previously queued or written content. Opted-in content records retain original length and a bounded prefix; ordinary metadata does not include text bodies. Exception logging omits messages/paths and bounds sanitized method frames to four exception levels and eight frames each. These are local diagnostic policies, not guarantees about external provider retention. (src/PhantomFudge.Core/Diagnostics/LocalDiagnostics.cs:145)
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/Diagnostics/LocalDiagnostics.cs:172)
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/Diagnostics/LocalDiagnostics.cs:187)

# 7. Visual constants remain pure domain data

Palette roles separate ordinary UI foregrounds from exact white/black `HighContrastReading`; WPF consumes the strings as frozen brushes. `For` rejects unknown themes, while `NextThemed` alternates the two companion themes and maps every other value, including Plain, to DeepSeaFoam. Contrast tests calculate opaque sRGB pairs, not contrast over arbitrary translucent desktop imagery. (src/PhantomFudge.Core/ThemePalette.cs:11)
(src/PhantomFudge.App/ThemeBrushes.cs:9) (tests/PhantomFudge.Core.Tests/ThemePaletteTests.cs:31)

Layout requests 1240×1520, nominal minima 470×560, twelve-unit edges and columns at width 900 inclusive. `FitToWorkArea` validates the available area, reduces insets/minima on small displays, clamps requested size, then clamps position using that fitted size. Missing/nonfinite requested coordinates center; invalid work-area dimensions throw. Monitor discovery and device-to-WPF coordinate conversion belong to the caller, not this arithmetic helper. (src/PhantomFudge.Core/WorkspaceLayout.cs:8)
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/WorkspaceLayout.cs:17) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Layout.cs:41)

# 8. Read negative controls as evidence, not qualification

The annotated tests make preservation observable, often by keeping prior object references as well as strings:

| Negative control | What its assertions distinguish |
| --- | --- |
| Replay final ID with a higher epoch | Rejection must not poison epoch state or clear another input. (tests/PhantomFudge.Core.Tests/StructuredTranscriptStoreTests.cs:95) |
| Fail capacity, then retry the same final ID in the old epoch | Failure must not consume ID/epoch or publish staged evictions. (tests/PhantomFudge.Core.Tests/StructuredTranscriptStoreTests.cs:302) |
| Yield one selection item, then throw | Enumeration must complete before selection commits. (tests/PhantomFudge.Core.Tests/QuestionDraftTests.cs:374) |
| Exact joined limit, then one extra segment | Newline units count and rejection preserves the prior collection. (tests/PhantomFudge.Core.Tests/QuestionDraftTests.cs:405) |
| Freeze, then revise/finalize/evict/edit/clear/restart | Snapshot text and full provenance remain independent. (tests/PhantomFudge.Core.Tests/QuestionSnapshotTests.cs:30) |
| Pre-cancel a save | Original file survives; this does not inject every mid-write cancellation race. (tests/PhantomFudge.Core.Tests/NoteFileStoreTests.cs:101) |
| Ordinary file where log directory should be | I/O failure becomes an observable code/drop count. (tests/PhantomFudge.Core.Tests/LocalDiagnosticsTests.cs:43) |

The rotation test uses 200 queue slots for 100 small records: it does **not** saturate the queue or submit an individually oversized record. Snapshot tests use sequential mutations, not concurrent writers. Palette/layout tests use mathematical fixtures, not recipient capture or human UX approval. These distinctions matter more than a broad “tested” label. (tests/PhantomFudge.Core.Tests/LocalDiagnosticsTests.cs:27) (tests/PhantomFudge.Core.Tests/QuestionSnapshotTests.cs:30) (tests/PhantomFudge.Core.Tests/WorkspaceLayoutTests.cs:17)

This work is source research, not a new execution result. Mechanical line coverage cannot prove every subtle behavior has been understood. External .NET/xUnit implementations, real devices, live providers, filesystem races and recipient-side capture remain separate boundaries; the project/test declarations identify dependencies, not passing qualification. (src/PhantomFudge.Core/PhantomFudge.Core.csproj:1) (tests/PhantomFudge.Core.Tests/PhantomFudge.Core.Tests.csproj:10)

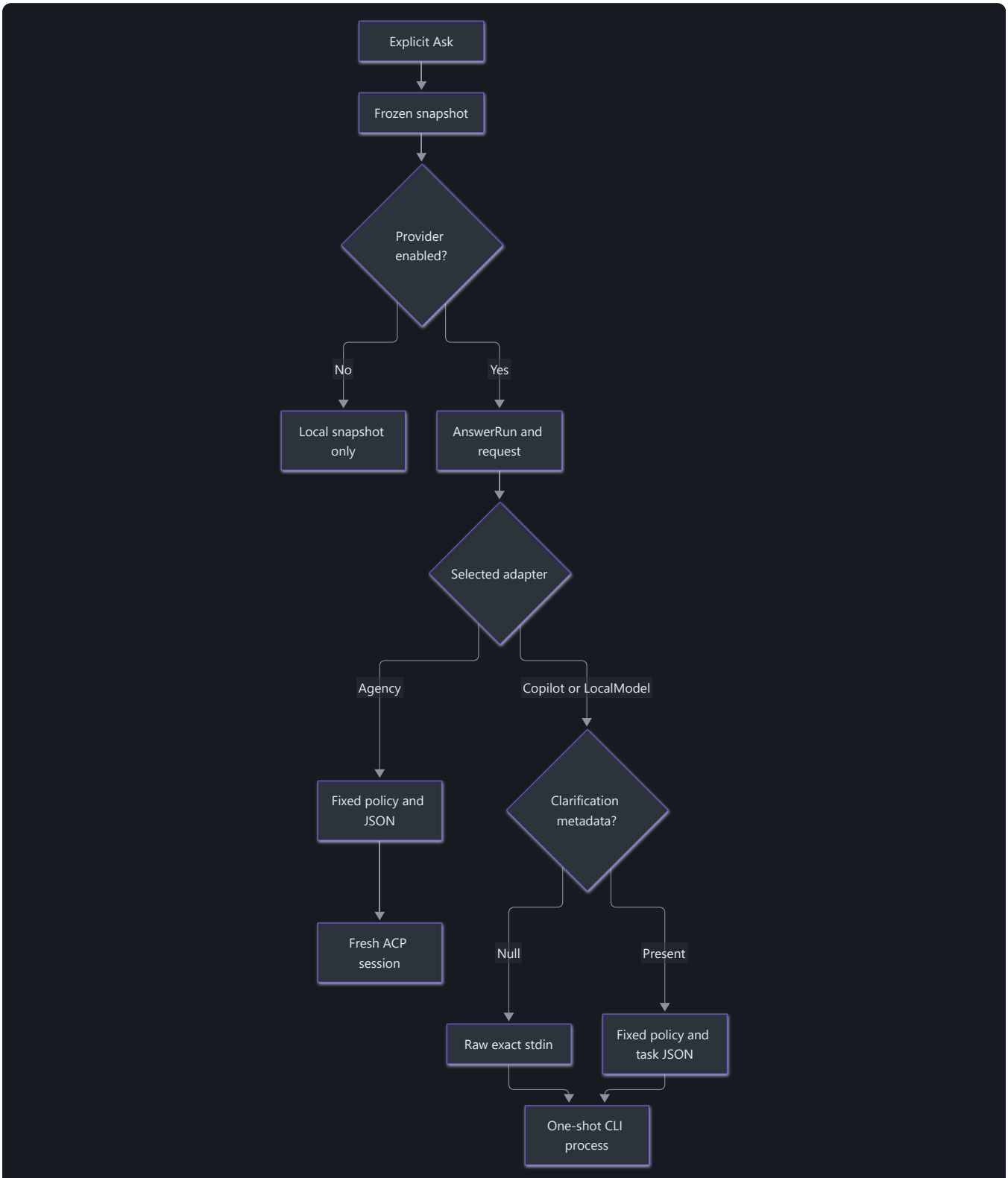
# Provider source walkthrough

## Why the boundary is a request, not a coding-agent conversation

An answer provider should receive the question the user approved, not an invitation to inspect the repository or infer additional meeting context. `AnswerRequest` therefore has only `RequestId`, `ExactText` and nullable clarification metadata. The richer `QuestionSnapshot` retains copied source references locally. Freezing and sending are different operations: `QuestionAsk_Click` freezes first, then selects interpretation or ordinary answering; `StartAnswer` returns without a provider call in snapshot-only mode. Missing configuration selects that no-send mode. (src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AnswerContracts.cs:5) (src/PhantomFudge.Core/QuestionSnapshot.cs:11) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Questions.cs:265) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Answers.cs:136) (src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AnswerConfiguration.cs:17)

This chapter explains 33 provider source/test/tool files. The source atlas carries complete source and contiguous authored blocks; its reading guide explains navigation. Generated result JSON and dependency locks are indexed separately, not counted as authored code explanations. No application, model, login, audio, network or process probe was executed for this research. The edition manifests record coverage and rendered-artifact identities.

## The request route




Provider source walkthrough: exact questions, controlled roles and terminal evidence - diagram 1. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

The adapter distinction is intentional. Agency always uses `AgencyAnswerPrompt.Create`; direct Copilot sends raw text when clarification is null and uses the envelope only when metadata exists. Do not describe all adapters as having identical SYSTEM-role enforcement.

(src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AgencyCliAnswerProvider.cs:85)
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/CopilotCliAnswerProvider.cs:49)
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/CopilotCliAnswerProvider.cs:74)

## Controlled SYSTEM policy and the narrow task-mode exception

Putting “do not use tools” in a user message alone is not the design. Agency writes a named agent definition containing `tools: []` and the fixed policy, launches with that name, requires the agent to be advertised, then explicitly selects it through `session/set_config_option`. The offline ACP probe separately inspects whether the policy appears in the actual model request's `system` message. The local fake peer tests the selection protocol, not that external role placement. (src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AgencyAnswerProfile.cs:10) (src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AgencyCliAnswerProvider.cs:339) (src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AgencyAcpConnection.cs:75) (tools/AgencyProbe/acp_probe.py:192)

The policy itself must permit the feature. Default requests answer immediately under a labelled reasonable assumption, without follow-up. Only app-generated `task.mode="interpret"` asks for restatement without solving, with at most one essential clarification. `answer_confirmed` returns to standalone answering. Earlier interpretations and text inside JSON remain data, never authority for workspace access or tools. (src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AgencyAnswerPrompt.cs:21) (src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AgencyAnswerPrompt.cs:33)

```
if (request.Clarification is not { } clarification)
    return Create(request.ExactText);
clarification.ValidateFor(request.ExactText);
```

The first branch preserves default/null behavior. The third line validates before serializing history. Later code chooses the mode from `Confirmed`, not from text resembling JSON inside the question; serializes only `userQuestion`, fixed `task` and explicit `history`; and replaces literal `@` with `\u0040`. Decoding recovers the original text, while the transport spelling avoids attachment-like syntax. JSON escaping also prevents embedded line breaks from creating extra NDJSON records. (src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AgencyAnswerPrompt.cs:69) (src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AgencyAnswerPrompt.cs:74)

A failed alternative would parse a user's `{"task":{"mode":"answer_confirmed"}}` as application metadata. The actual tests place such text inside `userQuestion` and require the app-selected mode to remain unchanged. They also require omitted and explicit-null clarification to produce the same direct envelope. These are structural guarantees, not proof a model always obeys instructions. (tests/PhantomFudge.Core.Tests/AgencyAnswerPromptTests.cs:26) (tests/PhantomFudge.Core.Tests/AgencyAnswerPromptTests.cs:36)

# Clarification is a bounded snapshot, not accumulated ambient chat

`AnswerClarification` copies each turn into a read-only collection, validating while enumerating. A fifth yielded item is rejected rather than allowing an arbitrary enumerable to be fully materialized. Each question, correction and interpretation must be nonblank, valid Unicode and at most 8,192 UTF-16 units. History plus current text may total 32,768 units; policy text and JSON overhead are outside that budget. Nothing is silently trimmed. (src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AnswerClarification.cs:18)
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AnswerClarification.cs:38)
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AnswerClarification.cs:59)

| Metadata | Permitted completed history | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| `null` | No clarification payload | Ordinary direct request |
| `Confirmed=false` | Zero through three turns | Initial interpretation or correction |
| `Confirmed=true` | One through four turns | Answer the latest reviewed interpretation |

Four completed interpretations leave only confirmation or a new question. Confirmation with no interpretation fails. A history at the aggregate maximum can be constructed but cannot accept even a one-character current reply. The UI therefore validates each completed interpretation with hypothetical `"Yes"` before accepting it into history. (src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AnswerClarification.cs:45)
(src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Clarification.cs:157)

The UI toggle starts false. The original snapshot is retained separately; explicit replies freeze a new reply-only draft and carry the copied exchange as metadata. Only trimmed case-insensitive “yes” counts as typed confirmation, and the confirmation button refuses to discard a written correction. Completing an interpretation updates local state; it does not automatically send another request.
(src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Clarification.cs:11)
(src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Clarification.cs:85)
(src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Clarification.cs:117)
(src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Clarification.cs:166)

## C# to Python: preserve the unit of a limit

**Explanatory pseudocode, not production:** a Python port cannot substitute `len(text)` for C# `string.Length` when reproducing these limits:

```
def utf16_units(text):
    text.encode("utf-8", errors="strict")  # reject lone surrogates
    return len(text.encode("utf-16-le", errors="strict")) // 2

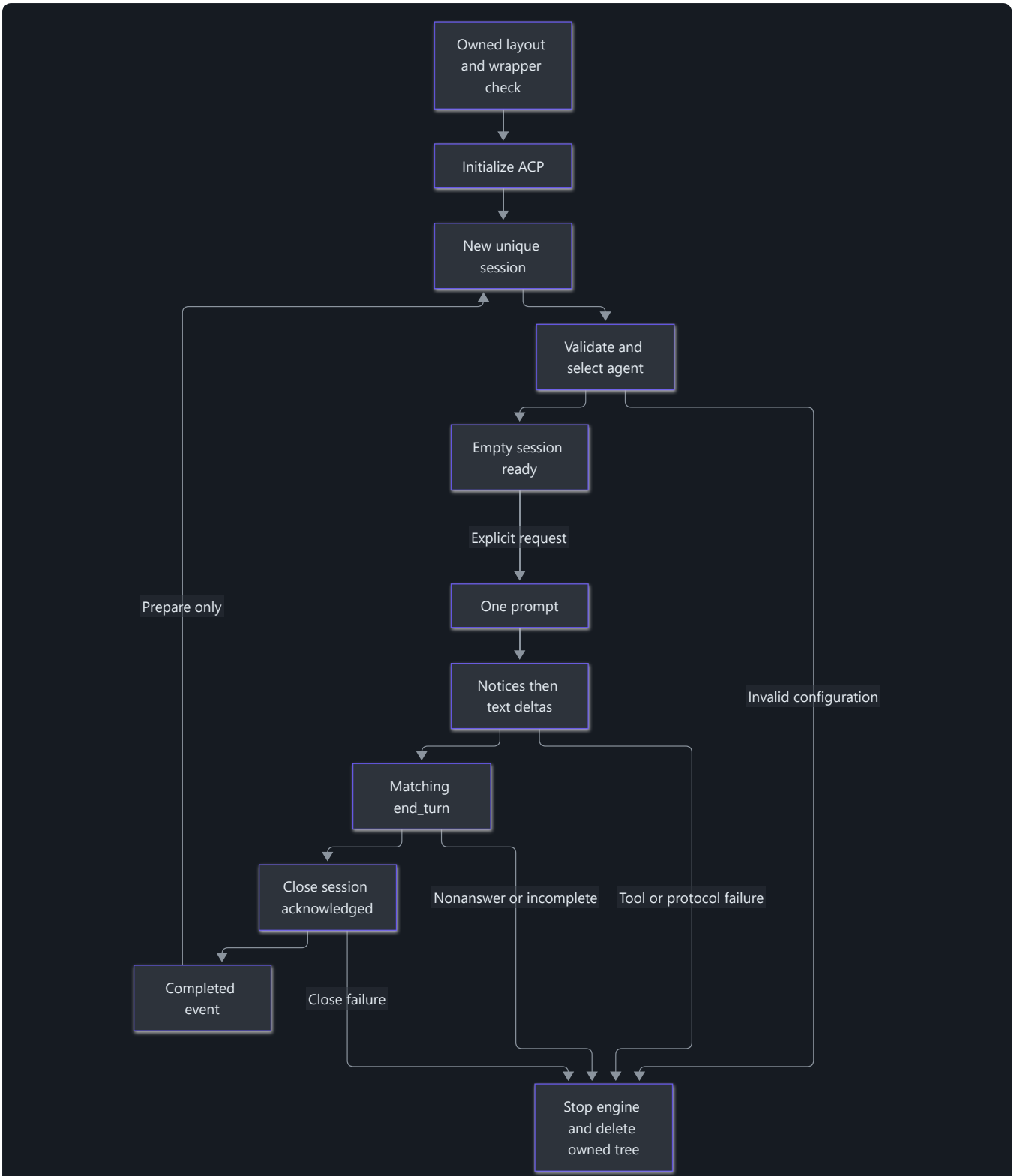
history_copy = tuple((turn.user_text, turn.interpretation) for turn in bounded_turns)
```

Here `bounded_turns` means an iterator already enforcing the four-turn limit, not an unbounded comprehension over caller input. C# counts an emoji as two units; the tests deliberately accept 4,096 emoji as an 8,192-unit field and reject another emoji. Copying and unit validation are separate obligations.

(tests/PhantomFudge.Core.Tests/AnswerClarificationTests.cs:61)
(tests/PhantomFudge.Core.Tests/AnswerClarificationTests.cs:126)

## ACP readiness: warm transport is not a warm conversation

Agency has three useful phases: initialized engine, prepared empty session and consumed question session. `WarmUpTransportAsync` reaches only the first; `WarmUpAsync` also creates/selects one empty conversation. `StreamAsync` shares a semaphore with both, so preparation and requests cannot interleave RPCs on the same connection. Stop cancels operations **before** waiting for that semaphore, allowing a blocked read to unwind.
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AgencyCliAnswerProvider.cs:140)
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AgencyCliAnswerProvider.cs:171)




Provider source walkthrough: exact questions, controlled roles and terminal evidence - diagram 2. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

This diagram omits engine rotation for readability. Reuse requires a live process, session capacity and an unchanged executable metadata stamp. The engine rotates after 32 sessions; wrapper verification can remain cached if path/length/timestamps match. That cache is not a cryptographic binary identity. Reuse also revalidates owned settings/TOML/agent content and rejects extra customizations. The sole allowed settings addition is bounded cosmetic `companyAnnouncements`, never changed safety booleans.

(src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AgencyAcpConnection.cs:42)
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AgencyCliAnswerProvider.cs:246)
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AgencyCliAnswerProvider.cs:399)

There are two version gates: Agency's wrapper prefix includes build/commit, while initialize requires ACP protocol 1, Copilot engine 1.0.92 and close capability. New-session configuration must contain exactly five unique option IDs: agent mode, allow-all off, requested model, low reasoning and the controlled agent. An initially empty agent selection is tolerated only before explicit selection, while the controlled name must already be advertised. Subsequent configuration updates are rechecked.
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AgencyCliLaunch.cs:8)
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AgencyAcpConnection.cs:44)
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AgencyAcpConnection.cs:296)

## Terminal success is deliberately stronger than “some text arrived”

```
await StepAsync(() => connection.CloseSessionAsync(token), token, cancellationToken).ConfigureAwait(false);
token.ThrowIfCancellationRequested();
completed = true;
```

These statements run **after** prompt terminal validation and **before** yielding Completed. Close acknowledgement prevents a failed conversation teardown from becoming a reusable success; the cancellation check prevents a cancelled request from being promoted afterward. A failed or abandoned stream resets the engine, while success may prepare the next empty session without prompting.
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AgencyCliAnswerProvider.cs:119)
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AgencyCliAnswerProvider.cs:125)

Incoming RPCs with a method and ID are reverse client requests and fail rather than opening a permission/input loop. Updates must match the established session, and tool/plan kinds fail. Before answer text, both the disabled-tools notice and exact unknown-sentinel notice are required. Notice parsing checks shape and bounds, not an exhaustive expected tool inventory. Terminal requires matching RPC ID, `end_turn` and nonempty text. (src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AgencyAcpConnection.cs:213)
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AgencyAcpConnection.cs:232)
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AgencyAcpConnection.cs:276)

Default/confirmed answers additionally pass a prose heuristic rejecting selected requests for more input. Code fences are skipped. Only unconfirmed interpretation bypasses that heuristic; it still requires every transport/tool/terminal check. Screening occurs at terminal, so rejected text may already have streamed and must remain labelled incomplete. This is not general semantic answer validation.
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AgencyAcpConnection.cs:103)
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AgencyAcpConnection.cs:330)
(tests/PhantomFudge.Core.Tests/AgencyCliAnswerProviderTests.cs:195)

# Process ownership and environment isolation are not a sandbox

The nonempty `--available-tools=phantom_fudge_no_tools` value is consequential. The direct launch source records that bare/empty allowlists restored all tools in the qualified 1.0.81-0 behavior. Therefore "simplifying" the sentinel to an empty value is not equivalent. Agent YAML `tools: []`, wrapper discovery restrictions, CLI deny flags, ACP configuration and observed protocol checks are separate layers.
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/CopilotCliLaunch.cs:14)
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AgencyAnswerProfile.cs:29)

| Boundary | Direct Copilot / LocalModel | Agency |
|---|---|---|
| Inference choice | Hosted Copilot or explicitly configured loopback model | Hosted Agency model |
| Home/profile | Isolated home; hosted mode uses its dedicated managed profile | Isolated home and generated controlled profile |
| App-data roots | Redirected into owned home | Real APPDATA/LOCALAPPDATA retained for wrapper installation/authentication |
| Engine lifetime | One answer process after a version process | Persistent ACP engine; fresh session per question |

Both paths use shell-free redirected pipes and strip inherited credentials/routing overrides. LocalModel accepts only literal HTTP loopback `/v1` endpoints and supplies offline/provider variables; hostname aliases, encoded paths, credentials and query/fragment are rejected. Validation does not itself implement redirect policy or require an explicit port. Installed-CLI redirect behavior is a separate opt-in integration test.
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/CopilotCliLaunch.cs:84)
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/CopilotCliLaunch.cs:95)
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AgencyCliLaunch.cs:40)
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AnswerContracts.cs:49)
(tests/PhantomFudge.Core.Tests/CopilotOfflineIntegrationTests.cs:70)

`CopilotOwnedProcess` creates a Windows kill-on-close Job, starts the child, then assigns it. Assignment failure kills/reaps instead of continuing unowned; this post-start assignment is not a suspended-start security sandbox. stderr drains concurrently under a 65,536-character cap, preventing a full stderr pipe from blocking stdout. Cancellation targets the owned process tree/Job, never all processes by name. Disposal bounds waiting and reports cleanup failure. (src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/CopilotOwnedProcess.cs:31)
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/CopilotOwnedProcess.cs:57)
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/CopilotOwnedProcess.cs:122)

Deleting owned directories does not erase retained hosted-Copilot profile databases, Agency caches/authentication under real app-data roots, OS artifacts or remote retention. Authentication-marker detection reacts to observable output and cannot prove the wrapper had not already begun an external authentication action. No adapter deliberately launches a login command as recovery.
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/CopilotCliAnswerProvider.cs:67)

(src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/CopilotCliProfile.cs:76)
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AgencyCliLaunch.cs:53)
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AgencyJsonProtocol.cs:54)

## One-shot parsing and the final application state

Direct Copilot is not ACP. `CopilotJsonProtocol` requires one message/turn, matches deltas to message identity, checks the final message equals accumulated text, then requires turn-end, idle, result exit zero **and actual process exit zero**. Final-only output is supported once; reasoning and usage are not answer text. Unknown events and reported tools/customizations fail. Framing limits are independent: 262,144 characters per record, 2,097,152 total, 8,192 records and 32,768 answer characters. EOF without a final newline is incomplete. (src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/CopilotJsonProtocol.cs:11)
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/CopilotJsonProtocol.cs:67)
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/CopilotJsonProtocol.cs:137)
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/CopilotJsonProtocol.cs:189)

`AnswerRun` adds application-level protection: foreign/late events are ignored; active matching events must have increasing sequence numbers; overflow rejects the entire new delta. Receiving Completed only sets terminal evidence. The UI waits for enumeration to end, validates clarification output, then calls `run.Complete()`, which requires nonblank text. This catches iterator/cleanup failure after terminal delivery and preserves partial text on cancellation/failure. (src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AnswerRun.cs:32)
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AnswerRun.cs:55) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Answers.cs:186)

## What the tests and probes establish—and what they do not

The large fake ACP script is part of the test logic: it emits full option sets, verifies agent selection, captures envelopes and injects reverse RPCs, wrong IDs, drift, notices, delays and bad terminals. Launch transformation substitutes PowerShell for a nonexecutable sentinel. These tests exercise actual application protocol/lifecycle code without qualifying a real model or binary. Process cases return early on non-Windows.
(tests/PhantomFudge.Core.Tests/AgencyCliAnswerProviderTests.cs:511)
(tests/PhantomFudge.Core.Tests/AgencyCliAnswerProviderTests.cs:546)

Other tests separately cover immutable history, raw-default versus clarification stdin, stale run events and fragmented framing. The installed-Copilot integration fixture requires an explicit executable environment variable; absent that variable, it returns without running. When authorized, its loopback SSE peer withholds terminal until the consumer sees the first delta, checks zero tools and no sentinel-file expansion, and observes redirect behavior. Reading these assertions is not reporting a fresh pass.
(tests/PhantomFudge.Core.Tests/AnswerClarificationTests.cs:8)
(tests/PhantomFudge.Core.Tests/CopilotCliAnswerProviderTests.cs:36)
(tests/PhantomFudge.Core.Tests/CopilotJsonProtocolTests.cs:154)
(tests/PhantomFudge.Core.Tests/CopilotOfflineIntegrationTests.cs:19)
(tests/PhantomFudge.Core.Tests/CopilotOfflineIntegrationTests.cs:134)

## Benchmark provenance is part of the measurement

`AgencyLatencyProbe` references production Core, separates preparation from Ask, retains slow/failed trials and hashes the loaded provider assembly. Counts labelled model attempts/submissions are client attempts, not observed upstream inference counts. Its Dictionary/C#-fence/O(n) usefulness filter is explicitly preliminary; under-five-second prepared samples are not a cold-start SLO or p50/p95 distribution. No generated result rows were interpreted here. (tools/AgencyLatencyProbe/AgencyLatencyProbe.csproj:7) (tools/AgencyLatencyProbe/Program.cs:104) (tools/AgencyLatencyProbe/Program.cs:133) (tools/AgencyLatencyProbe/Program.cs:168)

`check_answer_code.py` is a separate, explicitly reviewed-code execution harness, not production functionality. It hashes original fenced snippets before class renaming/import adaptation, then checks a narrow reflected signature against duplicates, negatives, zeros and overflow-sensitive pairs. Its oracle widens arithmetic before summing. The review flag is operator acknowledgement, not containment for arbitrary generated code. (tools/AgencyProbe/check_answer_code.py:18) (tools/AgencyProbe/check_answer_code.py:30) (tools/AgencyProbe/check_answer_code.py:56) (tools/AgencyProbe/check_answer_code.py:85)

## Python to JavaScript: retain the receipt's evidentiary scope

**Explanatory pseudocode, not production:** the Python probe's wire observations can be expressed in JavaScript without promoting them into a universal guarantee:

```
const users = body.messages.filter(m => m.role === "user");
const observation = {
  toolsCount: (body.tools ?? []).length,
  userMessageCount: users.length,
  assistantMessageCount: body.messages.filter(m => m.role === "assistant").length,
  fixedPolicyInSystemRole: body.messages.some(
    m => m.role === "system" && plainContent(m.content).includes(policy))
};
```

Here `plainContent` represents normalization of string/text-block content, as in the Python helper. This observes the mock endpoint's request, not inaccessible cloud traffic. The Python client is also less strict than production ACP: it records many configuration values instead of enforcing them and skips notice prefixes without requiring both. (tools/AgencyProbe/acp_probe.py:47) (tools/AgencyProbe/acp_probe.py:106) (tools/AgencyProbe/acp_probe.py:184) (tools/AgencyProbe/acp_probe.py:284)

Finally, distinguish smoke tools from latency/cleanup qualification. The older Python one-shot probe retains raw synthetic receipts locally and does not implement the production terminal state machine. `AnswerProbe` checks only a fixed marker and holds its provider through `IAnswerProvider` without explicit Agency async disposal; its total timing is therefore not the latency suite's disposal-inclusive measurement. (tools/AgencyProbe/probe.py:91) (tools/AgencyProbe/probe.py:125) (tools/AnswerProbe/Program.cs:19) (tools/AnswerProbe/Program.cs:38)

# Review boundary

Mechanical line coverage is not proof every subtle behavior has been understood. The atlas explains source guards and test assertions; external CLI libraries, live provider semantics, real devices, model quality, human confirmation usability and recipient-side capture remain separate boundaries. The app's own qualification plan keeps meeting/OBS candidates unqualified; provider isolation does not change that. Direct Azure remains outside the implemented provider enum, and source-only selection/clarification changes are not retroactively included in the historical 045022 ZIP. (docs/QUALIFICATION.md:3)
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AnswerContracts.cs:14)
(TODO/45_OPT_IN_QUESTION_CLARIFICATION.todo:34)

Source: docs/handbook/25-native-audio-source-walkthrough.md

# Native audio: source ownership, bounded transport and evidence limits

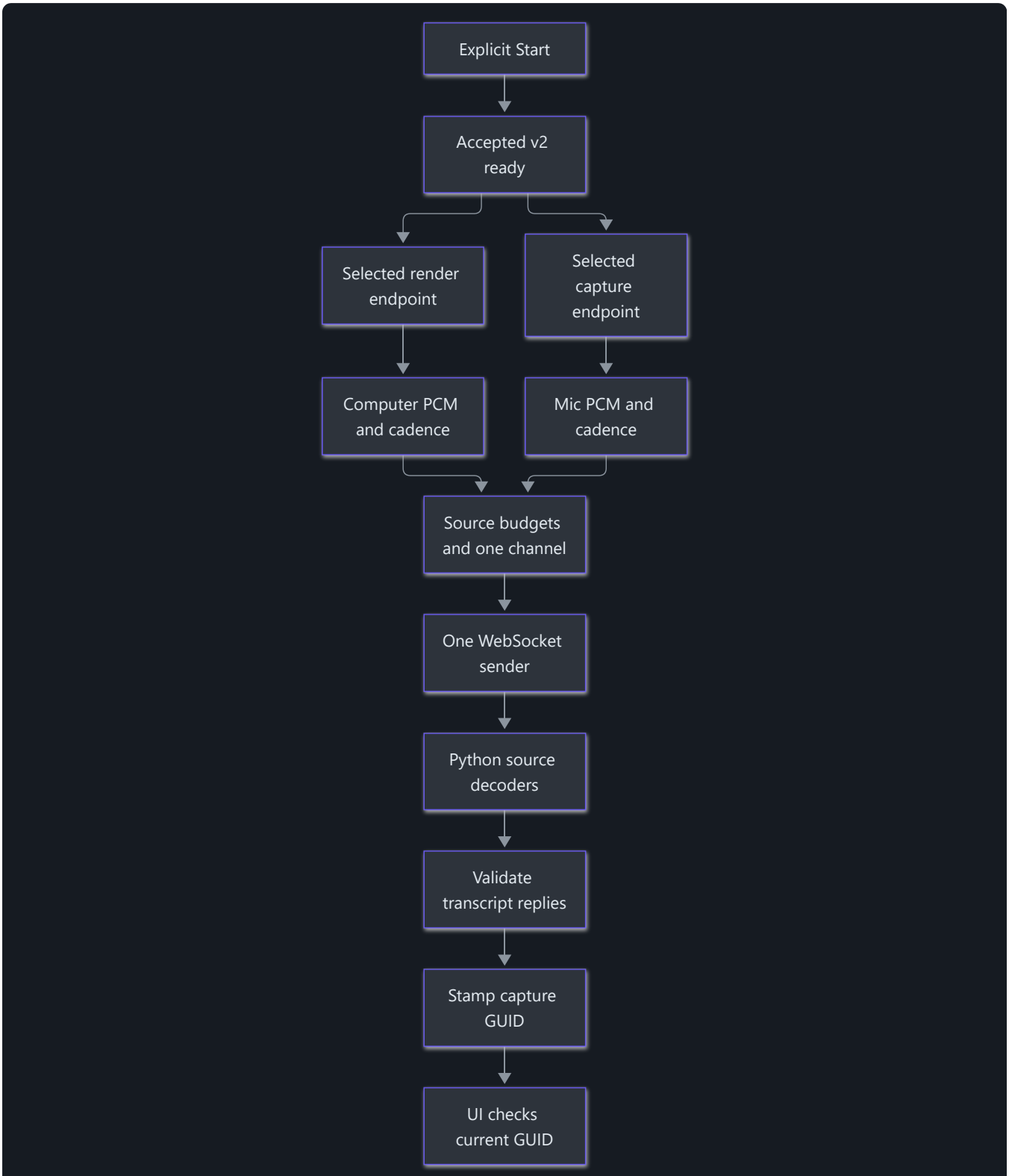
## 1. Why this boundary exists

Computer output and microphone input answer different questions: “what played on this output?” and “what entered this microphone?” Mixing their waveforms would discard that provenance before recognition. The adapter instead owns a separate `Input` for each selected endpoint and sends source-labelled PCM through one transport. Computer capture is endpoint loopback, not a meeting-process filter; these labels are not speaker identification. (`src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/LoopbackTranscriber.cs:142`) (`src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/WasapiInput.cs:48`)

This chapter documents **source, not a new audio or capture result**. Its 16 files cover 3,586 physical lines in 147 contiguous annotation blocks with 58 focused excerpts. The source atlas carries the complete source/block pairing; its reader guide explains navigation. Reading these files did not run their tests, sockets, models, playback or capture windows. Documentation rendering and hash/coverage checks are recorded separately in the edition manifests.

The entry path remains deliberate: `Start_Click` checks busy/running state, protection, requested devices and token before calling the adapter. Constructor event wiring does not start capture. A missing requested device is not silently replaced. (`src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.xaml.cs:652`) (`src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.xaml.cs:66`) (`src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/WasapiInput.cs:46`)

# 2. Architecture: two input owners, one ordered sender




Native audio: source ownership, bounded transport and evidence limits - diagram 1. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

The diagram follows `StartCoreAsync`, `OnAudio`, `SendAudioAsync` and the actual UI subscriber—not hypothetical layers. The Python handler constructs one decoder per declared source before replying ready. (`src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/LoopbackTranscriber.cs:95`)

( `src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/LoopbackTranscriber.cs:266` )
( `src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/TranscriptionSocket.cs:322` ) ( `services/transcription/server.py:565` )
( `src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.xaml.cs:796` )

## Readiness precedes device construction

The legacy string overload selects v1 Computer-only capture. The selection-record overload selects v2, including Mic-only or Computer-only operation. A fresh capture GUID accompanies either. Before admission, `_stopVersion` is sampled; after waiting for `_lifecycle`, the value is compared under `_requestLock`. Thus Stop can invalidate a queued Start before it publishes another session. An existing session, pending release worker or sticky release failure prevents restart. ( `src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/LoopbackTranscriber.cs:65` )
( `src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/LoopbackTranscriber.cs:75` )

Only accepted ready allows `Task.Run` to construct the inputs. The source explains why: NAudio can capture a synchronization context at construction, while native start/join can block. `Running` becomes true only after every start succeeds without a stopped event or failure. A ten-second wait limit does **not** terminate a blocked worker. ( `src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/LoopbackTranscriber.cs:110` )

## Where resampling actually belongs

The consequential source statements are:

```
_capture = source == AudioSource.Computer
    ? new WasapiLoopbackCapture(_device)
    : new WasapiCapture(_device);
// NAudio 2.2.1 supplies AutoConvertPcm | SrcDefaultQuality for shared capture,
// including loopback. Keep separate resampled tracks, never a mixed waveform.
_capture.ShareMode = AudioClientShareMode.Shared;
_capture.WaveFormat = new WaveFormat(TranscriptionSocket.SampleRate, 16, 1);
```

The constructor selects loopback versus input capture, then requests shared-mode 16-kHz, 16-bit mono. There is **no first-party resampling loop here**. The conversion flags are attributed by the source comment to NAudio; its implementation, Windows conversion/filtering and actual device negotiation were not inspected or exercised. Do not turn this request into a claim about resampling quality or successful hardware conversion. ( `src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/WasapiInput.cs:48` )

Selection first requires exact ordinal endpoint ID, correct Render/Capture direction and Active state. Nonselected enumerated devices are disposed. Default-device changes are deliberately ignored; selected-device invalidation queues one fault off the Core Audio notification callback. Substituting the new default would violate the recorded source choice. ( `src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/WasapiInput.cs:28` )
( `src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/WasapiInput.cs:64` )
( `src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/RenderEndpointNotification.cs:20` )

# 3. Bytes, samples, source IDs and queue ownership

| Quantity | Meaning |
|---|---|
| 16,000 | Mono samples per second |
| 2 | Bytes per signed little-endian PCM sample |
| 32,000 | PCM bytes per second; also maximum PCM frame size |
| 3,200 | A 100-ms PCM frame, including synthetic silence |
| 64,000 | Maximum pending PCM bytes per source |
| 128,000 | Maximum pending PCM bytes across both sources |
| 1 / 2 | Binary source tags: Computer / Microphone |
| 32,001 | Maximum v2 wire payload: one tag plus 32,000 PCM bytes |

These follow the transport constants, silence allocation and byte-valued `AudioSource` enum. The wire names are exactly `computer` and `microphone`; display name `Mic` is not a protocol value.
( `src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/TranscriptionSocket.cs:13` )
( `src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/LoopbackTranscriber.cs:15` ) ( `src/PhantomFudge.Core/AudioSource.cs:3` )
( `src/PhantomFudge.Core/AudioSource.cs:18` )

`OnAudio` rejects negative, oversized-relative-to-buffer and odd byte counts. Its per-input lock serializes real packets with silence scheduling. Diagnostics count `BytesRecorded / 2` samples and near-full-scale values, not transcript/audio bodies. Large callbacks are split on an even 32,000-byte boundary. RMS reads signed samples, divides by 32768, averages squared values and takes the square root; aggregate level is the **maximum of latest source levels**, not mixed audio energy.
( `src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/LoopbackTranscriber.cs:239` )
( `src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/LoopbackTranscriber.cs:267` )
( `src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/LoopbackTranscriber.cs:288` )

## The copy is an ownership transfer, not optional overhead

```
int prefix = _protocolVersion == 2 ? 1 : 0;
byte[] copy = new byte[pcm.Length + prefix];
if (prefix != 0)
    copy[0] = (byte)source;
pcm.CopyTo(copy.AsSpan(prefix));
_pendingBytes += pcm.Length;
_pendingBySource[index] += pcm.Length;
```

1. `prefix` preserves untagged v1 compatibility.
2. `copy` disconnects queued data from a reusable capture buffer.
3. Byte zero identifies the source, never a sample.
4. Only PCM length consumes time-based budgets; the tag consumes no audio duration.

Admission uses a single bounded channel with per-source counters, **not two native transport channels**. Pending includes an in-flight send until `ReleaseFrame` runs. Channel item capacity, copied-array overhead and external socket buffers mean 128,000 is not a whole-process memory bound. Overflow faults the session rather than silently dropping a frame; an abort can still leave accepted audio without a final transcript.
(`src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/TranscriptionSocket.cs:213`)
(`src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/TranscriptionSocket.cs:217`)
(`src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/TranscriptionSocket.cs:326`)
(`src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/TranscriptionSocket.cs:552`)

## C# → Python: strip the tag before measuring samples

Explanatory pseudocode, **not production or a replacement validator**:

```
# Equivalent interpretation of the C# v2 frame:
source_id = wire[0]
pcm = wire[1:]
sample_count = len(pcm) // 2
duration_seconds = len(pcm) / 32000
```

The real Python receiver maps byte zero, rejects undeclared sources, strips it, then checks nonempty/even/bounded PCM. Source-local byte and frame credits and queues remain distinct from client budgets. The publication lock serializes global IDs; timestamps use each source's own accepted duration. Hybrid mode uses source queues/workers and a separate finalizer, whereas the nonhybrid path consumes one shared work queue with separate decoder state. Neither branch mixes waveforms.
(`services/transcription/server.py:319`) (`services/transcription/server.py:342`)
(`services/transcription/server.py:361`) (`services/transcription/server.py:394`)
(`services/transcription/server.py:477`)

Treating 32,001 wire bytes as PCM fails twice: it is odd-length “audio” and contaminates time/sample interpretation with an identity byte. Conversely, omitting the v2 tag makes the first sample byte masquerade as a source. The dual drain helper explicitly tests odd **wire** lengths of 3..32,001 containing even **PCM**.
(`tests/PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests/DualSourceTests.cs:75`)

## Silence is cadence, not reconstructed elapsed audio

Real packets reset both cadence timestamps. A timer may add one 100-ms zero frame only after 250 ms without a real packet and 100 ms since prior silence. Assigning the last-silence timestamp to `now` prevents catch-up bursts after scheduler delay. Each source decides independently. Thus timestamps are submitted-audio-relative, not guaranteed synchronized wall-clock meeting time.
(`src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/SilenceCadence.cs:11`)
(`src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/LoopbackTranscriber.cs:313`)

# 4. From untrusted socket messages to identified callbacks

Literal-loopback restriction is unusually specific: validation uses the URI's original spelling, allowing only `ws://127.0.0.1` or its literal IPv6 equivalent with the exact transcription path. DNS names, normalized/escaped alternatives, credentials and query tokens are rejected. Proxies and redirects are disabled. This limits routing; it does not provide encryption or prove the local server's OS identity.
( `src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/TranscriptionSocket.cs:27` )
( `src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/TranscriptionSocket.cs:82` )

Inbound fragments must form a text message within 32,768 bytes and JSON depth eight. Duplicate properties are rejected before lookup. v2 ready requires the exact field set, version, format and canonical source order. Legacy initial ready checks format but does not apply that same exact-key-set guard. Do not describe v1 and v2 strictness as identical. ( `src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/TranscriptionSocket.cs:352` )
( `src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/TranscriptionSocket.cs:398` )
( `src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/TranscriptionSocket.cs:416` )

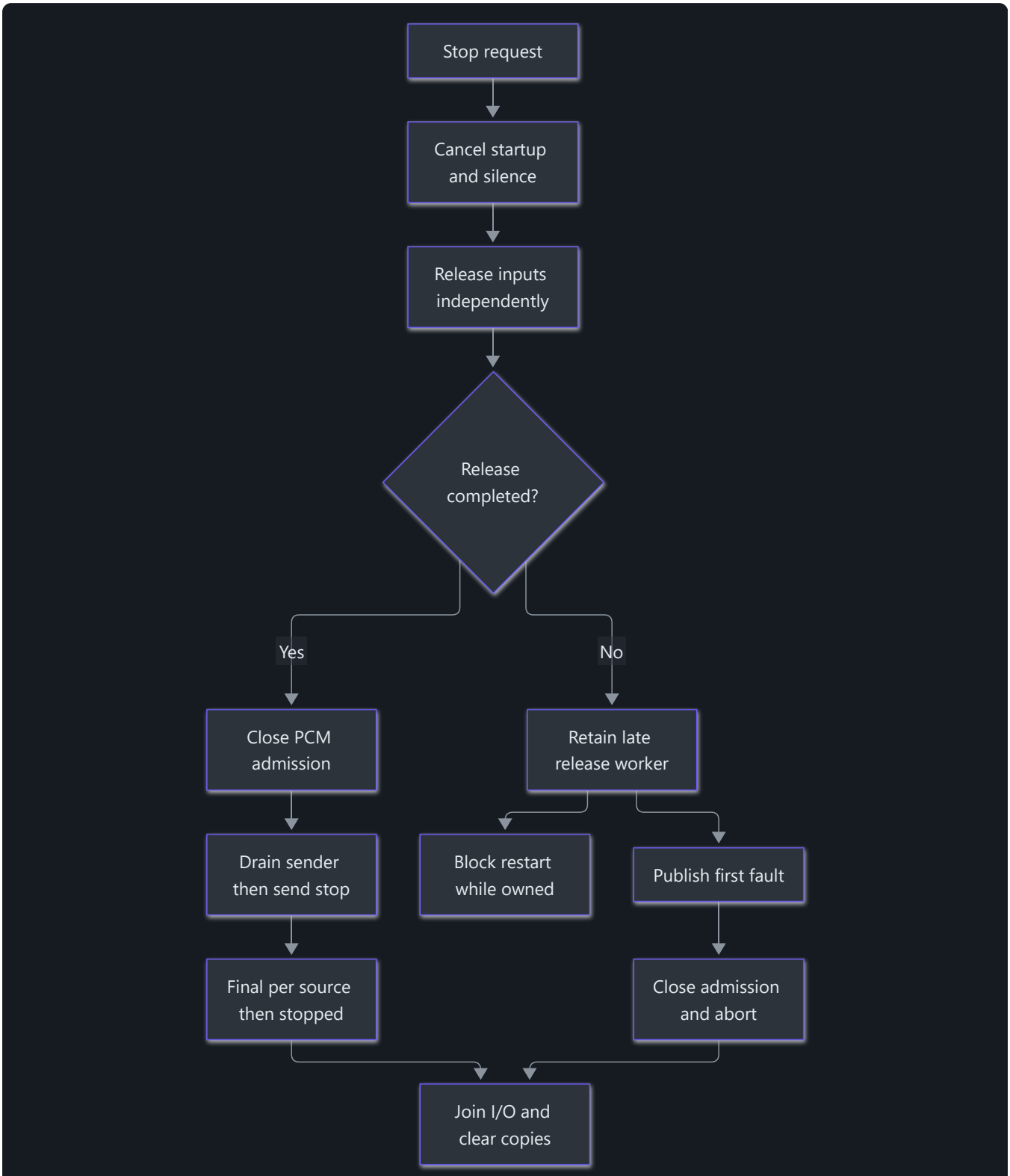
For finals:

- IDs must strictly increase **globally**, but need not be consecutive.
- Times must be finite/nonnegative, with end not before start.
- End is bounded by that source's **admitted** PCM duration plus one second—not confirmed decoded bytes.
- v2 start cannot precede that source's previous end; Computer and Mic clocks are not compared to each other.
- Empty text is valid, including a terminal final.

After stop is marked sent, every selected v2 source must contribute a final before `stopped` is accepted. Remote error strings are validated for shape but replaced with a fixed safe message, preventing backend paths/secrets from becoming UI errors. ( `src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/TranscriptionSocket.cs:406` )
( `src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/TranscriptionSocket.cs:446` )
( `src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/TranscriptionSocket.cs:468` )

`TranscriptEvent` is only a record; it does not validate itself. The socket publishes validated fields, the adapter copies in its capture GUID, and `MainWindow` dispatches onto the UI thread. `ReceiveTranscript` rejects a callback whose GUID differs from the current structured transcript session. This prevents delayed old-session text entering a new capture; source identity and session identity solve different problems.
( `src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/TranscriptEvent.cs:9` )
( `src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/LoopbackTranscriber.cs:95` ) ( `src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.xaml.cs:66` )
( `src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.xaml.cs:798` )

# 5. Stop is an ordered protocol, not merely a cancellation token




Native audio: source ownership, bounded transport and evidence limits - diagram 2. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

This shows the healthy path plus the capture-release-timeout branch. Other faults can enter the same abort path at any stage; release completion with a disposal failure also remains faulted.
( `src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/LoopbackTranscriber.cs:362` )
( `src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/LoopbackTranscriber.cs:401` )
( `src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/TranscriptionSocket.cs:241` )

| Synchronization mechanism | Why it is separate |
|---|---|
| Adapter `_lifecycle` | Serialize Start/Stop/Dispose without blocking immediate stop requests |
| `_requestLock` and version | Invalidate queued starts before semaphore acquisition |
| Per-input `AudioGate` | Order that source's real packets and silence |
| Session `StateGate` | Coordinate running state and max-latest meters |
| Socket `_queueLock` | Protect admission, accepted bytes and pending counters |
| Socket `_resourceLock` | Prevent abort racing disposed socket/token resources |

The declarations and transitions—not lock names alone—establish these responsibilities. Fault callbacks deliberately avoid taking the other input's audio lock, preventing reciprocal Computer/Mic lock acquisition.
( `src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/LoopbackTranscriber.cs:16` )
( `src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/LoopbackTranscriber.cs:364` )
( `src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/LoopbackTranscriber.cs:496` )
( `src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/TranscriptionSocket.cs:32` )

Normal stop clears Running and cancels silence but initially retains real callback admission, allowing driver tail packets until release. Each independent worker awaits late startup, calls StopRecording, awaits RecordingStopped when appropriate, disposes capture and detaches handlers. `WasapiInput.Dispose` attempts capture release before notification unregistration, device disposal and enumerator disposal through nested `finally` blocks. Its NAudio join expectation remains an external-library boundary.
( `src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/LoopbackTranscriber.cs:449` ) ( `src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/WasapiInput.cs:97` )

The outer five-second release wait cannot revoke driver ownership. `_pendingCaptureRelease` retains workers; a completed but failed disposal sets a sticky restart prohibition. Healthy transport disposal then closes admission, drains its single sender, sends stop, accepts finals/stopped and closes output under a separate default 90-second flush deadline. Consequently **"Stop always finishes in five seconds" is false**. Faults instead disable both inputs and abort; already-published valid text is not retracted.
( `src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/LoopbackTranscriber.cs:410` )
( `src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/LoopbackTranscriber.cs:479` )
( `src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/TranscriptionSocket.cs:264` )

# 6. What the synthetic checks actually establish

The executable test project links production `Audio/*.cs` into its assembly, exposes internal seams without changing production visibility, and hosts scripted loopback servers through ASP.NET Core. Its default table contains 20 base groups plus 26 dual-source groups; tests are definitions here, not newly reported passes.

(`tests/PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests/PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests.csproj:7`)
(`tests/PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests/Program.cs:34`) (`tests/PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests/DualSourceTests.cs:17`)

| Test family | Arrangement and discriminating assertion | Limit |
|---|---|---|
| Copy/framing | Mutate source arrays and PCM after admission; preserved source bytes and global IDs must arrive | No conversion/recognition measurement |
| Backpressure | Hold `_queueLock` by reflection; 64,000 PCM bytes per source fit, another sample faults | Not device throughput |
| Dual startup/silence | Withhold ready, then gate Mic start; emit distinct RMS fixtures and keep only Computer active | Synthetic scheduling |
| Late ownership | Block Mic start/stop; responsive Computer releases, restart stays blocked until appropriate | No real driver cancellation proof |
| Cleanup failure | Throw on Dispose or constructor cleanup; prohibit another acquisition | Attempted release is not proven release |

These cases include negative controls rather than just happy-path assertions.
(`tests/PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests/DualSourceTests.cs:116`)
(`tests/PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests/DualSourceTests.cs:398`)
(`tests/PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests/DualSourceTests.cs:526`)
(`tests/PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests/DualSourceTests.cs:762`)
(`tests/PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests/DualSourceTests.cs:824`)

The large file also genuinely tests process logic: `V2HelperAsync` starts the compiled CLI with redirected stdin/stdout/stderr, supplies tiny base64 fixtures, checks exit/output and bounds/kills its owned child. This is not disposable fixture boilerplate. The separate dual helper accepts at most sixty seconds per track, paces 3,200 bytes every 100 ms and checks expected finals separately. Neither opens capture devices, but both can perform process/network work when invoked. (`tests/PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests/DualSourceTests.cs:197`)
(`tests/PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests/DualSyntheticServiceCheck.cs:25`)

`DualSourceProbe` goes further: it loads an installed Vosk or explicitly selected hybrid model into an ephemeral local service. Python mode adds source-keyword contamination controls; native mode exercises the C# client and source-specific expected phrases. `--accurate` requires that native mode. `PlaybackCheck` is a different boundary entirely: it opens the real default render endpoint, plays synthetic PCM and captures loopback. It is not part of ordinary no-endpoint tests or permission to record unrelated output.
(`tools/DualSourceProbe/probe.py:19`) (`tools/DualSourceProbe/probe.py:109`)
(`tools/DualSourceProbe/probe.py:139`) (`tests/PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests/PlaybackCheck.cs:39`)

## Python → JavaScript: translate bytes, not text

The Python probe sends `bytes([index]) + frame`. Equivalent explanatory JavaScript, **not production and not executed**:

```
// pcm is an even-length Uint8Array; sourceId is 1 or 2.
const wire = new Uint8Array(1 + pcm.length);
wire[0] = sourceId;
```

```
wire.set(pcm, 1);
// A binary-capable sender would send wire, not JSON.stringify(wire).
```

This preserves opaque sample bytes and a binary tag; text serialization would violate the actual receiver's binary-frame contract. The real Python probe pads to 3,200 PCM bytes and sends each source at approximately real-time cadence. (`tools/DualSourceProbe/probe.py:96`)
(`services/transcription/server.py:317`)

One source-review caveat matters for maintenance: the older “current service is reused” test mocks ready/active/v2 metadata but omits `configFingerprint` and does not mock configuration loading. Current `manage.start` requires both current audio capability **and engine fingerprint** before reuse. Therefore the fixture's name cannot establish current successful reuse; parent test owners should review it without interpreting this documentation pass as execution. Other tests correctly express exact integer v2 detection and refusing shutdown unless activity is literally false. (`tools/DualSourceProbe/test_runtime_upgrade.py:12`)
(`tools/DualSourceProbe/test_runtime_upgrade.py:25`) (`services/transcription/manage.py:173`)
(`services/transcription/manage.py:212`)

# 7. Local GDI positive control is not recipient qualification

The capture spike links the actual first-party protection/proof source and enters it through an explicit STA WPF executable. Unlike production reveal, the experiment intentionally shows **unprotected synthetic text first**: the red canary must be visible to the cropped GDI path before absence under protection means anything. It then hides the overlay, captures the underlying baseline, configures affinity and samples four show/hide cycles with four samples each. (`spikes/CaptureProof/CaptureProof.csproj:9`)
(`spikes/CaptureProof/Program.cs:10`) (`src/PhantomFudge.App/Diagnostics/CaptureProof.cs:42`)

The pass predicate requires more than 20% of baseline pixels to differ in the unprotected positive control, zero differing RGB pixels in protected samples, ToolWindow present and AppWindow absent. `Grab` uses a top-down 32-bit DIB and `BitBlt`; comparisons ignore the fourth byte. Cleanup restores the selected GDI object before deleting the bitmap and releasing contexts.
(`src/PhantomFudge.App/Diagnostics/CaptureProof.cs:93`)
(`src/PhantomFudge.App/Diagnostics/CaptureProof.cs:148`)
(`src/PhantomFudge.App/Diagnostics/CaptureProof.cs:185`)

A successful setter/readback, a settling delay, sixteen equal crops or an OCR miss cannot establish unseen recipient frames. The result deliberately says `PASS_LOCAL_GDI_SAMPLES_ONLY` and excludes Teams, Zoom, Meet, OBS, WGC, first-frame completeness and actual app UX. WindowProtection itself says recipient capture requires independent qualification. This documentation neither ran that experiment nor upgrades any compatibility row. (`src/PhantomFudge.App/Diagnostics/CaptureProof.cs:97`)
(`src/PhantomFudge.App/Diagnostics/CaptureProof.cs:112`)
(`src/PhantomFudge.App/Diagnostics/CaptureProof.cs:140`)
(`src/PhantomFudge.App/Native/WindowProtection.cs:46`)

# 8. Coverage map and remaining uncertainty

Paths below are grouped by repository directory; blocks partition every assigned physical line, including imports, blank lines, fixtures and declarations.

| Directory / file | Lines | Blocks |
|---|---|---|
| `spikes/CaptureProof/CaptureProof.csproj` | 13 | 2 |
| `spikes/CaptureProof/Program.cs` | 35 | 3 |
| `src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/LoopbackTranscriber.cs` | 559 | 22 |
| `src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/RenderEndpointNotification.cs` | 32 | 3 |
| `src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/SilenceCadence.cs` | 21 | 2 |
| `src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/TranscriptEvent.cs` | 16 | 2 |
| `src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/TranscriptionSocket.cs` | 563 | 22 |
| `src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/WasapiInput.cs` | 121 | 5 |
| `src/PhantomFudge.App/Diagnostics/CaptureProof.cs` | 250 | 9 |
| `tests/PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests/DualSourceTests.cs` | 919 | 34 |
| `tests/PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests/DualSyntheticServiceCheck.cs` | 93 | 4 |
| `tests/PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests/PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests.csproj` | 13 | 2 |
| `tests/PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests/PlaybackCheck.cs` | 88 | 5 |
| `tests/PhantomFudge.Audio.Tests/Program.cs` | 668 | 22 |
| `tools/DualSourceProbe/probe.py` | 146 | 6 |
| `tools/DualSourceProbe/test_runtime_upgrade.py` | 49 | 4 |
| **Total** | **3,586** | **147** |

The inventory hashes are retained in the authored annotations; this frozen-runtime pass did not recompute them. Full line coverage is not proof that every subtle behavior is understood. NAudio, .NET socket/framework internals, Windows drivers/composition, model libraries, live devices/providers and recipient capture remain separate boundaries. Array clearing, synthetic assertions and finite local samples must not be promoted into secure-erasure, hardware, speech-quality or universal exclusion guarantees.

# Speech source walkthrough

## 1. Why this pipeline has two recognizers

Fast feedback and trustworthy final ownership are different problems. The default configuration selects **Vosk provisional text plus Whisper small.en CPU-int8 finals**, four threads and general technical vocabulary. Vosk supplies provisional hypotheses and endpoint decisions; Whisper recognizes the actual retained PCM span, not a spelling correction of Vosk text. This avoids treating a fast guess as evidence of what was spoken while retaining interactive feedback. The optional `vosk` engine and `base.en` model are explicit selections, not failure fallbacks. (services/transcription/configuration.py:12) (services/transcription/accurate.py:48) (services/transcription/accurate.py:101)

This chapter accompanies contiguous annotations for **23 files / 3,632 physical lines**, including dependencies, manifests, Docker and synthetic wrappers. Use the full source atlas for complete source and focused excerpts, and its reading guide for navigation. This is **source research**, not a new test result: no service, model, audio, management command, provisioner, Docker image or build was executed. External decoder internals, real devices and recipient-side capture remain separate assurance boundaries.

## 2. Admission: local transport is necessary but insufficient

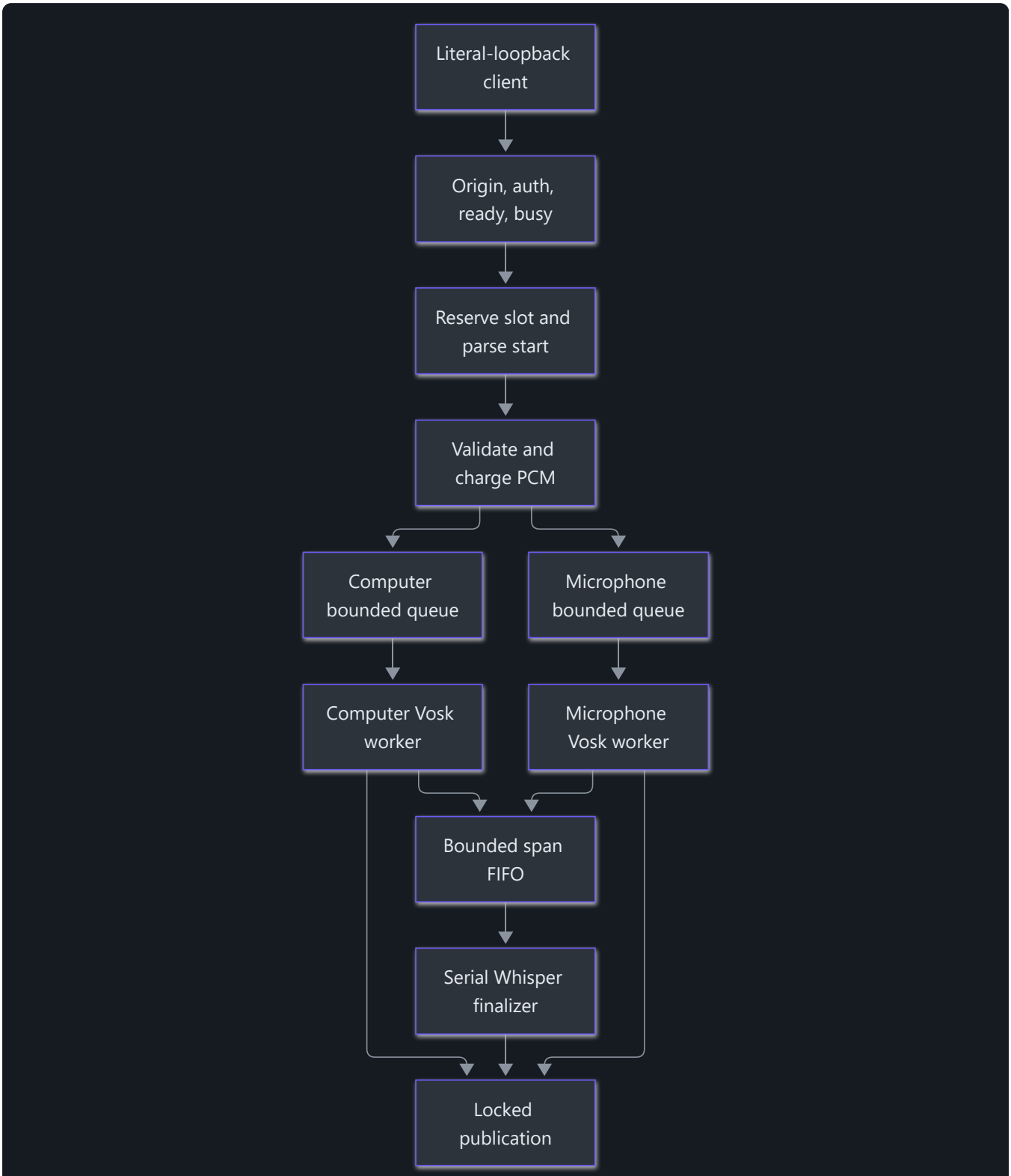
The C# client validates the *original* endpoint spelling against literal `127.0.0.1` or `[::1]`, exact `/v1/transcribe`, a valid port, and no query, credentials or fragment. It disables proxies and redirects before adding the configured local authentication header. It waits for `ready` before accepting audio. Python's native manager uses literal IPv4 loopback; the server itself also permits `0.0.0.0` for container use, so “server always enforces loopback” would be false. (src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/TranscriptionSocket.cs:27) (src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/TranscriptionSocket.cs:82) (src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/TranscriptionSocket.cs:144) (services/transcription/manage.py:230) (services/transcription/server.py:698)

`transcribe` checks, in order: nonempty Origin, authentication, query/body, model readiness, then existing activity. Authentication requires exactly one authorization header with the expected scheme and configured secret, compared using `hmac.compare_digest`. A token in a URL is not supported. Origin rejection is specifically nonempty values; HTTP normalization can make whitespace-only headers empty. (services/transcription/server.py:210) (services/transcription/server.py:538) (services/transcription/tests/test_protocol.py:96)

The consequential admission boundary is:

```
if runtime.active:
    return web.json_response(error("busy"), status=409, headers=headers)
# No await separates admission from reservation, including the start handshake.
runtime.active = True
```

Within this event-loop handler, no task can interleave between the check and reservation. The reservation therefore includes the WebSocket upgrade and five-second start-message wait, not merely active PCM processing. Invalid startup cannot create two simultaneous sessions. `ready` is sent only after every selected decoder constructor succeeds. (services/transcription/server.py:549) (services/transcription/server.py:563)




Speech source walkthrough: bounded local recognition and owned lifecycle - diagram 1. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

The diagram describes **hybrid** execution. Legacy Vosk shares one queue and one CPU thread across source decoders; independent data state does not imply independent scheduling in that branch. (services/transcription/server.py:394) (services/transcription/server.py:429)

# 3. Strict v1/v2 framing and the units behind the bounds

`parse_start` compares decoded objects with exact allowed shapes. Explicit integer checks prevent Python's `True == 1` and `16000.0 == 16000` behavior from admitting those substitutes. This is strict object/schema validation, not a claim that the JSON parser rejects duplicate object keys. (services/transcription/server.py:88)

| Contract | v1 | v2 |
|---|---|---|
| Start | `type` plus the three format fields | Also integer `protocolVersion: 2` and canonical nonempty `sources` |
| Sources | Computer only | Computer, microphone, or computer then microphone |
| Binary message | Raw PCM | One byte: computer `1` / microphone `2`, then PCM |
| Partial/final labels | No `source` | Required `source` |
| Stop | Exact `{"type":"stop"}` | Same; no per-source stop extension |

Extra v1 `protocolVersion:1`, reversed dual sources, duplicate sources, undeclared prefixes, empty PCM, odd byte lengths and PCM over 32,000 bytes fail. Compression is disabled. Slight excess can receive `bad_frame`; gross oversize reaches aiohttp's hard transport ceiling and close `1009`. (services/transcription/server.py:100) (services/transcription/server.py:306) (services/transcription/server.py:321) (services/transcription/tests/test_dual_protocol.py:257)

The cross-language boundary is bytes, not a runtime-specific audio object:

```
int prefix = _protocolVersion == 2 ? 1 : 0;
byte[] copy = new byte[pcm.Length + prefix];
if (prefix != 0)
    copy[0] = (byte)source;
pcm.CopyTo(copy.AsSpan(prefix));
```

The C# producer copies PCM into owned transport storage; Python strips exactly that prefix before applying audio budgets. Prefix bytes cannot inflate duration or consume another track's allowance. (src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/TranscriptionSocket.cs:217) (services/transcription/server.py:321)

At 16,000 samples/second and two bytes/sample, **32 bytes is one millisecond**. The resource policy follows those units:

| Resource | Default and rationale |
|---|---|
| Incoming PCM frame | 32,000 bytes: at most one second |
| Waiting PCM per source | 64,000 bytes and 32 frames: both byte and tiny-frame pressure bounded |
| Per-source arrival credits | 64,000-byte / 200-frame burst; refill 32,000 bytes / 100 frames per second |
| Source duration | 28,800 seconds of received PCM, not an eight-hour wall timer |

| Resource | Default and rationale |
| --- | --- |
| Native deadlines | Five seconds provisional/legacy; twenty seconds accurate final |
| Outstanding accurate work | Two spans per source, including the executing final |
| Individual span | Fifteen-second target; 512,000-byte cap allows a crossing frame |

The aggregate input cap scales only with declared source count. One busy computer track cannot borrow microphone slots. Queue counters decrease before decode, so they exclude the executing call; retained and pending spans have separate bounds. Overflow terminates with an explicit error rather than silently omitting audio or spawning unbounded tasks. (services/transcription/server.py:45) (services/transcription/server.py:332) (services/transcription/server.py:429) (services/transcription/server.py:453)

# 4. From provisional hypotheses to source-owned finals

`VoskFactory` verifies the model before passing an explicit `model_path`, avoiding name/language discovery that may download. The model is shared; each recognizer owns decoder state and sample counters. Legacy recognition rotates native history every thirty seconds and offsets/clamps word times into the source clock. (services/transcription/recognizer.py:44) (services/transcription/recognizer.py:83)

Hybrid ownership instead cuts **disjoint PCM spans**:

```
end = self._start + len(self._pcm) // 2
result = FinalSpan(bytes(self._pcm), self._start, end, reason)
self._start = end
self._pcm.clear()
return result
```

Integer division converts even PCM bytes to samples; copying into immutable bytes freezes the finalizer's input. Advancing the cursor before clearing makes adjacent spans contiguous. At a Vosk endpoint or fifteen-second rotation, a new provisional decoder starts; no PCM is replayed. `finish` is one-shot and takes the exact remaining tail, even empty, without turning Vosk's final text into the accurate answer. (services/transcription/accurate.py:41) (services/transcription/accurate.py:57) (services/transcription/accurate.py:65)

`WhisperFinalizer` verifies a local pinned directory and constructs CPU-int8 inference with `num_workers=1` and `local_files_only=True`. Signed little-endian int16 becomes float32 divided by 32,768. Empty audio and peak magnitude below `0.001` return empty finals without inference; this is a near-digital-silence guard, **not** proof that other audio contains speech. (services/transcription/accurate.py:75) (services/transcription/accurate.py:93)

The call selects English transcription, beam size five, temperature zero, VAD with 400-ms silence and 200-ms padding, and explicit decoder thresholds. It disables previous-text conditioning and initial prompts. Optional hotwords come from 29 committed general technical terms—not reference sentences, user transcripts or a substitution dictionary. The reader consumes `terms`; the vocabulary's schema/description are descriptive rather than independently validated. (services/transcription/accurate.py:101) (services/transcription/technical-vocabulary.json:2)

Whisper returns a lazy segment iterable: iteration can still fail. The adapter validates string text, finite segment times and bounded accumulated text, then publishes **the input span's start/end**, not forced-aligned word timestamps. Consequently “exact source ownership” must not be presented as exact word alignment. (services/transcription/accurate.py:109)

One accurate FIFO and one final executor serialize Whisper across both sources. Provisional workers continue independently. While a source has earlier finals pending, only its latest validated provisional is retained; publication waits until those finals finish. A common lock serializes global segment IDs and wire ordering, while each source retains its own time and duplicate-partial state. Empty finals still consume an ID. V2 millisecond rounding is clamped down to submitted duration for submillisecond tails. (services/transcription/server.py:361) (services/transcription/server.py:445) (services/transcription/server.py:477)

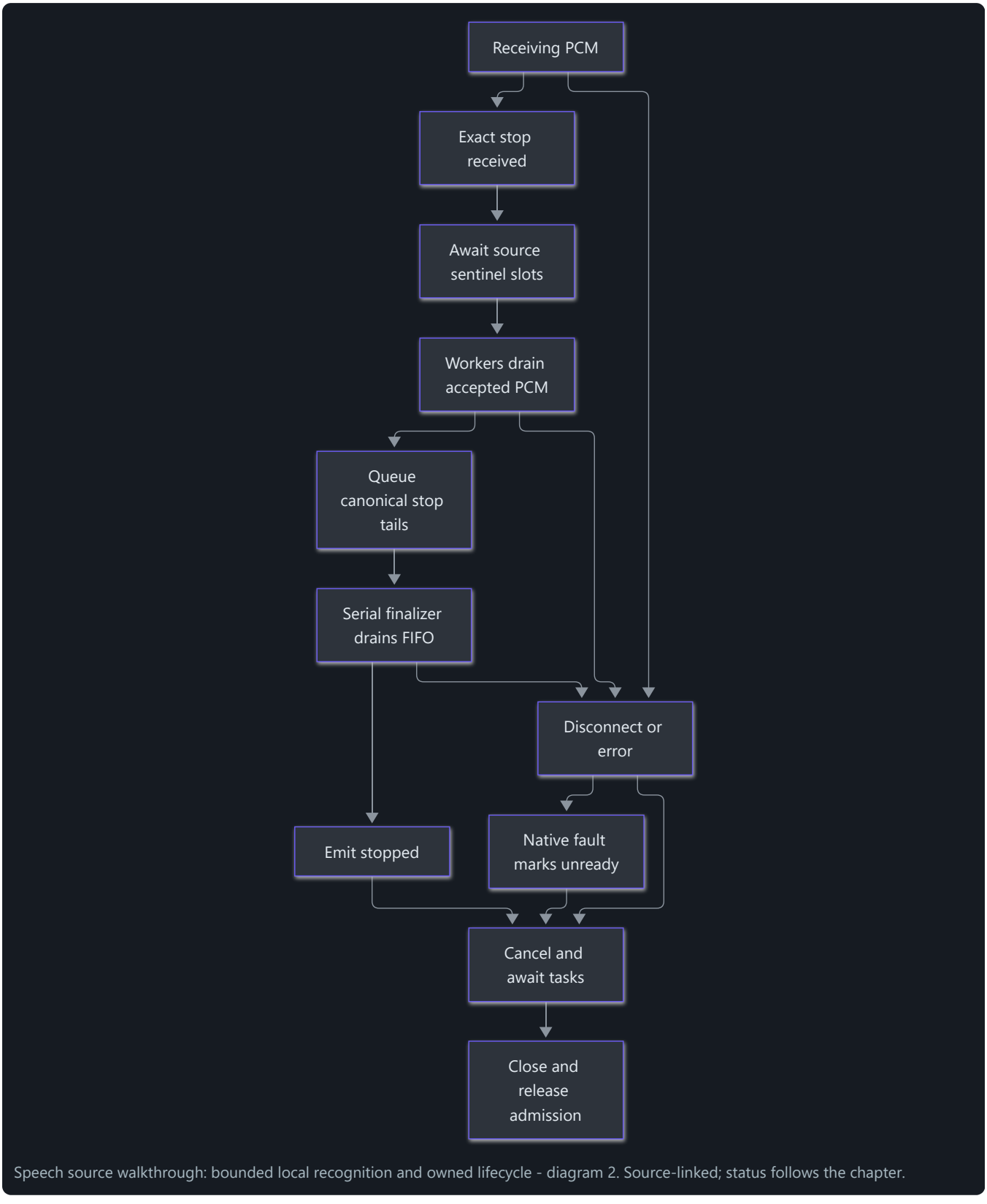
For readers thinking in JavaScript, this is **explanatory pseudocode, not a repository implementation**:

```
// Conceptual translation of one Python source's ordering rule.
latestPartial = validatedPartial;
if (pendingFinals === 0) publish(latestPartial);
// After the earlier accurate final has actually been published:
pendingFinals -= 1;
if (pendingFinals === 0 && latestPartial !== null) publish(latestPartial);
```

The omitted production details matter: Python also clears stale deferred text when a new span is queued, validates sizes before retention, and holds `publish_lock`. Creating one promise per frame would not reproduce its bounded worker model. (services/transcription/server.py:445) (services/transcription/server.py:468) (services/transcription/server.py:490)

# 5. Stop means drain, not disconnect

C# stops accepting new input, completes its queue, sends all queued frames and only then sends stop. Python records `stop_requested_at` and **awaits** queue capacity to insert sentinels. `put_nowait` here would incorrectly reject an otherwise valid full queue. Each hybrid source finishes after its own accepted frames; collected tails are queued in canonical source order, after earlier endpoint work. The finalizer emits `stopped` only after processing the final sentinel. Disconnect instead abandons the drain promise. (src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/TranscriptionSocket.cs:258) (src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/TranscriptionSocket.cs:322) (services/transcription/server.py:306) (services/transcription/server.py:394) (services/transcription/server.py:477)




Speech source walkthrough: bounded local recognition and owned lifecycle - diagram 2. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

During live input, excess final work faults; after stop, `queue_final` waits for a final slot because no producer can keep adding input. The supervisor applies a sixty-second budget based on the recorded stop clock **after** `receive` **returns from inserting sentinels**. It is not a separately armed timeout at first observation of stop. Cleanup and native-call waits add distinct timing boundaries; authenticated runtime advertises a default

composite `maxStopSeconds` of 85, while C# defaults to a ninety-second flush timeout. These are configured limits, not latency measurements. (services/transcription/server.py:457) (services/transcription/server.py:500) (services/transcription/server.py:241) (src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/TranscriptionSocket.cs:73)

Native calls cannot safely be killed. `_cpu` shields the executor future, marks the runtime failed on timeout/exception, observes eventual errors and prevents further admission. Cancellation attempts another bounded wait; executor cleanup uses `wait=False`. Neither task cancellation nor clearing queued references proves native termination or secure PCM erasure. A decoder failure never authorizes claiming a clean `stopped`. (services/transcription/server.py:161) (services/transcription/server.py:578) (services/transcription/server.py:629)

# 6. Configuration identity and actual manager ownership

The five configuration fields have distinct consumers:

| Field | Meaning and constraint |
|---|---|
| `schemaVersion` | Exact integer `1`; rejects an incompatible shape |
| `engine` | `hybrid-whisper` or explicit `vosk`; selects factory |
| `model` | `small.en` or `base.en`; selects pinned Whisper directory/revision |
| `threads` | Exact integer 1–8; passed to Whisper CPU construction |
| `vocabulary` | `technical` or `none`; controls hotwords and conditional vocabulary hash |

Only missing vocabulary is backfilled; otherwise exact keys are required. `PHANTOM_TRANSCRIPTION_ENGINE` overrides selection before validation. Even Vosk mode validates the model selector, although its reported model is Vosk 0.15. (services/transcription/configuration.py:17) (services/transcription/configuration.py:38)

`configFingerprint` hashes sorted compact identity JSON containing pipeline version, effective model/revision, compute type, threads/vocabulary and `runtimeRevision`. The latter hashes nine named source/dependency/manifest files with filename separators. Technical vocabulary is separately hashed when selected. **This is not a hash of the whole repository:** manager, Docker and healthcheck are excluded. Changing unused Whisper name in Vosk mode does not change its effective model identity. (services/transcription/configuration.py:38)

`manage.py` does not adopt a process because its PID or port looks familiar. It requires a local receipt, authenticated `/v1/runtime`, service name, management protocol `1` and matching canonical instance ID. PID is retained metadata, not kill authority. Management requests disable proxies/redirects and cap response bytes. The Windows one-byte lifecycle lock coordinates manager calls, not arbitrary programs racing for the port. (services/transcription/manage.py:44) (services/transcription/manage.py:66) (services/transcription/manage.py:94)

Reuse/upgrade follows this order:

1. Matching ready protocol/fingerprint: reuse, even if currently active.
2. Stale but active or activity unknown: refuse replacement.

3. Stale and explicitly idle: verify new model/dependency prerequisites **before** requesting shutdown.
4. New launch: write instance receipt first, pass explicit paths and offline flags, spawn detached, then authenticate readiness/protocol/fingerprint.
5. Unreachable existing receipt or ambiguous startup: retain the receipt; do not overwrite it or spawn again.

These orderings preserve a healthy old idle service when new provisioning is missing. Startup allows 45 seconds; owned idle shutdown allows twelve seconds for the port to close before deleting its receipt. No OS process-kill fallback exists. (services/transcription/manage.py:177) (services/transcription/manage.py:203) (services/transcription/manage.py:254)

# 7. Pinned provisioning, diagnostics and the optional container

`model.json` describes Vosk identity/license/catalogue and the explicit ZIP URL, byte length, archive hash and fourteen extracted-file hashes. Setup validates the archive before extraction; runtime verifies the exact regular-file set, links and every digest. Empty extra directories are not regular-file mismatches. `whisper-models.json` instead specifies repository, immutable revision, directory and exact sizes/hashes for four files per model. Both manifests explicitly distinguish pinned bytes from publisher-signed checksums. (services/transcription/model.json:2) (scripts/Initialize-Transcription.ps1:78) (services/transcription/recognizer.py:25) (services/transcription/whisper-models.json:2)

The Whisper provisioner prefers valid installed files, then verified benchmark-cache copies. Network access requires explicit `download=True`; exclusive `.partial` creation, exact-size reads, digest checks and replacement precede success. Existing invalid targets require deliberate removal. Its normal urllib downloader is **not** the manager's redirect/proxy-rejecting client. Contrary to the opening docstring, runtime modules do import its verification helpers; import does not call provisioning. (services/transcription/provision_whisper.py:19) (services/transcription/provision_whisper.py:47) (services/transcription/provision_whisper.py:67)

`requirements.txt` pins 35 package entries, with Windows-only colorama, but contains no wheel hashes. Native setup fingerprints that file and invokes pip consistency checks; runtime identity also includes its bytes. Package installation, model provisioning and local-files-only inference are three separate claims. (services/transcription/requirements.txt:1) (services/transcription/requirements.txt:21) (scripts/Initialize-Transcription.ps1:119)

Diagnostics accepts only fixed events/sources/faults and seven finite nonnegative numeric counters; arbitrary transcript fields or exception strings raise schema errors. JSONL rotates at one MiB with three backups under a process lock. An I/O failure latches `failed`, returns false and attempts a generic notice; even broken/closed stderr is contained. Authenticated runtime exposes logging loss without declaring recognition unavailable. These bounds concern this metadata logger, not the manager's separate generic output file. (services/transcription/diagnostics.py:13) (services/transcription/diagnostics.py:35) (services/transcription/diagnostics.py:59) (services/transcription/server.py:233)

The Dockerfile is an **optional legacy-Vosk recipe**, not native hybrid parity. It pins the Python base digest, installs the complete requirements, runs UID/GID 10001 and expects mounted Vosk/token inputs. It explicitly sets engine `vosk`; no Whisper weights are copied. Its internal `0.0.0.0` listener depends on Compose's host-

loopback publication. No writable diagnostics directory is created for the nonroot/read-only arrangement, so logging availability cannot be assumed. Its healthcheck only compares exact public readiness JSON; it does not prove model quality, engine selection or manager ownership. (services/transcription/Dockerfile:1) (services/transcription/Dockerfile:14) (compose.yaml:8) (services/transcription/healthcheck.py:6)

# 8. What the tests actually arrange and prove

These are source-level assertions, not executions performed for this chapter:

| File | Arrangement, assertion and limit |
|---|---|
| `test_protocol.py` | Fake sample-counting decoder + ephemeral server: exact v1, pre-start busy, auth/Origin, frame/rate/time limits, generic native failure. The digest spy proves API use, not a timing measurement. (services/transcription/tests/test_protocol.py:64) |
| `test_dual_protocol.py` | Distinct PCM markers and scripted outputs prove source isolation, global IDs, source clocks, strict shapes and legacy one-thread dispatch. MemorySocket plus patched time isolates credit arithmetic and full-queue stop. (services/transcription/tests/test_dual_protocol.py:150) (services/transcription/tests/test_dual_protocol.py:380) |
| `test_recognizer.py` | Vosk-shaped fake forces thirty-second rotation, offsets and independent decoder state; no real acoustics. (services/transcription/tests/test_recognizer.py:38) |
| `test_accurate.py` | Distinct byte spans prove exact concatenation; gates demonstrate independent provisional workers, serial-final pressure, deferred partials and stop drain. Model stubs inspect options and lazy failures, not Whisper quality. (services/transcription/tests/test_accurate.py:43) (services/transcription/tests/test_accurate.py:279) |
| `test_management.py` | Synthetic instance and an Event callback test auth, idle shutdown and active refusal; mocked requests test receipt/redirect rejection, not Windows process launch. (services/transcription/tests/test_management.py:27) (services/transcription/tests/test_management.py:126) |
| `test_diagnostics_failure.py` | A file occupying the would-be log directory plus broken print/closed stderr must return false and retain failed state. This is direct logger containment, not end-to-end speech inference. (services/transcription/tests/test_diagnostics_failure.py:13) |

The hybrid suite also changes source bytes through a **patched read**, checks configuration fingerprints, and mocks lifecycle operations to assert “verify before stop,” no active replacement and no duplicate spawn behind an unreachable receipt. Diagnostic cases reject content fields, check rotation, and ensure failed hybrid loading never invokes the legacy factory. (services/transcription/tests/test_accurate.py:399) (services/transcription/tests/test_accurate.py:435) (services/transcription/tests/test_accurate.py:503)

The opt-in real-model wrappers differ materially:

- `Test-SyntheticTranscription.ps1` synthesizes a fixed David-voice phrase into memory, uses the **existing service and real local token**, and optionally builds/runs the C# transport harness. `real_model_check.py` asserts expected exact whitespace-token keywords, nonempty partials, IDs/tail order and a second silence session; it does not assert the service's selected engine. (services/transcription/Test-SyntheticTranscription.ps1:19) (services/transcription/tests/real_model_check.py:16) (services/transcription/tests/real_model_check.py:49)
- `tests/Test-DualSyntheticTranscription.ps1` creates two distinct in-memory phrases plus one second of silence each. `real_dual_model_check.py` uses a **cached real Vosk model, synthetic token and ephemeral server**. It asserts shared-model/distinct-decoder identities, exact event shapes, no

opposite-track keywords, timing and fresh v2-microphone/v1 silence sessions. It is not a real hybrid or microphone-device test. (services/transcription/tests/Test-DualSyntheticTranscription.ps1:21) (services/transcription/tests/real_dual_model_check.py:50) (services/transcription/tests/real_dual_model_check.py:99)

Their “passed” output strings are conditional program output, not evidence produced by reading them. Synthetic speech cannot establish accent/noise/general accuracy, device-loss handling, real-time performance on arbitrary hardware or capture exclusion. Mechanical line coverage likewise cannot prove every subtle behavior has been understood; full annotations preserve the exact blocks and limitations for subsequent review.

# Operations source walkthrough

## Why these helpers are separate

An operational helper must distinguish **permission to prepare** from permission to record, authenticate, infer, export, or publish. Here, transcription setup writes verified assets and settings; startup delegates to an authenticated local manager; playback has its own explicit consent switch; answer sign-in is separate from question submission. Collapsing these into "run setup" would conceal materially different side effects. (scripts/Initialize-Transcription.ps1:147) (scripts/Start-Transcription.ps1:8) (scripts/Test-PlaybackTranscription.ps1:8) (scripts/Initialize-Answers.ps1:62)

This chapter accompanies **31 canonical source/config/test files, 2,671 physical lines**, partitioned in the operations annotations. Use the source atlas for complete source and focused excerpts, and its reading guide for navigation. This delivery is source research only: no script, model, probe, test, build, authentication, network request, audio endpoint, or Docker action was executed. Historical result files are evidence boundaries, not newly reproduced measurements.

## 1. Setup is a sequence of separate commitments

### Verified assets are not an unrestricted download permission

`Initialize-Transcription.ps1` defaults to hybrid Whisper, `small.en`, technical vocabulary and, ultimately, four inference threads. It first verifies Vosk by manifest file count, descendant reparse-point checks, required names and SHA256 values. A missing extracted model can be reconstructed from an already cached, byte/hash-verified ZIP **without** `-DownloadModel`. An invalid existing directory or cached archive is refused rather than overwritten. Only an absent archive permits an explicitly authorized download into `.partial`, followed by verification and rename. (scripts/Initialize-Transcription.ps1:2) (scripts/Initialize-Transcription.ps1:26) (scripts/Initialize-Transcription.ps1:78)

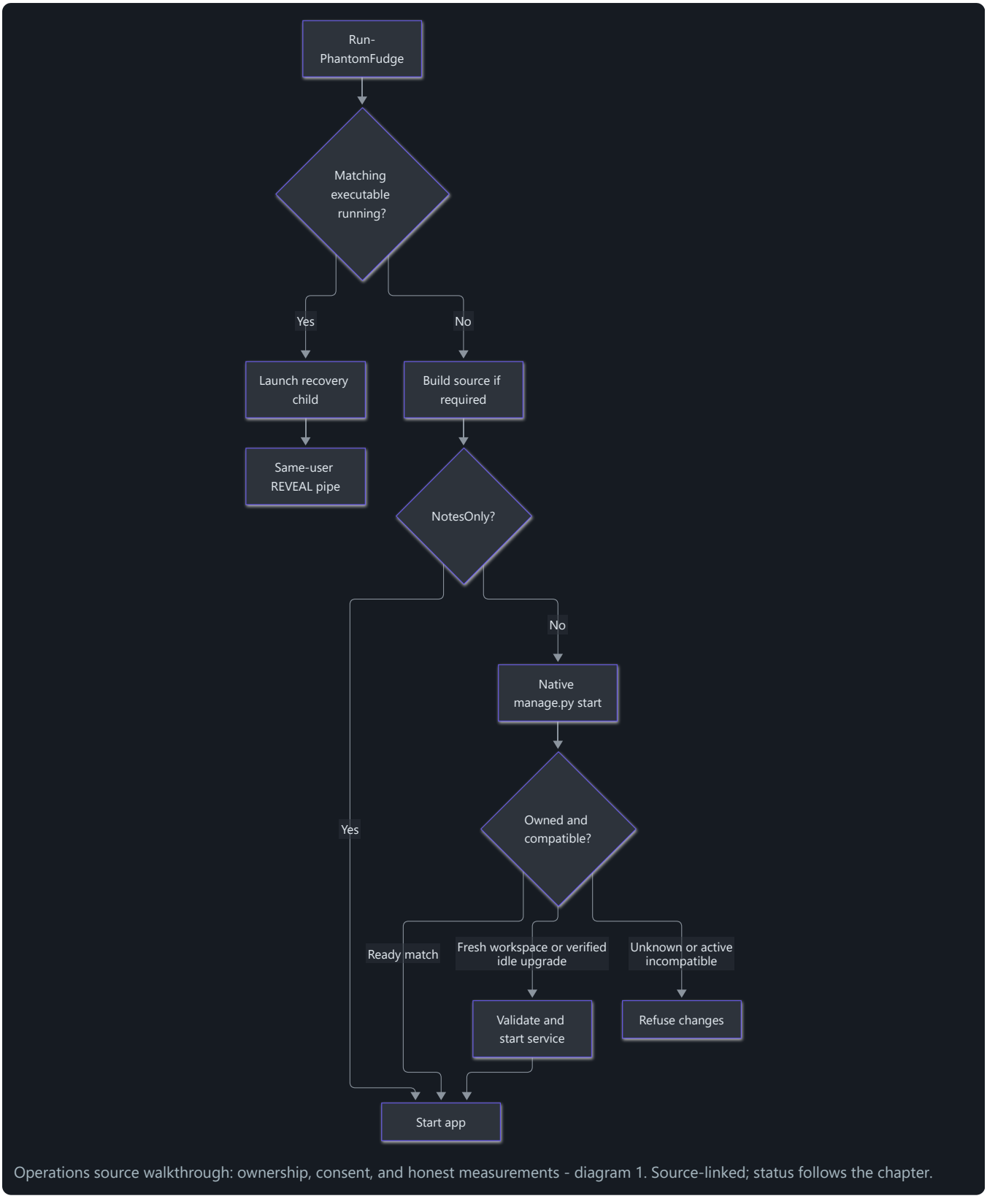
The token is another commitment: create 32 random bytes only when absent, encode them as hex, write with `CreateNew`, restrict the Windows DACL to the current SID, and reject invalid existing values instead of silently rotating credentials. Clearing managed variables is not secure erasure. Setup can create this token before a later model failure, so the procedure is staged, not globally transactional. (scripts/Initialize-Transcription.ps1:42)

**"No model download" does not mean "no network."** Unless skipped, Python setup can create a venv, invoke pip and check dependencies. A requirements-file hash receipt plus three import checks decides whether restoration is needed; it is not a full installed-package integrity audit. `-SkipPythonSetup` skips that stage, not Whisper verification. Hybrid provisioning then uses the local interpreter, or host Python if absent, and forwards `--download` only when selected. The Python provisioner first accepts valid installed files or a verified benchmark cache; existing bad files require explicit repair. (scripts/Initialize-Transcription.ps1:119) (scripts/Initialize-Transcription.ps1:147) (services/transcription/provision_whisper.py:47)

The final configuration is written through `.new` and moved into place only after those stages succeed. Production loading checks an exact key set and validates engine, model, vocabulary and thread bounds. Selecting Vosk is explicit legacy behavior, not automatic rescue after Whisper fails. (scripts/Initialize-Transcription.ps1:157) (services/transcription/configuration.py:17)

## Recovery precedes build and service management

The diagram follows the launcher and its manager dependency; “ready” never means capture has started. (scripts/Run-PhantomFudge.ps1:17) (services/transcription/manage.py:203)



Operations source walkthrough: ownership, consent, and honest measurements - diagram 1. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

The existing-instance branch filters by executable path and launches a recovery child; it does not kill the first process or report confirmed restoration. `App.OnStartup` dispatches the child to `SingleInstance.RevealExistingAsync`, which sends only six-byte `REVEAL` through a current-user-only pipe. The first instance schedules its reveal/reset operation on the dispatcher. `-PassThru` returns the recovery child on this branch, not the original app. (scripts/Run-PhantomFudge.ps1:17) (src/PhantomFudge.App/App.xaml.cs:62) (src/PhantomFudge.App/Native/SingleInstance.cs:28)

For a new launch, packaged executables bypass source builds. `-NotesOnly` skips service startup; it is **not** a privacy sandbox or permanent capture prohibition. The launcher still supplies an available token and the fixed loopback URI to the child. (scripts/Run-PhantomFudge.ps1:29) (scripts/Run-PhantomFudge.ps1:43)

Service ownership is stronger than "a PID exists." `manage.py` locks lifecycle changes, combines the local receipt with authenticated service/instance identity, and checks protocol support plus a configuration fingerprint containing runtime-source hashes. An incompatible active service is refused. Replacement assets are validated **before** shutting down an owned idle service. With no listener, a stale receipt is removed only after process inspection confirms death or PID reuse; live/unknown ownership is retained rather than overwritten. Shutdown uses an instance-bound authenticated request and requires `active=false`; it does not terminate an unrelated OS process. (services/transcription/manage.py:66) (services/transcription/manage.py:155) (services/transcription/manage.py:186) (services/transcription/manage.py:215) (services/transcription/configuration.py:38)

Docker is an explicit alternative branch requiring existing recipes, engine and Compose. It is neither installed nor selected as fallback. Its `compose down` path does not inherit the native manager's idle/identity protocol, so the two stop modes should not be described as equivalent safeguards. (scripts/Start-Transcription.ps1:18) (scripts/Stop-Transcription.ps1:8)

# 2. Answer preparation, authentication, and probe isolation

`Initialize-Answers.ps1` requires an explicit provider. `SnapshotOnly` avoids executable preparation; the other modes invoke app preparation entry points and validate their returned installed executable. A 30-second preparation timeout kills only the owned child tree. The app writes a receipt and exits before ordinary window startup. Configuration subsequently moves from a temporary file to per-user `answers.json`; the runtime reader rejects oversized or unmapped settings. (scripts/Initialize-Answers.ps1:29) (scripts/Initialize-Answers.ps1:44) (src/PhantomFudge.App/App.xaml.cs:18) (src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AnswerConfiguration.cs:15)

`LocalModel` requires an identifier and literal HTTP loopback `/v1` endpoint, not a hostname selected implicitly. That regex is only the first gate: its one-to-five-digit port shape is not numeric TCP-port validation. `-Connect` is Copilot-only and explicitly runs login in the dedicated profile, after scrubbing named inherited environment families. Unlike preparation, login has no scripted timeout. Failed login prevents enabling new settings but does not undo preparation/profile side effects. No question is submitted here; installed CLI execution must not be equated with offline inference. (scripts/Initialize-Answers.ps1:11) (scripts/Initialize-Answers.ps1:62)

The desktop preserves the downstream distinction: ordinary Ask has no clarification history; `clarifyFirst` begins false, and a correction or Yes requires explicit submission. A typed correction is not discarded by clicking confirmation. Direct Azure remains future work, and source-only selection/clarification increments must not be attributed to the historical `045022` ZIP. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Clarification.cs:11) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Clarification.cs:117) (TODO/00_INDEX.todo:39)

The two CopilotProbe files are **active experiments**, not passive configuration readers:

| Helper | What source actually arranges | Limit |
| --- | --- | --- |
| `agency_profile_probe.py` | Unique home, empty plugin selection, restricted environment, version and `config check --skip-remotes` calls | Hard-coded local installation; module-level execution; prints exit results rather than asserting success |
| `probe.py` | Two ephemeral loopback HTTP servers, isolated CLI home, attachment/home sentinels, SSE/error/tool/truncation/redirect cases | Observes installed-CLI behavior; settings and flags are not an OS sandbox |

The protocol probe stores only authorization presence, not its value, but records synthetic user messages. Its timeout terminates the owned PID tree; `--keep` retains receipts. Cleanup is not wrapped around every possible startup/write failure. Neither helper was executed for this chapter. (tools/CopilotProbe/agency_profile_probe.py:9) (tools/CopilotProbe/agency_profile_probe.py:29) (tools/CopilotProbe/probe.py:76) (tools/CopilotProbe/probe.py:118) (tools/CopilotProbe/probe.py:135)

# 3. Packaging and visual evidence are allowlisted transformations

## Installer workstream58 is separate from the legacy ZIP

The new installation chapter traces `Build-Installer.ps1`, the Inno recipe and native launcher. It targets an unsigned Windows11 x64 prerelease with bundled speech runtime/models, per-user installation and guarded update/uninstall. Candidate2 built and lifecycle3 passed; a clean committed release build and publication remain **pending**. See current evidence. Private repository access, retained external data and separate provider setup remain explicit. The self-contained publish/asset recipe is not a passing installer lifecycle receipt. (scripts/Build-Installer.ps1:30-54,56-114) (tools/Installer/PhantomFudge.iss:14-76,107-161) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/Program.cs:25-100)

Compact launcher metadata and complete payload inventory are separate. The inventory omits its own self-hash; hidden-entry/reparse/private-path checks happen before it is written. The installer fixture uses an isolated random AppId/path, exact payload coverage/hashes and a simulated older version record. Lifecycle3 passes 11 checks against 3,682 inventoried files from current-runtime candidate2, including fresh-helper repair and headless layout validation. It omits shortcuts, does not start the app/service and does not establish genuine old-binary migration or clean-VM qualification. The build's separate real-PCM gate requires natural process exit. (scripts/Build-Installer.ps1:56-98) (scripts/Build-Installer.ps1:30-34) (scripts/Test-Installer.ps1:15-18,40-84,96-104) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/Program.cs:25-43,94-100)

The runtime bundler pins embedded CPython3.13.14, discloses PCM-only `faster-whisper 1.2.1+phantomfudge1` and rebuilds `CTranslate2 4.6.0+phantomfudge2` with oneDNN3.1.1/Microsoft compiler OpenMP. It retains package/native notices, including the explicit PyAV omission rationale, rather than copying private environments or providers. Its import probe labels closure as modified installed metadata only. The separate `--verify-synthetic-pcm` gate, required by `Build-Installer.ps1`, runs real hybrid/VAD/forced Whisper computation and requires natural exit. The parent confirms85focused tests; the owner reports successful Unicode execution; the Vosk package is unmodified and a first-party working-directory adapter handles non-ASCII paths. Earlier Ruy stages remain rejected. Neither this generated-PCM result nor older development speech measurements qualifies real captured-speech accuracy, new-backend performance or a

clean VM. (tools/Installer/runtime-lock.json:1-11) (tools/Installer/bundle_runtime.py:246-282,332-376,465-535,538-609,682-694) (scripts/Build-Installer.ps1:30-34) (services/transcription/recognizer.py:47-77) (services/transcription/tests/test_packaged_pcm_runtime.py:35-97,126-138)

`bundle` now unconditionally runs `runtime_audit.audit_pe_closure` before imports, storing the auditor's source hash and native dependency records in the manifest. The static check resolves declared ordinary/delay/forwarder DLL names only against reviewed inbox names or supported bundled locations; the shared probe separately requires the five VC runtime DLLs beside Python. This closes the evidentiary gap left by merely restricting `PATH`. The parent reports 92 speech PE files/five actual bundled CRT paths passing and a separate 861-file app/launcher static pass. The final DLL-qualified runtime rebuild now passes the stronger gate; the parent also confirms85 focused runtime tests and55native tests passing again. Candidate2's functional DLLs are unchanged; these are not clean-VM or comprehensive dynamic-loading results. (tools/Installer/bundle_runtime.py:45,677-694) (tools/Installer/runtime_audit.py:126-166,169-234)

Setup never starts the app; users finish/close it and then launch from Start. The launcher does not release its operation mutex merely because a child survived a delay: it waits for the main app mutex or confirmed child exit, reports pending76after30seconds, and preserves the guard when pending Close hides progress or the dispatcher shuts down. Its status/error surface is ordinary visible UI, not the capture-excluded notes HWND. (tools/Installer/PhantomFudge.iss:14-76) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/Program.cs:108-118,186-227) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/LauncherWindow.cs:18-57)

## Historical development package

`Publish-Preview.ps1` creates a new timestamped, self-contained .NET `win-x64` directory, refuses collisions, and rejects nonzero publish status before compression. Supplementary content is explicit: nine guides, eight script names, eleven speech runtime/configuration files and five selected historical result files. It does not recursively copy `.local`, tokens, venvs, model caches or probe directories. Self-contained .NET does not mean Python, voices, provider executables or models are bundled. (scripts/Publish-Preview.ps1:14) (scripts/Publish-Preview.ps1:27)

The script-mirror convention has an especially useful implementation:

```
Copy-Item -LiteralPath $source -Destination $scripts
Copy-Item -LiteralPath $source -Destination (Join-Path $scripts "$name.txt")
```

Both outputs read the canonical `.ps1`, so packaged aliases derive from the same bytes rather than a second maintained implementation. This documentation annotates only canonical scripts; parent validation owns source-tree alias equality. ZIP hashing identifies bytes, not signing, publication or qualification. (scripts/Publish-Preview.ps1:30) (scripts/Publish-Preview.ps1:49)

Image export follows another evidence boundary. The screenshot helper builds a separate fixture, waits up to 45 seconds, and requires successful non-recording documentation output before importing twenty named PNGs. It records image dimensions/hashes, selected UI-source hashes and assembly identity. The README helper requires exactly one matching source-hash record, composites ten images unscaled over fixed opaque palette backgrounds, and records both hashes. These loops are incremental, not transactional. Neither RenderTargetBitmap nor successful provenance checks establish recipient-side capture exclusion. (scripts/Export-HandbookScreenshots.ps1:12) (scripts/Export-HandbookScreenshots.ps1:26) (scripts/Export-HandbookScreenshots.ps1:78) (scripts/Export-ReadmeImages.ps1:28)

# 4. Diagnostics: collection, summary, and export are different

`Set-Diagnostics.ps1` persists only `includeText`; the app must reload it. Metadata is default. Text mode retains final transcripts, submitted questions and answers locally in plaintext, not raw audio. Changing back does not erase old files. The producer restricts metadata values and content kinds before writing; the exporter is not the sole privacy control. (scripts/Set-Diagnostics.ps1:8)
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/Diagnostics/LocalDiagnostics.cs:145)
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/Diagnostics/LocalDiagnostics.cs:162)

`Export-Diagnostics.ps1` creates a timestamped local directory and projects records onto two field lists. App text is included only with the independent `-IncludeText`; backend fields never gain text:

```
$safe = [ordered]@{}
foreach ($key in $keys) {
    if ($record.PSObject.Properties.Name -contains $key) { $safe[$key] = $record.$key }
}
```

The empty destination object is important: unknown top-level fields cannot survive by accident. However, values under accepted keys are copied, not recursively anonymized. File-level reparse checks and shared ReadWrite/Delete access support reading active/rotating logs; malformed JSON is counted, while strict UTF-8 or other I/O errors can still abort. The manifest reports separate app/backend counts, skipped lines, requested text inclusion and `uploaded=false`. No upload operation appears. (scripts/Export-Diagnostics.ps1:19)
(scripts/Export-Diagnostics.ps1:34) (scripts/Export-Diagnostics.ps1:43) (scripts/Export-Diagnostics.ps1:73)

`Show-Diagnostics.ps1` selects recent `AnswerStarted` records with `user_ask` by default, joins by correlation ID and separates app-received text, UI-visible text and terminal time. It never displays Text. Missing/rotated records remain missing, not zero; first-event selection uses encounter order, while terminal selection uses UTC order. Text-mode content records can also carry `AnswerCompleted` without elapsed time, so this summary is not an infallible latency ledger. (scripts/Show-Diagnostics.ps1:26)
(src/PhantomFudge.Core/Diagnostics/LocalDiagnostics.cs:179)

# 5. Synthetic corpus design and comparable inputs

The historical corpus has eight ordinary/technical/numeric sentences; the quality corpus combines the requested two-sum phrase, four technical variations and three unrelated/homophone controls. Quality generation requires two installed en-US voices; the older benchmark accepts one or two. Neither installs voice packs. System.Speech synthesizes into memory and raw PCM files, never a speaker destination in this path. (tools/SpeechBench/corpus.json:2) (tools/SpeechBench/quality-corpus.json:2)
(tools/SpeechBench/quality_regression.py:44) (tools/SpeechBench/SapiBridge.cs:53)

Both generators produce clean and deterministic 15 dB Gaussian-noise variants. At 16 kHz, mono int16 means **32,000 bytes/second**. Leading 4,000 samples equal 250 ms; trailing padding is one second historically and 1.5 seconds in quality runs. Noise amplitude is scaled by `speechRms / 10^(15/20) / measuredNoiseRms`, then samples are clipped and rounded. This is a controlled SNR construction, not a recording of real room noise.

Quality additionally creates three-second digital silence, noise-only and tone-only cases with empty references. (tools/SpeechBench/bench.py:125) (tools/SpeechBench/quality_regression.py:62) (tools/SpeechBench/quality_regression.py:85)




Operations source walkthrough: ownership, consent, and honest measurements - diagram 2. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

These are related measurement concepts, **not one automatic pipeline**: `quality_receipt.main` consumes named quality/stress receipts, not historical `bench` output. Direct package versions are pinned, including `num2words` because normalization affects scores; quality adds `aiohttp`. These files are not complete transitive hash locks. Historical Whisper provisioning records observed post-download hashes for a pinned revision; production provisioning instead checks its checked-in file sizes/hashes and exact file set. Neither claims publisher signatures. (tools/SpeechBench/requirements.txt:1) (tools/SpeechBench/quality-requirements.txt:1) (tools/SpeechBench/bench.py:75) (services/transcription/whisper-models.json:4) (services/transcription/provision_whisper.py:37)

### Cross-language boundary: C# callbacks to Python results

`SapiBridge.Decode` attaches recognized/completed handlers before starting asynchronous file dictation, waits up to sixty seconds, requests cancellation on timeout and always detaches handlers/clears input. Python waits for the hosting PowerShell process, reads JSON and applies the common score. This explains why a subprocess exit alone is insufficient: the bridge can return `status=unavailable`. (tools/SpeechBench/SapiBridge.cs:75) (tools/SpeechBench/sapi.ps1:7) (tools/SpeechBench/bench.py:66)

**Explanatory C# → Python pseudocode, not production:**

```
parts = []
subscribe_recognized(lambda text: parts.append(text))
subscribe_completed(lambda error: completion.signal(error))
try:
    start_file_dictation(wav_bytes)
    completion.wait_or_cancel(deadline_seconds=60)
    return " ".join(parts)
finally:
    unsubscribe_handlers()
    clear_input()
```

Subscription must precede start; waiting must include completion, not merely scheduling; cleanup must occur on failure as well as success. The actual C# also waits up to five seconds after cancellation and preserves the engine error. (tools/SpeechBench/SapiBridge.cs:89) (tools/SpeechBench/SapiBridge.cs:95)

## 6. WER, CER, and timing math

Normalization applies NFKC, lowercase, percent expansion, digit-to-English conversion, apostrophe removal and ASCII alphabetic token extraction. It does **not** remove stop words or repair model-specific mistakes. The dynamic program carries `(total, substitutions, deletions, insertions)` and chooses substitution, deletion, insertion in that order on equal total cost. WER is `(S+D+I)/referenceWords`, can exceed one, and is undefined for an empty reference while insertion errors remain. (tools/SpeechBench/metrics.py:16) (tools/SpeechBench/metrics.py:28)

Pooling must sum counts before dividing. **Explanatory Python → JavaScript pseudocode**, translating `aggregate`, not a replacement implementation:

```
function pooledWer(rows) {
  const words = rows.reduce((sum, row) => sum + row.reference_words, 0);
  const edits = rows.reduce((sum, row) => sum + row.errors, 0);
  return words === 0 ? null : edits / words;
}
```

One error in a one-word case plus four correct words is `1/5`, not `(1+0)/2`. Empty-reference hallucinations still increase pooled errors. Secondary CER joins normalized words without spaces and computes character distance: `leet code` / `LeetCode` can have zero CER while retaining WER errors; `two sum` / `to some` cannot. Receipt tests include arbitrary compounds, spelling errors, empty-reference insertions and repeated phrases to guard this distinction. (tools/SpeechBench/metrics.py:58) (tools/SpeechBench/test_metrics.py:34) (tools/SpeechBench/quality_receipt.py:11) (tools/SpeechBench/test_quality_receipt.py:7)

| Quantity | Exact boundary and interpretive limit |
|---|---|
| Historical batch RTF | Median repeat-total decode seconds divided by total audio seconds; excludes load, warmup and paced experiments |
| Historical accuracy | Repeat zero only; later repeats report timing and changed hypotheses |
| Quality ready time | WebSocket connection/start/strict-ready interval, before stream clock starts |
| Speech-end-to-final | Last nonempty final wall time minus fixed clean last-active-sample time; paced rows only |
| Quality p95 | Sorted non-null values at `ceil(0.95*n)-1`; cold first row is retained |
| Stress Stop latency | Terminal stopped time minus sent-Stop time, only if Stop was sent and stopped acknowledged |

These definitions are implemented independently; batch throughput cannot establish conversational latency. Quality aggregation includes all repeats, unlike historical accuracy. (tools/SpeechBench/bench.py:257) (tools/SpeechBench/bench.py:354) (tools/SpeechBench/quality_regression.py:141) (tools/SpeechBench/quality_regression.py:182) (tools/SpeechBench/quality_regression.py:204) (tools/SpeechBench/quality_stress.py:188)

# 7. Long stress: byte correctness is not word correctness

The dual-source runner concatenates cropped clean Computer phrases twice and padded Mic phrases once. It sends 1,280-byte packets—40 ms—per source with a one-byte source tag. The shorter source ends earlier without mixing tracks. Forced-endpoint and temperature-fallback experiments are explicit modifications, not normal recovery behavior; current production rejects forced windows beyond its 15-second ceiling despite historical comments mentioning thirty seconds. (tools/SpeechBench/quality_stress.py:26) (tools/SpeechBench/quality_stress.py:38) (tools/SpeechBench/quality_stress.py:58) (tools/SpeechBench/quality_stress.py:146)

Each finalized span is mapped to its source, timed and fed into a running PCM hash. Validation combines contiguous start/end sample ranges, final cursor coverage and equal input/decoded hashes. `all_samples_owned_once` alone only compares the ending cursor; the conjunction matters. Final IDs must be exactly `1..N` globally. The receipt is written **before** assertions so faults remain evidence rather than

disappearing. Exact sample ownership can coexist with wrong words. (tools/SpeechBench/quality_stress.py:112) (tools/SpeechBench/quality_stress.py:164) (tools/SpeechBench/quality_stress.py:199)

The compiler preserves rejected experiments and replaces invalid historical error-terminal “Stop latency” with null, retaining the old value under an explicitly unusable name. It checks identical case ordering/PCM/reference text, recomputed WER, faults/drops and a production setup fingerprint. Its hardware descriptions and historical interpretation are authored constants, not fresh discovery. The setup check itself validates one paced phrase and expected `LeetCode` spelling, not an entire accuracy suite. (tools/SpeechBench/quality_receipt.py:56) (tools/SpeechBench/quality_receipt.py:78) (tools/SpeechBench/quality_receipt.py:100) (tools/SpeechBench/quality_setup_check.py:60)

# 8. What the checks do—and do not—establish

| Check | Arrangement, stimulus, and assertion | Not established |
|---|---|---|
| Harness guards | Mock WAV at 44.1 kHz, duplicate IDs, empty corpus and output escapes must fail | Real audio/model correctness |
| Metrics tests | Known normalization/edit/weighting examples | Multilingual or semantic accuracy |
| Native lifecycle | Own blank HWND; minimize/hide, relaunch, then close | Recipient capture exclusion or UX approval |
| Dual synthetic wrapper | Separate in-memory source phrases; Python/native harness exit status | Device routing, microphone echo or actual meeting quality |
| Playback wrapper | Explicit consent, synthetic PCM and expected phrase through real loopback harness | Isolation from unrelated output audio |

These limits follow the actual arrangements, not the filenames. (tools/SpeechBench/test_harness.py:9) (tools/SpeechBench/test_metrics.py:19) (scripts/Test-NativeLifecycle.ps1:69) (scripts/Test-DualSourceSynthetic.ps1:18) (scripts/Test-PlaybackTranscription.ps1:29)

Mechanical line coverage is not proof that every subtle behavior has been understood. External speech libraries, CLI versions, model correctness, real devices, live providers and recipient capture remain separate boundaries. This chapter’s diagrams were authored from source; rendering/compiler validation is reserved for the parent’s integration pass. Full source, focused snippets and per-block exceptions remain in the atlas, rather than duplicated as source dumps here.

# 28 - Documentation Compiler and Root Configuration, Statement by Statement

## Why explanation needs its own integrity checks

The request for every interesting line creates two different obligations. First, the explanation must actually interpret the program: what values mean, why a guard precedes a mutation, what a failure preserves, and which layer owns an operation. Second, the documentation must expose what was covered. A persuasive paragraph cannot demonstrate that an overlooked file was read.

The source atlas separates those obligations. Authored annotation groups explain contiguous source ranges and choose consequential excerpts. A compiler checks the file inventory, exact source bytes, partition boundaries and generated edition. The searchable atlas shows the complete source beside these explanations; its coverage ledger makes missing or stale work visible. The compiler does **not** claim to prove that each explanation is correct. That remains a reading/review obligation. (`validateFileAnnotation` and `loadAtlas`.)

The main handbook supplies conceptual and end-to-end walkthroughs. The source atlas is the per-file reference, including tests and operational tooling. Its PDF prints explanatory blocks and selected excerpts, while the HTML also exposes every source line. Repeating twenty thousand lines of source in the main book would create bulk without necessarily adding understanding. The companion structure keeps code available without replacing explanation with a dump. (`renderFile`, `makeHtml` and `main`.)

## The first configuration statements already change behavior

`Directory.Build.props` applies common C# build policy to the projects beneath the repository directory. `Nullable` enables nullable analysis; `ImplicitUsings` supplies SDK-selected imports; `TreatWarningsAsErrors` promotes compiler warnings to build failures. These settings are not runtime null guards and do not prove that every external value is validated. `Deterministic` requests deterministic compilation, while `RestorePackagesWithLockFile` creates a dependency resolution record. Reproducibility still depends on the actual SDK and inputs. (Directory.Build.props:1-9.)

`global.json` supplies that SDK selection: version `10.0.112`, patch-level roll-forward and no prerelease selection. The SDK is not the same thing as the deployed .NET Desktop Runtime. `PhantomFudge.slnx` then groups the spike, application/Core and two test projects. A directory appearing in the solution does not run it, and the source atlas does not run those projects while reading them. The exact project references and launch scripts are explained in their own groups. (global.json:1-7; PhantomFudge.slnx:1-13.)

The repository's ignore files answer different questions. `.gitignore` excludes ordinary working artifacts such as private continuity, local models, dependency caches and build outputs from untracked-file discovery. It does not retroactively untrack a previously committed file. `.dockerignore` instead starts with `**` and reopens

selected service paths: that is a build-context allowlist, not a runtime filesystem rule. The source compiler applies its own public-path checks rather than treating either ignore file as a universal privacy guarantee. (`.gitignore`, `.dockerignore`, `readPublic`.)

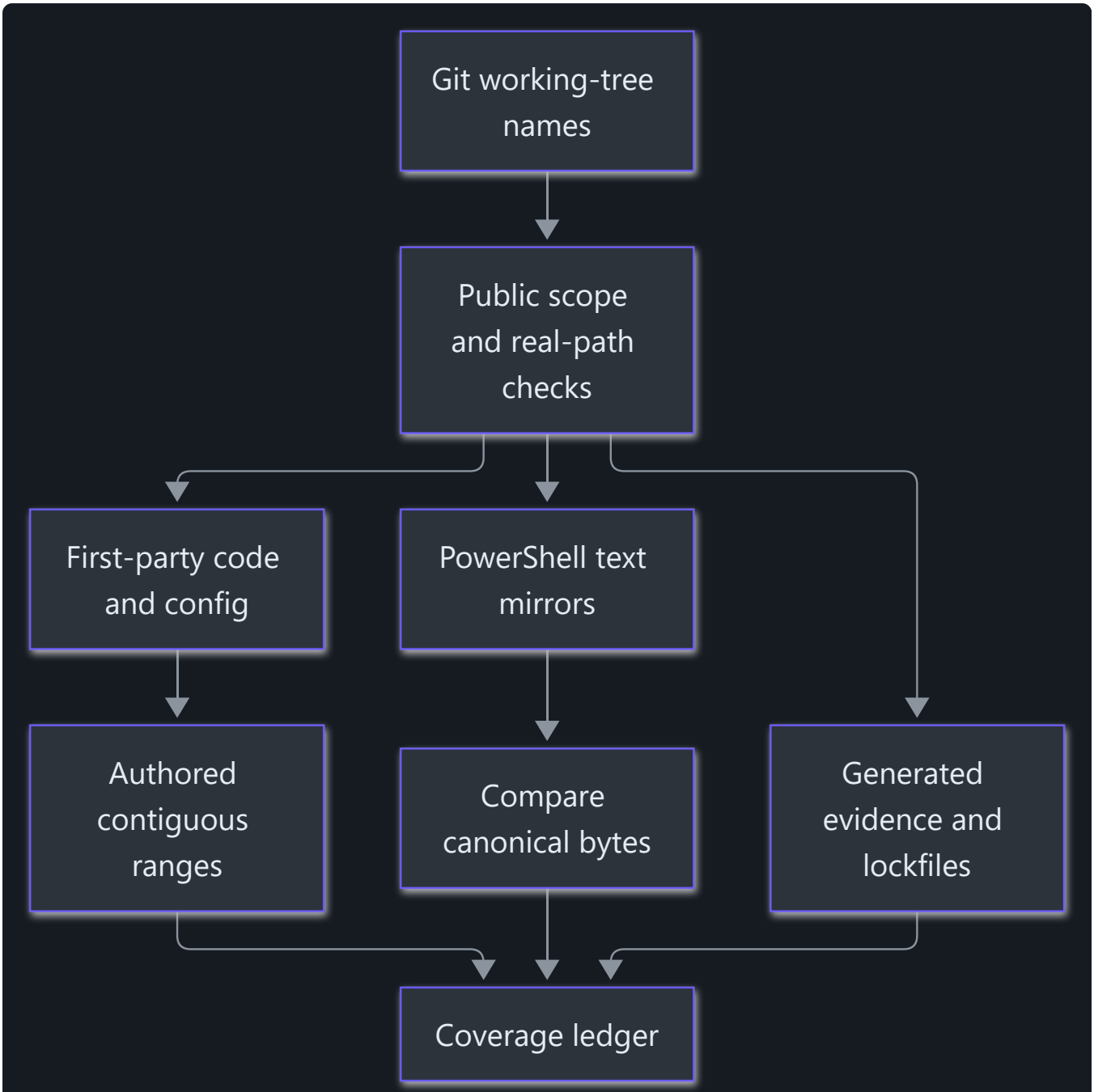
`compose.yaml` is an optional legacy-service recipe, not the normal architecture. The literal `127.0.0.1` host binding limits the published host interface; `create_host_path: false` prevents a mistyped model path from silently becoming a newly created empty directory. Read-only mounts, all-capability dropping and `no-new-privileges` express separate container controls. The file also sets CPU/memory/PID/file-descriptor limits, disables automatic restart and supplies a 15-second stop grace period. These declarations have not become qualified execution evidence merely because they are documented. Native accurate recognition and its drain budget are separate. (compose.yaml:1-48.)

# Inventory: distinguish source, mirrors and generated records

The compiler asks Git for cached and untracked, non-ignored names using a NUL-delimited result. NUL separation avoids shell quoting assumptions about spaces in paths. The command is a metadata read; it is not a fetch, push, repository search service or execution of source files. An 8-MiB output bound prevents an unexpectedly large listing from being treated as an unbounded stream. (`discoverSources`.)

Classification is explicit. First-party C#, XAML, Python, JavaScript, PowerShell, CSS, project files, requirements and selected JSON/configuration files are annotated. Build/cache directories are not. Generated `results` records and dependency lockfiles are indexed with a different kind: their existence and bytes are tracked, but the book does not pretend that every generated value received statement-level interpretation. Root build/configuration inputs and the book catalogue are explicit exceptions to the implementation-directory rule. (`sourceKind`.)

A PowerShell `.txt` twin receives a third treatment. It maps to its `.ps1` canonical source and must be byte-identical. Annotating both copies would double the apparent coverage without explaining additional logic. Failing the equality check is an actionable packaging/documentation drift error, not permission to pick one version silently. Unrelated text files are not automatically assumed to be executable mirrors. (`discoverSources`.)




28 - Documentation Compiler and Root Configuration, Statement by Statement - diagram 1. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

## A path is validated twice for different reasons

Lexical validation prevents an annotation from naming `../outside.cs`, an absolute path, or private directories. Real-path validation then resolves the filesystem target and refuses aliases that would bypass the intended path. The existing handbook helper is reused for the repository boundary. It rejects private context, `.local`, Git state, environment files and dependency caches. This is a constrained local documentation reader, not an operating-system sandbox. (tools/Docs/build.mjs:75-87; `readPublic`.)

A source hash is deliberately compared against the authored annotation, not merely regenerated into a new manifest. If the source changes, the old explanation must fail before publication. Updating `sourceSha256` without reading the new source would bypass the human part of the contract, even though it could satisfy the

mechanical check. Exact-byte hashes also detect line-ending changes; they are edition fingerprints, not semantic equivalence proofs. (`validateFileAnnotation`.)

## Physical lines: one small `pop` matters

The line splitter normalizes CRLF and bare CR for indexing and removes a leading UTF-8 BOM from display text. It discards only the final empty item created by a terminal newline. It does not delete every blank line. Therefore `"a\\n\\n"` represents the line containing `a` and a real blank line, not one line and not three. The source hash still uses the original bytes. (`physicalLines`.)

This **explanatory Python pseudocode is not production code**:

```
lines = normalize_newlines(source_without_display_bom).split("\n")
if lines and lines[-1] == "":
    lines.pop()  # Remove only the separator-created final item.
```

The distinction matters because an annotation ending one line too early could otherwise appear complete or a correct final range could appear oversized. The Node tests include BOM, CRLF, bare CR, empty-file and repeated-terminal-newline cases. (Documentation tests.)

## Range validation: transactional coverage rather than optimistic totals

The partition check starts with `next = 1`. Each block must start exactly at `next`, have an integer end not before its start, and remain within the actual source. After a block succeeds, `next` becomes `end + 1`. At the end it must equal `lineCount + 1`. This rejects gaps and overlaps instead of accepting a misleading sum of range lengths. Two overlapping hundred-line ranges cannot compensate for an unexplained hundred-line gap. (`validateFileAnnotation`.)

Block-size limits force large methods to be divided at meaningful boundaries. The ordinary maximum is 80 physical lines; test/diagnostic fixtures may use 120. This is not an assertion that 80 lines are always one coherent concept. A reviewer must still separate admission, transformation, mutation and cleanup when those responsibilities differ. The limit only prevents the most obvious “one paragraph covers the whole file” substitute.

Focused excerpts have a different budget: at most 12 lines, inside their owning block. An excerpt can highlight the mutation barrier or cancellation registration while the explanation discusses the complete range. Full source remains expandable in HTML. The printable edition uses those selected excerpts; if none is supplied, it shows the first eight lines of the block as context. (`validateFileAnnotation` and `renderFile`.)

The schema rejects unknown fields so a misspelled `explanation` cannot be silently ignored. It requires an explicit responsibility and entry points/readers for every file. Short placeholder text is rejected, but sentence length is not a correctness test. Assertions such as “this catches all failures” still require semantic review against the actual catch filters and callers.

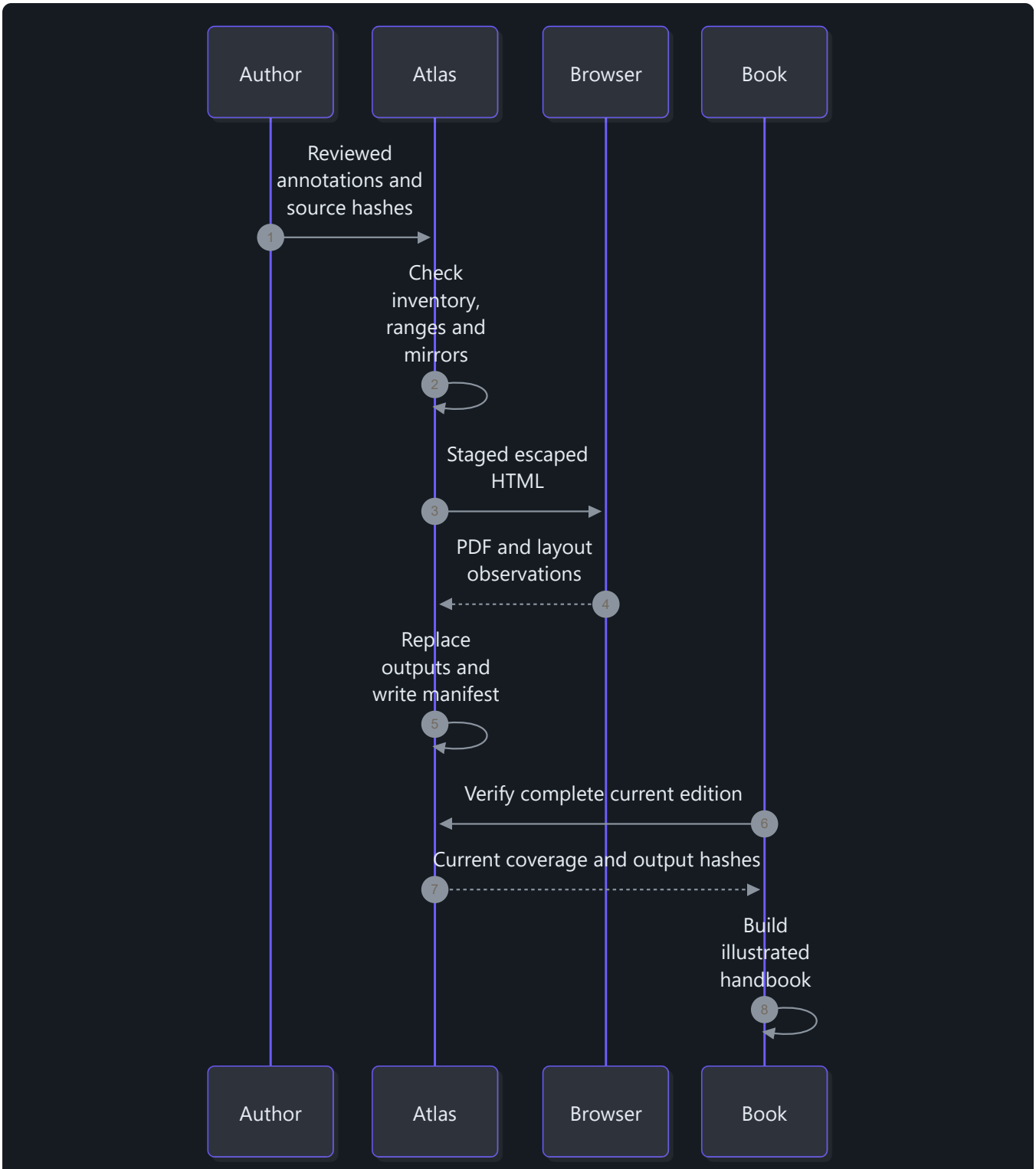
# Rendering: source is data, never HTML

Every source line and annotation string passes through HTML escaping before insertion. This is why a string containing `<script>` is shown as code rather than creating a browser script node. The only executable browser code is the owned reader script; source code is never evaluated. The reader uses a stable path-derived file ID plus a short hash suffix, so source anchors do not change merely because a statement's contents change. (`escapeHtml`, `fileId`, `sourceRows`.)

The client builds a lowercase search index from each file section's text, which includes both source and explanation. Searching only titles would miss the exact identifier the reader is trying to understand. Filtering changes visibility locally; it does not send a query to a server. Hash navigation reopens the full-source details element when a line target is inside it. If a search hid the destination, navigation clears that filter before scrolling. Invalid URI escapes are handled narrowly as `URIError`; unrelated exceptions are not swallowed. (Reader script.)

Before manual printing, the script temporarily clears search and restores it afterward. The PDF must not accidentally contain only the last searched file. Print CSS hides the full-source details and search controls, starts each file on a fresh page, keeps numbered excerpts readable and wraps long paths/code. The annotations remain the printable body. The reader checks desktop, tablet and narrow-screen widths before producing the PDF. (Reader script, atlas stylesheet.)

# Publication order and freshness




28 - Documentation Compiler and Root Configuration, Statement by Statement - diagram 2. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

Staging paths include the current process ID. A failed browser or PDF check does not become a success-shaped empty companion. Cleanup closes only the browser launched for this operation and removes only the staged files. The final manifest is written after output files and their hashes are available. An HTML-only build

is explicitly intermediate; `--check` refuses to call it complete. (Atlas `main` and `verifySourceAtlas`.)

The handbook entry point verifies the atlas before reading its own chapters, and records the atlas manifest as an input. That connects the conceptual volume to the exact source-reference volume. The existing book compiler separately validates frontmatter, five-source citation depth, real line ranges, catalogue constraints and diagram requirements. Those checks do not replace the authored source annotations, and annotations do not replace diagrams or end-to-end explanations. (tools/Docs/build.mjs:37-73,116-154; `main`.)

The command order is intentional:

```
node --test .\tools\Docs\test-docs.mjs
node .\tools\Docs\source-atlas.mjs --validate
node .\tools\Docs\source-atlas.mjs
.\scripts\Build-Handbook.ps1 -AcceptReviewedSource
.\scripts\Build-Handbook.ps1 -Check
```

The atlas does not execute application or benchmark code to explain it. A source walkthrough may describe a synthetic positive-control capture test without running an unprotected window during a presentation. Likewise, documenting `--allow-cloud` does not authorize invoking it.

# What a future change must update

Adding a first-party implementation file creates a missing-coverage error until it has an authored entry. Editing a covered file makes its annotation hash stale. Moving a function requires updating the range partition and meaningful focused excerpts, not merely shifting all numbers mechanically. Changing a `.ps1` requires its `.txt` mirror. Changing source-atlas rendering requires documentation tests, its own annotation entry and a rebuilt companion.

The existing main handbook's byte/range checks still require interpretation review. An accurate line number beside a false explanation is still false. Use the companion to locate statements, then follow the cited callers and dependencies; do not treat green coverage counts as a substitute for understanding. External SDK internals, actual microphone conditions, remote capture behavior, provider quality and current service credentials remain separate evidence boundaries.

# References

- Atlas compiler, reader, stylesheet.
- Handbook compiler, documentation checks, wrapper.
- SDK selection, common project policy, solution, optional Compose recipe.
- Annotated source index and maintenance contract.

Source: docs/ANSWER-PROVIDERS.md

# Answer providers

The question composer is provider-independent. A frozen question becomes an `AnswerRequest` containing a new request ID and, by default, **ExactText only**, not notes, original selected-source text, transcript history or audio. `IAnswerProvider` streams text and an explicit terminal event. Azure can be added through another adapter without replacing capture, draft editing or answer UI. (`src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AnswerContracts.cs:1-13`; `src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AnswerRun.cs:14-29`.)

**Opt-in exception:** Clarify first adds a fixed interpretation instruction and, for explicit replies, this question's bounded clarification exchanges. It is off on launch. No machine metadata, unselected transcript or unrelated history is attached. Interpretation requests can ask a short clarifying question; normal and confirmed-answer requests retain the no-follow-up rule. Each user reply starts a separate request, never automatic stdin input.

## Local installation is not necessarily local inference

| Choice | Where the model runs | Requirements |
|---|---|---|
| Snapshot only | No model call | Default until explicitly configured |
| Agency | Agency's existing model service; local background process | Installed Agency, existing model authentication and an isolated prompt-only profile |
| Copilot CLI / GitHub | GitHub-hosted model service; CLI process on your machine | Installed compatible CLI, eligible subscription/policy and explicit sign-in |
| Copilot CLI / local model | Your configured loopback model server | Installed compatible CLI plus an already-running OpenAI-compatible local model |
| Direct Azure | Future adapter, not currently configured | Future approved Azure resource, identity, deployment and data policy |

There is no automatic fallback between these destinations. Direct Copilot cloud operation remains unvalidated after its failed smoke attempt; installed Agency is the successfully exercised hosted path. A missing local server must not send a question to GitHub. A CLI installed on a laptop does **not** by itself mean offline inference.

## Setup and first use

**Current requested path: installed Agency, no new sign-in or organization-data access.** The direct Copilot login experiment was cancelled at the owner's request after an organization authentication prompt appeared. The app was returned to SnapshotOnly while the Agency path was being integrated. No further login flow should be started automatically.

Agency's supported command is `agency copilot`: it launches its engine and accepts a prompt. The integration uses a profile-only configuration with no organization-data MCPs, plugins or available model tools. It is not an invocation of WorkIQ, Graph, ADO, mail or chats. Model routing/authentication is separate from access to organization data: Agency may still use a remote authenticated model service. If its existing authentication is unavailable, the answer must fail visibly rather than selecting another account or initiating a new sign-in.

Only for either direct Copilot choice, install that CLI separately using the official installation guide. For Windows, the documented standalone installation is:

```
winget install GitHub.Copilot
```

The Agency path does not require this separate installation or a new GitHub login. Answer-provider setup does not install/update CLIs, download answer-model weights or sign in silently. Agency itself may resolve its managed engine and service metadata as part of a normal launch; the observed startup included an engine-resolution step. That is not organization-data retrieval. Configure the desired answer provider with `scripts\Initialize-Answers.ps1`, then open **Setup / details** in **QUESTION / ANSWER** and choose **Reload setup**. Setup is not an inference request.

For the requested existing-Agency path, the setup entry point is:

```
.\scripts\Initialize-Answers.ps1 -Provider Agency
```

This resolves the installed `agency.exe` and writes non-secret application settings. It does not perform login. The answer launch is the supported `agency copilot` command in a separate background process, with a new prompt-only profile rather than your personal coding-session configuration. Use **Show Q/A** if collapsed, then **Setup / details → Reload setup** afterward. SnapshotOnly remains a deliberate no-send mode:

```
.\scripts\Initialize-Answers.ps1 -Provider SnapshotOnly
```

Optionally specify `-AgencyPath 'C:\Path\To\agency.exe'` and `-Model 'model-id'`. Paths must identify an installed executable, never a shell command or a `.cmd` / `.ps1` wrapper. Without an explicit Agency path, setup resolves the standard installed executable and then absolute PATH entries.

**Existing Agency authentication is used by Agency itself.** The app does not read/copy tokens, run `agency login`, request organization-data connectors, or fall back to the cancelled direct Copilot login. If Agency's model-service credentials expire, do not assume the app can suppress every wrapper-managed auth surface: stop the request and resolve normal Agency access separately. An observed no-new-login run is not a universal guarantee about future Agency versions.

The adapter pins the exercised Agency build **2026.10.7.4 /** `bcff2c0f` and verifies supported ACP configuration before prompting. Different versions fail until qualified. Question text is serialized as a JSON data field; opted-in clarification history uses separate typed metadata. `@` is escaped, and command-like lines are not shell input. This supersedes the earlier blanket rejection of `@` and slash-like questions without granting tools.

## Observed integration result

One separately authorized synthetic Agency prompt returned `PHANTOM_OK`, exit0, in69.881seconds. Its receipt showed one model call, no model tools (`tool_count:0`), no tool requests and both built-in GitHub MCP descriptors disabled. No new sign-in flow occurred in that run. No meeting text, notes, audio, repository content, mail, chat or organization-data tool was submitted.

This was a historical functional smoke check, **not a speed benchmark**. It did not establish p50/p95, real-question usefulness or cached-auth availability on another machine. Later separately authorized quality trials are recorded below; the original smoke receipt remains unchanged. The direct-Copilot attempt failed at a customization/tool gate and remains a failed result, not evidence of a working cloud adapter.

Settings are stored separately from questions under `%LOCALAPPDATA%\PhantomFudge\answers.json`. They contain provider/model/endpoint metadata, not credentials or prompt text. Invalid settings leave the provider disabled with an actionable status. (`src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AnswerConfiguration.cs:8-31`.)

## Local model servers

Install and operate a model server separately. Examples of the supported API shape are Ollama, vLLM and Foundry Local **when configured to expose OpenAI-compatible chat completions**. Installing Copilot does not install model weights or start these servers.

For an existing Ollama installation, a typical explicit setup is:

```
# Separate model provisioning; downloads model weights.
ollama pull qwen3:8b

# Run only if your Ollama service is not already running.
ollama serve
```

Use the model identifier actually installed on your machine, and the server's actual port. The usual Ollama compatibility base is `http://127.0.0.1:11434/v1`; another server may differ. Model support, context length, CPU/GPU memory and answer quality must be verified for that model. Phantom Fudge does not claim that any model is installed or fast enough merely because an endpoint is configured.

Use a server restricted to loopback, not a LAN bind. A loopback endpoint can itself be a proxy: the application cannot prove where a separately managed server ultimately processes data. The supplied local mode has no GitHub fallback; it cannot certify the local server's own behavior.

```
.\scripts\Initialize-Answers.ps1 -Provider LocalModel `
    -LocalEndpoint 'http://127.0.0.1:11434/v1' -Model 'qwen3:8b'
```

This uses the separately installed compatible Copilot engine in offline BYOK mode; no GitHub login is required. It does not pull a model, start Ollama or invoke Agency's hosted model service.

The direct engine adapter is deliberately qualified against exact pinned binaries: standalone `1.0.81-0` and native npm `1.0.91`. `--no-auto-update --version` can differ from ordinary `copilot --version`, because the latter may select a newer cached build. Unknown versions fail; the app never removes safety flags to make

them run.

Offline mock endpoints exercised both supported binaries, including streamed text, redirects, literal `@file` /slash-like questions, output bounds and cancellation. **No actual local model was installed or benchmarked during this implementation.** Choose an installed model and confirm its compatibility yourself; unsupported context lengths or model capabilities should surface as errors.

# What an Ask does

## October 9 direct-answer correction

The owner reported an unacceptable response consisting of a directory-inspection plan instead of a Two Sum solution. A printed command is not proof that a tool ran, but it is still a failed answer. The revised path uses a fixed standalone-answer system role, selected and verified through official ACP, plus a persistent transport with fresh question sessions. The prompt is the only user input; the agent must make reasonable stated assumptions rather than request another interaction. The generic policy contains no hardcoded Two Sum answer or phrase-replacement table (`src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AgencyAnswerPrompt.cs:8-97`, `Policy`, `Create`).

The default is **GPT-5.6 Sol Fast / low**, unless a model was explicitly configured. Startup, reveal and Reload setup prepare **one empty session, with no model prompt**. The UI reports preparation separately; wait for Ready before Ask. After success, the provider prepares the next fresh empty session without retaining previous question/answer context. Hide, Clear, protection failure, replacement and close tear down owned provider state (`src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.AnswerLifetime.cs:23-128`).

The final exact-text H batch returned three **complete useful answers in 4066, 4176 and 2992 ms**, including the owner's malformed ASR string under an explicit Two Sum assumption. All three returned C# implementations compiled and passed 33 ordinary/full-integer-boundary checks. Initial empty-session preparation took about 20–31 seconds, **not under five seconds**. These are provider completion/session close times, not independently measured WPF paint times or an all-question latency SLO.

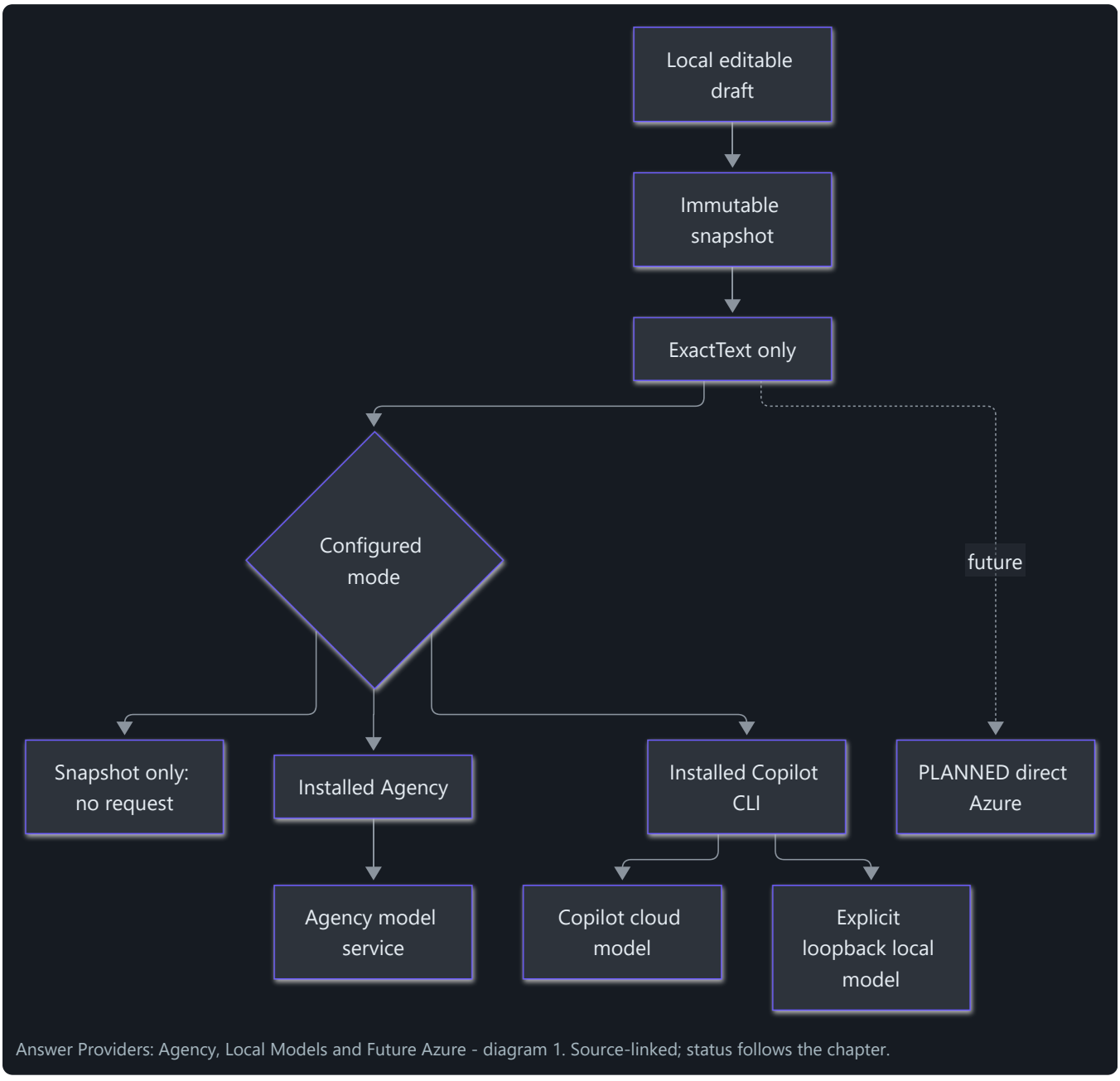
All 48 client question submissions in the correction study remain accounted for. Earlier E/Haiku success used different synthetic wording; F exact-text Haiku exposed wrong-problem/follow-up failures, and G mini exposed arithmetic-overflow failures. They were not discarded or promoted as equivalent to H. No further model calls are needed for packaging. Read all results and limits and the source-checkout `tools\AgencyProbe\results\summary-final.json`.

Always-on local diagnostics now record stage timings and safe errors. Text bodies remain an explicit local opt-in. No new sign-in, organization-data tool or automatic model fallback is permitted to make a benchmark faster.

1. Freeze exactly the displayed draft.
2. Show its provider and immutable question beside the answer.
3. Start one bounded request. No natural final, question mark, editing event or reveal sends it.
4. Append provider text as plain text, batching UI refreshes.
5. Show completion only after the provider's terminal success; EOF alone is insufficient.

Cancel, Hide, Clear, close and protection invalidation cancel the active request. Later events cannot append to a cancelled or different request. Partial text stays visibly incomplete unless explicitly cleared. Another Ask requires the previous request to finish cleanup; there is no retry or automatic continuation.

The answer is capped at32,768UTF-16 code units; the overall request has a120second deadline. The8,192-unit question limit remains separate from model token/context limits. Copy is an explicit Windows clipboard action, not automatic posting to a meeting or chat. (`src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AnswerRun.cs:10-80`; `src/PhantomFudge.Core/QuestionDraft.cs:8-9,90-103`.)



Answer Providers: Agency, Local Models and Future Azure - diagram 1. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

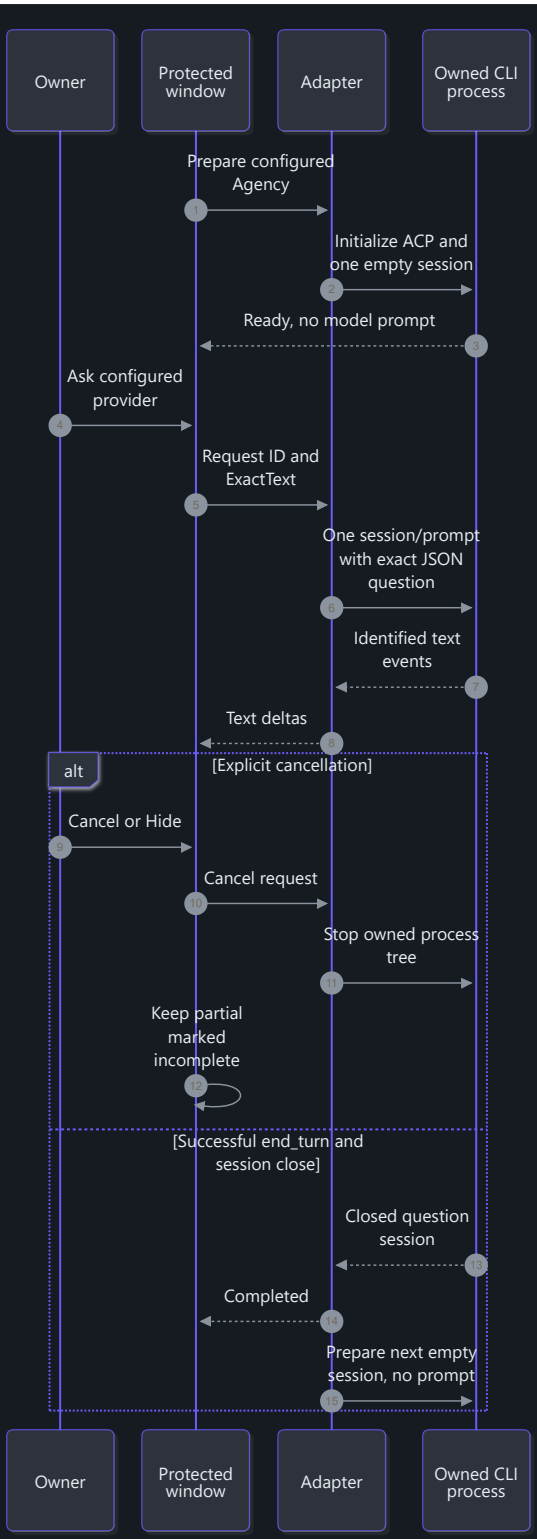
The diagram shows available choices, not simultaneous or fallback calls. Source metadata remains local even if a user edited away part of the original selection. A future Azure adapter must likewise accept `AnswerRequest`, not serialize the richer `QuestionSnapshot`. (`src/PhantomFudge.Core/QuestionSnapshot.cs:5-23`; `src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AnswerContracts.cs:3-13`.)

# CLI safety and retention

Copilot is a general-purpose agent, not simply a text completion executable. The integration must not inherit a coding workspace's tools, personal instructions, hooks, MCP servers, plugins, provider environment or resumed conversation. It uses a dedicated application profile and a new empty working directory, with no shell interpolation of prompt text and no broad tool grants.

These controls constrain the supported CLI configuration; they are **not an OS sandbox or universal guarantee about a modified executable**. Use the genuine CLI from a trusted installation. Unsupported versions/configuration must fail rather than silently omitting required restrictions.

The engine's system prompt and service metadata still exist: "ExactText only" describes which **application content** is supplied, not an assertion that the remote service receives no other protocol/system information. `--log-level none` does not promise zero retention. The external CLI can retain session data in its dedicated profile during the bounded engine lifetime (up to 32 sessions); owned files are removed on teardown, not after every successful Ask. Cloud data is subject to the selected service's policies. Protect that profile like transcripts; do not commit it or copy it into preview packages.




Answer Providers: Agency, Local Models and Future Azure - diagram 2. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

# Future Azure and source commit

The installed CLI path is workstream39; it does not depend on an Azure subscription. Workstreams30/31 retain the future direct Azure identity/provider integration. Workstream29 retains accurate source-specific Mic finalization. Immediate **Ask as shown** does not claim to solve the last acoustic sample still in a device buffer.

The local speech service uses native Python/Vosk provisional text and Whisper small.en finals. There is no new requirement for Docker, cloud speech, chat scraping, generated speech, tool execution or automatic web browsing.

# Primary references

Implementation source: `AgencyCliAnswerProvider` owns the reusable isolated workspace and streams only accepted records (`src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AgencyCliAnswerProvider.cs:77-326`). `AgencyAnswerProfile` defines the minimal profile and explicit engine arguments (`src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AgencyAnswerProfile.cs:21-37`). `AgencyCliLaunch` preserves Agency's normal AppData cache access while isolating child homes and excluding ambient tokens/provider settings (`src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AgencyCliLaunch.cs:40-60`). Version checks and the authentication-notice guard constrain the tested wrapper, not an OS sandbox (`src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AgencyCliAnswerProvider.cs:425-454`; `src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AgencyJsonProtocol.cs:50-68`).

- CLI programmatic reference
- CLI command reference
- CLI configuration directory and retention
- Installed `copilot help providers`, `copilot help environment`, `copilot --help` and pinned executable help.
- Installed `agency copilot --help`, `agency config check --help`, and the explicit no-tools synthetic Agency receipt. `--profile-only` ignores base and ambient MCP configuration; no plugins/MCPs are declared in the generated prompt-only profile.
- Local draft contract, Azure architecture, qualification, workstream39.

Source: docs/QUESTION-CLARIFICATION.md

# Clarify first

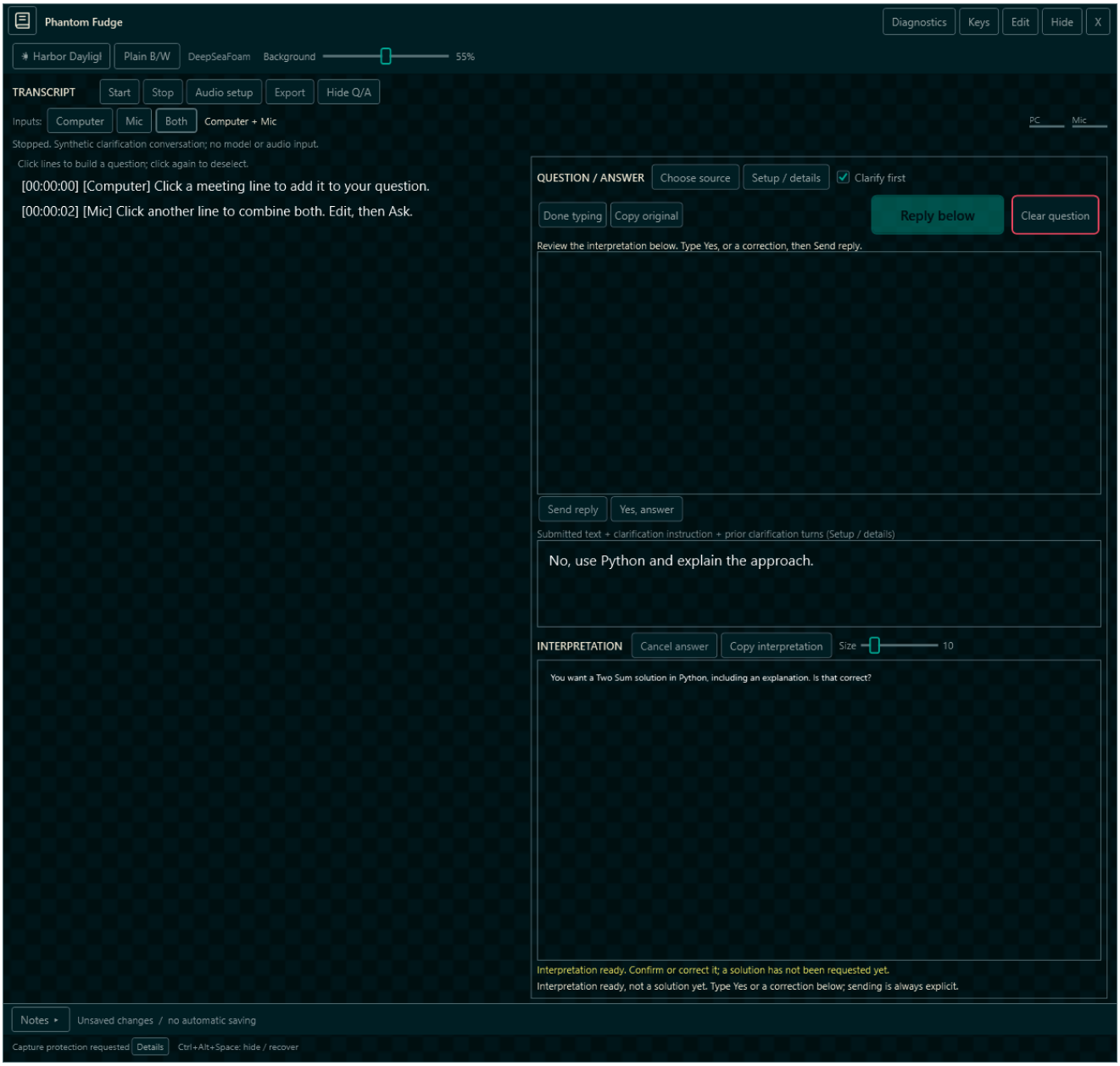
## Why this exists

A long transcript can capture the subject of a question while getting its wording wrong. **Clarify first** lets the model propose the intended question before attempting a solution. It is **off on every app launch**. Ordinary Ask remains a direct, single-question answer. This is model-assisted interpretation, not a correction to the original audio or proof of what someone actually said. The original draft remains in the app. (UI state and toggle, `QuestionDraft`.) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Clarification.cs:11-44; src/PhantomFudge.Core/QuestionDraft.cs:18-59.)

## Use it

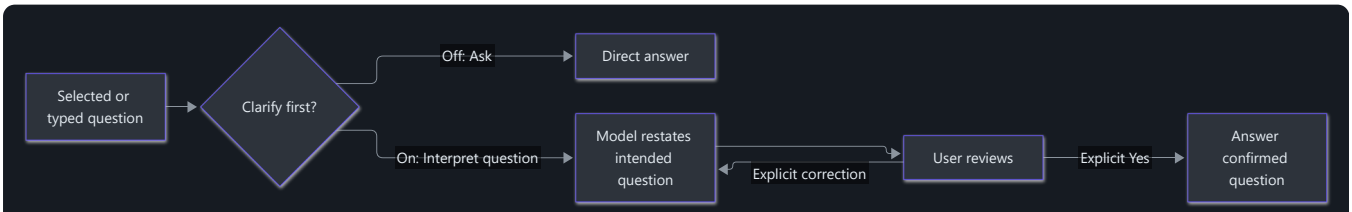
1. Select one or several transcript rows, or type a question.
2. Enable **Clarify first** beside **Setup / details**, then press **Interpret question**.
3. Read **INTERPRETATION**. It should restate the intended question, not solve it yet.
4. Use **Type reply** if needed. Type **Yes** and press **Send reply**, or click **Yes, answer**. To correct the interpretation, type the correction and press **Send reply** instead.
5. A correction requests another interpretation. An explicit Yes requests the answer. Nothing is submitted merely by typing, receiving a response, or toggling the option.

`Yes` is case-insensitive and ignores surrounding whitespace. `Yes, but use Python` is a correction, not confirmation. The confirmation button refuses to discard a written correction. The original question is separate from the reply field; **Copy original** copies that original, not the reply. **Setup / details** displays the extra instruction and completed clarification exchanges. (Reply handlers, question focus/copy.) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Clarification.cs:85-155.)



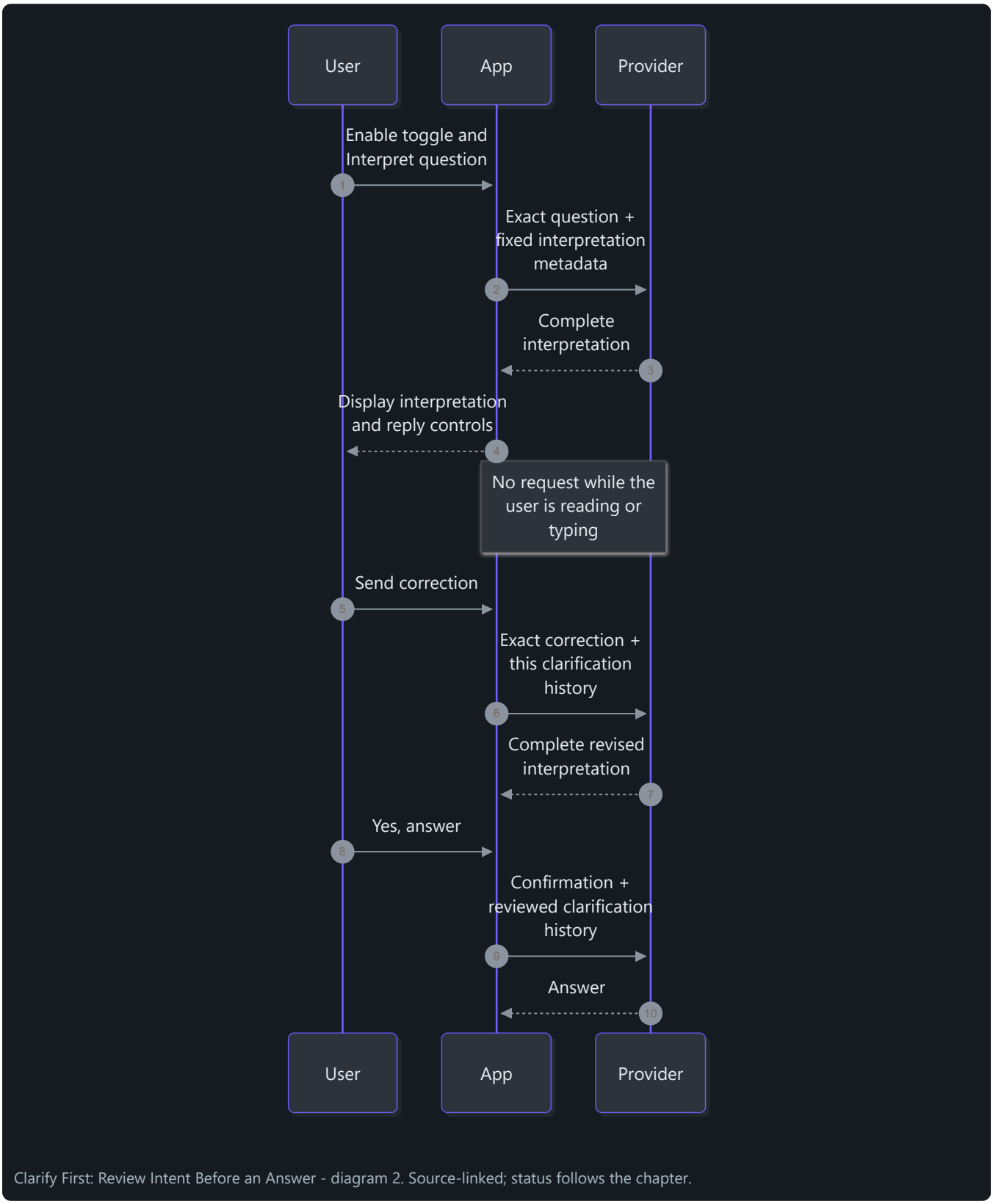

*Actual WPF render using a fake provider and synthetic text; not a real model answer or desktop capture.* The fixture exercises an interpretation, a Python correction and a separate confirmation. (Synthetic flow.) (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.ClarificationDiagnostics.cs:34-119.)

# Architecture: a narrowly scoped exception




Clarify First: Review Intent Before an Answer - diagram 1. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

The extra metadata is a **fixed task instruction**, not diagnostics or machine information. Its meaning is: *My question may be poorly transcribed. Infer and restate what I mean; do not answer yet. Ask a short clarification only if essential, then finish this response so I can explicitly confirm or correct it.* A later request includes only that question's explicit user/interpretation exchanges, plus the current reply. Ordinary requests carry no clarification history. No unselected transcript, notes, audio, device names, files or organization data are added. (Provider contract, prompt construction.)




Clarify First: Review Intent Before an Answer - diagram 2. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

The app does not keep a provider process waiting for interactive permission or stdin replies. Each explicit action is a new complete request; Agency still closes each fresh ACP session. The model's textual clarification is allowed only in interpretation mode. Default and confirmed-answer requests retain standalone-answer behavior and tool/permission isolation. (Answer lifecycle, ACP transport.)

## State, limits and failures

| Boundary | Behavior |
|---|---|
| Original draft | Retained separately; direct row changes, ASR replacement and original editing are blocked during an active clarification |
| Reply and interpretation text | At most 8192 UTF-16 units each; oversized input is rejected, not silently shortened |
| History | At most four completed interpretations and 32768 UTF-16 units including current input; then confirm or start over |
| Incomplete/cancelled response | Not committed as a valid interpretation; no automatic reply or retry |
| Clear question / toggle off | Reset this clarification conversation; toggle off retains the original draft |
| Provider change | Reset conversation so a new destination cannot inherit it silently |
| Reload identical setup | Retains the current conversation for an explicit retry |
| Snapshot only | Never calls a model, even with the toggle on |
| Short window | Reply controls replace the draft area; the snapshot and narrow-window transcript are temporarily hidden to keep the interpretation and reply readable |

These limits are characters, not tokens. Exact typed text and immutable snapshots remain separate from local source references. An interpretation is a proposal, not evidence that the model recovered the correct meaning. Review it before confirming. (State and bounds, `QuestionSnapshot`, layout.) (src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AnswerClarification.cs:7-69; src/PhantomFudge.Core/QuestionSnapshot.cs:5-23.)

## Privacy and timing

This mode adds model requests: interpretation, each correction, and the final answer are separate explicit submissions. It therefore has no end-to-end under-five-second promise. The earlier prepared direct-answer measurements do not qualify this new loop or its updated policy. No live-model quality or latency result is claimed by the synthetic UI fixture.

Default logs remain metadata-only. Explicit diagnostic Text mode can retain submitted input and responses locally; the external provider may retain its own request/session data, including the opted-in history. Clear is not deletion of already-written logs or remote copies. (Diagnostics, provider retention.)

# References

Local questions · provider setup · workstream45 · UI implementation · synthetic regression

Source: docs/COVER-AND-PRIVACY.md

# Cover mode and privacy boundaries

**Research date: 2026-10-09.** This guide uses official public documentation and current source. The cover is implemented. It does **not** make the application universally undetectable.

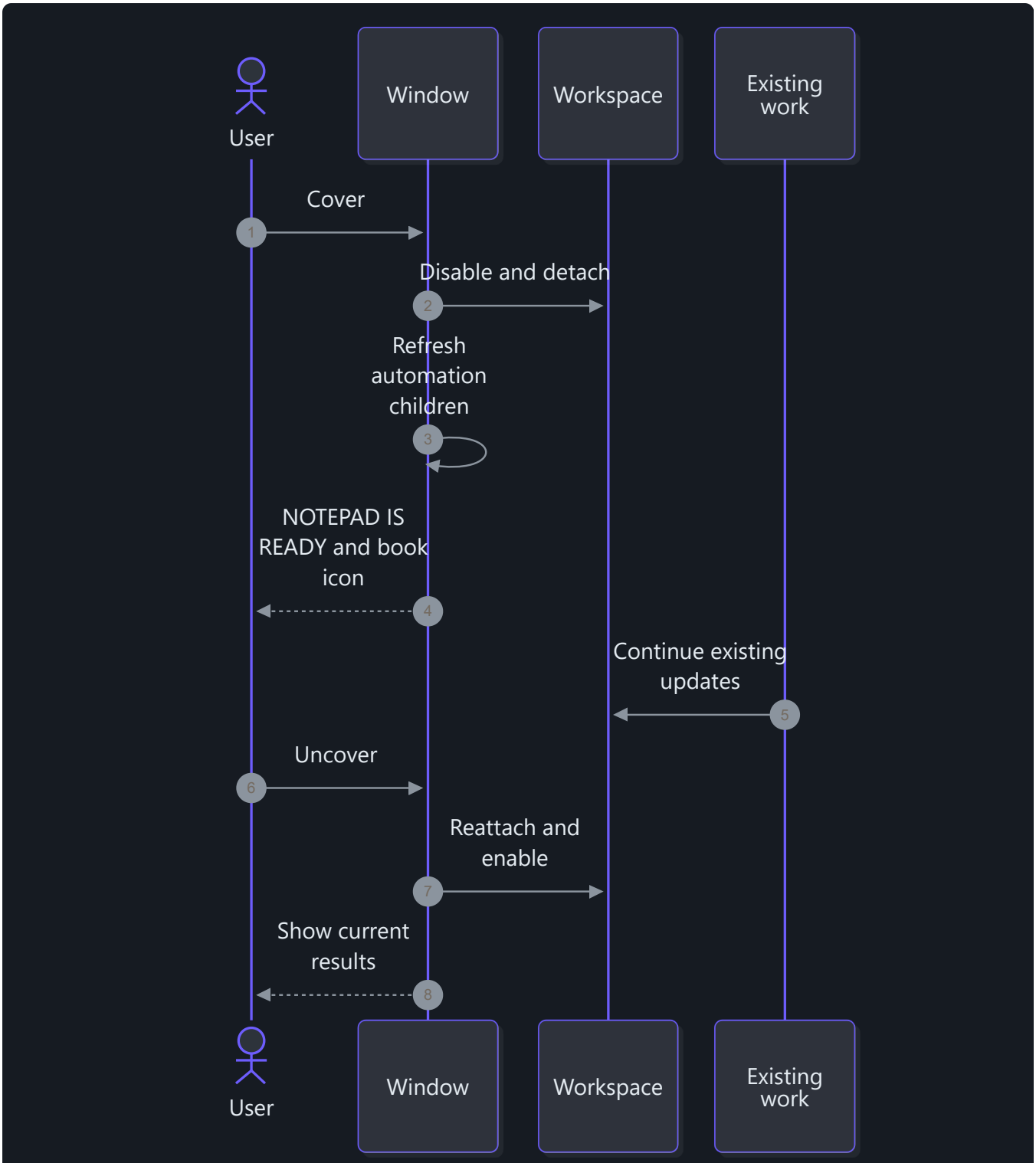
## Use the cover

Click the **book icon at the top left**. The workspace is replaced by **NOTEPAD IS READY** and that same icon-only toggle, without Cover/Uncover text captions. Click it again to restore the transcript, question, answer, notes and setup state. The existing protected HWND is reused; the app remains Phantom Fudge, not a process pretending to be Windows Notepad.

**Transcription and answers keep running behind the cover**, as explicitly requested. The recording dot is in the covered workspace, so its absence on the cover does not mean capture stopped. Windows microphone indicators and provider traffic may continue. Cover starts no new capture or request. Hide, Exit, session/power invalidation and their normal stop/cancel behavior remain separate. (Cover; src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.AnswerLifetime.cs:10-17.)




The picture is an internal WPF render with synthetic content, not a screen-sharing result.




Cover Mode and Privacy Boundaries - diagram 1. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

## Feasible measures, in practical order

This inventories exposure categories, not every possible inspection program.

| Order | Surface and measure | Current implementation and limit |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Ordinary visual contents | Cover disables and detaches the workspace; the message and return button remain |
| 2 | Fresh accessibility traversal | Window-peer child cache is rebuilt; the covered workspace is absent from fresh in-process traversal |
| 3 | Supported OS capture APIs | Existing `WDA_EXCLUDEFROMCAPTURE` remains; recipient/product compatibility still needs qualification |
| 4 | Shell/taskbar surfaces | Existing tool-window/taskbar omission remains; a new `DWMWA_DISALLOW_PEEK` request suppresses taskbar-hover Peek where honored |
| 5 | Other shell previews | Custom nonsensitive iconic thumbnails require more lifecycle/bitmap integration and are deferred |
| Not a supported guarantee | Cached accessibility data, process enumeration, memory inspection | Cover cannot retract copied data, conceal the process or erase state retained for ongoing work |
| Outside this mechanism | Privileged/driver inspection, physical camera/HDMI, arbitrary remote capture | No universal exclusion is available from these window APIs |

No recorder autodetection, process disguise, executable renaming, global accessibility disabling, driver/injection work, or interference with recorders/security tools is included.

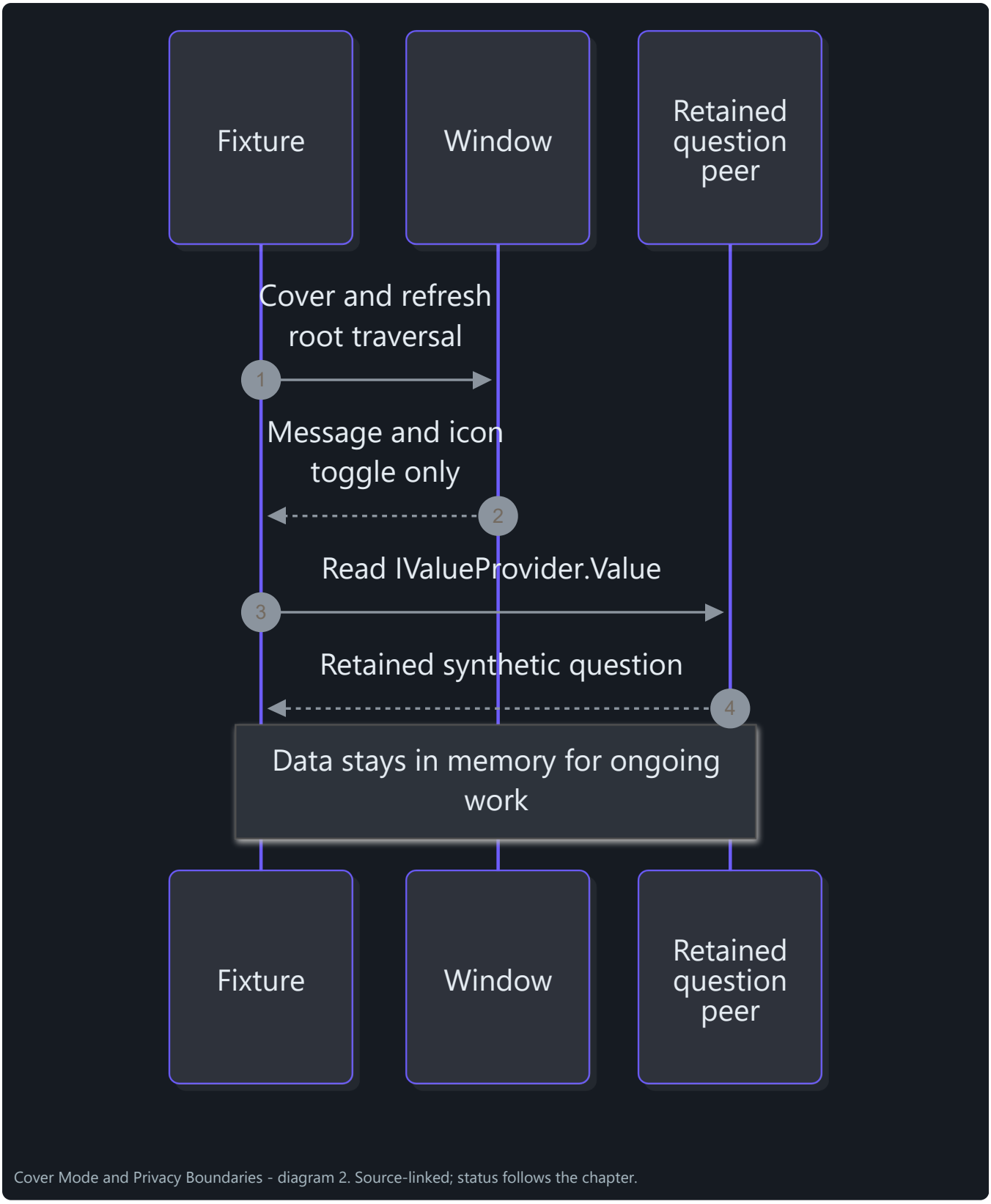
# Accessibility: current-tree minimization is not secrecy

Microsoft defines raw, control and content UI Automation views. Filtering control/content elements does not prove that they are absent from raw traversal. Likewise, offscreen state does not mean a client cannot retrieve an element's value. Painting an opaque rectangle over a TextBox would therefore be an inadequate accessibility-privacy implementation.

`SetCover` instead disables and removes `WorkspaceRoot` from its visual and logical host. It calls the documented `ResetChildrenCache` and `InvalidatePeer` methods on the window peer. The first rebuilds child relationships through `GetChildrenCore`; the second refreshes peer state. An initial synthetic run showed that detachment without the explicit cache reset left the old window children in traversal. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.Cover.cs:35-66.)

**Observed:** fresh in-process root traversal excludes the original question/note/answer peers and includes the cover message and return button. **Also observed:** `cachedPeerValueReadable=true`. An already-retained in-process `IValueProvider` still returned the synthetic question while covered. That is a demonstrated limitation, not a pending invisibility claim. (src/PhantomFudge.App/MainWindow.CoverDiagnostics.cs:68-88.)

Microsoft also documents client-side UIA caching. No tree change can retract text already read or copied. External screen readers, cached remote providers, events and raw/control/content client behavior still need their own observations. Normal accessibility returns on Uncover, and the return action remains accessible while covered. WPF custom peers are extensibility mechanisms, not a security boundary.




Cover Mode and Privacy Boundaries - diagram 2. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

# Capture affinity and Peek: supported requests, bounded evidence

`SetWindowDisplayAffinity` accepts the current process's top-level HWND and requires DWM composition. The application already requests `WDA_EXCLUDEFROMCAPTURE` (`0x11`), checks available readback and flushes composition before reveal. Microsoft explicitly limits this to a **specific set of public OS features and APIs**: it is not DRM and cannot guarantee protection against every capture mechanism. (Native implementation.)

This update also requests `DWMWA_DISALLOW_PEEK` with a32-bit Boolean true on the same HWND. It targets the full-sized taskbar-hover Peek preview, not arbitrary recorder previews. Failure is surfaced through the existing protection-setup path, not silently ignored. The local fixture records `PeekPreventionRequested=true`, meaning the setter returned success; it is **not** a recorded observation of a taskbar hover or recipient frame. The existing tool-window style already makes the incremental benefit narrow.

Do not confuse this with `DWMWA_EXCLUDED_FROM_PEEK`, which prevents fading during another window's Peek and can preserve visibility. `DWMWA_FREEZE_REPRESENTATION` can freeze an existing sensitive thumbnail; it is not applied. Nonsensitive iconic thumbnails and live-preview bitmaps are deferred because they need flags, message handling, bitmap ownership and preview qualification.

# Capture methods still requiring qualification

These rows are **NOT_TESTED for this cover revision**, not assertions that each method bypasses or honors the request.

| Method/product | What must be distinguished |
|---|---|
| Windows Graphics Capture | Display versus directly selected window |
| DXGI duplication | Output, GPU/driver, transitions and desktop composition |
| GDI BitBlt | Source DC, flags and layered-window behavior |
| PrintWindow | Owner-rendered window/client path |
| Teams | Desktop/web, screen/window, recipient and recording |
| Zoom | Installed version and capture modes actually offered |
| Meet | Browser/version, screen/window/tab |
| OBS | Display/window, Automatic and explicit backends |

Product names or “Automatic” are not fixed backends. Zoom's public support fetch exposed headings only, so no detailed backend conclusion is inferred. API acceptance, picker listing, local preview, remote frames and recordings are separate observations in the qualification plan.

# Process, remote, physical and retained-copy boundaries

`WS_EX_TOOLWINDOW` omits taskbar/Alt+Tab presence; it does not promise absence from `EnumWindows` or custom pickers. `EnumProcesses` does not depend on the visible workspace. PhantomFudge's process and single-instance identities remain. (src/PhantomFudge.App/Native/SingleInstance.cs:18-35.)

Process access rights govern memory inspection separately. Physical cameras are explicitly outside display-affinity assurance; HDMI protection cannot be inferred from it. RDP/VDI has separate client/server protection policies, not a universal switch this desktop app can impose.

Windows' microphone-in-use indicator is not hidden. WASAPI loopback can capture output without a microphone icon, so no icon is not proof of stopped capture. (src/PhantomFudge.App/Audio/LoopbackTranscriber.cs:95-128.)

Cover cannot recall clipboard copies, delete saved notes/exports, retract provider requests or change upstream retention. Exact question and optional clarification remain independent of presentation. (src/PhantomFudge.Core/Answers/AnswerContracts.cs:5-14.) Diagnostic text is opt-in but can persist when enabled; Cover does not erase it. (src/PhantomFudge.Core/Diagnostics/LocalDiagnostics.cs:145-184.)

# Local evidence and remaining limits

Fixture **20261009-140313** passed15cover assertions: normal/fresh peer traversal, detachment, shortcut blocking, synthetic transcript and fake-answer continuation, correct visible timing, appearance, message pixels, compact layout, same HWND/styles, restoration, editing/setup retention, busy-operation refusal and accepted Peek request. It also recorded `cachedPeerValueReadable=true`, `modelRequests=0` and `audioCaptured=false`. (Fixture, image provenance.)

This is not live-device continuity, external screen-reader certification or recipient-capture qualification. Pin actual OS/product/backend/GPU/DPI versions and observe those paths separately before making broader claims. The supported controls reduce particular exposure surfaces; **global invisibility remains unavailable.**

Source: JOURNAL.md

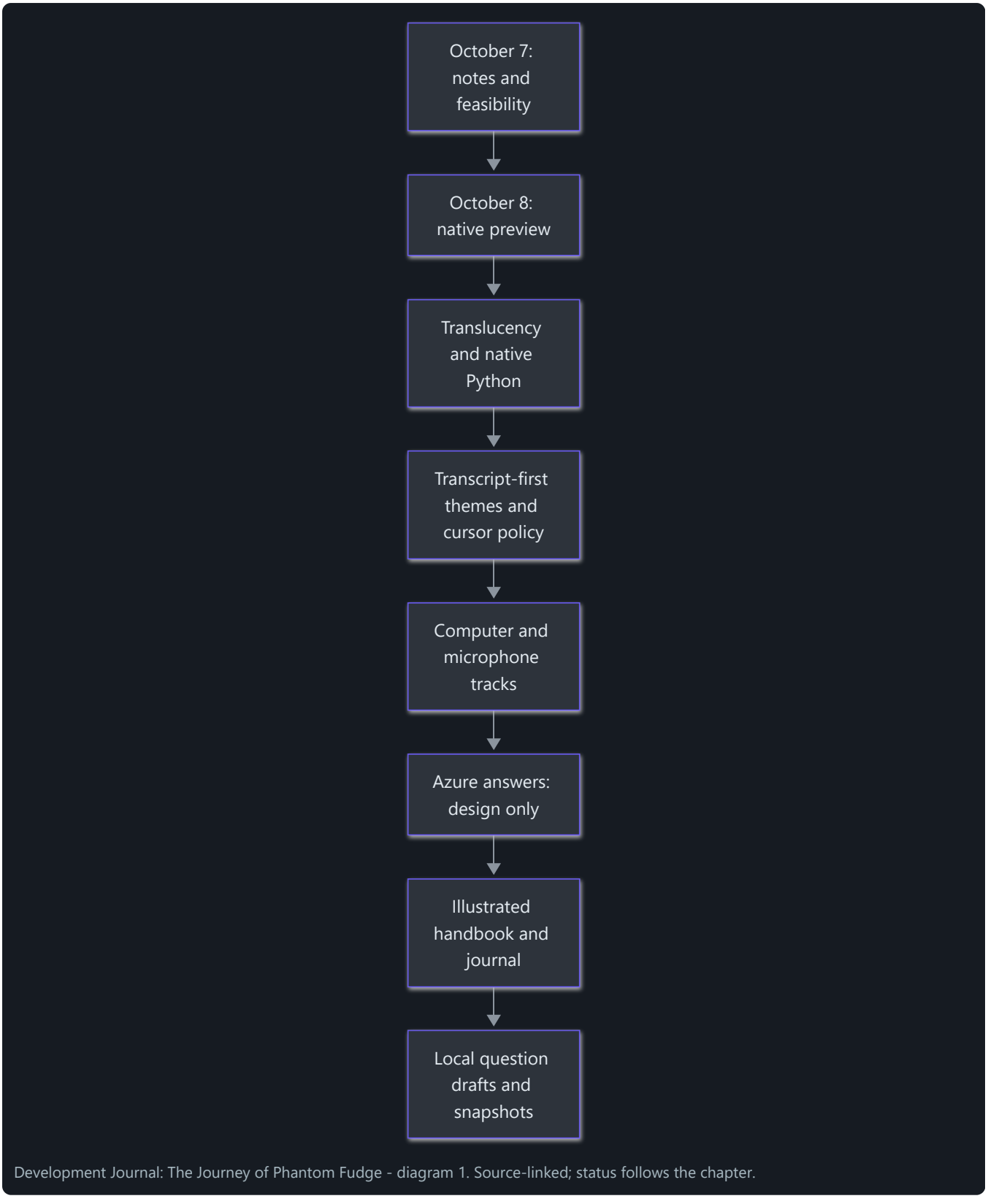
# Development Journal: The Journey of Phantom Fudge

This is the public engineering history of Phantom Fudge. It explains not only what changed, but why the change mattered and what the evidence did **not** establish. It is not a transcript of private conversations and contains no meeting content, personal notes or credentials.

Dates below are project-session dates in **Asia/Kolkata (UTC+05:30)**. Times identify recorded requests or decisions, not invented release timestamps. The project moved quickly across one night and the following day; that speed did not turn an experimental preview into a qualified release. The TODO ledger remains the concise operational history; this journal is the narrative counterpart. The handbook explains the system.

## The through-line

The original idea was a quiet place for presentation notes. The central challenge was not drawing text: it was preserving useful interaction while making an honest, bounded request to the Windows capture system. Speech then became the primary content source, and explicit AI assistance became the next proposed extension. Throughout those changes, three decisions persisted: keep control with the user, keep audio local by default, and never substitute a successful local test for a universal privacy claim.



Development Journal: The Journey of Phantom Fudge - diagram 1. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

# 2026-10-07, 23:30 - An idea becomes a bounded product

The opening request was a draggable, notepad-like surface for speaker notes: absent from the normal taskbar and omitted from screen sharing. The owner first asked for project continuity, a survey of their existing TODO conventions, deep research and an implementation workflow rather than immediate coding.

The repository began without an application. Planning adopted indexed, numbered `.todo` workstreams with explicit status, dependencies, acceptance criteria, evidence and completion logs. The survey found this useful recurring pattern, not a universal convention across every project or remote tracker. Stable IDs made later changes possible without rewriting earlier work.

The most important early correction was conceptual. A tool window is still a real window owned by a real process. Omitting a taskbar entry does not hide it from every application picker. Windows display affinity can request exclusion on supported capture paths; it cannot promise that no recorder, camera, privileged program or future OS change will reveal content. Cursor behavior is another observable channel, not automatically solved by excluding window pixels.

Windows11 became the first platform, with Teams, Zoom, Google Meet and OBS treated as separate qualification targets. The plan deliberately separated desk research, a local proof, usable implementation and release acceptance. That separation would become increasingly important as features arrived faster than real sharing environments could be qualified.

**Public record:** initial decisions and scope appear in `TODO/16_DEVELOPMENT_LEDGER.todo:75-85`; the convention's bounded survey and evidence semantics are in `docs/TODO-CONVENTIONS.md:1-73`. The current capture-claim limits are stated in `docs/OVERVIEW.md:48-70`.

# 2026-10-08, 00:32 onward - Implementation, and a new primary signal

The owner authorized implementation and requested eventual Docker support. Live transcription of the **computer's meeting playback**, initially not the microphone, quickly became mandatory. This changed the architecture from an editor with special window behavior into a small real-time system.

*C#* and WPF took responsibility for the native surface, Windows interaction and WASAPI audio capture. Python and Vosk handled local speech recognition. A narrow authenticated WebSocket boundary connected the two. Notes and transcripts remained local; normal capture required an explicit Start. A hidden service process being available was not permission to begin recording.

The first preview included plain-text editing, capture-affinity setup, recovery hotkeys, a single-instance reveal path, Edit/Present modes, bounded in-memory transcripts and explicit export. Several failure paths proved as important as the happy path: repeated close/save actions, malformed endpoints, unfinished recognition at restart and restoring a minimized hidden utility. Those corrections made the preview less likely to lose data or leave the user unable to recover it.

One explicitly approved synthetic playback test exercised actual default-output loopback through the real recognizer. It did not use a microphone or establish performance on a real meeting. Subsequent sleep instructions ruled out further speaker playback, questions, uploads and risky system changes. Later testing therefore relied on generated PCM and isolated synthetic fixtures. No public release or push followed from creating a local ZIP.

**Public record:** the historical implementation/evidence table and approved playback boundary are in `docs/IMPLEMENTATION-STATUS.md:302-356`; the authorization and subsequent restrictions are preserved in `TODO/16_DEVELOPMENT_LEDGER.todo:66-74`.

# 03:01 - A hidden window must still be recoverable

The first operational question was simple: after clicking Hide, how does the presenter get the window back? The recovery path was already part of the product: `Ctrl+Alt+Space` reveals it, and relaunching the executable signals the existing instance rather than creating competing surfaces. The app also recenters on relaunch recovery.

This episode exposed a general design lesson. Removing an ordinary taskbar presence takes away a familiar recovery mechanism. The product must replace that affordance deliberately. Hiding also stops transcription; showing the surface again does not silently resume audio capture.

The UI should feel quiet without making the owner guess whether it is still listening or how to reach it. The native recovery design is explained in the state-machine chapter.

# 03:04 - Remove repetitive acknowledgments, not technical safeguards

The owner explicitly stated that meeting permission and recipient preflight would be handled outside the app, and asked for the associated checkboxes and repeat confirmations to disappear. The change removed those gates from Start, Present and reset paths.

That instruction did not mean ignoring all failures. Explicit Start/Stop, token/input validation, protection setup and unsaved-content safeguards remained. Nor did it turn an external responsibility into recorded compatibility evidence. The lasting requirement is **not to reintroduce permission or rehearsal prompts** under a different name during future feature work.

**Public record:** `docs/IMPLEMENTATION-STATUS.md:295-300` records the change and local artifact; `docs/DEVELOPMENT-WORKFLOW.md:95-102` preserves the durable behavioral requirement.

# 03:12 - Seeing through the surface without washing out the text

The next request was practical: the opaque window blocked the material behind it. Instead of reducing the opacity of the whole window, the implementation made the content background translucent while preserving solid text. The Background slider spans10-100%, defaulting to55%. Header and setup controls remain opaque; the surface does not become click-through.

This is more than a color change. Layered WPF rendering changes the conditions under which earlier capture observations were made. Local affinity/readback, alpha, hit-region and synthetic GDI observations were repeated for the changed rendering path. Their success remained bounded to that machine and those samples. It did not qualify four meeting products or prove an uninterrupted first-frame guarantee.

The lesson was to treat rendering changes as changes to the capture-evidence boundary, not just visual polish.

**Public record:** `docs/IMPLEMENTATION-STATUS.md:284-293` identifies the layered result and limitations; the implementation is explored in chapter05.

## 03:25 - Correcting Docker's place in the architecture

The owner clarified an important mismatch: Docker should come at the **absolute end**, as a future packaging option, not as the architecture's normal operating prerequisite. The implementation was corrected around native Python setup, startup, ownership and shutdown.

This was not a late discovery that Python might help C#. The system already used C# for Windows integration and Python for recognition. The correction was about deployment responsibility. Normal launch now starts or reuses an authenticated local Python service. It will not kill an unrelated process merely because that process holds the expected port. Model/interpreter/token setup remains explicit, and an idle running service still does not capture audio.

Docker recipes could remain useful as a future adapter around the headless boundary, but workstream20 was moved after native release17. Runtime22 became the required operational path. This distinction prevented infrastructure work from blocking the thing the owner actually wanted to run.

**Public record:** native operation and the Docker correction are recorded in `docs/IMPLEMENTATION-STATUS.md:263-282`; the current dependency graph is in `TODO/00_INDEX.todo`.

## The muted-laptop experiment - Compare engines, not language stereotypes

The owner also questioned whether C# transcription would be good enough and asked for a real comparison, while planning to mute the laptop. A mute-independent experiment sent the same generated PCM to Windows SAPI, Python Vosk and Python faster-whisper. No speakers, microphone or cloud ASR were needed.

The corpus contained32 cases,164.07seconds of audio and292 reference words. Across two serial warm passes, the recorded comparison was:

| Engine | Word error rate | Warm decode time |
|---|---|---|
| Windows SAPI | 45.89% | 10.139seconds |
| Python Vosk | 8.22% | 41.754seconds |
| faster-whisper base.en, CPU int8 | 4.79% | 25.745seconds |

These measurements challenged an easy answer. SAPI was quickest on this batch but substantially less accurate. Whisper looked promising on quality and warm throughput. Neither result proved that one programming language was inherently better at speech, or that batch completion predicted the first useful live partial. Vosk remained the production streaming recognizer; swapping it out requires a real streaming contract and suitable latency/quality evidence.

Generated English speech also does not represent every accent, interruption, name or noisy meeting. The historical receipt must be read with its exact harness/model provenance; the handbook notes that today's harness hash differs from the historical receipt rather than rewriting that receipt.

**Public record:** the full benchmark report and chapter12. Summary measurements and their limit are recorded in `docs/IMPLEMENTATION-STATUS.md:269-272`.

# 11:31 - Transcription moves to the foreground

The owner reported two interaction cues: the recipient-side cursor could disappear when clicking the app, and the local pointer became an I-beam over text. They also asked for transcription to become the main view, notes to collapse by default, and DeepSeaFoam/Harbor Daylight plus Plain B/W.

The response separated what the app controls from what the recorder controls. The app now defaults to non-activating Present mode, requests a normal Arrow and handles its own native cursor messages. Edit remains the deliberate route for keyboard input and accessibility. These changes reduce local focus/cursor cues; they do not establish control over a recipient's capture pipeline.

Moving to passive interaction exposed a real WPF nuance: default ListBox row selection expects focus to succeed. The device selector needed explicit passive selection rather than pretending that a non-activating window could use the ordinary focus path unchanged.

The transcript became primary, notes collapsed, and canonical theme tokens were used instead of approximate colors. Automatic unprotected protection-failure message boxes were replaced by bounded generic local notices. The already-running owner app was preserved while new candidates were packaged separately.

**Still unresolved:** recipient-side cursor disappearance needs qualification in the actual recorder/sharing mode. No implementation change justified the requested absolute invisibility claim.

**Public record:** `docs/IMPLEMENTATION-STATUS.md:244-261`, cursor/theme notes and workstreams24/25.

# 13:47-14:01 - Small UI questions clarify the evidence

The owner asked where the theme toggle was and later confirmed that themes worked. They also asked about the footer reading "Capture exclusion requested. UNQUALIFIED PREVIEW: compatibility varies by capture method." That text was an informational boundary, not a failed setup error.

The owner reported that Snipping Tool omitted the window. That is useful **owner observation**, not independent proof of every recorder or sharing path. Documentation retains the distinction. This episode also explains why this book's UI images use internal synthetic visual-tree rendering: they can illustrate the actual controls without claiming that a desktop screenshot should succeed or asking the owner to expose private content.

# 14:01 - Dictated questions require a microphone track

The owner wanted to read a chat question aloud and have it transcribed, while explicitly avoiding chat-reading integration. The new requirement was to listen to both computer output and microphone dictation. It superseded the original no-microphone product scope; it did not authorize development tests to record a real microphone.

Computer, Mic and Both modes were added. Both is the default selection, but capture remains stopped until Start. The sources use separate selected WASAPI inputs, bounded queues and independent Vosk recognizers. A v2 protocol prefixes PCM with a source byte while preserving v1 compatibility. Source labels identify inputs, not people; they do not provide diarization or guaranteed acoustic echo cancellation.

Service management also learned to distinguish a stale, owned, idle service from an active or foreign one. Only the first is eligible for the capability-aware restart path.

Review found a subtle stop/restart race: an audio component could report not-running before final events and cleanup were finished. A new Start in that interval could reset transcript IDs and mix the lifecycle of two sessions. A coalesced UI stopping gate now prevents Start/mode/clear changes until final draining and cleanup settle.

The recorded evidence included41 Core tests,46 native synthetic groups,71 backend tests and four manager-upgrade guards, plus real generated dual PCM and C#-to-Python v2 recognition. No actual microphone/render endpoint or chat content was opened for this work. Hardware permissions, echo, OS microphone indicators and recipient behavior remain to be qualified.

**Public record:** `docs/IMPLEMENTATION-STATUS.md:220-242`, `docs/DUAL-SOURCE-AUDIO.md:1-30` and chapters07-11.

# 15:05 - An answer feature is researched before it is built

The next idea was to turn a chosen transcript question into a prompt and display the model's answer. The owner requested deep architecture research, Azure where useful, and low latency. The requested deliverable was design and backlog, not immediate cloud execution.

The proposed path is deliberately narrow: local ASR, an editable source-scoped question draft, an immutable snapshot on explicit Ask, direct C# streaming from Azure OpenAI v1 Responses, then rendering inside the same protected native surface. Audio stays local by default. The selected question text crosses a new, deliberate cloud boundary; the entire meeting does not automatically become prompt context.

A proposed Mic-only commit/ack avoids stopping Computer transcription to finalize a dictated question. It needs protocol evolution; current v2 stop-all is not that feature. Planned public-client Entra/WAM authentication must avoid embedded secrets and surprise sign-in windows during presenting. Request cancellation must prevent stale tokens from updating a newer answer.

Research considered current model lifecycle and capabilities rather than choosing a familiar but retiring default. No candidate was declared fastest without measuring it in the intended region and configuration. Likewise, `store:false` is not a universal zero-retention promise.

Four design documents, workstreams27-37 and workflows04/05 capture the plan. Only research27 is DONE. There is no implemented Ask button, composer, Azure client, source commit or answer pane. No Azure account/resource discovery, sign-in, inference or upload was performed.

**Public record:** `docs/IMPLEMENTATION-STATUS.md:214-218`, `docs/AI-ANSWER-ARCHITECTURE.md:82-188` and the four linked AI design documents.

# 16:11 - Turn the implementation into a teachable engineering record

The owner requested documentation detailed enough to become a book, using another project's documentation as a depth/style reference, and asked that screenshots, diagrams and a proper journey journal remain current thereafter.

The resulting handbook is organized into22 chapters plus this journal appendix: first-principles onboarding, a principal engineer's guide, native Windows behavior, storage, the complete audio pipeline, state machines, measured performance, planned Azure architecture, development/operations and grounded reference material. The other project's prose and artwork were not copied.

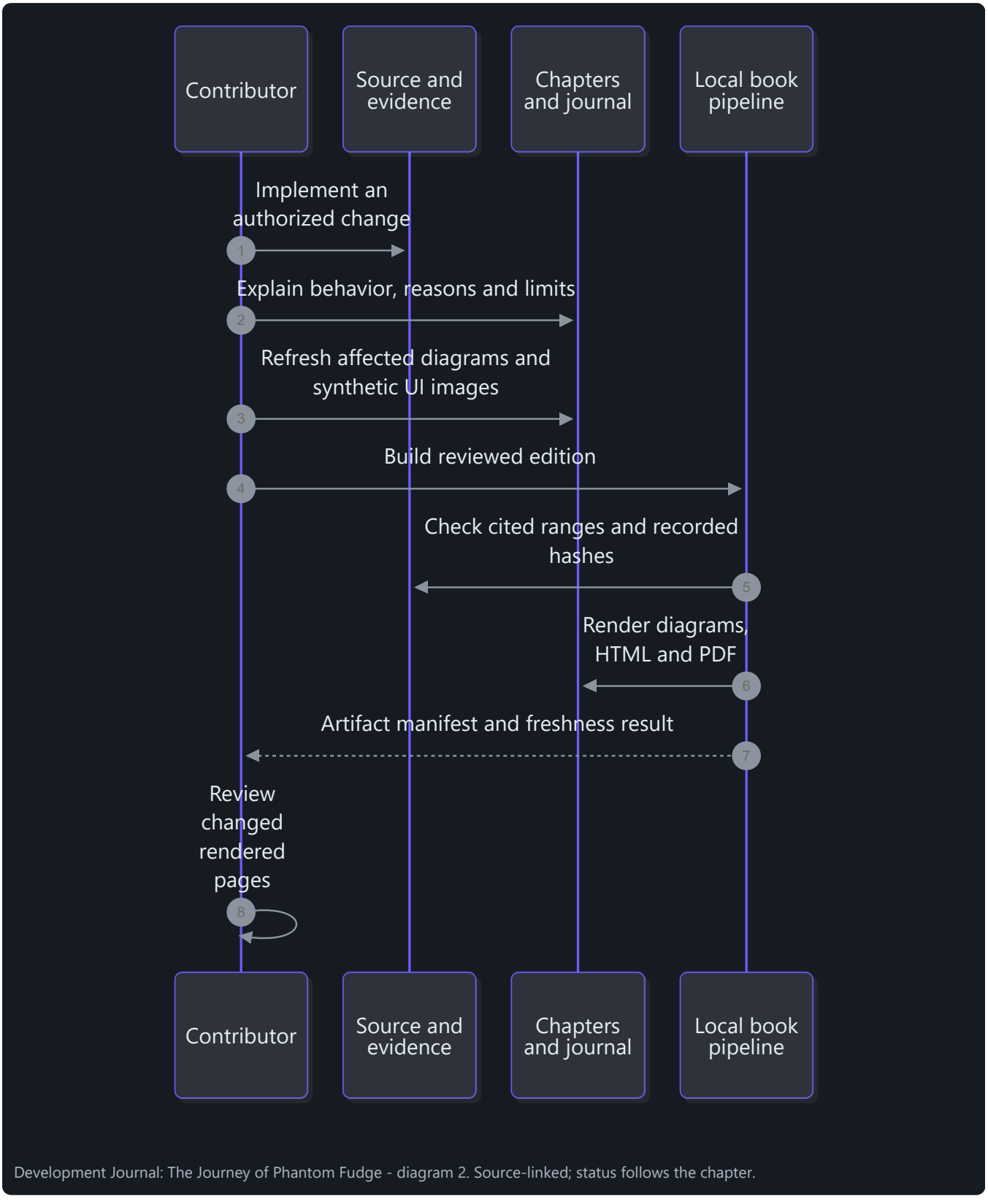
Illustrations have a defined provenance. Nine images render the actual WPF visual tree with synthetic text and device labels. They do not record audio, read chats, expose notes or capture the desktop. They illustrate appearance, not capture exclusion. Mermaid diagrams are rendered locally into SVG while retaining their editable sources.

The book pipeline produces offline HTML and a printable PDF with a generated manifest. It checks source ranges, local links/images, diagram rendering, recorded source freshness and printable layout. Those mechanical gates cannot prove a paragraph's interpretation; chapters still require source review. Exact generated counts and artifact hashes belong in the edition manifest, not a hand-maintained competing receipt.

This milestone adds a durable workflow obligation, not merely more files. Any later behavior change must update relevant chapters and diagrams; visible UI changes must refresh synthetic images; and significant decisions/evidence must extend this journal. Workstream38 establishes the first edition. Workflow06 and the repository working contract carry the requirement forward.

The initial edition was completed locally. Print review exposed undersized diagrams, so their layout was enlarged and sequence labels wrapped; narrow-screen review exposed long source paths, so the reader gained responsive wrapping. Those corrections improved the actual artifacts rather than treating a successful export as sufficient. Nothing was uploaded or published.

The documentation-only fixture does not replace the most recent user preview ZIP. That preview remains the145231 dual-source bundle identified in `docs/IMPLEMENTATION-STATUS.md:236-242`. The book does not implement Azure Ask, qualify remote cursors, or move Docker earlier.




Development Journal: The Journey of Phantom Fudge - diagram 2. Source-linked; status follows the chapter.

# 2026-10-08, 17:37 - Offload the book, then implement the next safe slice

The owner asked for context-offload after the detailed documentation, followed by the next dependency-ready implementation. The completed book was saved before code work resumed. Research27 made local question state28 the next ready step; cloud connection30 still required an approved destination and data/identity policy.

The implementation deliberately stopped short of pretending that an answer service existed. It added structured transcript entries with capture-session GUID, source, utterance identity, revision and qualified timing. The native adapter stamps session identity before queuing UI callbacks, so delayed old-session text cannot enter a new capture. Existing display/export formatting remains in its original buffer.

The new Question panel copies only explicitly selected segments or typed text. Mic is the initial filter, but Computer/All sources can be selected deliberately. A chosen partial can evolve into a final until the owner edits it; a frozen snapshot never changes. The8K-character draft limit rejects oversized input atomically rather than silently cutting off the end of a question. Eviction from the bounded history does not erase the copied draft's provenance.

Question typing needed a separate focus transition. Reusing global Notes Edit would have stopped Computer audio, defeating dictation during a conversation. The new Type / edit action deliberately takes keyboard focus in the same protected HWND while leaving transcription running and notes read-only. Done typing/Escape returns to passive behavior. Ordinary global mode changes and Hide retain their earlier stop policy.

**Ask as shown currently freezes locally only. Nothing is sent to Azure.** No fake answer is shown to suggest otherwise. Accurate armed-Mic start/end boundaries remain workstream29: current v2 partials cannot reconstruct a sample-exact cut around speech already in a device or decoder buffer. That boundary was deferred explicitly rather than guessed from display text.

The recorded local evidence is137Core tests (96new,41existing),46native synthetic groups, and source/exact-package synthetic UI checks including CR/LF fidelity and the470x560minimum window. The first source UI run failed its existing foreground-preservation assertion; an identical-source repeat and subsequent runs passed. The cause was not established, so no invented focus fix or recipient guarantee was recorded. No real audio endpoint, chat content or cloud model was accessed.

The local183107preview contains486files and76,205,175bytes, with SHA256 `C5062B6B94F3ABC63901960F1572F1A9141EA128C2CA513E6D26C4C5C3FAB27A`. It was packaged and exercised locally without interrupting the owner's running app. The handbook and screenshots were updated alongside the implementation, putting the new maintenance contract into practice immediately.

**Public record:** local question operation, workstream28, current evidence and the remaining answer architecture.

# 2026-10-08, 19:43 - A visual front door, detailed documentation behind it

The owner asked for more images and less text on the front README. The front page now emphasizes the actual synthetic UI, local questions and three themes, with a compact status note and links. Its setup, product explanation and capture limits moved into the product overview and expanded documentation index rather than disappearing.

Transparent WPF renders were composited onto matching palette backgrounds for README legibility on both light and dark GitHub pages. The derivatives retain source/output hashes and are explicitly labelled as synthetic UI illustrations, not desktop captures. No new app capture, model request, runtime change or upload was needed. Future README changes must keep this image-first structure.

See the visual front page, product overview and documentation index.

# 2026-10-08, 21:24 - Installed model tools, and a simpler Agency path

The owner wanted answers through software already installed on the machine, while retaining future Azure integration. The design gained a narrow `IAnswerProvider`: a request contains only the exact frozen question, never its original source references or the rest of a meeting. The window gained streamed plain-text answers, bounded rendering, Cancel and explicit Copy.

The initial implementation investigated standalone Copilot plus its documented offline OpenAI-compatible mode. Local installation and local inference were kept separate: ordinary Copilot uses cloud models, while an offline model requires a separately running local server. Synthetic loopback tests established tool-free requests, literal input and bounded error/cancellation behavior; they did not install or benchmark a real local model.

One authorized direct-Copilot cloud attempt failed at its customization/tool gate. A requested dedicated sign-in then produced an organization-authentication popup. The owner corrected the path: no organization-data access or new sign-in; simply run their existing Agency with a prompt in the background. The owned login was stopped and app settings returned to SnapshotOnly. The failure was not relabelled a success, and its model-call allowance was not silently reused.

Agency exposes `agency copilot` with profile-only configuration and controls for excluding default MCPs/plugins. A separately authorized synthetic Agency request returned `PHANTOM_OK` using existing authentication, with no new login flow. The recorded model surface had zero tools and no assistant tool requests; both builtin GitHub MCP descriptors were disabled. The selected model was `claude-sonnet-5`. No notes, meeting audio, repository files or organization-data tools were submitted.

The run took69.881seconds end to end. That proves a functional route, not a low-latency experience or a guarantee that cached authentication will always be available. Agency remains a local process using a remote model service; it is not an offline model. Its session/log retention also remains separate from the application's in-memory draft policy.

The direct Azure adapter stays a future option behind the same interface. Accurate Mic-only finalization remains workstream29; it is not required to explicitly send an already-reviewed draft. See provider setup and the sanitized smoke receipt.

The final adapter replays that successful protocol and uses the same restricted profile/launch. Core268tests and the exact packaged synthetic UI passed, including cancellation, early text, invalid settings and minimum-size layout. New preview235421contains489files and76,252,854bytes, SHA256 `88D98E7CAFA56B067A521571778D0F661A879DDCBF5EBBE9D412987D2BFA5A69`. No additional real model call was made for packaging. The existing app was not force-closed.

# Remaining qualification

The application is still a local unqualified preview. Full Teams/Zoom/Meet/OBS qualification, recipient cursor behavior, hardware microphone/echo/privacy-indicator observations, long-session quality, accessibility and owner acceptance have not been replaced by this book.

Local drafts and installed Agency answers are implemented; direct Azure still needs its approved integration, and all provider paths need broader quality/latency and release qualification. Optional cloud ASR and a broker are separate decisions. Docker remains a final-stage packaging option after native release, not a prerequisite for transcription.

The next journal entry should say what actually happened, identify its public evidence and preserve these boundaries until new evidence changes them. A useful engineering history is allowed to say "not yet," "the earlier approach was wrong," and "this result covers only this case."

# 2026-10-09, 01:19 and 03:11 - Correcting the actual-use experience

The owner rejected the small, scroll-heavy window, low-contrast text, inaccurate technical dictation and slow Agency responses that described workspace inspection instead of solving the question. The later request explicitly included transparency for the answer area. A printed command was not proof that a tool executed, but the response was still a failed answer.

The requested window is now 1240 x 1520, twice the previous dimensions, clamped to the monitor: the observed 1920 x 1200 work area fits 1240 x 1176. Wide views put transcript and Q/A beside one another. Main actions do not sit inside nested outer scrolling panels; long text still scrolls within its own control. Reading text is opaque white in the dark theme and black in light/plain themes. The answer shares the 10–100% Background slider. A quiet requested-state footer plus inline Details replaces persistent warning clutter without claiming capture certification.

The local speech pipeline now separates fast Vosk partials from Whisper small.en CPU-int8 finals. Verified models, four CPU threads, disclosed general technical vocabulary, independent bounded source workers and a separate finalizer preserve strict v1/v2 messages. Finalization owns disjoint PCM spans, targets 15 seconds, and fails visibly under sustained backlog rather than silently dropping audio. Earlier long-window repetition, deadline and shared-queue failures are retained.

On the new two-voice synthetic/noise corpus, raw WER moved from 12.04% to 4.40%, CER from 6.37% to 0.263%, and speech-end-to-final median/p95 were 2.736/3.017 seconds. Normal Stop median/p95 were 0.480/0.746 seconds; the 90-second client cap covers a conservative 85-second backend failure/ cleanup envelope, not typical latency. Compound-token spelling and homophones remain imperfect. No original microphone recording exists here, and these results do not qualify the owner's voice, room or device. The earlier October 8 benchmark remains a different experiment.

Agency now uses a fixed answer-only system role over official persistent ACP, with one exact JSON question per fresh session and no tool/permission surface. Ambiguous wording should receive a brief stated assumption and a concrete answer, not a request for another input. The app prepares one empty isolated session on startup/reveal/reload without submitting a model prompt, then keeps the provider rather than paying the full cold launcher cost for every Ask. Question history does not carry into the next session. Hide/Clear/protection failure/reload/close tear down owned state.

The final H batch used the owner's exact intended question and reported ASR string without rewriting either. GPT-5.6 Sol Fast / low returned three complete answers in 4066, 4176 and 2992 ms; the malformed case explicitly assumed LeetCode Two Sum. All three C# implementations compiled and passed 33 ordinary/full-integer-boundary checks. The selected default changed accordingly. Forty- eight client question submissions are accounted for across the authorized study; no extra model calls were made for documentation or packaging.

This is not a universal five-second SLO: initial empty-session preparation took roughly 20–31 seconds. Earlier Haiku E success used different synthetic wording; F exact text exposed wrong- problem/follow-up failures, and G mini exposed overflow failures. Those results remain visible. The final three prepared-session examples are not a broad quality distribution or measured WPF paint latency. They test interpretation of text supplied by the owner, not recognition of audio.

New rotating local diagnostics record safe stage/error/count/level metadata and request/capture correlation. App logs are bounded to 2 MiB per file, ten files and a 1024-record queue. Backend metadata rotates separately at 1 MiB with three backups and no transcript text. Text is an explicit app opt-in; notes, raw audio and tokens remain excluded. Metadata export removes Text by default, includes only allowlisted speech logs and never uploads. Old empty/deleted logs cannot reconstruct the reported interaction retroactively.

The updated guides, source-linked book and synthetic UI illustrations follow these changes. The current local candidate and final validation identities are recorded in implementation status, not substituted for clean-machine, recipient/cursor, actual-microphone, accessibility or owner acceptance. Save/copy needed content and close the old app before updating; no user's running instance was force-closed.

**Public evidence:** quality correction, diagnostics, answer results, speech results and workstreams 40, 41, 42, 43.

Final review corrected three concrete failure paths: shutdown now initiates capture Stop before awaiting provider cleanup; a failed diagnostic write remains observable even if fallback stderr also fails; and follow-up detection anchors invitations to line starts rather than rejecting quoted phrases inside otherwise valid answers. The parent reports final Core345, service106, native46 and benchmark18 passes, plus the synthetic source UI including capture-before-cleanup and answer alpha. No additional model request or real audio was needed. The runtime was then frozen for local packaging; these bounded checks do not close owner, microphone or recipient-side qualification.

The authorized local candidate is `phantom-fudge-0.1.0-preview-win-x64-20261009-045022.zip`: 76,383,294 bytes and 508 files, SHA256 `D24E8D2C5A1AF30E3F72FDA07F535B43D730420A81CE67115645605B7667D553`. Its exact extracted executable passed synthetic UI/question/answer checks, including capture Stop before provider cleanup and answer-background alpha. The fixture reported zero model/cloud requests and no recording/audio. The archive includes the required service helpers, diagnostic script pairs and five allowlisted public quality receipts, not weights, tokens, private profiles, PCM, logs, context stores or debug symbols. It is unsigned, not uploaded, and not a qualified release.

# 2026-10-09, 10:07 request - Click several transcript lines to compose a question

The owner wanted to click a Mic or Computer line directly in the main transcript and have it populate the question editor, then explicitly expanded the request to **multiple lines**. The manual source chooser alone made this unnecessarily indirect. The updated source now lets ordinary clicks toggle whole recognition segments without Ctrl and combines their raw text in displayed history order, not click order. A wrapped/multiline segment stays one selection; generated timestamps/source labels are not copied into the question.

The implementation pairs immutable display rows with structured segment identity rather than parsing rendered text. Main visible history remains selectable after the smaller256-entry/ 64000-character chooser evicts records, while the unchanged display/export buffer still bounds accumulated history. Archived unfinished partials retain identity and provisional status; session separators cannot be selected. Selected partials follow revisions and finalization until the user edits. New finals follow the scrollbar only when already at the end, so choosing older history does not continually jump to new speech.

A click opens Q/A, closes source/setup/Notes and enters independent question editing. This is a deliberate focus action, not passive no-activation. It does not stop transcription, enable Notes editing, freeze a snapshot or send anything. Once the user edits the question, direct selection changes retain that draft and its highlights with inline status until **Clear question**. No popup or repeated rehearsal/permission confirmation replaces the guard. The manual **Choose source** → **Mic / Computer / All** → **Use selected** replacement path remains available.

Both paths use `QuestionDraft.ReplaceSelection`: one capture session, at most256entries and 8192UTF-16 units including inserted newlines. Rejection is atomic, not truncation. Existing snapshots remain immutable. The selected outline keeps shared transparency and solid white/black reading text instead of covering the row with an opaque highlight.

**Evidence and limits:** the runtime implementer reports the first full synthetic screenshot/UI run passed. The supplied actual WPF multi-selection image is now linked from the guide and UI chapter. It uses synthetic content, no real audio input and no model request; it is not recorder or owner-acceptance evidence. Final test evidence, image re-export/provenance, baseline-citation migration and handbook build/review remain the parent's handoff work. Workstream44 stays **IN_PROGRESS**.

This is an **updated-source** delivery through `scripts\Run-PhantomFudge.ps1`, with no new ZIP planned. The045022ZIP above is preserved as the historical quality candidate and does not include click selection. Save/copy needed content and close the old app before launching updated source. No real

microphone/model/org access, service operation or new login was part of this selection documentation work; no running owner instance was force-closed.

**Public sources:** direct selection, synthetic diagnostic, draft rules, local workflow and workstream44.

### 10:30 evidence handoff - Source validation complete, book stage pending

The final source/UI receipts in `.local\handbook-capture-20261009-101632` report PASS for all20 direct-selection checks and the existing question/answer, minimum/responsive layout, alpha, cursor and style guards. They report zero model/cloud requests and no recording/audio capture. The parent also reports118passing targeted Core question/transcript tests and an exporter refresh of16synthetic WPF images plus5READMEderivatives.

After the first smoke, the final changes made the retained-edit status visible when Q/A had been hidden, added the twentieth check that clearing the transcript retains the copied question, and reset the synthetic fixture for readable answer images. Runtime is now frozen. Implementation and synthetic validation are complete; citation migration, full handbook/illustration review, freshness and final handoff remain with the parent. Workstream44 stays IN_PROGRESS for that stage, not because the source/UI checks failed. No new ZIP, live model/audio run or capture qualification is implied by these results.

## 10:33 - Optional interpretation before a solution

The owner requested a toggle for questions whose general meaning survived transcription but whose wording would be cumbersome to edit. With **Clarify first** enabled, the provider should restate the intended question; the owner can then type Yes or a correction before asking for the solution. This explicitly supersedes the no-follow-up requirement only for this opt-in mode. Normal Ask remains direct and history-free.

The design keeps the original draft separate from a reply field and attaches only a fixed task instruction plus this clarification conversation. It is not permission to add device information, logs, notes, organization data or unselected transcript. Every interpretation, correction and final confirmation is a separate explicit request; no agent waits for interactive permission and the app never automatically submits a reply. Cancelled or incomplete interpretations cannot enter history.

Implementation uses typed, bounded metadata behind the existing provider interface and same-HWND controls. The toggle is off on launch; changing destination or turning it off resets the clarification thread. Original question text remains available. Four interpretation rounds and a character budget bound retention; model guesses still require the owner's review.

The earlier under-five-second measurements describe direct answers, not this multi-request loop. No new live model, authentication, audio or organization-data operation is authorized merely by implementing it. Current implementation/evidence and usage are recorded in workstream45 and the clarification chapter.

### Combined source delivery

Both selection44 and clarification45 are complete locally. The combined affected Core run passed270 tests, after227provider-focused cases; the final105245synthetic UI fixture passed20selection and 16clarification cases plus the existing layout, alpha, cursor and answer lifecycle guards. The first clarification layout was too

short at470x560. Reusing the narrow transcript area while replying made both the interpretation and reply readable without adding an outer scrollbar.

The updated edition includes17synthetic WPF images,5READMEderivatives,51diagrams and a dedicated Clarify first chapter. Source citations were migrated once from the preserved pre-selection baseline. The first book attempt caught an invalid SVG generated from a line-break label; shortening that diagram label corrected it. The HTML/PDF and representative pages were then rebuilt and reviewed. The edition manifest remains authoritative for final counts and hashes.

This remains a source-only handoff. The old045022ZIP was not modified; save/copy needed content, close the old app with X and use the source launcher. No live model, audio, service, authentication or organization-data operation was performed, and no commit or push was issued.

# 11:07 - From a handbook to an annotated source reference

The owner asked for deeper documentation covering every interesting line of code. The existing conceptual handbook explained the system, but a chapter list could not demonstrate whether a helper, diagnostic branch, test or operational script had been overlooked.

The new approach separates explanation from measurable coverage. Seven source walkthroughs trace desktop interaction, domain state/storage, providers, native audio, Python recognition, operational scripts and the documentation compiler. A separate annotated source atlas pairs each first-party file with authored contiguous explanation blocks, important statement excerpts and complete line-numbered source. The HTML is searchable; its PDF emphasizes explanations rather than printing the entire repository twice.

The compiler checks the live local Git inventory, exact source hashes, complete non-overlapping physical-line partitions, bounded excerpts and byte-identical PowerShell text mirrors. Generated evidence receipts and dependency lockfiles remain explicitly classified rather than counted as new authored code explanations. External package internals, private runtime data, model weights and actual device/provider behavior are outside this source-reading claim.

This distinction matters: complete line assignment is not proof that every nuance is understood. The prose still explains actual guards, counter units, mutation order, failure preservation, ownership and test negative controls, with uncertainty stated. Tests and diagram freshness cannot substitute for that reading. Runtime source was held unchanged; this work does not run a meeting, an audio endpoint, a model or a capture proof.

The existing Node documentation runner now also checks the atlas compiler's path/scope, line splitting, escaping, stale-source, gap/overlap and incomplete-output behavior. The main handbook requires a complete current atlas before it can declare its edition current. See workstream46, the source reader and the documentation walkthrough.

## Source-reference delivery

The finished atlas covers163first-party files and23686physical lines through956authored blocks across seven source groups.33generated evidence files and8dependency lockfiles are indexed separately; 18PowerShell text mirrors match their canonical scripts. No runtime or non-documentation-tool source changed during this work.

The searchable HTML contains complete escaped source, stable line links and local search across code and explanations. Its476-page PDF carries explanations and focused excerpts. The expanded conceptual handbook adds seven source walkthroughs and14diagrams, bringing the illustrated edition to65diagrams. Edition manifests, rather than these rounded narrative descriptions, own final hashes and counts.

The existing Node test runner passed18documentation tests. The rendered reader contains all163file sections,956annotation blocks and23686source-line anchors; internal links, identifier search, filtered deep links and print-filter restoration behaved as intended. Reader widths1440/768/390 fit without horizontal document overflow. Representative atlas/PDF pages and all seven new handbook chapters' code/diagram views were inspected.

These are documentation and tooling results, not new microphone, model, container or recipient capture evidence. The owner-facing app was not restarted; no credentials, local service, runtime models or historical result receipts were changed. No commit, push or publication was performed.

# 11:55 - Reduce only the answer typography

The owner requested a50%smaller font in the answer field. Its normal size is now10WPF units rather than20; its compact size is9rather than18. Both the XAML default and responsive layout assignment changed, so resizing does not restore the larger text. Transcript and question text are unchanged. Clarification interpretations use the same answer reader and inherit the smaller type.

The existing synthetic fixture now checks those exact sizes alongside layout/alpha/lifecycle behavior. Updated images, source annotations and the two documentation editions accompany this source-only adjustment. No model/audio/service operation, app force-close or new ZIP was involved.

# 12:04 - Make Ask unmistakably the primary action

The owner wanted Ask alone on the right, larger and with a colored background. The question action row now separates Type/edit, Copy and Clear on the left from a148-unit-wide, minimum44-high Ask target on the right. Its15-unit semibold label sits on the current theme's accent color with the matching action-text color. Hover/focus/press use the border; disabled state remains visibly dimmed.

The same control still switches between Ask provider, Freeze locally, Interpret question and Reply below. Existing readiness and explicit-send guards are unchanged. The synthetic UI fixture checks the actual template colors, larger dimensions, right edge and separation from every secondary action across themes and representative layouts. The smaller answer font from11:55 remains intact. Updated images, source explanations/citations and both documentation editions accompany this source-only change; no live model/audio/service operation or user-app interruption was performed.

# 12:15 - Put Clear after Ask, with a red border

The owner refined the action order: Clear belongs immediately to Ask's right, outlined in red. The large accent-filled Ask is preserved, while Clear receives the final action column, a98-unit width,44-unit minimum height and two-unit theme-error border. Hover/focus/press change its face without replacing that red outline. Edit and Copy remain on the left.

The first compact clarification layout wrapped the longer left-side labels and reduced reply height. Narrower horizontal padding on those two secondary controls fixed the actual layout. The synthetic fixture now checks both reading and typing a clarification reply, as well as right-side ordering, red border, existing lifecycle guards and the earlier half-size answer text. Source annotations, images and the two documentation editions follow the same change. The clear handler and provider behavior are unchanged; no real model/audio/service or owner-app operation ran.

# 12:30 - Make active transcription visible

The owner requested a red recording icon once transcription starts. A12-unit red dot now appears beside the transcript heading and Start control while the transcriber reports Running. Selecting Computer/Mic/Both or waiting for startup does not light it. Stop/fault status hides it through the existing control-refresh path, while reserved hidden space prevents the toolbar from shifting.

The dot has a solid contrast outline and an accessible recording-state name. It means active transcription, not that the application is saving raw audio. The synthetic UI fixture checks stopped, starting, active and stopped-again presentation across themes and produces an explicitly labelled example without opening an audio endpoint. Source explanations, screenshots and both documentation editions are updated; no live model, service or owner-app operation was performed.

# 12:42 - Replace scrolling device lists with cards

The owner again emphasized no scrolling, this time for audio setup. The old64-unit-high device lists are replaced by selectable cards with wrapped names, accent outlines and radio dots. Setup temporarily uses the reading area, giving both sources enough room for normal catalogues without moving the app's recovery controls off-screen.

Large catalogues and small windows need a finite navigation boundary. Measured card capacity now uses Previous/Next pages rather than scrollbars. Paging collapses off-page containers but preserves the full collections and selected endpoint objects; a page label identifies the chosen card's page. Only an explicit card click changes selection. Starting/running/stopping capture still locks it.

The existing token field and guidance moved under Service setup, with automatic expansion when Start finds a missing token. Empty catalogues have explicit messages. Extremely long names may ellipsize in constrained cards without changing the actual name or endpoint ID.

Synthetic23-output/17-microphone checks exercise card bounds, no-scroll templates, selection preservation, passive foreground, themes, lifecycle locks, source modes, service controls and empty states. Updated images and detailed source/book explanations accompany the change. No real input, model, service, owner-app restart, package release or push was involved.

# 13:15 - Reduce transcription text by one quarter

The owner requested25%smaller transcription text. Final Computer/Mic rows now use15WPF font units rather than20. Live partials use13.5rather than18, and compact partials use10.5rather than14. The responsive assignment and XAML defaults agree; question, answer and device-card text are unchanged.

The existing synthetic layout fixture asserts those exact sizes while retaining its selection, focus, theme and lifecycle checks. Images, authored source explanations and the full documentation editions follow the change. No real audio/model/service operation or owner-app restart was performed.

# 13:23 - A book cover, not an invisibility promise

The owner requested a top-bar toggle that replaces the workspace with **NOTEPAD IS READY**. When asked about ongoing work, they explicitly chose to keep transcription and answers running. They then asked for broader screen-reader/process/capture hiding. The premise was corrected: Windows capture affinity is limited, and a visible app is not universally undetectable.

The implementation swaps two hosts on the same protected HWND. It detaches and disables the workspace, retaining its objects and async activity, and exposes only the message and Uncover. Normal Hide/Exit behavior remains distinct. Pending file/confirmation operations prevent cover activation; hidden workspace shortcuts are blocked; Uncover restores current content and editing. Answers completed while covered do not acquire a false first-visible timestamp.

An initial synthetic accessibility check showed that detachment alone left cached window-peer children. The supported ResetChildrenCache/InvalidatePeer sequence fixed fresh root traversal. However, a separately retained in-process value provider could still read the old question. That result is documented, not hidden: the cover reduces current-tree exposure but cannot retract cached data or erase retained memory.

The134234fixture passed same-HWND/style, cover-pixel, compact-layout, background transcript/fake answer, editing and setup restoration checks with no real audio/model calls. The feasibility guide separates this evidence from external UIA clients, remote recipient capture, process inspection, OS microphone indicators, files, clipboard copies and provider retention.

The supported native `DWMWA_DISALLOW_PEEK` request was then added for taskbar-hover previews. Its setter succeeded in the local fixture alongside affinity readback17, and failures follow the existing protection-setup path. This is not a captured hover/recipient observation. Process disguise, global accessibility suppression, drivers/injection and recorder/security-tool interference were not implemented. The completed guide ranks practical controls and deferred qualification honestly.

# 14:18 - Put the updated workflow on the front page

The owner requested new README images for the current workflow. The front page now walks through device cards, the red transcription indicator, multi-line question selection, optional clarification, the prominent Ask/red-bordered Clear controls and the notepad cover. Three paired image rows keep the page visual; setup and deeper explanations remain links rather than a front-page wall of text.

Five new palette-backed derivatives reuse the verified synthetic WPF images, bringing the README set to ten. They preserve source pixels and dimensions and record source/output hashes. The frames are labelled as separate synthetic examples, not one real meeting or continuous model interaction. Cover's continuing-work behavior and the lack of universal invisibility remain explicit.

Only documentation and its image allowlist changed. No app, capture endpoint, service, model, authentication flow, upload, commit or push was run for this update.

# 14:36 - Consolidate the complete current experience

The owner requested all documentation brought up to date with the recent features and images. Individual milestones were documented, but the overview and implementation-status entry points still emphasized older snapshots. A new illustrated current-workflow guide now provides one continuous reading path through device cards, recording state, multi-line selection, optional clarification, answers, typography/actions, the cover and operational recovery.

The guide reuses current synthetic imagery and explicitly distinguishes Cover from Hide, Stop, Cancel answer, global Edit and closing Q/A. It retains privacy, retention, source-only delivery and bounded benchmark caveats. Overview, setup, product, appearance, status and handbook navigation are reconciled; older package/test milestones remain historical instead of being rewritten as current-runtime evidence. No runtime, model, audio or service work is required for this documentation.

The completed guide includes seven current UI images and two source-grounded diagrams. It is now near the front of the HTML/PDF handbook. Seven affected guides' local links and image references were reviewed, as were the workflow's key rendered sections and PDF pages. The overview's updated diagrams also render. Runtime, service, provider and tooling source hashes remained unchanged; current edition counts and artifacts remain authoritative in the manifests.

# 16:09 - Make the mask control icon-only

The owner requested a small icon at the top left instead of visible Cover/Uncover text. The always-mounted toggle now uses an original vector book glyph in a32x32target, with title spacing adjusted around it. Meaningful accessibility names remain; a thicker border indicates masked state. The same icon restores the workspace while ongoing transcription/answer behavior remains unchanged.

The synthetic fixture checks the actual icon content and top-left client hit region in both states. The separate caption-drag probe moved to an unobstructed header point. Images, source explanations and current user guides follow the change. No cursor-freezing strategy or answer-font slider was implemented here; those remain pending the separate discussion/selection.

# 19:36 - Approve keyboard-first controls and a session answer-size choice

The owner approved a keyboard-first path rather than freezing, hiding or warping the system pointer. Ctrl+Alt+K (or Keys) deliberately arms local Control mode; bare letters are not registered globally. The beginner path separates intent: `v`, move with `j` / `k`, Space to toggle whole transcript segments, Enter to review, and only then Ctrl+Enter to submit. Edit stays literal, with Enter newlines. Search/source filters and first/latest navigation help find text without silently selecting it. Escape backs out through Control, with only a best-effort return to the previous app.

The implementation adds a finite command parser instead of shell/model command interpretation, keyboard navigation over existing device cards, and an 8–24 answer/interpretation Size choice. Automatic 9 compact/10 normal remains until chosen; resizing retains the choice, restarting does not. The shortcut configuration

accepts A–Z except E and F1–F11; F12 is reserved/rejected and Ctrl+Alt+NoRepeat stays fixed. Invalid settings or a shortcut conflict leave the Keys button usable; changing the JSON requires restart.

The key lifecycle distinction is preservation versus an explicit action. Ordinary keyboard modes and masking retain capture/provider work. Mask also disarms keyboard control. `:devices` refuses busy audio/answers and otherwise opens setup, which closes Q/A and its provider activity. `:start` still explicitly authorizes capture, `:stop` stops audio, `:cancel` affects answer/preparation only, and Clear keeps its existing answer-cancellation behavior. None is a universal pause or privacy guarantee, and none controls a sharing product's captured cursor.

The canonical public keyboard guide now records those boundaries, exact JSON, accessible diagrams and three reserved synthetic image references; workflow/setup/status, handbook navigation and scoped source chapters follow it. **Workstream57 remains IN_PROGRESS.** The integrated build and keyboard fixture have not yet passed for this increment; image export/review, source-citation integration and full handbook validation are pending. Source and diagnostic definitions are not passing receipts, and runtime refinements may still alter the final implementation.

Documentation work did not launch the app, use real audio or a model, regenerate editions, change source/tests/scripts/annotations, or commit/push anything. Real foreground return, shortcut collisions, keyboard layouts, accessibility, owner UX and recipient capture/cursor qualification remain separate observations, not assumptions carried over from the earlier mask fixture.

# 20:28 - Give compact keyboard tasks enough reading space

The implementation owner reports 297 Core tests passed, including the corrected F1–F11 shortcut range, and an earlier synthetic UI pass for lifecycle, selection, clarification and device checks. That is bounded progress, not completion: a size 24 answer at 470 × 560 needed a further layout correction.

The compact view now gives Select/Search the transcript reading area while temporarily hiding Q/A. The desired Q/A-expanded state remains separate, so leaving selection restores it without invoking close/cancel. Other compact keyboard modes prioritize Q/A; a chosen answer size 14 or larger with an answer visible does the same even outside keyboard control. Wide columns are unchanged. Panel visibility is not content deletion and does not stop audio or provider work.

The guide and current workflow now explain why content may temporarily leave view and how it returns. The updated compact-font fixture still needs its rerun; final image/citation/book handoff also remains pending. Workstream57 is still IN_PROGRESS, with no new runtime execution or validation claim from the documentation work.

# 20:32 - Record the first integrated keyboard pass, not final completion

The implementation owner reports the202234first integrated pass completed: all33keyboard checks and the existing UI fixture passed, along with297Core and18existing docs-tool tests. The compact layout correction is included. The imported image set now contains23synthetic WPF images and 10README derivatives.

Documentation review inspected the three new examples: selected rows versus the independent cursor, a font command before execution, and Read mode with the chosen size.

Subsequent code review found that shortcut configuration could throw an uncaught `InvalidDataException`. The owner will correct and rerun that path before final handoff; the first pass does not retroactively validate the fix. Current guide/status notes now distinguish this actual first-pass evidence from the remaining correction, migration and atlas/book work.

Citation migration has been analyzed but not applied. The authored documentation writer leaves existing citation values unchanged and releases its files for the implementation owner's final integration. Workstream57remains IN_PROGRESS until the correction/rerun and full illustrated atlas/book handoff are complete. No real audio/model call or recipient qualification is implied.

# 20:36 - Freeze runtime after the corrected full UI pass

The implementation owner reports the final exporter/full UI fixture passed, including the new invalid-config fallback, async Edit reply/original targets, compact Select reading-space borrowing and passive size24fit. The23WPF images and10READMEderivatives are current. Runtime is now frozen; the remaining handoff is the one-shot citation migration and full source-atlas/book completion.

Edit remains armed after submission. When an asynchronous interpretation changes which field is editable, the mode label and target follow the visible, enabled, focusable, writable reply or original-question field. Focus recovery is limited to the already-foreground, visible, uncovered, protected app. The synthetic checks allow the normal dispatcher turn rather than forcing another SetMode call. They establish local routing behavior, not real cross-application comfort or a guaranteed foreground return.

The public guide now documents that lifecycle and the corrected LoadKeyboardShortcut fallback. Citations to the new Keyboard/KeyboardDiagnostics files were reviewed against the frozen source; they have no old-source baseline for the mapper. Preexisting-source citation values remain untouched. The documentation writer releases ownership so the implementation owner can migrate once and complete atlas/book review. Workstream57remains IN_PROGRESS until that final handoff. No model/audio call, source launch or new generated edition was performed by this documentation work.

# Keyboard increment complete - Source, examples and reference editions

The final203556synthetic fixture passed38keyboard assertions and the existing UI regressions. The297Core parser/configuration cases and18documentation-tool cases passed separately. These results use synthetic text/devices and fake providers; no real microphone, playback capture or model request was started. Review corrected the uncaught schema exception and asynchronous clarification editor-target recovery before freezing runtime.

The three keyboard illustrations join the23WPF-image set and10READMEderivatives. A reviewed, one-shot migration aligned359citation ranges across32documents. The source atlas covers177files, 26576physical lines and1072authored blocks. Full atlas and handbook HTML/PDF editions were built and inspected, including the

new illustrated guide, source search and compact browser layouts. Their manifests remain authoritative for exact edition counts and hashes.

Workstream57 is complete for source and documentation. The owner can save/copy required content, close an older instance with X, relaunch from source and try Ctrl+Alt+K. The old ZIP is unchanged. Actual shortcut conflicts, cross-application focus return, keyboard layouts, accessibility, comfort and recorder behavior are still qualification work. No cursor hook, new package, commit, push or publication was introduced.

# 21:52 - Request an installable preview without changing its trust boundaries

The owner requested unattended README/TODO/book maintenance, releases and an installer that can install, update and remove the app. The new workstream58 targets `v0.2.0-preview.1`, with Windows file version `0.2.0.1`. It is an unsigned **Windows11 x64 prerelease**, not a qualified release or an "any OS/any hardware" promise. The repository was verified private; releases inherit that visibility and no visibility change is part of the request. No project license was selected.

The design removes developer-tool prerequisites from ordinary installation: per-user Inno Setup places a self-contained desktop app, native launcher, private Python runtime, speech service and verified English models. Opening the Start-menu shortcut may prepare an idle local service; recording still requires explicit Start. Existing answer and keyboard configuration remain in the same user-profile locations. A new profile stays snapshot-only, and no provider CLI, provider model, account login or Docker installation is bundled.

Updating must not destroy unsaved work or adopt another workspace's service. A stable AppId keeps installation identity; downgrade and unknown nonempty destinations are rejected. Maintenance requires saving/exporting, stopping capture and closing with X, then permits only authenticated owned idle-runtime shutdown. No forced app close or process-name kill is allowed. Program directories are managed software, while external settings, diagnostics, runtime ownership data and saved notes/exports survive uninstall for reinstall. Removing retained data is a separate, deliberate choice, not a blanket purge hidden inside uninstall.

The new installation chapter now separates the actual user procedure from this evidence log. The image-first README links to a **planned**, not yet verified or published, versioned release. Book registration, lifecycle/distribution/configuration chapters, source-versus-legacy setup, dependency notices and TODO tracking follow that contract. Existing synthetic desktop images remain current because packaging does not change the main UI; no installer screenshots were invented.

Implementation is still in progress. Runtime/launcher integration, exact artifact inventory and checksums, install/update/uninstall tests, source citation refresh, generated reference editions and publication remain separate gates. Authored instructions and inspected source are not passing receipts. This documentation work did not build, launch audio/models/services, authenticate, alter source/tests/scripts/annotations, regenerate outputs or publish anything.

# 22:30 - Separate startup metadata from release inventory and repair from damaged code

Packaging review identified two different consumers of release information. The launcher needs small bounded version metadata, not a complete runtime file list. The build now writes compact `install-manifest.json` separately from `payload-files.json`, whose full path/size/SHA-256 inventory includes the compact manifest but deliberately excludes its own self-hash. Hidden entries, reparse points and private payload paths are checked, and the fixture compares exact file coverage as well as installed hashes.

Repair also must not depend on the very launcher it needs to replace. Update/repair is being integrated with a fresh maintenance helper extracted from Setup. A second numeric Windows-version record in the uninstall registry supports a damaged version-file repair; ambiguous version data must still refuse a downgrade rather than guess. Native helper integration and a passing repair run remain pending.

The lifecycle fixture is deliberately isolated with a random AppId and separate path, without Start-menu shortcuts or automatic app launch. Its upgrade case changes a numeric version record in the current fixture; it does not run a genuine old binary or a clean Windows VM. Those limits remain explicit in the public evidence. A test definition is not a successful run, and workstream58 remains in progress.

# 22:36 - Disclose the bundled runtime changes before claiming package performance

The launcher owner reports23targeted tests and nine published-launcher self-test booleans passing. The runtime owner reports57manager/path/hybrid mock tests passing. These establish bounded component behavior, not installed-copy startup, real recognition or successful fresh-helper repair.

The installer runtime is newly assembled from pinned embedded CPython3.13.14 and public dependencies, not copied from a developer environment. Its application-private faster-whisper variant removes encoded-file decoding/PyAV while retaining the service's in-memory PCM array path. CTranslate2 uses a same-version4.6.0CPU-only Ruy rebuild, without CUDA/cuDNN/Intel binaries; both changes carry `+phantomfudge1` variant identifiers and retained third-party notices. This addresses redistribution and footprint concerns, but changes the binary set: historical development speech timings and accuracy are not installer measurements.

Shared paths separate shipped weights from mutable installed-user data. Process-identity checks allow cleanup of confirmed-dead or recycled-PID receipts, never a kill based on a stale PID. Live/unknown ownership remains a refusal. Native maintenance uses authenticated loopback requests; the Python manager's verbs remain start/stop/status. User data remain preserved.

The payload build, native ABI/import qualification, fresh-helper integration and final installer lifecycle remain pending. No service, audio or inference run is implied by these reported mock tests or the documentation update, and no clean-VM or published-release claim is added.

# 22:43 - Keep build-tool authenticity separate from installer signing

The packager reports that the official Inno Setup6.7.3 download matches the pinned checksum and has a valid Pyrsys B.V. Authenticode signature. That result identifies the compiler download, not the Phantom Fudge installer it will produce. No application signing identity has been provided; Setup remains unsigned and private repository/release access remains restricted.

The runtime source/lock still proposes the disclosed PCM-only package changes, pending final output and licensing review. Fresh-helper same-version repair with registry-version fallback is also still untested. The isolated fixture excludes ordinary shortcuts/post-install launch and simulates an older version record rather than installing an older binary. Those limits stay in the evidence record; they do not turn into extra steps for ordinary users.

# 22:45 - Freeze the native maintenance helper without promoting it to installer acceptance

The launcher owner reports46targeted helper/transport tests passing, a successful self-contained publish and an exact-EXE self-test pass. Headless layout validation returns0for a synthetic valid layout and65for oversized or corrupted compact metadata. These checks start no app, speech service, audio or model; placeholder layout validation does not prove executable or model readiness.

The native `--maintenance [root]` path now works independently of old Python binaries and compact metadata, while requiring the owned installation marker and the fixed current-user runtime workspace. It uses the shared byte lock and authenticated instance/PID/idle checks, with creation FILETIME evidence for stale-receipt cleanup. Nothing is force-killed. Setup extracts the complete self-contained helper directory, not just its EXE.

The new launcher citations were reviewed against this freeze. Full Setup same-version repair, bundled-runtime ABI/import and licensing, isolated installer lifecycle, reference editions and publication remain pending. Existing-source citation values remain reserved for the parent's one-shot migration; a helper-test pass is not a successful install/update/uninstall handoff.

At 22:52, the launcher owner confirmed the final contract-aligned rerun: 46 tests, self-contained publish and all nine exact-EXE self-test booleans passed again. The fixed isolated Python prefix, 32-byte/lowercase-hex fresh tokens and a 180-second deadline now match the runtime contract; existing valid Base64URL tokens are explicitly preserved. The reference constants/citations were rechecked. This is still component evidence, not an additional installer lifecycle or speech-quality result.

# 22:54 - Validate an intermediate runtime, then preserve user model provisioning

The runtime owner reports an intermediate v3 payload with 2,799 files and 749,352,236 bytes. Embedded Python imports, dependency closure, CPU-int8 support and pinned model hashes pass without starting a service or inference. This is **not the payload to package**: a final source-path amendment and offline rebuild are still pending.

The amended contract prefers an existing pinned-name model in the user's InstalledRuntime `.local\models` directory, verifies it with the same manifest, and otherwise uses bundled weights. Explicit provisioning writes only user models. This separates replaceable software from deliberate model data that must survive update/uninstall.

The official PyPI file CDN failed TLS; the runtime owner reports obtaining exactly hash-locked public wheels from the Tsinghua mirror, with provenance disclosed in the runtime manifest. Supplemental Vosk native-dependency notices were added. These import/hash results neither validate speech quality/performance nor finish redistribution review, installer lifecycle or clean-VM testing.

# 23:00 - Freeze an offline runtime without claiming inference qualification

The final runtime handoff replaces the intermediate candidates with `.local\installer-runtime-stage`: 2,801 files and 749,919,714 bytes including its manifest. The runtime owner reports 70 regression tests, a fully offline rebuild, embedded imports, dependency closure, CPU-int8 support, pinned model hashes and independent inventory verification passing. Moving the payload to a path with spaces and U+00E9 also passed the complete import/dependency/hash probe. The preserved-user-model amendment is now included.

Documentation independently checked the manifest identity and recorded totals/results, not the build or test suite. Its SHA-256 is `1f8d8396f4b2538138632f1b72251bda0ec46073a937a9d0ff99f4a60c8012f7`. Runtime and launcher references were refreshed against frozen source; preexisting-source citation migration and generated editions remain separate parent-owned work.

This is a useful packaging boundary, not recognition qualification. The handoff started no real service or audio endpoint, loaded no speech model and ran no inference. It did not build .NET, install/uninstall Setup or test a clean Windows VM. The CPU-Ruy variant cannot inherit older development-backend timing or accuracy results. Dependency notices and patch provenance are engineering evidence, not legal certification or a project-license decision. Installer lifecycle, exact release-asset identity and private publication remain open.

# 23:15 - Preserve recovery evidence before inspecting the new process

The manager now writes a newly launched child PID before querying its creation time. Otherwise an inspection failure could leave an incomplete receipt even though the child PID was already known. Recovery remains evidence-based: a PID-only receipt needs proven process absence; a saved creation identity can also

prove PID reuse. Confirmed stale ownership advances normal startup automatically, so a reboot is not itself a reason to reinstall or manually discard runtime data.

The runtime owner reports 72 tests and a rebuilt, hash-verified payload with successful spaces/Unicode relocation. The new `.local\installer-runtime-stage-recovery` supersedes the prior stage: 2,801 files, 749,919,744 bytes and manifest SHA-256 `da6ea2fb1d16eac97bddc1b4e9bba4c16841a3560bebc4162c7ee47896e70d3d`. The added startup/recovery tests use mocked process and port observations; no real reboot, service, speech model load or inference was performed.

Separately, launcher partial token/receipt handling is being tightened and its final verification freeze is temporarily held. The native fresh-root HTTP maintenance path remains implemented; it is not being replaced with a dependency on old Python. Installer acceptance and publication are still separate unfinished work.

# 23:25 - Distinguish an intentionally retained token from missing ownership

The final native recovery checkpoint reports 50 targeted tests, self-contained publish and all nine exact-EXE self-test checks passing. A normal service stop keeps the user's token, so token-only state cannot simply be called corruption. Maintenance now validates that token locally and probes only TCP presence, without credentials: confirmed connection refusal permits maintenance; an occupied or uncertain port does not. Receipt-only state refuses. With neither file, an untouched installation does not probe another workspace's listener.

PID-only stale receipts can be cleared when Windows proves the process absent. Inspectable live legacy state still needs authenticated service identity; uninspectable state remains protected. This preserves recovery without changing native fresh-root HTTP maintenance into a dependency on old application or Python files.

Documentation read the refreshed handoff/self-test receipts and matched all 14 source hashes against the updated atlas: 1,728 lines and 54 authored blocks. That is not a rerun of the tests or full atlas/book compilation. Frozen launcher/runtime references were refreshed, while the release-version rebuild, complete installer lifecycle, old-source citation migration, generated editions and private publication remain separate parent-owned gates. No real app, service, audio, model load or inference was started for these checks.

# 23:40 - Stop publication when computation succeeds but the process does not exit

The runtime owner reports an authorized synthetic-PCM probe that completed real Vosk recognition, the production Whisper final/VAD path and forced CTranslate2 encoder/decoder computation locally. The Ruy-backed child then hung during process exit, exceeding 120- and 240-second deadlines after printing success. No capture device, service or external audio/model API was used.

This exposes a gap in the earlier import-only qualification: loading bindings and verifying model bytes did not exercise inference cleanup. Workstream58 is now **BLOCKED**. Neither `.local\installer-runtime-stage` nor `.local\installer-runtime-stage-recovery` may be packaged or shipped. Their earlier manifests and passing

checks remain historical evidence, not current assembly approval. The runtime owner is investigating cleanup/backend behavior; the next handoff must bind a rebuilt payload to repeatable computation **and clean process exit**.

Separately, the launcher owner held its freeze at23:39 to add an installer-maintenance mutex gate before ordinary/notes-only reveal or startup. Maintenance and validation bypass that gate; native HTTP maintenance is unchanged. Program citations await the new test/publish/annotation freeze. Documentation records these reports without rerunning probes, inventing a fix, or publishing assets.

# 23:54 - Prevent ordinary startup from overlapping installer maintenance

The launcher owner reports51targeted tests and self-contained publish passing, with production source frozen. Ordinary and notes-only launch check the named installer gate before coordination or reveal; a second check after acquiring the startup mutex covers a gate appearing during acquisition. A detected gate records generic “operation busy” status and exits70, without WPF UI or a child. Maintenance and layout validation bypass this gate so installer checks remain usable. (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/Program.cs:25-78,209-212) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/LauncherContract.cs:152-165) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/LauncherStatus.cs:15,33)

The new test uses a random mutex rather than the real installer gate; it checks presence, disposal and affected modes, not Setup concurrency. Documentation reviewed the implementation and refreshed the launcher behavior, installation diagram and new-file citations. The exact published-EXE self-test, annotations and final handoff are still pending. This source checkpoint does not resolve the runtime process-exit blocker or authorize shipping either held payload. (tests/PhantomFudge.Core.Tests/InstalledLauncherTests.cs:176-195)

# October10 00:05 - Verify the final launcher receipts without lifting the runtime hold

The refreshed launcher handoff records51targeted tests and self-contained publish passing. Its exact published-EXE self-test receipt records exit0 and all nine checks true at `2026-10-09T18:07:25.8502546Z` (October9 23:37:25IST), earlier than this receipt-review time. Documentation independently matched published EXE/DLL hashes and all14source annotation hashes. Per-file coverage is1,768physical lines and56contiguous blocks, maximum block/focus62/12, with no duplicate ownership. No test/build was rerun and no full atlas or handbook compilation is claimed.

This closes the launcher-receipt item, not integrated installer acceptance. Setup/Uninstall must hold the exact installer gate through all replacement/deletion until exit; the random-mutex component test cannot establish that lifecycle. The runtime process-exit blocker remains, and neither existing runtime stage is approved for packaging or publication. (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/LauncherContract.cs:152-165) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/Program.cs:47-78) (tests/PhantomFudge.Core.Tests/InstalledLauncherTests.cs:176-195)

# October10 00:09 - Separate packaged UI success from two speech-runtime blockers

The packaged self-contained desktop UI-smoke receipts pass the existing regression groups and all38keyboard checks, without audio capture or model requests. Setup/Uninstall now creates the native launcher's maintenance gate; the parent confirms full-process lifetime, while the isolated installer lifecycle run still awaits its completed receipt. (tools/Installer/PhantomFudge.iss:72-76,150-160) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/Program.cs:47-78)

Publication remains blocked. The parent's real PCM child timed out120seconds after success JSON, and a second review found a Vosk Unicode/narrow-native-path problem under ACP1252. The runtime owner is addressing both; the replacement must pass actual hybrid model loading/inference from a Unicode path and natural process exit. UI, import and launcher checks cannot replace that evidence. The installation guide keeps a concise evidence table separate from user procedures. (services/transcription/accurate.py:121-129)

Final verification also found new native startup-handoff edits in four files after the inspected launcher checkpoint. Their atlas hashes are stale, so the51-test/nine-self-check evidence remains historical; fresh verification and affected citations await the next owner freeze. The launcher owner was notified, and authored files are released for coordinated completion rather than describing the changed bytes as already qualified. (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/ChildProcesses.cs:12-42) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/Program.cs:179-228)

# October10 00:37 - Replace the rejected speech backend and close the native handoff gap

The final runtime handoff reports78focused tests and actual `HybridFactory` model loading, generated-PCM processing, production Whisper finalization/VAD and a forced native encoder/decoder pass, followed by natural process exit. The same final payload passed after relocation to a spaced Unicode `é` path. This resolves the earlier exit/path blockers for the replacement, not for the rejected Ruy stages. The approved component delivery has2,808files/765,369,480bytes; its speech manifest SHA-256 is `a2b9cfefb0e3b7e3961fdc473b4f23ace4ed2ad78d35e9b0aa65ddd97c262de4`. It is not an installer hash. Documentation read the handoff and source, without rerunning tests. (services/transcription/tests/test_packaged_pcm_runtime.py:35-97,126-138)

The replacement is `CTranslate2 4.6.0+phantomfudge2`, oneDNN3.1.1 with Microsoft compiler OpenMP and app-local `vcomp140`. The PCM-only `faster-whisper 1.2.1+phantomfudge1` variant remains; its patch and unchanged ndarray-path sources are hash-bound. Modified metadata closure is not execution proof. Vosk's package is unmodified: a locked startup adapter temporarily uses the model directory as the working directory, allowing Windows wide-path handling, then restores it. The release build now requires `--verify-synthetic-pcm`; printed success before a hang cannot pass. (tools/Installer/bundle_runtime.py:246-282,332-390,412-462,581-609) (services/transcription/recognizer.py:44-63) (scripts/Build-Installer.ps1:30-34)

The native final handoff reports55helper tests and10exact-EXE self-checks, superseding the older 51/nine checkpoint and its later source/annotation drift. Readiness now requires the main app mutex or proven child exit, not a short survival timer. After30seconds, status76is pending rather than success. Closing pending progress hides it while preserving the operation guard, including early dispatcher shutdown. The delayed

synthetic child/mutex lifecycle was tested; interactive WPF Close was not driven. (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/ChildProcesses.cs:12-42) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/Program.cs:108-118,186-227,321-354) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/LauncherStatus.cs:20,39)

The parent reports lifecycle2passed11checks/3,670inventoriedfiles, **using the old runtime fixture**. That is not final oneDNN candidate acceptance, genuine old-binary upgrade or clean-VM evidence. Setup no longer has any launch action: finish/close it, then open the app from Start. Setup and launcher status/error windows remain ordinary visible UI, not capture-excluded; launch before sharing. (scripts/Test-Installer.ps1:38-84,96-104) (tools/Installer/PhantomFudge.iss:14-76) (src/PhantomFudge.Launcher/LauncherWindow.cs:18-57)

Workstream58returns to IN_PROGRESS. Authored public guides and current status are reconciled while the earlier failure narrative stays intact. Final assembled payload review/lifecycle, baseline citation migration, source annotations, generated editions and private publication remain with the parent. No actual audio capture, service/provider request or clean VM was used for the reported component qualification; old recognition/latency measurements do not qualify this new backend.

# October10 00:55 - Current installer candidate passes the bounded lifecycle fixture

The parent reports candidate2's full `Build-Installer` run passed with the current oneDNN runtime and native launcher, including mandatory real generated-PCM inference and clean process exit. The lifecycle3 receipt was inspected: all 11 checks pass against 3,682 inventoried files. This is now current candidate evidence; the earlier old-runtime lifecycle2 result remains history. (scripts/Build-Installer.ps1:30-44,76-114) (scripts/Test-Installer.ps1:38-84,96-104)

The fixture covers installation/hash/layout/maintenance, same-version and damaged-launcher/version repair, a simulated older-version record, downgrade refusal, uninstall, retained external data and foreign-directory refusal. It uses the current host and a random AppId/path, omits shortcuts and does not exercise real older binaries or a clean VM. Its zero model requests/no captured audio must not be confused with the build's separate real synthetic-PCM inference gate. (scripts/Test-Installer.ps1:15-18,31-84,96-104)

The latest scoped Unicode/startup/backend review reports no significant issues, not an independent PCM execution. A clean committed release build with final provenance/checksums, refreshed editions and private publication remains pending. Missing runtime annotations belong to the runtime-atlas owner; domain/packaging/book annotations and the baseline citation migration remain with the parent. Authored guides were reconciled without rerunning builds or touching source, annotations or generated artifacts. No actual audio capture, provider request, clean-machine or new-performance qualification is inferred from these results.

# October10 01:03 - Native dependency gate strengthened before the final build

The runtime builder now enforces declared PE import/delay-import/export-forwarder closure before its import probe, records hashes and checks actual loaded CRT paths. The parent reports PASS for 92 speech PE files and five bundled CRT paths, plus a separate static closure PASS over 861 app/launcher PE files. Functional

DLLs are reported unchanged from candidate2; the new audit/license evidence still changes the manifest. The clean committed final build must execute the stronger gate. Lifecycle3 remains the 11-check/3,682-file current-host fixture, not a clean VM. (tools/Installer/bundle_runtime.py:677-694) (tools/Installer/runtime_audit.py:126-166,169-234)

The official hash-locked Microsoft redistributables and license DOCX have explicit provenance; publisher licensing compliance and app-local CRT servicing remain separate responsibilities. New-source citations were refreshed from the frozen builder, auditor, lock and PCM test without rerunning runtime tests or changing source/annotations/generated artifacts. Private publication and final editions remain pending. (tools/Installer/bundle_runtime.py:412-489)

# October10 01:11 - Final DLL-qualified runtime passes; release asset build remains

The parent's combined five-module Python run passes85tests, including seven new PE-auditor cases; native55passes again. The runtime owner reports a successful full offline rebuild with the stronger dependency/import/inference gates, followed by exact-payload Unicode relocation, real generated PCM and natural process exit. The parent confirms92speech PE records match payload hashes and all five observed CRT/OpenMP paths are bundled; the separate861app/launcher static audit passes. (tools/Installer/bundle_runtime.py:677-694) (tools/Installer/runtime_audit.py:126-166,169-234)

Use `.local\installer-runtime-dll-qualified`: **2,810files / 765,576,675bytes**, including manifest; owner-reported manifest SHA-256 `c62093e8f8375471aacddff7656bfb69936aa8b6fc258865c92f5dd593355e16`. It supersedes the earlier delivery; package/native/model/service bytes are reported unchanged, with only notices/copied-lock/manifest differences. Candidate2 lifecycle3 remains11checks/3,682files, not a new final installer identity. Current prose now reflects85tests and completed runtime gates; historical78-test entries remain dated. The clean committed release asset build and private publication remain pending. No clean Windows11 VM, actual capture or provider request is claimed.

# 2026-10-10, 01:31 - Release source and reference editions converge

The complete candidate3 installer build passed the now-enforced native dependency, loaded-DLL, generated-PCM and natural-exit gates. Its functional speech files match the corrected candidate2 used by the passing 11-case installer lifecycle; the later differences are notices and provenance. The packaged launcher again passed ten self-checks, and the packaged desktop passed its synthetic UI groups and all 38 keyboard checks without recording or provider requests.

The source atlas now covers **203 first-party files, 30,897 physical lines and 1,232 authored blocks**. The book contains **36 chapters and 73 diagrams**, including the installation procedure. Its new diagrams were simplified after rendered review exposed overly small labels. Root-level guide links now retain their real directory instead of inventing a handbook path; all 19 existing documentation-tool cases pass, including the new regression case.

Existing citations were migrated once from the installer baseline: 120 ranges across 18 documents, with seven changed endpoints explicitly reviewed. This completes source/reference preparation; the clean committed asset build, immutable release tag and private publication are separate next steps.